



Top 858 CAT Reading Comprehension Questions With Video Solutions

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Questions

Instructions

Fifty feet away three male lions lay by the road. They didn't appear to have a hair on their heads. Noting the color of their noses (leonine noses darken as they age, from pink to black), Craig estimated that they were six years old – young adults. "This is wonderful!" he said, after staring at them for several moments. "This is what we came to see. They really are maneless." Craig, a professor at the University of Minnesota, is arguably the leading expert on the majestic Serengeti lion, whose head is mantled in long, thick hair. He and Peyton West, a doctoral student who has been working with him in Tanzania, had never seen the Tsavo lions that live some 200 miles east of the Serengeti. The scientists had partly suspected that the maneless males were adolescents mistaken for adults by amateur observers. Now they knew better.

The Tsavo research expedition was mostly Peyton's show. She had spent several years in Tanzania, compiling the data she needed to answer a question that ought to have been answered long ago: Why do lions have manes? It's the only cat, wild or domestic, that displays such ornamentation. In Tsavo she was attacking the riddle from the opposite angle. Why do its lions not have manes? (Some "maneless" lions in Tsavo East do have partial manes, but they rarely attain the regal glory of the Serengeti lions.) Does environmental adaptation account for the trait? Are the lions of Tsavo, as some people believe, a distinct subspecies of their Serengeti cousins?

The Serengeti lions have been under continuous observation for more than 35 years, beginning with George Schaller's pioneering work in the 1960s. But the lions in Tsavo, Kenya's oldest and largest protected ecosystem, have hardly been studied. Consequently, legends have grown up around them. Not only do they look different, according to the myths, they behave differently, displaying greater cunning and aggressiveness. "Remember too," Kenya: The Rough Guide warns, "Tsavo's lions have a reputation of ferocity." Their fearsome image became well-known in 1898, when two males stalled construction of what is now Kenya Railways by allegedly killing and eating 135 Indian and African laborers. A British Army officer in charge of building a railroad bridge over the Tsavo River, Lt. Col. J. H. Patterson, spent nine months pursuing the pair before he brought them to bay and killed them. Stuffed and mounted, they now glare at visitors to the Field Museum in Chicago. Patterson's account of the leonine reign of terror, *The Man-Eaters of Tsavo*, was an international best seller when published in 1907. Still in print, the book has made Tsavo's lions notorious. That annoys some scientists. "People don't want to give up on mythology," Dennis King told me one day. The zoologist has been working in Tsavo off and on for four years. "I am so sick of this maneater business. Patterson made a helluva lot of money off that story, but Tsavo's lions are no more likely to turn man-eater than lions from elsewhere."

But tales of their savagery and wiliness don't all come from sensationalist authors looking to make a buck. Tsavo lions are generally larger than lions elsewhere, enabling them to take down the predominant prey animal in Tsavo, the Cape buffalo, one of the strongest, most aggressive animals of Earth. The buffalo don't give up easily: They often kill or severely injure an attacking lion, and a wounded lion might be more likely to turn to cattle and humans for food.

And other prey is less abundant in Tsavo than in other traditional lion haunts. A hungry lion is more likely to attack humans. Safari guides and Kenya Wildlife Service rangers tell of lions attacking Land Rovers, raiding camps, stalking tourists. Tsavo is a tough neighborhood, they say, and it breeds tougher lions.

But are they really tougher? And if so, is there any connection between their manelessness and their ferocity? An intriguing hypothesis was advanced two years ago by Gnoske and Peterhans: Tsavo lions may be similar to the unmaned cave lions of the Pleistocene. The Serengeti variety is among the most evolved of the species – the latest model, so to speak – while certain morphological differences in Tsavo lions (bigger bodies, smaller skulls, and maybe even lack of a mane) suggest that they are closer to the primitive ancestor of all lions. Craig and Peyton had serious doubts about this idea, but admitted that Tsavo lions pose a mystery to science.

Question 1

The book *Man-Eaters of Tsavo* annoys some scientists because

- A** it revealed that Tsavo lions are ferocious.

- B Patterson made a helluva lot of money from the book by sensationalism.
- C it perpetuated the bad name Tsavo lions had.
- D it narrated how two male Tsavo lions were killed.

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Question 2

Which of the following, if true, would weaken the hypothesis advanced by Gnoske and Peterhans most?

- A Craig and Peyton develop even more serious doubts about the idea that Tsavo lions are primitive.
- B The maneless Tsavo East lions are shown to be closer to the cave lions.
- C Pleistocene cave lions are shown to be far less violent than believed.
- D The morphological variations in body and skull size between the cave and Tsavo lions are found to be insignificant.

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Question 3

The sentence which concludes the first paragraph, "Now they knew better", implies that:

- A The two scientists were struck by wonder on seeing maneless lions for the first time.
- B Though Craig was an expert on the Serengeti lion, now he also knew about the Tsavo lions.
- C Earlier, Craig and West thought that amateur observers had been mistaken.

D Craig was now able to confirm that darkening of the noses as lions aged applied to Tsavo lions as well.

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Question 4

According to the passage, which of the following has NOT contributed to the popular image of Tsavo lions as savage creatures?

- A Tsavo lions have been observed to bring down one of the strongest and most aggressive animals . the Cape buffalo.
- B In contrast to the situation in traditional lion haunts, scarcity of non-buffalo prey in the Tsavo makes the Tsavo lions more aggressive.
- C The Tsavo lion is considered to be less evolved than the Serengeti variety.
- D Tsavo lions have been observed to attack vehicles as well as humans.

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Nature has all along yielded her flesh to humans. First, we took nature's materials as food, fibers, and shelter. Then we learned to extract raw materials from her biosphere to create our own new synthetic materials. Now Bios is yielding us her mind—we are taking her logic.

Clockwork logic—the logic of the machines—will only build simple contraptions. Truly complex systems such as a cell, a meadow, an economy, or a brain (natural or artificial) require a rigorous nontechnological logic. We now see that no logic except bio-logic can assemble a thinking device, or even a workable system of any magnitude.

It is an astounding discovery that one can extract the logic of Bios out of biology and have something useful. Although many philosophers in the past have suspected one could abstract the laws of life and apply them elsewhere, it wasn't until the complexity of computers and human-made systems became as complicated as living things, that it was possible to prove this. It's eerie how much of life can be transferred. So far, some of the traits of the living that have successfully been transported to mechanical systems are: self-replication, self-governance, limited self-repair, mild evolution, and partial learning.

We have reason to believe yet more can be synthesized and made into something new. Yet at the same time that the logic of Bios is being imported into machines, the logic of Technos is being imported into life. The root of bioengineering is the desire to control the organic long enough to improve it. Domesticated plants and animals are examples of technos-logic applied to life. The wild aromatic root of the Queen Anne's lace weed has been fine-tuned over generations by selective herb gatherers until it has evolved into a sweet carrot of the garden; the udders of wild bovines have been selectively enlarged in an "unnatural" way to satisfy humans rather than calves. Milk cows and carrots, therefore, are human inventions as much as steam engines and gunpowder are. But milk cows and carrots are more indicative of the kind of inventions humans will make in the future: products that are grown rather than manufactured.

Genetic engineering is precisely what cattle breeders do when they select better strains of Holsteins, only bioengineers employ more precise and powerful control. While carrot and milk cow breeders had to rely on diffuse organic evolution, modern genetic engineers can use directed artificial evolution—purposeful design—which greatly accelerates improvements.

The overlap of the mechanical and the lifelike increases year by year. Part of this bionic convergence is a matter of words. The meanings of "mechanical" and "life" are both stretching until all complicated things can be perceived as machines, and all self-sustaining machines can be perceived as alive. Yet beyond semantics, two concrete trends are happening: (1) Human-made things are behaving more lifelike, and (2) Life is becoming more engineered. The apparent veil between the organic and the manufactured has crumpled to reveal that the two really are, and have always been, of one being.

Question 5

None of the following statements is implied by the arguments of the passage, EXCEPT:

- A historically, philosophers have known that the laws of life can be abstracted and applied elsewhere.
- B genetic engineers and bioengineers are the same insofar as they both seek to force evolution in an artificial way.
- C the biological realm is as complex as the mechanical one; which is why the logic of Bios is being imported into machines.
- D purposeful design represents the pinnacle of scientific expertise in the service of human betterment and civilisational progress.

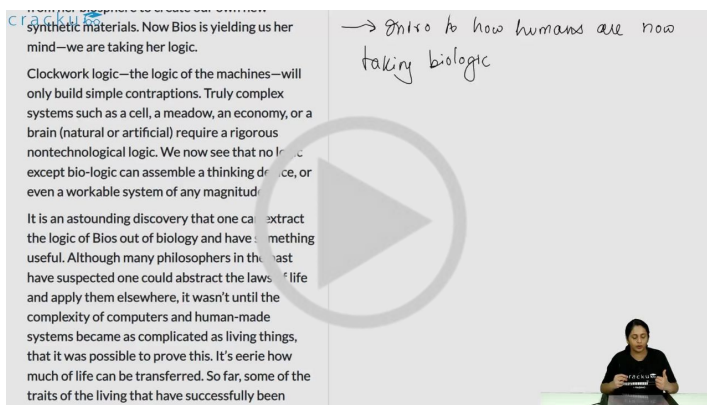
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Question 6

Which one of the following sets of words/phrases best serves as keywords to the passage?

- A Complex systems; Carrots; Milk cows; Convergence; Technos-logic
- B Nature; Computers; Carrots; Milk cows; Genetic engineering
- C Nature; Bios; Technos; Self-repair; Holsteins
- D Complex systems; Bio-logic; Bioengineering; Technos-logic; Convergence

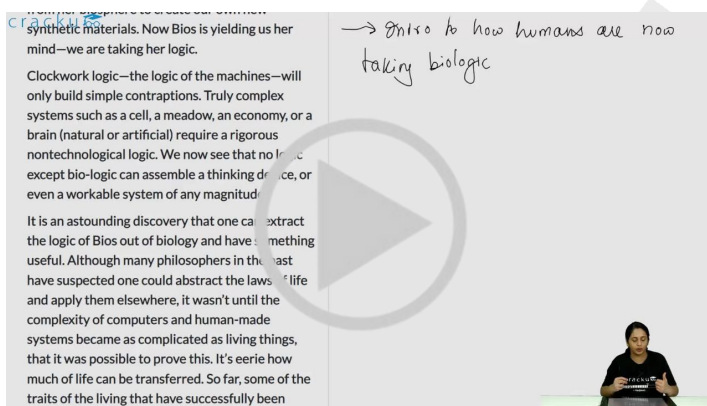
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Question 7

The author claims that, "Part of this bionic convergence is a matter of words". Which one of the following statements best expresses the point being made by the author?

- A "Bios" and "Technos" are both convergent forms of logic, but they generate meanings about the world that are mutually exclusive.
- B "Mechanical" and "life" are words from different logical systems and are, therefore, fundamentally incompatible in meaning.

- C** A bionic convergence indicates the meeting ground of genetic engineering and artificial intelligence.
- D** “Mechanical” and “life” were earlier seen as opposite in meaning, but the difference between the two is increasingly blurred.

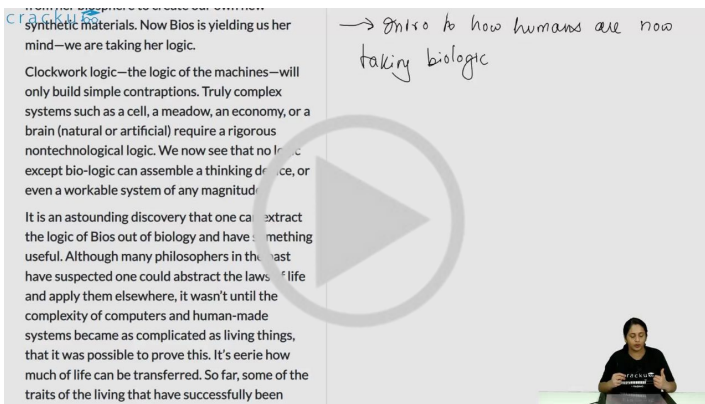
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Question 8

The author claims that, “The apparent veil between the organic and the manufactured has crumpled to reveal that the two really are, and have always been, of one being.” Which one of the following statements best expresses the point being made by the author here?

- A** Organic reality has crumpled under the veil of manufacturing, rendering the apparent and the real as the same being.
- B** The crumpling of the organic veil between apparent and manufactured reality reveals them to have the same being.
- C** Scientific advances are making it increasingly difficult to distinguish between organic reality and manufactured reality.
- D** Apparent reality and organic reality are distinguished by the fact that the former is manufactured.

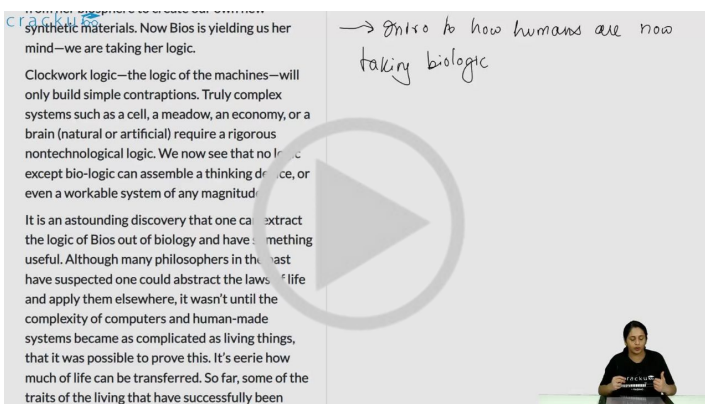
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Instructions

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

When researchers at Emory University in Atlanta trained mice to fear the smell of almonds (by pairing it with electric shocks), they found, to their consternation, that both the children and grandchildren of these mice were spontaneously afraid of the same smell. That is not supposed to happen. Generations of schoolchildren have been taught that the inheritance of acquired characteristics is impossible. A mouse should not be born with something its parents have learned during their lifetimes, any more than a mouse that loses its tail in an accident should give birth to tailless mice. . . .

Modern evolutionary biology dates back to a synthesis that emerged around the 1940s-60s, which married Charles Darwin's mechanism of natural selection with Gregor Mendel's discoveries of how genes are inherited. The traditional, and still dominant, view is that adaptations - from the human brain to the peacock's tail - are fully and satisfactorily explained by natural selection (and subsequent inheritance). Yet [new evidence] from genomics, epigenetics and developmental biology [indicates] that evolution is more complex than we once assumed. . . .

In his book *On Human Nature* (1978), the evolutionary biologist Edward O Wilson claimed that human culture is held on a genetic leash. The metaphor [needs revision]. . . . Imagine a dog-walker (the genes) struggling to retain control of a brawny mastiff (human culture). The pair's trajectory (the pathway of evolution) reflects the outcome of the struggle. Now imagine the same dog-walker struggling with multiple dogs, on leashes of varied lengths, with each dog tugging in different directions. All these tugs represent the influence of developmental factors, including epigenetics, antibodies and hormones passed on by parents, as well as the ecological legacies and culture they bequeath. . . .

The received wisdom is that parental experiences can't affect the characters of their offspring. Except they do. The way that genes are expressed to produce an organism's phenotype - the actual characteristics it ends up with - is affected by chemicals that attach to them. Everything from diet to air pollution to parental behaviour can influence the addition or removal of these chemical marks, which switches genes on or off. Usually these so-called 'epigenetic' attachments are removed during the production of sperm and eggs cells, but it turns out that some escape the resetting process and are passed on to the next generation, along with the genes. This is known as 'epigenetic inheritance', and more and more studies are confirming that it really happens. Let's return to the almond-fearing mice. The inheritance of an epigenetic mark transmitted in the sperm is what led the mice's offspring to acquire an inherited fear. . . .

Epigenetics is only part of the story. Through culture and society, [humans and other animals] inherit knowledge and skills acquired by [their] parents. . . . All this complexity . . . points to an evolutionary process in which genomes (over hundreds to thousands of generations), epigenetic modifications and inherited cultural factors (over several, perhaps tens or hundreds of generations), and parental effects (over single-generation timespans) collectively inform how organisms adapt. These extra-genetic kinds of inheritance give organisms the flexibility to make rapid adjustments to environmental challenges, dragging genetic change in their wake - much like a rowdy pack of dogs.

Question 9

The Emory University experiment with mice points to the inheritance of:

- A** acquired parental fears
- B** acquired characteristics
- C** psychological markers
- D** personality traits

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Question (1)

The passage uses the metaphor of a dog walker to argue that evolutionary adaptation is most comprehensively understood as being determined by:

A) ecological, hormonal, extra genetic and genetic legacies.
 B) genetic, epigenetic, developmental factors, and ecological legacies.
 C) extra genetic, genetic, epigenetic and genomic legacies.
 D) socio-cultural, genetic, epigenetic, and genomic legacies.

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Question 10

Which of the following, if found to be true, would negate the main message of the passage?

- A A study affirming the sole influence of natural selection and inheritance on evolution.
- B A study highlighting the criticality of epigenetic inheritance to evolution.
- C A study indicating the primacy of ecological impact on human adaptation.
- D A study affirming the influence of socio-cultural markers on evolutionary processes.

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Question 12

Which of the following options best describes the author's argument?

- A Wilson's theory of evolution is scientifically superior to either Darwin's or Mendel's.
- B Darwin's theory of natural selection cannot fully explain evolution.
- C Darwin's and Mendel's theories together best explain evolution.
- D Mendel's theory of inheritance is unfairly underestimated in explaining evolution.

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CAT Syllabus PDF



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

In 1982, a raging controversy broke out over a forest act drafted by the Government of India. This act sought to strengthen the already extensive powers enjoyed by the forest bureaucracy in controlling the extraction, disposal and sale of forest produce. It also gave forest officials greater powers to strictly regulate the entry of any person into reserved forest areas. While forest officials justified the act on the grounds that it was

necessary to stop the continuing deforestation, it was bitterly opposed by representatives of grassroots organisations, who argued that it was a major violation of the rights of peasants and tribals living in and around forest areas. . . .

The debate over the draft forest act fuelled a larger controversy over the orientation of state forest policy. It was pointed out, for example, that the draft act was closely modelled on its predecessor, the Forest Act of 1878. The earlier Act rested on a usurpation of rights of ownership by the colonial state which had little precedent in precolonial history. It was further argued that the system of forestry introduced by the British—and continued, with little modification, after 1947—emphasised revenue generation and commercial exploitation, while its policing orientation excluded villagers who had the most longstanding claim on forest resources. Critics called for a complete overhaul of forest administration, pressing the government to formulate policy and legislation more appropriate to present needs. . . .

That debate is not over yet. The draft act was shelved, though it has not as yet been formally withdrawn. Meanwhile, the 1878 Act (as modified by an amendment in 1927) continues to be in operation. In response to its critics, the government has made some important changes in forest policy, e.g., no longer treating forests as a source of revenue, and stopping ecologically hazardous practices such as the clearfelling of natural forests. At the same time, it has shown little inclination to meet the major demand of the critics of forest policy—namely, abandoning the principle of state monopoly over forest land by handing over areas of degraded forests to individuals and communities for afforestation.

. . . [The] 1878 Forest Act itself was passed only after a bitter and prolonged debate within the colonial bureaucracy, in which protagonists put forward arguments strikingly similar to those being advanced today. As is well known, the Indian Forest Department owes its origin to the requirements of railway companies. The early years of the expansion of the railway network, c. 1853 onwards, led to tremendous deforestation in peninsular India owing to the railway's requirements of fuelwood and construction timber. Huge quantities of durable timbers were also needed for use as sleepers across the newly laid tracks. Inexperienced in forestry, the British called in German experts to commence systematic forest management. The Indian Forest Department was started in 1864, with Dietrich Brandis, formerly a Lecturer at Bonn, as the first Inspector General of Forests. The new department needed legislative backing to function effectively, and in the following year, 1865, the first forest act was passed. . . .

Question 13

Which one of the following best encapsulates the reason for the “raging controversy” developing into a “larger controversy”?

- A The 1982 draft forest act replicated colonial measures of control and regulation of forest resources.
- B The 1982 draft forest act was unjustifiably defended by forest officials in the face of bitter opposition by grassroots organisations.
- C The 1982 draft forest act violated the rights of tribals and peasants who lived in and around forest areas.
- D The 1982 draft forest act further enabled the commercial exploitation of forest resources by the forest bureaucracy.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 14

All of the following, if true, would weaken the narrative presented in the passage EXCEPT that:

- A certain tribal groups in India are responsible for climate change because their sustenance has historically depended on mass scale deforestation.

- B** before British rule, peasants and tribal groups were denied access to forest resources by Indian rulers and their administrations.
- C** the timber requirement for railway works in nineteenth century India was met through import from China, in exchange for spices.
- D** nineteenth century German forestry experts were infamous for violating the rights of indigenous communities that lived in forest regions.

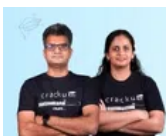
[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 15

According to the passage, which one of the following reforms is yet to happen in India's forest policies?

- A** Recognising the state's claim to forest land use.
- B** A ban on deforestation.
- C** Recognising the significance of forests to ecology.
- D** Involving local people in cultivating forests.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Formula PDF



Question 16

According to the passage, which one of the following is not common to the 1878 Forest Act and the 1982 draft forest act?

- A** Both sparked controversy and debate among the various stakeholders.
- B** Both reflect a colonial mindset.
- C** Both resulted in large scale deforestation.
- D** Both sought to establish the state's monopoly over forest resources.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

RESIDENTS of Lozère, a hilly department in southern France, recite complaints familiar to many rural corners of Europe. In remote hamlets and villages, with names such as Le Bacon and Le Bacon Vieux, mayors grumble about a lack of local schools, jobs, or phone and internet connections. Farmers of grazing animals add another concern: the return of wolves. Eradicated from France last century, the predators are gradually creeping back to more forests and hillsides. "The wolf must be taken in hand," said an aspiring parliamentarian, Francis Palombi, when pressed by voters in an election campaign early this summer. Tourists enjoy visiting a wolf park in Lozère, but farmers fret over their livestock and their livelihoods. .

As early as the ninth century, the royal office of the Luparii—wolf-catchers—was created in France to tackle the predators. Those official hunters (and others) completed their job in the 1930s, when the last wolf disappeared from the mainland. Active hunting and improved technology such as rifles in the 19th century, plus the use of poison such as strychnine later on, caused the population collapse. But in the early 1990s the animals reappeared. They crossed the Alps from Italy, upsetting sheep farmers on the French side of the border. Wolves have since spread to areas such as Lozère, delighting environmentalists, who see the predators' presence as a sign of wider ecological health. Farmers, who say the wolves cause the deaths of thousands of sheep and other grazing animals, are less cheerful. They grumble that green activists and politically correct urban types have allowed the return of an old enemy.

Various factors explain the changes of the past few decades. Rural depopulation is part of the story. In Lozère, for example, farming and a once-flourishing mining industry supported a population of over 140,000 residents in the mid-19th century. Today the department has fewer than 80,000 people, many in its towns. As humans withdraw, forests are expanding. In France, between 1990 and 2015, forest cover increased by an average of 102,000 hectares each year, as more fields were given over to trees. Now, nearly one-third of mainland France is covered by woodland of some sort. The decline of hunting as a sport also means more forests fall quiet. In the mid-to-late 20th century over 2m hunters regularly spent winter weekends tramping in woodland, seeking boars, birds and other prey. Today the Fédération Nationale des Chasseurs, the national body, claims 1.1m people hold hunting licences, though the number of active hunters is probably lower. The mostly protected status of the wolf in Europe—hunting them is now forbidden, other than when occasional culls are sanctioned by the state—plus the efforts of NGOs to track and count the animals, also contribute to the recovery of wolf populations.

As the lupine population of Europe spreads westwards, with occasional reports of wolves seen closer to urban areas, expect to hear of more clashes between farmers and those who celebrate the predators' return. Farmers' losses are real, but are not the only economic story. Tourist venues, such as parks where wolves are kept and the animals' spread is discussed, also generate income and jobs in rural areas.

Question 17

The author presents a possible economic solution to an existing issue facing Lozère that takes into account the divergent and competing interests of:

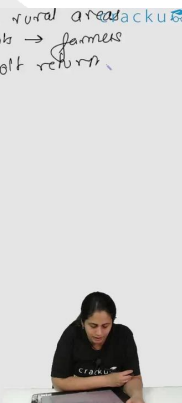
- A politicians and farmers.
- B environmentalists and politicians.
- C farmers and environmentalists.
- D tourists and environmentalists.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

RESIDENTS of Lozère, a hilly department in southern France, recite complaints familiar to many rural corners of Europe. In remote hamlets and villages, with names such as Le Bacon and Le Bacon Vieux, mayors grumble about a lack of local schools, jobs, or phone and internet connections. Farmers of grazing animals add another concern: the return of wolves. Eradicated from France last century, the predators are gradually creeping back to more forests and hillsides. "The wolf must be taken in hand," said an aspiring parliamentarian, Francis Palombi, when pressed by voters in an election campaign early this summer. Tourists enjoy visiting a wolf park in Lozère, but farmers fret over their livestock and their livelihoods.

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→ In Lozère, like rural areas, similar complaints → farmers complain abt wolf return.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 18

Which one of the following has NOT contributed to the growing wolf population in Lozère?

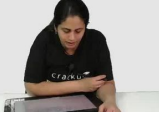
- A A decline in the rural population of Lozère.
- B An increase in woodlands and forest cover in Lozère.
- C The shutting down of the royal office of the Luparii.
- D The granting of a protected status to wolves in Europe.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

RESIDENTS of Lozère, a hilly department in southern France, recite complaints familiar to many rural corners of Europe. In remote hamlets and villages, with names such as Le Bacon and Le Bacon Vieux, mayors grumble about a lack of local schools, jobs, or phone and internet connections. Farmers of grazing animals add another concern: the return of wolves. Eradicated from France last century, the predators are gradually creeping back to more forests and hillsides. "The wolf must be taken in hand," said an aspiring parliamentarian, Francis Palombi, when pressed by voters in an election campaign early this summer. Tourists enjoy visiting a wolf park in Lozère, but farmers fret over their livestock and their livelihoods.

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→ In Lozere, like rural areas
Similar complaints → farmers
complain abt wolf return.



VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 19

Which one of the following statements, if true, would weaken the author's claims?

- A Having migrated out in the last century, wolves are now returning to Lozère.
- B Unemployment concerns the residents of Lozère.
- C Wolf attacks on tourists in Lozère are on the rise.
- D The old mining sites of Lozère are now being used as grazing pastures for sheep.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

RESIDENTS of Lozère, a hilly department in southern France, recite complaints familiar to many rural corners of Europe. In remote hamlets and villages, with names such as Le Bacon and Le Bacon Vieux, mayors grumble about a lack of local schools, jobs, or phone and internet connections. Farmers of grazing animals add another concern: the return of wolves. Eradicated from France last century, the predators are gradually creeping back to more forests and hillsides. "The wolf must be taken in hand," said an aspiring parliamentarian, Francis Palombi, when pressed by voters in an election campaign early this summer. Tourists enjoy visiting a wolf park in Lozère, but farmers fret over their livestock and their livelihoods.

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→ In Lozere, like rural areas
Similar complaints → farmers
complain abt wolf return.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 20

The inhabitants of Lozère have to grapple with all of the following problems, EXCEPT:

- A lack of educational facilities.
- B poor rural communication infrastructure.
- C livestock losses.
- D decline in the number of hunting licences.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

RESIDENTS of Lozère, a hilly department in southern France, recite complaints familiar to many rural corners of Europe. In remote hamlets and villages, with names such as Le Bacon and Le Bacon Vieux, mayors grumble about a lack of local schools, jobs, or phone and internet connections. Farmers of grazing animals add another concern: the return of wolves. Eradicated from France last century, the predators are gradually creeping back to more forests and hillsides. "The wolf must be taken in hand," said an aspiring parliamentarian, Francis Palombi, when pressed by voters in an election campaign early this summer. Tourists enjoy visiting a wolf park in Lozère, but farmers fret over their livestock and their livelihoods.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Imagine a world in which artificial intelligence is entrusted with the highest moral responsibilities: sentencing criminals, allocating medical resources, and even mediating conflicts between nations. This might seem like the pinnacle of human progress: an entity unburdened by emotion, prejudice or inconsistency, making ethical decisions with impeccable precision. . . .

Yet beneath this vision of an idealised moral arbiter lies a fundamental question: can a machine understand morality as humans do, or is it confined to a simulacrum of ethical reasoning? AI might replicate human decisions without improving on them, carrying forward the same biases, blind spots and cultural distortions from human moral judgment. In trying to emulate us, it might only reproduce our limitations, not transcend them. But there is a deeper concern. Moral judgment draws on intuition, historical awareness and context - qualities that resist formalisation. Ethics may be so embedded in lived experience that any attempt to encode it into formal structures risks flattening its most essential features. If so, AI would not merely reflect human shortcomings; it would strip morality of the very depth that makes ethical reflection possible in the first place.

Still, many have tried to formalise ethics, by treating certain moral claims not as conclusions, but as starting points. A classic example comes from utilitarianism, which often takes as a foundational axiom the principle that one should act to maximise overall wellbeing. From this, more specific principles can be derived, for example, that it is right to benefit the greatest number, or that actions should be judged by their consequences for total happiness. As computational resources increase, AI becomes increasingly well-suited to the task of starting from fixed ethical assumptions and reasoning through their implications in complex situations.

But what, exactly, does it mean to formalise something like ethics? The question is easier to grasp by looking at fields in which formal systems have long played a central role. Physics, for instance, has relied on formalisation for centuries. There is no single physical theory that explains everything. Instead, we have many physical theories, each designed to describe specific aspects of the Universe: from the behaviour of quarks and electrons to the motion of galaxies. These theories often diverge. Aristotelian physics, for instance, explained falling objects in terms of natural motion toward Earth's centre; Newtonian mechanics replaced this with a universal force of gravity. These explanations are not just different; they are incompatible. Yet both share a common structure: they begin with basic postulates - assumptions about motion, force or mass - and derive increasingly complex consequences. . . .

Ethical theories have a similar structure. Like physical theories, they attempt to describe a domain - in this case, the moral landscape. They aim to answer questions about which actions are right or wrong, and why. These theories also diverge and, even when they recommend similar actions, such as giving to charity, they justify them in different ways. Ethical theories also often begin with a small set of foundational principles or claims, from which they reason about more complex moral problems.

Question 21

All of the following can reasonably be inferred from the passage EXCEPT:

- by analogy with physics, compact postulates can yield broad predictions across incompatible theories

A and ethics can likewise share structure while continuing to diverge rather than close on a single comprehensive framework.
- encoding ethics into fixed structures risks stripping away intuition, history, and context and, if that

B occurs, the depth that enables reflective judgement disappears. So, machines would mirror our limits rather than exceed them.
- the appeal of an AI judge rests on immunity to bribery, partiality, and fatigue; yet the text questions

C whether procedural cleanliness amounts to moral understanding without lived context and interpretive depth.
- with fixed moral starting points and expanding computational resources, the argument forecasts

D convergence on one ethical system and treats contextual judgement as unnecessary once formal reasoning scales across domains and cultures.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 22

Which one of the options below best summarises the passage?

- The passage rejects formal methods in principle. It holds that moral judgement cannot be expressed in

A disciplined terms and concludes that AI should not serve in courts, medicine, or diplomacy under any conditions.
- The passage weighs the appeal of an impersonal AI judge against doubts about moral grasp. It claims

B codified schemes retain case nuance at scale and uses a physics analogy to predict convergence on a unified framework.
- The passage weighs the appeal of an impersonal AI judge against doubts about moral grasp. It warns

C that codification can erode case-sensitive judgement, allow axiom-led reasoning at scale, and use a physics analogy to model structured plurality.
- The passage highlights administrative gains from automation. It treats reproducing human moral

D judgement as progress and argues that, as computational resources increase, AI can be responsible for decision-making across varied institutional settings.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 23

Choose the one option below that comes closest to being the opposite of "utilitarianism".

- A The committee adopted a non-egoist framework, ranking policies by their contribution to overall social welfare and treating self-interest as a derivative concern within institutional evaluation.
- B The authors advocated an absolutist stance, following exceptionless rules regardless of outcomes and evaluating choices by broadest societal benefit.
- C The council followed a prioritarian approach, assigning greater moral weight to improvements for the worst-off rather than to maximising total welfare across the affected population.
- D The policy was cast as deontological ethics, selecting the option that delivered the highest total benefit to citizens while presenting duty as a secondary consideration in public decision-making.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 24

The passage compares ethics to physics, where different theories apply to different aspects of a domain and says AI can reason from fixed starting points in complex cases. Which one of the assumptions below must hold for that comparison to guide practice?

- A There is a principled way to decide which ethical framework applies to which class of cases, so the system can select the relevant starting points before deriving a recommendation.
- B Real cases never straddle different areas, so a case always fits exactly one framework without any overlap whatsoever.
- C A single master framework replaces all others after translation into one code, so domain boundaries disappear in application.
- D Once formalised, all ethical frameworks yield the same recommendation in every case, so selection among them is unnecessary.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Score Calculator



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

For early postcolonial literature, the world of the novel was often the nation. Postcolonial novels were usually [concerned with] national questions. Sometimes the whole story of the novel was taken as an allegory of the nation, whether India or Tanzania. This was important for supporting anti-colonial nationalism, but could also be limiting - land-focused and inward-looking.

My new book "Writing Ocean Worlds" explores another kind of world of the novel: not the village or nation, but the Indian Ocean world. The book describes a set of novels in which the Indian Ocean is at the centre of the story. It focuses on the novelists Amitav Ghosh, Abdulrazak Gurnah, Lindsey Collen and Joseph Conrad [who have] centred the Indian Ocean world in the majority of their novels. . . . Their work reveals a world that is outward-looking - full of movement, border-crossing and south-south interconnection. They are all very different - from colonially inclined (Conrad) to radically anti-capitalist (Collen), but together draw on and shape a wider sense of Indian Ocean space through themes, images, metaphors and language. This has the effect of remapping the world in the reader's mind, as centred in the interconnected global south. . . .

The Indian Ocean world is a term used to describe the very long-lasting connections among the coasts of East Africa, the Arab coasts, and South and East Asia. These connections were made possible by the geography of the Indian Ocean. For much of history, travel by sea was much easier than by land, which meant that port cities very far apart were often more easily connected to each other than to much closer inland cities. Historical and archaeological evidence suggests that what we now call globalisation first appeared in the Indian Ocean. This is the interconnected oceanic world referenced and produced by the novels in my book. . . .

For their part Ghosh, Gurnah, Collen and even Conrad reference a different set of histories and geographies than the ones most commonly found in fiction in English. Those [commonly found ones] are mostly centred in Europe or the US, assume a background of Christianity and whiteness, and mention places like Paris and New York. The novels in [my] book highlight instead a largely Islamic space, feature characters of colour and centralise the ports of Malindi, Mombasa, Aden, Java and Bombay. . . . It is a densely imagined, richly sensory image of a southern cosmopolitan culture which provides for an enlarged sense of place in the world.

This remapping is particularly powerful for the representation of Africa. In the fiction, sailors and travellers are not all European. . . . African, as well as Indian and Arab characters, are traders, nakhodas (dhow ship captains), runaways, villains, missionaries and activists. This does not mean that Indian Ocean Africa is romanticised. Migration is often a matter of force; travel is portrayed as abandonment rather than adventure, freedoms are kept from women and slavery is rife. What it does mean is that the African part of the Indian Ocean world plays an active role in its long, rich history and therefore in that of the wider world.

Question 25

All of the following statements, if true, would weaken the passage's claim about the relationship between mainstream English-language fiction and Indian Ocean novels EXCEPT:

- A the depiction of Africa in most Indian Ocean novels is driven by a postcolonial nostalgia for an idyllic past
- B the depiction of Africa in most Indian Ocean novels is driven by an Orientalist imagination of its cultural crudeness.
- C very few mainstream English-language novels have historically been set in American and European metropolitan centres.
- D most mainstream English-language novels have historically privileged the Christian, white, male experience of travel and adventure.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ Post-colonial literature cracku



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 26

All of the following claims contribute to the "remapping" discussed by the passage, EXCEPT:

- A Indian Ocean novels have gone beyond the specifics of national concerns to explore rich regional pasts.

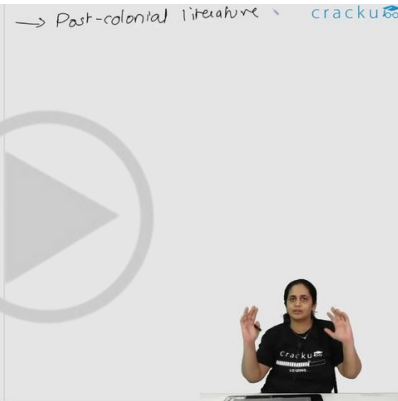
- B the world of early international trade and commerce was not the sole domain of white Europeans.
- C cosmopolitanism originated in the West and travelled to the East through globalisation.
- D the global south, as opposed to the global north, was the first centre of globalisation.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ Post-colonial literature cracku



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 27

On the basis of the nature of the relationship between the items in each pair below, choose the odd pair out:

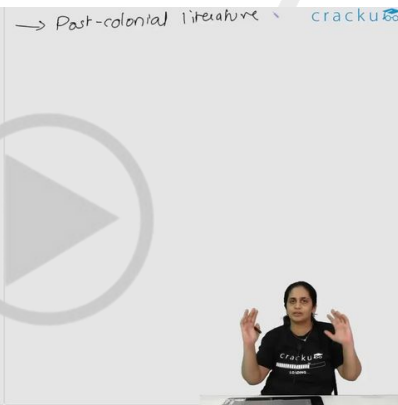
- A Indian Ocean novels : Outward-looking
- B Postcolonial novels : Border-crossing
- C Indian Ocean world : Slavery
- D Postcolonial novels : Anti-colonial nationalism

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ Post-colonial literature cracku



VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 28

Which one of the following statements is not true about migration in the Indian Ocean world?

- A The Indian Ocean world's migration networks connected the global north with the global south.

- B** Geographical location rather than geographical proximity determined the choice of destination for migrants.
- C** The Indian Ocean world's migration networks were shaped by religious and commercial histories of the region.
- D** Migration in the Indian Ocean world was an ambivalent experience.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

For early postcolonial literature, the world of the novel was often the nation. Postcolonial novels were usually [concerned with] national questions. Sometimes the whole story of the novel was taken as an allegory of the nation, whether India or Tanzania. This was important for supporting anti-colonial nationalism, but could also be limiting - land-focused and inward-looking.

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→ Post-colonial literature cracku



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Many human phenomena and characteristics - such as behaviors, beliefs, economies, genes, incomes, life expectancies, and other things - are influenced both by geographic factors and by non-geographic factors. Geographic factors mean physical and biological factors tied to geographic location, including climate, the distributions of wild plant and animal species, soils, and topography. Non-geographic factors include those factors subsumed under the term culture, other factors subsumed under the term history, and decisions by individual people. . . .

[T]he differences between the current economies of North and South Korea . . . cannot be attributed to the modest environmental differences between [them] . . . They are instead due entirely to the different [government] policies . . . At the opposite extreme, the Inuit and other traditional peoples living north of the Arctic Circle developed warm fur clothes but no agriculture, while equatorial lowland peoples around the world never developed warm fur clothes but often did develop agriculture. The explanation is straightforwardly geographic, rather than a cultural or historical quirk unrelated to geography. . . . Aboriginal Australia remained the sole continent occupied only by hunter/gatherers and with no indigenous farming or herding . . . [Here the] explanation is biogeographic: the Australian continent has no domesticable native animal species and few domesticable native plant species. Instead, the crops and domestic animals that now make Australia a food and wool exporter are all non-native (mainly Eurasian) species such as sheep, wheat, and grapes, brought to Australia by overseas colonists.

Today, no scholar would be silly enough to deny that culture, history, and individual choices play a big role in many human phenomena. Scholars don't react to cultural, historical, and individual-agent explanations by denouncing "cultural determinism," "historical determinism," or "individual determinism," and then thinking no further. But many scholars do react to any explanation invoking some geographic role, by denouncing "geographic determinism" . . .

Several reasons may underlie this widespread but nonsensical view. One reason is that some geographic explanations advanced a century ago were racist, thereby causing all geographic explanations to become tainted by racist associations in the minds of many scholars other than geographers. But many genetic, historical, psychological, and anthropological explanations advanced a century ago were also racist, yet the validity of newer non-racist genetic etc. explanations is widely accepted today.

Another reason for reflex rejection of geographic explanations is that historians have a tradition, in their discipline, of stressing the role of contingency (a favorite word among historians) based on individual decisions and chance. Often that view is warranted . . . But often, too, that view is unwarranted. The development of warm fur clothes among the Inuit living north of the Arctic Circle was not because one influential Inuit leader persuaded other Inuit in 1783 to adopt warm fur clothes, for no good environmental reason.

A third reason is that geographic explanations usually depend on detailed technical facts of geography and other fields of scholarship . . . Most historians and economists don't acquire that detailed knowledge as part of the professional training.

Question 29

The author criticises scholars who are not geographers for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

- A their rejection of the role of biogeographic factors in social and cultural phenomena.
- B their outdated interpretations of past cultural and historical phenomena.
- C the importance they place on the role of individual decisions when studying human phenomena
- D their labelling of geographic explanations as deterministic.

Geographic factors mean physical and biological factors tied to geographic location, including climate, the distributions of wild plant and animal species, soils, and topography. Non-geographic factors include those factors subsumed under the term culture, other factors subsumed under the term history, and decisions by individual people....

[T]he differences between the current economies of North and South Korea... cannot be attributed to the modest environmental differences between [them]... They are instead due entirely to the different [government] policies... At the opposite extreme, the Inuit and other traditional peoples living north of the Arctic Circle developed warm fur clothes but no agriculture, while equatorial lowland peoples around the world never developed warm fur clothing but often did develop agriculture. The explanation is straightforwardly geographic, rather than a cultural or historical quirk unrelated to geography... Aboriginal Australia remained the sole continent occupied only by hunter/gatherers and with no indigenous farming or herding... [Here the] explanation is biogeographic: the Australian continent has no domesticable native animal species and few domesticable native plant species. Instead, the crops and domestic animals that now make Australia a food and wool exporter are all non-native (mainly Eurasian) species

Handwritten diagram:

- Human phenomena
 - Geographic
 - Non-geographic

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 30

All of the following can be inferred from the passage EXCEPT:

- A individual dictat and contingency were not the causal factors for the use of fur clothing in some very cold climates.
- B agricultural practices changed drastically in the Australian continent after it was colonised.
- C while most human phenomena result from culture and individual choice, some have bio-geographic origins.
- D several academic studies of human phenomena in the past involved racist interpretations.

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→ Human phenomena
→ Geographic
→ Non-geographic




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Question 31

The examples of the Inuit and Aboriginal Australians are offered in the passage to show:

- A human resourcefulness across cultures in adapting to their surroundings.
- B how physical circumstances can dictate human behaviour and cultures.
- C that despite geographical isolation, traditional societies were self-sufficient and adaptive.
- D how environmental factors lead to comparatively divergent paths in livelihoods and development.

Geographic factors mean physical and biological factors tied to geographic location, including climate, the distributions of wild plant and animal species, soils, and topography. Non-geographic factors include those factors subsumed under the term culture, other factors subsumed under the term history, and decisions by individual people....

[T]he differences between the current economies of North and South Korea... cannot be attributed to the modest environmental differences between [them]... They are instead due entirely to the different [government] policies... At the opposite extreme, the Inuit and other traditional peoples living north of the Arctic Circle developed warm fur clothes but no agriculture, while equatorial lowland peoples around the world never developed warm fur clothing but often did develop agriculture. The explanation is straightforwardly geographic, rather than a cultural historical quirk unrelated to geography... Aboriginal Australia remained the sole continent occupied only by hunter/gatherers and with no indigenous farming or herding... [Here the] explanation is biogeographic: the Australian continent has no domesticable native animal species and few domesticable native plant species. Instead, the crops and domestic animals that now make Australia a food and wool exporter are all non-native (mainly Eurasian) species

→ Human phenomena
→ Geographic
→ Non-geographic




VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 32

All of the following are advanced by the author as reasons why non-geographers disregard geographic influences on human phenomena EXCEPT their:

- A lingering impressions of past geographic analyses that were politically offensive.
- B belief in the central role of humans, unrelated to physical surroundings, in influencing phenomena.
- C disciplinary training which typically does not include technical knowledge of geography.

D dismissal of explanations that involve geographical causes for human behaviour.

Geographic factors mean physical and biological factors tied to geographic location, including climate, the distributions of wild plant and animal species, soils, and topography. Non-geographic factors include those factors subsumed under the term culture, other factors subsumed under the term history, and decisions by individual people....

[T]he differences between the current economies of North and South Korea... cannot be attributed to the modest environmental differences between [them]... They are instead due entirely to the different [government] policies... At the opposite extreme, the Inuit and other traditional peoples living north of the Arctic Circle develop warm fur clothes but no agriculture, while equatorial lowland peoples around the world never developed warm fur clothing but often did develop agriculture. The explanation is straightforwardly geographic, rather than a cultural historical quirk unrelated to geography... Aboriginal Australia remained the sole continent occupied only by hunter/gatherers and with no indigenous farming or herding... [Here the] explanation is biogeographic: the Australian continent has no domesticable native animal species and few domesticable native plant species. Instead, the crops and domestic animals that now make Australia a food and wool exporter are all non-native (mainly Eurasian) species

→ Human phenomena
→ Geographic
→ Non-geographic

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[Fifty] years after its publication in English [in 1972], and just a year since [Marshall] Sahlins himself died—we may ask: why did [his essay] “Original Affluent Society” have such an impact, and how has it fared since? . . . Sahlins’s principal argument was simple but counterintuitive: before being driven into marginal environments by colonial powers, hunter-gatherers, or foragers, were not engaged in a desperate struggle for meager survival. Quite the contrary, they satisfied their needs with far less work than people in agricultural and industrial societies, leaving them more time to use as they wished. Hunters, he quipped, keep bankers’ hours. Refusing to maximize, many were “more concerned with games of chance than with chances of game.” . . . The so-called Neolithic Revolution, rather than improving life, imposed a harsher work regime and set in motion the long history of growing inequality . . .

Moreover, foragers had other options. The contemporary Hadza of Tanzania, who had long been surrounded by farmers, knew they had alternatives and rejected them. To Sahlins, this showed that foragers are not simply examples of human diversity or victimhood but something more profound: they demonstrated that societies make real choices. Culture, a way of living oriented around a distinctive set of values, manifests a fundamental principle of collective self-determination. . . .

But the point [of the essay] is not so much the empirical validity of the data—the real interest for most readers, after all, is not in foragers either today or in the Paleolithic—but rather its conceptual challenge to contemporary economic life and bourgeois individualism. The empirical served a philosophical and political project, a thought experiment and stimulus to the imagination of possibilities.

With its title’s nod toward *The Affluent Society* (1958), economist John Kenneth Galbraith’s famously skeptical portrait of America’s postwar prosperity and inequality, and dripping with New Left contempt for consumerism, “The Original Affluent Society” brought this critical perspective to bear on the contemporary world. It did so through the classic anthropological move of showing that radical alternatives to the readers’ lives really exist. If the capitalist world seeks wealth through ever greater material production to meet infinitely expansive desires, foraging societies follow “the Zen road to affluence”: not by getting more, but by wanting less. If it seems that foragers have been left behind by “progress,” this is due only to the ethnocentric self-congratulation of the West. Rather than accumulate material goods, these societies are guided by other values: leisure, mobility, and above all, freedom. . . .

Viewed in today’s context, of course, not every aspect of the essay has aged well. While acknowledging the violence of colonialism, racism, and dispossession, it does not thematize them as heavily as we might today. Rebuking evolutionary anthropologists for treating present-day foragers as “left behind” by progress, it too can succumb to the temptation to use them as proxies for the Paleolithic. Yet these characteristics should not distract us from appreciating Sahlins’s effort to show that if we want to conjure new possibilities, we need to learn about actually inhabitable worlds.

Question 33

We can infer that Sahlins's main goal in writing his essay was to:

- A put forth the view that, despite egalitarian origins, economic progress brings greater inequality and social hierarchies.
- B highlight the fact that while we started off as a fairly contented egalitarian people, we have progressively degenerated into materialism.
- C hold a mirror to an acquisitive society, with examples of other communities that have chosen successfully to be non-materialistic
- D counter Galbraith's pessimistic view of the inevitability of a capitalist trajectory for economic growth.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[Fifty] years after its publication in English [in 1972], and just a year since [Marshall] Sahlins himself died—we may ask: why did [his essay] "Original Affluent Society" have such an impact, and how has it fared since? ... Sahlins's principal argument was simple but counterintuitive: before being driven into marginal environments by colonial powers hunter-gatherers, or foragers, were not engaged in a desperate struggle for meager survival. Quite the contrary, they satisfied their needs with far less work than people in agricultural and industrial societies, leaving them more time to use as they wished. Hunters, he quipped, keep "hunters' hours. Refusing to maximize, many were "more concerned with games of chance than with chances of game." ... the so-called Neolithic Revolution, rather than improving life, imposed a harsher work regime and set in motion the long history of growing inequality ...

Moreover, foragers had other options. The contemporary Hadza of Tanzania, who had long been surrounded by farmers, knew they had alternatives and rejected them. To Sahlins, this showed that foragers are not simply examples of human diversity or victimhood but something more.

→ How relevant



VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Daily Targets

Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile

Question 34

The author mentions Tanzania's Hadza community to illustrate:

- A that hunter-gatherer communities' subsistence-level techniques equipped them to survive well into contemporary times.
- B how pre-agrarian societies did not hamper the emergence of more advanced agrarian practices in contiguous communities.
- C that forager communities' lifestyles derived not from ignorance about alternatives, but from their own choice.
- D how two vastly different ways of living and working were able to coexist in proximity for centuries.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[Fifty] years after its publication in English [in 1972], and just a year since [Marshall] Sahlins himself died—we may ask: why did [his essay] “Original Affluent Society” have such an impact, and how has it fared since? ... Sahlins’s principal argument was simple but counterintuitive: before being driven into marginal environments by colonial powers hunter-gatherers, or foragers, were not engaged in a desperate struggle for meager survival. Quite the contrary, they satisfied their needs with far less work than people in agricultural and industrial societies, leaving them more time to use as they wished. Hunters, he quipped, kept “killers” hours. Refusing to maximize, many were “more concerned with games of chance than with chances of game.” ... the so-called Neolithic Revolution, rather than improving life, imposed a harsher work regime and set in motion the long history of growing inequality ...

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→ How relevant

cracku



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 35

The author of the passage criticises Sahlins’s essay for its:

- A cursory treatment of the effects of racism and colonialism on societies.
- B outdated values regarding present-day foragers versus ancient foraging communities.
- C critique of anthropologists who disparage the choices of foragers in today’s society
- D failure to supplement its thesis with robust empirical data.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[Fifty] years after its publication in English [in 1972], and just a year since [Marshall] Sahlins himself died—we may ask: why did [his essay] “Original Affluent Society” have such an impact, and how has it fared since? ... Sahlins’s principal argument was simple but counterintuitive: before being driven into marginal environments by colonial powers hunter-gatherers, or foragers, were not engaged in a desperate struggle for meager survival. Quite the contrary, they satisfied their needs with far less work than people in agricultural and industrial societies, leaving them more time to use as they wished. Hunters, he quipped, kept “killers” hours. Refusing to maximize, many were “more concerned with games of chance than with chances of game.” ... the so-called Neolithic Revolution, rather than improving life, imposed a harsher work regime and set in motion the long history of growing inequality ...

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→ How relevant

cracku



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 36

The author of the passage mentions Galbraith’s “The Affluent Society” to:

- A show how Galbraith’s theories refute Sahlins’s thesis on the contentment of pre-hunter-gatherer communities.
- B contrast the materialist nature of contemporary growth paths with the pacifist content ways of living among the foragers.
- C document the influence of Galbraith’s cynical views on modern consumerism on Sahlins’s analysis of pre-historic societies.
- D show how Sahlins’s views complemented Galbraith’s criticism of the consumerism and inequality of contemporary society.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[Fifty] years after its publication in English [in 1972], and just a year since [Marshall] Sahlins himself died—we may ask: why did [his essay] "Original Affluent Society" have such an impact, and how has it fared since? ... Sahlins's principal argument was simple but counterintuitive: before being driven into marginal environments by colonial powers hunter-gatherers, or foragers, were not engaged in a desperate struggle for meager survival. Quite the contrary, they satisfied their needs with far less work than people in agricultural and industrial societies, leaving them more time to use as they wished. Hunters, he quipped, keep "leisure" hours. Refusing to maximize, many were "more concerned with games of chance than with chances of game." ... the so-called Neolithic Revolution, rather than improving life, imposed a harsher work regime and set in motion the long history of growing inequality ...

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→ how relevant

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

In 2006, the Met [art museum in the US] agreed to return the Euphronios krater, a masterpiece Greek urn that had been a museum draw since 1972. In 2007, the Getty [art museum in the US] agreed to return 40 objects to Italy, including a marble Aphrodite, in the midst of looting scandals. And in December, Sotheby's and a private owner agreed to return an ancient Khmer statue of a warrior, pulled from auction two years before, to Cambodia.

Cultural property, or patrimony, laws limit the transfer of cultural property outside the source country's territory, including outright export prohibitions and national ownership laws. Most art historians, archaeologists, museum officials and policymakers portray cultural property laws in general as invaluable tools for counteracting the ugly legacy of Western cultural imperialism.

During the late 19th and early 20th century — an era former Met director Thomas Hoving called "the age of piracy" — American and European art museums acquired antiquities by hook or by crook, from grave robbers or souvenir collectors, bounty from digs and ancient sites in impoverished but art-rich source countries. Patrimony laws were intended to protect future archaeological discoveries against Western imperialist designs. . . .

I surveyed 90 countries with one or more archaeological sites on UNESCO's World Heritage Site list, and my study shows that in most cases the number of discovered sites diminishes sharply after a country passes a cultural property law. There are 222 archaeological sites listed for those 90 countries. When you look into the history of the sites, you see that all but 21 were discovered before the passage of cultural property laws. . . .

Strict cultural patrimony laws are popular in most countries. But the downside may be that they reduce incentives for foreign governments, nongovernmental organizations and educational institutions to invest in overseas exploration because their efforts will not necessarily be rewarded by opportunities to hold, display and study what is uncovered. To the extent that source countries can fund their own archaeological projects, artifacts and sites may still be discovered. . . . The survey has far-reaching implications. It suggests that source countries, particularly in the developing world, should narrow their cultural property laws so that they can reap the benefits of new archaeological discoveries, which typically increase tourism and enhance cultural pride. This does not mean these nations should abolish restrictions on foreign excavation and foreign claims to artifacts.

China provides an interesting alternative approach for source nations eager for foreign archaeological investment. From 1935 to 2003, China had a restrictive cultural property law that prohibited foreign ownership of Chinese cultural artifacts. In those years, China's most significant archaeological discovery occurred by

chance, in 1974, when peasant farmers accidentally uncovered ranks of buried terra cotta warriors, which are part of Emperor Qin's spectacular tomb system.

In 2003, the Chinese government switched course, dropping its cultural property law and embracing collaborative international archaeological research. Since then, China has nominated 11 archaeological sites for inclusion in the World Heritage Site list, including eight in 2013, the most ever for China.

Question 37

Which one of the following statements best expresses the paradox of patrimony laws?

- A They were aimed at protecting cultural property, but instead reduced business for auctioneers like Sotheby's.
- B They were intended to protect cultural property, but instead resulted in the neglect of historical sites.
- C They were intended to protect cultural property, but instead resulted in the withholding of national treasure from museums.
- D They were aimed at protecting cultural property, but instead reduced new archaeological discoveries.

In 1972, the Getty Center for the History of Art and the Humanities acquired the Euphronios krater, a masterpiece Greek urn that had been a museum draw since 1972. In 2007, the Getty [art museum in the US] agreed to return 40 objects to Italy, including a marble Aphrodite, in the midst of looting scandals. And in December, Sotheby's and a private owner agreed to return an ancient Khmer statue of a warrior, pulled from auction two years before, to Cambodia.

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During the late 19th and early 20th century — an era when the Met director Thomas Hoving called "the age of piracy" — American and European art museums acquired antiquities by hook or by crook, from grave robbers or souvenir collectors, bounty from digs and ancient sites in impoverished but art-rich source countries. Patrimony laws were intended to protect future archaeological discoveries against Western imperialist designs. ...

→ 3 examples of antiques being returned to countries
→ Cultural patrimony

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 38

Which one of the following statements, if true, would undermine the central idea of the passage?

- A Affluent archaeologically-rich source countries can afford to carry out their own excavations.
- B Museums established in economically deprived archaeologically-rich source countries can display the antiques discovered there.
- C UNESCO finances archaeological research in poor, but archaeologically-rich source countries.
- D Western countries will have to apologise to countries for looting their cultural property in the past century.

the Euphronios krater, a masterpiece Greek urn that had been a museum draw since 1972. In 2007, the Getty [art museum in the US] agreed to return 40 objects to Italy, including a marble Aphrodite, in the midst of looting scandals. And in December, Sotheby's and a private owner agreed to return an ancient Khmer statue of a warrior, pulled from auction two years before, to Cambodia.

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→ 3 examples of antiques being returned to countries
→ Cultural patrimony

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 39

It can be inferred from the passage that archaeological sites are considered important by some source countries because they:

- A are a symbol of Western imperialism.
- B are subject to strict patrimony laws.
- C generate funds for future discoveries.
- D give a boost to the tourism sector.

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→ 3 examples of antiques being returned to countries
→ Cultural patrimony

VIDEO SOLUTION

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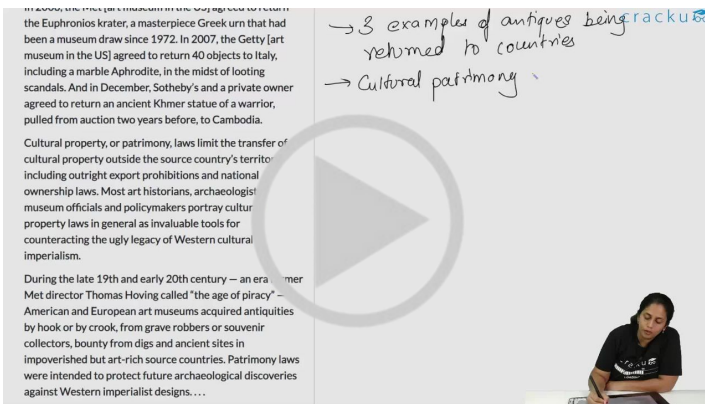
cracku

Question 40

From the passage we can infer that the author is likely to advise poor, but archaeologically-rich source countries to do all of the following, EXCEPT:

- A fund institutes in other countries to undertake archaeological exploration in the source country reaping the benefits of cutting-edge techniques.
- B allow foreign countries to analyse and exhibit the archaeological finds made in the source country.

- C to find ways to motivate other countries to finance archaeological explorations in their country.
- D adopt China's strategy of dropping its cultural property laws and carrying out archaeological research through international collaboration.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Steven Pinker's new book, "Rationality: What It Is, Why It Seems Scarce, Why It Matters," offers a pragmatic dose of measured optimism, presenting rationality as a fragile but achievable ideal in personal and civic life. . . . Pinker's ambition to illuminate such a crucial topic offers the welcome prospect of a return to sanity. . . . It's no small achievement to make formal logic, game theory, statistics and Bayesian reasoning delightful topics full of charm and relevance.

It's also plausible to believe that a wider application of the rational tools he analyzes would improve the world in important ways. His primer on statistics and scientific uncertainty is particularly timely and should be required reading before consuming any news about the [COVID] pandemic. More broadly, he argues that less media coverage of shocking but vanishingly rare events, from shark attacks to adverse vaccine reactions, would help prevent dangerous overreactions, fatalism and the diversion of finite resources away from solvable but less-dramatic issues, like malnutrition in the developing world.

It's a reasonable critique, and Pinker is not the first to make it. But analyzing the political economy of journalism — its funding structures, ownership concentration and increasing reliance on social media shares — would have given a fuller picture of why so much coverage is so misguided and what we might do about it.

Pinker's main focus is the sort of conscious, sequential reasoning that can track the steps in a geometric proof or an argument in formal logic. Skill in this domain maps directly onto the navigation of many real-world problems, and Pinker shows how greater mastery of the tools of rationality can improve decision-making in medical, legal, financial and many other contexts in which we must act on uncertain and shifting information. . . .

Despite the undeniable power of the sort of rationality he describes, many of the deepest insights in the history of science, math, music and art strike their originators in moments of epiphany. From the 19th-century chemist Friedrich August Kekulé's discovery of the structure of benzene to any of Mozart's symphonies, much extraordinary human achievement is not a product of conscious, sequential reasoning. Even Plato's Socrates — who anticipated many of Pinker's points by nearly 2,500 years, showing the virtue of knowing what you do not know and examining all premises in arguments, not simply trusting speakers' authority or charisma — attributed many of his most profound insights to dreams and visions. Conscious reasoning is helpful in sorting the wheat from the chaff, but it would be interesting to consider the hidden aquifers that make much of the grain grow in the first place.

The role of moral and ethical education in promoting rational behavior is also underexplored. Pinker recognizes that rationality “is not just a cognitive virtue but a moral one.” But this profoundly important point, one subtly explored by ancient Greek philosophers like Plato and Aristotle, doesn’t really get developed. This is a shame, since possessing the right sort of moral character is arguably a precondition for using rationality in beneficial ways.

Question 41

According to the author, for Pinker as well as the ancient Greek philosophers, rational thinking involves all of the following EXCEPT:

- A an awareness of underlying assumptions in an argument and gaps in one’s own knowledge
- B the belief that the ability to reason logically encompasses an ethical and moral dimension.
- C the primacy of conscious sequential reasoning as the basis for seminal human achievements.
- D arriving at independent conclusions irrespective of who is presenting the argument.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ Pinker's new book on rationality is
→ fragile but achievable → crucial topic and well-written

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 42

The author mentions Kekulé’s discovery of the structure of benzene and Mozart’s symphonies to illustrate the point that:

- A great innovations across various fields can stem from flashes of intuition and are not always propelled by logical thinking.
- B Pinker’s conclusions on sequential reasoning are belied by European achievements which, in the past, were more rooted in unconscious bursts of genius.
- C it is not just the creative arts, but also scientific fields that have benefitted from flashes of creativity.
- D unlike the sciences, human achievements in other fields are a mix of logical reasoning and spontaneous epiphanies.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Steven Pinker's new book, "Rationality: What It Is, Why It Seems Scarce, Why It Matters," offers a pragmatic dose of measured optimism, presenting rationality as a fragile but achievable ideal in personal and civic life.... Pinker's ambition to illuminate such a crucial topic offers the welcome prospect of a return to sanity.... It's no small achievement to make formal logic, game theory, statistics and Bayesian reasoning delightful topics full of charm and relevance.

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→ Pinker's new book on rationality is a crucial topic and well-written.
→ fragile but achievable



VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 43

The author refers to the ancient Greek philosophers to:

- A show how dreams and visions have for centuries influenced subconscious behaviour and pathbreaking inventions.
- B indicate the various similarities between their thinking and Pinker's conclusions.
- C reveal gaps in Pinker's discussion of the importance of ethical considerations in rational behaviour.
- D highlight the influence of their thinking on the development of Pinker's arguments.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Steven Pinker's new book, "Rationality: What It Is, Why It Seems Scarce, Why It Matters," offers a pragmatic dose of measured optimism, presenting rationality as a fragile but achievable ideal in personal and civic life.... Pinker's ambition to illuminate such a crucial topic offers the welcome prospect of a return to sanity.... It's no small achievement to make formal logic, game theory, statistics and Bayesian reasoning delightful topics full of charm and relevance.

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→ Pinker's new book on rationality is a crucial topic and well-written.
→ fragile but achievable



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 44

The author endorses Pinker's views on the importance of logical reasoning as it:

- A provides a moral compass for resolving important ethical dilemmas.
- B focuses public attention on real issues like development rather than sensational events.
- C equips people with the ability to tackle challenging practical problems.

D helps people to gain expertise in statistics and other scientific disciplines.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ Pinker's new book on rationality is crucial
→ fragile but achievable
→ topic and well-written



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Understanding romantic aesthetics is not a simple undertaking for reasons that are internal to the nature of the subject. Distinguished scholars, such as Arthur Lovejoy, Northrop Frye and Isaiah Berlin, have remarked on the notorious challenges facing any attempt to define romanticism. Lovejoy, for example, claimed that romanticism is "the scandal of literary history and criticism" . . . The main difficulty in studying the romantics, according to him, is the lack of any "single real entity, or type of entity" that the concept "romanticism" designates. Lovejoy concluded, "the word 'romantic' has come to mean so many things that, by itself, it means nothing" . . .

The more specific task of characterizing romantic aesthetics adds to these difficulties an air of paradox. Conventionally, "aesthetics" refers to a theory concerning beauty and art or the branch of philosophy that studies these topics. However, many of the romantics rejected the identification of aesthetics with a circumscribed domain of human life that is separated from the practical and theoretical domains of life. The most characteristic romantic commitment is to the idea that the character of art and beauty and of our engagement with them should shape all aspects of human life. Being fundamental to human existence, beauty and art should be a central ingredient not only in a philosophical or artistic life, but also in the lives of ordinary men and women. Another challenge for any attempt to characterize romantic aesthetics lies in the fact that most of the romantics were poets and artists whose views of art and beauty are, for the most part, to be found not in developed theoretical accounts, but in fragments, aphorisms and poems, which are often more elusive and suggestive than conclusive.

Nevertheless, in spite of these challenges the task of characterizing romantic aesthetics is neither impossible nor undesirable, as numerous thinkers responding to Lovejoy's radical skepticism have noted. While warning against a reductive definition of romanticism, Berlin, for example, still heralded the need for a general characterization: "[Although] one does have a certain sympathy with Lovejoy's despair...[he is] in this instance mistaken. There was a romantic movement...and it is important to discover what it is" . . .

Recent attempts to characterize romanticism and to stress its contemporary relevance follow this path. Instead of overlooking the undeniable differences between the variety of romanticisms of different nations that Lovejoy had stressed, such studies attempt to characterize romanticism, not in terms of a single definition, a specific time, or a specific place, but in terms of "particular philosophical questions and concerns" . . .

While the German, British and French romantics are all considered, the central protagonists in the following are the German romantics. Two reasons explain this focus: first, because it has paved the way for the other romanticisms, German romanticism has a pride of place among the different national romanticisms . . . Second, the aesthetic outlook that was developed in Germany roughly between 1796 and 1801-02 — the period that corresponds to the heyday of what is known as "Early Romanticism" . . . — offers

the most philosophical expression of romanticism since it is grounded primarily in the epistemological, metaphysical, ethical, and political concerns that the German romantics discerned in the aftermath of Kant's philosophy.

Question 45

According to the romantics, aesthetics:

- A should be confined to a specific domain separate from the practical and theoretical aspects of life.
- B is primarily the concern of philosophers and artists, rather than of ordinary people.
- C is widely considered to be irrelevant to human existence.
- D permeates all aspects of human life, philosophical and mundane.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question. Understanding romantic aesthetics is not a simple undertaking for reasons that are internal to the nature of the subject. Distinguished scholars, such as Arthur Lovejoy, Northrop Frye and Isaiah Berlin, have remarked on the notorious challenges facing any attempt to define romanticism. Lovejoy, for example, claimed that romanticism is "the scandal of literary history and criticism" ... The main difficulty in studying the romantics, according to him, is the lack of any "single real entity, or type of entity" that the concept "romanticism" designates. Lovejoy concluded, "the word 'romantic' has come to mean so many things that, by itself, it means nothing" ...

The more specific task of characterizing romantic aesthetics adds to these difficulties an air of paradox. Conventionally, "aesthetics" refers to a theory concerning beauty and art, the branch of philosophy that studies these topics. However, many of the romantics rejected the identification of aesthetics with a circumscribed domain of human life that is separated from the practical and theoretical domains of life. The most characteristic romantic commitment is to the idea that the character of art and beauty and of our engagement



VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 46

Which one of the following statements is NOT supported by the passage?

- A Characterising romantic aesthetics is both possible and desirable, despite the challenges involved.
- B Recent studies on romanticism seek to refute the differences between national romanticisms.
- C Romantic aesthetics are primarily expressed through fragments, aphorisms, and poems.
- D Many romantics rejected the idea of aesthetics as a domain separate from other aspects of life.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Understanding romantic aesthetics is not a simple undertaking for reasons that are internal to the nature of the subject. Distinguished scholars, such as Arthur Lovejoy, Northrop Frye and Isaiah Berlin, have remarked on the notorious challenges facing any attempt to define romanticism. Lovejoy, for example, claimed that romanticism is "the scandal of literary history and criticism" ... The main difficulty in studying the romantics, according to him, is the lack of any "single real entity, or type of entity" that the concept "romanticism" designates. Lovejoy concluded, "the word 'romantic' has come to mean so many things that, by itself, it means nothing" ...

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 47

According to the passage, recent studies on romanticism avoid "a single definition, a specific time, or a specific place" because they:

- A understand that the variety of romanticisms renders a general analysis impossible.
- B prefer to highlight the paradox of romantic aesthetics as a concept.
- C prefer to focus on the fundamental concerns of the romantics.
- D seek to discredit Lovejoy's scepticism regarding romanticism.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Understanding romantic aesthetics is not a simple undertaking for reasons that are internal to the nature of the subject. Distinguished scholars, such as Arthur Lovejoy, Northrop Frye and Isaiah Berlin, have remarked on the notorious challenges facing any attempt to define romanticism. Lovejoy, for example, claimed that romanticism is "the scandal of literary history and criticism" ... The main difficulty in studying the romantics, according to him, is the lack of any "single real entity, or type of entity" that the concept "romanticism" designates. Lovejoy concluded, "the word 'romantic' has come to mean so many things that, by itself, it means nothing" ...

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 48

The main difficulty in studying romanticism is the:

- A elusive and suggestive nature of romantic aesthetics.
- B lack of clear conceptual contours of the domain.
- C controversial and scandalous history of romantic literature.
- D absence of written accounts by romantic poets and artists.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Understanding romantic aesthetics is not a simple undertaking for reasons that are internal to the nature of the subject. Distinguished scholars, such as Arthur Lovejoy, Northrop Frye and Isaiah Berlin, have remarked on the notorious challenges facing any attempt to define romanticism. Lovejoy, for example, claimed that romanticism is "the scandal of literary history and criticism" ... The main difficulty in studying the romantics, according to him, is the lack of any "single real entity, or type of entity" that the concept "romanticism" designates. Lovejoy concluded, "the word 'romantic' has come to mean so many things that, by itself, it means nothing" ...

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VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT DILR Questions

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Comprehension:

The biggest challenge [The Nutmeg's Curse by Ghosh] throws down is to the prevailing understanding of when the climate crisis started. Most of us have accepted . . . that it started with the widespread use of coal at the beginning of the Industrial Age in the 18th century and worsened with the mass adoption of oil and natural gas in the 20th. Ghosh takes this history at least three centuries back, to the start of European colonialism in the 15th century. He [starts] the book with a 1621 massacre by Dutch invaders determined to impose a monopoly on nutmeg cultivation and trade in the Banda islands in today's Indonesia. Not only do the Dutch systematically depopulate the islands through genocide, they also try their best to bring nutmeg cultivation into plantation mode. These are the two points to which Ghosh returns through examples from around the world. One, how European colonialists decimated not only indigenous populations but also indigenous understanding of the relationship between humans and Earth. Two, how this was an invasion not only of humans but of the Earth itself, and how this continues to the present day by looking at nature as a 'resource' to exploit. . . .

We know we are facing more frequent and more severe heatwaves, storms, floods, droughts and wildfires due to climate change. We know our expansion through deforestation, dam building, canal cutting - in short, terraforming, the word Ghosh uses - has brought us repeated disasters . . . Are these the responses of an angry Gaia who has finally had enough? By using the word 'curse' in the title, the author makes it clear that he thinks so. I use the pronoun 'who' knowingly, because Ghosh has quoted many non-European sources to enquire into the relationship between humans and the world around them so that he can question the prevalent way of looking at Earth as an inert object to be exploited to the maximum.

As Ghosh's text, notes and bibliography show once more, none of this is new. There have always been challenges to the way European colonialists looked at other civilisations and at Earth. It is just that the invaders and their myriad backers in the fields of economics, politics, anthropology, philosophy, literature, technology, physics, chemistry, biology have dominated global intellectual discourse. . . .

There are other points of view that we can hear today if we listen hard enough. Those observing global climate negotiations know about the Latin American way of looking at Earth as Pachamama (Earth Mother). They also know how such a framing is just provided lip service and is ignored in the substantive portions of the negotiations. In The Nutmeg's Curse, Ghosh explains why. He shows the extent of the vested interest in the oil economy - not only for oil-exporting countries, but also for a superpower like the US that controls oil drilling, oil

prices and oil movement around the world. Many of us know power utilities are sabotaging decentralised solar power generation today because it hits their revenues and control. And how the other points of view are so often drowned out.

Question 49

On the basis of information in the passage, which one of the following is NOT a reason for the failure of policies seeking to address climate change?

- A The greed of organisations benefiting from non-renewable energy resources.
- B The global dominance of oil economies and international politics built around it.
- C The marginalised status of non-European ways of looking at nature and the environment.
- D The decentralised characteristic of renewable energy resources like solar power.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Comprehension:
The biggest challenge [The Nutmeg's Curse by Ghosh] throws down is to the prevailing understanding of when the climate crisis started. Most of us have accepted... that it started with the widespread use of coal at the beginning of the Industrial Age in the 18th century and worsened with the mass adoption of oil and natural gas in the 20th. Ghosh takes this history at least three centuries back, to the start of European colonialism in the 15th century. He [starts] the book with a 1621 massacre by Dutch invaders determined to impose a monopoly on nutmeg cultivation and trade in the Banda Islands in today's Indonesia. Not only did the Dutch systematically depopulate the islands through genocide, they also try their best to bring nutmeg cultivation into plantation mode. These are the two points to which Ghosh returns through examples from around the world. One, how European colonialists decimated not only indigenous populations but also indigenous understanding of the relationship between humans and Earth. Two, how this was an invasion not only of humans but of the Earth itself, and how this continues to the present day by looking



VIDEO SOLUTION

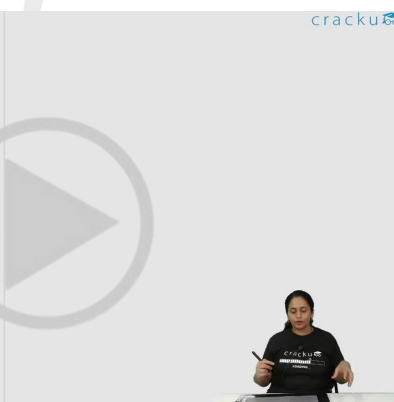
Question 50

Which one of the following, if true, would make the reviewer's choice of the pronoun "who" for Gaia inappropriate?

- A Modern western science discovers new evidence for the Earth being an inanimate object.
- B There is a direct cause-effect relationship between human activities and global climate change.
- C Ghosh's book has a different title: "The Nutmeg's Revenge".
- D Non-European societies have perceived the Earth as a non-living source of all resources.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Comprehension:
The biggest challenge [The Nutmeg's Curse by Ghosh] throws down is to the prevailing understanding of when the climate crisis started. Most of us have accepted... that it started with the widespread use of coal at the beginning of the Industrial Age in the 18th century and worsened with the mass adoption of oil and natural gas in the 20th. Ghosh takes this history at least three centuries back, to the start of European colonialism in the 15th century. He [starts] the book with a 1621 massacre by Dutch invaders determined to impose a monopoly on nutmeg cultivation and trade in the Banda Islands in today's Indonesia. Not only did the Dutch systematically depopulate the islands through genocide, they also try their best to bring nutmeg cultivation into plantation mode. These are the two points to which Ghosh returns through examples from around the world. One, how European colonialists decimated not only indigenous populations but also indigenous understanding of the relationship between humans and Earth. Two, how this was an invasion not only of humans but of the Earth itself, and how this continues to the present day by looking



Question 51

All of the following can be inferred from the reviewer's discussion of "The Nutmeg's Curse", EXCEPT:

- A the history of climate change is deeply intertwined with the history of colonialism.
- B the contemporary dominant perception of nature and the environment was put in place by processes of colonialism.
- C environmental preservation policy makers can learn a lot from non-European and/or pre-colonial societies.
- D academic discourses have always served the function of raising awareness about environmental preservation.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Comprehension:
The biggest challenge [The Nutmeg's Curse by Ghosh] throws down is to the prevailing understanding of when the climate crisis started. Most of us have accepted... that it started with the widespread use of coal at the beginning of the Industrial Age in the 18th century and worsened with the mass adoption of oil and natural gas in the 20th century. Ghosh takes this history at least three centuries back, to the start of European colonialism in the 15th century. He starts the book with a 1621 massacre by Dutch invaders determined to impose a monopoly on nutmeg cultivation and trade in the Banda Islands in today's Indonesia. Not only did the Dutch systematically depopulate the islands through genocide, they also try their best to bring nutmeg cultivation into plantation mode. These are the two points to which Ghosh returns through examples from around the world. One, how European colonialists decimated not only indigenous populations but also indigenous understanding of the relationship between humans and Earth. Two, how this was an invasion not only of humans but of the Earth itself, and how this continues to the present day by looking



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Question 52

Which one of the following best explains the primary purpose of the discussion of the colonisation of the Banda islands in "The Nutmeg's Curse"?

- A To illustrate the role played by the cultivation of certain crops in the plantation mode in contributing to climate change.
- B To illustrate the first instance in history when the processes responsible for climate change were initiated.
- C To illustrate how systemic violence against the colonised constituted the cornerstone of colonialism.
- D To illustrate how colonialism represented and perpetuated the mindset that has led to climate change.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Comprehension:
The biggest challenge [The Nutmeg's Curse by Ghosh] throws down is to the prevailing understanding of when the climate crisis started. Most of us have accepted... that it started with the widespread use of coal at the beginning of the Industrial Age in the 18th century and worsened with the mass adoption of oil and natural gas in the 20th. Ghosh takes this history at least three centuries back, to the start of European colonialism in the 15th century. He starts the book with a 1621 massacre by Dutch invaders determined to impose a monopoly on nutmeg cultivation and trade in the Banda Islands in today's Indonesia. Not only did the Dutch systematically depopulate the islands through genocide, they also try their best to bring nutmeg cultivation into plantation mode. These are the two points to which Ghosh returns through examples from around the world. One, how European colonialists decimated not only indigenous populations but also indigenous understanding of the relationship between humans and Earth. Two, how this was an invasion not only of humans but of the Earth itself, and how this continues to the present day by looking



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

As you set out for Ithaka
hope the journey is a long one,
full of adventure, full of discovery.
Laistrygonians and Cyclops,
angry Poseidon – don't be afraid of them:
you'll never find things like that on your way
as long as you keep your thoughts raised high,
as long as a rare excitement
stirs your spirit and your body.
Laistrygonians and Cyclops,
wild Poseidon – you won't encounter them
unless you bring them along inside your soul,
unless your soul sets them up in front of you.
Hope the voyage is a long one,
may there be many a summer morning when,
with what pleasure, what joy,
you come into harbours seen for the first time;
may you stop at Phoenician trading stations
to buy fine things,
mother of pearl and coral, amber and ebony,
sensual perfume of every kind –
as many sensual perfumes as you can;
and may you visit many Egyptian cities
to gather stores of knowledge from their scholars.
Keep Ithaka always in your mind.
Arriving there is what you are destined for.
But do not hurry the journey at all.
Better if it lasts for years,

so you are old by the time you reach the island,
 wealthy with all you have gained on the way,
 not expecting Ithaka to make you rich.
 Ithaka gave you the marvelous journey,
 without her you would not have set out.
 She has nothing left to give you now.
 And if you find her poor, Ithaka won't have fooled you.
 Wise as you will have become, so full of experience,
 you will have understood by then what these Ithakas mean.

Question 53

The poet recommends a long journey. Which of the following is the most comprehensive reason for it?

- A You can gain knowledge as well as sensual experience.
- B You can visit new cities and harbours.
- C You can experience the full range of sensuality.
- D You can buy a variety of fine things.

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 54

In the poem, Ithaka is a symbol of

- A the divine mother.
- B your inner self.
- C the path to wisdom.
- D life's distant goal.

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hope the journey is a long one,
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Laistrygonians and Cyclops,
angry Poseidon – you will encounter them:
you'll never find things like that on your way
as long as you keep your thoughts raised high,
as long as a rare excitement
stirs your spirit and your body.

Laistrygonians and Cyclops,
wild Poseidon – you won't encounter them
unless you bring them along inside your soul,
unless your soul sets them up in front of you.
Hope the voyage is a long one,
may there be many a summer morning when,
with what pleasure, what joy,
you come into harbours seen for the first time;

poet is wishing
the reader a good
journey to Ithaka



VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF



Question 55

Which of the following best reflects the central theme of this poem?

- A If you don't have high expectations, you will not be disappointed.
- B Don't rush to your goal; the journey is what enriches you.
- C The longer the journey the greater the experiences you gather.
- D You cannot reach Ithaka without visiting Egyptian ports.

cracku

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you come into harbours seen for the first time;

poet is wishing
the reader a good
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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 56

Which of the following best reflects the tone of the poem?

- A Prescribing.
- B Exhorting.
- C Pleading.
- D Consoling.

Question 57

What does the poet mean by 'Laistrygonians' and 'Cyclops'?

- A Creatures which, along with Poseidon, one finds during a journey.
- B Mythological characters that one should not be afraid of.
- C Intra-personal obstacles that hinder one's journey.
- D Problems that one has to face to derive the most from one's journey.

**Instructions**

Modern science, exclusive of geometry, is a comparatively recent creation and can be said to have originated with Galileo and Newton. Galileo was the first scientist to recognize clearly that the only way to further our understanding of the physical world was to resort to experiment. However obvious Galileo's contention may appear in the light of our present knowledge, it remains a fact that the Greeks, in spite of their proficiency in geometry, never seem to have realized the importance of experiment. To a certain extent this may be attributed to the crudeness of their instruments of measurement. Still an excuse of this sort can scarcely be put forward when the elementary nature of Galileo's experiments and observations is recalled. Watching a lamp oscillate in the cathedral of Pisa, dropping bodies from the leaning tower of Pisa, rolling balls down inclined planes, noticing the magnifying effect of water in a spherical glass vase, such was the nature of Galileo's experiments and observations. As can be seen, they might just as well have been performed by the Greeks. At any rate, it was thanks to such experiments that Galileo discovered the fundamental law of dynamics, according to which the acceleration imparted to a body is proportional to the force acting upon it.

The next advance was due to Newton, the greatest scientist of all time if account be taken of his joint contributions to mathematics and physics. As a physicist, he was of course an ardent adherent of the empirical method, but his greatest title to fame lies in another direction. Prior to Newton, mathematics, chiefly in the form of geometry, had been studied as a fine art without any view to its physical applications other than in very trivial cases. But with Newton all the resources of mathematics were turned to advantage in the solution of physical problems. Thenceforth mathematics appeared as an instrument of discovery, the most powerful one known to man, multiplying the power of thought just as in the mechanical domain the lever multiplied our physical action. It is this application of mathematics to the solution of physical problems, this combination of two separate fields of investigation, which constitutes the essential characteristic of the Newtonian method. Thus problems of physics were metamorphosed into problems of mathematics.

But in Newton's day the mathematical instrument was still in a very backward state of development. In this field again Newton showed the mark of genius by inventing the integral calculus. As a result of this remarkable discovery, problems, which would have baffled Archimedes, were solved with ease. We know that in Newton's hands this new departure in scientific method led to the discovery of the law of gravitation. But here again the real significance of Newton's achievement lay not so much in the exact quantitative formulation of the law of attraction, as in his having established the presence of law and order at least in one important realm of nature, namely, in the motions of heavenly bodies. Nature thus exhibited rationality and was not mere blind chaos and uncertainty. To be sure, Newton's investigations had been concerned with but a small group of natural phenomena, but it appeared unlikely that this mathematical law and order should turn out to be restricted to certain special phenomena; and the feeling was general that all the physical processes of nature would prove to be unfolding themselves according to rigorous mathematical laws.

When Einstein, in 1905, published his celebrated paper on the electrodynamics of moving bodies, he remarked that the difficulties, which surrounded the equations of electrodynamics, together with the negative experiments of Michelson and others, would be obviated if we extended the validity of the Newtonian principle of the relativity of Galilean motion, which applies solely to mechanical phenomena, so as to include all manner of phenomena: electrodynamics, optical etc. When extended in this way the Newtonian principle of relativity became Einstein's special principle of relativity. Its significance lay in its assertion that absolute Galilean motion or absolute velocity must ever escape all experimental detection. Henceforth absolute velocity should be conceived of as physically meaningless, not only in the particular realm of mechanics, as in Newton's day, but in the entire realm of physical phenomena. Einstein's special principle, by adding increased emphasis to this relativity of velocity, making absolute velocity metaphysically meaningless, created a still more profound distinction between velocity and accelerated or rotational motion. This latter type of motion remained absolute and real as before. It is most important to understand this point and to realize that Einstein's special principle is merely an extension of the validity of the classical Newtonian principle to all classes of phenomena.

Question 58

The significant implication of Einstein's special principle of relativity is that

- A absolute velocity was meaningless in the realm of mechanics.
- B Newton's principle of relativity needs to be modified.
- C there are limits to which experimentation can be used to understand some physical phenomena.
- D it is meaningless to try to understand the distinction between velocity and accelerated or rotational motion.

Modern science, exclusive of geometry, is a comparatively recent creation and can be said to have originated with Galileo and Newton. Galileo was the first scientist to recognize clearly that the only way to further our understanding of the physical world was to resort to experiment. However obvious Galileo's contention may appear in the light of our present knowledge, it remains a fact that the Greeks, in spite of their proficiency in geometry, never seem to have realized the importance of experiment. To a certain extent this may be attributed to the crudeness of the instruments of measurement. Still an excuse of this sort can scarcely be put forward when the elementary nature of Galileo's experiments and observations is recalled. Watching a lamp oscillate in the cathedral of Pisa, dropping bodies from the leaning tower of Pisa, rolling balls down inclined planes, noticing the magnifying effect of water in a spherical glass vase, such was the nature of

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 59

Which of the following statements about modern science best captures the theme of the passage?

- A Modern science rests firmly on the platform built by the Greeks.
- B We need to go back to the method of enquiry used by the Greeks to better understand the laws of dynamics.
- C Disciplines like Mathematics and Physics function best when integrated into one.
- D New knowledge about natural phenomena builds on existing knowledge.

Modern science, exclusive of geometry, is a comparatively recent creation and can be said to have originated with Galileo and Newton. Galileo was the first scientist to recognize clearly that the only way to further our understanding of the physical world was to resort to experiment. However obvious Galileo's contention may appear in the light of our present knowledge, it remains a fact that the Greeks, in spite of their proficiency in geometry, never seem to have realized the importance of experiment. To a certain extent this may be attributed to the crudeness of the instruments of measurement. Still an excuse of this sort can scarcely be put forward when the elementary nature of Galileo's experiments and observations is recalled. Watching a lamp oscillate in the cathedral of Pisa, dropping bodies from the leaning tower of Pisa, rolling balls down inclined planes, noticing the magnifying effect of water in a spherical glass vase, such was the nature of

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 60

According to the author, why did the Greeks NOT conduct experiments to understand the physical world?

- A Apparently they did not think it necessary to experiment.
- B They focused exclusively on geometry.
- C Their instruments of measurement were very crude.
- D The Greeks considered the application of geometry to the physical world more important.

Modern science, exclusive of geometry, is a comparatively recent creation and can be said to have originated with Galileo and Newton. Galileo was the first scientist to recognize clearly that the only way to further our understanding of the physical world was to resort to experiment. However obvious Galileo's contention may appear in the light of our present knowledge, it remains a fact that the Greeks, in spite of their proficiency in geometry, never seem to have realized the importance of experiment. To a certain extent this may be attributed to the crudeness of the instruments of measurement. Still an excuse of this sort can scarcely be put forward when the elementary nature of Galileo's experiments and observations is recalled. Watching a lamp oscillate in the cathedral of Pisa, dropping bodies from the leaning tower of Pisa, rolling balls down inclined planes, noticing the magnifying effect of water in a spherical glass vase, such was the nature of

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VIDEO SOLUTION



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Question 61

The statement "Nature thus exhibited rationality and was not mere blind chaos and uncertainty" suggests that

- A problems that had baffled scientists like Archimedes were not really problems.
- B only a small group of natural phenomena was chaotic.
- C physical phenomena conformed to mathematical laws.
- D natural phenomena were evolving towards a less chaotic future.

Modern science, exclusive of geometry, is a comparatively recent creation and can be said to have originated with Galileo and Newton. Galileo was the first scientist to recognize clearly that the only way to further our understanding of the physical world was to resort to experiment. However obvious Galileo's contention may appear in the light of our present knowledge, it remains a fact that the Greeks, in spite of their proficiency in geometry, never seem to have realized the importance of experiment. To a certain extent this may be attributed to the crudeness of the instruments of measurement. Still an excuse of this sort can scarcely be put forward when the elementary nature of Galileo's experiments and observations is recalled. Watching a lamp oscillate in the cathedral of Pisa, dropping bodies from the leaning tower of Pisa, rolling balls down inclined planes, noticing the magnifying effect of water in a spherical glass vase, such was the nature of

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 62

Newton may be considered one of the greatest scientists of all time because he

- A discovered the law of gravitation.
- B married physics with mathematics.
- C invented integral calculus.
- D started the use of the empirical method in science.

Modern science, exclusive of geometry, is a comparatively recent creation and can be said to have originated with Galileo and Newton. Galileo was the first scientist to recognize clearly that the only way to further our understanding of the physical world was to resort to experiment. However obvious Galileo's contention may appear in the light of our present knowledge, it remains a fact that the Greeks, in spite of their proficiency in geometry, never seem to have realized the importance of experiment. To a certain extent this may be attributed to the crudeness of the instruments of measurement. Still an excuse of this sort can scarcely be put forward when the elementary nature of Galileo's experiments and observations is recalled. Watching a lamp oscillate in the cathedral of Pisa, dropping bodies from the leaning tower of Pisa, rolling balls down inclined planes, noticing the magnifying effect of water in a spherical glass vase, such was the nature of

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The controversy over genetically modified food continues unabated in the West. Genetic modification (GM) is the science by which the genetic material of a plant is altered, perhaps to make it more resistant to pests or killer weeds, or to enhance its nutritional value. Many food biotechnologists claim that GM will be a major contribution of science to mankind in the 21st century. On the other hand, large numbers of opponents, mainly in Europe, claim that the benefits of GM are a myth propagated by multinational corporations to increase their profits, that they pose a health hazard, and have therefore called for government to ban the sale of genetically-modified food.

The anti-GM campaign has been quite effective in Europe, with several European Union member countries imposing a virtual ban for five years over genetically-modified food imports. Since the genetically-modified food industry is particularly strong in the United States of America, the controversy also constitutes another chapter in the US-Europe skirmishes which have become particularly acerbic after the US invasion of Iraq.

To a large extent, the GM controversy has been ignored in the Indian media, although Indian biotechnologists have been quite active in GM research. Several groups of Indian biotechnologists have been working on various issues connected with crops grown in India. One concrete achievement which has recently figured in the news is that of a team led by the former vice-chancellor of Jawaharlal Nehru university, Asis Datta — it has successfully added an extra gene to potatoes to enhance the protein content of the tuber by at least 30 percent. It is quite likely that the GM controversy will soon hit the headlines in India since a spokesperson of the Indian Central government has recently announced that the government may use the protato in its midday meal programme for schools as early as next year.

Why should “scientific progress”, with huge potential benefits to the poor and malnourished, be so controversial? The anti-GM lobby contends that pernicious propaganda has vastly exaggerated the benefits of GM and completely evaded the costs which will have to be incurred if the genetically-modified food industry is allowed to grow unchecked. In particular, they allude to different types of costs.

This group contends that the most important potential cost is that the widespread distribution and growth of genetically-modified food will enable the corporate world (alias the multinational corporations – MNCs) to completely capture the food chain. A “small” group of biotech companies will patent the transferred genes as well as the technology associated with them. They will then buy up the competing seed merchants and seed-breeding centers, thereby controlling the production of food at every possible level. Independent farmers, big and small, will be completely wiped out of the food industry. At best, they will be reduced to the status of being subcontractors.

This line of argument goes on to claim that the control of the food chain will be disastrous for the poor since the MNCs, guided by the profit motive, will only focus on the high-value food items demanded by the affluent. Thus, in the long run, the production of basic staples which constitute the food basket of the poor will taper off. However, this vastly overestimates the power of the MNCs. Even if the research promoted by them does focus on the high-value food items, much of biotechnology research is also funded by governments in both developing and developed countries. Indeed, the potato is a by-product of this type of research. If the potato passes the field trials, there is no reason to believe that it cannot be marketed in the global potato market. And this type of success story can be repeated with other basic food items.

The second type of cost associated with the genetically modified food industry is environmental damage. The most common type of “genetic engineering” involved gene modification in plants designed to make them resistant to applications of weed-killers. This then enables farmers to use massive dosages of weedkillers so as to destroy or wipe out all competing varieties of plants in their field. However, some weeds through genetically-modified pollen contamination may acquire resistance to a variety of weed-killers. The only way to destroy these weeds is through the use of ever-stronger herbicides which are poisonous and linger on in the environment.

Question 63

According to the passage, biotechnology research

- A** is of utility only for high value food items.
- B** is funded only by multinational corporations.
- C** allows multinational corporations to control the food basket of the poor.
- D** addresses the concerns of developed and developing countries.

The controversy over genetically modified food continues unabated in the West. Genetic modification (GM) is the science by which the genetic material of a plant is altered, perhaps to make it more resistant to pests or killer weeds, or to enhance its nutritional value. Many food biotechnologists claim that GM will be a major contribution of science to mankind in the 21st century. On the other hand, large numbers of opponents, mainly in Europe, claim that the benefits of GM are a myth propagated by multinational corporations to increase their profits, that they pose a health hazard, and have therefore called for government to ban the sale of genetically-modified food.

The anti-GM campaign has been quite effective in Europe, with several European Union member countries imposing a virtual ban for five years over genetically-modified food imports. Since the genetically-modified food industry is particularly

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Question 64

Genetic modification makes plants more resistant to killer weeds. However, this can lead to environmental damage by

- A wiping out competing varieties of plants which now fall prey to killer weeds.
- B forcing application of stronger herbicides to kill weeds which have become resistant to weak herbicides.
- C forcing application of stronger herbicides to keep the competing plants weed-free.
- D not allowing growth of any weeds, thus reducing soil fertility.

The controversy over genetically modified food continues unabated in the West. Genetic modification (GM) is the science by which the genetic material of a plant is altered, perhaps to make it more resistant to pests or killer weeds, or to enhance its nutritional value. Many food biotechnologists claim that GM will be a major contribution of science to mankind in the 21st century. On the other hand, large numbers of opponents, mainly in Europe, claim that the benefits of GM are a myth propagated by multinational corporations to increase their profits, that they pose a health hazard, and have therefore called for government to ban the sale of genetically-modified food.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 65

Using the clues in the passage, which of the following countries would you expect to be in the forefront of the anti-GM campaign?

- A USA and Spain.
- B India and Iraq.

- C Germany and France.
- D Australia and New Zealand.

The controversy over genetically modified food continues unabated in the West. Genetic modification (GM) is the science by which the genetic material of a plant is altered, perhaps to make it more resistant to pests or killer weeds, or to enhance its nutritional value. Many food biotechnologists claim that GM will be a major contribution of science to mankind in the 21st century. On the other hand, large numbers of opponents, mainly in Europe, claim that the benefits of GM are a myth propagated by multinational corporations to increase their profits, that they pose a health hazard, and have therefore called for government to ban the sale of genetically-modified food.

The anti-GM campaign has been quite effective in Europe, with several European Union member countries imposing a virtual ban for five years over genetically-modified food imports. Since the genetically-modified food industry is particularly

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 66

The author doubts the anti-GM lobby's contention that MNC control of the food chain will be disastrous for the poor because

- A MNCs will focus on high-value food items.
- B MNCs are driven by the motive of profit maximization.
- C MNCs are not the only group of actors in genetically-modified food research.
- D Economic development will help the poor buy MNC-produced food.

The controversy over genetically modified food continues unabated in the West. Genetic modification (GM) is the science by which the genetic material of a plant is altered, perhaps to make it more resistant to pests or killer weeds, or to enhance its nutritional value. Many food biotechnologists claim that GM will be a major contribution of science to mankind in the 21st century. On the other hand, large numbers of opponents, mainly in Europe, claim that the benefits of GM are a myth propagated by multinational corporations to increase their profits, that they pose a health hazard, and have therefore called for government to ban the sale of genetically-modified food.

The anti-GM campaign has been quite effective in Europe, with several European Union member countries imposing a virtual ban for five years over genetically-modified food imports. Since the genetically-modified food industry is particularly

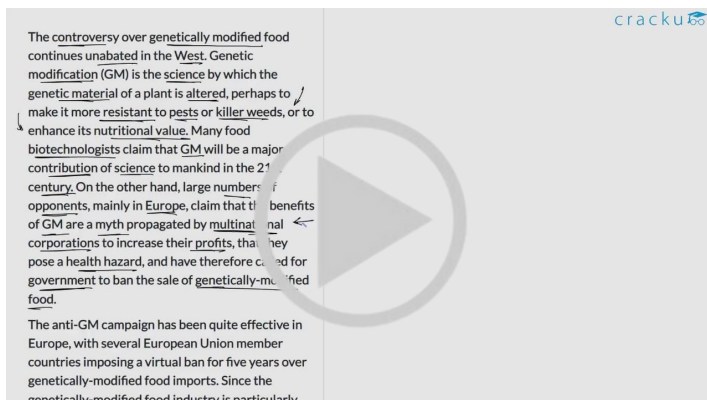
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Question 67

Which of the following about the Indian media's coverage of scientific research does the passage seem to suggest?

- A Indian media generally covers a subject of scientific importance when its mass application is likely.
- B Indian media's coverage of scientific research is generally dependent on MNCs interests.
- C Indian media, in partnership with the government, is actively involved in publicizing the results of scientific research.
- D Indian media only highlights scientific research which is funded by the government.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Right through history, imperial powers have clung to their possessions to death. Why, then, did Britain in 1947 give up the jewel in its crown, India? For many reasons. The independence struggle exposed the hollowness of the white man's burden. Provincial self-rule since 1935 paved the way for full self-rule. Churchill resisted independence, but the Labour government of Atlee was anti-imperialist by ideology. Finally, the Royal Indian Navy mutiny in 1946 raised fears of a second Sepoy mutiny, and convinced British waverers that it was safer to withdraw gracefully. But politico-military explanations are not enough. The basis of empire was always money. The end of empire had much to do with the fact that British imperialism had ceased to be profitable. World War II left Britain victorious but deeply indebted, needing Marshall Aid and loans from the World Bank. This constituted a strong financial case for ending the no-longer profitable empire.

Empire building is expensive. The US is spending one billion dollars a day in operations in Iraq that fall well short of full scale imperialism. Through the centuries, empire building was costly, yet constantly undertaken because it promised high returns. The investment was in armies and conquest. The returns came through plunder and taxes from the conquered.

No immorality was attached to imperial loot and plunder. The biggest conquerors were typically revered (hence titles like Alexander the Great, Akbar the Great, and Peter the Great). The bigger and richer the empire, the more the plunderer was admired. This mindset gradually changed with the rise of new ideas about equality and governing for the public good, ideas that culminated in the French and American revolutions.

Robert Clive was impeached for making a little money on the side, and so was Warren Hastings. The white man's burden came up as a new moral rationale for conquest. It was supposedly for the good of the conquered. This led to much muddled hypocrisy. On the one hand, the empire needed to be profitable. On the other hand, the white man's burden made brazen loot impossible.

An additional factor deterring loot was the 1857 Sepoy Mutiny. Though crushed, it reminded the British vividly that they were a tiny ethnic group who could not rule a gigantic subcontinent without the support of important locals. After 1857, the British stopped annexing one princely state after another, and instead treated the princes as allies. Land revenue was fixed in absolute terms, partly to prevent local unrest and partly to promote the notion of the white man's burden. The empire proclaimed itself to be a protector of the Indian peasant against exploitation by Indian elites. This was denounced as hypocrisy by nationalists like Dadabhoi Naoroji in the 19th century, who complained that land taxes led to an enormous drain from India to Britain. Objective calculations

by historians like Angus Maddison suggest a drain of perhaps 1.6 percent of Indian Gross National Product in the 19th century. But land revenue was more or less fixed by the Raj in absolute terms, and so its real value diminished rapidly with inflation in the 20th century. By World War II, India had ceased to be a profit center for the British Empire.

Historically, conquered nations paid taxes to finance fresh wars of the conqueror. India itself was asked to pay a large sum at the end of World War I to help repair Britain's finances. But, as shown by historian Indivar Kamtekar, the independence movement led by Gandhiji changed the political landscape, and made mass taxation of India increasingly difficult. By World War II, this had become politically impossible. Far from taxing India to pay for World War II, Britain actually began paying India for its contribution of men and goods. Troops from white dominions like Australia; Canada and New Zealand were paid for entirely by these countries, but Indian costs were shared by the British government. Britain paid in the form of nonconvertible sterling balances, which mounted swiftly. The conqueror was paying the conquered, undercutting the profitability on which all empire is founded. Churchill opposed this, and wanted to tax India rather than owe it money. But he was overruled by Indian hands who said India would resist payment, and paralyze the war effort. Leo Amery, Secretary of State for India, said that when you are driving in a taxi to the station to catch a life-or-death train, you do not loudly announce that you have doubts whether to pay the fare. Thus, World War II converted India from a debtor to a creditor with over one billion pounds in sterling balances. Britain, meanwhile, became the biggest debtor in the world. It's not worth ruling over people you are afraid to tax.

Question 68

Which one of the following best expresses the main purpose of the author?

- A To present the various reasons that can lead to the collapse of an empire and the granting of independence of the subjects of an empire.
- B To point out the critical role played by the 'white man's burden' in making a colonizing power give up its claims to native possessions.
- C To highlight the contradictory impulse underpinning empire building which is a costly business but very attractive at the same time.
- D To illustrate how erosion of the financial basis of an empire supports the granting of independence to an empire's constituents.

Right through history, imperial powers have clung to their possessions to death. Why, then, did Britain in 1947 give up the jewel in its crown, India? For many reasons. The independence struggle exposed the hollowness of the white man's burden. Provincial self-rule since 1935 paved the way for full self-rule. Churchill resisted independence but the Labour government of Atlee was anti-imperialist by ideology. Finally, the Royal Indian Navy mutiny in 1946 raised fears of a second Sepoy mutiny, and convinced British waverers that it was safer to withdraw gracefully. But politico-military explanations are not enough. The basis of empire was always money. The end of empire had much to do with the fact that British imperialism had ceased to be profitable. World War II left Britain victorious but deeply indebted, needing Marshall Aid and loans from the World Bank. This constituted a strong financial case for ending the no-longer profitable empire.

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 69

Which of the following best captures the meaning of the 'white man's burden', as it is used by the author?

- A The British claim to a civilizing mission directed at ensuring the good of the natives.
- B The inspiration for the French and American revolutions.

- C The resource drain that had to be borne by the home country's white population.
- D An imperative that made open looting of resources impossible.

Right through history, imperial powers have clung to their possessions to death. Why, then, did Britain in 1947 give up the jewel in its crown, India? For many reasons. The independence struggle exposed the hollowness of the white man's burden. Provincial self-rule since 1935 paved the way for full self-rule. Churchill resisted independence but the Labour government of Atlee was anti-imperialist by ideology. Finally, the Royal Indian Navy mutiny in 1946 raised fears of a second Sepoy mutiny, and convinced British waverers that it was safer to withdraw gracefully. But politico-military explanations are not enough. The basis of empire was always money. The end of empire had much to do with the fact that British imperialism had ceased to be profitable. World War II left Britain victorious but deeply indebted, needing Marshall Aid and loans from the World Bank. This constituted a strong financial case for ending the no-longer profitable empire.

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Question 70

Why didn't Britain tax India to finance its World War II efforts?

- A Australia, Canada and New Zealand had offered to pay for Indian troops.
- B India has already paid a sufficiently large sum during World War I.
- C It was afraid that if India refused to pay, Britain's war efforts would be jeopardized.
- D The British empire was built on the premise that the conqueror pays the conquered.

Right through history, imperial powers have clung to their possessions to death. Why, then, did Britain in 1947 give up the jewel in its crown, India? For many reasons. The independence struggle exposed the hollowness of the white man's burden. Provincial self-rule since 1935 paved the way for full self-rule. Churchill resisted independence but the Labour government of Atlee was anti-imperialist by ideology. Finally, the Royal Indian Navy mutiny in 1946 raised fears of a second Sepoy mutiny, and convinced British waverers that it was safer to withdraw gracefully. But politico-military explanations are not enough. The basis of empire was always money. The end of empire had much to do with the fact that British imperialism had ceased to be profitable. World War II left Britain victorious but deeply indebted, needing Marshall Aid and loans from the World Bank. This constituted a strong financial case for ending the no-longer profitable empire.

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 71

What was the main lesson the British learned from the Sepoy Mutiny of 1857.

- A That the local princes were allies, not foes.
- B That the land revenue from India would decline dramatically.

- C That the British were a small ethnic group.
- D That India would be increasingly difficult to rule.

Right through history, imperial powers have clung to their possessions to death. Why, then, did Britain in 1947 give up the jewel in its crown, India? For many reasons. The independence struggle exposed the hollowness of the white man's burden. Provincial self-rule since 1935 paved the way for full self-rule. Churchill resisted independence but the Labour government of Atlee was anti-imperialist by ideology. Finally, the Royal Indian Navy mutiny in 1946 raised fears of a second Sepoy mutiny, and convinced British waverers that it was safer to withdraw gracefully. But politico-military explanations are not enough. The basis of empire was always money. The end of empire had much to do with the fact that British imperialism had ceased to be profitable. World War II left Britain victorious but deeply indebted, needing Marshall Aid and loans from the World Bank. This constituted a strong financial case for ending the no-longer profitable empire.



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 72

Which of the following was NOT a reason for the emergence of the 'white man's burden' as a new rationale for empire-building in India?

- A The emergence of the idea of the public good as an element of governance.
- B The decreasing returns from imperial loot and increasing costs of conquest.
- C The weakening of the immorality attached to an emperor's looting behaviour.
- D A growing awareness of the idea of equality among peoples.

 VIEW SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



Instructions

At the heart of the enormous boom in wine consumption that has taken place in the English-speaking world over the last two decades or so is a fascinating, happy paradox. In the days when wine was exclusively the preserve of a narrow cultural elite, bought either at auctions or from gentleman wine merchants in wing collars and bow-ties, to be stored in rambling cellars and decanted to order by one's butler, the ordinary drinker didn't get a look-in. Wine was considered a highly technical subject, in which anybody without the necessary ability could only fall flat on his or her face in embarrassment. It wasn't just that you needed a refined aesthetic sensibility for the stuff if it wasn't to be hopelessly wasted on you. It required an intimate knowledge of what came from where, and what it was supposed to taste like.

Those were times, however, when wine appreciation essentially meant a familiarity with the great French classics, with perhaps a smattering of other wines – like sherry and port. That was what the wine trade dealt in. These days, wine is bought daily in supermarkets and high-street chains to be consumed that evening, hardly anybody has a cellar to store it in and most don't even possess a decanter. Above all, the wines of literally dozens of countries are available on our market. When a supermarket offers its customers a couple of fruity little numbers from Brazil, we scarcely raise an eyebrow.

It seems, in other words, that the commercial jungle that wine has now become has not in the slightest deterred people from plunging adventurously into the thickets in order to taste and see. Consumers are no longer intimidated by the thought of needing to know their Pouilly-Fume from their Pouilly-Fuisse, just at the very moment when there is more to know than ever before.

The reason for this new mood of confidence is not hard to find. It is on every wine label from Australia, New Zealand, South Africa and the United States: the name of the grape from which the wine is made. At one time, that might have sounded like a fairly technical approach in itself. Why should native English-speakers know what Cabernet Sauvignon or Chardonnay were? The answer lies in the popularity that wines made from those grape varieties now enjoy. Consumers effectively recognize them as brand names, and have acquired a basic lexicon of wine that can serve them even when confronted with those Brazilian upstarts.

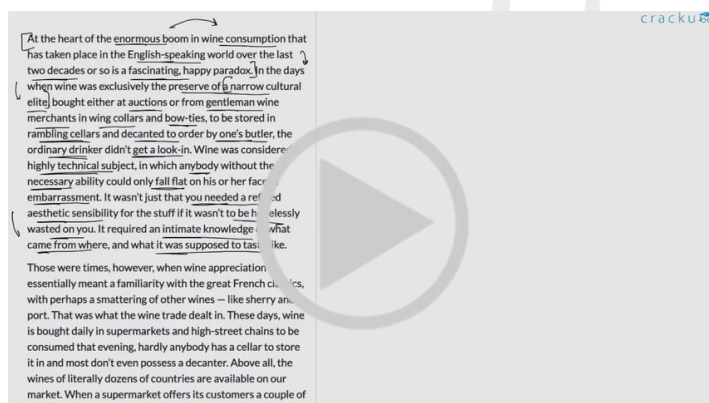
In the wine heartlands of France, they are scared to death of that trend—not because they think their wine isn't as good as the best from California or South Australia (what French winemaker will ever admit that?) but because they don't traditionally call their wines Cabernet Sauvignon or Chardonnay. They call them Chateau Ducru Beaucaillou or Corton-Charlemagne, and they aren't about to change. Some areas, in the middle of southern France, have now produced a generation of growers using the varietal names on their labels and are tempting consumers back to French wine. It will be an uphill struggle, but there is probably no other way if France is to avoid simply becoming a specialty source of old-fashioned wines for old-fashioned connoisseurs.

Wine consumption was also given a significant boost in the early 1990s by the work of Dr. Serge Renaud, who has spent many years investigating the reasons for the uncannily low incidence of coronary heart disease in the south of France. One of his major findings is that the fat-derived cholesterol that builds up in the arteries and can eventually lead to heart trouble, can be dispersed by the tannins in wine. Tannin is derived from the skins of grapes, and is therefore present in higher levels in red wines, because they have to be infused with their skins to attain the red colour. That news caused a huge upsurge in red wine consumption in the United States. It has not been accorded the prominence it deserves in the UK, largely because the medical profession still sees all alcohol as a menace to health, and is constantly calling for it to be made prohibitively expensive. Certainly, the manufacturers of anticoagulant drugs might have something to lose if we all got the message that we would do just as well by our hearts by taking half a bottle of red wine every day!

Question 73

The development which has created fear among winemakers in the wine heartland of France is the

- A tendency not to name wines after the grape varieties that are used in the wines
- B 'education' that consumers have derived from wine labels from English speaking countries.
- C new generation of local winegrowers who use labels that show names of grape varieties
- D ability of consumers to understand a wine's qualities when confronted with "Brazilian upstarts".



The screenshot shows a video player interface with a transcript on the left and a video frame on the right. The transcript text is as follows:

At the heart of the enormous boom in wine consumption that has taken place in the English-speaking world over the last two decades or so is a fascinating, happy paradox. In the days when wine was exclusively the preserve of a narrow cultural elite, bought either at auctions or from gentleman wine merchants in wing collars and bow-ties, to be stored in rambling cellars and decanted to order by one's butler, the ordinary drinker didn't get a look-in. Wine was considered a highly technical subject, in which anybody without the necessary ability could only fall flat on his or her face in embarrassment. It wasn't just that you needed a refined aesthetic sensibility for the stuff if it wasn't to be hopelessly wasted on you. It required an intimate knowledge of what came from where, and what it was supposed to taste like.

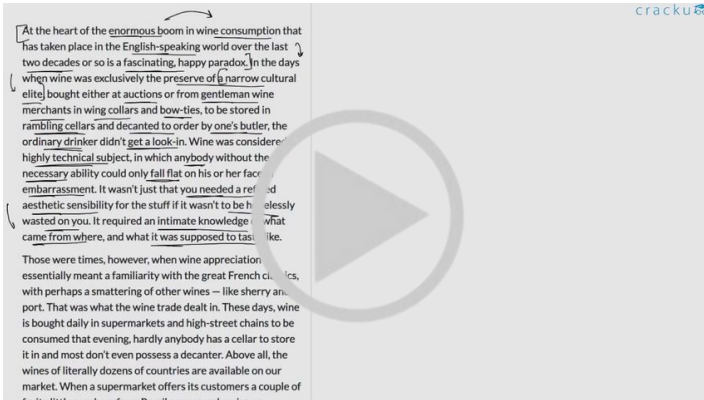
Those were times, however, when wine appreciation essentially meant a familiarity with the great French classics, with perhaps a smattering of other wines — like sherry and port. That was what the wine trade dealt in. These days, wine is bought daily in supermarkets and high-street chains to be consumed that evening, hardly anybody has a cellar to store it in and most don't even possess a decanter. Above all, the wines of literally dozens of countries are available on our market. When a supermarket offers its customers a couple of

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 74

Which one of the following CANNOT be reasonably attributed to the labeling strategy followed by wine producers in English speaking countries?

- A Consumers buy wines on the basis of their familiarity with a grape variety's name.
- B Even ordinary customers now have more access to technical knowledge about wine.
- C Consumers are able to appreciate better quality wines.
- D Some non-English speaking countries like Brazil indicate grape variety names on their labels.

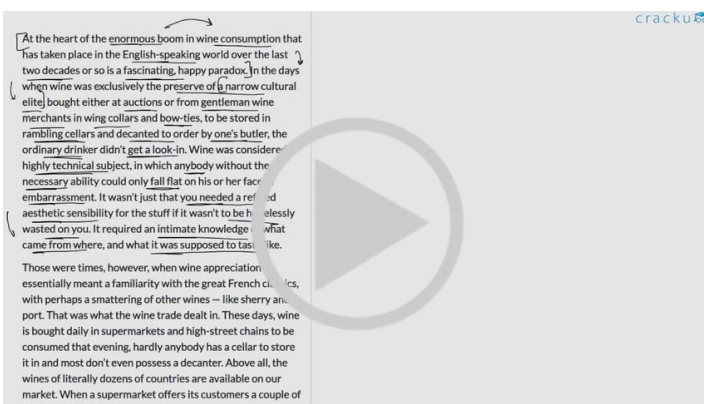


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 75

The tone that the author uses while asking “what French winemaker will ever admit that?” is best described as

- A caustic
- B satirical
- C critical
- D hypocritical



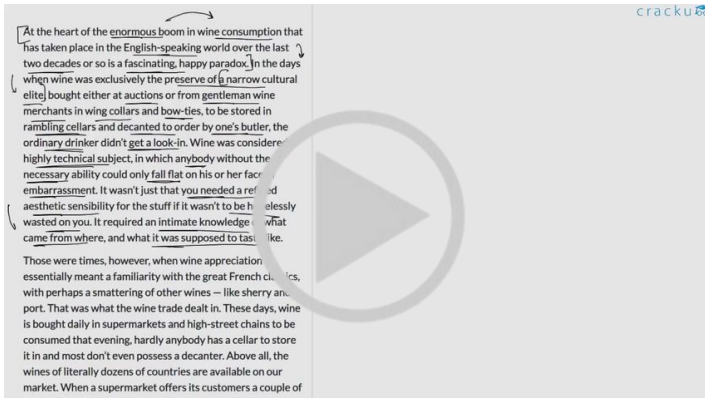
VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 76

Which one of the following, if true, would provide most support for Dr. Renaud's findings about the effect of tannins?

- A A survey showed that film celebrities based in France have a low incidence of coronary heart disease.
- B Measurements carried out in southern France showed red wine drinkers had significantly higher levels of coronary heart incidence than white wine drinkers did.
- C Data showed a positive association between sales of red wine and incidence of coronary heart disease.
- D Long-term surveys in southern France showed that the incidence of coronary heart disease was significantly lower in red wine drinkers than in those who did not drink red wine.

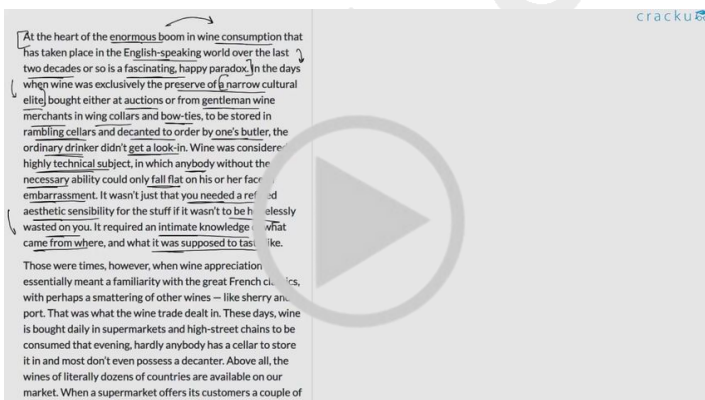


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 77

What according to the author should the French do to avoid becoming a producer of merely old fashioned wines?

- A Follow the labeling strategy of the English-speaking countries
- B Give their wines English names
- C Introduce fruity wines as Brazil has done
- D Produce the wines that have become popular in the English-speaking world



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The teaching and transmission of North Indian classical music is, and long has been, achieved by largely oral means. The raga and its structure, the often breathtaking intricacies of talc, or rhythm, and the incarnation of raga and tala as bandish or composition, are passed thus, between guru and shishya by word of mouth and direct demonstration, with no printed sheet of notated music, as it were, acting as a go-between. Saussure's conception of language as a communication between addresser and addressee is given, in this model, a further instance, and a new, exotic complexity and glamour.

These days, especially with the middle class having entered the domain of classical music and playing not a small part ensuring the continuation of this ancient tradition, the tape recorder serves as a handy technological slave and preserves, from oblivion, the vanishing, elusive moment of oral transmission. Hoary gurus, too, have seen the advantage of this device, and increasingly use it as an aid to instructing their pupils; in place of the shawls and other traditional objects that used to pass from shishya to guru in the past, as a token of the regard of the former for the latter, it is not unusual, today, to see cassettes changing hands.

Part of my education in North Indian classical music was conducted via this rather ugly but beneficial rectangle of plastic, which I carried with me to England when I was a undergraduate. Once cassette had stored in it various talas played upon the tabla, at various tempos, by my music teacher's brother-in law, Hazarilalii, who was a teacher of Kathak dance, as well as a singer and a tabla player. This was a work of great patience and prescience, a one-and-a-half hour performance without my immediate point or purpose, but intended for some delayed future moment when I'd practise the talas solitarily.

This repeated playing out of the rhythmic cycles on the tabla was inflected by the noises—an hate auto driver blowing a horn; the sound of overbearing pigeons that were such a nuisance on the banister; even the cry of a kulfi seller in summer—entering from the balcony of the third floor flat we occupied in those days, in a lane in a Bombay suburb, before we left the city for good. These sounds, in turn, would invade, hesitantly, the ebb and flow of silence inside the artificially heated room, in a borough of West London, in which I used to live as an undergraduate. There, in the trapped dust, silence and heat, the theka of the tabla, qualified by the imminent but intermittent presence of the Bombay suburb, would come to life again. A few years later, the tabla and, in the background, the pigeons and the itinerant kulfi seller, would inhabit a small graduate room in Oxford.

The tape recorder, though, remains an extension of the oral transmission of music, rather than a replacement of it. And the oral transmission of North Indian classical music remains, almost uniquely, testament to the fact that the human brain can absorb, remember and reproduces structures of great complexity and sophistication without the help of the hieroglyph or written mark or a system of notation. I remember my surprise on discovering the Hazarilaji— who had mastered Kathak dance, tala and North Indian classical music, and who used to narrate to me, occasionally, compositions meant for dance that were grand and intricate in their verbal prosody, architecture and rhythmic complexity— who had barely learnt to write his name in large and clumsy letters.

Of course, attempts have been made, throughout the 20th century, to formally codify and even notate this music, and institutions set up and degrees created, specifically to educate students in this “scientific” and codified manner. Paradoxically, however, this style of teaching has produced no noteworthy student or performer; the most creative musicians still emerge from the guru-shishya relationship, their understanding of music developed by oral communication.

The fact that North Indian classical music emanates from, and has evolved through, oral culture, means that this music has a significantly different aesthetic, and that this aesthetic has a different politics, from that of Western classical music. A piece of music in the Western tradition, at least in its most characteristic and popular conception, originates in its composer, and the connection between the two, between composer and the piece of music, is relatively unambiguous precisely because the composer writes down, in notation, his composition, as a poet might write down and publish his poem. However far the printed sheet of notated music might travel thus from the composer, it still remains his property; and the notion of property remains at the heart of the Western conception of “genius”, which derives from the Latin *gignere* or ‘to beget’.

The genius in Western classical music is, then, the originator, begetter and owner of his work the printed, notated sheet testifying to his authority over his product and his power, not only of expression or imagination, but of origination. The conductor is a custodian and guardian of this property. Is it an accident that

Mandelstam, in his notebooks, compares — celebratorily—the conductor's baton to a policeman's, saying all the music of the orchestra lies mute within it, waiting for its first movement to release it into the auditorium?

The raga — transmitted through oral means — is, in a sense, no one's property; it is not easy to pin down its source, or to know exactly where its provenance or origin lies. Unlike the Western classical tradition, where the composer begets his piece, notates it and stamps it with his ownership and remains, in effect, larger than, or the father of, his work, in the North India classical tradition, the raga — unconfined to a single incarnation, composer or performer — remains necessarily greater than the artiste who invokes it.

This leads to a very different politics of interpretation and valuation, to an aesthetic that privileges the evanescent moment of performance and invocation over the controlling authority of genius and the permanent record. It is a tradition, thus, that would appear to value the performer, as medium, more highly than the composer who presumes to originate what, effectively, cannot be originated in a single person — because the raga is the inheritance of a culture.

Question 78

According to the passage, in the North Indian classical tradition, the raga remains greater than the artiste who invokes it. This implies an aesthetic which:

- A emphasises performance and invocation over the authority of genius and permanent record.
- B makes the music no one's property.
- C values the composer more highly than the performer.
- D supports oral transmission of traditional music)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

The banner features two individuals on the left, the text 'IIM Call Predictor' in large white font, a subtext 'Accurate analysis of your profile' in a yellow box, and a bar chart icon on the right.

Question 79

From the author's explanation of the notion that in the Western tradition, music originates in its composer, which one of the following cannot be inferred?

- A It is easy to transfer a piece of Western classical music to a distant place.
- B The conductor in the Western tradition, as a custodian, can modify the music, since it 'lies mute' in his baton.
- C The authority of the Western classical music composer over his music product is unambiguous.
- D The power of the Western classical music composer extends to the expression of his music)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 80

The author holds that the "rather ugly but beneficial rectangle of plastic" has proved to be a "hand technological slave" in:

- A storing the tala played upon the tabla, at various tempos.
- B ensuring the continuance of an ancient tradition.
- C transporting North Indian classical music across geographical borders.

- D capturing the transient moment of oral transmission.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 81

Saussure's conception of language as a communication between addresser and addressee, according to the author, is exemplified by the:

- A teaching of North Indian classical music by word of mouth and direct demonstration.
- B use of the recorded cassette as a transmission medium between the music teacher and the trainee.
- C written down notation sheets of musical compositions.
- D conductor's baton and the orchestra)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

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Question 82

Which of the following statements best conveys the overall idea of the passage?

- A North Indian and Western classical music are structurally different.
- B Western music is. the intellectual property of the genius while the North Indian raga is the inheritance of a culture.
- C Creation as well as performance are important in the North Indian classical tradition.
- D North Indian classical music is orally transmitted while Western classical music depends on written down notations.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 83

The oral transmission of North Indian classical music is an almost unique testament of the:

- A efficacy of the guru-shishya tradition.
- B learning impact of direct demonstration.
- C brain's ability to reproduce complex structures without the help of written marks.
- D the ability of an illiterate person to narrate grand and intricate musical compositions.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 84

According to the author, the inadequacy of teaching North Indian classical music through a codified, notation based system is best illustrated by:

- A a loss of the structural beauty of the ragas.
- B a fusion of two opposing approaches creating mundane music
- C c) the conversion of free-flowing ragas into stilted set pieces.
- D its failure to produce any noteworthy

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 85

The author's contention that the notion of property lies at the heart of the Western conception of genius is best indicated by which one of the following?

- A The creative output of a genius is invariably written down and recorded.
- B The link between the creator and his output is unambiguous.
- C The word "genius" is derived from a Latin word which means "to beget".
- D The music composer notates his music and thus becomes the "father" of a particular piece of music)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

[Octopuses are] misfits in their own extended families . . . They belong to the Mollusca class Cephalopoda. But they don't look like their cousins at all. Other molluscs include sea snails, sea slugs, bivalves - most are shelled invertebrates with a dorsal foot. Cephalopods are all arms, and can be as tiny as 1 centimetre and as large at 30 feet. Some of them have brains the size of a walnut, which is large for an invertebrate. . . .

It makes sense for these molluscs to have added protection in the form of a higher cognition; they don't have a shell covering them, and pretty much everything feeds on cephalopods, including humans. But how did cephalopods manage to secure their own invisibility cloak? Cephalopods fire from multiple cylinders to achieve this in varying degrees from species to species. There are four main catalysts - chromatophores, iridophores, papillae and leucophores. . . .

[Chromatophores] are organs on their bodies that contain pigment sacs, which have red, yellow and brown pigment granules. These sacs have a network of radial muscles, meaning muscles arranged in a circle radiating outwards. These are connected to the brain by a nerve. When the cephalopod wants to change colour, the brain carries an electrical impulse through the nerve to the muscles that expand outwards, pulling open the sacs to display the colours on the skin. Why these three colours? Because these are the colours the light reflects at the depths they live in (the rest is absorbed before it reaches those depths). . . .

Well, what about other colours? Cue the iridophores. Think of a second level of skin that has thin stacks of cells. These can reflect light back at different wavelengths. . . . It's using the same properties that we've seen in hologram stickers, or rainbows on puddles of oil. You move your head and you see a different colour. The sticker isn't doing anything but reflecting light - it's your movement that's changing the appearance of the colour. This property of holograms, oil and other such surfaces is called "iridescence". . . .

Papillae are sections of the skin that can be deformed to make a texture bumpy. Even humans possess them (goosebumps) but cannot use them in the manner that cephalopods can. For instance, the use of these cells is how an octopus can wrap itself over a rock and appear jagged or how a squid or cuttlefish can imitate the look of a coral reef by growing miniature towers on its skin. It actually matches the texture of the substrate it chooses.

Finally, the leucophores: According to a paper, published in Nature, cuttlefish and octopuses possess an additional type of reflector cell called a leucophore. They are cells that scatter full spectrum light so that they appear white in a similar way that a polar bear's fur appears white. Leucophores will also reflect any filtered light shown on them . . . If the water appears blue at a certain depth, the octopuses and cuttlefish can appear blue; if the water appears green, they appear green, and so on and so forth.

Question 86

Based on the passage, we can infer that all of the following statements, if true, would weaken the camouflaging adeptness of Cephalopods EXCEPT:

- A the number of chromatophores in Cephalopods is half the number of iridophores and leucophores.
- B the temperature of water at the depths at which Cephalopods reside renders the transmission of neural signals difficult.
- C light reflects the colours red, green, and yellow at the depths at which Cephalopods reside.
- D the hydrostatic pressure at the depths at which Cephalopods reside renders radial muscle movements difficult.

Invertebrates with a dorsal foot. Cephalopods are all arms, and can be as tiny as 1 centimetre and as large as 30 feet. Some of them have brains the size of a walnut, which is large for an invertebrate. . . .

It makes sense for these molluscs to have added protection in the form of a higher cognition; they don't have a shell covering them, and pretty much everything feeds on cephalopods, including humans. But how did cephalopods manage to secure their own invisibility cloak? Cephalopods fire from multiple cylinders to achieve this in varying degrees from species to species. There are four main catalysts - chromatophores, iridophores, papillae and leucophores. . . .

[Chromatophores] are organs on their bodies that contain pigment sacs, which have red, yellow and brown pigment granules. These sacs have a network of radial muscles, meaning muscles arranged in a circle radiating outwards. These are connected to the brain by a nerve. When the cephalopod wants to change colour, the brain carries an electrical impulse through the nerve to the muscles that expand outwards, pulling open the sacs to display the colours on the skin. Why these three colours? Because these are the colours the light reflects at the depths they live in (the rest is absorbed before it reaches those depths). . . .

Well, what about other colours? Cue the iridophores. Think of a thin level of skin that has thin stacks of cells. These can reflect light back at different wavelengths. . . . It's using the same properties that we've seen in hologram stickers, or rainbows on puddles of oil. You move your head and you see a different colour. The sticker isn't doing anything but reflecting light - it's your movement that's changing the appearance of the colour. This property of holograms, oil and other such surfaces is called "iridescence". . . .

Papillae are sections of the skin that can be deformed to make a texture

→ Cephalopods (Octopus) also come under other molluscs

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 87

All of the following are reasons for octopuses being "misfits" EXCEPT that they:

- A are consumed by humans and other animals.
- B do not possess an outer protective shell.
- C exhibit higher intelligence than other molluscs.
- D have several arms

invertebrates with a dorsal foot. Cephalopods are all arms, and can be as tiny as 1 centimetre and as large as 30 feet. Some of them have brains the size of a walnut, which is large for an invertebrate....

It makes sense for these molluscs to have added protection in the form of a higher cognition; they don't have a shell covering them, and pretty much everything feeds on cephalopods, including humans. But how did cephalopods manage to secure their own invisibility cloak? Cephalopods fire from multiple cylinders to achieve this in varying degrees from species to species. There are four main catalysts - chromatophores, iridophores, papillae and leucophores....

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Papillae are sections of the skin that can be deformed to make a texture

→ Cephalopods (Octopus) are *cracku* *cracku*
other molluscs
→

VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 88

Based on the passage, it can be inferred that camouflaging techniques in an octopus are most dissimilar to those in:

- A sea snails
- B cuttlefish
- C polar bears
- D squids

invertebrates with a dorsal foot. Cephalopods are all arms, and can be as tiny as 1 centimetre and as large as 30 feet. Some of them have brains the size of a walnut, which is large for an invertebrate....

It makes sense for these molluscs to have added protection in the form of a higher cognition; they don't have a shell covering them, and pretty much everything feeds on cephalopods, including humans. But how did cephalopods manage to secure their own invisibility cloak? Cephalopods fire from multiple cylinders to achieve this in varying degrees from species to species. There are four main catalysts - chromatophores, iridophores, papillae and leucophores....

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Papillae are sections of the skin that can be deformed to make a texture

→ Cephalopods (Octopus) are *cracku* *cracku*
other molluscs
→

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 89

Which one of the following statements is not true about the camouflaging ability of Cephalopods?

- A Cephalopods can blend into the colour of their surroundings.
- B Cephalopods can change their texture.
- C Cephalopods can change their colour.

D Cephalopods can take on the colour of their predator.

invertebrates with a dorsal foot. Cephalopods are all arms, and can be as tiny as 1 centimetre and as large as 30 feet. Some of them have brains the size of a walnut, which is large for an invertebrate. ...

It makes sense for these molluscs to have added protection in the form of a higher cognition; they don't have a shell covering them, and pretty much everything feeds on cephalopods, including humans. But how did cephalopods manage to secure their own invisibility cloak? Cephalopods fire from multiple cylinders to achieve this in varying degrees from species to species. There are four main catalysts - chromatophores, iridophores, papillae and leucophores. ...

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Papillae are sections of the skin that can be deformed to make a texture

→ Cephalopods (Octopus) are chromatic u. too
other molluscs

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Of each of the great leaders, it is said by his followers, long after he is gone, he made us do it. If leadership is the art of persuading your people to follow your bidding, without their realising your involvement, the archetype of its practice is N. R. Narayana Murthy, the chairman and managing director of the Rs. 143.81 crore Infosys Technologies (Infosys). For, the 52-year-old CEO of the globalised software corporation — which he founded with six friends, and a combined capital of Rs. 10,000 in 1981 and which now occupies the front ranks of the country's most admired corporations, leads with the subtlest of weapons: personal example.

Infosys ranks only 578th among the country's listed companies, and sixth in the software sector, in terms of its turnover. But it is setting new standards for India Inc. through its practices of inter alia awarding stock options to its employees, putting the value of its intellectual assets and its brands on its balance sheet, and conforming to the disclosure standards of the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) of the US. Behind all this is the stubborn personal subscription of its CEO to the underlying causes of wealth creation — people-power and transparency. "What were choices earlier are compulsions now," asserts Murthy.

In fact, the mirror images of Murthy, the Man, can be found all over Infosys, his company. His egalitarianism — which finds expression in such habits as using the same table and chair as anyone else in the organization — is practised firmly when it comes to charting a course for the company's future: everyone has a voice. "We have no hierarchy just for the sake of control.

"Brimming with the conviction that customer satisfaction is the key to success, Murthy has built a fleetfooted human resource management system that treats employees as customers, using the resources of the organisation to meet their professional and personal needs. His instruments are not just top-of-the-market salaries, but also operational empowerment as well as every facility that an employee needs to focus on the job.

Just what methods does Murthy use to ensure that his DNA is replicated in his company? Not for him are the classical leadership genre — transactional or transformational, situational or visionary. His chosen style, instead, is to lead by example, ensuring that the CEO's actions set the template for all Infosians.

Murthy believes that the betterment of man can be brought about through the 'creation of wealth, legally and ethically'. The personal example that he has set enabled his company to mirror those beliefs, tying his own rewards, and measuring his value to the company, to his ability to create wealth, and erecting systems for the company's wealth to be shared by its people. Sums up Nandan Nilekani, 41, deputy managing director, Infosys: "This is the future model of the corporation. Run an excellent company, and let the market increase its value to create wealth." Although Murthy is one of the prime beneficiaries of the philosophy — his 10 per cent stake in Infosys is worth Rs. 130 crore today — in his book, the leader leads not by grabbing the booty but by teaching others to take what they deserve. That's why, on the Infosys' balance sheet, the value of Murthy's intellectual capital is nowhere near the top, on the rationale, that the CEO, at 52, is worth far less to his company than, say, a

bright young programmer of 26. To spread the company's wealth, Murthy has instituted stock options – the first to do so in the country – for employees, creating 300 millionaires already. By 2000, he wants the number to climb to 1000.

To act as a beacon for his version of the learning organisation, Murthy not only spends an hour a day surfing the Internet to learn about new technological developments in his field, he also makes as many luncheon appointments as he can with technical people and academicians – dons from the Indian Institutes of Technology for instance – systematically plumbing their depths for an understanding of new developments in infotech. Murthy's objective is not just to stay abreast of the state-of-the-art, but also to find a way to use that knowledge for the company.

Following Murthy's example, Infosys has set up a technology advancement unit, whose mandate is to track, evaluate, and assimilate new techniques and methodologies. In fact, Murthy views learning not just as amassing data, but as a process that enables him to use the lessons from failure to achieve success. This self-corrective loop is what he demonstrates through his leadership during a crisis.

In 1995, for example, Infosys lost a Rs. 15 crore account – then 20 per cent of its revenues – when the \$69 billion GE yanked its business from it. Instead of recriminations, Murthy activated Infosys' machinery to understand why the business was taken away and to leverage the learning for getting new clients instead. Feeling determined instead of guilty, his employees went on to sign up high profile customers like the \$20 billion Xerox, the \$7 billion Levi Strauss, and the \$14 billion Nynex.

"You must have a multi-dimensional view of paradigms," says the multi-tasking leader. The objective is obvious: ensure that Infosys' perspective on its business and the world comes from as many vantage points as possible so that corporate strategy can be synthesised not from a narrow vision, but from a wide angle lens. In fact, Murthy still regrets that, in its initial years, Infosys didn't distil a multi-pronged understanding of the environment into its strategies, which forced it onto an incremental path that led revenues to snake up from Rs. 0.02 crore to just Rs. 5 crore in the first 10 years.

It was after looking around itself instead of focusing on its initial business of banking software, that Infosys managed to accelerate. Today the company operates with stretch targets setting distant goals and working backwards to get to them. The crucial pillar on which Murthy bases his ethical leadership is openness. Transparency, he reckons, is the clearest signal that one has nothing to hide. The personal manifestations of that are inter alia the practice of always giving complete information whenever any employee, customer, or investor asks for it: the loudly proclaimed insistence that every Infoscion pay taxes and file returns: and a perpetually open office into which anyone can walk.

But even as he tries to lead Infosys into cloning his own approach to enterprise, is Murthy choosing the best future for it? If Infosys grows with the same lack of ambition, the same softness of style, and the same absence of aggression, is it not cutting off avenues of growth that others may seize? As Infosys approaches the 21st century it is obvious that Murthy's leadership will have to set ever-improving role models for his ever-learning company. After all, men grow old; companies shouldn't.

Question 90

The cornerstone of Murthy's human resource management system is

- A the employee as God.
- B optimum utilization of human potential.
- C customer satisfaction.
- D satisfaction of employees' personal and professional needs.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 91

According to the passage,

- A Infosys is a reflection of its CEO.
- B Infosys brings the best out in Murthy.
- C Infosys and Murthy are synonymous.
- D Murthy, the man, and Murthy the CEO are incompatible.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 92

It is evident from the passage that

- A Infosys will have to devise new strategies to meet the challenges of the 21st century.
- B Infosys will stagnate if it does not become aggressive.
- C Infosys may have to become more aggressive in order to retain its market.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 93

According to Murthy, learning is

- A the essence of a employee.
- B the art of amassing data.
- C a process that helps him to learn from failure.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 94

One of the ways in which Infosys spreads the company's wealth among its employees is

- A by awarding stock options.
- B by giving an extravagant bonus at the end of each year.
- C Both a and b
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 95

According to the passage,

- A Infosys could not have succeeded without working backward.
- B Infosys succeeded because it worked backwards.
- C working backwards contributed to Infosys' success.
- D working backwards is a hallmark of Infosys' functioning today.

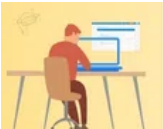
[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 96

Openness at Infosys includes

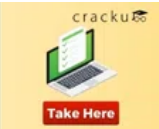
- A the payment of taxes.
- B giving complete information.
- C sharing secrets.
- D Both a and b

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)





CAT Sectional Tests



Question 97

The example of the Rs. 15 crore account highlights

- A Murthy's ability to see his company through a crisis.
- B Murthy's ability to turn failure into success.
- C Murthy's potential to handle a crisis.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 98

According to the passage, at Infosys

- A control is exerted through a system of hierarchy.
- B control is not exerted through a system of hierarchy.
- C hierarchy does not have pride of place.

D popular opinion is the most respected voice.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 99

Murthy believes in

- A betterment of man through learning.
- B betterment of man through ethical creation of wealth.
- C betterment of man through experimentation.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Instructions

A set of questions accompanies the passage below. Choose the best answer to each question.

Interpretations of the Indian past . . . were inevitably influenced by colonial concerns and interests, and also by prevalent European ideas about history, civilization and the Orient. Orientalist scholars studied the languages and the texts with selected Indian scholars, but made little attempt to understand the worldview of those who were teaching them. The readings, therefore, are something of a disjuncture from the traditional ways of looking at the Indian past. . . .

Orientalism [which we can understand broadly as Western perceptions of the Orient] fuelled the fantasy and the freedom sought by European Romanticism, particularly in its opposition to the more disciplined Neo-Classicism. The cultures of Asia were seen as bringing a new Romantic paradigm. Another Renaissance was anticipated through an acquaintance with the Orient, and this, it was thought, would be different from the earlier Greek Renaissance. It was believed that this Oriental Renaissance would liberate European thought and literature from the increasing focus on discipline and rationality that had followed from the earlier Enlightenment. . . . [The Romantic English poets, Wordsworth and Coleridge,] were apprehensive of the changes introduced by industrialization and turned to nature and to fantasies of the Orient.

However, this enthusiasm gradually changed, to conform with the emphasis later in the nineteenth century on the innate superiority of European civilization. Oriental civilizations were now seen as having once been great but currently in decline. The various phases of Orientalism tended to mould European understanding of the Indian past into a particular pattern. . . . There was an attempt to formulate Indian culture as uniform, such formulations being derived from texts that were given priority. The so-called 'discovery' of India was largely through selected literature in Sanskrit. This interpretation tended to emphasize non-historical aspects of Indian culture, for example, the idea of an unchanging continuity of society and religion over 3,000 years; and it was believed that the Indian pattern of life was so concerned with metaphysics and the subtleties of religious belief that little attention was given to the more tangible aspects.

German Romanticism endorsed this image of India, and it became the mystic land for many Europeans, where even the most ordinary actions were imbued with a complex symbolism. This was the genesis of the idea of the spiritual east, and also, incidentally, the refuge of European intellectuals seeking to distance themselves from the changing patterns of their own societies. A dichotomy in values was maintained, Indian values being described as 'spiritual' and European values as 'materialistic', with little attempt to juxtapose these values with the reality of Indian society. This theme has been even more firmly endorsed by a section of Indian opinion during the last hundred years.

It was a consolation to the Indian intelligentsia for its perceived inability to counter the technical superiority of the west, a superiority viewed as having enabled Europe to colonize Asia and other parts of the world. At the height of anti-colonial nationalism it acted as a salve for having been made a colony of Britain.

Question 100

In the context of the passage, all of the following statements are true EXCEPT:

- A Indian texts influenced Orientalist scholars.
- B Orientalist scholarship influenced Indians.
- C India's spiritualism served as a salve for European colonisers.
- D Orientalists' understanding of Indian history was linked to colonial concerns.

cracku

A set of questions accompanies the passage below. Choose the best answer to each question.

Interpretations of the Indian past... were inevitably influenced by colonial concerns and interests, and also by prevalent European ideas about history, civilization and the Orient. Orientalist scholars studied the languages and the texts with selected Indian scholars, but made little attempt to understand the worldview of those who were teaching them. The readings, therefore, are something of a disjunction from the traditional ways of looking at the Indian past.

Orientalism (which we can understand broadly as Western perceptions of the Orient) fuelled the fantasy and the freedom sought by European Romanticism, particularly in its opposition to the more disciplined Neo-Classicism. The cultures of Asia were seen as bringing a new Romantic paradigm. Another Renaissance was anticipated through acquaintance with the Orient, and this, it was thought, would be different from the earlier Greek Renaissance. It was believed that this Oriental Renaissance would liberate European thought and literature from the increasing focus on discipline and rationality that had followed from the earlier Enlightenment.... [The Romantic English poets, Wordsworth

→ European interpretation of India



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 101

It can be inferred from the passage that to gain a more accurate view of a nation's history and culture, scholars should do all of the following EXCEPT:

- A develop an oppositional framework to grasp cultural differences.
- B examine their own beliefs and biases.
- C read widely in the country's literature.
- D examine the complex reality of that nation's society.

cracku

A set of questions accompanies the passage below. Choose the best answer to each question.

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→ European interpretation of India



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 102

It can be inferred from the passage that the author is not likely to support the view that:

- A India's culture has evolved over the centuries.
- B the Orientalist view of Asia fired the imagination of some Western poets.
- C India became a colony although it matched the technical knowledge of the West.
- D Indian culture acknowledges the material aspects of life.

cracku

A set of questions accompanies the passage below. Choose the best answer to each question.

→ European interpretation of India

Interpretations of the Indian past... were inevitably influenced by colonial concerns and interests, and also by prevalent European ideas about history, civilization and the Orient. Orientalist scholars studied the languages and the texts with selected Indian scholars, but made little attempt to understand the worldview of those who were teaching them. The readings, therefore, are something of a disjunction from the traditional ways of looking at the Indian past.

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VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Daily Articles



Question 103

Which one of the following styles of research is most similar to the Orientalist scholars' method of understanding Indian history and culture?

- A Studying artefacts excavated at a palace to understand the lifestyle of those who lived there.
- B Reading 18th century accounts by travellers to India to see how they viewed Indian life and culture of the time.
- C Reading about the life of early American settlers and later waves of migration to understand the evolution of American culture.
- D Analysing Hollywood action movies that depict violence and sex to understand contemporary America.

cracku

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→ European interpretation of India



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[S]pices were a global commodity centuries before European voyages. There was a complex chain of relations, yet consumers had little knowledge of producers and vice versa. Desire for spices helped fuel European colonial empires to create political, military and commercial networks under a single power.

Historians know a fair amount about the supply of spices in Europe during the medieval period - the origins, methods of transportation, the prices - but less about demand. Why go to such extraordinary efforts to procure expensive products from exotic lands? Still, demand was great enough to inspire the voyages of Christopher Columbus and Vasco Da Gama, launching the first fateful wave of European colonialism. . . .

So, why were spices so highly prized in Europe in the centuries from about 1000 to 1500? One widely disseminated explanation for medieval demand for spices was that they covered the taste of spoiled meat. . . . Medieval purchasers consumed meat much fresher than what the average city-dweller in the developed world of today has at hand. However, refrigeration was not available, and some hot spices have been shown to serve as an anti-bacterial agent. Salting, smoking or drying meat were other means of preservation. Most spices used in cooking began as medical ingredients, and throughout the Middle Ages spices were used as both medicines and condiments. Above all, medieval recipes involve the combination of medical and culinary lore in order to balance food's humoral properties and prevent disease. Most spices were hot and dry and so appropriate in sauces to counteract the moist and wet properties supposedly possessed by most meat and fish. . . .

Where spices came from was known in a vague sense centuries before the voyages of Columbus. Just how vague may be judged by looking at medieval world maps . . . To the medieval European imagination, the East was exotic and alluring. Medieval maps often placed India close to the so-called Earthly Paradise, the Garden of Eden described in the Bible.

Geographical knowledge has a lot to do with the perceptions of spices' relative scarcity and the reasons for their high prices. An example of the varying notions of scarcity is the conflicting information about how pepper is harvested. As far back as the 7th century Europeans thought that pepper in India grew on trees "guarded" by serpents that would bite and poison anyone who attempted to gather the fruit. The only way to harvest pepper was to burn the trees, which would drive the snakes underground. Of course, this bit of lore would explain the shriveled black peppercorns, but not white, pink or other colors.

Spices never had the enduring allure or power of gold and silver or the commercial potential of new products such as tobacco, indigo or sugar. But the taste for spices did continue for a while beyond the Middle Ages. As late as the 17th century, the English and the Dutch were struggling for control of the Spice Islands: Dutch New Amsterdam, or New York, was exchanged by the British for one of the Moluccan Islands where nutmeg was grown.

Question 104

If a trader brought white peppercorns from India to medieval Europe, all of the following are unlikely to happen, EXCEPT:

- A medieval maps would be used as navigational aids.
- B Europeans would doubt the story of pepper harvesting.
- C the price of spices would decrease.
- D pepper would no longer be considered exotic.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[S]pices were a global commodity centuries before European voyages. There was a complex chain of relations, yet consumers had little knowledge of producers and vice versa. Desire for spices helped fuel European colonial empires to create political, military and commercial networks under a single power.

Historians know a fair amount about the supply of spices in Europe during the medieval period - the origins, methods of transportation, the prices - but less about demand. Why go to such extraordinary efforts to procure expensive products from exotic lands? Still, demand was great enough to inspire the voyages of Christopher Columbus and Vasco Da Gama, launching the first fateful wave of European colonialism.

So, why were spices so highly prized in Europe in the centuries from about 1000 to 1500? One widely disseminated explanation for medieval demand for spices was that they covered the taste of spoiled meat. ... Medieval purchasers consumed meat much fresher than what the average city-dweller in the developed world of today has at hand. However, refrigeration was not available, and some

→ Spices were a global commodity
→ demand for spices fueled colonial empire



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 105

It can be inferred that all of the following contributed to a decline in the allure of spices, EXCEPT:

- A the development of refrigeration techniques.
- B increase in the availability of spices.
- C changes in the system of medical treatment.
- D changes in European cuisine.

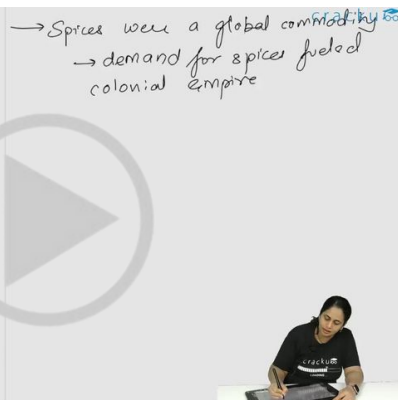
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→ Spices were a global commodity
→ demand for spices fueled colonial empire



VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 106

In the context of the passage, the people who heard the story of pepper trees being guarded by snakes would be least likely to arrive at the conclusion that

- A this is why pepper is so hot.
- B pepper is costly for good reason.
- C it is not advisable to go to India to harvest the pepper themselves.
- D it is no surprise that the pepper supply is so limited.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[S]pices were a global commodity centuries before European voyages. There was a complex chain of relations, yet consumers had little knowledge of producers and vice versa. Desire for spices helped fuel European colonial empires to create political, military and commercial networks under a single power.

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→ Spices were a global commodity
→ demand for spices fueled colonial empire



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 107

In the context of the passage, which one of the following conclusions CANNOT be reached?

- A The spice trade was a driver of colonial expansion.
- B India was colonised for its spices and gold.
- C Tobacco was more marketable than spices.
- D Colonialism was motivated by the demand for spices.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

[S]pices were a global commodity centuries before European voyages. There was a complex chain of relations, yet consumers had little knowledge of producers and vice versa. Desire for spices helped fuel European colonial empires to create political, military and commercial networks under a single power.

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→ Spices were a global commodity
→ demand for spices fueled colonial empire



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

A distinction should be made between work and occupation. Work implies necessity; it is something that must be done as contributing to the means of life in general and to one's own subsistence in particular. Occupation absorbs time and energy so long as we choose to give them; it demands constant initiative, and it is its own reward. For the average person, the element of necessity in work is valuable, for he is saved the mental stress involved in devising outlets for his energy. Work has for him obvious utility, and it brings the satisfaction of tangible rewards. Whereas occupation is an end in itself, and we, therefore, demand that it shall be agreeable, work is usually the means to other ends which present themselves to the mind as sufficiently important to compensate for any disagreeableness in the means. There are forms of work, of course, which since external compulsion is reduced to a minimum, are hardly to be differentiated from occupation. The artist, the imaginative writer, the scientist, the social worker, for instance, find their pleasure in the constant spontaneous exercise of creative energy and the essential reward of their work is in the doing of it. In all work performed by a suitable agent, there must be a pleasurable element, and the greater the amount of pleasure that can be associated with work, the better. But for most people, the pleasure of occupation needs the addition of the necessity provided in work. It is better for them to follow a path of employment marked out for them than to have to find their own.

When, therefore, we look ahead to the situation likely to be produced by the continued rapid extension of machine production, we should think not so much about providing occupation for leisure as about limiting the amount of leisure to that which can be profitably used. We shall have to put the emphasis on the work providing rather than the goods providing aspect of the economic process. In the earlier and more ruthless days of capitalism, the duty of the economic system to provide work was overlooked. The purpose of competitive enterprise was to realize a profit. When profit ceased or was curtailed, production also ceased or was curtailed. Thus the workers, who were regarded as units of labour forming part of the costs of production, were taken on when required and dismissed when not required. They hardly thought of demanding work as a right. And so long as British manufacturers had their eyes mainly on the markets awaiting them abroad, they could conveniently neglect the fact that since workers are also consumers, unemployment at home means loss of trade. Moral considerations did not yet find a substitute in ordinary business prudence. The labour movements arose largely as a revolt against the conception of workers as commodities to be bought and sold without regard to their needs as human beings. In a socialist system it is assumed that they will be treated with genuine consideration, for, the making of profit not being essential, central planning will not only adjust the factors of production to the best advantage but will secure regularity of employment. But has the socialist thought about what he would do if owing to technological advancements, the amount of human labour were catastrophically reduced? So far as I know, he has no plan beyond drastically lining the hours of work, and sharing out as much work as there may be. And, of course, he would grant monetary relief to those who were actually unemployed. But has he considered what would be the moral effect of life imagined as possible in the highly mechanized state of the future? Has he thought of the possibility of bands of unemployed and under-employed workers marching on the capital to demand not income (which they will have) but work?

Question 108

The chief purpose of competitive enterprise is to

- A create more job opportunities.
- B produce as much as possible.
- C create more wealth in the country.
- D realize the maximum profit.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions



Question 109

The activities of the artist, the writer, the scientist etc. may be considered to be occupations because

- A they often does not have any utilitarian value.
- B external compulsion is reduced to a minimum and they are agreeable and require quite a lot of initiative.
- C they occupies time and energy only so long as the workers choose to give them.
- D they care only for the pleasure which brings them without any consideration of reward.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 110

Which of the following statements is not true according to the information contained in the passage?

- A Work is something done as contributing to the means of life in general and to one.s own subsistence in particular.
- B Occupation is something that requires initiative and can be done at one.s will and pleasure and not as a task.
- C Work brings in tangible rewards while occupation is not utilitarian.
- D There is no form of work which shows approximation to occupation.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 111

In the situation created by the rapid extension of machine production, our object should be to

- A make work as light as possible.
- B provide increased opportunities for interesting occupation.
- C limit the amount of leisure to that which can be profitably used.
- D produce more and more goods.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



Question 112

Future, according to the passage, may find the workers

- A without money.
- B without work.
- C replacing machines.
- D without leisure.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 113

The labour movement was the outcome of

- A an effort to increase productivity.
- B a move to make workers share in the prosperity of the capitalists.
- C a revolt against the conception of workers as commodities.
- D a move to avert mass unemployment because of the mechanization.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 114

The main defect of socialism at present is that

- A it has not evolved a satisfactory system of making workers co-sharers in prosperity.
- B it has not made work less burdensome for the mass of workers.
- C it has not taken into consideration the possibility of an immense reduction of human labour in the wake of mechanization.
- D it is not concerned with improving and streamlining the method of production.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF

cracku



Question 115

The chief reason for a person taking up an occupation may be stated to be :-

- A a desire to make profit.
- B an irresistible urge to do something uncommon.
- C a wish to do something useful to society.
- D a desire to do something which requires initiative and doing it at his will and pleasure.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 116

The distinction between work and occupation is as follows :-

- A Work at all times is unpleasant and occupation is always agreeable.
- B In work there is an element of necessity which is totally wanting in occupation.
- C Work has obvious utility and brings tangible rewards, while occupation is an end in itself.

- D Work and occupation often seem to be so very much alike that no distinction can be made between them.

 VIEW SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The job of a peer reviewer is thankless. Collectively, academics spend around 70 million hours every year evaluating each other's manuscripts on the behalf of scholarly journals — and they usually receive no monetary compensation and little if any recognition for their effort. Some do it as a way to keep abreast with developments in their field; some simply see it as a duty to the discipline. Either way, academic publishing would likely crumble without them.

In recent years, some scientists have begun posting their reviews online, mainly to claim credit for their work. Sites like Publons allow researchers to either share entire referee reports or simply list the journals for whom they've carried out a review.... The rise of Publons suggests that academics are increasingly placing value on the work of peer review and asking others, such as grant funders, to do the same. While that's vital in the publish-or-perish culture of academia, there's also immense value in the data underlying peer review. Sharing peer review data could help journals stamp out fraud, inefficiency, and systemic bias in academic publishing.....

Peer review data could also help root out bias. Last year, a study based on peer review data for nearly 24,000 submissions to the biomedical journal eLife found that women and non- Westerners were vastly underrepresented among peer reviewers. Only around one in every five reviewers was female, and less than two percent of reviewers were based in developing countries.... Openly publishing peer review data could perhaps also help journals address another problem in academic publishing: fraudulent peer reviews. For instance, a minority of authors have been known to use phony email addresses to pose as an outside expert and review their own manuscripts....

Opponents of open peer review commonly argue that confidentiality is vital to the integrity of the review process; referees may be less critical of manuscripts if their reports are published, especially if they are revealing their identities by signing them. Some also hold concerns that open reviewing may deter referees from agreeing to judge manuscripts in the first place, or that they'll take longer to do so out of fear of scrutiny....

Even when the content of reviews and the identity of reviewers can't be shared publicly, perhaps journals could share the data with outside researchers for study. Or they could release other figures that wouldn't compromise the anonymity of reviews but that might answer important questions about how long the reviewing process takes, how many researchers editors have to reach out to on average to find one who will carry out the work, and the geographic distribution of peer reviewers.

Of course, opening up data underlying the reviewing process will not fix peer review entirely, and there may be instances in which there are valid reasons to keep the content of peer reviews hidden and the identity of the referees confidential. But the norm should shift from opacity in all cases to opacity only when necessary.

Question 117

All of the following are listed as reasons why academics choose to review other scholars' work EXCEPT:

- A It helps them keep current with cutting-edge ideas in their academic disciplines.
- B Some use this as an opportunity to publicise their own review work.
- C It is seen as a form of service to the academic community.
- D It is seen as an opportunity to expand their influence in the academic community.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The job of a peer reviewer is thankless. Collectively, academics spend around 70 million hours every year evaluating each other's manuscripts on the behalf of scholarly journals — and they usually receive no monetary compensation and little if any recognition for their effort. Some do it as a way to keep abreast with developments in their field; some simply see it as a duty to the discipline. Either way, academic publishing would likely crumble without them.

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→ Peer review unpaid thanks for the discipline



VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Important Topics

Question 118

According to the passage, some are opposed to making peer reviews public for all the following reasons EXCEPT that it

- A makes reviewers reluctant to review manuscripts, especially if these are critical of the submitted work.
- B leaves the reviewers unexposed to unwarranted and unjustified criticism or comments from others.
- C deters reviewers from producing honest, if critical, reviews that are vital to the sound publishing process.
- D delays the manuscript evaluation process as reviewers would take longer to write their reviews.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The job of a peer reviewer is thankless. Collectively, academics spend around 70 million hours every year evaluating each other's manuscripts on the behalf of scholarly journals — and they usually receive no monetary compensation and little if any recognition for their effort. Some do it as a way to keep abreast with developments in their field; some simply see it as a duty to the discipline. Either way, academic publishing would likely crumble without them.

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→ Peer review unpaid thanks for the discipline



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 119

Based on the passage we can infer that the author would most probably support

- A more careful screening to ensure the recruitment of content-familiar peer reviewers.
- B preserving the anonymity of reviewers to protect them from criticism.
- C publicising peer review data rather than the publication of actual reviews.

D greater transparency across the peer review process in academic publishing.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

→ Peer review unpaid thanks for the discipline

The job of a peer reviewer is thankless. Collectively, academics spend around 70 million hours every year evaluating each other's manuscripts on the behalf of scholarly journals — and they usually receive no monetary compensation and little if any recognition for their effort. Some do it as a way to keep abreast with developments in their field; some simply see it as a duty to the discipline. Either way, academic publishing would likely crumble without them.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 120

According to the passage, which of the following is the only reason NOT given in favour of making peer review data public?

- A It will deal with peer review fraud such as authors publishing bogus reviews of their work.
- B It would highlight the gender and race biases currently existing in the selection of reviewers.
- C It could address various inefficiencies and fraudulent practices that continue in academic publishing process.
- D It can tackle the problem of selecting appropriately qualified reviewers for academic writing.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

→ Peer review unpaid thanks for the discipline

The job of a peer reviewer is thankless. Collectively, academics spend around 70 million hours every year evaluating each other's manuscripts on the behalf of scholarly journals — and they usually receive no monetary compensation and little if any recognition for their effort. Some do it as a way to keep abreast with developments in their field; some simply see it as a duty to the discipline. Either way, academic publishing would likely crumble without them.

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VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT WhatsApp Group



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Ofentimes the secondary effects seem to belong to an entirely different sphere of society. When Willis Carrier hit upon the idea of air-conditioning, the technology was primarily intended for industrial use: ensuring cool, dry air for factories that required low-humidity environments. But...it touched off one of the largest migrations in the history of the United States, enabling the rise of metropolitan areas like Phoenix and Las Vegas that barely existed when Carrier first started tinkering with the idea in the early 1900s.

We live under the gathering storm of modern history's most momentous unintended consequence....carbon-based climate change. Imagine the vast sweep of inventors whose ideas started the Industrial Revolution, all the entrepreneurs and scientists and hobbyists who had a hand in bringing it about. Line up a thousand of them and ask them all what they had been hoping to do with their work. Not one would say that their intent had been to deposit enough carbon in the atmosphere to create a greenhouse effect that trapped heat at the surface of the planet. And yet here we are.

Indeed, it is reasonable to see CFCs (chlorofluorocarbons) as a forerunner of the kind of threat we will most likely face in the coming decades, as it becomes increasingly possible for individuals or small groups to create new scientific advances — through chemistry or biotechnology or materials science — setting off unintended consequences that reverberate on a global scale.

Which of the following best conveys the main point of the first paragraph?

- Join our WhatsApp Community

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The history of any major technological or industrial advance is inevitably shadowed by a less predictable history of unintended consequences and secondary effects – what economists sometimes call “externalities.” Sometimes those consequences are innocuous ones, or even beneficial. Gutenberg invented the printing press, and literacy rates rise, which causes a significant part of the reading public to require spectacles for the first time, which creates a surge of investment in lens-making across Europe, which leads to the invention of the telescope and the microscope.

Oftentimes the secondary effects seem to belong to an entirely different sphere of society. When Willis Carrier hit upon the idea of air-conditioning, the technology was primarily intended for

Externalities → secondary effects
Printing press → ↑ literacy

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 122

The author lists all of the following examples as “externalities” of major technical advances EXCEPT:

- A build-up of chlorofluorocarbons in the atmosphere
- B cooling and de-humidifying of factories through air-conditioning
- C application of the Jacquard loom to modern IT programming
- D extension of the phonograph to large-scale recording of music

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The history of any major technological or industrial advance is inevitably shadowed by a less predictable history of unintended consequences and secondary effects – what economists sometimes call “externalities.” Sometimes those consequences are innocuous ones, or even beneficial. Gutenberg invented the printing press, and literacy rates rise, which causes a significant part of the reading public to require spectacles for the first time, which creates a surge of investment in lens-making across Europe, which leads to the invention of the telescope and the microscope.

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Externalities → secondary effects
Printing press → ↑ literacy

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 123

We can assume that the author would support all of the following views EXCEPT:

- A While technological advances in the past have had innocuous or beneficial outcomes, more recent advances have the potential to be more threatening globally.
- B The by-products of leaded fuel, rather than the fuel itself, were responsible for the build-up of carbon-related gases in the atmosphere.
- C It has become far easier for people today to bring out innovations with dire worldwide consequences than it was earlier.
- D The emissions caused by the large-scale use of leaded fuel ought to have been addressed earlier than they were.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The history of any major technological or industrial advance is inevitably shadowed by a less predictable history of unintended consequences and secondary effects – what economists sometimes call “externalities.” Sometimes those consequences are innocuous ones, or even beneficial. Gutenberg invented the printing press, and literacy rates rise, which causes a significant part of the reading public to require spectacles for the first time, which creates a surge of investment in lens-making across Europe, which leads to the invention of the telescope and the microscope.

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Handwritten notes: Externalities → secondary effects
Printing press → ↑ literacy



VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Mock Test

Mocks designed exactly like the actual CAT



Question 124

Carrier, Babbage, and Edison are mentioned in the passage to illustrate the author's point that

- A the secondary effect of past inventions mostly resulted in the creation of new inventions.
- B these inventors could not have visualised the eventual impact of their inventions on society.
- C despite the original intention, the unintended consequences of their inventions were largely beneficial.
- D inventions typically end up being used for entirely different purposes than the intended ones.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The history of any major technological or industrial advance is inevitably shadowed by a less predictable history of unintended consequences and secondary effects – what economists sometimes call “externalities.” Sometimes those consequences are innocuous ones, or even beneficial. Gutenberg invented the printing press, and literacy rates rise, which causes a significant part of the reading public to require spectacles for the first time, which creates a surge of investment in lens-making across Europe, which leads to the invention of the telescope and the microscope.

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Handwritten notes: Externalities → secondary effects
Printing press → ↑ literacy



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

174 incidents of piracy were reported to the International Maritime Bureau last year, with Somali pirates responsible for only three. The rest ranged from the discreet theft of coils of rope in the Yellow Sea to the notoriously ferocious Nigerian gunmen attacking and hijacking oil tankers in the Gulf of Guinea, as well as armed robbery off Singapore and the Venezuelan coast and kidnapping in the Sundarbans in the Bay of Bengal. For [Dr. Peter] Lehr, an expert on modern-day piracy, the phenomenon's history should be a source of instruction rather than entertainment, piracy past offering lessons for piracy present. . . .

But . . . where does piracy begin or end? According to St Augustine, a corsair captain once told Alexander the Great that in the forceful acquisition of power and wealth at sea, the difference between an emperor and a pirate was simply one of scale. By this logic, European empire-builders were the most successful pirates of all time. A more eclectic history might have included the conquistadors, Vasco da Gama and the East India Company. But Lehr sticks to the disorganized small fry, making comparisons with the renegades of today possible.

The main motive for piracy has always been a combination of need and greed. Why toil away as a starving peasant in the 16th century when a successful pirate made up to £4,000 on each raid? Anyone could turn to freebooting if the rewards were worth the risk . . .

Increased globalisation has done more to encourage piracy than suppress it. European colonialism weakened delicate balances of power, leading to an influx of opportunists on the high seas. A rise in global shipping has meant rich pickings for freebooters. Lehr writes: "It quickly becomes clear that in those parts of the world that have not profited from globalisation and modernisation, and where abject poverty and the daily struggle for survival are still a reality, the root causes of piracy are still the same as they were a couple of hundred years ago." . . .

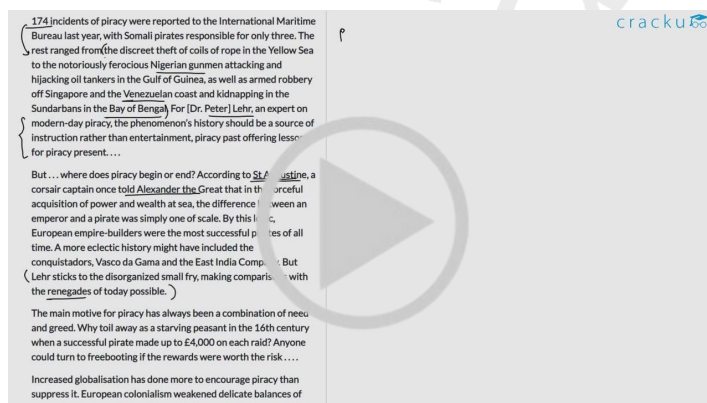
Modern pirate prevention has failed. After the French yacht Le Gonant was ransomed for \$2 million in 2008, opportunists from all over Somalia flocked to the coast for a piece of the action. . . . A consistent rule, even today, is there are never enough warships to patrol pirate-infested waters. Such ships are costly and only solve the problem temporarily; Somali piracy is bound to return as soon as the warships are withdrawn. Robot shipping, eliminating hostages, has been proposed as a possible solution; but as Lehr points out, this will only make pirates switch their targets to smaller carriers unable to afford the technology.

His advice isn't new. Proposals to end illegal fishing are often advanced but they are difficult to enforce. Investment in local welfare put a halt to Malaysian piracy in the 1970s, but was dependent on money somehow filtering through a corrupt bureaucracy to the poor on the periphery. Diplomatic initiatives against piracy are plagued by mutual distrust: the Russians execute pirates, while the EU and US are reluctant to capture them for fear they'll claim asylum.

Question 125

The author ascribes the rise in piracy today to all of the following factors EXCEPT:

- A decreased surveillance of the high seas.
- B the high rewards via ransoms for successful piracy attempts.
- C the growth in international shipping with globalisation.
- D colonialism's disruption of historic ties among countries.

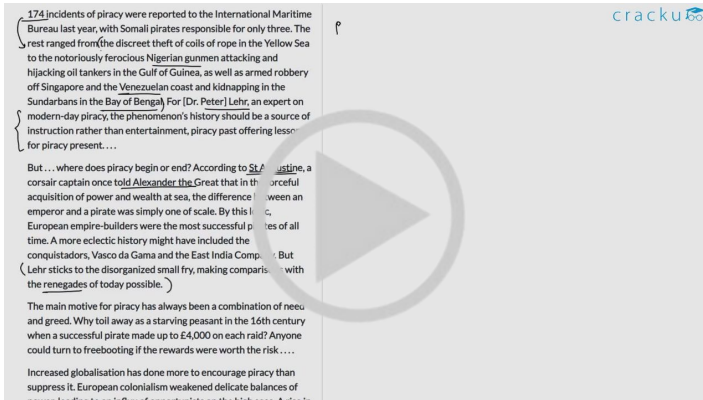


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 126

"A more eclectic history might have included the conquistadors, Vasco da Gama and the East India Company. But Lehr sticks to the disorganised small fry . . ." From this statement we can infer that the author believes that:

- A Lehr does not assign adequate blame to empire builders for their past deeds.
- B the disorganised piracy of today is no match for the organised piracy of the past.
- C Vasco da Gama and the East India Company laid the ground for modern piracy.
- D colonialism should be considered an organised form of piracy.



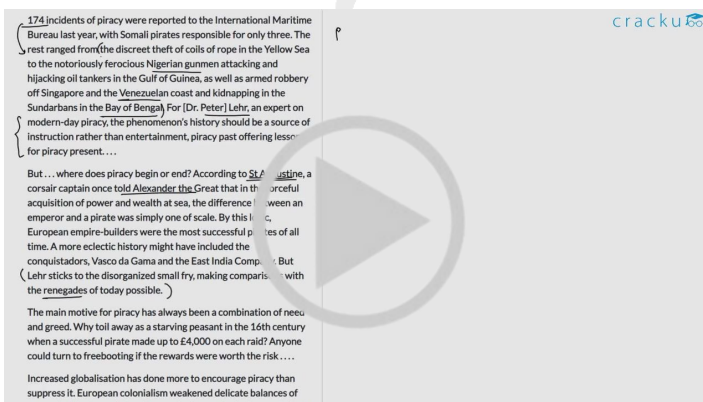
VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 127

"Why toil away as a starving peasant in the 16th century when a successful pirate made up to £4,000 on each raid?" In this sentence, the author's tone can best be described as being:

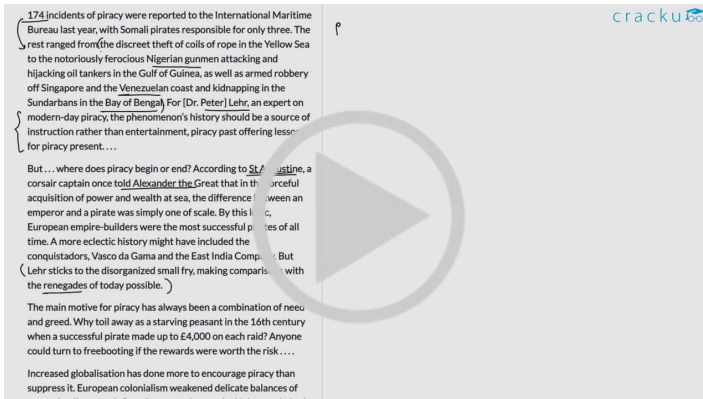
- A facetious, about the hardships of peasant life in medieval England.
- B analytical, to explain the contrasts between peasant and pirate life in medieval England.
- C ironic, about the reasons why so many took to piracy in medieval times.
- D indignant, at the scale of wealth successful pirates could amass in medieval times.



Question 128

We can deduce that the author believes that piracy can best be controlled in the long run:

- A if we eliminate poverty and income disparities in affected regions.
- B through international cooperation in enforcing stringent deterrents.
- C through lucrative welfare schemes to improve the lives of people in affected regions.
- D through the extensive deployment of technology to track ships and cargo.



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Landing in Australia, the British colonists weren't much impressed with the small-bodied, slender-snouted marsupials called bandicoots. "Their muzzle, which is much too long, gives them an air exceedingly stupid," one naturalist noted in 1805. They nicknamed one type the "zebra rat" because of its black-striped rump.

Silly-looking or not, though, the zebra rat—the smallest bandicoot, more commonly known today as the western barred bandicoot—exhibited a genius for survival in the harsh outback, where its ancestors had persisted for some 26 million years. Its births were triggered by rainfall in the bone-dry desert. It carried its breath-mint-size babies in a backward-facing pouch so mothers could forage for food and dig shallow, camouflaged shelters.

Still, these adaptations did not prepare the western barred bandicoot for the colonial-era transformation of its ecosystem, particularly the onslaught of imported British animals, from cattle and rabbits that damaged delicate desert vegetation to ravenous house cats that soon developed a taste for bandicoots. Several of the dozen-odd bandicoot species went extinct, and by the 1940s the western barred bandicoot, whose original range stretched across much of the continent, persisted only on two predator-free islands in Shark Bay, off Australia's western coast.

"Our isolated fauna had simply not been exposed to these predators," says Reece Pedler, an ecologist with the Wild Deserts conservation program.

Now Wild Deserts is using descendants of those few thousand island survivors, called Shark Bay bandicoots, in a new effort to seed a mainland bandicoot revival. They've imported 20 bandicoots to a preserve on the edge of the Strzelecki Desert, in the remote interior of New South Wales. This sanctuary is a challenging place, desolate much of the year, with one of the world's most mercurial rainfall patterns—relentless droughts followed by sudden drenching floods.

The imported bandicoots occupy two fenced “exclosures,” cleared of invasive rabbits (courtesy of Pedler’s sheepdog) and of feral cats (which slunk off once the rabbits disappeared). A third fenced area contains the program’s Wild Training Zone, where two other rare marsupials (bilbies, a larger type of bandicoot, and mulgaras, a somewhat fearsome fuzzball known for sucking the brains out of prey) currently share terrain with controlled numbers of cats, learning to evade them. It’s unclear whether the Shark Bay bandicoots, which are perhaps even more predator-naïve than their now-extinct mainland bandicoot kin, will be able to make that kind of breakthrough.

For now, though, a recent surge of rainfall has led to a bandicoot joey boom, raising the Wild Deserts population to about 100, with other sanctuaries adding to that number. There are also signs of rebirth in the landscape itself. With their constant digging, the bandicoots trap moisture and allow for seed germination so the cattle-damaged desert can restore itself.

They have a new nickname—a flattering one, this time. “We call them ecosystem engineers,” Pedler says.

Question 129

The text uses the word ‘exclosures’ because Wild Deserts has adopted a measure of

- A restoring cattle damaged deserts to green landscapes.
- B ridding the main desert of feral cats and large bilbies
- C excluding animals to make the islands predator-free.
- D barring the entry of invasive species.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION



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Question 130

Which one of the following statements provides a gist of this passage?

- A The onslaught of animals, such as cattle, rabbits and housecats, brought in by the British led to the extinction of the western barred bandicoot.
- B The negligent attitude of the British colonists towards these bandicoots evidenced by the names given to them led to their annihilation.
- C Marsupials are going extinct due to the colonial era transformation of the ecosystem which also destroyed natural vegetation

- D A type of bandicoots was nearly wiped out by invasive species but rescuers now pin hopes on a remnant island population.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 131

Which one of the following options does NOT represent the characteristics of the western barred bandicoot?

- A Shallow diggers having an elongated muzzle
- B Smallest black striped marsupial that uses camouflage and dig
- C Look of a rat but with a baby pouch and a slender snout
- D Long thin nose, black striped back, pouch for joeys

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 132

According to the text, the western barred bandicoots now have a flattering name because they have

- A aided in altering an arid environment.
- B led a revival in preserving the species.
- C grown fivefold in terms of population
- D led to a surge and increase of rainfall

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Landing in Australia, the British colonists weren't much impressed with the small-bodied, slender-snouted marsupials called bandicoots. "Their muzzle, which is much too long, gives them an air exceedingly stupid," one naturalist noted in 1805. They nicknamed one type the "zebra rat" because of its black-striped rump.

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VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



Instructions

When I was little, children were bought two kinds of ice cream, sold from those white wagons with canopies made of silvery metal: either the two-cent cone or the four-cent ice-cream pie. The two-cent cone was very small, in fact, it could fit comfortably into a child's hand, and it was made by taking the ice cream from its container with a special scoop and piling it on the cone. Granny always suggested I eat only a part of the cone, then throw away the pointed end, because it had been touched by the vendor's hand (though that was the best part, nice and crunchy, and it was regularly eaten in secret, after a pretence of discarding it).

The four-cent pie was made by a special little machine, also silvery, which pressed two disks of sweet biscuit against a cylindrical section of ice cream. First, you had to thrust your tongue into the gap between the biscuits until it touched the central nucleus of ice cream; then, gradually, you ate the whole thing, the biscuit surfaces softening as they became soaked in creamy nectar. Granny had no advice to give here: in theory, the pies had been touched only by the machine; in practice, the vendor had held them in his hand while giving them to us, but it was impossible to isolate the contaminated area.

I was fascinated, however, by some of my peers, whose parents bought them not a four-cent pie but two two-cent cones. These privileged children advanced proudly with one cone in their right hand and one in their left; and expertly moving their head from side to side, they licked first one, then the other. This liturgy seemed to me so sumptuously enviable, that many times I asked to be allowed to celebrate it. In vain. My elders were inflexible: a four-cent ice, yes; but two two-cent ones, absolutely no.

As anyone can see, neither mathematics nor economy nor dietetics justified this refusal. Nor did hygiene, assuming that in due course the tips of both cones were discarded. The pathetic, and obviously mendacious, justification was that a boy concerned with turning his eyes from one cone to the other was more inclined to stumble over stones, steps, or cracks in the pavement. I dimly sensed that there was another secret justification, cruelly pedagogical, but I was unable to grasp it.

Today, citizen and victim of a consumer society, a civilization of excess and waste (which the society of the thirties was not), I realize that those dear and now departed elders were right. Two two-cent cones instead of one at four cents did not signify squandering, economically speaking, but symbolically they surely did. It was for this precise reason, that I yearned for them: because two ice creams suggested excess. And this was precisely why they were denied to me: because they looked indecent, an insult to poverty, a display of fictitious privilege, a boast of wealth. Only spoiled children ate two cones at once, those children who in fairy tales were rightly punished, as Pinocchio was when he rejected the skin and the stalk. And parents who encouraged this weakness, appropriate to little parvenus, were bringing up their children in the foolish theatre of "I'd like to but I

can't." They were preparing them to turn up at tourist-class check-in with a fake Gucci bag bought from a street peddler on the beach at Rimini.

Nowadays the moralist risks seeming at odds with morality, in a world where the consumer civilization now wants even adults to be spoiled, and promises them always something more, from the wristwatch in the box of detergent to the bonus bangle sheathed, with the magazine it accompanies, in a plastic envelope. Like the parents of those ambidextrous gluttons I so envied, the consumer civilization pretends to give more, but actually gives, for four cents, what is worth four cents. You will throw away the old transistor radio to purchase the new one, that boasts an alarm clock as well, but some inexplicable defect in the mechanism will guarantee that the radio lasts only a year. The new cheap car will have leather seats, double side mirrors adjustable from inside, and a panelled dashboard, but it will not last nearly so long as the glorious old Fiat 500, which, even when it broke down, could be started again with a kick. The morality of the old days made Spartans of us all, while today's morality wants all of us to be sybarites.

Question 133

According to the author, the justification for refusal to let him eat two cones was plausibly

- A didactic.
- B dietetic.
- C dialectic.
- D diatonic.
- E diastolic

When I was little, children were bought two kinds of ice cream, sold from those white wagons with canopies made of silvery metal: either the two-cent cone or the four-cent ice-cream pie. The two-cent cone was very small, in fact, it could fit comfortably into a child's hand, and it was made by taking the ice cream from its container with a special scoop and piling it on the cone. Granny always suggested I eat only a part of the cone, then throw away the pointed end, because it had been touched by the vendor's hand (though that was the best part, nice and crunchy, and it was regularly eaten in secret, after a pretence of discarding it).

The four-cent pie was made by a special little machine, also silvery, which pressed two disks of sweet biscuit against a cylindrical section of ice cream. First, you had to thrust your tongue into the gap between the biscuits until it touched the central nucleus of ice cream; then, gradually, you



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 134

What does the author mean by "nowadays the moralist risks seeming at odds with morality"?

- A The moralists of yesterday have become immoral today.
- B The concept of morality has changed over the years.
- C Consumerism is amoral.
- D The risks associated with immorality have gone up.
- E The purist's view of morality is fast becoming popular

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 135

The author pined for two two-cent cones instead of one four-cent pie because

- A it made dietetic sense.
- B it suggested intemperance.
- C it was more fun.
- D it had a visual appeal.
- E he was a glutton.

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VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Formula PDF



Question 136

In the passage, the phrase "little parvenus" refers to

- A naughty midgets.
- B old hags.
- C arrogant people.

D young upstarts.

E foolish kids.

VIEW SOLUTION

Question 137

Which of the following cannot be inferred from the passage?

- A Today's society is more extravagant than the society of the 1930s.
- B The act of eating two ice cream cones is akin to a ceremonial process.
- C Elders rightly suggested that a boy turning eyes from one cone to the other was more likely to fall.
- D Despite seeming to promise more, the consumer civilization gives away exactly what the thing is worth.
- E The consumer civilization attempts to spoil children and adults alike.

When I was little, children were bought two kinds of ice cream, sold from those white wagons with canopies made of silvery metal: either the two-cent cone or the four-cent ice-cream pie. The two-cent cone was very small, in fact, it could fit comfortably into a child's hand, and it was made by taking the ice cream from its container with a special scoop and piling it on the cone. Granny always suggested I eat only a part of the cone, then throw away the pointed end, because it had been touched by the vendor's hand (though that was the best part, nice and crunchy, and it was regularly eaten in secret, after a pretence of discarding it).

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Language is not a cultural artifact that we learn the way we learn to tell time or how the federal government works. Instead, it is a distinct piece of the biological makeup of our brains. Language is a complex, specialized skill, which develops in the child spontaneously, without conscious effort or formal instruction, is deployed without awareness of its underlying logic, is qualitatively the same in every individual, and is distinct from more general abilities to process information or behave intelligently. For these reasons some cognitive scientists have described language as a psychological faculty, a mental organ, a neural system, and a computational module. But I prefer the admittedly quaint term "instinct". It conveys the idea that people know how to talk in more or less the sense that spiders know how to spin webs. Web-spinning was not invented by some unsung spider genius and does not depend on having had the right education or on having an aptitude for architecture or the construction trades. Rather, spiders spin spider webs because they have spider brains, which give them the urge to spin and the competence to succeed. Although there are differences between webs and words, I will encourage you to see language in this way, for it helps to make sense of the phenomena we will explore.

Thinking of language as an instinct inverts the popular wisdom, especially as it has been passed down in the canon of the humanities and social sciences. Language is no more a cultural invention than is upright posture. It is not a manifestation of a general capacity to use symbols: a three-year-old, we shall see, is a grammatical genius, but is quite incompetent at the visual arts, religious iconography, traffic signs, and the other staples of the semiotics curriculum. Though language is a magnificent ability unique to Homo sapiens among living species, it does not call for sequestering the study of humans from the domain of biology, for a magnificent ability unique to a particular living species is far from unique in the animal kingdom. Some kinds of bats home

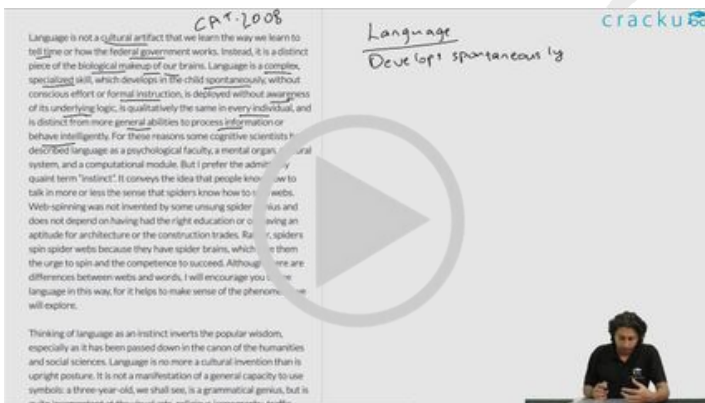
in on flying insects using Doppler sonar. Some kinds of migratory birds navigate thousands of miles by calibrating the positions of the constellations against the time of day and year. In nature's talent show, we are simply a species of primate with our own act, a knack for communicating information about who did what to whom by modulating the sounds we make when we exhale.

Once you begin to look at language not as the ineffable essence of human uniqueness but as a biological adaptation to communicate information, it is no longer as tempting to see language as an insidious shaper of thought, and, we shall see, it is not. Moreover, seeing language as one of nature's engineering marvels — an organ with “that perfection of structure and co-adaptation which justly excites our admiration,” in Darwin's words - gives us a new respect for your ordinary Joe and the much-maligned English language (or any language). The complexity of language, from the scientist's point of view, is part of our biological birthright; it is not something that parents teach their children or something that must be elaborated in school — as Oscar Wilde said, “Education is an admirable thing, but it is well to remember from time to time that nothing that is worth knowing can be taught.” A preschooler's tacit knowledge of grammar is more sophisticated than the thickest style manual or the most state-of-the-art computer language system, and the same applies to all healthy human beings, even the notorious syntaxfracturing professional athlete and the, you know, like, inarticulate teenage skateboarder. Finally, since language is the product of a wellengineered biological instinct, we shall see that it is not the nutty barrel of monkeys that entertainercolumnists make it out to be.

Question 138

According to the passage, which of the following does not stem from popular wisdom on language?

- A Language is a cultural artifact.
- B Language is a cultural invention.
- C Language is learnt as we grow.
- D Language is unique to Homo sapiens.
- E Language is a psychological faculty.



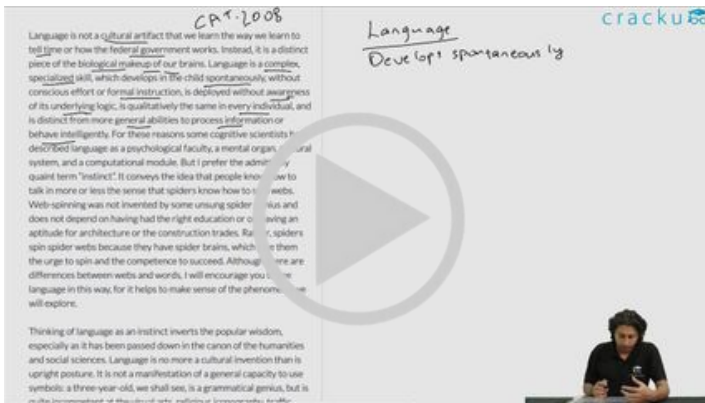
VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 139

Which of the following can be used to replace the “spiders know how to spin webs” analogy as used by the author?

- A A kitten learning to jump over a wall
- B Bees collecting nectar
- C A donkey carrying a load
- D A horse running a Derby
- E A pet clog protecting its owner's property

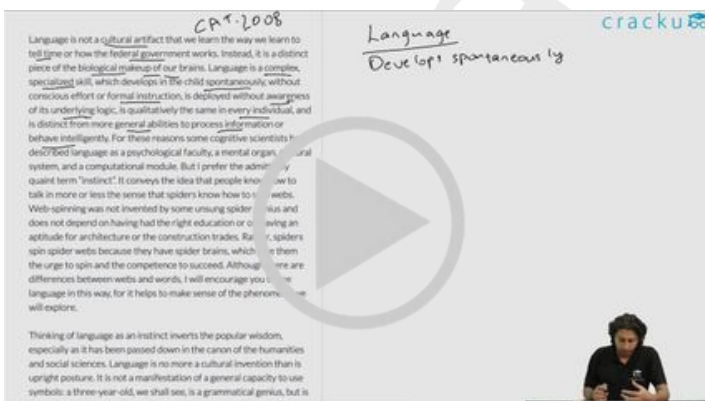


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 140

According to the passage, which of the following is unique to human beings?

- A Ability to use symbols while communicating with one another.
- B Ability to communicate with each other through voice modulation.
- C Ability to communicate information to other members of the species.
- D Ability to use sound as means of communication.
- E All of the above.

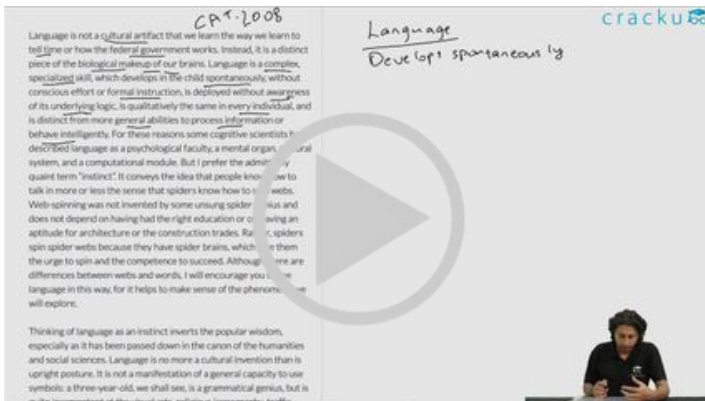


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 141

Which of the following best summarizes the passage?

- A Language is unique to Homo sapiens.
- B Language is neither learnt nor taught.
- C Language is not a cultural invention or artifact as it is made out.
- D Language is instinctive ability of human beings.
- E Language is use of symbols unique to human beings.



VIDEO SOLUTION

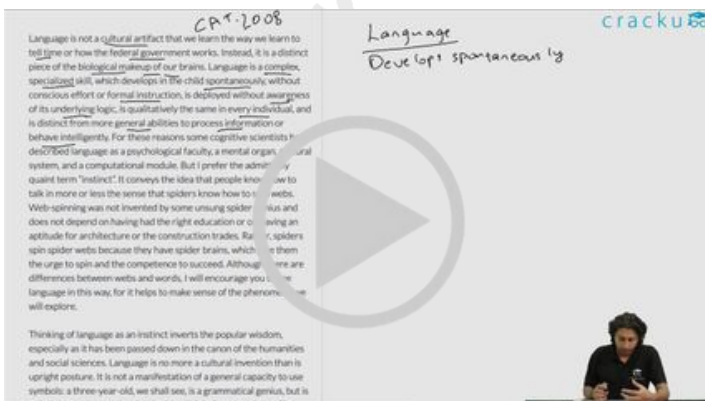
CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 142

According to the passage, complexity of language cannot be taught by parents or at school to children because

- A children instinctively know language.
- B children learn the language on their own.
- C language is not amenable to teaching.
- D children know language better than their teachers or parents.
- E children are born with the knowledge of semiotics.



Instructions

To summarize the Classic Maya collapse, we can tentatively identify five strands. I acknowledge, however, that Maya archaeologists still disagree vigorously among themselves in part, because the different strands evidently varied in importance among different parts of the Maya realm; because detailed archaeological studies are available for only some Maya sites; and because it remains puzzling why most of the Maya heartland remained nearly empty of population and failed to recover after the collapse and after re-growth of forests.

With those caveats, it appears to me that one strand consisted of population growth outstripping available resources: a dilemma similar to the one foreseen by Thomas Malthus in 1798 and being played out today in Rwanda, Haiti and elsewhere. As the archaeologist David Webster succinctly puts it, "Too many farmers grew too many crops on too much of landscape." Compounding that mismatch between population and resources was the second strand: the effects of deforestation and hillside erosion, which caused a decrease in the amount of useable farmland at a time when more rather than less farmland was needed, and possibly exacerbated by an anthropogenic drought resulting from deforestation, by soil nutrient depletion and other soil problems, and by the struggle to prevent bracken ferns from overrunning the fields.

The third strand consisted of increased fighting, as more and more people fought over fewer resources. Maya warfare, already endemic, peaked just before the collapse. That is not surprising when one reflects that at least five million people, perhaps many more, were crammed into an area smaller than the US state of Colorado (104,000 square miles). That warfare would have decreased further the amount of land available for agriculture, by creating no-man's lands between principalities where it was now unsafe to farm. Bringing matters to a head was the strand of climate change. The drought at the time of the Classic collapse was not the first drought that the Maya had lived through, but it was the most severe. At the time of previous droughts, there were still uninhabited parts of the Maya landscape, and people at a site affected by drought could save themselves by moving to another site. However, by the time of the Classic collapse the landscape was now full, there was no useful unoccupied land in the vicinity on which to begin anew, and the whole population could not be accommodated in the few areas that continued to have reliable water supplies.

As our fifth strand, we have to wonder why the kings and nobles failed to recognize and solve these seemingly obvious problems undermining their society. Their attention was evidently focused on their short-term concerns of enriching themselves, waging wars, erecting monuments, competing with each other, and extracting enough food from the peasants to support all those activities. Like most leaders throughout human history, the Maya kings and nobles did not heed long-term problems, insofar as they perceived them.

Finally, while we still have some other past societies to consider before we switch our attention to the modern world, we must already be struck by some parallels between the Maya and the past societies. As on Mangareva, the Maya environmental and population problems led to increasing warfare and civil strife. Similarly, on Easter Island and at Chaco Canyon, the Maya peak population numbers were followed swiftly by political and social collapse. Paralleling the eventual extension of agriculture from Easter Island's coastal lowlands to its uplands, and from the Mimbres floodplain to the hills, Copan's inhabitants also expanded from the floodplain to the more fragile hill slopes, leaving them with a larger population to feed when the agricultural boom in the hills went bust. Like Easter Island chiefs erecting ever larger statues, eventually crowned by pukao, and like Anasazi elite treating themselves to necklaces of 2,000 turquoise beads, Maya kings sought to outdo each other with more and more impressive temples, covered with thicker and thicker plaster — reminiscent in turn of the extravagant conspicuous consumption by modern American CEOs. The passivity of Easter chiefs and Maya kings in the face of the real big threats to their societies completes our list of disquieting parallels.

Question 143

According to the passage, which of the following best represents the factor that has been cited by the author in the context of Rwanda and Haiti?

- A** Various ethnic groups competing for land and other resources

- B Various ethnic groups competing for limited land resources
- C Various ethnic groups fighting with each other
- D Various ethnic groups competing for political power
- E Various ethnic groups fighting for their identity

To summarize the Classic Maya collapse, we can tentatively identify five strands. I acknowledge, however, that Maya archaeologists still disagree vigorously among themselves in part, because the different strands evidently varied in importance ① among different parts of the Maya realm; because detailed archaeological studies are available for only some Maya sites; and because it remains puzzling why most of the Maya heartland remained nearly empty of population and failed to recover after the collapse and after re-growth of forests. ②

With those caveats, it appears to me that one strand consisted of population growth outstripping available resources: a dilemma similar to the one foreseen by Thomas Malthus in 1798 and being played out today in Rwanda, Haiti and elsewhere. As the archaeologist David Webster succinctly puts it, "Too many farmers grew too many crops on too much of landscape." Compounding that mismatch

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 144

According to the passage, the drought at the time of Maya collapse had a different impact compared to the droughts earlier because

- A the Maya kings continued to be extravagant when common people were suffering.
- B it happened at the time of collapse of leadership among Mayas.
- C it happened when the Maya population had occupied all available land suited for agriculture.
- D it was followed by internecine warfare among Mayans.
- E irreversible environmental degradation led to this drought.

To summarize the Classic Maya collapse, we can tentatively identify five strands. I acknowledge, however, that Maya archaeologists still disagree vigorously among themselves in part, because the different strands evidently varied in importance ① among different parts of the Maya realm; because detailed archaeological studies are available for only some Maya sites; and because it remains puzzling why most of the Maya heartland remained nearly empty of population and failed to recover after the collapse and after re-growth of forests. ②

With those caveats, it appears to me that one strand consisted of population growth outstripping available resources: a dilemma similar to the one foreseen by Thomas Malthus in 1798 and being played out today in Rwanda, Haiti and elsewhere. As the archaeologist David Webster succinctly puts it, "Too many farmers grew too many crops on too much of landscape." Compounding that mismatch

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

 **CAT Score Calculator** 

Question 145

Which factor has not been cited as one of the factors causing the collapse of Maya society?

- A Environmental degradation due to excess population
- B Social collapse due to excess population
- C Increased warfare among Maya people
- D Climate change
- E Obsession of Maya population with their own short-term concerns

To summarize the Classic Maya collapse, we can tentatively identify five strands. I acknowledge, however, that Maya archaeologists still disagree vigorously among themselves in part, because the different strands evidently varied in importance among different parts of the Maya realm; because detailed archaeological studies are available from only some Maya sites; and because it remains puzzling why most of the Maya heartland remained nearly empty of population and failed to recover after the collapse and after re-growth of forests.

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cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 146

According to the author, why is it difficult to explain the reasons for Maya collapse?

- A Copan inhabitants destroyed all records of that period.
- B The constant deforestation and hillside erosion have wiped out all traces of the Maya kingdom.
- C Archaeological sites of Mayas do not provide any consistent evidence.
- D It has not been possible to ascertain which of the factors best explains why the Maya civilization collapsed.
- E At least five million people were crammed into a small area.

To summarize the Classic Maya collapse, we can tentatively identify five strands. I acknowledge, however, that Maya archaeologists still disagree vigorously among themselves in part, because the different strands evidently varied in importance among different parts of the Maya realm; because detailed archaeological studies are available from only some Maya sites; and because it remains puzzling why most of the Maya heartland remained nearly empty of population and failed to recover after the collapse and after re-growth of forests.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 147

By an anthropogenic drought, the author means

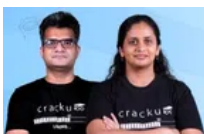
- A a drought caused by lack of rains.
- B a drought caused due to deforestation.
- C a drought caused by failure to prevent bracken ferns from overrunning the fields.
- D a drought caused by actions of human beings.
- E a drought caused by climate changes.

To summarize the Classic Maya collapse, we can tentatively identify five strands. I acknowledge, however, that Maya archaeologists still disagree vigorously among themselves in part, because the different strands evidently varied in importance among different parts of the Maya realm; because detailed archaeological studies are available for only some Maya sites; and because it remains puzzling why most of the Maya heartland remained nearly empty of population and failed to recover after the collapse and after re-growth of forests.

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VIDEO SOLUTION



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Instructions

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

Economists have spent most of the 20th century ignoring psychology, positive or otherwise. But today there is a great deal of emphasis on how happiness can shape global economies, or — on a smaller scale — successful business practice. This is driven, in part, by a trend in "measuring" positive emotions, mostly so they can be optimized. Neuroscientists, for example, claim to be able to locate specific emotions, such as happiness or disappointment, in particular areas of the brain. Wearable technologies, such as Spire, offer data-driven advice on how to reduce stress.

We are no longer just dealing with "happiness" in a philosophical or romantic sense — it has become something that can be monitored and measured, including by our behavior, use of social media and bodily indicators such as pulse rate and facial expressions.

There is nothing automatically sinister about this trend. But it is disquieting that the businesses and experts driving the quantification of happiness claim to have our best interests at heart, often concealing their own agendas in the process. In the workplace, happy workers are viewed as a "win-win." Work becomes more pleasant, and employees, more productive. But this is now being pursued through the use of performance-evaluating wearable technology, such as Humanyze or Virgin Pulse, both of which monitor physical signs of stress and activity toward the goal of increasing productivity.

Cities such as Dubai, which has pledged to become the "happiest city in the world," dream up ever-more elaborate and intrusive ways of collecting data on well-being — to the point where there is now talk of using CCTV cameras to monitor facial expressions in public spaces. New ways of detecting emotions are hitting the market all the time: One company, Beyond Verbal, aims to calculate moods conveyed in a phone conversation,

potentially without the knowledge of at least one of the participants. And Facebook [has] demonstrated . . . that it could influence our emotions through tweaking our news feeds — opening the door to ever-more targeted manipulation in advertising and influence.

As the science grows more sophisticated and technologies become more intimate with our thoughts and bodies, a clear trend is emerging. Where happiness indicators were once used as a basis to reform society, challenging the obsession with money that G.D.P. measurement entrenches, they are increasingly used as a basis to transform or discipline individuals.

Happiness becomes a personal project, that each of us must now work on, like going to the gym. Since the 1970s, depression has come to be viewed as a cognitive or neurological defect in the individual, and never a consequence of circumstances. All of this simply escalates the sense of responsibility each of us feels for our own feelings, and with it, the sense of failure when things go badly. A society that deliberately removed certain sources of misery, such as precarious and exploitative employment, may well be a happier one. But we won't get there by making this single, often fleeting emotion, the over-arching goal.

Question 148

According to the author, wearable technologies and social media are contributing most to:

- A making individuals aware of stress in their lives.
- B depression as a thing of the past.
- C disciplining individuals to be happy.
- D happiness as a “personal project”.

cracku

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

Economists have spent most of the 20th century ignoring psychology, positive or otherwise. But today there is a great deal of emphasis on how happiness can shape global economies, or — on a smaller scale — successful business practices. This is driven, in part, by a trend to “measuring” positive emotions, mostly so they can be optimized. Neuroscientists, for example, claim to be able to locate specific emotions, such as happiness or disappointment, in particular areas of the brain. Wearable technologies, such as Spire, offer data-driven advice on how to reduce stress.

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graph LR; Economists --> Earlier[Earlier: Psychology]; Economists --> Now[Now: Impact of Happiness]
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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 149

The author's view would be undermined by which of the following research findings?

- A Stakeholders globally are moving away from collecting data on the well-being of individuals.
- B There is a definitive move towards the adoption of wearable technology that taps into emotions.
- C A proliferation of gyms that are collecting data on customer well-being.
- D Individuals worldwide are utilising technologies to monitor and increase their well-being.

cracku

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graph TD
    Economists --> Earlier[Earlier: Psychology]
    Economists --> Now[Now: Impact of Happiness]
  
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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 150

In the author's opinion, the shift in thinking in the 1970s:

- A put people in touch with their own feelings rather than depending on psychologists.
- B was a welcome change from the earlier view that depression could be cured by changing circumstances.
- C introduced greater stress into people's lives as they were expected to be responsible for their own happiness.
- D reflected the emergence of neuroscience as the authority on human emotions.

cracku

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Economists have spent most of the 20th century ignoring psychology, positive or otherwise. But today there is a great deal of emphasis on how happiness can shape global economies, or — on a smaller scale — successful business practices. This is driven, in part, by a trend in “measuring” positive emotions, mostly so they can be optimized. Neuroscientists, for example, claim to be able to locate specific emotions, such as happiness or disappointment, in particular areas of the brain. Wearable technologies, such as *Spire*, offer data-driven advice on how to reduce stress.

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graph TD
    Economists --> Earlier[Earlier: Psychology]
    Economists --> Now[Now: Impact of Happiness]
  
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VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 151

According to the author, Dubai:

- A collaborates with Facebook to selectively influence its inhabitants' moods.
- B develops sophisticated technologies to monitor its inhabitants' states of mind.

C is on its way to becoming one of the world's happiest cities.

D incentivises companies that prioritise worker welfare.

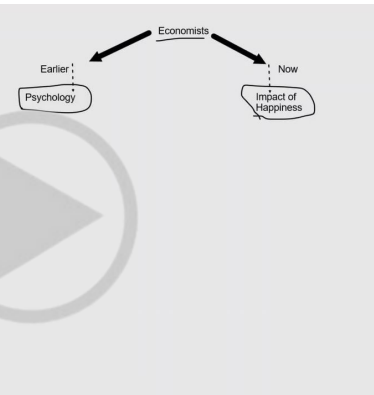
cracku

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graph TD; Economists --> Earlier; Economists --> Now; Earlier --- Psychology; Now --- ImpactOfHappiness[Impact of Happiness];
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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 152

From the passage we can infer that the author would like economists to:

- A work closely with neuroscientists to understand human behaviour.
- B incorporate psychological findings into their research cautiously.
- C correlate measurements of happiness with economic indicators.
- D measure the effectiveness of Facebook and social media advertising.

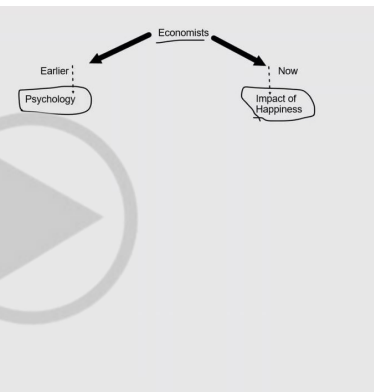
cracku

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graph TD; Economists --> Earlier; Economists --> Now; Earlier --- Psychology; Now --- ImpactOfHappiness[Impact of Happiness];
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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

A game of strategy, as currently conceived in game theory, is a situation in which two or more “players” make choices among available alternatives (moves). The totality of choices determines the outcomes of the game, and it is assumed that the rank order of preferences for the outcomes is different for different players. Thus the “interests” of the players are generally in conflict. Whether these interests are diametrically opposed or only partially opposed depends on the type of game.

Psychologically, most interesting situations arise when the interests of the players are partly coincident and partly opposed, because then one can postulate not only a conflict among the players but also inner conflicts within the players. Each is torn between a tendency to cooperate, so as to promote the common interests, and a tendency to compete, so as to enhance his own individual interests.

Internal conflicts are always psychologically interesting. What we vaguely call “interesting” psychology is in very great measure the psychology of inner conflict. Inner conflict is also held to be an important component of serious literature as distinguished from less serious genres. The classical tragedy, as well as the serious novel, reveals the inner conflict of central figures. The superficial adventure story, on the other hand, depicts only external conflict; that is, the threats to the person with whom the reader (or viewer) identifies stem in these stories exclusively from external obstacles and from the adversaries who create them. On the most primitive level this sort of external conflict is psychologically empty. In the fistcuffs between the protagonists of good and evil, no psychological problems are involved or, at any rate, none are depicted in juvenile representations of conflict.

The detective story, the “adult” analogue of a juvenile adventure tale, has at times been described as a glorification of intellectualized conflict. However, a great deal of the interest in the plots of these stories is sustained by withholding the unraveling of a solution to a problem. The effort of solving the problem is in itself not a conflict if the adversary (the unknown criminal) remains passive, like Nature, whose secrets the scientist supposedly unravels by deduction. If the adversary actively puts obstacles in the detective’s path toward the solution, there is genuine conflict. But the conflict is psychologically interesting only to the extent that it contains irrational components such as a tactical error on the criminal’s part or the detective’s insight into some psychological quirk of the criminal or something of this sort. Conflict conducted in a perfectly rational manner is psychologically no more interesting than a standard Western. For example, Tic-tac-toe, played perfectly by both players, is completely devoid of psychological interest. Chess may be psychologically interesting but only to the extent that it is played not quite rationally. Played completely rationally, chess would not be different from Tic-tac-toe.

In short, a pure conflict of interest (what is called a zero-sum game) although it offers a wealth of interesting conceptual problems, is not interesting psychologically, except to the extent that its conduct departs from rational norms.

Question 153

According to the passage, internal conflicts are psychologically more interesting than external conflicts because

- A internal conflicts, rather than external conflicts, form an important component of serious literature as distinguished from less serious genres.
- B only juveniles or very few “adults” actually experience external conflict, while internal conflict is more widely prevalent in society.
- C in situations of internal conflict, individuals experience a dilemma in resolving their own preferences for different outcomes.
- D there are no threats to the reader (or viewer) in case of external conflicts.

A game of strategy, as currently conceived in game theory, is a situation in which two or more “players” make choices among available alternatives (moves). The totality of choices determines the outcomes of the game, and it is assumed that the rank order of preferences for the outcomes is different for different players. Thus the “interests” of the players are generally in conflict. Whether these interests are diametrically opposed or only partially opposed depends on the type of game.

Psychologically, most interesting situations arise when the interests of the players are partly coincident and partly opposed, because then one can postulate not only a conflict among the players but also inner conflicts within the players. Each is torn between a tendency to cooperate, so as to promote the common interests, and a tendency to compete, so as to enhance his own individual interests.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 154

The problem solving process of a scientist is different from that of a detective because

- A scientists study inanimate objects, while detectives deal with living criminals or law offenders.
- B scientists study known objects, while detectives have to deal with unknown criminals or law offenders.
- C scientists study phenomena that are not actively altered, while detectives deal with phenomena that have been deliberately influenced to mislead.
- D scientists study psychologically interesting phenomena, while detectives deal with "adult" analogues of juvenile adventure tales.

A game of strategy, as currently conceived in game theory, is a situation in which two or more "players" make choices among available alternatives (moves). The totality of choices determines the outcomes of the game, and it is assumed that the rank order of preferences for the outcomes is different for different players. Thus the "interests" of the players are generally in conflict. Whether these interests are diametrically opposed or only partially opposed depends on the type of game.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 155

According to the passage, which of the following options about the application of game theory to a conflict-of-interest situation is true?

- A Assuming that the rank order of preferences for options is different for different players.
- B Accepting that the interests of different players are often in conflict.
- C Not assuming that the interests are in complete disagreement.
- D All of the above.

A game of strategy, as currently conceived in game theory, is a situation in which two or more "players" make choices among available alternatives (moves). The totality of choices determines the outcomes of the game, and it is assumed that the rank order of preferences for the outcomes is different for different players. Thus the "interests" of the players are generally in conflict. Whether these interests are diametrically opposed or only partially opposed depends on the type of game.

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Question 156

Which, according to the author, would qualify as interesting psychology?

- A A statistician's dilemma over choosing the best method to solve an optimisation problem.
- B A chess player's predicament over adopting a defensive strategy against an aggressive opponent.
- C A mountaineer's choice of the best path to Mt. Everest from the base camp.
- D A finance manager's quandary over the best way of raising money from the market.

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Cuttlefish are full of personality, as behavioral ecologist Alexandra Schnell found out while researching the cephalopod's potential to display self-control. . . . "Self-control is thought to be the cornerstone of intelligence, as it is an important prerequisite for complex decision-making and planning for the future," says Schnell . . .

[Schnell's] study used a modified version of the "marshmallow test" . . . During the original marshmallow test, psychologist Walter Mischel presented children between age four and six with one marshmallow. He told them that if they waited 15 minutes and didn't eat it, he would give them a second marshmallow. A long-term follow-up study showed that the children who waited for the second marshmallow had more success later in life. . . . The cuttlefish version of the experiment looked a lot different. The researchers worked with six cuttlefish under nine months old and presented them with seafood instead of sweets. (Preliminary experiments showed that cuttlefishes' favorite food is live grass shrimp, while raw prawns are so-so and Asian shore crab is nearly unacceptable.) Since the researchers couldn't explain to the cuttlefish that they would need to wait for their shrimp, they trained them to recognize certain shapes that indicated when a food item would become available. The symbols were pasted on transparent drawers so that the cuttlefish could see the food that was stored inside. One drawer, labeled with a circle to mean "immediate," held raw king prawn. Another drawer, labeled with a triangle to mean "delayed," held live grass shrimp. During a control experiment, square labels meant "never."

"If their self-control is flexible and I hadn't just trained them to wait in any context, you would expect the cuttlefish to take the immediate reward [in the control], even if it's their second preference," says Schnell . . . and that's what they did. That showed the researchers that cuttlefish wouldn't reject the prawns if it was the only food available. In the experimental trials, the cuttlefish didn't jump on the prawns if the live grass shrimp were

labeled with a triangle— many waited for the shrimp drawer to open up. Each time the cuttlefish showed it could wait, the researchers tacked another ten seconds on to the next round of waiting before releasing the shrimp. The longest that a cuttlefish waited was 130 seconds.

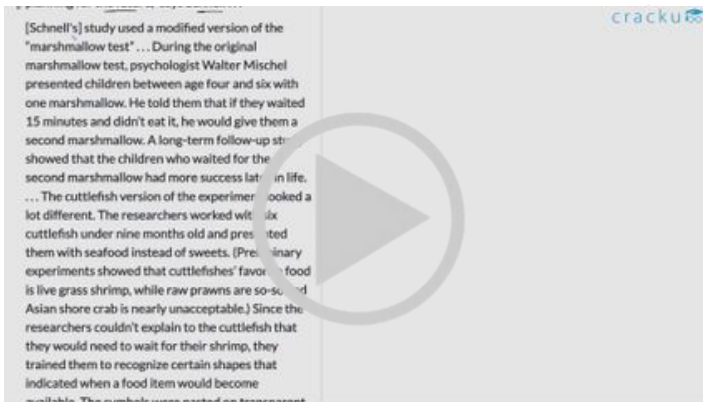
Schnell [says] that the cuttlefish usually sat at the bottom of the tank and looked at the two food items while they waited, but sometimes, they would turn away from the king prawn “as if to distract themselves from the temptation of the immediate reward.” In past studies, humans, chimpanzees, parrots and dogs also tried to distract themselves while waiting for a reward.

Not every species can use self-control, but most of the animals that can share another trait in common: long, social lives. Cuttlefish, on the other hand, are solitary creatures that don’t form relationships even with mates or young. . . . “We don’t know if living in a social group is important for complex cognition unless we also show those abilities are lacking in less social species,” says . . . comparative psychologist Jennifer Vonk.

Question 157

All of the following constitute a point of difference between the “original” and “modified” versions of the marshmallow test EXCEPT that:

- A the former had human subjects, while the latter had cuttlefish.
- B the former correlated self-control and future success, while the latter correlated selfcontrol and survival advantages.
- C the former used verbal communication with its subjects, while the latter had to develop a symbolic means of communication.
- D the former was performed over a longer time span than the latter.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 158

Which one of the following, if true, would best complement the passage’s findings?

- A Cuttlefish are equally fond of live grass shrimp and raw prawns.
- B Cuttlefish live in big groups that exhibit sociability.
- C Cuttlefish wait longer than 100 seconds for the shrimp drawer to open up.
- D Cuttlefish cannot distinguish between geometrical shapes.

[Schnell's] study used a modified version of the "marshmallow test" ... During the original marshmallow test, psychologist Walter Mischel presented children between age four and six with one marshmallow. He told them that if they waited 15 minutes and didn't eat it, he would give them a second marshmallow. A long-term follow-up study showed that the children who waited for the second marshmallow had more success later in life. ... The cuttlefish version of the experiment looked a lot different. The researchers worked with six cuttlefish under nine months old and presented them with seafood instead of sweets. (Preliminary experiments showed that cuttlefishes' favorite food is live grass shrimp, while raw prawns are so-called Asian shore crab is nearly unacceptable.) Since the researchers couldn't explain to the cuttlefish that they would need to wait for their shrimp, they trained them to recognize certain shapes that indicated when a food item would become available. The cuttlefish were trained on transparent

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 159

Which one of the following cannot be inferred from Alexandra Schnell's experiment?

- A Like human children, cuttlefish are capable of self-control.
- B Intelligence in a species is impossible without sociability.
- C Cuttlefish exercise choice when it comes to food.
- D Cuttlefish exert self-control with the help of diversions.

[Schnell's] study used a modified version of the "marshmallow test" ... During the original marshmallow test, psychologist Walter Mischel presented children between age four and six with one marshmallow. He told them that if they waited 15 minutes and didn't eat it, he would give them a second marshmallow. A long-term follow-up study showed that the children who waited for the second marshmallow had more success later in life. ... The cuttlefish version of the experiment looked a lot different. The researchers worked with six cuttlefish under nine months old and presented them with seafood instead of sweets. (Preliminary experiments showed that cuttlefishes' favorite food is live grass shrimp, while raw prawns are so-called Asian shore crab is nearly unacceptable.) Since the researchers couldn't explain to the cuttlefish that they would need to wait for their shrimp, they trained them to recognize certain shapes that indicated when a food item would become available. The cuttlefish were trained on transparent

VIDEO SOLUTION

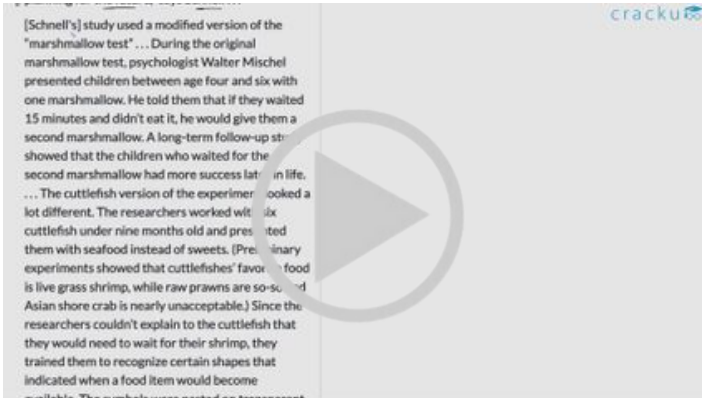


Question 160

In which one of the following scenarios would the cuttlefish's behaviour demonstrate self-control?

- A Asian shore crabs and raw prawns are simultaneously released while a live grass shrimp drawer labelled with a triangle is placed in front of the cuttlefish, to be opened after one minute.
- B raw prawns are released while a live grass shrimp drawer labelled with a square is placed in front of the cuttlefish.

- C raw prawns are released while an Asian shore crab drawer labelled with a triangle is placed in front of the cuttlefish, to be opened after one minute.
- D live grass shrimp are released while two raw prawn drawers labelled with a circle and a triangle respectively are placed in front of the cuttlefish; the triangle-labelled drawer is opened after 50 seconds.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

In the past, credit for telling the tale of Aladdin has often gone to Antoine Galland . . . the first European translator of . . . Arabian Nights [which] started as a series of translations of an incomplete manuscript of a medieval Arabic story collection. . . But, though those tales were of medieval origin, Aladdin may be a more recent invention. Scholars have not found a manuscript of the story that predates the version published in 1712 by Galland, who wrote in his diary that he first heard the tale from a Syrian storyteller from Aleppo named Hanna Diyab. . .

Despite the fantastical elements of the story, scholars now think the main character may actually be based on a real person's real experiences. . . Though Galland never credited Diyab in his published translations of the Arabian Nights stories, Diyab wrote something of his own: a travelogue penned in the mid-18th century. In it, he recalls telling Galland the story of Aladdin [and] describes his own hard-knocks upbringing and the way he marveled at the extravagance of Versailles. The descriptions he uses were very similar to the descriptions of the lavish palace that ended up in Galland's version of the Aladdin story. [Therefore, author Paulo Lemos] Horta believes that "Aladdin might be the young Arab Maronite from Aleppo, marveling at the jewels and riches of Versailles." . . .

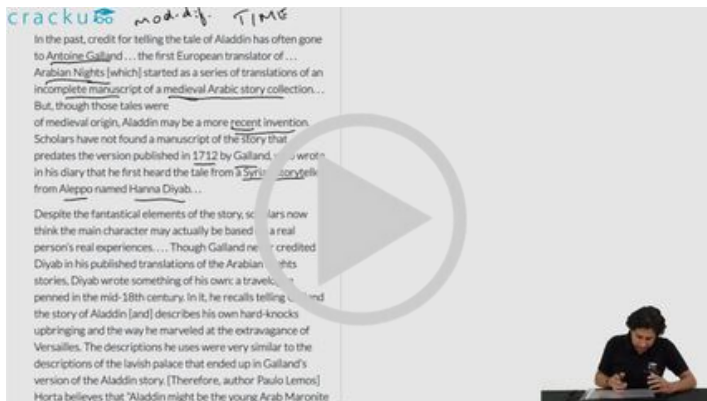
For 300 years, scholars thought that the rags-to-riches story of Aladdin might have been inspired by the plots of French fairy tales that came out around the same time, or that the story was invented in that 18th century period as a byproduct of French Orientalism, a fascination with stereotypical exotic Middle Eastern luxuries that was prevalent then. The idea that Diyab might have based it on his own life — the experiences of a Middle Eastern man encountering the French, not vice-versa — flips the script. [According to Horta,] "Diyab was ideally placed to embody the overlapping world of East and West, blending the storytelling traditions of his homeland with his youthful observations of the wonder of 18th-century France." . . .

To the scholars who study the tale, its narrative drama isn't the only reason storytellers keep finding reason to return to Aladdin. It reflects not only "a history of the French and the Middle East, but also [a story about] Middle Easterners coming to Paris and that speaks to our world today," as Horta puts it. "The day Diyab told the story of Aladdin to Galland, there were riots due to food shortages during the winter and spring of 1708 to 1709, and Diyab was sensitive to those people in a way that Galland is not. When you read this diary, you see this solidarity among the Arabs who were in Paris at the time. . . There is little in the writings of Galland that would suggest that he was capable of developing a character like Aladdin with sympathy, but Diyab's memoir reveals a narrator adept at capturing the distinctive psychology of a young protagonist, as well as recognizing the kinds of injustices and opportunities that can transform the path of any youthful adventurer."

Question 161

Which of the following, if true, would invalidate the inversion that the phrase “flips the script” refers to?

- A Diyab’s travelogue described the affluence of the French city of Bordeaux, instead of Versailles.
- B The French fairy tales of the eighteenth century did not have rags-to-riches plot lines like that of the tale of Aladdin.
- C The description of opulence in Hanna Diyab’s and Antoine Galland’s narratives bore no resemblance to each other.
- D Galland acknowledged in the published translations of Arabian Nights that he heard the story of Aladdin from Diyab.

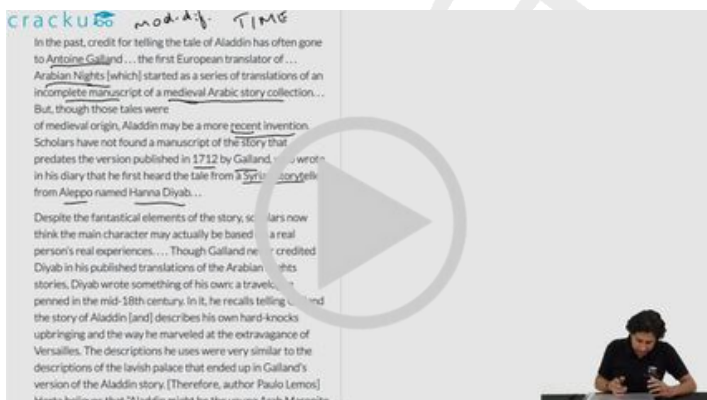


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 162

Which of the following is the primary reason for why storytellers are still fascinated by the story of Aladdin?

- A The traveller's experience that inspired the tale of Aladdin resonates even today.
- B The archetype of the rags-to-riches story of Aladdin makes it popular even today.
- C The tale of Aladdin documents the history of Europe and Middle East.
- D The story of Aladdin is evidence of the eighteenth century French Orientalist attitude.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 163

All of the following serve as evidence for the character of Aladdin being based on Hanna Diyab EXCEPT:

- A Diyab's narration of the original story to Galland.
- B Diyab's humble origins and class struggles, as recounted in his travelogue.
- C Diyab's description of the wealth of Versailles in his travelogue.
- D Diyab's cosmopolitanism and cross-cultural experience.



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 164

The author of the passage is most likely to agree with which of the following explanations for the origins of the story of Aladdin?

- A Basing it on his own life experiences, Diyab transmitted the story of Aladdin to Galland who included it in Arabian Nights.
- B Galland derived the story of Aladdin from Diyab's travelogue in which he recounts his fascination with the wealth of Versailles.
- C The story of Aladdin has its origins in an undiscovered, incomplete manuscript of a medieval Arabic collection of stories.
- D Galland received the story of Aladdin from Diyab who, in turn, found it in an incomplete medieval manuscript.



historical sciences, is most feasible on large spatial scales and over long times, when the unique features of millions of small-scale brief events become averaged out. Just as I could predict the sex ratio of the next 1,000 newborns but not the sexes of my own two children, the historian can recognize factors that made 1 inevitable the broad outcome of the collision between American and Eurasian societies after 13,000 years of separate developments, but not the outcome of the 1960 U.S. presidential election. The details of which candidate said what during a single televised debate in October 1960 could have given the electoral victory to Nixon instead of to Kennedy, but no details of who said what could have blocked the European conquest of Native Americans. How can students of human history profit from the experience of scientists in other historical sciences? A methodology that has proved useful involves the comparative method and so-called natural experiments. While neither astronomers studying galaxy formation nor human historians can manipulate their systems in controlled laboratory experiments, they both can take advantage of natural experiments, by comparing systems differing in the presence or absence (or in the strong or weak effect) of some putative causative factor. For example, epidemiologists, forbidden to feed large amounts of salt to people experimentally, have still been able to identify effects of high salt intake by comparing groups of humans who already differ greatly in their salt intake; and cultural anthropologists, unable to provide human groups experimentally with varying resource abundances for many centuries, still study long-term effects of resource abundance on human societies by comparing recent Polynesian populations living on islands differing naturally in resource abundance.

The student of human history can draw on many more natural experiments than just comparisons among the five inhabited continents. Comparisons can also utilize large islands that have developed complex societies in a considerable degree of isolation (such as Japan, Madagascar, Native American Hispaniola, New Guinea, Hawaii, and many others), as well as societies on hundreds of smaller islands and regional societies within each of the continents. Natural experiments in any field, whether in ecology or human history, are inherently open to potential methodological criticisms. Those include confounding effects of natural variation in additional variables besides the one of interest, as well as problems in inferring chains of causation from observed correlations between variables. Such methodological problems have been discussed in great detail for some of the historical sciences. In particular, epidemiology, the science of drawing inferences about human diseases by comparing groups of people (often by retrospective historical studies), has for a long time successfully employed formalized procedures for dealing with problems similar to those facing historians of human societies. In short, I acknowledge that it is much more difficult to understand human history than to understand problems in fields of science where history is unimportant and where fewer individual variables operate. Nevertheless, successful methodologies for analyzing historical problems have been worked out in several fields. As a result, the histories of dinosaurs, nebulae, and glaciers are generally acknowledged to belong to fields of science rather than to the humanities.

Question 166

According to the author, which of the following statements would be true?

- A Students of history are missing significant opportunities by not conducting any natural experiments.
- B Complex societies inhabiting large islands provide great opportunities for natural experiments.
- C Students of history are missing significant opportunities by not studying an adequate variety of natural experiments.
- D A unique problem faced by historians is their inability to establish cause and effect relationships.
- E Cultural anthropologists have overcome the problem of confounding variables through natural experiments.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 167

Why do islands with considerable degree of isolation provide valuable insights into human history?

- A Isolated islands may evolve differently and this difference is of interest to us.

- B Isolated islands increase the number of observations available to historians.
- C Isolated islands, differing in their endowments and size may evolve differently and this difference can be attributed to their endowments and size.
- D Isolated islands, differing in their endowments and size, provide a good comparison to large islands such as Eurasia, Africa, Americas and Australia.
- E Isolated islands, in so far as they are inhabited, arouse curiosity about how human beings evolved there.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 168

According to the author, why is prediction difficult in history?

- A Historical explanations are usually broad so that no prediction is possible.
- B Historical outcomes depend upon a large number of factors and hence predictions are difficult for each case.
- C Historical sciences, by their very nature, are not interested in a multitude of minor factors, which might be important in a specific historical outcome.
- D Historians are interested in evolution of human history and hence are only interested in long term predictions.
- E Historical sciences suffer from the inability to conduct controlled experiments and therefore have explanations based on a few long term factors.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions

cracku



Instructions

The passage given below is followed by a set of three questions. Choose the most appropriate answer to each question.

Every civilized society lives and thrives on a silent but profound agreement as to what is to be accepted as the valid mould of experience. Civilization is a complex system of dams, dykes, and canals warding off, directing, and articulating the influx of the surrounding fluid element; a fertile fenland, elaborately drained and protected from the high tides of chaotic, unexercised, and inarticulate experience. In such a culture, stable and sure of itself within the frontiers of 'naturalized' experience, the arts wield their creative power not so much in width as in depth. They do not create new experience, but deepen and purify the old. Their works do not differ from one another like a new horizon from a new horizon, but like a madonna from a madonna.

The periods of art which are most vigorous in creative passion seem to occur when the established pattern of experience loosens its rigidity without as yet losing its force. Such a period was the Renaissance, and Shakespeare its poetic consummation. Then it was as though the discipline of the old order gave depth to the excitement of the breaking away, the depth of joy and tragedy, of incomparable conquests and irredeemable losses. Adventurers of experience set out as though in lifeboats to rescue and bring back to the shore treasures of knowing and feeling which the old order had left floating on the high seas. The works of the early Renaissance and the poetry of Shakespeare vibrate with the compassion for live experience in danger of dying from exposure and neglect. In this compassion was the creative genius of the age. Yet, it was a genius of

courage, not of desperate audacity. For, however elusively, it still knew of harbours and anchors, of homes to which to return, and of barns in which to store the harvest. The exploring spirit of art was in the depths of its consciousness still aware of a scheme of things into which to fit its exploits and creations.

But the more this scheme of things loses its stability, the more boundless and uncharted appears the ocean of potential exploration. In the blank confusion of infinite potentialities flotsam of significance gets attached to jetsam of experience; for everything is sea, everything is at sea -

The sea is all about us;

The sea is the land's edge also, the granite

Into which it reaches, the beaches where it tosses

Its hints of earlier and other creation ...

- and Rilke tells a story in which, as in T.S. Eliot's poem, it is again the sea and the distance of 'other creation' that becomes the image of the poet's reality. A rowing boat sets out on a difficult passage. The oarsmen labour in exact rhythm. There is no sign yet of the destination. Suddenly a man, seemingly idle, breaks out into song. And if the labour of the oarsmen meaninglessly defeats the real resistance of the real waves, it is the idle single who magically conquers the despair of apparent aimlessness. While the people next to him try to come to grips with the element that is next to them, his voice seems to bind the boat to the farthest distance so that the farthest distance draws it towards itself. 'I don't know why and how,' is Rilke's conclusion, 'but suddenly I understood the situation of the poet, his place and function in this age. It does not matter if one denies him every place - except this one. There one must tolerate him.'

Question 169

In the passage, the expression "like a madonna from a madonna" alludes to

- A The difference arising as a consequence of artistic license.
- B The difference between two artistic interpretations.
- C The difference between 'life' and 'interpretation of life'.
- D The difference between 'width' and 'depth' of creative power.
- E The difference between the legendary character and the modern day singer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 170

According to the passage, the term "adventurers of experience" refers to

- A Poets and artists who are driven by courage.
- B Poets and artists who create their own genre.
- C Poets and artists of the Renaissance.
- D Poets and artists who revitalize and enrich the past for us.
- E Poets and artists who delve in flotsam and jetsam in sea.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 171

The sea and 'other creation' leads Rilke to

- A Define the place of the poet in his culture.
- B Reflect on the role of the oarsman and the singer.

- C Muse on artistic labour and its aim lessens.
- D Understand the elements that one has to deal with.
- E Delve into natural experience and real waves.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

We begin with the emergence of the philosophy of the social sciences as an arena of thought and as a set of social institutions. The two characterisations overlap but are not congruent. Academic disciplines are social institutions. . . . My view is that institutions are all those social entities that organise action: they link acting individuals into social structures. There are various kinds of institutions. Hegelians and Marxists emphasise universal institutions such as the family, rituals, governance, economy and the military. These are mostly institutions that just grew. Perhaps in some imaginary beginning of time they spontaneously appeared. In their present incarnations, however, they are very much the product of conscious attempts to mould and plan them. We have family law, established and disestablished churches, constitutions and laws, including those governing the economy and the military. Institutions deriving from statute, like joint-stock companies are formal by contrast with informal ones such as friendships. There are some institutions that come in both informal and formal variants, as well as in mixed ones. Consider the fact that the stock exchange and the black market are both market institutions, one formal one not. Consider further that there are many features of the work of the stock exchange that rely on informal, noncodifiable agreements, not least the language used for communication. To be precise, mixtures are the norm . . . From constitutions at the top to by-laws near the bottom we are always adding to, or tinkering with, earlier institutions, the grown and the designed are intertwined.

It is usual in social thought to treat culture and tradition as different from, although alongside, institutions. The view taken here is different. Culture and tradition are sub-sets of institutions analytically isolated for explanatory or expository purposes. Some social scientists have taken all institutions, even purely local ones, to be entities that satisfy basic human needs - under local conditions . . . Others differed and declared any structure of reciprocal roles and norms an institution. Most of these differences are differences of emphasis rather than disagreements. Let us straddle all these versions and present institutions very generally . . . as structures that serve to coordinate the actions of individuals. . . . Institutions themselves then have no aims or purpose other than those given to them by actors or used by actors to explain them . . .

Language is the formative institution for social life and for science . . . Both formal and informal language is involved, naturally grown or designed. (Language is all of these to varying degrees.) Languages are paradigms of institutions or, from another perspective, nested sets of institutions. Syntax, semantics, lexicon and alphabet/character-set are all institutions within the larger institutional framework of a written language. Natural languages are typical examples of what Ferguson called 'the result of human action, but not the execution of any human design'[] reformed natural languages and artificial languages introduce design into their modifications or refinements of natural language. Above all, languages are paradigms of institutional tools that function to coordinate.

Question 172

"Consider the fact that the stock exchange and the black market are both market institutions, one formal one not." Which one of the following statements best explains this quote, in the context of the passage?

- A Market instruments can be formally traded in the stock exchange and informally traded in the black market.

- B** The stock exchange and the black market are both organised to function by rules.
- C** The stock exchange and the black market are examples of how, even within the same domain, different kinds of institutions can co-exist.
- D** The stock exchange and the black market are both dependent on the market to survive.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

→ 2 ways of looking @ social sciences

We begin with the emergence of the philosophy of the social sciences as an arena of thought and as a set of social institutions. The two characterisations overlap but are not congruent. Academic disciplines are social institutions. ... My view is that institutions are all those social entities that organise action: they link acting individuals into social structures. There are various kinds of institutions. Hegelians and Marxists emphasise universal institutions such as the family, rituals, governance, economy and the military. These are mostly institutions that just appeared. In their present incarnations, however, they are the product of conscious attempts to mould and plan them. We have family law, established and disestablished churches, constitutions and laws, including those governing the economy and the military. Institutions deriving from statute, like joint-stock companies are formally contrasted with informal ones such as friendships. There are some institutions that come in both informal and formal variants, as well as in mixed ones. Consider the fact that the stock exchange and the black market are both market institutions, one formal one not. Consider further that there are many features of the work of the stock exchange that rely on informal noncodifiable agreements, not least the language used for communication. To be precise, mixtures are the norm. ... From constitutions at the top to by-laws near the bottom we are always adding to, or tinkering with, earlier institutions, the grown and the designed are intertained.

It is usual in social thought to treat culture and tradition as different from, although alongside, institutions. The view taken here is different. Culture

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 173

All of the following inferences from the passage are false, EXCEPT:

- A** as concepts, "culture" and "tradition" have no analytical, explanatory or expository power, especially when they are treated in isolation.
- B** the institution of friendship cannot be found in the institution of joint-stock companies because the first is an informal institution, while the second is a formal one.
- C** institutions like the family, rituals, governance, economy, and the military are natural and cannot be consciously modified.
- D** "natural language" refers to that stage of language development where no conscious human intent is evident in the formation of language.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

→ 2 ways of looking @ social sciences

We begin with the emergence of the philosophy of the social sciences as an arena of thought and as a set of social institutions. The two characterisations overlap but are not congruent. Academic disciplines are social institutions. ... My view is that institutions are all those social entities that organise action: they link acting individuals into social structures. There are various kinds of institutions. Hegelians and Marxists emphasise universal institutions such as the family, rituals, governance, economy and the military. These are mostly institutions that just appeared. In their present incarnations, however, they are the product of conscious attempts to mould and plan them. We have family law, established and disestablished churches, constitutions and laws, including those governing the economy and the military. Institutions deriving from statute, like joint-stock companies are formally contrasted with informal ones such as friendships. There are some institutions that come in both informal and formal variants, as well as in mixed ones. Consider the fact that the stock exchange and the black market are both market institutions, one formal one not. Consider further that there are many features of the work of the stock exchange that rely on informal noncodifiable agreements, not least the language used for communication. To be precise, mixtures are the norm. ... From constitutions at the top to by-laws near the bottom we are always adding to, or tinkering with, earlier institutions, the grown and the designed are intertained.

It is usual in social thought to treat culture and tradition as different from, although alongside, institutions. The view taken here is different. Culture

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 174

Which of the following statements best represents the essence of the passage?

- A It is usual in social thought to treat culture and tradition as different from institutions.
- B Language is the fundamental formal institution for social life and for science.
- C The stock exchange and the black market are both market institutions.
- D Institutions are structures that serve to coordinate the actions of individuals.



VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF



Question 175

In the first paragraph of the passage, what are the two “characterisations” that are seen as overlapping but not congruent?

- A “an arena of thought” and “academic disciplines”.
- B “individuals” and “social structures”.
- C “the philosophy of the social sciences” and “a set of social institutions”.
- D “academic disciplines” and “institutions”.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

For a relatively new class of consumer-products start-ups, there's another method entirely. Instead of making sense of a sea of existing stuff, these companies claim to disrupt stuff as Americans know it. Casper (mattresses), Glossier (makeup), Away (suitcases), and many others have sprouted up to offer consumers freedom from choice: The companies have a few aesthetically pleasing and supposedly highly functional options, usually at mid-range prices. They're selling nice things, but maybe more importantly, they're selling a confidence in those things, and an ability to opt out of the stuff rat race. . . .

For start-ups that promise accessible simplicity, their very structure still might eventually push them toward overwhelming variety. Most of these companies are based on hundreds of millions of dollars of venture capital, the investors of which tend to expect a steep growth rate that can't be achieved by selling one great mattress or one great sneaker. Casper has expanded into bedroom furniture and bed linens. Glossier, after years of marketing itself as no-makeup makeup that requires little skill to apply, recently launched a full line of glittering color cosmetics. There may be no way to opt out of stuff by buying into the right thing.

Which of the following hypothetical statements would add the least depth to the author's prediction of the fate of start-ups offering few product options?

- 114/732

cracku 2E IM ID

Contemporary internet shopping conjures a perfect storm of choice anxiety. Research has consistently held that people who are presented with a few options make better, easier decisions than those presented with many.... Helping consumers figure out what to buy amid an endless sea of choice online has become a cottage industry unto itself. Many brands and retailers now wield marketing buzzwords such as curate, differentiation, and discovery as they attempt to sell an assortment of stuff targeted to their ideal customers. Companies find such shoppers through the data mine of digital advertising, which can catalog people by level, personal interests, and more. Since Americans have lost the ability to sort through the sheer volume of choices available to them, a ghost now has to be the retail machine, whether it's an algorithm, an influencer, or some snazzy ad tech to help a product follow you around the Internet. Indeed, choice fatigue is one reason so many people gravitate toward lifestyle influencers on Instagram—the relentlessly chic young moms and perpetually vacationing 20-somethings—who present an aspirational worldview, and then recommend the products and services that help achieve it.... For a relatively new class of consumer-products start-ups, the



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 177

All of the following, IF TRUE, would weaken the author's claims EXCEPT:

- A the annual sale of companies that hired lifestyle influencers on Instagram for marketing their products were 40% less than those that did not.
- B product options increased market competition, bringing down the prices of commodities, which, in turn, increased purchasing power of the poor.
- C the empowerment felt by purchasers in buying a commodity were directly proportional to the number of options they could choose from.
- D the annual sales growth of companies with fewer product options were higher than that of companies which curated their products for target consumers.

cracku 2E IM ID

Contemporary internet shopping conjures a perfect storm of choice anxiety. Research has consistently held that people who are presented with a few options make better, easier decisions than those presented with many.... Helping consumers figure out what to buy amid an endless sea of choice online has become a cottage industry unto itself. Many brands and retailers now wield marketing buzzwords such as curate, differentiation, and discovery as they attempt to sell an assortment of stuff targeted to their ideal customers. Companies find such shoppers through the data mine of digital advertising, which can catalog people by level, personal interests, and more. Since Americans have lost the ability to sort through the sheer volume of choices available to them, a ghost now has to be the retail machine, whether it's an algorithm, an influencer, or some snazzy ad tech to help a product follow you around the Internet. Indeed, choice fatigue is one reason so many people gravitate toward lifestyle influencers on Instagram—the relentlessly chic young moms and perpetually vacationing 20-somethings—who present an aspirational worldview, and then recommend the products and services that help achieve it.... For a relatively new class of consumer-products start-ups, the



VIDEO SOLUTION

cracku

IMPORTANT

CAT Important Topics

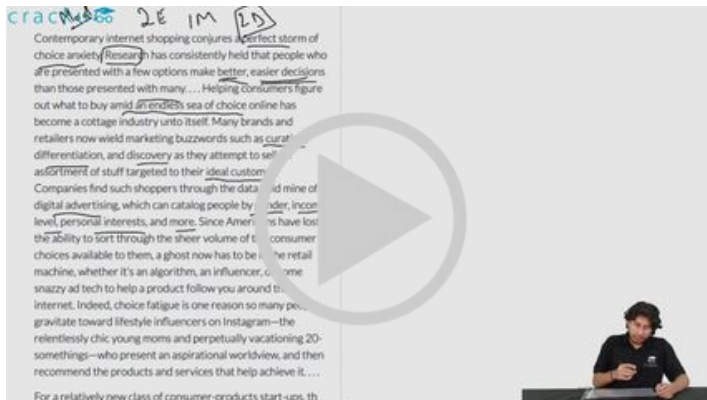


Question 178

Which one of the following best sums up the overall purpose of the examples of Casper and Glossier in the passage?

- A They are exceptions to a dominant trend in consumer markets.

- B They are increasing the purchasing power of poor Americans.
- C They might transform into what they were exceptions to.
- D They are facilitating a uniform distribution of commodities in the market.

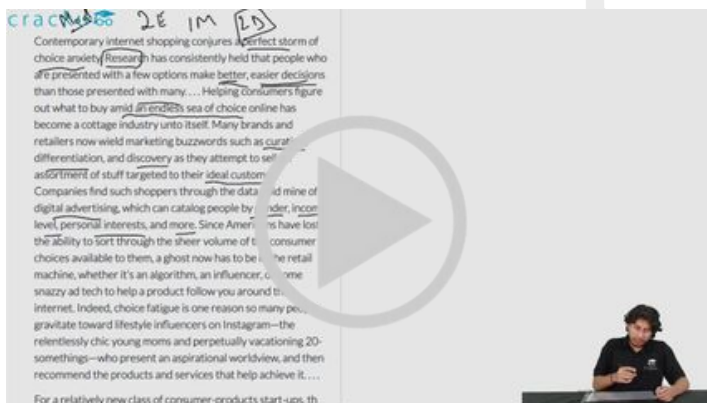


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 179

A new food brand plans to launch a series of products in the American market. Which of the following product plans is most likely to be supported by the author of the passage?

- A A range of 10 products priced between \$5 and \$10.
- B A range of 25 products priced between \$5 and \$10.
- C A range of 10 products priced between \$10 and \$25.
- D A range of 25 products priced between \$10 and \$25.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 180

Based on the passage, all of the following can be inferred about consumer behaviour EXCEPT that:

- A having too many product options can be overwhelming for consumers.
- B too many options have made it difficult for consumers to trust products.
- C consumers tend to prefer products by start-ups over those by established companies.

D consumers are susceptible to marketing images that they see on social media.



VIDEO SOLUTION



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

This book takes the position that setting in literature is more than just backdrop, that important insight into literary texts can be made by paying close attention to how authors craft place, as well as to how place functions in a narrative. The authors included in this reference work engage deeply with either real or imagined geographies. They care about how human decisions have shaped landscapes and how landscapes have shaped human practices and values. Some of the best writing is highly vivid, employing the language of the senses because this is the primary means through which humans know physical space.

Literature can offer valuable perspectives on physical and cultural geography. Unlike scientific reports, a literary narrative can provide the emotional component missing from the scientific record. In human experience, geographical places have a spiritual or emotional component in addition to and as part of a physical layout and topography. This emotional component, although subjective, is no less "real" than a surveyor's map. Human consciousness of place is experienced in a multimodal manner. Histories of places live on in many forms, one of which is the human memory or imagination.

Both real and imaginary landscapes provide insight into the human experience of place. The pursuit of such a topic speaks to the valuable knowledge produced from bridging disciplines and combining material from both the arts and the sciences to better understand the human condition. The perspectives that most concern cultural geographers are often those regarding movement and migration, cultivation of natural resources, and organization of space. The latter two reflect concerns of the built environment, a topic shared with the field of architectural study. Many of these concerns are also reflected in work sociologists do. Scholars from literary studies can contribute an aesthetic dimension to what might otherwise be a purely ideological approach.

Literature can bring together material that spans different branches of science. For example, a literary description of place may involve not only the environment and geography but the noises and quality of light, or how people from different races or classes can experience the same place in different ways linked to those racial or class disparities. Literary texts can also account for the way in which absence—of other people, animals, and so on—affects a human observer or inhabitant. Both literary and scientific approaches to place are necessary, working in unison, to achieve a complete record of an environment. It is important to note that the interdisciplinary nature of this work teaches us that landscapes are not static, that they are not unchanged by human culture. At least part of their identity derives from the people who inhabit them and from the way space

can alter and inspire human perspective. The intersection of scientific and literary expression that happens in the study of literary geography is of prime importance due to the complexity of the personal and political ways that humans experience place.

Question 181

All of the following statements, if false, would contradict the arguments in the passage, EXCEPT that:

- A descriptions of places do not need satellite imagery or other visual aids to give a “real” sense of the place.
- B literature provides us with deep insights into the ways in which movement and migration affect physical geography.
- C highly vivid writing, employing the language of the senses, can capture the multi-modal manner in which humans experience places.
- D humans do not interact with places in subjective, emotional ways because places are only physical topography.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 182

The author uses the example of the literary description of place to illustrate that:

- A scientific approaches to place are more accurate than literary ones.
- B literature can convey how different people experience the same place differently.
- C architects use diverse methods to calibrate the noises and lights of a given place.
- D the absence of other people, animals, and so on in a place can profoundly affect its inhabitants.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 183

Which one of the following is a valid conclusion to draw from the author’s statement that, “The pursuit of such a topic speaks to the valuable knowledge produced from bridging disciplines and combining material from both the arts and the sciences to better understand the human condition.”?

- A A comprehensive bridging of the human condition can best be achieved by a disciplined pursuit of human understanding.
- B A comprehensive understanding of the valuable knowledge produced by the arts and sciences can best be achieved by studying the human condition.
- C A comprehensive understanding of the human condition can best be achieved by combining the findings of disciplines from the arts and the sciences.
- D The literary descriptions of the emotions we experience in the places we visit can contribute to our understanding of the arts and sciences.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Mock Test

Mocks designed exactly like the actual CAT



Question 184

Which one of the following is not true of the argument in the second paragraph?

- A Analysing the literary descriptions of a place can give us a sense of how people relate emotionally to it.
- B The spiritual experience of a place may be considered as real as the physical experience of it.
- C The emotional and spiritual experience of a place can replace a surveyor's map.
- D Literary accounts of places can be filled with histories, manifested as memory or imagination.

 VIEW SOLUTION

Instructions

The persistent patterns in the way nations fight reflect their cultural and historical traditions and deeply rooted attitudes that collectively make up their strategic culture. These patterns provide insights that go beyond what can be learnt just by comparing armaments and divisions. In the Vietnam War, the strategic tradition of the United States called for forcing the enemy to fight a massed battle in an open area, where superior American weapons would prevail. The United States was trying to re-fight World War II in the jungles of Southeast Asia, against an enemy with no intention of doing so.

Some British military historians describe the Asian way of war as one of indirect attacks, avoiding frontal attacks meant to overpower an opponent. This traces back to Asian history and geography: the great distances and harsh terrain have often made it difficult to execute the sort of open-field clashes allowed by the flat terrain and relatively compact size of Europe. A very different strategic tradition arose in Asia. The bow and arrow were metaphors for an Eastern way of war. By its nature, the arrow is an indirect weapon. Fired from a distance of hundreds of yards, it does not necessitate immediate physical contact with the enemy. Thus, it can be fired from hidden positions. When fired from behind a ridge, the barrage seems to come out of nowhere, taking the enemy by surprise. The tradition of this kind of fighting is captured in the classical strategic writings of the East. The 2,000 years' worth of Chinese writings on war constitutes the most subtle writings on the subject in any language. Not until Clausewitz, did the West produce a strategic theorist to match the sophistication of Sun-tzu, whose Art of War was written 2,300 years earlier.

In Sun-tzu and other Chinese writings, the highest achievement of arms is to defeat an adversary without fighting. He wrote: "To win one hundred victories in one hundred battles is not the acme of skill. To subdue the enemy without fighting is the supreme excellence." Actual combat is just one among many means towards the goal of subduing an adversary. War contains too many surprises to be a first resort. It can lead to ruinous losses, as has been seen time and again. It can have the unwanted effect of inspiring heroic efforts in an enemy, as the United States learned in Vietnam, and as the Japanese found out after Pearl Harbor. Aware of the uncertainties of a military campaign, Sun-tzu advocated war only after the most thorough preparations. Even then it should be quick and clean. Ideally, the army is just an instrument to deal the final blow to an enemy already weakened by isolation, poor morale, and disunity. Ever since Sun-tzu, the Chinese have been seen as masters of subtlety who take measured actions to manipulate an adversary without his knowledge. The dividing line between war and peace can be obscure. Low-level violence often is the backdrop to a larger strategic campaign. The unwitting victim, focused on the day-to-day events, never realizes what's happening to him until it's too late. History holds many examples. The Viet Cong lured French and U.S. infantry deep into the jungle, weakening their morale over several years. The mobile army of the United States was designed to fight on the plains of Europe, where it could quickly move unhindered from one spot to the next. The jungle did more than make quick movement impossible; broken down into smaller units and scattered in isolated bases, US forces were deprived of the feeling of support and protection that ordinarily comes from being part of a big army. The isolation of U.S. troops in Vietnam was not just a logistical detail, something that could be overcome by, for instance, bringing in reinforcements by helicopter. In a big army reinforcements are readily available. It was Napoleon who realized the extraordinary effects on morale that come from being part of a larger formation. Just the knowledge of it lowers the soldier's fear and increases his aggressiveness. In the jungle and on isolated bases, this feeling was removed. The thick vegetation slowed down the reinforcements and made it difficult to find stranded units. Soldiers felt they were on their own.

More important, by altering the way the war was fought, the Viet Cong stripped the United States of its belief in the inevitability of victory, as it had done to the French before them. Morale was high when these armies first went to Vietnam. Only after many years of debilitating and demoralizing fighting did Hanoi launch its decisive attacks, at Dienbienphu in 1954 and against Saigon in 1975. It should be recalled that in the final push to victory the North Vietnamese abandoned their jungle guerrilla tactics completely, committing their entire army of twenty divisions to pushing the South Vietnamese into collapse. This final battle, with the enemy's army all in one place, was the one that the United States had desperately wanted to fight in 1965. When it did come out into the open in 1975, Washington had already withdrawn its forces and there was no possibility of re-intervention. The Japanese early in World War II used a modern form of the indirect attack, one that relied on stealth and surprise for its effect. At Pearl Harbor, in the Philippines, and in Southeast Asia, stealth and surprise were attained by sailing under radio silence so that the navy's movements could not be tracked. Moving troops aboard ships into Southeast Asia made it appear that the Japanese army was also "invisible." Attacks against Hawaii and Singapore seemed, to the American and British defenders, to come from nowhere. In Indonesia and the Philippines the Japanese attack was even faster than the German blitz against France in the West.

The greatest military surprises in American history have all been in Asia. Surely there is something going on here beyond the purely technical difficulties of detecting enemy movements. Pearl Harbor, the Chinese intervention in Korea, and the Tet offensive in Vietnam all came out of a tradition of surprise and stealth. U.S. technical intelligence – the location of enemy units and their movements was greatly improved after each surprise, but with no noticeable improvement in the American ability to foresee or prepare what would happen next. There is a cultural divide here, not just a technical one. Even when it was possible to track an army with intelligence satellites, as when Iraq invaded Kuwait or when Syria and Egypt attacked Israel, surprise was achieved. The United States was stunned by Iraq's attack on Kuwait even though it had satellite pictures of Iraqi troops massing at the border. The exception that proves the point that cultural differences obscure the West's understanding of Asian behavior was the Soviet Union's 1979 invasion of Afghanistan. This was fully anticipated and understood in advance. There was no surprise because the United States understood Moscow's worldview and thinking. It could anticipate Soviet action almost as well as the Soviets themselves, because the Soviet Union was really a Western country.

The difference between the Eastern and the Western way of war is striking. The West's great strategic writer, Clausewitz, linked war to politics, as did Sun-tzu. Both were opponents of militarism, of turning war over to the generals. But there all similarity ends. Clausewitz wrote that the way to achieve a larger political purpose is through destruction of the enemy's army. After observing Napoleon conquer Europe by smashing enemy armies to bits, Clausewitz made his famous remark in *On War* (1932) that combat is the continuation of politics by violent means. Morale and unity are important, but they should be harnessed for the ultimate battle. If the Eastern way of war is embodied by the stealthy archer, the metaphorical Western counterpart is the swordsman charging forward, seeking a decisive showdown, eager to administer the blow that will obliterate the enemy once and for all. In this view, war proceeds along a fixed course and occupies a finite extent of time, like a play in three acts with a beginning, a middle, and an end. The end, the final scene, decides the issue for good.

When things don't work out quite this way, the Western military mind feels tremendous frustration. Sun-tzu's great disciples, Mao Zedong and Ho Chi Minh, are respected in Asia for their clever use of indirection and deception to achieve an advantage over stronger adversaries. But in the West their approach is seen as underhanded and devious. To the American strategic mind, the Viet Cong guerrilla did not fight fairly. He should have come out into the open and fought like a man, instead of hiding in the jungle and sneaking around like a cat in the night.

Question 185

The difference in the concepts of war of Clausewitz and Sun-tzu is best characterized by

- A** Clausewitz's support for militarism as against Sun-tzu's opposition to it.
- B** their relative degrees of sophistication.
- C** their attitude to guerrilla warfare.
- D** their differing conceptions of the structure, time and sequence of a war.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 186

Which of the following statements does not describe the 'Asian' way of war?

- A Indirect attacks without frontal attacks.
- B The swordsman charging forward to obliterate the enemy once and for all.
- C Manipulation of an adversary without his knowledge.
- D Subduing an enemy without fighting.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 187

According to the author, the main reason for the U.S. losing the Vietnam war was

- A the Vietnamese understood the local terrain better.
- B the lack of support for the war from the American people.
- C the failure of the U.S. to mobilize its military strength.
- D their inability to fight a war on terms other than those they understood well.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 188

Which of the following is not one of Sun-tzu's ideas?

- A Actual combat is the principal means of subduing an adversary.
- B War should be undertaken only after thorough preparation.
- C War is linked to politics.
- D War should not be left to the generals alone.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 189

According to the author, the greatest military surprises in American history have been in Asia because

- A The Americans failed to implement their military strategies many miles away from their own country.
- B The Americans were unable to use their technologies like intelligence satellites effectively to detect enemy movements.
- C The Americans failed to understand the Asian culture of war that was based on stealth and surprise.

D Clausewitz is inferior to Sun-tzu.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 190

To the Americans, the approach of the Viet Cong seemed devious because

- A the Viet Cong did not fight like men out in the open.
- B the Viet Cong allied with America's enemies.
- C the Viet Cong took strategic advice from Mao Zedong.
- D the Viet Cong used bows and arrows rather than conventional weapons.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

Since World War II, the nation-state has been regarded with approval by every political system and every ideology. In the name of modernisation in the West, of socialism in the Eastern bloc, and of development in the Third World, it was expected to guarantee the happiness of individuals as citizens and of peoples as societies. However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisan secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails.

As one observes the awakening of communities in different parts of the world, one cannot ignore the context in which identity issues arise. It is no longer a context of sealed frontiers and isolated regions but is one of integrated global systems. In a reaction to this trend towards globalisation, individuals and communities everywhere are voicing their desire to exist, to use their power of creation and to play an active part in national and international life.

There are two ways in which the current upsurge in demands for the recognition of identities can be looked at. On the positive side, the efforts by certain population groups to assert their identity can be regarded as "liberation movements", challenging oppression and injustice. What these groups are doing - proclaiming that they are different, rediscovering the roots of their culture or strengthening group solidarity - may accordingly be seen as legitimate attempts to escape from their state of subjugation and enjoy a certain measure of dignity. On the downside, however, militant action for recognition tends to make such groups more deeply entrenched in their attitude and to make their cultural compartments even more watertight. The assertion of identity then starts turning into self-absorption and isolation, and is liable to slide into intolerance of others and towards ideas of "ethnic cleansing", xenophobia and violence.

Whereas continuous variations among peoples prevent drawing of clear dividing lines between the groups, those militating for recognition of their group's identity arbitrarily choose a limited number of criteria such as religion, language, skin colour, and place of origin so that their members recognise themselves primarily in terms of the labels attached to the group whose existence is being asserted. This distinction between the group in question and other groups is established by simplifying the feature selected. Simplification also works by transforming groups into essences, abstractions endowed with the capacity to remain unchanged through time. In some cases, people actually act as though the group has remained unchanged and talk, for example,

about the history of nations and communities as if these entities survived for centuries without changing, with the same ways of acting and thinking, the same desires, anxieties, and aspirations. Paradoxically, precisely because identity represents a simplifying fiction, creating uniform groups out of disparate people, that identity performs a cognitive function. It enables us to put names to ourselves and others, form some idea of who we are and who others are, and ascertain the place we occupy along with the others in the world and society. The current upsurge to assert the identity of groups can thus be partly explained by the cognitive function performed by identity. However, that said, people would not go along as they do, often in large numbers, with the propositions put to them, in spite of the sacrifices they entail, if there was not a very strong feeling of need for identity, a need to take stock of things and know "who we are", "where we come from", and "where we are going".

Identity is thus a necessity in a constantly changing world, but it can also be a potent source of violence and disruption. How can these two contradictory aspects of identity be reconciled? First, we must bear the arbitrary nature of identity categories in mind, not with a view to eliminating all forms of identification—which would be unrealistic since identity is a cognitive necessity—but simply to remind ourselves that each of us has several identities at the same time. Second, since tears of nostalgia are being shed over the past, we recognise that culture is constantly being recreated by cobbling together fresh and original elements and counter-cultures. There are in our own country a large number of syncretic cults wherein modern elements are blended with traditional values or people of different communities venerate saints or divinities of particular faiths. Such cults and movements are characterised by a continual inflow and outflow of members which prevent them from taking on a self-perpetuating existence of their own and hold out hope for the future, indeed, perhaps for the only possible future. Finally, the nation-state must respond to the identity urges of its constituent communities and to their legitimate quest for security and social justice. It must do so by inventing what the French philosopher and sociologist, Raymond Aron, called "peace through law". That would guarantee justice both to the state as a whole and its parts, and respect the claims of both reason and emotions. The problem is one of reconciling nationalist demands with the exercise of democracy.

Question 191

According to the author, the nation-state

- A has fulfilled its potential.
- B is willing to do anything to preserve order.
- C generates security for all its citizens.
- D has been a major force in preventing civil and international wars.

Since World War II, the nation-state has been regarded with approval by every political system and every ideology. In the name of modernisation in the West, of socialism in the Eastern bloc, and of development in the Third World, it was expected to guarantee the happiness of individuals as citizens and of peoples as societies. However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisanship, secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails.

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 192

Demands for recognition of identities can be viewed:

- A Positively and negatively.

- B As liberation movements and militant action.
- C As efforts to rediscover cultural roots which can slide towards intolerance of others.
- D All the above

Since World War II, the nation-state has been regarded with approval by every political system and every ideology. In the name of modernisation in the West, of socialism in the Eastern bloc, and of development in the Third World, it was expected to guarantee the happiness of individuals as citizens and of peoples as societies. However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisan secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails.

VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



Question 193

According to the author, happiness of individuals was expected to be guaranteed in the name of:

- A Development in the Third world.
- B Socialism in the Third world.
- C Development in the West.
- D Modernisation in the Eastern Bloc.

Since World War II, the nation-state has been regarded with approval by every political system and every ideology. In the name of modernisation in the West, of socialism in the Eastern bloc, and of development in the Third World, it was expected to guarantee the happiness of individuals as citizens and of peoples as societies. However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisan secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails.

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 194

Going by the author's exposition of the nature of identity, which of the following statements is untrue?

- A Identity represents creating uniform groups out of disparate people.

- B Identity is a necessity in the changing world.
- C Identity is a cognitive necessity.
- D None of the above.

Since World War II, the nation-state has been regarded with approval by every political system and every ideology. In the name of modernisation in the West, of socialism in the Eastern bloc, and of development in the Third World, it was expected to guarantee the happiness of individuals as citizens and of peoples as societies. However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisan secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails.

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 195

Which of the following views of the nation-state cannot be attributed to the author?

- A It has not guaranteed peace and security.
- B It may go as far as genocide for self-preservation.
- C It represents the demands of communities within it.
- D It is unable to prevent international wars.

Since World War II, the nation-state has been regarded with approval by every political system and every ideology. In the name of modernisation in the West, of socialism in the Eastern bloc, and of development in the Third World, it was expected to guarantee the happiness of individuals as citizens and of peoples as societies. However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisan secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails.

VIDEO SOLUTION

 CAT Formula PDF

Instructions

Each one has his reasons: for one art is a flight; for another, a means of conquering. But one can flee into a hermitage, into madness, into death. One can conquer by arms. Why does it have to be writing, why does one have to manage his escapes and conquests by writing? Because, behind the various aims of authors, there is a

deeper and more immediate choice which is common to all of us. We shall try to elucidate this choice, and we shall see whether it is not in the name of this very choice of writing that the engagement of writers must be required.

Each of our perceptions is accompanied by the consciousness that human reality is a 'revealer', that is, it is through human reality that 'there is' being, or, to put it differently, that man is the means by which things are manifested. It is our presence in the world which multiplies relations. It is we who set up a relationship between this tree and that bit of sky. Thanks to us, that star which has been dead for millennia, that quarter moon, and that dark river are disclosed in the unity of a landscape. It is the speed of our auto and our airplane which organizes the great masses of the earth. With each of our acts, the world reveals to us a new face. But, if we know that we are directors of being, we also know that we are not its producers. If we turn away from this landscape, it will sink back into its dark permanence. At least, it will sink back; there is no one mad enough to think that it is going to be annihilated. It is we who shall be annihilated, and the earth will remain in its lethargy until another consciousness comes along to awaken it. Thus, to our inner certainty of being 'revealers' is added that of being inessential in relation to the thing revealed. One of the chief motives of artistic creation is certainly the need of feeling that we are essential in relationship to the world. If I fix on canvas or in writing a certain aspect of the fields or the sea or a look on someone's face which I have disclosed, I am conscious of having produced them by condensing relationships, by introducing order where there was none, by imposing the unity of mind on the diversity of things. That is, I think myself essential in relation to my creation. But this time it is the created object which escapes me; I cannot reveal and produce at the same time. The creation becomes inessential in relation to the creative activity. First of all, even if it appears to others as definitive, the created object always seems to us in a state of suspension; we can always change this line, that shade, that word. Thus, it never forces itself. A novice painter asked his teacher, 'When should I consider my painting finished?' And the teacher answered, 'When you can look at it in amazement and say to yourself "I'm the one who did that!..."

Which amounts to saying 'never'. For it is virtually impossible considering one's work with someone else's eyes and revealing what has been created. But it is self-evident that we are proportionally less conscious of the thing produced and more conscious of our productive activity. When it is a matter of poetry or carpentry, we work according to traditional norms, with tools whose usage is codified; it is Heidegger's famous 'they' who are working with our hands. In this case, the result can seem to us sufficiently strange to preserve its objectivity in our eyes. But if we ourselves produce the rules of production, the measures, the criteria, and if our creative drive comes from the very depths of our heart, then we never find anything but ourselves in our work. It is we who have invented the laws by which we judge it. It is our history, our love, our gaiety that we recognize in it. Even if we should regard it without touching it any further, we never receive from it that gaiety or love. We put them into it. The results which we have obtained on canvas or paper never seem to us objective. We are too familiar with the processes of which they are the effects. These processes remain a subjective discovery; they are ourselves, our inspiration, our ruse, and when we seek to perceive our work, we create it again, we repeat mentally the operations which produced it; each of its aspects appears as a result. Thus, in the perception, the object is given as the essential thing and the subject as the inessential.

The latter seeks essentiality in the creation and obtains it, but then it is the object which becomes the inessential. The dialectic is nowhere more apparent than in the art of writing, for the literary object is a peculiar top which exists only in movement. To make it come into view a concrete act called reading is necessary, and it lasts only as long as this act can last. Beyond that, there are only black marks on paper. Now, the writer can not read what he writes, whereas the shoemaker can put on the shoes he has just made if they are to his size, and the architect can live in the house he has built. In reading, one foresees; one waits. He foresees the end of the sentence, the following sentence, the next page. He waits for them to confirm or disappoint his foresights. The reading is composed of a host of hypotheses, followed by awakenings, of hopes and deceptions. Readers are always ahead of the sentence they are reading in a merely probable future which partly collapses and partly comes together in proportion as they progress, which withdraws from one page to the next and forms the moving horizon of the literary object. Without waiting, without a future, without ignorance, there is no objectivity.

Question 196

The art of writing manifests the dialectic of perception and creation because

- A** reading reveals the writing till the act of reading lasts.

- B writing to be meaningful needs the concrete act of reading.
- C this art is anticipated and progresses on a series of hypotheses.
- D this literary object has a moving horizon brought about by the very act of creation.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 197

The author holds that:

- A There is an objective reality and a subjective reality.
- B Nature is the sum total of disparate elements.
- C It is human action that reveals the various facets of nature.
- D Apparently disconnected elements in nature are unified in a fundamental sense.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 198

It is the author's contention that:

- A Artistic creations are results of human consciousness.
- B The very act of artistic creation leads to the escape of the created object.
- C Man can produce and reveal at the same time.
- D An act of creation forces itself on our consciousness leaving us full of amazement.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 199

The passage makes a distinction between perception and creation in terms of

- A Objectivity and subjectivity.
- B Revelation and action.
- C Objective reality and perceived reality.
- D Essentiality and non-essentiality of objects and subjects.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 200

A writer, as an artist,

- A reveals the essentiality of revelation.
- B makes us feel essential vis-a-vis nature.
- C creates reality.
- D reveals nature in its permanence.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The passage given below is followed by questions. For each question, choose the best answer.

The World Trade Organisation (WTO) was created in the early 1990s as a component of the Uruguay Round negotiation. However, it could have been negotiated as part of the Tokyo Round of the 1970s, since that negotiation was an attempt at a 'constitutional reform' of the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT). Or it could have been put off to the future, as the US government wanted. What factors led to the creation of the WTO in the early 1990s?

One factor was the pattern of multilateral bargaining that developed late in the Uruguay Round. Like all complex international agreements, the WTO was a product of a series of trade-offs between principal actors and groups. For the United States, which did not want a new Organisation, the dispute settlement part of the WTO package achieved its longstanding goal of a more effective and more legal dispute settlement system. For the Europeans, who by the 1990s had come to view GATT dispute settlement less in political terms and more as a regime of legal obligations, the WTO package was acceptable as a means to discipline the resort to unilateral measures by the United States. Countries like Canada and other middle and smaller trading partners were attracted by the expansion of a rules-based system and by the symbolic value of a trade Organisation, both of which inherently support the weak against the strong. The developing countries were attracted due to the provisions banning unilateral measures. Finally, and perhaps most important, many countries at the Uruguay Round came to put a higher priority on the export gains than on the import losses that the negotiation would produce, and they came to associate the WTO and a rules-based system with those gains. This reasoning - replicated in many countries - was contained in U.S. Ambassador Kantor's defence of the WTO, and it amounted to a recognition that international trade and its benefits cannot be enjoyed unless trading nations accept the discipline of a negotiated rules-based environment.

A second factor in the creation of the WTO was pressure from lawyers and the legal process. The dispute settlement system of the WTO was seen as a victory of legalists over pragmatists but the matter went deeper than that. The GATT, and the WTO, are contract organisations based on rules, and it is inevitable that an Organisation created to further rules will in turn be influenced by the legal process. Robert Hudec has written of the 'momentum of legal development', but what is this precisely? Legal development can be defined as promotion of the technical legal values of consistency, clarity (or, certainty) and effectiveness; these are values that those responsible for administering any legal system will seek to maximise. As it played out in the WTO, consistency meant integrating under one roof the whole lot of separate agreements signed under GATT auspices; clarity meant removing ambiguities about the powers of contracting parties to make certain decisions or to undertake waivers; and effectiveness meant eliminating exceptions arising out of grandfather-rights and resolving defects in dispute settlement procedures and institutional provisions. Concern for these values is inherent in any rules-based system of co-operation, since without these values rules would be meaningless in the first place. Rules, therefore, create their own incentive for fulfilment.

The momentum of legal development has occurred in other institutions besides the GATT, most notably in the European Union (EU). Over the past two decades the European Court of Justice (ECJ) has consistently rendered decisions that have expanded incrementally the EU's internal market, in which the doctrine of 'mutual recognition' handed down in the case Cassis de Dijon in 1979 was a key turning point. The Court is now widely recognised as a major player in European integration, even though arguably such a strong role was not originally envisaged in the Treaty of Rome, which initiated the current European Union. One means the Court used to expand integration was the 'teleological method of interpretation', whereby the actions of member states were evaluated against 'the accomplishment of the most elementary community goals set forth in the

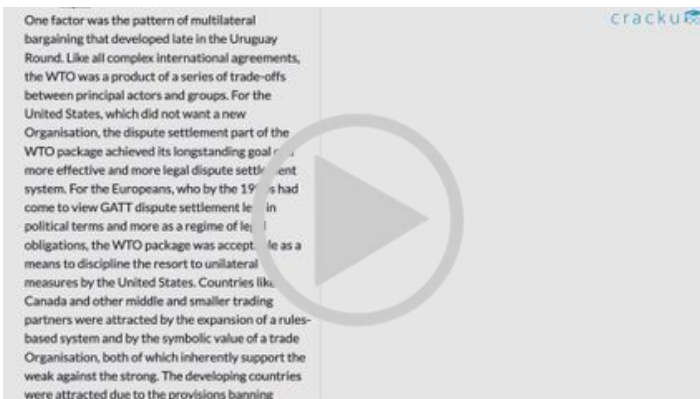
Preamble to the [Rome] treaty'. The teleological method represents an effort to keep current policies consistent with stated goals, and it is analogous to the effort in GATT to keep contracting party trade practices consistent with stated rules. In both cases legal concerns and procedures are an independent force for further cooperation.

In large part the WTO was an exercise in consolidation. In the context of a trade negotiation that created a near-revolutionary expansion of international trade rules, the formation of the WTO was a deeply conservative act needed to ensure that the benefits of the new rules would not be lost. The WTO was all about institutional structure and dispute settlement: these are the concerns of conservatives and not revolutionaries, which is why lawyers and legalists took the lead on these issues. The WTO codified the GATT institutional practice that had developed by custom over three decades, and it incorporated a new dispute settlement system that was necessary to keep both old and new rules from becoming a sham. Both the international structure and the dispute settlement system were necessary to preserve and enhance the integrity of the multilateral trade regime that had been built incrementally from the 1940s to the 1990s.

Question 201

What could be the closest reason why the WTO was not formed in the 1970s?

- A The US government did not like it.
- B Important players did not find it in their best interest to do so.
- C Lawyers did not work for the dispute settlement system.
- D The Tokyo Round negotiation was an attempt at constitutional reform.



▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 202

The importance of Cassis de Dijon is that it

- A gave a new impetus to the momentum of legal development at the European Court of Justice.
- B resulted in a decision that expanded incrementally the EU's internal market.
- C strengthened the role of the Court more than envisaged in the Treaty of Rome.
- D led to a doctrine that was a key turning point in European integration.

One factor was the pattern of multilateral bargaining that developed late in the Uruguay Round. Like all complex international agreements, the WTO was a product of a series of trade-offs between principal actors and groups. For the United States, which did not want a new Organisation, the dispute settlement part of the WTO package achieved its longstanding goal of a more effective and more legal dispute settlement system. For the Europeans, who by the 1990s had come to view GATT dispute settlement less in political terms and more as a regime of legal obligations, the WTO package was acceptable as a means to discipline the resort to unilateral measures by the United States. Countries like Canada and other middle and smaller trading partners were attracted by the expansion of a rules-based system and by the symbolic value of a trade Organisation, both of which inherently support the weak against the strong. The developing countries were attracted due to the provisions banning

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 203

According to the passage, WTO promoted the technical legal values partly through

- A integrating under one roof the agreements signed under GATT.
- B rules that create their own incentive for fulfilment.
- C grandfather-rights exceptions and defects in dispute settlement procedures.
- D ambiguities about the powers of contracting parties to make certain decisions.

One factor was the pattern of multilateral bargaining that developed late in the Uruguay Round. Like all complex international agreements, the WTO was a product of a series of trade-offs between principal actors and groups. For the United States, which did not want a new Organisation, the dispute settlement part of the WTO package achieved its longstanding goal of a more effective and more legal dispute settlement system. For the Europeans, who by the 1990s had come to view GATT dispute settlement less in political terms and more as a regime of legal obligations, the WTO package was acceptable as a means to discipline the resort to unilateral measures by the United States. Countries like Canada and other middle and smaller trading partners were attracted by the expansion of a rules-based system and by the symbolic value of a trade Organisation, both of which inherently support the weak against the strong. The developing countries were attracted due to the provisions banning

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 204

The most likely reason for the acceptance of the WTO package by nations was that

- A it had the means to prevent the US from taking unilateral measures.
- B they recognized the need for a rule-based environment to protect the benefits of increased trade.
- C it settles disputes more legally and more effectively.
- D its rule-based system leads to import gains.

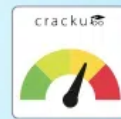
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VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Score Calculator



Question 205

In the method of interpretation of the European Court of Justice,

- A current policies needed to be consistent with stated goals.
- B contracting party trade practices needed to be consistent with stated rules.
- C enunciation of the most elementary community goals needed to be emphasized.
- D actions of member states needed to be evaluated against the stated community goals.

One factor was the pattern of multilateral bargaining that developed late in the Uruguay Round. Like all complex international agreements, the WTO was a product of a series of trade-offs between principal actors and groups. For the United States, which did not want a new Organisation, the dispute settlement part of the WTO package achieved its longstanding goal of a more effective and more legal dispute settlement system. For the Europeans, who by the 1970s had come to view GATT dispute settlement less in political terms and more as a regime of legal obligations, the WTO package was acceptable as a means to discipline the resort to unilateral measures by the United States. Countries like Canada and other middle and smaller trading partners were attracted by the expansion of a rules-based system and by the symbolic value of a trade Organisation, both of which inherently support the weak against the strong. The developing countries were attracted due to the provisions banning

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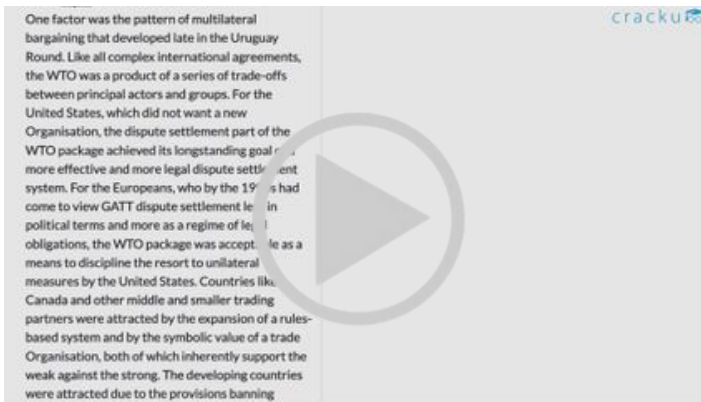
VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 206

In the statement "...it amounted to a recognition that international trade and its benefits cannot be enjoyed unless trading nations accept the discipline of a negotiated rules-based environment.", 'it' refers to:

- A Ambassador Kantor's defence of the WTO.
- B The higher priority on export gains placed by many countries at the Uruguay Round.
- C The export gains many countries came to associate with a rule-based system.

D The provision of a rule-based system by the WTO.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The second plan to have to examine is that of giving to each person what she deserves. Many people, especially those who are comfortably off, think this is what happens at present: that the industrious and sober and thrifty are never in want, and that poverty is due to idleness, improvidence, drinking, betting, dishonesty, and bad character generally. They can point to the fact that a labourer whose character is bad finds it more difficult to get employment than one whose character is good; that a farmer or country gentleman who gambles and bets heavily, and mortgages his land to live wastefully and extravagantly, is soon reduced to poverty; and that a man of business who is lazy and does not attend to it becomes bankrupt. But this proves nothing that you cannot eat your cake and have it too; it does not prove that your share of the cake was a fair one. It shows that certain vices make us rich. People who are hard, grasping, selfish, cruel, and always ready to take advantage of their neighbours, become very rich if they are clever enough not to overreach themselves. On the other hand, people who are generous, public spirited, friendly, and not always thinking of the main chance, stay poor when they are born poor unless they have extraordinary talents. Also as things are today, some are born poor and others are born with silver spoons in their mouths: that is to say, they are divided into rich and poor before they are old enough to have any character at all. The notion that our present system distributes wealth according to merit, even roughly, may be dismissed at once as ridiculous. Everyone can see that it generally has the contrary effect; it makes a few idle people very rich, and a great many hardworking people very poor.

On this, intelligent Lady, your first thought may be that if wealth is not distributed according to merit, it ought to be; and that we should at once set to work to alter our laws so that in future the good people shall be rich in proportion to their goodness and the bad people poor in proportion to their badness. There are several objections to this; but the very first one settles the question for good and all. It is, that the proposal is impossible and impractical. How are you going to measure anyone's merit in money? Choose any pair of human beings you like, male or female, and see whether you can decide how much each of them should have on her or his merits. If you live in the country, take the village blacksmith and the village clergyman, or the village washerwoman and the village schoolmistress, to begin with. At present, the clergyman often gets less pay than the blacksmith; it is only in some villages he gets more. But never mind what they get at present: you are trying whether you can set up a new order of things in which each will get what he deserves. You need not fix a sum of money for them: all you have to do is to settle the proportion between them. Is the blacksmith to have as much as the clergyman? Or twice as much as the clergyman? Or half as much as the clergyman? Or how much more or less? It is no use saying that one ought to have more the other less; you must be prepared to say exactly how much more or less in calculable proportion.

Well, think it out. The clergyman has had a college education; but that is not any merit on his part: he owns it to his father; so you cannot allow him anything for that. But through it he is able to read the New Testament in Greek; so that he can do something the blacksmith cannot do. On the other hand, the blacksmith can make a horse-shoe, which the parson cannot. How many verses of the Greek Testament are worth one horse-shoe? You have only to ask the silly question to see that nobody can answer it.

Since measuring their merits is no use, why not try to measure their faults? Suppose the blacksmith swears a good deal, and gets drunk occasionally! Everybody in the village knows this; but the parson has to keep his faults to himself. His wife knows them; but she will not tell you what they are if she knows that you intend to cut off some of his pay for them. You know that as he is only a mortal human being, he must have some faults; but you cannot find them out. However, suppose he has some faults he is a snob; that he cares more for sport and fashionable society than for religion! Does that make him as bad as the blacksmith, or twice as bad, or twice and quarter as bad, or only half as bad? In other words, if the blacksmith is to have a shilling, is the parson to have six pence, or five pence and one-third, or two shillings? Clearly these are fools' questions: the moment they bring us down from moral generalities to business particulars it becomes plain to every sensible person that no relation can be established between human qualities, good or bad, and sums of money, large or small.

It may seem scandalous that a prize-fighter, for hitting another prize-fighter so hard at Wembley that he fell down and could not rise within ten seconds, received the same sum that was paid to the Archbishop of Canterbury for acting as Primate of the Church of England for nine months; but none of those who cry out against the scandal can express any better in money the difference between the two. Not one of the persons who think that the prize-fighter should get less than the Archbishop can say how much less. What the prize-fighter got for his six or seven months' boxing would pay a judge's salary for two years; and we all agree that nothing could be more ridiculous, and that any system of distributing wealth which leads to such absurdities must be wrong. But to suppose that it could be changed by any possible calculation that an ounce of archbishop of three ounces of judge is worth a pound of prize-fighter would be sillier still. You can find out how many candles are worth a pound of butter in the market on any particular day; but when you try to estimate the worth of human souls the utmost you can say is that they are all of equal value before the throne of God: And that will not help you in the least to settle how much money they should have. You must simply give it up, and admit that distributing money according to merit is beyond mortal measurement and judgement.

Question 207

The author gives the example of the Archbishop of Canterbury and the prize-fighter to

- A prove that there cannot be any division of wealth based on moral standards.
- B prove that in this day and age might always scores over religion and love.
- C prove the existence of a non-discriminating god.
- D prove that a pound of butter is worth more than any amount of candles any day.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 208

What, according to the author, do the generous and public spirited people need to become rich?

- A A criminal mind
- B To be born with silver spoons
- C Extraordinary talents
- D Strength of character

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 209

Which of the following is not a vice attributed to the poor by the rich?

- A Idleness
- B Drug addition
- C Gambling
- D Alcoholism

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 210

What, according to the author, is the main problem in distributing wealth according to the goodness or badness of human beings?

- A Because the bad people will as always, cheat the good people of their fair share of the money.
- B Because there are too many people in the world and it will take a long time to categorise them into good or bad.
- C Because there are no standards by which to judge good or bad in relation to money.
- D None of the above

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 211

The word 'improvidence' in the context of the passage, means

- A extravagance.
- B lasciviousness.
- C corruption.
- D indelicacy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 212

In the passage, which kind of people are not mentioned as likely to get rich quickly?

- A Selfish people
- B Grasping people
- C Hard people
- D Ambitious people

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 213

This passage most probably is a part of

- A a newspaper article.
- B an anthropological document.
- C a letter to someone.
- D an ecclesiastical liturgy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 214

Which of the following about the author's thinking may be inferred from the passage?

- A The poor should work hard to become rich.
- B The present system of distribution of wealth is biased in favour of the rich.
- C The honest men should resort to trickery if they want to become rich.
- D The present system of government should give way to a more progressive one.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The membrane-bound nucleus is the most prominent feature of the eukaryotic cell. Schleiden and Schwann, when setting forth the cell doctrine in the 1830s, considered that it had a central role in growth and development. Their belief has been fully supported even though they had only vague notions as to what that role might be, and how the role was to be expressed in some cellular action. The membraneless nuclear area of the prokaryotic cell, with its tangle of fine threads, is now known to play a similar role.

Some cells, like the sieve tubes of vascular plants and the red blood cells of mammals, do not possess nuclei during the greater part of their existence, although they had nuclei when in a less differentiated state. Such cells can no longer divide and their life span is limited. Other cells are regularly multinucleate. Some, like the cells of striated muscles or the latex vessels of higher plants, become so through cell fusion. Some, like the unicellular protozoan paramecium, are normally binucleate, one of the nuclei serving as a source of hereditary information for the next generation, the other governing the day-to-day metabolic activities of the cell. Still other organisms, such as some fungi, are multinucleate because cross walls, dividing the mycelium into specific cells, are absent or irregularly present. The uninucleate situation, however, is typical for the vast majority of cells, and it would appear that this is the most efficient and most economical manner of partitioning living substance into manageable units. This point of view is given credence not only by the prevalence of uninucleate cells, but because for each kind of cell there is a ratio maintained between the volume of the nucleus and that of the cytoplasm. If we think of the nucleus as the control centre of the cell, this would suggest that for a given kind of cell performing a given kind of work, one nucleus can 'take care of' a specific volume of cytoplasm and keep it in functioning order. In terms of material and energy, this must mean providing the kind of information needed to keep flow of materials and energy moving at the correct rate and in the proper channels. With the multitude

of enzymes in the cell, materials and energy can of course be channelled in a multitude of ways; it is the function of some information molecules to make channels of use more preferred than others at any given time. How this regulatory control is exercised is not entirely clear.

The nucleus is generally a rounded body. In plant cells, however, where the centre of the cell is often occupied by a large vacuole, the nucleus may be pushed against the cell wall, causing it to assume a lens shape. In some white blood cells, such as polymorphonucleated leukocytes, and in cells of the spinning gland of some insects and spiders, the nucleus is very much lobed. The reason for this is not clear, but it may relate to the fact that for a given volume of nucleus, a lobate form provides a much greater surface area for nuclear-cytoplasmic exchanges, possibly affecting both the rate and the amount of metabolic reactions. The nucleus, whatever its shape, is segregated from the cytoplasm by a double membrane, the nuclear envelope, with the two membranes separated from each other by a perinuclear space of varying width. The envelope is absent only during the time of cell division, and then just for a brief period. The outer membrane is often continuous with the membranes of the endoplasmic reticulum, a possible retention of an earlier relationship, since the envelope, at least in part, is formed at the end cell division by coalescing fragments of the endoplasmic reticulum. The cytoplasmic side of the nucleus is frequently coated with ribosomes, another fact that stresses the similarity and relation of the nuclear envelope to the endoplasmic reticulum. The inner membrane seems to possess a crystalline layer where it abuts the nucleoplasm, but its function remains to be determined.

Everything that passes between the cytoplasm and the nucleus in the eukaryotic cell must transverse the nuclear envelope. This includes some fairly large molecules as well as bodies such as ribosomes, which measure about 25 nm in diameter. Some passageway is, therefore, obviously necessary since there is no indication of dissolution of the nuclear envelope in order to make such movement possible. The nuclear pores appear to be reasonable candidates for such passageways. In plant cells these are irregularly, rather sparsely distributed over the surface of the nucleus, but in the amphibian oocyte, for example, the pores are numerous, regularly arranged, and octagonal and are formed by the fusion of the outer and inner membrane.

Question 215

Why, according to the passage, do the fungi multinucleate?

- A Because they need more food to survive.
- B Because they frequently lack walls dividing the mycelium.
- C Because the mycelium is areawise much bigger than other cells.
- D Cannot be determined from the passage

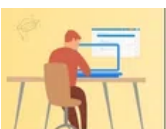
[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 216

It may be inferred from the passage that the vast majority of cells are

- A multinucleate.
- B binucleate.
- C uninucleate.
- D anucleate.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 217

According to the first paragraph, the contention of Schleiden and Schwann that the nucleus is the most important part of the cell has

- A been proved to be true.
- B has been true so far but false in the case of the prokaryotic cell.
- C is only partially true.
- D has been proved to be completely false.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 218

Which of the following kinds of cells never have a nuclei?

- A Sieve Tubes
- B Red blood cells of mammals
- C Prokaryotic cells
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 219

The function of the crystalline layer of the inner membrane of the nucleus is

- A generation of nourishment of the cell.
- B holding together the disparate structures of the endoplasmic reticulum.
- C helping in transversal of the nuclear envelope.
- D Cannot be determined from the passage

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 220

What is definitely a function of the nuclei of the normally binucleate cell?

- A To arrange for the growth and nourishment of the cell.
- B To hold hereditary information for the next generation.
- C To make up the basic physical structure of the organism.
- D To fight the various foreign diseases attacking the body.

Question 221

Why, according to the passage, is the polymorphonucleated leukocyte probably lobed?

- A Because it is quite convoluted in its functions.
- B Because it is the red blood cell which is the most important cell in the body.
- C Because it provides a greater area for metabolism reactions.
- D Because it provides greater strength to the spider web due to greater area.

Instructions

Governments looking for easy popularity have frequently been tempted into announcing give-aways of all sorts; free electricity, virtually free water, subsidised food, cloth at half price, and so on. The subsidy culture has gone to extremes. The richest farmers in the country get subsidised fertiliser. University education, typically accessed by the wealthier sections, is charged at a fraction of cost. Postal services are subsidised, and so are railway services. Bus fares cannot be raised to economical levels because there will be violent protests, so bus travel is subsidised too. In the past, price control on a variety of items, from steel to cement, meant that industrial consumers of these items got them at less than actual cost, while the losses of the public sector companies that produced them were borne by the taxpayer! A study, done a few years ago, came to the conclusion that subsidies in the Indian economy total as much as 14.5 per cent of gross domestic product. At today's level, that would work out to about Rs. 1,50,000 crore.

And who pays the bill? The theory — and the political fiction on the basis of which it is sold to unsuspecting voters — is that subsidies go to the poor, and are paid for by the rich. The fact is that most subsidies go to the 'rich' (defined in the Indian context as those who are above the poverty line, and much of the tab goes indirectly to the poor. Because the hefty subsidy bill results in fiscal deficits, which in turn push up rates of inflation — which, as everyone knows, hits the poor the hardest of all. Indeed, that is why taxmen call inflation the most regressive form of taxation.

The entire subsidy system is built on the thesis that people cannot help themselves, therefore governments must do so. That people cannot afford to pay for a variety of goods and services, and therefore the government must step in. This thesis has been applied not just in the poor countries but in the rich ones as well; hence the birth of the welfare state in the West, and an almost Utopian social security system; free medical care, food aid, old age security, et al. But with the passage of time, most of the wealthy nations have discovered that their economies cannot sustain this social safety net, which in fact reduces the desire among people to pay their own way, and takes away some of the incentive to work. In short, the bill was unaffordable, and their societies were simply not willing to pay. To the regret of many, but because of the laws of economics are harsh, most Western societies have been busy pruning the welfare bill.

In India, the lessons of this experience — over several decades, and in many countries — do not seem to have been learnt. Or, they are simply ignored in the pursuit of immediate votes. People who are promised cheap food or clothing do not in most cases look beyond the gift horses — to the question of who picks up the tab. The uproar over higher petrol, diesel and cooking gas prices ignored this basic question: if the user of cooking gas does not want to pay for its cost, who should pay? Diesel in the country is subsidised, and if the trucker or owner of a diesel generator does not want to pay for its full cost, who does he or she think should pay the balance of the cost? It is a simple question, nevertheless it remains unasked.

The Deve Gowda government has shown some courage in biting the bullet when it comes to the price of petroleum products. But it has been bitten by a much bigger subsidy bug. It wants to offer food at half its cost to everyone below the poverty line, supposedly estimated at some 380 million people. What will be the cost? And, of course, who will pick up the tab? The Andhra Pradesh Government has been bankrupted by selling rice at Rs. 2 per kg. Should the Central Government be bankrupted too, before facing up to the question of what is

affordable and what is not? Already, India is perennially short of power because the subsidy on electricity has bankrupted most electricity boards, and made private investment wary unless it gets all manner of state guarantees.

Delhi's subsidised bus fares have bankrupted the Delhi Transport Corporation., whose buses have slowly disappeared from the capital's streets. It is easy to be soft and sentimental, by looking at programmes that will be popular. After all, who doesn't like a free lunch? But the evidence is surely mounting that the lunch isn't free at all. Somebody is paying the bill. And if you want to know who, take a look at the country's poor economic performance over the years.

Question 222

Which of the following is not true, in the context of the passage?

- A Where subsidies are concerned, the poor ultimately pay the tab
- B Inflation is caused by too much subsidies.
- C Experts call subsidies the most regressive form of taxation.
- D Fiscal deficits are caused due to heavy subsidy bills.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 223

Which of the following should not be subsidised now, according to the passage?

- A University education
- B Postal services
- C Steel
- D All of the above

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 224

What, according to the author, is a saving grace of the Deve Gowda government?

- A It has realised that it has to raise the price of petroleum products.
- B It has avoided been bitten by a bigger subsidy bug.
- C Both a and b.
- D Neither a and b.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 225

Which of the following is not a victim of extreme subsidies?

- A The poor
- B The Delhi Transport Corporation
- C The Andhra Pradesh Government
- D None of these

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100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 226

Why do you think that the author calls the Western social security system Utopian?

- A The countries' belief in the efficacy of the system was bound to turn out to be false.
- B The system followed by these countries is the best available in the present context.
- C Every thing under this system was supposed to be free but people were charging money for them.
- D The theory of system followed by these countries was devised by Dr Utopia.

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Question 227

It can be inferred from the passage that the author

- A believes that people can help themselves and do not need the government.
- B believes that the theory of helping with subsidy is destructive.
- C believes in democracy and free speech.
- D is not a successful politician.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 228

The statement that subsidies are paid for by the rich and go to the poor is

- A fiction.
- B fact.
- C fact, according to the author.
- D fiction, according to the author.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions



Question 229

A suitable title to the passage would be-

- A There's No Such Thing as a Free Lunch.
- B The Economic Overview.
- C Deve Gowda's Government and its Follies.
- D It Takes Two to Tango.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

Now let us turn back to inquire whether sending our capital abroad, and consenting to be taxed to pay emigration fares to get rid of the women and men who are left without employment in consequence, is all that capitalism can do when our employers, who act for our capitalists in industrial affairs, and are more or less capitalists themselves in the earlier stages of capitalistic development, find that they can sell no more of their goods at a profit, or indeed at all, in their own country.

Clearly they cannot send abroad the capital they have already invested, because it has all been eaten up by the workers, leaving in its place factories and railways and mines and the like; and these cannot be packed into a ship's hold and sent to Africa. It is only the freshly saved capital that can be sent out of the country. This, as we have seen, does go abroad in heaps of finished products. But the British land held by him on long lease, must, when once he has sold all the goods at home that his British customers can afford to buy, either shut up his works until the customers have worn out their stock of what they have bought, which would bankrupt him (for the landlord will not wait), or else sell his superfluous goods somewhere else; that is, he must send them abroad. Now it is not easy to send them to civilized countries, because they practise Protection, which means that they impose heavy taxes (customs duties) on foreign goods. Uncivilized countries, without Protection, and inhabited by natives to whom gaudy calicoes and cheap showy brassware are dazzling and delightful novelties, are the best places to make for at first.

But trade requires a settled government to put down the habit of plundering strangers. This is not a habit of simple tribes, who are often friendly and honest. It is what civilized men do where there is no law to restrain them. Until quite recent times it was extremely dangerous to be wrecked on our own coasts, as wrecking, which meant plundering wrecked ships and refraining from any officious efforts to save the lives of their crews, was a well-established business in many places on our shores. The Chinese still remember some astonishing outbursts of looting perpetrated by English ladies of high position, at moments when law was suspended and priceless works of art were to be had for the grabbing. When trading with aborigines begins with the visit of a single ship, the cannons and cutlasses carried may be quite sufficient to overawe the natives if they are troublesome. The real difficulty begins when so many ships come that a little trading station of white men grows up and attracts the white ne'er-do-wells and violent roughs who are always being squeezed out of civilization by the pressure of law and order. It is these riff-raff who turn the place into a sort of hell in which sooner or later missionaries are murdered and traders plundered. Their home governments are appealed to put a stop to this. A gunboat is sent out and inquiry made. The report after the inquiry is that there is nothing to be done but set up a civilized government, with a post office, police, troops and the navy in the offing. In short, the place is added to some civilized Empire. And the civilized taxpayer pays the bill without getting a farthing of the profits.

Of course the business does not stop there. The riff-raff who have created the emergency move out just beyond the boundary of the annexed territory, and are as great a nuisance as ever to the traders when they have exhausted the purchasing power of the included natives and push on after fresh customers. Again they call on

their home government to civilize a further area; and so bit by bit the civilized Empire grows at the expense of the home taxpayers, without any intention or approval on their part, until at last although all their real patriotism is centred on their own people and confined to their own country, their own rulers, and their own religious faith; they find that the centre of their beloved realm has shifted to the other hemisphere. That is how we in the British Islands have found our centre moved from London to the Suez Canal, and are now in the position that out of every hundred of our fellow-subjects, in whose defence we are expected to shed the last drop of our blood, only 11 are whites or even Christians. In our bewilderment some of us declare that the Empire is a burden and a blunder, whilst others glory in it as a triumph. You and I need not argue with them just now, our point for the moment being that, whether blunder or glory, the British Empire was quite unintentional. What should have been undertaken only as a most carefully considered political development has been a series of commercial adventures thrust on us by capitalists forced by their own system to cater to foreign customers before their own country's needs were one-tenth satisfied.

Question 230

According to the author, the main reason why capitalist go abroad to sell their goods is

- A that they want to civilize the under developed countries of the world by giving them their goods.
- B that they have to have new places to sell their surplus goods some where in new markets.
- C that they actually want to rule new lands and selling goods is an excuse.
- D None of the above

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 231

Why do the capitalistic traders prefer the uncivilized countries to the civilized ones?

- A Because they find it easier to rule them.
- B Because civilized countries would make them pay protection duties.
- C Because civilized countries would make their own goods.
- D Because uncivilized countries like the cheap and gaudy goods of bad quality all capitalists produce.

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100+ CAT VARC Questions



Question 232

Which of the following may be called the main complaint of the author?

- A The race of people he belongs to are looters and plunderers.
- B The capitalists are taking over the entire world.
- C It is a way of life for English ladies to loot and plunder.
- D The English taxpayer has to pay for the upkeep of territories he did not want.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 233

Which of the following does not come under the aegis of capital already invested?

- A Construction of factories
- B Development of a mine
- C Trade of finished products
- D All of the above

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Question 234

It may be inferred that the passage was written

- A when Britain was still a colonial power.
- B when the author was in a bad mood.
- C when the author was working in the foreign service of Britain.
- D when the author's country was overrun by the British.

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CAT Expected Questions PDF



Question 235

The word 'officious', in the context of the passage, means

- A self-important.
- B official.
- C rude.
- D oafish.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 236

According to the author, the habit of plundering the strangers

- A is usually not found in simple tribes but civilized people.
- B is usually found in the barbaric tribes of the uncivilized nations.
- C is a habit limited only to English ladies of high position.
- D is a usual habit with all white-skinned people.

Instructions

I want to stress this personal helplessness we are all stricken with in the face of a system that has passed beyond our knowledge and control. To bring it nearer home, I propose that we switch off from the big things like empires and their wars to more familiar little things. Take pins for example! I do not know why it is that I so seldom use a pin when my wife cannot get on without boxes of them at hand; but it is so; and I will therefore take pins as being for some reason specially important to women.

There was a time when pinmakers would buy the material; shape it; make the head and the point; ornament it; and take it to the market, and sell it and the making required skill in several operations. They not only knew how the thing was done from beginning to end, but could do it all by themselves. But they could not afford to sell you a paper of pins for the farthing. Pins cost so much that a woman's dress allowance was calling pin money.

By the end of the 18th century Adam Smith boasted that it took 18 men to make a pin, each man doing a little bit of the job and passing the pin on to the next, and none of them being able to make a whole pin or to buy the materials or to sell it when it was made. The most you could say for them was that at least they had some idea of how it was made, though they could not make it. Now as this meant that they were clearly less capable and knowledgeable men than the old pin-makers, you may ask why Adam Smith boasted of it as a triumph of civilisation when its effect had so clearly a degrading effect. The reason was that by setting each man to do just one little bit of the work and nothing but that, over and over again, he became very quick at it. The men, it is said, could turn out nearly 5000 pins a day each; and thus pins became plentiful and cheap. The country was supposed to be richer because it had more pins, though it had turned capable men into mere machines doing their work without intelligence and being fed by the spare food of the capitalist just as an engine is fed with coals and oil. That was why the poet Goldsmith, who was a farsighted economist as well as a poet, complained that 'wealth accumulates, and men decay'.

Nowadays Adam Smith's 18 men are as extinct as the diplodocus. The 18 flesh-and-blood men have been replaced by machines of steel which spout out pins by the hundred million. Even sticking them into pink papers is done by machinery. The result is that with the exception of a few people who design the machines, nobody knows how to make a pin or how a pin is made: that is to say, the modern worker in pin manufacture need not be one-tenth so intelligent, skilful and accomplished as the old pinmaker; and the only compensation we have for this deterioration is that pins are so cheap that a single pin has no expressible value at all. Even with a big profit stuck on to the cost-price you can buy dozens for a farthing; and pins are so recklessly thrown away and wasted that verses have to be written to persuade children (without success) that it is a sin to steal, if even it's a pin.

Many serious thinkers, like John Ruskin and William Morris, have been greatly troubled by this, just as Goldsmith was, and have asked whether we really believe that it is an advance in wealth to lose our skill and degrade our workers for the sake of being able to waste pins by the ton. We shall see later on, when we come to consider the Distribution of Leisure, that the cure for this is not to go back to the old free for higher work than pin-making or the like. But in the meantime the fact remains that the workers are now not able to make anything themselves even in little bits. They are ignorant and helpless, and cannot lift their finger to begin their day's work until it has all been arranged for them by their employer's who themselves do not understand the machines they buy, and simply pay other people to set them going by carrying out the machine maker's directions.

The same is true for clothes. Earlier the whole work of making clothes, from the shearing of the sheep to the turning out of the finished and washed garment ready to put on, had to be done in the country by the men and women of the household, especially the women; so that to this day an unmarried woman is called a spinster. Nowadays nothing is left of all this but the sheep shearing; and even that, like the milking of cows, is being done by machinery, as the sewing is. Give a woman a sheep today and ask her to produce a woollen dress for you; and not only will she be quite unable to do it, but you are likely to find that she is not even aware of any connection between sheep and clothes. When she gets her clothes, which she does by buying them at the shop, she knows that there is a difference between wool and cotton and silk, between flannel and merino, perhaps even between stockinet and other wefts; but as to how they are made, or what they are made of, or how they

came to be in the shop ready for her to buy, she knows hardly anything. And the shop assistant from whom she buys is no wiser. The people engaged in the making of them know even less; for many of them are too poor to have much choice of materials when they buy their own clothes.

Thus the capitalist system has produced an almost universal ignorance of how things are made and done, whilst at the same time it has caused them to be made and done on a gigantic scale. We have to buy books and encyclopaedias to find out what it is we are doing all day; and as the books are written by people who are not doing it, and who get their information from other books, what they tell us is twenty to fifty years out of date knowledge and almost impractical today. And of course most of us are too tired of our work when we come home to want to read about it; what we need is cinema to take our minds off it and feel our imagination.

It is a funny place, this world of capitalism, with its astonishing spread of education and enlightenment. There stand the thousands of property owners and the millions of wage workers, none of them able to make anything, none of them knowing what to do until somebody tells them, none of them having the least notion of how it is made that they find people paying them money, and things in the shops to buy with it. And when they travel they are surprised to find that savages and Esquimaux and villagers who have to make everything for themselves are more intelligent and resourceful! The wonder would be if they were anything else. We should die of idiocy through disuse of our mental faculties if we did not fill our heads with romantic nonsense out of illustrated newspapers and novels and plays and films. Such stuff keeps us alive, but it falsifies everything for us so absurdly that it leaves us more or less dangerous lunatics in the real world.

Excuse my going on like this; but as I am a writer of books and plays myself, I know the folly and peril of it better than you do. And when I see that this moment of our utmost ignorance and helplessness, delusion and folly, has been stumbled on by the blind forces of capitalism as the moment for giving votes to everybody, so that the few wise women are hopelessly overruled by the thousands whose political minds, as far as they can be said to have any political minds at all, have been formed in the cinema, I realise that I had better stop writing plays for a while to discuss political and social realities in this book with those who are intelligent enough to listen to me.

Question 237

Which of the following can be a suitable first line to introduce the hypothetical next paragraph at the end of the passage?

- A The distribution of leisure is not a term that can be explained in a few words.
- B If people wear clothes they hardly seem to think about the method of production.
- C Machines are the gods of our age and there seems to be no atheists.
- D None of the above.

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**CAT Important Topics**

Question 238

The reason that children have to be taught that stealing a pin is wrong is that

- A they have an amazing proclivity to steal them right from childhood.
- B pins are so common and cheap that taking one would not even be considered stealing by them.
- C stealing a pin would lead to stealing bigger and bigger things in the future.
- D stealing an insignificant thing like a pin smacks of kleptomania.

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Question 239

Which of the following is true as far as pins are concerned?

- A The cost of pins is more nowadays to produce.
- B Earlier, workmen made pins with a lot of love and care.
- C Pinball machines are the standard pin producing gadgets nowadays.
- D It took much longer to make a pin earlier.

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Question 240

A suitable title to the passage would be

- A You Can't Hear a Pin-drop Nowadays.
- B Capitalism and Labour Disintegration: Pinning the Blame.
- C The Saga of the Non Safety Pins.
- D Reaching the Pinnacle of Capitalistic Success.

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Question 241

When the author says that a woman now is likely to know about any connection between sheep and clothes, he is probably being

- A vindictive.
- B chauvinistic
- C satirical.
- D demeaning.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 242

Goldsmith's dictum, "wealth accumulates, and men decay," in the context of the passage, probably means

- A the more wealthy people get, they become more and more corrupt.
- B the more rich people get, they forget the nuances of individual ability.
- C people may have a lot of money, but they have to die and decay someday.

- D the more a company gets wealthy the less they take care of people.

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Question 243

It may be inferred from the passage that the author

- A is a supporter of the craftsmanship over bulk mechanised production.
- B is a supporter of assembly line production over socialistic systems of the same.
- C is a defender of the faith in capitalistic production.
- D None of the above

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Question 244

Why do you think that the author gives the example of Adam Smith?

- A Because he thinks that Adam Smith was a boaster without any facts to back his utterance.
- B Because he wants to give us an example of something undesirable that Adam Smith was proud of.
- C Because he is proud to be a believer in a tenet of production that even a great man like Adam Smith boasted about.
- D Because he feels that Adam Smith was right when he said that it took 18 men to make a pin.

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Question 245

Which of the following is not against the modern capitalistic system of mass production?

- A John Ruskin
- B Goldsmith
- C Adam Smith
- D William Morris

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Instructions

The painter is now free to paint anything he chooses. There are scarcely any forbidden subjects, and today everybody is prepared to admit that a painting of some fruit can be as important as a painting of a hero dying. The Impressionists did as much as anybody to win this previously unheard-of freedom for the artist. Yet, by the next generation, painters began to abandon the subject altogether, and began to paint abstract pictures. Today the majority of pictures painted are abstract.

Is there a connection between these two developments? Has art gone abstract because the artist is embarrassed by his freedom? Is it that, because he is free to paint anything, he doesn't know what to paint? Apologists for abstract art often talk of it as the art of maximum freedom. But could this be the freedom of the desert island? It would take too long to answer these questions properly. I believe there is a connection. Many things have encouraged the development of abstract art. Among them has been the artists' wish to avoid the difficulties of finding subjects when all subjects are equally possible.

I raise the matter now because I want to draw attention to the fact that the painter's choice of a subject is a far more complicated question than it would at first seem. A subject does not start with what is put in front of the easel or with something which the painter happens to remember. A subject starts with the painter deciding he would like to paint such-and-such because for some reason or other he finds it meaningful. A subject begins when the artist selects something for special mention. (What makes it special or meaningful may seem to the artist to be purely visual - its colours or its form.) When the subject has been selected, the function of the painting itself is to communicate and justify the significance of that selection.

It is often said today that subject matter is unimportant. But this is only a reaction against the excessively literary and moralistic interpretation of subject matter in the nineteenth century. In truth, the subject is literally the beginning and end of a painting. The painting begins with a selection (I will paint this and not everything else in the world); it is finished when that selection is justified (now you can see all that I saw and felt in this and how it is more than merely itself).

Thus, for a painting to succeed it is essential that the painter and his public agree about what is significant. The subject may have a personal meaning for the painter or individual spectator; but there must also be the possibility of their agreement on its general meaning. It is at this point that the culture of the society and period in question precedes the artist and his art. Renaissance art would have meant nothing to the Aztecs -and vice versa. If, to some extent, a few intellectuals can appreciate them both today it is because their culture is an historical one; its inspiration is history and therefore it can include within itself, in principle if not in every particular, all known developments to date.

When a culture is secure and certain of its values, it presents its artists with subjects. The general agreement about what is significant is so well established that the significance of a particular subject accrues and becomes traditional. This is true, for instance, of reeds and water in China, of the nude body in Renaissance, of the animal in Africa. Furthermore, in such cultures the artist is unlikely to be a free agent: he will be employed for the sake of particular subjects, and the problem, as we have just described it, will not occur to him.

When a culture is in a state of disintegration or transition, the freedom of the artist increases - but the question of subject matter becomes problematic for him: he, himself, has to choose for society. This was at the basis of all the increasing crises in European art during the nineteenth century. It is too often forgotten how many of the art scandals of that time were provoked by the choice of subject (Gericault, Courbet, Daumier, Degas, Lautrec, Van Gogh, etc.).

By the end of the nineteenth century there were, roughly speaking, two ways in which the painter could meet this challenge of deciding what to paint and so choosing for society. Either he identified himself with the people and so allowed their lives to dictate his subjects to him, or he had to find his subjects within himself as a painter. By people, I mean everybody except the bourgeoisie. Many painters did of course work for the bourgeoisie according to their copy-book of approved subjects, but all of them, filling the Salon and the Royal Academy year after year, are now forgotten, buried under the hypocrisy of those they served so sincerely.

Question 246

In the context of the passage, which of the following statements would NOT be true?

- A Painters decided subjects based on what they remembered from their own lives.
- B Painters of reeds and water in China faced no serious problem of choosing a subject.
- C The choice of subject was a source of scandals in nineteenth century European art.
- D Agreement on the general meaning of a painting is influenced by culture and historical context.

The painter is now free to paint anything he chooses. There are scarcely any forbidden subjects, and today everybody is prepared to admit that a painting of some fruit can be as important as a painting of a hero dying. The Impressionists did as much as anybody to win this previously unheard-of freedom for the artist. Yet, by the next generation, painters began to abandon the subject altogether, and began to paint abstract pictures. Today the majority of pictures painted are abstract.

Is there a connection between these two developments? Has art gone abstract because the artist is embarrassed by his freedom? Is it that, because he is free to paint anything, he doesn't know what to paint? Apologists for abstract art often talk of it as the art of maximum freedom. But could this be the freedom of the desert island? It would take too long to answer these questions properly. I believe there is a connection. Many things have encouraged the development of

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Question 247

Which of the following views is taken by the author?

- A The more insecure a culture, the greater the freedom of the artist.
- B The more secure a culture, the greater the freedom of the artist.
- C The more secure a culture, more difficult the choice of subject.
- D The more insecure a culture, the less significant the choice of the subject.

The painter is now free to paint anything he chooses. There are scarcely any forbidden subjects, and today everybody is prepared to admit that a painting of some fruit can be as important as a painting of a hero dying. The Impressionists did as much as anybody to win this previously unheard-of freedom for the artist. Yet, by the next generation, painters began to abandon the subject altogether, and began to paint abstract pictures. Today the majority of pictures painted are abstract.

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Question 248

Which of the following is NOT necessarily among the attributes needed for a painter to succeed:

- A The painter and his public agree on what is significant.
- B The painting is able to communicate and justify the significance of its subject selection.
- C The subject has a personal meaning for the painter.
- D The painting of subjects is inspired by historical developments.

The painter is now free to paint anything he chooses. There are scarcely any forbidden subjects, and today everybody is prepared to admit that a painting of some fruit can be as important as a painting of a hero dying. The Impressionists did as much as anybody to win this previously unheard-of freedom for the artist. Yet, by the next generation, painters began to abandon the subject altogether, and began to paint abstract pictures. Today the majority of pictures painted are abstract.

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Question 249

When a culture is insecure, the painter chooses his subject on the basis of:

- A The prevalent style in the society of his time.
- B Its meaningfulness to the painter.
- C What is put in front of the easel.
- D Past experience and memory of the painter

The painter is now free to paint anything he chooses. There are scarcely any forbidden subjects, and today everybody is prepared to admit that a painting of some fruit can be as important as a painting of a hero dying. The Impressionists did as much as anybody to win this previously unheard-of freedom for the artist. Yet, by the next generation, painters began to abandon the subject altogether, and began to paint abstract pictures. Today the majority of pictures painted are abstract.

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Question 250

In the sentence, "I believe there is a connection" (second paragraph), what two developments is the author referring to?

- A Painters using a dying hero and using a fruit as a subject of painting.
- B Growing success of painters and an increase in abstract forms.
- C Artists gaining freedom to choose subjects and abandoning subjects altogether.

D Rise of Impressionists and an increase in abstract forms.

The painter is now free to paint anything he chooses. There are scarcely any forbidden subjects, and today everybody is prepared to admit that a painting of some fruit can be as important as a painting of a hero dying. The Impressionists did as much as anybody to win this previously unheard-of freedom for the artist. Yet, by the next generation, painters began to abandon the subject altogether, and began to paint abstract pictures. Today the majority of pictures painted are abstract.

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Instructions

The passage given below is followed by a set of three questions. Choose the most appropriate answer to each question.

Human Biology does nothing to structure human society. Age may enfeeble us all, but cultures vary considerably in the prestige and power they accord to the elderly. Giving birth is a necessary condition for being a mother, but it is not sufficient. We expect mothers to behave in maternal ways and to display appropriately maternal sentiments. We prescribe a clutch of norms or rules that govern the role of a mother. That the social role is independent of the biological base can be demonstrated by going back three sentences. Giving birth is certainly not sufficient to be a mother but, as adoption and fostering show, it is not even necessary!

The fine detail of what is expected of a mother or a father or a dutiful son differs from culture to culture, but everywhere behaviour is coordinated by the reciprocal nature of roles. Husbands and wives, parents and children, employers and employees, waiters and customers, teachers and pupils, warlords and followers; each makes sense only in its relation to the other. The term 'role' is an appropriate one, because the metaphor of an actor in a play neatly expresses the rule-governed nature or scripted nature of much of social life and the sense that society is a joint production. Social life occurs only because people play their parts (and that is as true for war and conflicts as for peace and love) and those parts make sense only in the context of the overall show. The drama metaphor also reminds us of the artistic licence available to the players. We can play a part straight or, as the following from J.P. Sartre conveys, we can ham it up.

Let us consider this waiter in the cafe. His movement is quick and forward, a little too precise, a little too rapid. He comes towards the patrons with a step a little too quick. He bends forward a little too eagerly; his voice, his eyes express an interest a little too solicitous for the order of the customer. Finally there he returns, trying to imitate in his walk the inflexible stiffness of some kind of automaton while carrying his tray with the recklessness of a tightrope-walker....All his behaviour seems to us a game....But what is he playing? We need not watch long before we can explain it: he is playing at being a waiter in a cafe.

The American sociologist Erving Goffman built an influential body of social analysis on elaborations of the metaphor of social life as drama. Perhaps his most telling point was that it is only through acting out a part that we express character. It is not enough to be evil or virtuous; we have to be seen to be evil or virtuous. There is distinction between the roles we play and some underlying self. Here we might note that some roles are more absorbing than others. We would not be surprised by the waitress who plays the part in such a way as to signal to us that she is much more than her occupation. We would be surprised and offended by the father who played his part 'tongue in cheek'. Some roles are broader and more far-reaching than others. Describing someone as a clergyman or faith healer would say far more about that person than describing someone as a bus driver.

Question 251

It has been claimed in the passage that "some roles are more absorbing than others". According to passage, which of the following seem(s) appropriate reason(s) for such a claim?

- A. Some roles carry great expectations from the society preventing manifestation of the true self.
- B. Society ascribes so much importance to some roles that the conception of self may get aligned with the roles being performed.
- C. Some roles require development of skill and expertise leaving little time for manifestation of self.
- A A only
- B B only
- C C only
- D A & B
- E B & C

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Question 252

What is the thematic highlight of this passage?

- A In the absence of strong biological linkages, reciprocal roles provide the mechanism for coordinating human behaviour.
- B In the absence of reciprocal roles, biological linkages provide the mechanism for coordinating human behaviour.
- C Human behaviour is independent of biological linkages and reciprocal roles.
- D Human behaviour depends on biological linkages and reciprocal roles.
- E Reciprocal roles determine normative human behavior in society.

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Question 253

Which of the following would have been true if biological linkages structured human society?

- A The role of mother would have been defined through her reciprocal relationship with her children.
- B We would not have been offended by the father playing his role 'tongue in cheek'.
- C Women would have adopted and fostered children rather than giving birth to them.
- D Even if warlords were physically weaker than their followers, they would still dominate them.
- E Waiters would have stronger motivation to serve their customers.

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Instructions

Read the following paragraph carefully and answer the questions given below:

While complex in the extreme, Derrida's work has proven to be a particularly influential approach to the analysis of the ways in which language structures our understanding of ourselves and the world we inhabit, an approach he termed deconstruction. In its simplest formulation, deconstruction can be taken to refer to a methodological strategy which seeks to uncover layers of hidden meaning in a text that have been denied or suppressed. The term 'text', in this respect, does not refer simply to a written form of communication, however. Rather, texts are something we all produce and reproduce constantly in our everyday social relations, be they spoken, written or embedded in the construction of material artifacts. At the heart of Derrida's deconstructive approach is his critique of what he perceives to be the totalitarian impulse of the Enlightenment pursuit to bring all that exists in the world under the domain of a representative language, a pursuit he refers to as logocentrism. Logocentrism is the search for a rational language that is able to know and represent the world and all its aspects perfectly and accurately. Its totalitarian dimension, for Derrida at least, lies primarily in its tendency to marginalize or dismiss all that does not neatly comply with its particular linguistic representations, a tendency that, throughout history, has all too frequently been manifested in the form of authoritarian institutions. Thus logocentrism has, in its search for the truth of absolute representation, subsumed difference and oppressed that which it designates as its alien 'other'. For Derrida, western civilization has been built upon such a systematic assault on alien cultures and ways of life, typically in the name of reason and progress.

In response to logocentrism, deconstruction posits the idea that the mechanism by which this process of marginalization and the ordering of truth occurs is through establishing systems of binary opposition. Oppositional linguistic dualisms, such as rational/irrational, culture/nature and good/bad are not, however, construed as equal partners as they are in, say, the semiological structuralism of Saussure. Rather, they exist, for Derrida, in a series of hierarchical relationships, with the first term normally occupying a superior position. Derrida defines the relationship between such oppositional terms using the neologism 'différance'. This refers to the realization that in any statement, oppositional terms differ from each other (for instance, the difference between rationality and irrationality is constructed through oppositional usage), and at the same time, a hierarchical relationship is maintained by the deference of one term to the other (in the positing of rationality over irrationality, for instance). It is this latter point which is perhaps the key to understanding Derrida's approach to deconstruction.

For the fact that at any given time, one term must defer to its oppositional 'other', means that the two terms are constantly in a state of interdependence. The presence of one is dependent upon the absence or 'absent-presence' of the 'other', such as in the case of good and evil, whereby to understand the nature of one, we must constantly relate it to the absent term in order to grasp its meaning. That is, to do good, we must understand that our act is not evil, for without that comparison, the term becomes meaningless. Put simply, deconstruction represents an attempt to demonstrate the absent-presence of this oppositional 'other', to show that what we say or write is in itself not expressive simply of what is present, but also of what is absent. Thus, deconstruction seeks to reveal the interdependence of apparently dichotomous terms and their meanings relative to their textual context; that is, within the linguistic power relations which structure dichotomous terms hierarchically. In Derrida's own words, a deconstructive reading "must always aim at a certain relationship, unperceived by the writer, between what he commands and what he does not command of the patterns of a language that he uses. . . .[It] attempts to make the not-seen accessible to sight."

Meaning, then, is never fixed or stable, whatever the intention of the author of a text. For Derrida, language is a system of relations that are dynamic, in that all meanings we ascribe to the world are dependent not only on what we believe to be present but also on what is absent. Thus, any act of interpretation must refer not only to what the author of a text intends, but also to what is absent from his or her intention. This insight leads, once again, to Derrida's further rejection of the idea of the definitive authority of the intentional agent or subject. The subject is decentred; it is conceived as the outcome of relations of différance. As author of its own biography, the subject thus becomes the ideological fiction of modernity and its logocentric philosophy, one that depends upon the formation of hierarchical dualisms, which repress and deny the presence of the absent 'other'. No meaning can, therefore, ever be definitive, but is merely an outcome of a particular interpretation.

Question 254

According to the passage, Derrida believes that the system of binary opposition

- A represents a prioritization or hierarchy.

- B reconciles contradictions and dualities.
- C weakens the process of marginalization and ordering of truth.
- D deconstructs reality.

all its aspects perfectly and accurately. Its totalitarian dimension, for Derrida at least, lies primarily in its tendency to marginalize or dismiss all that does not neatly comply with its particular linguistic representations, a tendency that, throughout history, has all too frequently been manifested in the form of authoritarian institutions. Thus logocentrism has, in its search for the truth of absolute representation, subsumed difference and oppressed that which it designates as its alien 'other'. For Derrida, western civilization has been built upon such a systematic assault on alien cultures and ways of life, typically in the name of reason and progress.

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Question 255

Derrida rejects the idea of 'definitive authority of the subject' because

- A interpretation of the text may not make the unseen visible.
- B the meaning of the text is based on binary opposites.
- C the implicit power relationship is often ignored.
- D any act of interpretation must refer to what the author intends.

all its aspects perfectly and accurately. Its totalitarian dimension, for Derrida at least, lies primarily in its tendency to marginalize or dismiss all that does not neatly comply with its particular linguistic representations, a tendency that, throughout history, has all too frequently been manifested in the form of authoritarian institutions. Thus logocentrism has, in its search for the truth of absolute representation, subsumed difference and oppressed that which it designates as its alien 'other'. For Derrida, western civilization has been built upon such a systematic assault on alien cultures and ways of life, typically in the name of reason and progress.

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Question 256

To Derrida, 'logocentrism' does not imply:

- A A totalitarian impulse.

- B A domain of representative language.
- C Interdependence of the meanings of dichotomous terms.
- D A pursuit that seeks to suppress hidden meanings in a text.

all its aspects perfectly and accurately. Its totalitarian dimension, for Derrida at least, lies primarily in its tendency to marginalize or dismiss all that does not neatly comply with its particular linguistic representations, a tendency that, throughout history, has all too frequently been manifested in the form of authoritarian institutions. Thus logocentrism has, in its search for the truth of absolute representation, subsumed difference and oppressed that which it designates as its alien 'other'. For Derrida, western civilization has been built upon such a systematic assault on alien cultures and ways of life, typically in the name of reason and progress.

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Question 257

According to the passage, Derrida believes that:

- A Reality can be construed only through the use of rational analysis.
- B Language limits our construction of reality.
- C A universal language will facilitate a common understanding of reality.
- D We need to uncover the hidden meaning in a system of relations expressed by language.

all its aspects perfectly and accurately. Its totalitarian dimension, for Derrida at least, lies primarily in its tendency to marginalize or dismiss all that does not neatly comply with its particular linguistic representations, a tendency that, throughout history, has all too frequently been manifested in the form of authoritarian institutions. Thus logocentrism has, in its search for the truth of absolute representation, subsumed difference and oppressed that which it designates as its alien 'other'. For Derrida, western civilization has been built upon such a systematic assault on alien cultures and ways of life, typically in the name of reason and progress.

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Creativity is at once our most precious resource and our most inexhaustible one. As anyone who has ever spent any time with children knows, every single human being is born creative; every human being is innately endowed with the ability to combine and recombine data, perceptions, materials and ideas, and devise new ways of thinking and doing. What fosters creativity? More than anything else: the presence of other creative

people. The big myth is that creativity is the province of great individual geniuses. In fact creativity is a social process. Our biggest creative breakthroughs come when people learn from, compete with, and collaborate with other people.

Cities are the true founts of creativity... With their diverse populations, dense social networks, and public spaces where people can meet spontaneously and serendipitously, they spark and catalyze new ideas. With their infrastructure for finance, organization and trade, they allow those ideas to be swiftly actualized.

As for what stanches creativity, that's easy, if ironic. It's the very institutions that we build to manage, exploit and perpetuate the fruits of creativity — our big bureaucracies, and sad to say, too many of our schools. Creativity is disruptive; schools and organizations are regimented, standardized and stultifying.

The education expert Sir Ken Robinson points to a 1968 study reporting on a group of 1,600 children who were tested over time for their ability to think in out-of-the-box ways. When the children were between 3 and 5 years old, 98 percent achieved positive scores. When they were 8 to 10, only 32 percent passed the same test, and only 10 percent at 13 to 15. When 280,000 25-year-olds took the test, just 2 percent passed. By the time we are adults, our creativity has been wrung out of us.

I once asked the great urbanist Jane Jacobs what makes some places more creative than others. She said, essentially, that the question was an easy one. All cities, she said, were filled with creative people; that's our default state as people. But some cities had more than their shares of leaders, people and institutions that blocked out that creativity. She called them "squelchers."

Creativity (or the lack of it) follows the same general contours of the great socio-economic divide — our rising inequality — that plagues us. According to my own estimates, roughly a third of us across the United States, and perhaps as much as half of us in our most creative cities — are able to do work which engages our creative faculties to some extent, whether as artists, musicians, writers, techies, innovators, entrepreneurs, doctors, lawyers, journalists or educators — those of us who work with our minds. That leaves a group that I term "the other 66 percent," who toil in low-wage rote and rotten jobs — if they have jobs at all — in which their creativity is subjugated, ignored or wasted.

Creativity itself is not in danger. It's flourishing is all around us — in science and technology, arts and culture, in our rapidly revitalizing cities. But we still have a long way to go if we want to build a truly creative society that supports and rewards the creativity of each and every one of us.

Question 258

The central idea of this passage is that

- A social interaction is necessary to nurture creativity.
- B creativity and ideas are gradually declining in all societies.
- C the creativity divide is widening in societies in line with socio-economic trends.
- D more people should work in jobs that engage their creative faculties.

creativity is at once our most precious resource and our most inexhaustible one. As anyone who has ever spent any time with children knows, every single human being is born creative; every human being is innately endowed with the ability to combine and recombine data, perceptions, materials and ideas, and devise new ways of thinking and doing. What fosters creativity? More than anything else: the presence of other creative people. The big myth is that creativity is the province of great individual geniuses. In fact creativity is a social process. Our biggest creative breakthroughs come when people learn from, compete with, and collaborate with other people.

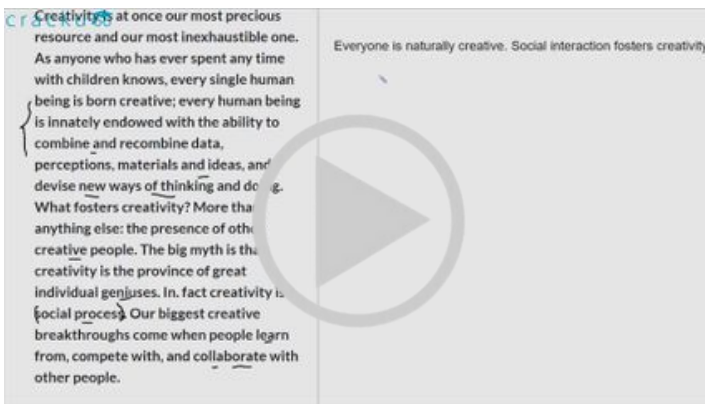
Everyone is naturally creative. Social interaction fosters creativity



Question 259

The 1968 study is used here to show that

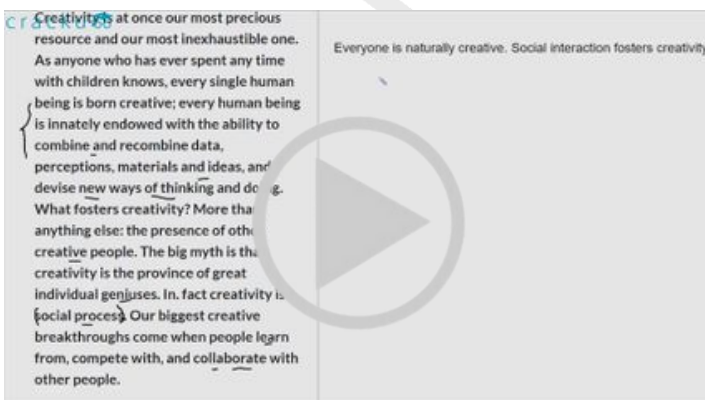
- A as they get older, children usually learn to be more creative.
- B schooling today does not encourage creative thinking in children.
- C the more children learn, the less creative they become.
- D technology today prevents children from being creative.



Question 260

Jane Jacobs believed that cities that are more creative

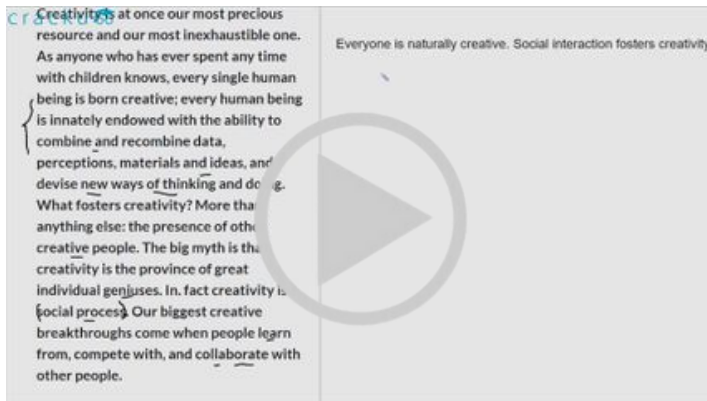
- A have to struggle to retain their creativity.
- B have to 'squench' unproductive people and promote creative ones.
- C have leaders and institutions that do not block creativity.
- D typically do not start off as creative hubs.



Question 261

In the author's view, cities promote human creativity for all the following reasons EXCEPT that they

- A contain spaces that enable people to meet and share new ideas.
- B expose people to different and novel ideas, because they are home to varied groups of people.
- C provide the financial and institutional networks that enable ideas to become reality.
- D provide access to cultural activities that promote new and creative ways of thinking.



CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 262

The author's conclusions about the most 'creative cities' in the US (paragraph 6) are based on his assumption that

- A people who work with their hands are not doing creative work.
- B more than half the population works in non-creative jobs.
- C only artists, musicians, writers, and so on should be valued in a society.
- D most cities ignore or waste the creativity of low-wage workers.

Creativity is at once our most precious resource and our most inexhaustible one. As anyone who has ever spent any time with children knows, every single human being is born creative; every human being is innately endowed with the ability to combine and recombine data, perceptions, materials and ideas, and devise new ways of thinking and doing. What fosters creativity? More than anything else: the presence of other creative people. The big myth is that creativity is the province of great individual geniuses. In fact creativity is a social process. Our biggest creative breakthroughs come when people learn from, compete with, and collaborate with other people.

Everyone is naturally creative. Social interaction fosters creativity

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 263

The author uses 'ironic' in the third paragraph to point out that

- A people need social contact rather than isolation to nurture their creativity.
- B institutions created to promote creativity eventually stifle it.
- C the larger the creative population in a city, the more likely it is to be stifled.
- D large bureaucracies and institutions are the inevitable outcome of successful cities.

Creativity is at once our most precious resource and our most inexhaustible one. As anyone who has ever spent any time with children knows, every single human being is born creative; every human being is innately endowed with the ability to combine and recombine data, perceptions, materials and ideas, and devise new ways of thinking and doing. What fosters creativity? More than anything else: the presence of other creative people. The big myth is that creativity is the province of great individual geniuses. In fact creativity is a social process. Our biggest creative breakthroughs come when people learn from, compete with, and collaborate with other people.

Everyone is naturally creative. Social interaction fosters creativity

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

During the frigid season... it's often necessary to nestle under a blanket to try to stay warm. The temperature difference between the blanket and the air outside is so palpable that we often have trouble leaving our warm refuge. Many plants and animals similarly hunker down, relying on snow cover for safety from winter's harsh conditions. The small area between the snowpack and the ground, called the subnivium... might be the most important ecosystem that you have never heard of.

The subnivium is so well-insulated and stable that its temperature holds steady at around 32 degree Fahrenheit (0 degree Celsius). Although that might still sound cold, a constant temperature of 32 degree Fahrenheit can often be 30 to 40 degrees warmer than the air temperature during the peak of winter. Because of this large temperature difference, a wide variety of species...depend on the subnivium for winter protection.

For many organisms living in temperate and Arctic regions, the difference between being under the snow or outside it is a matter of life and death. Consequently, disruptions to the subnivium brought about by climate change will affect everything from population dynamics to nutrient cycling through the ecosystem.

The formation and stability of the subnivium requires more than a few flurries. Winter ecologists have suggested that eight inches of snow is necessary to develop a stable layer of insulation. Depth is not the only factor, however. More accurately, the stability of the subnivium depends on the interaction between snow depth and snow density. Imagine being under a stack of blankets that are all flattened and pressed together. When compressed, the blankets essentially form one compacted layer. In contrast, when they are lightly placed on top of one another, their insulative capacity increases because the air pockets between them trap heat. Greater depths of low-density snow are therefore better at insulating the ground.

Both depth and density of snow are sensitive to temperature. Scientists are now beginning to explore how climate change will affect the subnivium, as well as the species that depend on it. At first glance, warmer winters seem beneficial for species that have difficulty surviving subzero temperatures; however, as with most ecological phenomena, the consequences are not so straightforward. Research has shown that the snow season (the period when snow is more likely than rain) has become shorter since 1970. When rain falls on snow, it increases the density of the snow and reduces its insulative capacity. Therefore, even though winters are expected to become warmer overall from future climate change, the subnivium will tend to become colder and more variable with less protection from the above-ground temperatures.

The effects of a colder subnivium are complex... For example, shrubs such as crowberry and alpine azalea that grow along the forest floor tend to block the wind and so retain higher depths of snow around them. This captured snow helps to keep soils insulated and in turn increases plant decomposition and nutrient release. In field experiments, researchers removed a portion of the snow cover to investigate the importance of the subnivium's insulation. They found that soil frost in the snow-free area resulted in damage to plant roots and sometimes even the death of the plant.

Question 264

The purpose of this passage is to

- A introduce readers to a relatively unknown ecosystem: the subnivium.
- B explain how the subnivium works to provide shelter and food to several species.
- C outline the effects of climate change on the subnivium.
- D draw an analogy between the effect of blankets on humans and of snow cover on species living in the subnivium.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

During the frigid season... it's often necessary to nestle under a blanket to try to stay warm. The temperature difference between the blanket and the air outside is so palpable that we often have trouble leaving our warm refuge. Many plants and animals similarly hunker down, relying on snow cover for safety from winter's harsh conditions. The small area between the snowpack and the ground, called the subnivium, might be the most important ecosystem that you have never heard of.

The subnivium is so well-insulated and stable that its temperature holds steady at around 32

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 **CAT Score Calculator** 

Question 265

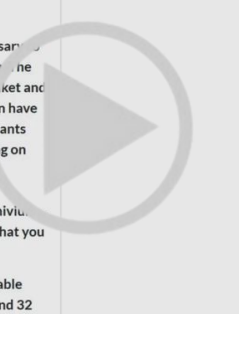
Which one of the following statements can be inferred from the passage?

- A In an ecosystem, altering any one element has a ripple effect on all others.
- B Climate change affects temperate and Arctic regions more than equatorial or arid ones.
- C A compact layer of wool is warmer than a similarly compact layer of goose down.
- D The loss of the subnivium, while tragic, will affect only temperate and Arctic regions.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

During the frigid season... it's often necessary to nestle under a blanket to try to stay warm. The temperature difference between the blanket and the air outside is so palpable that we often have trouble leaving our warm refuge. Many plants and animals similarly hunker down, relying on snow cover for safety from winter's harsh conditions. The small area between the snowpack and the ground, called the subnivium, might be the most important ecosystem that you have never heard of.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 266

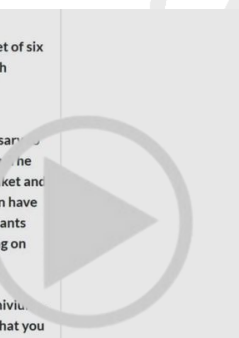
In paragraph 6, the author provides the examples of crowberry and alpine azalea to demonstrate that

- A Despite frigid temperatures, several species survive in temperate and Arctic regions.
- B Due to frigid temperatures in the temperate and Arctic regions, plant species that survive tend to be shrubs rather than trees.
- C The crowberry and alpine azalea are abundant in temperate and Arctic regions.
- D The stability of the subnivium depends on several interrelated factors, including shrubs on the forest floor.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

During the frigid season... it's often necessary to nestle under a blanket to try to stay warm. The temperature difference between the blanket and the air outside is so palpable that we often have trouble leaving our warm refuge. Many plants and animals similarly hunker down, relying on snow cover for safety from winter's harsh conditions. The small area between the snowpack and the ground, called the subnivium, might be the most important ecosystem that you have never heard of.

The subnivium is so well-insulated and stable that its temperature holds steady at around 32



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 267

Based on this extract, the author would support which one of the following actions?

- A The use of snow machines in winter to ensure snow cover of at least eight inches.
- B Government action to curb climate change.
- C Adding nutrients to the soil in winter.
- D Planting more shrubs in areas of short snow season.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

During the frigid season... it's often necessary to nestle under a blanket to try to stay warm. The temperature difference between the blanket and the air outside is so palpable that we often have trouble leaving our warm refuge. Many plants and animals similarly hunker down, relying on snow cover for safety from winter's harsh conditions. The small area between the snowpack and the ground, called the subnivium, might be the most important ecosystem that you have never heard of.

The subnivium is so well-insulated and stable that its temperature holds steady at around 32

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Question 268

All of the following statements are true EXCEPT

- A Snow depth and Snow density both influence the stability of the subnivium.
- B Climate change has some positive effects on the subnivium.
- C The subnivium maintains a steady temperature that can be 30 to 40 degrees warmer than the winter air temperature.
- D Researchers have established the adverse effects of dwindling snow cover on the subnivium.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

During the frigid season... it's often necessary to nestle under a blanket to try to stay warm. The temperature difference between the blanket and the air outside is so palpable that we often have trouble leaving our warm refuge. Many plants and animals similarly hunker down, relying on snow cover for safety from winter's harsh conditions. The small area between the snowpack and the ground, called the subnivium, might be the most important ecosystem that you have never heard of.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 269

In paragraph 1, the author uses blankets as a device to

- A evoke the bitter cold of winter in the minds of readers.
- B explain how blankets work to keep us warm.
- C draw an analogy between blankets and the snow pack.
- D alert readers to the fatal effects of excessive exposure to the cold.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

During the frigid season... it's often necessary to nestle under a blanket to try to stay warm. The temperature difference between the blanket and the air outside is so palpable that we often have trouble leaving our warm refuge. Many plants and animals similarly hunker down, relying on snow cover for safety from winter's harsh conditions. The small area between the snowpack and the ground, called the subnivium, might be the most important ecosystem that you have never heard of.

The subnivium is so well-insulated and stable that its temperature holds steady at around 32

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The end of the age of the internal combustion engine is in sight. There are small signs everywhere: the shift to hybrid vehicles is already under way among manufacturers. Volvo has announced it will make no purely petrol-engined cars after 2019...and Tesla has just started selling its first electric car aimed squarely at the middle classes: the Tesla 3 sells for \$35,000 in the US, and 400,000 people have put down a small, refundable deposit towards one. Several thousand have already taken delivery, and the company hopes to sell half a million more next year. This is a remarkable figure for a machine with a fairly short range and a very limited number of specialised charging stations.

Some of it reflects the remarkable abilities of Elon Musk, the company's founder, as a salesman, engineer, and a man able to get the most out of his factory workers and the governments he deals with...Mr Musk is selling a dream that the world wants to believe in.

This last may be the most important factor in the story. The private car is...a device of immense practical help and economic significance, but at the same time a theatre for myths of unattainable self-fulfilment. The one thing you will never see in a car advertisement is traffic, even though that is the element in which drivers spend their lives. Every single driver in a traffic jam is trying to escape from it, yet it is the inevitable consequence of mass car ownership.

The sleek and swift electric car is at one level merely the most contemporary fantasy of autonomy and power. But it might also disrupt our exterior landscapes nearly as much as the fossil fuel-engined car did in the last century. Electrical cars would of course pollute far less than fossil fuel-driven ones; instead of oil reserves, the rarest materials for batteries would make undeserving despots and their dynasties fantastically rich. Petrol stations would disappear. The air in cities would once more be breathable and their streets as quiet as those of Venice. This isn't an unmixed good. Cars that were as silent as bicycles would still be as dangerous as they are now to anyone they hit without audible warning.

The dream goes further than that. The electric cars of the future will be so thoroughly equipped with sensors and reaction mechanisms that they will never hit anyone. Just as brakes don't let you skid today, the steering wheel of tomorrow will swerve you away from danger before you have even noticed it...

This is where the fantasy of autonomy comes full circle. The logical outcome of cars which need no driver is that they will become cars which need no owner either. Instead, they will work as taxis do, summoned at will but only for the journeys we actually need. This the future towards which Uber...is working. The ultimate development of the private car will be to reinvent public transport. Traffic jams will be abolished only when the private car becomes a public utility. What then will happen to our fantasies of independence? We'll all have to take to electrically powered bicycles.

Question 270

According to the author, the main reason for Tesla's remarkable sales is that

- A in the long run, the Tesla is more cost effective than fossil fuel-driven cars.
- B the US government has announced a tax subsidy for Tesla buyers.
- C the company is rapidly upscaling the number of specialised charging stations for customer convenience.
- D people believe in the autonomy represented by private cars.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The end of the age of the internal combustion engine is in sight. There are small signs everywhere: the shift to hybrid vehicles is already under way among manufacturers. Volvo has announced it will make no purely petrol-engined cars after 2019, and Tesla has just started selling its first electric car aimed squarely at the middle classes: the Tesla 3 sells for \$35,000 in the US, and 400,000 people have put down a small, refundable deposit towards one. Several thousand have already taken delivery, and the company hopes to sell half a million more next year. This is a remarkable figure for a machine with a fairly short range and a very limited number of specialised charging stations.

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Question 271

Which of the following statements best reflects the author's argument?

- A Hybrid and electric vehicles signal the end of the age of internal combustion engines.
- B Elon Musk is a remarkably gifted salesman.
- C The private car represents an unattainable myth of independence.
- D The future Uber car will be environmentally friendlier than even the Tesla.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The end of the age of the internal combustion engine is in sight. There are small signs everywhere: the shift to hybrid vehicles is already under way among manufacturers. Volvo has announced it will make no purely petrol-engined cars after 2019, and Tesla has just started selling its first electric car aimed squarely at the middle classes: the Tesla 3 sells for \$35,000 in the US, and 400,000 people have put down a small, refundable deposit towards one. Several thousand have already taken delivery, and the company hopes to sell half a million more next year. This is a remarkable future for a machine with a fairly short range and a very limited number of specialised charging stations.

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Question 272

In paragraphs 5 and 6, the author provides the example of Uber to argue that

- A in the future, electric cars will be equipped with mechanisms that prevent collisions.
- B in the future, traffic jams will not exist.
- C in the future, the private car will be transformed into a form of public transport.
- D in the future, Uber rides will outstrip Tesla sales.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The end of the age of the internal combustion engine is in sight. There are small signs everywhere: the shift to hybrid vehicles is already under way among manufacturers. Volvo has announced it will make no purely petrol-engined cars after 2019, and Tesla has just started selling its first electric car aimed squarely at the middle classes: the Tesla 3 sells for \$35,000 in the US, and 400,000 people have put down a small, refundable deposit towards one. Several thousand have already taken delivery, and the company hopes to sell half a million more next year. This is a remarkable future for a machine with a fairly short range and a very limited number of specialised charging stations.

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This last may be the most important factor in the story. The private car is... a device of immense practical help and economic significance, but at the same time a theatre for

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Question 273

The author points out all of the following about electric cars EXCEPT

- A Their reliance on rare materials for batteries will support despotic rule.
- B They will reduce air and noise pollution.
- C They will not decrease the number of traffic jams.
- D They will ultimately undermine rather than further driver autonomy.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The end of the age of the internal combustion engine is in sight. There are small signs everywhere: the shift to hybrid vehicles is already under way among manufacturers. Volvo has announced it will make no purely petrol-engined cars after 2019, and Tesla has just started selling its first electric car aimed squarely at the middle classes: the Tesla 3 sells for \$35,000 in the US, and 400,000 people have put down a small, refundable deposit towards one. Several thousand have already taken delivery, and the company hopes to sell half a million more next year. This is a remarkable figure for a machine with a fairly short range and a very limited number of specialised charging stations.

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CAT Daily Targets

Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile

Question 274

The author comes to the conclusion that

- A car drivers will no longer own cars but will have to use public transport.
- B cars will be controlled by technology that is more efficient than car drivers.
- C car drivers dream of autonomy but the future may be public transport.
- D electrically powered bicycles are the only way to achieve autonomy in transportation.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The end of the age of the internal combustion engine is in sight. There are small signs everywhere: the shift to hybrid vehicles is already under way among manufacturers. Volvo has announced it will make no purely petrol-engined cars after 2019, and Tesla has just started selling its first electric car aimed squarely at the middle classes: the Tesla 3 sells for \$35,000 in the US, and 400,000 people have put down a small, refundable deposit towards one. Several thousand have already taken delivery, and the company hopes to sell half a million more next year. This is a remarkable figure for a machine with a fairly short range and a very limited number of specialised charging stations.

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This last may be the most important factor in the story. The private car is...a device of immense practical help and economic significance, but at the same time a theatre for the dreams of a self-deluded man. The one thing you will

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Question 275

In paragraph 6, the author mentions electrically powered bicycles to argue that

- A if Elon Musk were a true visionary, he would invest funds in developing electric bicycles.
- B our fantasies of autonomy might unexpectedly require us to consider electric bicycles.
- C in terms of environmental friendliness and safety, electric bicycles rather than electric cars are the future.

D electric buses are the best form of public transport.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The end of the age of the internal combustion engine is in sight. There are small signs everywhere: the shift to hybrid vehicles is already under way among manufacturers. Volvo has announced it will make no purely petrol-engined cars after 2019, and Tesla has just started selling its first electric car aimed squarely at the middle classes: the Tesla 3 sells for \$35,000 in the US, and 400,000 people have put down a small, refundable deposit towards one. Several thousand have already taken delivery, and the company hopes to sell half a million more next year. This is a remarkable figure for a machine with a fairly short range and a very limited number of specialised charging stations.

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This last may be the most important factor in the story. The private car is... a device of immense practical help and economic significance, but at the same time a theatre for the making of a sustainable self.

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of three questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Despite their fierce reputation, Vikings may not have always been the plunderers and pillagers popular culture imagines them to be. In fact, they got their start trading in northern European markets, researchers suggest.

Combs carved from animal antlers, as well as comb manufacturing waste and raw antler material has turned up at three archaeological sites in Denmark, including a medieval marketplace in the city of Ribe. A team of researchers from Denmark and the U.K. hoped to identify the species of animal to which the antlers once belonged by analyzing collagen proteins in the samples and comparing them across the animal kingdom, Laura Geggel reports for LiveScience. Somewhat surprisingly, molecular analysis of the artifacts revealed that some combs and other material had been carved from reindeer antlers.... Given that reindeer (*Rangifer tarandus*) don't live in Denmark, the researchers posit that it arrived on Viking ships from Norway. Antler craftsmanship, in the form of decorative combs, was part of Viking culture. Such combs served as symbols of good health, Geggel writes. The fact that the animals shed their antlers also made them easy to collect from the large herds that inhabited Norway.

Since the artifacts were found in marketplace areas at each site it's more likely that the Norsemen came to trade rather than pillage. Most of the artifacts also date to the 780s, but some are as old as 725. That predates the beginning of Viking raids on Great Britain by about 70 years. (Traditionally, the so-called "Viking Age" began with these raids in 793 and ended with the Norman conquest of Great Britain in 1066.) Archaeologists had suspected that the Vikings had experience with long maritime voyages [that] might have preceded their raiding days. Beyond Norway, these combs would have been a popular industry in Scandinavia as well: It's possible that the antler combs represent a larger trade network, where the Norsemen supplied raw material to craftsmen in Denmark and elsewhere.

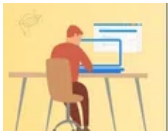
Question 276

The primary purpose of the passage is:

- A to explain the presence of reindeer antler combs in Denmark.
- B to contradict the widely-accepted beginning date for the Viking Age in Britain, and propose an alternate one.
- C to challenge the popular perception of Vikings as raiders by using evidence that suggests their early trade relations with Europe.
- D to argue that besides being violent pillagers, Vikings were also skilled craftsmen and efficient traders.

Combs carved from animal antlers, as well as comb manufacturing waste and raw antler material has turned up at three archaeological sites in Denmark, including a medieval marketplace in the city of Ribe. A team of researchers from Denmark and the U.K. hoped to identify the species of animal to which the antlers once belonged by analyzing collagen proteins in the samples and comparing them across the animal kingdom, Laura Geggel reports for LiveScience. Somewhat surprisingly, molecular analysis of the artifacts revealed that the combs and other material had been carved from reindeer antler. Given that reindeer (Rangifer tarandus) don't live in Denmark, the researchers posit that the Vikings had ships from Norway. Antler craftsmanship, in the form of decorative combs, was part of Viking culture. Such combs served as symbols of good health, Geggel writes. The fact that the animals shed their antlers also made them easy to collect from the large herds that inhabited Norway.

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Question 277

The evidence - "Most of the artifacts also date to the 780s, but some are as old as 725" — has been used in the passage to argue that:

- A the beginning date of the Viking Age should be changed from 793 to 725.
- B the Viking raids started as early as 725.
- C some of the antler artifacts found in Denmark and Great Britain could have come from Scandinavia.
- D the Vikings' trade relations with Europe pre-dates the Viking raids.

Combs carved from animal antlers, as well as comb manufacturing waste and raw antler material has turned up at three archaeological sites in Denmark, including a medieval marketplace in the city of Ribe. A team of researchers from Denmark and the U.K. hoped to identify the species of animal to which the antlers once belonged by analyzing collagen proteins in the samples and comparing them across the animal kingdom, Laura Geggel reports for LiveScience. Somewhat surprisingly, molecular analysis of the artifacts revealed that the combs and other material had been carved from reindeer antler. Given that reindeer (Rangifer tarandus) don't live in Denmark, the researchers posit that the Vikings had ships from Norway. Antler craftsmanship, in the form of decorative combs, was part of Viking culture. Such combs served as symbols of good health, Geggel writes. The fact that the animals shed their antlers also made them easy to collect from the large herds that inhabited Norway.

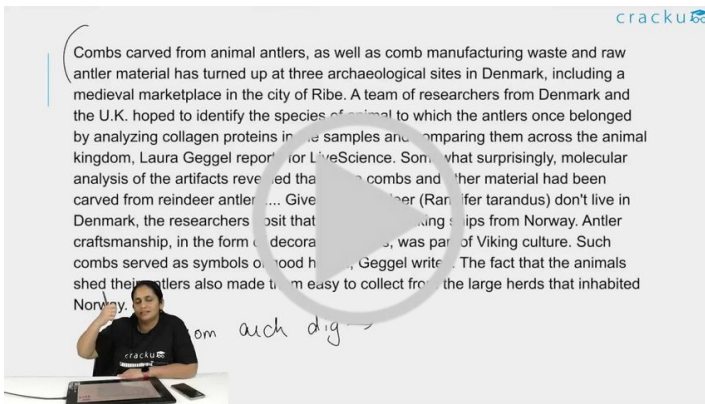
VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 278

All of the following hold true for Vikings EXCEPT

- A Vikings brought reindeer from Norway to Denmark for trade purposes.
- B Before becoming the raiders of northern Europe, Vikings had trade relations with European nations.
- C Antler combs, regarded by the Vikings as a symbol of good health, were part of the Viking culture.

D Vikings, once upon a time, had trade relations with Denmark and Scandinavia.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

As defined by the geographer Yi-Fu Tuan, topophilia is the affective bond between people and place. His 1974 book set forth a wide-ranging exploration of how the emotive ties with the material environment vary greatly from person to person and in intensity, subtlety, and mode of expression. Factors influencing one's depth of response to the environment include cultural background, gender, race, and historical circumstance, and Tuan also argued that there is a biological and sensory element. Topophilia might not be the strongest of human emotions—

indeed, many people feel utterly indifferent toward the environments that shape their lives - but when activated it has the power to elevate a place to become the carrier of emotionally charged events or to be perceived as a symbol.

Aesthetic appreciation is one way in which people respond to the environment. A brilliantly colored rainbow after gloomy afternoon showers, a busy city street alive with human interaction—one might experience the beauty of such landscapes that had seemed quite ordinary only moments before or that are being newly discovered. This is quite the opposite of a second topophilic bond, namely that of the acquired taste for certain landscapes and places that one knows well. When a place is home, or when a space has become the locus of memories or the means of gaining a livelihood, it frequently evokes a deeper set of attachments than those predicated purely on the visual. A third response to the environment also depends on the human senses but may be tactile and olfactory, namely a delight in the feel and smell of air, water, and the earth.

Topophilia—and its very close conceptual twin, sense of place—is an experience that, however elusive, has inspired recent architects and planners. Most notably, new urbanism seeks to counter the perceived placelessness of modern suburbs and the decline of central cities through neo-traditional design motifs. Although motivated by good intentions, such attempts to create places rich in meaning are perhaps bound to disappoint. As Tuan noted, purely aesthetic responses often are suddenly revealed, but their intensity rarely is longlasting. Topophilia is difficult to design for and impossible to quantify, and its most articulate interpreters have been self-reflective philosophers such as Henry David Thoreau, evoking a marvelously intricate sense of place at Walden Pond, and Tuan, describing his deep affinity for the desert.

Topophilia connotes a positive relationship, but it often is useful to explore the darker affiliations between people and place. Patriotism, literally meaning the love of one's terra patria or homeland, has long been cultivated by governing elites for a range of nationalist projects, including war preparation and ethnic cleansing. Residents of upscale residential developments have disclosed how important it is to maintain their community's distinct identity, often by casting themselves in a superior social position and by reinforcing class and racial differences. And just as a beloved landscape is suddenly revealed, so too may landscapes of fear cast a dark shadow over a place that makes one feel a sense of dread or anxiety—or topophobia.

Question 279

In the last paragraph, the author uses the example of “Residents of upscale residential developments” to illustrate the:

- A manner in which environments are designed to minimise the social exclusion of their clientele.
- B introduction of nationalist projects by such elites to produce a sense of dread or topophobia.
- C social exclusivism practised by such residents in order to enforce a sense of racial or class superiority.
- D sensitive response to race and class problems in upscale residential developments.



VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 280

Which one of the following comes closest in meaning to the author's understanding of topophilia?

- A Scientists have found that most creatures, including humans, are either born with or cultivate a strong sense of topography.
- B The tendency of many cultures to represent their land as “motherland” or “fatherland” may be seen as an expression of their topophilia
- C Nomadic societies are known to have the least affinity for the lands through which they traverse because they tend to be topophobic.
- D The French are not overly patriotic, but they will refuse to use English as far as possible, even when they know it well.

cracku

As defined by the geographer Yi-Fu Tuan, topophilia is the affective bond between people and place. His 1974 book set forth a wide-ranging exploration of how the emotive ties with the material environment vary greatly from person to person and in intensity, subtlety and mode of expression. Factors influencing one's depth of response to the environment include cultural background, gender, race, and historical circumstance, and Tuan also argued that there is a biological and sensory element. Topophilia might not be the strongest of human emotions—indeed, many people feel utterly indifferent toward the environments that shape their lives—but when activated it has the power to elevate a place to become the carrier of emotionally charged events or to be perceived as a symbol.

Aesthetic appreciation is one way in which people respond to the environment. A brilliantly colored rainbow after gloomy afternoon showers, a busy city street alive with human interaction—one might experience the beauty of such landscapes that had seemed quite ordinary only moments before or that are being newly discovered. This is quite the opposite of a second topophilic bond, namely that of the acquired taste for certain landscapes and places that one



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 281

Which of the following statements, if true, could be seen as not contradicting the arguments in the passage?

- A New Urbanism succeeded in those designs where architects collaborated with their clients.
- B Generally speaking, in a given culture, the ties of the people to their environment vary little in significance or intensity.
- C The most important, even fundamental, response to our environment is our tactile and olfactory response.
- D Patriotism, usually seen as a positive feeling, is presented by the author as a darker form of topophilia.

cracku

As defined by the geographer Yi-Fu Tuan, topophilia is the affective bond between people and place. His 1974 book set forth a wide-ranging exploration of how the emotive ties with the material environment vary greatly from person to person and in intensity, subtlety and mode of expression. Factors influencing one's depth of response to the environment include cultural background, gender, race, and historical circumstance, and Tuan also argued that there is a biological and sensory element. Topophilia might not be the strongest of human emotions—indeed, many people feel utterly indifferent toward the environments that shape their lives—but when activated it has the power to elevate a place to become the carrier of emotionally charged events or to be perceived as a symbol.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 282

The word “topophobia” in the passage is used:

- A to represent a feeling of dread towards particular spaces and places.
- B to signify the fear of studying the complex discipline of topography.
- C to signify feelings of fear or anxiety towards topophilic people.
- D as a metaphor expressing the failure of the homeland to accommodate non-citizens.



VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 283

Which one of the following best captures the meaning of the statement, "Topophilia is difficult to design for and impossible to quantify . . . "?

- A The deep anomie of modern urbanisation led to new urbanism's intricate sense of place.
- B Architects have to objectively quantify spaces and hence cannot be topophilic.
- C Philosopher-architects are uniquely suited to develop topophilic design
- D People's responses to their environment are usually subjective and so cannot be rendered in design.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

"Free of the taint of manufacture" - that phrase, in particular, is heavily loaded with the ideology of what the Victorian socialist William Morris called the "anti-scrape", or an anticapitalist conservationism (not conservatism) that solaced itself with the vision of a preindustrial golden age. In Britain, folk may often appear a cosy, fossilised form, but when you look more closely, the idea of folk - who has the right to sing it, dance it, invoke it, collect it, belong to it or appropriate it for political or cultural ends - has always been contested territory.

...

In our own time, though, the word "folk" . . . has achieved the rare distinction of occupying fashionable and unfashionable status simultaneously. Just as the effusive floral prints of the radical William Morris now cover genteel sofas, so the revolutionary intentions of many folk historians and revivalists have led to music that is commonly regarded as parochial and conservative. And yet - as newspaper columns periodically rejoice - folk is hip again, influencing artists, clothing and furniture designers, celebrated at music festivals, awards ceremonies and on TV, reissued on countless record labels. Folk is a sonic "shabby chic", containing elements of the uncanny and eerie, as well as an antique veneer, a whiff of Britain's heathen dark ages. The very obscurity and anonymity of folk music's origins open up space for rampant imaginative fancies. . . .

[Cecil Sharp, who wrote about this subject, believed that] folk songs existed in constant transformation, a living example of an art form in a perpetual state of renewal. "One man sings a song, and then others sing it after him, changing what they do not like" is the most concise summary of his conclusions on its origins. He compared each rendition of a ballad to an acorn falling from an oak tree; every subsequent iteration sows the song anew. But there is tension in newness. In the late 1960s, purists were suspicious of folk songs recast in rock idioms. Electrification, however, comes in many forms. For the early-20th-century composers such as Vaughan Williams and Holst, there were thunderbolts of inspiration from oriental mysticism, angular modernism and the body blow of the first world war, as well as input from the rediscovered folk tradition itself.

For the second wave of folk revivalists, such as Ewan MacColl and AL Lloyd, starting in the 40s, the vital spark was communism's dream of a post-revolutionary New Jerusalem. For their younger successors in the 60s, who thronged the folk clubs set up by the old guard, the lyrical freedom of Dylan and the unchained melodies of psychedelia created the conditions for folkrock's own golden age, a brief Indian summer that lasted from about 1969 to 1971. . . . Four decades on, even that progressive period has become just one more era ripe for fashionable emulation and pastiche. The idea of a folk tradition being exclusively confined to oral transmission has become a much looser, less severely guarded concept. Recorded music and television, for today's metropolitan generation, are where the equivalent of folk memories are seeded. . . .

Question 284

Which of the following statements about folk revivalism of the 1940s and 1960s cannot be inferred from the passage?

- A Electrification of music would not have happened without the influence of rock music.
- B Even though it led to folk-rock's golden age, it wasn't entirely free from critique.
- C It reinforced Cecil Sharp's observation about folk's constant transformation.
- D Freedom and rebellion were popular themes during the second wave of folk revivalism.

cracku

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 285

The author says that folk "may often appear a cosy, fossilised form" because:

- A folk is a sonic “shabby chic” with an antique veneer.
- B of its nostalgic association with a pre-industrial past.
- C it has been arrogated for various political and cultural purposes.
- D the notion of folk has led to several debates and disagreements.

cracku

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Question 286

At a conference on folk forms, the author of the passage is least likely to agree with which one of the following views?

- A Folk forms, in their ability to constantly adapt to the changing world, exhibit an unusual poise and homogeneity with each change.
- B The plurality and democratising impulse of folk forms emanate from the improvisation that its practitioners bring to it.
- C The power of folk resides in its contradictory ability to influence and be influenced by the present while remaining rooted in the past.
- D Folk forms, despite their archaic origins, remain intellectually relevant in contemporary times.

cracku

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Question 287

The primary purpose of the reference to William Morris and his floral prints is to show:

- A that despite its archaic origins, folk continues to remain a popular tradition.
- B the pervasive influence of folk on contemporary art, culture, and fashion.
- C that what is once regarded as radical in folk, can later be seen as conformist.
- D that what was once derided as genteel is now considered revolutionary.

cracku

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Question 288

All of the following are causes for plurality and diversity within the British folk tradition EXCEPT:

- A that British folk continues to have traces of pagan influence from the dark ages.
- B paradoxically, folk forms are both popular and unpopular.
- C the fluidity of folk forms owing to their history of oral mode of transmission.
- D that British folk forms can be traced to the remote past of the country.

cracku

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Instructions

Comprehension:

Around the world, capital cities are disgorging bureaucrats. In the post-colonial fervour of the 20th century, coastal capitals picked by trade-focused empires were spurned for “regionally neutral” new ones. But decamping wholesale is costly and unpopular; governments these days prefer piecemeal dispersal. The trend reflects how the world has changed. In past eras, when information travelled at a snail’s pace, civil servants had to cluster together. But now desk-workers can ping emails and video-chat around the world. Travel for face-to-face meetings may be unavoidable, but transport links, too, have improved.

Proponents of moving civil servants around promise countless benefits. It disperses the risk that a terrorist attack or natural disaster will cripple an entire government. Wonks in the sticks will be inspired by new ideas that walled-off capitals cannot conjure up. Autonomous regulators perform best far from the pressure and lobbying of the big city. Some even hail a cure for ascendant cynicism and populism. The unloved bureaucrats of faraway capitals will become as popular as firefighters once they mix with regular folk.

Beyond these sunny visions, dispersing central-government functions usually has three specific aims: to improve the lives of both civil servants and those living in clogged capitals; to save money; to redress regional imbalances. The trouble is that these goals are not always realised.

The first aim—improving living conditions—has a long pedigree. After the second world war, Britain moved thousands of civil servants to “agreeable English country towns” as London was rebuilt. But swapping the capital for somewhere smaller is not always agreeable. Attrition rates can exceed 80%. . . . The second reason to pack bureaucrats off is to save money. Office space costs far more in capitals. Agencies that are moved elsewhere can often recruit better workers on lower salaries than in capitals, where well-paying multinationals mop up talent.

The third reason to shift is to rebalance regional inequality. Norway treats federal jobs as a resource every region deserves to enjoy, like profits from oil. Where government jobs go, private ones follow. Sometimes the aim is to fulfil the potential of a country’s second-tier cities. Unlike poor, remote places, bigger cities can make the most of relocated government agencies, linking them to local universities and businesses and supplying a better-educated workforce. The decision in 1946 to set up America’s Centres for Disease Control in Atlanta rather than Washington, D.C., has transformed the city into a hub for health-sector research and business.

The dilemma is obvious. Pick small, poor towns, and areas of high unemployment get new jobs, but it is hard to attract the most qualified workers; opt for larger cities with infrastructure and better-qualified residents, and the country’s most deprived areas see little benefit.

Others contend that decentralisation begets corruption by making government agencies less accountable. A study in America found that state-government corruption is worse when the state capital is isolated—journalists, who tend to live in the bigger cities, become less watchful of those in power.

Question 289

According to the author, relocating government agencies has not always been a success for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

- A a rise in pollution levels and congestion in the new locations.
- B the difficulty of attracting talented, well-skilled people in more remote areas.
- C increased avenues of corruption away from the capital city.
- D high staff losses, as people may not be prepared to move to smaller towns.

cracku

Comprehension:

Around the world, capital cities are disgorging bureaucrats. In the post-colonial fervour of the 20th century, coastal capitals picked by trade-focused empires were spurned for "regionally-neutral" new ones. But decamping whole is costly and unpopular. Governments these days prefer piecemeal dispersal. The trend reflects how the world has changed. In past eras when information travelled at a snail's pace, civil servants had to cluster together. But now desk-workers can ping emails and video-chat around the world. Travel for face-to-face meetings may be unavoidable, but transport links, too, have improved.

Proponents of moving civil servants around promise countless benefits. It disperses the risk

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 290

The "dilemma" mentioned in the passage refers to:

- A keeping government agencies in the largest city with good infrastructure or moving them to a remote area with few amenities.
- B relocating government agencies to boost growth in remote areas with poor amenities or to relatively larger cities with good amenities.
- C encouraging private enterprises to relocate to smaller towns or not incentivising them in order to keep government costs in those towns low.
- D concentrating on decongesting large cities or focusing on boosting employment in relatively larger cities.

cracku

Comprehension:

Around the world, capital cities are disgorging bureaucrats. In the post-colonial fervour of the 20th century, coastal capitals picked by trade-focused empires were spurned for "regionally-neutral" new ones. But decamping whole is costly and unpopular. Governments these days prefer piecemeal dispersal. The trend reflects how the world has changed. In past eras when information travelled at a snail's pace, civil servants had to cluster together. But now desk-workers can ping emails and video-chat around the world. Travel for face-to-face meetings may be unavoidable, but transport links, too, have improved.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 291

Based on the passage, people who support decentralising central government functions are LEAST likely to cite which of the following reasons for their view?

- A It could weaken the nexus between bureaucrats and media in the capital.
- B More independence could be enjoyed by regulatory bodies located away from political centres.
- C Policy makers may benefit from fresh thinking in a new environment.

- D It reduces expenses as infrastructure costs and salaries are lower in smaller cities.

cracku

Comprehension:

Around the world, capital cities are disgorging bureaucrats. In the post-colonial fervour of the 20th century, coastal capitals picked by trade-focused empires were spurned for "regionally neutral" new ones. But decamping whole is costly and unpopular. Governments these days prefer piecemeal dispersal. The trend reflects how the world has changed. In past eras when information travelled at a snail's pace, civil servants had to cluster together. But now, desk-workers can ping emails and video-chat around the world. Travel for face-to-face meetings must be unavoidable, but transport links, too, have improved.

Proponents of moving civil servants around promise countless benefits. It disperses the risk

VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 292

The "long pedigree" of the aim to shift civil servants to improve their living standards implies that this move:

- A has become common practice in several countries worldwide.
- B is supported by politicians and the ruling elites.
- C takes a long time to achieve its intended outcomes.
- D is not a new idea and has been tried in the past.

cracku

Comprehension:

Around the world, capital cities are disgorging bureaucrats. In the post-colonial fervour of the 20th century, coastal capitals picked by trade-focused empires were spurned for "regionally neutral" new ones. But decamping whole is costly and unpopular. Governments these days prefer piecemeal dispersal. The trend reflects how the world has changed. In past eras when information travelled at a snail's pace, civil servants had to cluster together. But now, desk-workers can ping emails and video-chat around the world. Travel for face-to-face meetings must be unavoidable, but transport links, too, have improved.

Proponents of moving civil servants around promise countless benefits. It disperses the risk

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 293

According to the passage, colonial powers located their capitals:

- A based on political expediency.
- B to promote their trading interests.
- C where they had the densest populations.

D to showcase their power and prestige.

cracku

Comprehension:

Around the world, capital cities are disgorging bureaucrats. In the post-colonial fervour of the 20th century, coastal capital cities picked by trade-focused empires were spurned for "regionally neutral" new ones. But decamping whole cities is costly and unpopular. Governments these days prefer piecemeal dispersal. The trend reflects how the world has changed. In past eras, when information travelled at a snail's pace, civil servants had to cluster together. But now, desk-workers can ping emails and video-chat around the world. Travel for face-to-face meetings must be unavoidable, but transport links, too, have improved.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I've been following the economic crisis for more than two years now. I began working on the subject as part of the background to a novel, and soon realized that I had stumbled across the most interesting story I've ever found. While I was beginning to work on it, the British bank Northern Rock blew up, and it became clear that, as I wrote at the time, "If our laws are not extended to control the new kinds of super-powerful, super-complex, and potentially super risky investment vehicles, they will one day cause a financial disaster of global-systemic proportions." . . . I was both right and too late, because all the groundwork for the crisis had already been done—though the sluggishness of the world's governments, in not preparing for the great unraveling of autumn 2008, was then and still is stupefying. But this is the first reason why I wrote this book: because what's happened is extraordinarily interesting. It is an absolutely amazing story, full of human interest and drama, one whose byways of mathematics, economics, and psychology are both central to the story of the last decades and mysteriously unknown to the general public. We have heard a lot about "the two cultures" of science and the arts—we heard a particularly large amount about it in 2009, because it was the fiftieth anniversary of the speech during which C. P. Snow first used the phrase. But I'm not sure the idea of a huge gap between science and the arts is as true as it was half a century ago—it's certainly true, for instance, that a general reader who wants to pick up an education in the fundamentals of science will find it easier than ever before. It seems to me that there is a much bigger gap between the world of finance and that of the general public and that there is a need to narrow that gap, if the financial industry is not to be a kind of priesthood, administering to its own mysteries and feared and resented by the rest of us. Many bright, literate people have no idea about all sorts of economic basics, of a type that financial insiders take as elementary facts of how the world works. I am an outsider to finance and economics, and my hope is that I can talk across that gulf.

My need to understand is the same as yours, whoever you are. That's one of the strangest ironies of this story: after decades in which the ideology of the Western world was personally and economically individualistic, we've suddenly been hit by a crisis which shows in the starkest terms that whether we like it or not—and there are large parts of it that you would have to be crazy to like—we're all in this together. The aftermath of the crisis is going to dominate the economics and politics of our societies for at least a decade to come and perhaps longer.

Question 294

Which one of the following, if true, would be an accurate inference from the first sentence of the passage?

- A The author's preoccupation with the economic crisis is not less than two years old.
- B The author is preoccupied with the economic crisis because he is being followed.

- C The economic crisis outlasted the author's preoccupation with it.
- D The author has witnessed many economic crises by travelling a lot for two years

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

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cracku



Question 295

Which one of the following best captures the main argument of the last paragraph of the passage?

- A The aftermath of the crisis will strengthen the central ideology of individualism in the Western world
- B Whoever you are, you would be crazy to think that there is no crisis.
- C In the decades to come, other ideologies will emerge in the aftermath of the crisis.
- D The ideology of individualism must be set aside in order to deal with the crisis.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I've been following the economic crisis for more than two years now. I began working on the subject as part of the background to a novel, and soon realized that I had stumbled across the most interesting story I've ever found. While I was beginning to work on it, the British bank Northern Rock blew up, and it became clear that, as I wrote at the time, "If our laws are not extended to control the new kinds of super-powerful, super-complex, and potentially super-risky investment vehicles, they will not only cause a financial disaster of global-systemic proportions"... I was right and too late, because all the groundwork for the crisis had already been done—though the sluggishness of the world's governments in not preparing for the great unraveling of autumn 2008, was then still stupefying. But this is the first reason why I wrote this book: because what's happened is extraordinarily interesting. It is an absolutely amazing story, full of human interest and drama, one whose byways of mathematics, economics, and psychology are both central to the story. At the same time, it is a story that has been mysteriously unknown to the general public. We have heard a lot about "the two cultures" of science and the arts—we heard a particularly large amount about it in 2009, because it was the fiftieth anniversary of the speech during which C. P. Snow first used the phrase. But I'm not sure the idea of a huge gap between science and the arts is as true as it was half a century ago—it's certainly true, for instance, that a general reader who wants to pick up an education in the fundamentals of science will find it easier than ever before. It seems to me that there is a much bigger gap between the world of finance and that of the general public and that there is a need to narrow that gap, if the financial industry is not to be a kind of priesthood, administering to its own mysteries and feared and resented

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 296

All of the following, if true, could be seen as supporting the arguments in the passage, EXCEPT:

- A The failure of economic systems does not necessarily mean the failure of their ideologies.
- B The difficulty with understanding financial matters is that they have become so arcane.
- C The story of the economic crisis is also one about international relations, global financial security, and mass psychology.
- D Economic crises could be averted by changing prevailing ideologies and beliefs.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I've been following the economic crisis for more than two years now. I began working on the subject as part of the background to a novel, and soon realized that I had stumbled across the most interesting story I've ever found. While I was beginning to work on it, the British bank Northern Rock blew up, and it became clear that, as I wrote at the time, "If our laws are not extended to control the new kinds of super-powerful, super-complex, and potentially super risky investment vehicles, they will not only cause a financial disaster of global-systemic proportions"... I was right and too late, because all the groundwork for the crisis had already been done—though the sluggishness of the world's governments in not preparing for the great unraveling of autumn 2008, was then still is stupefying. But this is the first reason why I wrote this book: because what's happened is extraordinarily interesting. It is an absolutely amazing story, full of human interest and drama, one whose byways of mathematics, economics, and psychology are both central to the story of the last decades and mysteriously unknown to the general public. We have heard a lot about "the two cultures" of science and the arts—we heard a particularly large amount about it in 2009, because it was the fiftieth anniversary of the speech during which C. P. Snow first used the phrase. But I'm not sure the idea of a huge gap between science and the arts is as true as it was half a century ago—it's certainly true, for instance, that a general reader who wants to pick up an education in the fundamentals of science will find it easier than ever before. It seems to me that there is a much bigger gap between the world of finance and that of the general public and that there is a need to narrow that gap. If the financial industry is not to be a kind of priesthood, administering to its own mysteries and feared and resented

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 297

According to the passage, the author is likely to be supportive of which one of the following programmes?

- A Economic policies that are more sensitively calibrated to the fluctuations of the market.
- B An educational curriculum that promotes economic research
- C An educational curriculum that promotes developing financial literacy in the masses.
- D The complete nationalisation of all financial institutions

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I've been following the economic crisis for more than two years now. I began working on the subject as part of the background to a novel, and soon realized that I had stumbled across the most interesting story I've ever found. While I was beginning to work on it, the British bank Northern Rock blew up, and it became clear that, as I wrote at the time, "If our laws are not extended to control the new kinds of super-powerful, super-complex, and potentially super risky investment vehicles, they will not only cause a financial disaster of global-systemic proportions"... I was right and too late, because all the groundwork for the crisis had already been done—though the sluggishness of the world's governments in not preparing for the great unraveling of autumn 2008, was then still is stupefying. But this is the first reason why I wrote this book: because what's happened is extraordinarily interesting. It is an absolutely amazing story, full of human interest and drama, one whose byways of mathematics, economics, and psychology are both central to the story of the last decades and mysteriously unknown to the general public. We have heard a lot about "the two cultures" of science and the arts—we heard a particularly large amount about it in 2009, because it was the fiftieth anniversary of the speech during which C. P. Snow first used the phrase. But I'm not sure the idea of a huge gap between science and the arts is as true as it was half a century ago—it's certainly true, for instance, that a general reader who wants to pick up an education in the fundamentals of science will find it easier than ever before. It seems to me that there is a much bigger gap between the world of finance and that of the general public and that there is a need to narrow that gap. If the financial industry is not to be a kind of priesthood, administering to its own mysteries and feared and resented

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Important Topics



Question 298

Which one of the following, if false, could be seen as supporting the author's claims?

- A The huge gap between science and the arts has steadily narrowed over time.
- B The economic crisis was not a failure of collective action to rectify economic problems.
- C Most people are yet to gain any real understanding of the workings of the financial world.
- D The global economic crisis lasted for more than two years.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I've been following the economic crisis for more than two years now. I began working on the subject as part of the background to a novel, and soon realized that I had stumbled across the most interesting story I've ever found. While I was beginning to work on it, the British bank Northern Rock blew up, and it became clear that, as I wrote at the time, "If our laws are not extended to control the new kinds of super-powerful, super-complex, and potentially super risky investment vehicles, they will not only cause a financial disaster of global-systemic proportions," ... I was right and too late, because all the groundwork for the crisis had already been done—though the sluggishness of the world's governments in not preparing for the great unraveling of autumn 2008, was then still stupefying. But this is the first reason why I wrote this book: because what's happened is extraordinarily interesting. It is an absolutely amazing story, full of human interest and drama, one whose byways of mathematics, economics, and psychology are both central to the story itself, and at the same time, decades and mysteriously unknown to the general public. We have heard a lot about "the two cultures" of science and the arts—we heard a particularly large amount about it in 2009, because it was the fiftieth anniversary of the speech during which C. P. Snow first used the phrase. But I'm not sure the idea of a huge gap between science and the arts is as true as it was half a century ago—it's certainly true, for instance, that a general reader who wants to pick up an education in the fundamentals of science will find it easier than ever before. It seems to me that there is a much bigger gap between the world of finance and that of the general public and that there is a need to narrow that gap. If the financial industry is not to be a kind of priesthood, administering to its own mysteries and feared and resented

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

In a modern computer, electronic and magnetic storage technologies play complementary roles. Electronic memory chips are fast but volatile (their contents are lost when the computer is unplugged). Magnetic tapes and hard disks are slower, but have the advantage that they are non-volatile, so that they can be used to store software and documents even when the power is off.

In laboratories around the world, however, researchers are hoping to achieve the best of both worlds. They are trying to build magnetic memory chips that could be used in place of today's electronics. These magnetic memories would be nonvolatile; but they would also be faster, would consume less power, and would be able to stand up to hazardous environments more easily. Such chips would have obvious applications in storage cards for digital cameras and music players; they would enable handheld and laptop computers to boot up more quickly and to operate for longer; they would allow desktop computers to run faster; they would doubtless have military and space-faring advantages too. But although the theory behind them looks solid, there are tricky practical problems and need to be overcome.

Two different approaches, based on different magnetic phenomena, are being pursued. The first, being investigated by Gary Prinz and his colleagues at the Naval Research Laboratory (NRL) in Washington, D.C), exploits the fact that the electrical resistance of some materials changes in the presence of magnetic field—a phenomenon known as magneto-resistance. For some multi-layered materials this effect is particularly powerful and is, accordingly, called "giant" magneto-resistance (GMR). Since 1997, the exploitation of GMR has made cheap multi-gigabyte hard disks commonplace. The magnetic orientations of the magnetised spots on the surface of a spinning disk are detected by measuring the changes they induce in the resistance of a tiny sensor. This technique is so sensitive that it means the spots can be made smaller and packed closer together than was previously possible, thus increasing the capacity and reducing the size and cost of a disk drive. Dr. Prinz and his colleagues are now exploiting the same phenomenon on the surface of memory chips, rather than spinning disks. In a conventional memory chip, each binary digit (bit) of data is represented using a capacitor-reservoir of electrical charge that is either empty or filled to represent a zero or a one. In the NRL's magnetic design, by contrast, each bit is stored in a magnetic element in the form of a vertical pillar of magnetisable material. A matrix of wires passing above and below the elements allows each to be magnetised, either clockwise or anti-clockwise, to represent zero or one. Another set of wires allows current to pass through any

particular element. By measuring an element's resistance you can determine its magnetic orientation, and hence whether it is storing a zero or a one. Since the elements retain their magnetic orientation even when the power is off, the result is non-volatile memory. Unlike the elements of an electronic memory, a magnetic memory's elements are not easily disrupted by radiation. And compared with electronic memories, whose capacitors need constant topping up, magnetic memories are simpler and consume less power. The NRL researchers plan to commercialise their device through a company called Non-Volatile Electronics, which recently began work on the necessary processing and fabrication techniques. But it will be some years before the first chips roll off the production line.

Most attention in the field is focused on an alternative approach based on magnetic tunnel-junctions (MTJs), which are being investigated by researchers at chipmakers such as IBM, Motorola, Siemens and Hewlett-Packard. IBM's research team, led by Stuart Parkin, has already created a 500-element working prototype that operates at 20 times the speed of conventional memory chips and consumes 1% of the power. Each element consists of a sandwich of two layers of magnetisable material separated by a barrier of aluminium oxide just four or five atoms thick. The polarisation of lower magnetisable layer is fixed in one direction, but that of the upper layer can be set (again, by passing a current through a matrix of control wires) either to the left or to the right, to store a zero or a one. The polarisations of the two layers are then either the same or opposite directions.

Although the aluminum-oxide barrier is an electrical insulator, it is so thin that electrons are able to jump across it via a quantum-mechanical effect called tunnelling. It turns out that such tunnelling is easier when the two magnetic layers are polarised in the same direction than when they are polarised in opposite directions. So, by measuring the current that flows through the sandwich, it is possible to determine the alignment of the topmost layer, and hence whether it is storing a zero or a one.

To build a full-scale memory chip based on MTJs is, however, no easy matter. According to Paulo Freitas, an expert on chip manufacturing at the Technical University of Lisbon, magnetic memory elements will have to become far smaller and more reliable than current prototypes if they are to compete with electronic memory. At the same time, they will have to be sensitive enough to respond when the appropriate wires in the control matrix are switched on, but not so sensitive that they respond when a neighbouring element is changed. Despite these difficulties, the general consensus is that MTJs are the more promising ideas. Dr. Parkin says his group evaluated the GMR approach and decided not to pursue it, despite the fact that IBM pioneered GMR in hard disks. Dr. Prinz, however, contends that his plan will eventually offer higher storage densities and lower production costs.

Not content with shaking up the multi-billion-dollar market for computer memory, some researchers have even more ambitious plans for magnetic computing. In a paper published last month in *Science*, Russell Cowburn and Mark Welland of Cambridge University outlined research that could form the basis of a magnetic microprocessor — a chip capable of manipulating (rather than merely storing) information magnetically. In place of conducting wires, a magnetic processor would have rows of magnetic dots, each of which could be polarised in one of two directions. Individual bits of information would travel down the rows as magnetic pulses, changing the orientation of the dots as they went. Dr. Cowburn and Dr. Welland have demonstrated how a logic gate (the basic element of a microprocessor) could work in such a scheme. In their experiment, they fed a signal in at one end of the chain of dots and used a second signal to control whether it propagated along the chain.

It is, admittedly, a long way from a single logic gate to a full microprocessor, but this was true also when the transistor was first invented. Dr. Cowburn, who is now searching for backers to help commercialise the technology, says he believes it will be at least ten years before the first magnetic microprocessor is constructed. But other researchers in the field agree that such a chip, is the next logical step. Dr. Prinz says that once magnetic memory is sorted out "the target is to go after the logic circuits." Whether all-magnetic computers will ever be able to compete with other contenders that are jostling to knock electronics off its perch — such as optical, biological and quantum computing — remains to be seen. Dr. Cowburn suggests that the future lies with hybrid machines that use different technologies. But computing with magnetism evidently has an attraction all its own.

Question 299

From the passage, which of the following cannot be inferred?

- A Electronic memory chips are faster and non-volatile
- B Electronic and magnetic storage technologies play a complementary role.
- C MTJs are the more promising idea, compared to the magneto-resistance approach.
- D Non-volatile Electronics is the company set up to commercialise the GMR chips.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 300

A magnetic chip that can both store and manipulate information, is being pursued by:

- A Paul Freitas
- B Stuart Parkin
- C Gary Prinz
- D none of the above.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 301

In the MTJs approach, it is possible to identify whether the topmost layer of the magnetised memory element is storing a zero or one by:

- A measuring an element's resistance and thus determining its magnetic orientation.
- B measuring the degree of disruption caused by radiation in the elements of the magnetic memory.
- C magnetising the elements either clockwise or anti-clockwise.
- D measuring the current that flows through

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 302

Experimental research currently underway, using rows of magnetic dots, each of which could be polarised in one of the two directions, has led to the demonstration of:

- A working of a microprocessor
- B working of a logic gate
- C working of a magneto-resistance based chip
- D working of a magneto tunnelling-junction (MTJ) based chip

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 303

A major barrier on the way to build a full-scale memory chip based on MTJs is:

- A the low sensitivity of the magnetic memory elements.
- B the thickness of aluminium oxide barriers.
- C the need to develop more reliable and far smaller magnetic memory chips.
- D all of the above.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 304

In magnetic tunnel-junctions (MTJs) tunnelling is easier when:

- A two magnetic layers are polarised in the same direction.
- B two magnetic layers are polarised in the opposite directions.
- C two aluminium-oxide barriers are polarised in the same direction.
- D two aluminium-oxide barriers are polarised in opposite directions.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 305

A binary digit or bit is represented in the magneto-resistance based magnetic chip using:

- A a layer of aluminium oxide.
- B a capacitor.
- C a vertical pillar of magnetised material.
- D a matrix of wires.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 306

In developing magnetic memory chips to replace the electronic ones, two alternative research paths are being pursued. These are approaches based on:

- A volatile and non-volatile memories.
- B magneto-resistance and magnetic tunnel- junctions.
- C radiation-disruption and radiation-neutral effects.
- D orientation of magnetised spots on the surface of a spinning disk and alignment of magnetic dots on the surface of a conventional memory chip.



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Aggression is any behavior that is directed toward injuring, harming, or inflicting pain on another living being or group of beings. Generally, the victim(s) of aggression must wish to avoid such behavior in order for it to be considered true aggression. Aggression is also categorized according to its ultimate intent. Hostile aggression is an aggressive act that results from anger, and is intended to inflict pain or injury because of that anger. Instrumental aggression is an aggressive act that is regarded as a means to an end other than pain or injury. For example, an enemy combatant may be subjected to torture in order to extract useful intelligence, though those inflicting the torture may have no real feelings of anger or animosity toward their subject. The concept of aggression is very broad, and includes many categories of behavior (e.g., verbal aggression, street crime, child abuse, spouse abuse, group conflict, war, etc.). A number of theories and models of aggression have arisen to explain these diverse forms of behavior, and these theories/models tend to be categorized according to their specific focus. The most common system of categorization groups the various approaches to aggression into three separate areas, based upon the three key variables that are present whenever any aggressive act or set of acts is committed. The first variable is the aggressor him/herself. The second is the social situation or circumstance in which the aggressive act(s) occur. The third variable is the target or victim of aggression.

Regarding theories and research on the aggressor, the fundamental focus is on the factors that lead an individual (or group) to commit aggressive acts. At the most basic level, some argue that aggressive urges and actions are the result of inborn, biological factors. Sigmund Freud (1930) proposed that all individuals are born with a death instinct that predisposes us to a variety of aggressive behaviors, including suicide (self directed aggression) and mental illness (possibly due to an unhealthy or unnatural suppression of aggressive urges). Other influential perspectives supporting a biological basis for aggression conclude that humans evolved with an abnormally low neural inhibition of aggressive impulses (in comparison to other species), and that humans possess a powerful instinct for property accumulation and territorialism. It is proposed that this instinct accounts for hostile behaviors ranging from minor street crime to world wars. Hormonal factors also appear to play a significant role in fostering aggressive tendencies. For example, the hormone testosterone has been shown to increase aggressive behaviors when injected into animals. Men and women convicted of violent crimes also possess significantly higher levels of testosterone than men and women convicted of non violent crimes. Numerous studies comparing different age groups, racial/ethnic groups, and cultures also indicate that men, overall, are more likely to engage in a variety of aggressive behaviors (e.g., sexual assault, aggravated assault, etc.) than women. One explanation for higher levels of aggression in men is based on the assumption that, on average, men have higher levels of testosterone than women.

Question 307

All of the following statements can be seen as logically implied by the arguments of the passage EXCEPT:

- A a common theory of aggression is that it is the result of an abnormally low neural regulation of testosterone.
- B if the alleged aggressive act is not sought to be avoided, it cannot really be considered aggression.
- C Freud's theory of aggression proposes that aggression results from the suppression of aggressive urges.
- D the Freudian theory of suicide as self-inflicted aggression implies that an aggressive act need not be sought to be avoided in order for it to be considered aggression.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Aggression is any behavior that is directed toward injuring, harming, or inflicting pain on another living being or group of beings. Generally, the victim(s) of aggression must wish to avoid such behavior in order for it to be considered true aggression. Aggression is also categorized according to its ultimate intent. (Hostile aggression) is an aggressive act that results from anger and is intended to inflict pain or injury because of that anger. (Instrumental aggression) is an aggressive act that is regarded as a means to an end other than pain or injury. For example, an enemy combatant may be subjected to torture in order to extract useful intelligence, though those inflicting the torture may have no real feelings of anger or animosity toward their subject. The concept of aggression is very broad, and includes many categories of behavior (e.g., verbal aggression, street crime, child abuse, spouse abuse, group conflict, war, etc.). A number of theories and models of aggression have arisen to explain these diverse forms of behavior, and these theories/models tend to be categorized according to their specific focus. The most common system of categorization groups the various approaches to aggression into three separate areas, based upon the three key variables that are present whenever any aggressive act or set of acts is committed. The first variable is the aggressor him/herself. The second is the social situation or circumstance in which the aggressive act(s) occur. The

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Question 308

"[A]n enemy combatant may be subjected to torture in order to extract useful intelligence, though those inflicting the torture may have no real feelings of anger or animosity toward their subject." Which one of the following best explicates the larger point being made by the author here?

- A In certain kinds of aggression, inflicting pain is not the objective, and is no more than a utilitarian means to achieve another end.
- B Information revealed by subjecting an enemy combatant to torture is not always reliable because of the animosity involved.
- C When an enemy combatant refuses to reveal information, the use of torture can sometimes involve real feelings of hostility.
- D The use of torture to extract information is most effective when the torturer is not emotionally involved in the torture.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Aggression is any behavior that is directed toward injuring, harming, or inflicting pain on another living being or group of beings. Generally, the victim(s) of aggression must wish to avoid such behavior in order for it to be considered true aggression. Aggression is also categorized according to its ultimate intent. (Hostile aggression) is an aggressive act that results from anger and is intended to inflict pain or injury because of that anger. (Instrumental aggression) is an aggressive act that is regarded as a means to an end other than pain or injury. For example, an enemy combatant may be subjected to torture in order to extract useful intelligence, though those inflicting the torture may have no real feelings of anger or animosity toward their subject. The concept of aggression is very broad, and includes many categories of behavior (e.g., verbal aggression, street crime, child abuse, spouse abuse, group conflict, war, etc.). A number of theories and models of aggression have arisen to explain these diverse forms of behavior, and these theories/models tend to be categorized according to their specific focus. The most common system of categorization groups the various approaches to aggression into three separate areas, based upon the three key variables that are present whenever any aggressive act or set of acts is committed. The first variable is the aggressor him/herself. The second is the social situation or circumstance in which the aggressive act(s) occur. The

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Question 309

The author discusses all of the following arguments in the passage EXCEPT that:

- A men in general are believed to be more hormonally driven to exhibit violence than women.
- B several studies indicate that aggression may have roots in the biological condition of humanity.

- C aggression in most societies is kept under control through moderating the death instinct identified by Freud.
- D the nature of aggression can vary depending on several factors, including intent.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Aggression is any behavior that is directed toward injuring, harming, or inflicting pain on another living being or group of beings. Generally, the victim(s) of aggression must wish to avoid such behavior in order for it to be considered true aggression. Aggression is also categorized according to its ultimate intent. Hostile aggression is an aggressive act that results from anger and is intended to inflict pain or injury because of that anger. Instrumental aggression is an aggressive act that is regarded as a means to an end other than pain or injury. For example, an enemy combatant may be subjected to torture in order to extract useful intelligence, though those inflicting the torture may have no real feelings of anger or animosity toward their subject. The concept of aggression is very broad, and includes many categories of behavior (e.g., verbal aggression, street crime, child abuse, spouse abuse, group conflict, war, etc.). A number of theories and models of aggression have arisen to explain these diverse forms of behavior, and these theories/models tend to be categorized according to their specific focus. The most common system of categorization groups the various approaches to aggression into three separate areas, based upon the three key variables that are present whenever any aggressive act or set of acts is committed. The first variable is the aggressor him/herself. The second is the social situation or circumstance in which the aggressive act(s) occur. The

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Question 310

The author identifies three essential factors according to which theories of aggression are most commonly categorised. Which of the following options is closest to the factors identified by the author?

- A Aggressor - Circumstances of aggression - Victim.
- B Psychologically - Sociologically - Medically.
- C Hostile - Instrumental - Hormonal.
- D Extreme - Moderate - Mild.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Aggression is any behavior that is directed toward injuring, harming, or inflicting pain on another living being or group of beings. Generally, the victim(s) of aggression must wish to avoid such behavior in order for it to be considered true aggression. Aggression is also categorized according to its ultimate intent. Hostile aggression is an aggressive act that results from anger and is intended to inflict pain or injury because of that anger. Instrumental aggression is an aggressive act that is regarded as a means to an end other than pain or injury. For example, an enemy combatant may be subjected to torture in order to extract useful intelligence, though those inflicting the torture may have no real feelings of anger or animosity toward their subject. The concept of aggression is very broad, and includes many categories of behavior (e.g., verbal aggression, street crime, child abuse, spouse abuse, group conflict, war, etc.). A number of theories and models of aggression have arisen to explain these diverse forms of behavior, and these theories/models tend to be categorized according to their specific focus. The most common system of categorization groups the various approaches to aggression into three separate areas, based upon the three key variables that are present whenever any aggressive act or set of acts is committed. The first variable is the aggressor him/herself. The second is the social situation or circumstance in which the aggressive act(s) occur. The

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Instructions

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

Recycling plastic is to saving the Earth what hammering a nail is to halting a falling skyscraper. You struggle to find a place to do it and feel pleased when you succeed. But your effort is wholly inadequate and distracts from the real problem of why the building is collapsing in the first place. The real problem is that single-use plastic—the very idea of producing plastic items like grocery bags, which we use for an average of 12 minutes but can persist in the environment for half a millennium—is an incredibly reckless abuse of technology. Encouraging individuals to recycle more will never solve the problem of a massive production of single-use plastic that should have been avoided in the first place.

Beginning in the 1950s, big beverage companies like Coca-Cola and Anheuser-Busch, along with Phillip Morris and others, formed a non-profit called Keep America Beautiful. Its mission is/was to educate and encourage environmental stewardship in the public. . . . At face value, these efforts seem benevolent, but they obscure the real problem, which is the role that corporate polluters play in the plastic problem. This clever misdirection has led journalist and author Heather Rogers to describe Keep America Beautiful as the first corporate greenwashing front, as it has helped shift the public focus to consumer recycling behavior and actively thwarted legislation that would increase extended producer responsibility for waste management. . . . [T]he greatest success of Keep America Beautiful has been to shift the onus of environmental responsibility onto the public while simultaneously becoming a trusted name in the environmental movement. . . .

Question 311

A an innovative example of a collaborative corporate social responsibility initiative.

B a sham as it diverted attention away from the role of corporates in plastics pollution.

C an important step in sensitising producers to the need to tackle plastics pollution.

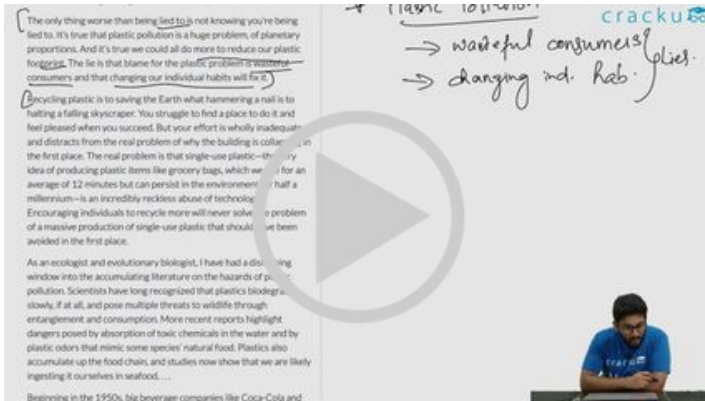
D a "greenwash" because it was a benevolent attempt to improve public recycling habits.



Question 312

Which of the following interventions would the author most strongly support:

- A having all consumers change their plastic consumption habits.
- B recycling all plastic debris in the seabed.
- C passing regulations targeted at producers that generate plastic products.
- D completely banning all single-use plastic bags.



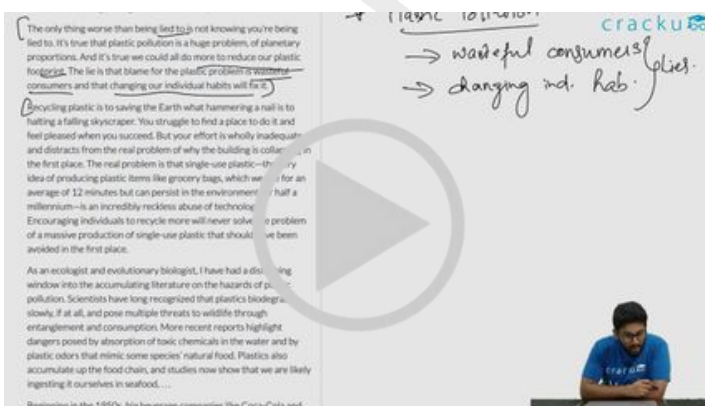
CAT Syllabus PDF



Question 313

In the first paragraph, the author uses “lie” to refer to the:

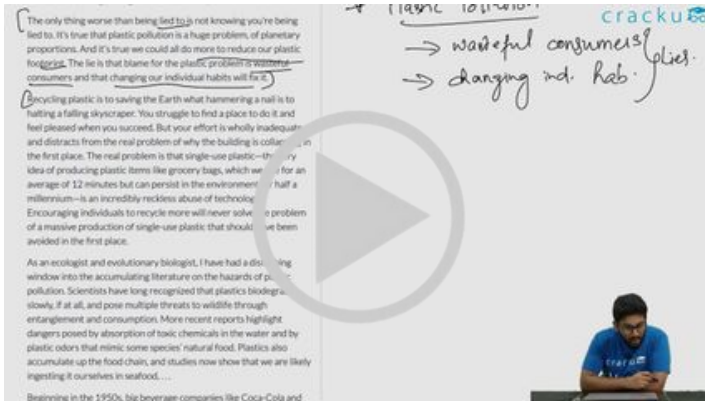
- A understatement of the effects of recycling plastics.
- B understatement of the enormity of the plastics pollution problem.
- C blame assigned to consumers for indiscriminate use of plastics.
- D fact that people do not know they have been lied to.



Question 314

In the second paragraph, the phrase “what hammering a nail is to halting a falling skyscraper” means:

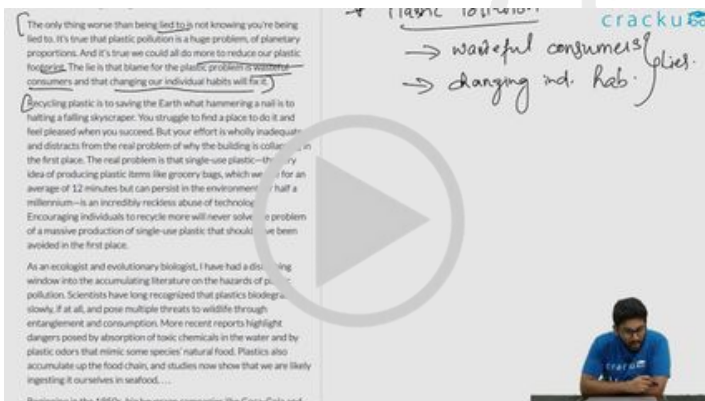
- A focusing on single-use plastic bags to reduce the plastics footprint.
- B encouraging the responsible production of plastics by firms.
- C relying on emerging technologies to mitigate the ill-effects of plastic pollution.
- D focusing on consumer behaviour to tackle the problem of plastics pollution.



Question 315

The author lists all of the following as negative effects of the use of plastics EXCEPT the:

- A air pollution caused during the process of recycling plastics.
- B poisonous chemicals released into the water and food we consume.
- C adverse impacts on the digestive systems of animals exposed to plastic.
- D slow pace of degradation or non-degradation of plastics in the environment.





Instructions

The passage given below is followed by a set of three questions. Choose the most appropriate answer to each question.

To discover the relation between rules, paradigms, and normal science, consider first how the historian isolates the particular loci of commitment that have been described as accepted rules. Close historical investigation of a given specialty at a given time discloses a set of recurrent and quasi-standard illustrations of various theories in their conceptual, observational, and instrumental applications. These are the community's paradigms, revealed in its textbooks, lectures, and laboratory exercises. By studying them and by practicing with them, the members of the corresponding community learn their trade. The historian, of course, will discover in addition a penumbral area occupied by achievements whose status is still in doubt, but the core of solved problems and techniques will usually be clear. Despite occasional ambiguities, the paradigms of a mature scientific community can be determined with relative ease.

That demands a second step and one of a somewhat different kind. When undertaking it, the historian must compare the community's paradigms with each other and with its current research reports. In doing so, his object is to discover what isolable elements, explicit or implicit, the members of that community may have abstracted from their more global paradigms and deploy it as rules in their research. Anyone who has attempted to describe or analyze the evolution of a particular scientific tradition will necessarily have sought accepted principles and rules of this sort. Almost certainly, he will have met with at least partial success. But, if his experience has been at all like my own, he will have found the search for rules both more difficult and less satisfying than the search for paradigms. Some of the generalizations he employs to describe the community's shared beliefs will present more problems. Others, however, will seem a shade too strong. Phrased in just that way, or in any other way he can imagine, they would almost certainly have been rejected by some members of the group he studies. Nevertheless, if the coherence of the research tradition is to be understood in terms of rules, some specification of common ground in the corresponding area is needed. As a result, the search for a body of rules competent to constitute a given normal research tradition becomes a source of continual and deep frustration.

Recognizing that frustration, however, makes it possible to diagnose its source. Scientists can agree that a Newton, Lavoisier, Maxwell, or Einstein has produced an apparently permanent solution to a group of outstanding problems and still disagree, sometimes without being aware of it, about the particular abstract characteristics that make those solutions permanent. They can, that is, agree in their identification of a paradigm without agreeing on, or even attempting to produce, a full interpretation or rationalization of it. Lack of a standard interpretation or of an agreed reduction to rules will not prevent a paradigm from guiding research. Normal science can be determined in part by the direct inspection of paradigms, a process that is often aided by but does not depend upon the formulation of rules and assumption. Indeed, the existence of a paradigm need not even imply that any full set of rules exists.

Question 316

The term 'loci of commitment' as used in the passage would most likely correspond with which of the following?

- A Loyalty between a group of scientists in a research laboratory
- B Loyalty between groups of scientists across research laboratories
- C Loyalty to a certain paradigm of scientific inquiry
- D Loyalty to global patterns of scientific inquiry
- E Loyalty to evolving trends of scientific inquiry

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 317

What is the author attempting to illustrate through this passage?

- A Relationships between rules, paradigms, and normal science
- B How a historian would isolate a particular 'loci of commitment'
- C How a set of shared beliefs evolve in to a paradigm.
- D Ways of understanding a scientific tradition
- E The frustrations of attempting to define a paradigm of a tradition

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 318

The author of this passage is likely to agree with which of the following?

- A Paradigms almost entirely define a scientific tradition.
- B A group of scientists investigating a phenomenon would benefit by defining a set of rules.
- C Acceptance by the giants of a tradition is a sine qua non for a paradigm to emerge.
- D Choice of isolation mechanism determines the types of paradigm that may emerge from a tradition.
- E Paradigms are a general representation of rules and beliefs of a scientific tradition.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Instructions

Comprehension:

British colonial policy . . . went through two policy phases, or at least there were two strategies between which its policies actually oscillated, sometimes to its great advantage. At first, the new colonial apparatus exercised caution and occupied India by a mix of military power and subtle diplomacy, the high ground in the middle of the circle of circles. This, however, pushed them into contradictions. For, whatever their sense of the strangeness of the country and the thinness of colonial presence, the British colonial state represented the great conquering discourse of Enlightenment rationalism, entering India precisely at the moment of its greatest unchecked arrogance. As inheritors and representatives of this discourse, which carried everything before it, this colonial state could hardly adopt for long such a self-denying attitude. It had restructured everything in Europe—the productive system, the political regimes, the moral and cognitive orders—and would do the same in India, particularly as some empirically inclined theorists of that generation considered the colonies a massive laboratory of utilitarian

or other theoretical experiments. Consequently, the colonial state could not settle simply for eminence at the cost of its marginality; it began to take initiatives to introduce the logic of modernity into Indian society. But this modernity did not enter a passive society. Sometimes, its initiatives were resisted by pre-existing structural

forms. At times, there was a more direct form of collective resistance. Therefore the map of continuity and discontinuity that this state left behind at the time of independence was rather complex and has to be traced with care.

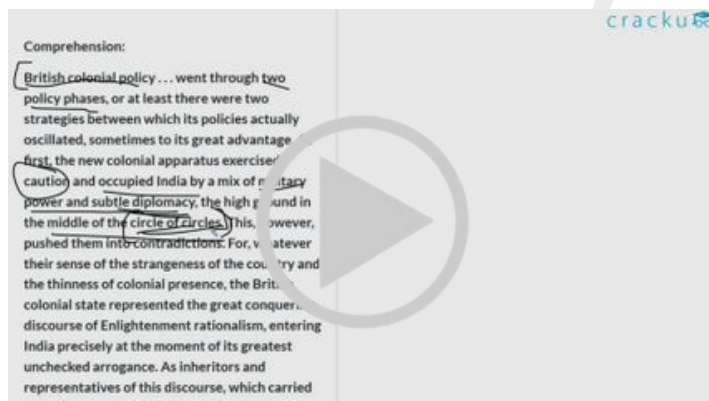
Most significantly, of course, initiatives for modernity came to assume an external character. The acceptance of modernity came to be connected, ineradicably, with subjection. This again points to two different problems, one theoretical, the other political. Theoretically, because modernity was externally introduced, it is explanatorily unhelpful to apply the logical format of the 'transition process' to this pattern of change. Such a logical format would be wrong on two counts. First, however subtly, it would imply that what was proposed to be built was something like European capitalism. (And, in any case, historians have forcefully argued that what it was to replace was not like feudalism, with or without modificatory adjectives.) But, more fundamentally, the logical structure of endogenous change does not apply here. Here transformation agendas attack as an external force. This externality is not something that can be casually mentioned and forgotten. It is inscribed on every move, every object, every proposal, every legislative act, each line of causality. It comes to be marked on the epoch itself. This repetitive emphasis on externality should not be seen as a nationalist initiative that is so well-rehearsed in Indian social science. . . .

Quite apart from the externality of the entire historical proposal of modernity, some of its contents were remarkable. . . . Economic reforms, or rather alterations . . . did not foreshadow the construction of a classical capitalist economy, with its necessary emphasis on extractive and transport sectors. What happened was the creation of a degenerate version of capitalism —what early dependency theorists called the 'development of underdevelopment'.

Question 319

Which one of the following 5-word sequences best captures the flow of the arguments in the passage?

- A Colonial policy—Enlightenment—external modernity—subjection — underdevelopment.
- B Military power—colonialism—restructuring—feudalism—capitalism.
- C Military power—arrogance—laboratory—modernity—capitalism.
- D Colonial policy—arrogant rationality—resistance—independence—development.



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 320

Which of the following observations is a valid conclusion to draw from the author's statement that "the logical structure of endogenous change does not apply here. Here transformation agendas attack as an external force"?

- A Colonised societies cannot be changed through logic; they need to be transformed with external force.
- B The transformation of Indian society did not happen organically, but was forced by colonial agendas.

- C The endogenous logic of colonialism can only bring change if it attacks and transforms external forces.
- D Indian society is not endogamous; it is more accurately characterised as aggressively exogamous.

Comprehension:

British colonial policy ... went through two policy phases, or at least there were two strategies between which its policies actually oscillated, sometimes to its great advantage. First, the new colonial apparatus exercised caution and occupied India by a mix of military power and subtle diplomacy, the high ground in the middle of the circle of circles. This, however, pushed them into contradictions. For, whatever their sense of the strangeness of the country and the thinness of colonial presence, the British colonial state represented the great conqueror. The discourse of Enlightenment rationalism, entering India precisely at the moment of its greatest unchecked arrogance. As inheritors and representatives of this discourse, which carried everything before it, the colonial state could

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 321

All of the following statements, if true, could be seen as supporting the arguments in the passage, EXCEPT:

- A throughout the history of colonial conquest, natives have often been experimented on by the colonisers.
- B modernity was imposed upon India by the British and, therefore, led to underdevelopment.
- C the change in British colonial policy was induced by resistance to modernity in Indian society.
- D the introduction of capitalism in India was not through the transformation of feudalism, as happened in Europe.

Comprehension:

British colonial policy ... went through two policy phases, or at least there were two strategies between which its policies actually oscillated, sometimes to its great advantage. First, the new colonial apparatus exercised caution and occupied India by a mix of military power and subtle diplomacy, the high ground in the middle of the circle of circles. This, however, pushed them into contradictions. For, whatever their sense of the strangeness of the country and the thinness of colonial presence, the British colonial state represented the great conqueror. The discourse of Enlightenment rationalism, entering India precisely at the moment of its greatest unchecked arrogance. As inheritors and representatives of this discourse, which carried everything before it, the colonial state could

VIDEO SOLUTION

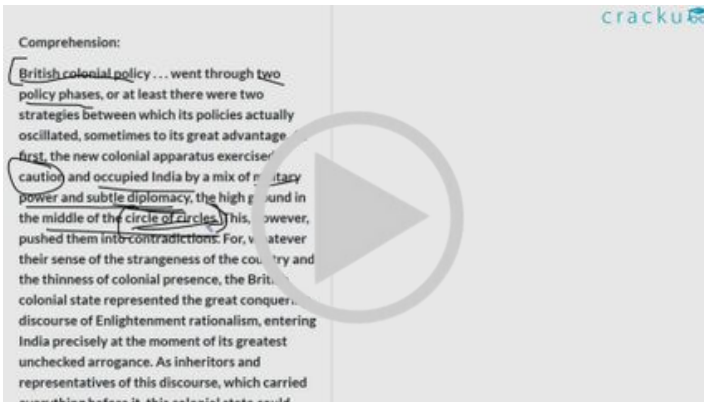
CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 322

"Consequently, the colonial state could not settle simply for eminence at the cost of its marginality; it began to take initiatives to introduce the logic of modernity into Indian society." Which of the following best captures the sense of this statement?

- A The cost of the colonial state's eminence was not settled; therefore, it took the initiative of introducing modernity into Indian society.
- B The colonial enterprise was a costly one; so to justify the cost it began to take initiatives to introduce the logic of modernity into Indian society.
- C The colonial state's eminence was unsettled by its marginal position; therefore, it developed Indian society by modernising it.
- D The colonial state felt marginalised from Indian society because of its own modernity; therefore, it sought to address that marginalisation by bringing its modernity to change Indian society.

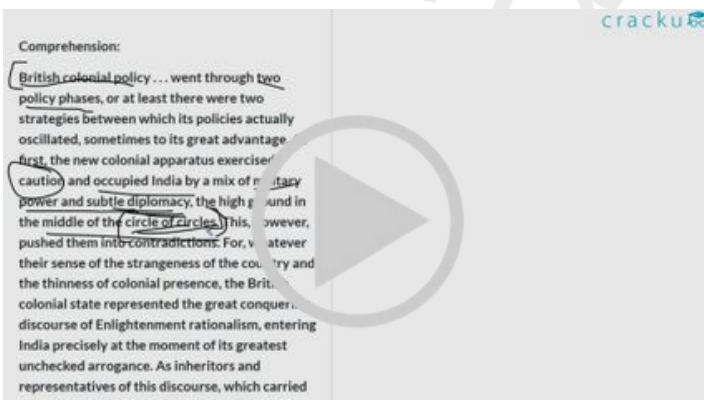


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 323

All of the following statements about British colonialism can be inferred from the first paragraph, EXCEPT that it:

- A allowed some to consider the colonies as experimental sites.
- B faced resistance from existing structural forms of Indian modernity.
- C was at least partly an outcome of Enlightenment rationalism.
- D was at least partly shaped by the project of European modernity.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

There are a seemingly endless variety of laws, restrictions, customs and traditions that affect the practice of abortion around the world. Globally, abortion is probably the single most controversial issue in the whole area of women's rights and family matters. It is an issue that inflames women's right groups, religious institutions, and the self-proclaimed 'guardians' of public morality. The growing worldwide belief is that the right to control one's fertility is a basic human right. This has resulted in a worldwide trend towards liberalization of abortion laws. Forty per cent of the world's population live in countries where induced abortion is permitted on request. An additional 25 per cent live in countries where it is allowed if the women's life would be endangered if she went to full term with her pregnancy. The estimate is that between 26 and 31 million legal abortions were performed in that year. However, there were also between 10 and 22 million illegal abortions performed in that year.

Feminists have viewed the patriarchal control of women's bodies as one of the prime issues facing the contemporary women's movement. They observe that the definition and control of women's reproductive freedom have always been the province of men. Patriarchal religion, as manifest in Islamic fundamentalism, traditionalist Hindu practice, orthodox Judaism, and Roman Catholicism, has been an important historical contributory factor for this and continues to be an important presence in contemporary societies. In recent times, governments, usually controlled by men, have 'given' women the right to contraceptive use and abortion access when their countries were perceived to have an overpopulation problem. When these countries are perceived to be underpopulated, that right had been absent. Until the 19th century, a woman's rights to an abortion followed English common law; it could only be legally challenged if there was a 'quickening', when the first movements of the fetus could be felt. In 1800, drugs to induce abortions were widely advertised in local newspapers. By 1900, abortion was banned in every state except to save the life of the mother. The change was strongly influenced by medical profession, which focussed its campaign ostensibly on health and safety issues for pregnant women and the sanctity of life. Its position was also a means of control of non-licensed medical practitioners such as midwives and women healers who practiced abortion.

The anti-abortion campaign was also influenced by political considerations. The large influx of eastern and southern European immigrants with their large families was seen as a threat to the population balance of the future United States. Middle and upper-classes Protestants were advocates of abortion as a form of birth control. By supporting abortion prohibitions the hope was that these Americans would have more children and thus prevent the tide of immigrant babies from overwhelming the demographic characteristics of Protestant America.

The anti-abortion legislative position remained in effect in the United States through the first 65 years of the 20th century. In the early 1960s, even when it was widely known that the drug thalidomide taken during pregnancy to alleviate anxiety was shown to contribute to the formation of deformed 'flipper-like' hands or legs of children, abortion was illegal in the United States. A second health tragedy was the severe outbreak of rubella during the same time period, which also resulted in major birth defects. These tragedies combined with a change of attitude towards a woman's right to privacy led a number of states to pass abortion permitting legislation.

On one side of the controversy are those who call themselves 'pro-life'. They view the foetus as a human life rather than as an unformed complex of cells; therefore, they hold to the belief that abortion is essentially murder of an unborn child. These groups cite both legal and religious reasons for their opposition to abortion. Pro-lifers point to the rise in legalised abortion figures and see this as morally intolerable. On the other side of the issue are those who call themselves 'pro-choice'. They believe that women, not legislators or judges, should have the right to decide whether and under what circumstances they will bear children. Pro-choicers are of the opinion that laws will not prevent women from having abortions and cite the horror stories of the past when many women died at the hands of 'backroom' abortionists and in desperate attempts to self-abort. They also observe that legalized abortion is especially important for rape victims and incest victims who became pregnant. They stress physical and mental health reasons why women should not have unwanted children.

To get a better understanding of the current abortion controversy, let us examine a very important work by Kristin Luker titled Abortion and the Politics of Motherhood. Luker argues that female pro-choice and pro-life activists hold different world views regarding gender, sex, and the meaning of parenthood. Moral positions on abortions are seen to be tied intimately to views on sexual behaviour, the care of children, family life, technology, and the importance of the individual. Luker identified 'pro-choice' women as educated, affluent, and liberal. Their contrasting counterparts, 'pro-life' women, support traditional concepts of women as wives and

mothers. It would be instructive to sketch out the differences in the world views of these two sets of women. Luker examines California, with its liberalized abortion law, as a case history. Public documents and newspaper accounts over a 26-year period were analysed and over 200 interviews were held with both pro-life and pro-choice activists.

Luker found that pro-life and pro-choice activists have intrinsically different views with respect to gender. Pro-life women have a notion of public and private life. The proper place for men is in the public sphere of work; for women, it is the private sphere of the home. Men benefit through the nurturance of women; women benefit through the protection of men. Children are seen to be the ultimate beneficiaries of this arrangement of having the mother as a full-time loving parent and by having clear role models. Pro-choice advocates reject the view of separate spheres. They object to the notion of the home being the 'women's sphere'. Women's reproductive and family roles are seen as potential barriers to full equality. Motherhood is seen as a voluntary, not a mandatory or 'natural' role. In summarizing her findings, Luker believes that women become activists in either of the two movements as the end result of lives that centre around different conceptualizations of motherhood. Their beliefs and values are rooted to the concrete circumstances of their lives, their educations, incomes, occupations, and the different marital and family choices that they have made. They represent two different world views of women's roles in contemporary society and as such the abortion issues represent the battleground for the justification of their respective views.

Question 324

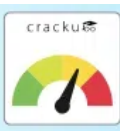
Historically, the pro-choice movements has got support from, among others,

- A major patriarchal religions.
- B countries with low population density.
- C medical profession.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 325

Two health tragedies affecting the US society in the 1960s led to

- A a change in attitude to women's right to privacy.
- B retaining the anti-abortion laws with some exceptions.
- C scrapping of anti-abortion laws.
- D strengthening of the pro-life lobby.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 326

Pro-choice women object to the notion of the home being the 'women's sphere' because they believe

- A that home is a 'joint sphere' shared between men and women.
- B that reproduction is a matter of choice for women

- C that men and women are equal
- D Both (2) and (3)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 327

According to your understanding of the author's arguments, which countries are more likely to allow abortion?

- A Over populated countries like India and China
- B Underpopulated countries like Australia and Mongolia
- C Cannot be inferred from the passage
- D Both (1) and (2)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 328

A pro-life woman would advocate abortion if

- A the mother of an unborn child is suicidal.
- B bearing a child conflicts with a woman's career prospects.
- C the mother becomes pregnant accidentally.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 329

Which amongst these was not a reason for banning of abortions by 1900?

- A Medical professionals stressing the health and safety of women
- B Influx of eastern and southern European immigrants
- C Control of unlicensed medical practitioners
- D A tradition of matriarchal control

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The narrator of *Midnight's Children* describes it as a kind of collective fantasy. I suppose what he, or I, through him was trying to say, was that there never had been a political entity called India until 1947. The thing that became independent had never previously existed, except that there had been an area, a zone called India. So it

struck me that what was coming into being, this idea of a nation-state, was an invention. It was an invention of the nationalist movement. And a very successful invention.

One could argue that nation-states are a kind of collective fantasies. Very similar things happened with the unification of Italy, and also with the unification of Germany. The history of India is a history of independent nation-states. It is a history of Oudh or Bengal or Maratha kingdoms. All those independent histories agreed to collectivise themselves into the idea of the nation of India. In the case of Pakistan, it was less successful. Pakistan was under-imagined. It did not survive as a nation-state.

If you ask people in general, they would have absolutely no problem with the idea of India at all. I think, in a way the strength of the nationalist idea is shown by its ability to survive the extraordinary stresses that it was placed under. I think the stresses of things — communalism, the high degree of public corruption, of regional rivalries, of the tension between the centre and the state, the external pressures of bad relations with Pakistan — these are colossal pressures which any state could be forgiven for being damaged by. I think the thing to say about the success of the idea is that it remains an idea though people might not find it very easy to give a simple definition of it. But that it does exist and that it is something to which people feel they belong, I think is now the case. That it survives these stresses is an indication of its strength.

I'm not interested in an idealised, romantic vision of India, I know it is the great pitfall of the exile. So you know for me, always, the issue of writing about India has been not to write as an outsider. On the other hand, evidently something has changed in the last 10 years, which is that as a result of various circumstances, I've not been able to return. All I can say is that I have felt it as the most profound loss and I still do. There have been many losses in the last decade but the loss of the easy return to India has been for me an absolute anguish, an inescapable anguish. I feel as if I've lost a limb. I am very anxious to bring that period to an end.

I do not think that one of the most interesting phenomena for India as a country is the phenomenon of the Indian Diaspora. I often think Indian — Indian Indians — find that very hard to understand. In England, when people call themselves British Indian, they mean both halves of that. And yet, what it means to be a British Indian is very alien to an Indian Indian. The same is true in the Caribbean, in Africa, in Canada, in the United States, and so on. The thing that has interested me is that there are now many, many ways of being something which you can legitimately call Indian. Being an Indian in India is just one of those ways.

The forces of disintegration are always there. I think in every society there is the tension between the forces that bring it together and the forces that pull it apart. I'm worried, above all, of the communal issue because half a century is no time at all in the eye of history, and half a century ago something of colossally horrible proportion took place. The fact that it hasn't happened for 50 years on quite the same scale means nothing. It could still happen tomorrow. One of the things that I remember very vividly, being there 10 years ago at about the time of the killings that took place in Assam, is discussing this with good friends and fellow writers. And I remember somebody said to me, until we understand that we are capable of these things, we can't begin to move beyond them. Because it's a very easy response to atrocities, to say: oh those terrible people did that, and we are not like that. I think the difficult response is to accept we are also capable of that, the thing that happened there could also, in certain circumstances, be something that we were able to perpetrate. The civilising influence is what prevents most of us from giving vent to those terrible urges. Those urges are part of humanity as well as the more civilized urges.

Of course, I fear in India the recurrence of communal or regionalist inter-community violence. I fear the long-term damage to a democracy that can be done by mass corruption. I think corruption is in a way a subversion of democracy and the commonplace view in India is that corruption is everywhere. In a sense, you could say that is not a democratic society. If money, favour and privilege is what makes the place work, then that's not a democracy. At least it runs the danger of being no longer able to call itself a democracy.

What was happening, I thought, was that people were trying to seize control of that rhetoric. That is to say, special interest groups. You could say Hindus are a very large special interest group. If any group inside such a complex and many faceted country tries to define the nation exclusively in its own terms, then it begins to create terrible stresses. I do think that the kind of attempt to define India in Hindu terms is worrying for that reason. It creates backlashes, it creates polarisation, and it creates the risk of more upheaval. Partly, I am saying this as a kind of objective observer, but nobody is an objective observer.

I come from an Indian minority, I no doubt have a minority perspective. I can't ignore that and nor would I wish to. Partly, also I am speaking temperamentally. That is to say, the kind of religious language in politics is something I find temperamentally unpleasant. I don't like people who do that, whether they be sectarians in Northern Ireland or India. I believe in, if possible, separating one's personal spiritual needs and aspirations from the way in which a country is run. I think in those countries where that separation has not taken place, one can see all kinds of distortions of social and ordinary life which are unpleasant. Iran is an obvious example. The country in which that kind of separation has completely fragmented it.

Where Naipaul is right, although I don't share his conclusions about it, but I think where he is right, is in saying that this is a great historical moment. One reason why the 50th anniversary is interesting is that it does seem to represent the end of the first age and the beginning of second age. And to that extent that is true now, if someone was born today, they would be born into a very different set of cultural assumptions and hopes than somebody born 50 years ago. We were entirely sold on the Nehru-Gandhi kind of plan. We grew up and that was the portrait of the nation we had hung on our wall, and to the extent that you never entirely lose those formative ideas, that's still the picture of the country I've got on my wall. But it's clear that for somebody being born now, they are being born into a very different country.

I also think of taking the Naipaul point on what would happen if the BJP were to form a government. Well, what I would like to think is that in order for the BJP or anybody of that persuasion to form a government, they would have to change. There is even some kind of suggestion that it may even be happening a little bit because they are intelligent people. They understand their weaknesses as well as their strengths. Clearly, for a Hinduist party to form the government of the country is not at all unlikely. So I think one does have to engage with that in the same way as many people in the country who, like myself, were not remotely in tune with the Thatcherite revolution but have to engage with it because it was in fact happening, and kept winning elections, and the world was not going to go back. So, of course, both people inside the Hindu political enterprise and people outside it will have to shift. I am optimistic about India's ability to force those changes that are necessary because I do believe it is not fundamentally an intolerant country and will not fundamentally accept intolerant politics.

On the other hand, there has to be reckoning with the fact that these are ideas, which are gaining in popularity. I'll tell you where I would draw the line myself. I think there was a great historical mistake made in Europe about the Nazi Party. People attempted to see whether they could live with it and discovered very rapidly that was a mistake, that appeasement was a great historical mistake. So, it seems to me, the question is: What do we make of this political enterprise? Is it fundamentally democratic or fundamentally anti-democratic? If democratic, then we must all learn to make the best of it. If anti-democratic, then we must fight it very hard.

What happened in India happened before the book (Satanic Verses) had actually entered. It happened because of an article in India Today, which, I must say, I thought was an irresponsibly written article, because it was written by somebody, who, as a friend, asked me for an early copy of the book, and then presented that book in the most inflammatory sort of way.

This was one of the things that disappointed me, that after a lifetime of having written from a certain sensibility, and a certain point of view, I would have expected people in India to know about it since it was all entirely about India. It was written from a deep sense of connection and affection for India. I would have expected that I had some money in the bank. That is to say, if Salman Rushdie wrote any book, then we know who he is. He is not some idiot who just arrived from nowhere shouting abuse. This is somebody whose work, whose opinions, whose lectures and whose stories we know. I would have hoped that my work would have been judged in the context of what people already knew about me. Instead, it seemed as if everything I had been in my life up to that point suddenly vanished out of the window and this other Rushdie was invented who was this complete bastard who had done this terrible thing. There did not seem to be any attempt to correct that or to combat that. I was surprised and disappointed it did not. It didn't happen here either. It didn't happen anywhere in the world. It was as if the force of history, the force of a historical event was so huge that it erases all that goes before it.

The negative response to the Satanic Verses, let us remember that there was also a positive response, was such that it erased my personality and put in its place some other guy who they didn't recognize at all. Anybody who knows anything about these countries, and I do know something about these countries, knows that every cheap politician can put a demonstration in the street in five minutes. That doesn't represent in any sense the

people's will. It represents a certain kind of political structure, political organization. It doesn't represent truth. But I always believed and I still believe that India would come back. I never believe that the loss of India is forever. Because India is not Iran, it's not even Pakistan, and I thought good sense will prevail in India because that's my life experience of Indian people and of the place.

Question 330

The idea of India that inspired the writer's generation was the one dominated or formed by

- A the Nehru-Gandhi politics.
- B the Nehru-Gandhi ideology.
- C the Nehru-Gandhi idea regarding India's formative years.
- D the Nehruvian idea of socialism.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 331

The writer contradicts his assertion of being an 'objective observer' on the basis that

- A no one can be an 'objective observer'.
- B no one is an 'objective observer'.
- C he is a subjective observer.
- D everybody is a subjective observer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 332

What according to the passage prevents us from giving in to violent, terrible urges?

- A Our education
- B Our upbringing
- C Our cultural influences
- D The civilising influence

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 333

According to the passage, the secret of India's survival lies in

- A its ability to fight back in the face of tremendous stress and strains.
- B the highly fertile imagination of the Indian people.
- C a sense of belonging that people feel for it.

D Both a and c

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 334

According to the writer's friend,

- A we should fight against communal pressure.
- B the fact that communal conflagrations haven't occurred in India for half a century, is something to be proud of.
- C we can move beyond things, only after we know we are capable of those things.
- D we have to identify with the people who were involved in inciting communal passions.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 335

According to the writer,

- A politicians incite the general public to demonstrate against writers.
- B a politician's demonstration does not reflect the people's will.
- C Both a and b
- D Neither a nor b

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 336

The writer does not share

- A Naipaul's stand that the 50th anniversary is a historical moment.
- B Naipaul's stand that the 50th anniversary is not a historical moment.
- C Naipaul's conclusion on the 50th anniversary being a historical moment.
- D Naipaul's conclusion on the 50th anniversary not being a historical moment.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 337

The writer shows faith in India's basic

- A stability.
- B resilience.
- C fortitude.
- D democracy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 338

In the first paragraph of the passage, the writer questions

- A the existence of a political entity called India prior to independence.
- B the contention that a political entity called India did not exist.
- C the stand that India was an invention.
- D the stand that India needs to think in terms of its being a nation-state.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 339

According to the writer, what disqualifies India from being called a democracy?

- A Its communalism
- B Its corruption
- C Its anti-minority stance
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 340

The writer's view of India is determined mainly by

- A his experience.
- B his fondness for the country.
- C his love for the resilience of the Indian people.
- D his love of writing about India.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 341

According to the writer, the difference between India and Pakistan was that

- A India and Pakistan both did not survive as a nation-state.
- B Indians were full of fantastic ideas in 1947.
- C Pakistan was born out of another nation.
- D the creation of Pakistan suffered from under-imaginativeness.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The story begins as the European pioneers crossed the Alleghenies and started to settle in the Midwest. The land they found was covered with forests. With incredible efforts they felled the trees, pulled the stumps and planted their crops in the rich, loamy soil. When they finally reached the western edge of the place we now call Indiana, the forest stopped and ahead lay a thousand miles of the great grass prairie. The Europeans were puzzled by this new environment. Some even called it the "Great Desert". It seemed untillable. The earth was often very wet and it was covered with centuries of tangled and matted grasses. With their cast iron plows, the settlers found that the prairie sod could not be cut and the wet earth stuck to their plowshares. Even a team of the best oxen bogged down after a few years of tugging. The iron plow was a useless tool to farm the prairie soil. The pioneers were stymied for nearly two decades. Their western march was hefted and they filled in the eastern regions of the Midwest.

In 1837, a blacksmith in the town of Grand Detour, Illinois, invented a new tool. His name was John Deere and the tool was a plow made of steel. It was sharp enough to cut through matted grasses and smooth enough to cast off the mud. It was a simple too, the "sod buster" that opened the great prairies to agricultural development.

Sauk Country, Wisconsin is the part of that prairie where I have a home. It is named after the Sauk Indians. In 1673 Father Marquette was the first European to lay his eyes upon their land. He found a village laid out in regular patterns on a plain beside the Wisconsin River. He called the place Prairie du Sac) The village was surrounded by fields that had provided maize, beans and squash for the Sauk people for generations reaching back into the unrecorded time.

When the European settlers arrived at the Sauk prairie in 1837, the government forced the native Sank people west of the Mississippi River. The settlers came with John Deere's new invention and used the tool to open the area to a new kind of agriculture. They ignored the traditional ways of the Sank Indians and used their sod-busting tool for planting wheat. Initially, the soil was generous and the nurturing thrived. However each year the soil lost more of its nurturing power. It was only thirty years after the Europeans arrived with their new technology that the land was depleted, Wheat farming became uneconomic and tens of thousands of farmers left Wisconsin seeking new land with sod to bust.

It took the Europeans and their new technology just one generation to make their homeland into a desert. The Sank Indians who knew how to sustain themselves on the Sauk prairie land were banished to another kind of desert called a reservation. And they even forgot about the techniques and tools that had sustained them on the prairie for generations unrecorded. And that is how it was that three deserts were created – Wisconsin, the reservation and the memories of a people. A century later, the land of the Sauks is now populated by the children of a second wave of European tanners who learned to replenish the soil through the regenerative powers of dairying, ground cover crops and animal manures. These third and fourth generation farmers and townspeople do not realise, however, that a new settler is coming soon with an invention as powerful as John Deere's plow.

The new technology is called 'bereavement counselling'. It is a tool forged at the great state university, an innovative technique to meet the needs of those experiencing the death of a loved one, tool that an "process" the grief of the people who now live on the Prairie of the Sauk. As one can imagine the final days of the village of the Sauk Indians before the arrival of the settlers with John Deere's plow, one can also imagine these final days before the arrival of the first bereavement counsellor at Prairie du Sac) In these final days, the farmers arid

the townspeople mourn at the death of a mother, brother, son or friend. The bereaved is joined by neighbours and kin. They meet grief together in lamentation, prayer and song. They call upon the words of the clergy and surround themselves in community.

It is in these ways that they grieve and then go on with life. Through their mourning they are assured of the bonds between them and renewed in the knowledge that this death is a part of the Prairie of the Sauk. Their grief is common property, an anguish from which the community draws strength and gives the bereaved the courage to move ahead.

It is into this prairie community that the bereavement counsellor arrives with the new grief technology. The counsellor calls the invention a service and assures the prairie folk of its effectiveness and superiority by invoking the name of the great university while displaying a diploma and certificate. At first, we can imagine that the local people will be puzzled by the bereavement counsellor's claim. However, the counsellor will tell a few of them that the new technique is merely to assist the bereaved's community at the time of death. To some other prairie folk who are isolated or forgotten, the counsellor will approach the Country Board and advocate the right to treatment for these unfortunate souls. This right will be guaranteed by the Board's decision to reimburse those too poor to pay for counselling services. There will be others, schooled to believe in the innovative new tools certified by universities and medical centres, who will seek out the bereavement counsellor by force of habit. And one of these people will tell a bereaved neighbour who is unschooled that unless his grief is processed by a counsellor, he will probably have major psychological problems in later life. Several people will begin to use the bereavement counsellor because, since the Country Board now taxes them to insure access to the technology, they will feel that to fail to be counselled is to waste their money, and to be denied a benefit, or even a right.

Finally, one day, the aged father of a Sauk woman will die. And the next door neighbour will not drop by because he doesn't want to interrupt the bereavement counsellor. The woman's kin will stay home because they will have learned that only the bereavement counsellor knows how to process grief the proper way. The local clergy will seek technical assistance from the bereavement counsellor to learn the correct form of service to deal with guilt and grief. And the grieving daughter will know that it is the bereavement counsellor who really cares for her because only the bereavement counsellor comes when death visits this family on the Prairie of the Sauk.

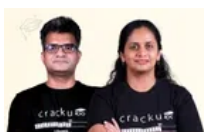
It will be only one generation between the bereavement counsellor arrives and the community of mourners disappears. The counsellor's new tool will cut through the social fabric, throwing aside kinship, care, neighbourly obligations and communality ways of coming together and going on. Like John Deere's plow, the tools of bereavement counselling will create a desert where a community once flourished. And finally, even the bereavement counsellor will see the impossibility of restoring hope in clients once they are genuinely alone with nothing but a service for consolation. In the inevitable failure of the service, the bereavement counsellor will find the deserts even in herself.

Question 342

Which of the following parallels between the plow and bereavement counselling is not claimed by the author?

- A Both are innovative technologies.
- B Both result in migration of the communities into which the innovations are introduced.
- C Both lead to 'deserts' in the space of only one generation
- D Both are tools introduced by outsiders entering existing communities.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Daily Articles



Question 343

According to the author, people will begin to utilise the service of the bereavement counsellor because:

- A new Country regulations will make them feel it is a right, and if they don't use it, it would be a loss.
- B the bereaved in the community would find her a helpful friend.
- C she will fight for subsistence allowance from the Country Board for the poor among the bereaved.
- D grief processing needs tools certified by universities and medical centres.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 344

According to the author, the bereavement counsellor is:

- A a friend of the bereaved helping him or her handle grief.
- B an advocate of the right to treatment for the community.
- C a kin of the bereaved helping him/her handle grief.
- D a formally trained person helping the bereaved handle grief.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 345

Due to which of the following reasons, according to the author, will the bereavement counsellor find the deserts even in herself?

- A Over a period of time, working with Sauk Indians who have lost their kinship and relationships, she becomes one of them,
- B She is working in an environment where the disappearance of community mourners makes her work place a social desert.
- C her efforts at grief processing with the bereaved will fail as no amount of professional service can make up for the loss due to the disappearance of community mourners.
- D She has been working with people who have settled for a long time in the Great Desert

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 346

Which one of the following best describes the approach of the author?

- A Comparing experiences with two innovations tried, in order to illustrate the failure of both.
- B Presenting community perspectives on two technologies which have had negative effects on people.
- C Using the negative outcomes of one innovation to illustrate the likely outcomes of another innovation.
- D Contrasting two contexts separated in time, to illustrate how 'deserts' have arisen.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 347

According to the passage, bereavement handling traditionally involves:

- A the community bereavement counsellors working with the bereaved to help him/her overcome grief.
- B the neighbours and kin joining the bereaved and meeting grief together in mourning and prayer.
- C using techniques developed systematically in formal institutions of learning, a trained counsellor helping the bereaved cope with grief.
- D the Sauk Indian Chief leading the community with rituals and rites to help lessen the grief of the bereaved.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 348

The Prairie. was a great puzzlement for the European pioneers because:

- A it was covered with thick, untellable layers of grass over a vast stretch.
- B it was a large desert immediately next to lush forests.
- C it was rich cultivable land left fallow for centuries.
- D it could be easily tilled with iron plows.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

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Question 349

Which of the following does the 'desert' in the passage refer to?

- A Prairie soil depleted by cultivation of wheat.
- B Reservations in which native Indians were resettled.
- C Absence of, and emptiness in, community kinship and relationships.
- D All of the above.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

One of the criteria by which we judge the vitality of a style of painting is its ability to renew itself- its responsiveness to the changing nature and quality of experience, the degree of conceptual and formal innovation that it exhibits. By this criterion, it would appear that the practice of abstractionism has failed to engage creatively with the radical change in human experience in recent decades. it has, seemingly, been unwilling to re-invent itself in relation to the systems of artistic expression and viewers' expectations that have developed under the impact of the mass media.

The judgement that abstractionism has slipped into 'inertia gear' is gaining endorsement, not only among discerning viewers and practitioners of other art forms, but also among abstract painters themselves. Like their companions elsewhere in the world, abstraction lists in India are asking themselves an overwhelming question today: Does abstractionism have a future? The major crisis that abstractionists face is that of revitalising their picture surface; few have improvised any solutions beyond the ones that were exhausted by the 1970s. Like all revolutions, whether in politics or in art, abstractionism must now confront its moment of truth: having begun life as a new and radical pictorial approach to experience, it has become an entrenched orthodoxy itself. Indeed, when viewed against a historical situation in which a variety of subversive, interactive and richly hybrid forms are available to the art practitioner, abstractionism assumes the remote and defiant air of an aristocracy that has outlived its age; trammelled by formulaic conventions yet buttressed by a rhetoric of sacred mystery, it seems condemned to being the last citadel of the self-regarding 'fine art' tradition, the last hurrah of painting for painting's sake.

The situation is further complicated in India by the circumstances in which an indigenous abstractionism came into prominence here during the 1960s. From the beginning it was propelled by the dialectic between two motives, one revolutionary and the other conservative-it was inaugurated as an act of emancipation from the dogmas of the nascent Indian nation state, when art was officially viewed as an indulgence at worst, and at best, as an instrument for the celebration of the republic's hopes and aspirations. Having rejected these dogmas, the pioneering abstractionists also went on to reject the various figurative styles associated with the Santiniketan circle and others. In such a situation, abstractionism was a revolutionary move. It led art towards the exploration of the subconscious mind, the spiritual quest and the possible expansion of consciousness. Indian painting entered into a phase of self-inquiry, a meditative inner space where cosmic symbols and non-representational images ruled. Often, the transition from figurative idioms to abstractionist ones took place within the same artist.

At the same time, Indian abstractionists have rarely committed themselves wholeheartedly to a nonrepresentational idiom. They have been preoccupied with the fundamentally metaphysical project of aspiring to the mystical-holy without altogether renouncing the symbolic. This has been sustained by a hereditary reluctance to give up the murti, the inviolable iconic form, which explains why abstractionism is marked by the conservative tendency to operate with images from the sacred repertoire of the past. Abstractionism thus entered India as a double-edged device in a complex cultural transaction. Ideologically, it served as an internationalist legitimisation of the emerging revolutionary local trends. However, on entry, it was conscripted to serve local artistic preoccupations. A survey of indigenous abstractionism will show that its most obvious points of affinity with European and American abstract art were with the more mystically oriented of the major sources of abstractionist philosophy and practice, for instance the Kandinsky-Klee school. There have been no takers for Malevich's Suprematism, which militantly rejected both the artistic forms of the past and the world of appearances, privileging the new-minted geometric symbol as an autonomous sign of the desire for infinity.

Against this backdrop, we can identify three major abstractionist idioms in Indian art. The first develops from a love of the earth, and assumes the form of a celebration of the self's dissolution in the cosmic panorama; the landscape is no longer a realistic transcription of the scene, but is transformed into a visionary occasion for contemplating the cycles of decay and regeneration. The second idiom phrases its departures from symbolic and archetypal devices as invitations to heightened planes of awareness. Abstractionism begins with the establishment or dissolution of the motif, which can be drawn from diverse sources, including the hieroglyphic tablet, the Sufi meditation dance or the Tantric diagram. The third idiom is based on the lyric play of forms guided by gesture or allied with formal improvisations like the assemblage. Here, sometimes, the line dividing abstract image from patterned design or quasi-random expressive marking may blur. The flux of forms can also be regimented through the poetics of pure colour arrangements, vector-diagrammatic spaces anti gestural design.

In this genealogy, some pure lines of descent follow their logic to the inevitable point of extinction, others engage in cross-fertilisation and yet others undergo mutation to maintain their energy. However, this genealogical survey demonstrates the wave at its crests, those points

where the metaphysical and the painterly have been fused in images of abiding potency, ideas sensuously ordained rather than fabricated programmatically to a concept. It is equally possible to enumerate the troughs where the two principles do not come together, thus arriving at a very different account. Uncharitable as it may sound, the history of Indian abstractionism records a series of attempts to avoid the risks of abstraction by resorting to an overt and near-generic symbolism which many Indian abstractionists embrace when they find themselves bereft of the imaginative energy to negotiate the union of metaphysics and painterliness.

Such symbolism falls into a dual trap: it succumbs to the pompous vacuity of pure metaphysics when the burden of intention is passed off as justification; or then it is desiccated by the arid formalism of pure painterliness, with delight in the measure of chance or pattern guiding the execution of a painting. The ensuing conflict of purpose stalls the progress of abstractionism in an impasse. The remarkable Indian abstractionists are precisely those who have overcome this and addressed themselves to the basic elements of their art with a decisive sense of independence from prior models. In their recent work, we see the logic of Indian abstractionism pushed almost to the furthest it can be taken. Beyond such artists stands a lost generation of abstractionists whose work invokes a wistful, delicate beauty but stops there. Abstractionism is not a universal language; it is an art that points up the loss of a shared language of signs in society. And yet, it affirms the possibility of its recovery through the effort of awareness. While its rhetoric has always emphasised a call for new forms of attention, abstractionist practice has tended to fall into a complacent pride in its own incomprehensibility; a complacency fatal in an ethos where vibrant new idioms compete for the viewers' attention. Indian abstractionists ought to really return to basics, to reformulate and replenish their understanding of the nature of the relationship between the painted image and the world around it. But will they abandon their favourite conceptual habits and formal conventions, if this becomes necessary?

Question 350

Which one of the following is not part of the author's characterisation of the conservative trend in India abstractionism?

- A An exploration of the subconscious mind.
- B A lack of full commitment to non-representational symbols.
- C An adherence to the symbolic while aspiring to the mystical.
- D Usage of the images of gods or similar symbols.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 351

According to the author, the introduction of abstractionism was revolutionary because it:

- A celebrated the hopes and aspirations of a newly independent nation.
- B provided a new direction to Indian art, towards self-inquiry and non-representational images.
- C managed to obtain internationalist support for the abstractionist agenda)
- D was an emancipation from the dogmas of the nascent nation state.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

 **100+ CAT VARC Questions**



Question 352

Which one of the following, according to the author, is the most important reason for the stalling of abstractionism's progress in an impasse?

- A Some artists have followed their abstractionist logic to the point of extinction.
- B Some artists have allowed chance or pattern to dominate the execution of their paintings.
- C Many artists have avoided the trap of a near-generic and an open symbolism.
- D Many artists have found it difficult to fuse the twin principles of the metaphysical and the painterly.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 353

Given the author's delineation of the three abstractionist idioms in Indian art, the third idiom can be best distinguished from the other two idioms through its:

- A depiction of nature's cyclical renewal.
- B use of non-representational images.
- C emphasis on arrangement of forms.
- D limited reliance on original models.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 354

According to the author, which one of the following characterises the crisis faced by abstractionism?

- A Abstractionists appear to be unable to transcend the solutions tried out earlier.
- B Abstractionism has allowed itself to be confined by set forms and practices.
- C Abstractionists have been unable to use the multiplicity of forms now becoming available to an artist.
- D All of the above.

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CAT Expected Questions PDF



Question 355

Which one of the following, according to the author, is the role that abstractionism plays in a society?

- A It provides an idiom that can be understood by most members in a society.
- B It highlights the absence of a shared language of meaningful symbols which can be recreated through greater awareness.
- C It highlights the contradictory artistic trends of revolution and conservatism that any society needs to move forward.

- D It helps abstractionist invoke the wistful, delicate beauty that may exist in society.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 356

According to the author, the attraction of the Kandinsky-Klee school for Indian abstractionist can be explained by which one of the following?

- A The conservative tendency to aspire to the mystical without a complete renunciation of the symbolic)
- B The discomfort of Indian abstractionists with Malevich's Suprematism.
- C The easy identification of obvious points of affinity with European and American abstract art, of which the Kandinsky-Klee school is an example.
- D The double-edged nature of abstractionism which enabled identification with mystically-oriented schools.

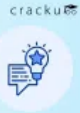
[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 357

Which one of the following is not stated by the author as a reason for abstractionism losing its vitality?

- A Abstractionism has failed to reorient itself in the context of changing human experience.
- B Abstractionism has not considered the developments in artistic expression that have taken place in recent times.
- C Abstractionism has not followed the path taken by all revolutions, whether in politics or art.
- D The impact of mass media on viewers' expectations has not been assessed, and responded to, by abstractionism.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

**CAT Important Topics**

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question

Studies showing that income inequality plays a positive role in economic growth are largely based on three arguments. The first argument focuses on investment indivisibilities wherein large sunk costs are required when implementing new fundamental innovations. Without stock markets and financial institutions to mobilize large sums of money, a high concentration of wealth is needed for individuals to undertake new industrial activities accompanied by high sunk costs . . . [One study] shows the relation between economic growth and income inequality for 45 countries during 1966-1995. [It was found] that the increase in income inequality has a significant positive relationship with economic growth in the short and medium term. Using system GMM, [another study estimated] the relation between income inequality and economic growth for 106 countries during 1965- 2005 period. The results show that income inequality has a positive impact on economic growth in the short run, but the two are negatively correlated in the long run. The second argument is related to moral hazard and incentives . . . Because economic performance is determined by the unobservable level of effort that agents make, paying compensations without taking into account the economic performance achieved by

individual agents will fail to elicit optimum effort from the agents. Thus, certain income inequalities contribute to growth by enhancing worker motivation . . . and by giving motivation to innovators and entrepreneurs . . . Finally, [another study] point[s] out that the concentration of wealth or stock ownership in relation to corporate governance contributes to growth. If stock ownership is distributed and owned by a large number of shareholders, it is not easy to make quick decisions due to the conflicting interests among shareholders, and this may also cause a free-rider problem in terms of monitoring and supervising managers and workers. . . .

Various studies have examined the relationships between income inequality and economic growth, and most of these assert that a negative correlation exists between the two. . . . Analyzing 159 countries for 1980-2012, they conclude that there exists a negative relation between income inequality and economic growth; when the income share of the richest 20% of population increases by 1%, the GDP decreases by 0.08%, whereas when the income share of the poorest 20% of population increases by 1%, the GDP increases by 0.38%. Some studies find that inequality has a negative impact on growth due to poor human capital accumulation and low fertility rates . . . while [others] point out that inequality creates political instability, resulting in lower investment. . . . [Some economists] argue that widening income inequality has a negative impact on economic growth because it negatively affects social consensus or social capital formation. One important research topic is the correlation between democratization and income redistribution. [Some scholars] explain that social pressure for income redistribution rises as income inequality increases in a democratic society. In other words, when democratization extends suffrage to a wider class of people, the increased political power of low- and middle-income voters results in broader support for income redistribution and social welfare expansion. However . . . if the rich have more political influence than the poor, the democratic system actually worsens income inequality rather than improving it.

Question 358

The primary function of the three-part case for a positive income inequality-economic growth link in the first half of the passage is to show that:

- A inequality boosts growth in every period and type of economy, regardless of finance or governance conditions.
- B mature stock markets make wealth concentration unnecessary, yet they might still be harmful to investment.
- C inequality can aid short-term growth in settings with high sunk costs, incentive alignment, and concentrated ownership.
- D dispersed ownership speeds corporate decision-making and removes free rider problems.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 359

Which one of the options below best summarises the passage?

- A The passage claims that evaluating the effect of income inequality on economic growth without considering both short- and long-term consequences is misguided
- B The passage confines its discussion to financing gaps and corporate control while undercutting cross country evidence and overlooking the significance of concerns regarding human capital accumulation, fertility rates, and income redistribution under democratisation.
- C The passage argues that income inequality accelerates economic growth while also emphasising the significance of concerns regarding human capital accumulation, fertility rates, and political instability.
- D The passage outlines investment, incentive, and governance channels through which income inequality may support economic growth and reports short-term gains while noting longterm drawbacks

Question 360

The passage refers to "democratization". Choose the one option below that comes closest to the opposite of this process.

- A After the emergency decree, the regime shifted toward authoritarianism as suffrage narrowed and opposition parties were deregistered.
- B Corporate donations were capped and parties received public funding which was portrayed as establishing an oligarchy.
- C Municipalities adopted participatory budgeting and recall elections which a press release called totalitarianism.
- D The coalition imposed term limits and strengthened judicial review in order to further entrench autocratic rule.

**Question 361**

According to the incentive or moral hazard argument, which one of the designs below is most consistent with the claim that some inequality can raise growth?

- A Pay rewards on verifiable performance for highly productive workers.
- B Rents protected by market power that enlarge top incomes without linking pay to results
- C Wages are determined by tenure rather than output to ensure equity.
- D A regime that concentrates stock ownership in relation to corporate governance.

Instructions

A difficult readjustment in the scientist's conception of duty is imperatively necessary. As Lord Adrain said in his address to the British Association, unless we are ready to give up some of our old loyalties, we may be forced into a fight which might end the human race. This matter of loyalty is the crux. Hitherto, in the East and in the West alike, most scientists, like most other people, have felt that loyalty to their own state is paramount. They have no longer a right to feel this. Loyalty to the human race must take its place. Everyone in the West will at once admit this as regards Soviet scientists. We are shocked that Kapitza who was Rutherford's favourite pupil, was willing when the Soviet government refused him permission to return to Cambridge, to place his scientific skill at the disposal of those who wished to spread communism by means of H-bombs. We do not so readily apprehend a similar failure of duty on our own side. I do not wish to be thought to suggest treachery, since that is only a transference of loyalty to another national state. I am suggesting a very different thing; that scientists the world over should join in enlightening mankind as to the perils of a great war and in devising methods for its prevention. I urge with all the emphasis at my disposal that this is the duty of scientists in East and West alike. It is a difficult duty, and one likely to entail penalties for those who perform it. But, after all, it is the labours of scientists which have caused the danger and on this account, if on no other, scientists must do everything in their power to save mankind from the madness which they have made possible. Science from the dawn of

History, and probably longer, has been intimately associated with war. I imagine that when our ancestors descended from the trees they were victorious over the arboreal conservatives because flints were sharper than coconuts. To come to more recent times, Archimedes was respected for his scientific defense of Syracuse against the Romans; Leonardo obtained employment under the Duke of Milan because of his skill in fortification, though he did mention in a postscript that he could also paint a bit. Galileo similarly derived an income from the Grand Duke of Tuscany because of his skill in calculating the trajectories of projectiles. In the French Revolution, those scientists who were not guillotined devoted themselves to making new explosives. There is therefore no departure from tradition in the present day scientists manufacture of A-bombs and H-bomb. All that is new is the extent of their destructive skill.

I do not think that men of science can cease to regard the disinterested pursuit of knowledge as their primary duty. It is true that new knowledge and new skills are sometimes harmful in their effects, but scientists cannot profitably take account of this fact since the effects are impossible to foresee. We cannot blame Columbus because the discovery of the Western Hemisphere spread throughout the Eastern Hemisphere an appallingly devastating plague. Nor can we blame James Watt for the Dust Bowl although if there had been no steam engines and no railways the West would not have been so carelessly or so quickly cultivated. To see that knowledge is wisely used is primarily the duty of statesmen, not of science; but it is part of the duty of men of science to see that important knowledge is widely disseminated and is not falsified in the interests of this or that propaganda.

Scientific knowledge has its dangers; but so has every great thing. And over and beyond the dangers with which it threatens the present, it opens up, as nothing else can, the vision of a possible happy world, a world without poverty, without war, with little illness. And what is perhaps more than all, when science has mastered the forces which mould human character, it will be able to produce populations in which few suffer from destructive fierceness and in which the great majority regard other people, not as competitors, to be feared, but as helpers in a common task. Science has only recently begun to apply itself to human beings except in their purely physical aspect. Such science as exists in psychology and anthropology has hardly begun to affect political behaviour or private ethics. The minds of men remain attuned to a world that is fast disappearing. The changes in our physical environment require, if they are to bring well being, correlative changes in our beliefs and habits. If we cannot effect these changes, we shall suffer the fate of the dinosaurs, who could not live on dry land.

I think it is the duty of science. I do not say of every individual man of science, to study the means by which we can adapt ourselves to the new world. There are certain things that the world quite obviously needs; tentativeness, as opposed to dogmatism in our beliefs: an expectation of co-operation, rather than competition, in social relations, a lessening of envy and collective hatred. These are things which education could produce without much difficulty. They are not things adequately sought in the education of the present day.

It is progress in the human sciences that we must look to undo the evils which have resulted from a knowledge of the physical world hastily and superficially acquired by populations unconscious of the changes in themselves that the new knowledge has made imperative. The road to a happier world than any known in the past lies open before us if atavistic destructive passion can be kept in leash while the necessary adaptations are made. Fears are inevitable in our time, but hopes are equally rational and far more likely to bear good fruit. We must learn to think rather less of the dangers to be avoided than of the good that will be within our grasp if we believe in it and let it dominate our thoughts. Science, whatever unpleasant consequences it may have by the way, is in its very nature a liberator, a liberator of bondage to physical nature and, in time to come a liberator from the weight of destructive passion. We are on the threshold of utter disaster or unprecedented glorious achievement. No previous age has been fraught with problems so momentous and it is to science that we must look for happy issue.

Question 362

In modern times, the crux of the matter as far as scientists are concerned is that

- A** their loyalty to the state should be declared in no uncertain terms.
- B** a readjustment in the scientist's conception of duty is imperatively necessary.
- C** they should not object to stringent control by the state over their activities.

- D they should assert their independence and refuse to subject themselves to any kind of control.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 363

The duty of science, according to the author is :-

- A to realize the vision of a happy new world
- B to pursue knowledge for its own sake
- C to see that only such discoveries as conducive to the progress of humanity should be made
- D to study the means by which we can adapt ourselves to the new world

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

A banner for 'CAT Mock Test' featuring two students on the left, the text 'CAT Mock Test' in large blue letters in the center, and a yellow box below it saying 'Mocks designed exactly like the actual CAT'. On the right, there is a small illustration of a desk with a clock and books, with the word 'cracku' above it.

Question 364

The instance of Kapitza cited by the author goes to prove that

- A every scientist has his price.
- B in Soviet Russia, communists do not tolerate independent scientists.
- C scientists, whether in the East or West, have hitherto felt that loyalty to their own state is paramount.
- D scientists in the West have a higher sense of responsibility than their counterparts in the East.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 365

The ground on which the author suggests that all scientists should join in educating mankind regarding the perils of a great war is that

- A scientists being among the most learned among people, should take the lead in this process of education.
- B it is the work of scientists which has led to this perilous situation and so they should do something to undo the mischief.
- C science has always been associated with war and in the fitness of things, scientists should take the lead in trying to end it.
- D all others like politicians and soldiers have vested interest in perpetuating war and by elimination, scientists alone may be trusted to work for its abolition.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 366

Which among the following statements is not true according to the information provided in the passage?

- A If there is no readjustment in the scientists conception of duty, the extinction of the human race by war is a distinct possibility.
- B Up till now, scientists all over the world have felt that loyalty to their own state is paramount
- C It is the labours of scientists which have caused the danger of annihilation of mankind.
- D The tradition up to now has been that scientists have been respected for their pursuit of knowledge and not for their part in devising potent weapons of destruction

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 367

Science may be considered a liberator in the sense that :-

- A ultimately it may bring the nations of the world together
- B it may make man.s life a great deal happier than what it is now
- C it may free man from bondage to physical nature and the weight of destructive passions
- D it may end the tyranny of age old beliefs and superstitions.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 368

Archimedes, Leonardo and Galileo have been mentioned to substantiate the statement that

- A science has always been intimately associated with war
- B from ancient times science has played a leading part in the life of man
- C all learning has flourished only under the patronage of royalty and eminent personages
- D in the past pursuit of knowledge was done for its own sake

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 369

The duty of the scientist, according to the passage, is

- A to further the interests of his state with as much devotion as possible
- B to pursue knowledge regardless of the consequences of their discoveries and inventions
- C to see that important knowledge is widely disseminated and is not falsified in the interests of propaganda
- D to refuse to serve national interests

**Question 370**

The evils which have resulted from knowledge of the physical world can only be overcome by

- A a more intensive pursuit of scientific knowledge
- B making scientists more responsible to society
- C adequate progress in the human sciences
- D enlightening the general public about the evils

Instructions

The motive force that has carried the psychoanalytic movement to a voluminous wave of popular attention and created for it considerable following those discontent with traditional methods and attitudes, is the frank direction of the psychological instruments of exploration to the insistent and intimate problems of human relations. However false or however true its conclusions, however weak or strong its arguments, however effective or defective or even pernicious its practice, its mission is broadly humanistic. Psychological enlightenment is presented as a program of salvation. By no other appeal could the service of psychology have become so glorified. The therapeutic promise of psychoanalysis came as the most novel, most ambitious, most releasing of the long procession of curative systems that mark the History of mental healing.

To the contemporary trends in psychology psychoanalysis actually offered a rebuke, a challenge, a supplement, though it appeared to ignore them. With the practical purpose of applied psychology directed to human efficiency, it had no direct relation and thus no quarrel. The solution of behaviorism, likewise bidding for popular approval by reducing adjustment to a program of conditioning, it inevitably found alien and irrelevant, as the behaviorist in reciprocity found psychoanalytic doctrine mystical, fantastic, assumptive, remote. Even to the cognate formulations of mental hygiene, as likewise in its contacts with related fields of psychology, psychoanalysis made no conciliatory advances. Towards psychiatry, its nearest of kin, it took an unfriendly position, quite too plainly implying a disdain for an unprogressive relative.

These estrangements affected its relations throughout the domain of mind and its ills; but they came to head in the practice. From the outset in the days of struggle, when it had but a sparse and scattered discipleship, to the present position of prominence, Freudianism went its own way, for the most part neglected by academic psychology. Of dreams, lapses and neuroses, orthodox psychology had little say. The second reason for the impression made by psychoanalysis when once launched against the tide of academic resistance was its recognition of depth psychology, so much closer to human motivation, so much more intimate and direct than the analysis of mental factors. Most persons in trouble would be grateful for relief without critical examination of the theory behind the practice that helped them.

Anyone at all acquainted with the ebb and flow of cures - cures that cure and cures that fail - need not be told that the scientific basis of the system is often the least important factor. Many of these systems arise empirically within a practice, which by trial, seems to give results. This is not the case in psychoanalysis. Psychoanalysis belongs to the typical groups of therapies in which practice is entirely a derivative of theory. Here the pertinent psychological principle reads: Create a belief in the theory, and the fact will create themselves.

Question 371

The only statement to receive support from the passage is which of the following?

- A Psychoanalysis concentrated more on the theoretical remedies than their practical implementation.
- B Psychoanalysis broke the shackles of convention in its involvement with humanistic issues.
- C The attitude of psychoanalysis towards allied branches of psychology could at best be described as indifferent.
- D Psychoanalysis dispelled the prevalent notion that dreams were repressed desires.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 372

The distinctive feature of psychoanalysis is that

- A it provided the laymen with a scientific basis to the theories of psychology.
- B it blasted the popular theory that the conscious mind could be aptly linked the tip of an iceberg.
- C it provided effective means for the cure of mental disorders.
- D it rendered existing trends in psychology defunct.

The motive force that has carried the psychoanalytic movement to a voluminous wave of popular attention and created for it considerable following those discontent with traditional methods and attitudes, is the frank direction of the psychological instruments of exploration to the insistent and intimate problems of human relations. However false or however true its conclusions, however weak or strong its arguments, however effective or defective or even pernicious its practice, its mission is broadly humanistic. Psychological enlightenment is presented as a program of salvation. By no other appeal could the service of psychology have become so glorified. The therapeutic promise of psychoanalysis came as the most novel, most ambitious, most releasing of the long procession of curative systems that mark the History of mental healing.

To the contemporary trends in psychology psychoanalysis actually offered a rebuke, a





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Question 373

Freudian psychoanalysis was ignored by academic psychology because of which of the following?

- A Its theories were not substantiated by practical evidence.
- B It probed too deep into the human mind thereby divesting it of its legitimate privacy.
- C It did not have a large following.
- D It was pre-occupied with unfamiliar concepts such as dreams and the subconscious mind.

The motive force that has carried the psychoanalytic movement to a voluminous wave of popular attention and created for it considerable following those discontent with traditional methods and attitudes, is the frank direction of the psychological instruments of exploration to the insistent and intimate problems of human relations. However false or however true its conclusions, however weak or strong its arguments, however effective or defective or even pernicious in practice, its mission is broadly humanistic. Psychological enlightenment is presented as a program of salvation. By no other appeal could the service of psychology have become so glorified. The therapeutic promise of psychoanalysis came as the most novel, most ambitious, most releasing of the long procession of curative systems that mark the History of mental healing.

To the contemporary trends in psychology psychoanalysis actually offered a rebuke, a

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Question 374

The popularity enjoyed by the psychoanalytical movement may be directly attributed to

- A dissatisfaction with existing methods of psychology.
- B its logical, coherent process of ratiocination.
- C its novel unconventionality in both postulate and practice.
- D its concentration upon the humanistic aspect of psychological analysis.

The motive force that has carried the psychoanalytic movement to a voluminous wave of popular attention and created for it considerable following those discontent with traditional methods and attitudes, is the frank direction of the psychological instruments of exploration to the insistent and intimate problems of human relations. However false or however true its conclusions, however weak or strong its arguments, however effective or defective or even pernicious in practice, its mission is broadly humanistic. Psychological enlightenment is presented as a program of salvation. By no other appeal could the service of psychology have become so glorified. The therapeutic promise of psychoanalysis came as the most novel, most ambitious, most releasing of the long procession of curative systems that mark the History of mental healing.

To the contemporary trends in psychology psychoanalysis actually offered a rebuke, a

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Question 375

Psychoanalysis are of the opinion that

- A methods of psychoanalysis must be in keeping with individual needs.
- B inferences can be drawn empirically from repeated experiments with any given theory.
- C theory leads to practice.
- D practice culminates into theory.

VIEW SOLUTION



Question 376

Create a belief in theory and

- A belief will be created itself.
- B theory will be created itself.
- C facts will be created themselves .
- D All of the above.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 377

The statement which is refuted by the passage is this:

- A The popularity enjoyed by psychoanalysis is partly due to the disenchantment with traditional methods of psychology.
- B Psychoanalysis wooed people dissatisfied with other branches of psychology to swell their ranks.
- C Psychoanalysis were pioneers in the realm of analysis of the subconscious mind.
- D Psychoanalysis alienated allied branches of psychology.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 378

The distinction between behaviorism and psychoanalysis that is heightened here is which of the following?

- A Behaviorism is wide in scope; psychoanalysis more restricted.
- B Behaviorism are more tolerant in their outlook; psychoanalysis more dogmatic.
- C Behaviorism traces all action to conditioning by habit; psychoanalysis to the depths of the human mind.
- D Behaviorism are more circumspect and deliberate in their propagation of theory; psychoanalysis jump to conclusion impetuously.

The motive force that has carried the psychoanalytic movement to a voluminous wave of popular attention and created for it considerable following those discontent with traditional methods and attitudes, is the frank direction of the psychological instruments of exploration to the insistent and intimate problems of human relations. However false or however true its conclusions, however weak or strong its arguments, however effective or defective or even pernicious in practice, its mission is broadly humanistic. Psychological enlightenment is presented as a program of salvation. By no other appeal could the service of psychology have become so glorified. The therapeutic promise of psychoanalysis came as the most novel, most ambitious, most releasing of the long procession of curative systems that mark the History of mental healing.

To the contemporary trends in psychology psychoanalysis actually offered a rebuke, a



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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

How can we know what someone else is thinking or feeling, let alone prove it in court? In his 1863 book, *A General View of the Criminal Law of England*, James Fitzjames Stephen, among the most celebrated legal thinkers of his generation, was of the opinion that the assessment of a person's mental state was an inference made with "little consciousness." In a criminal case, jurors, doctors, and lawyers could watch defendants—scrutinizing clothing, mannerisms, tone of voice—but the best they could hope for were clues. . . . Rounding these clues up to a judgment about a defendant's guilt, or a defendant's life, was an act of empathy and imagination. . . . The closer the resemblance between defendants and their judges, the easier it was to overlook the gap that inference filled. Conversely, when a defendant struck officials as unlike themselves, whether by dint of disease, gender, confession, or race, the precariousness of judgments about mental state was exposed.

In the nineteenth century, physicians who specialized in the study of madness and the care of the insane held themselves out as experts in the new field of mental science. Often called alienists or mad doctors, they were the predecessors of modern psychiatrists, neurologists, and psychologists. . . . The opinions of family and neighbors had once been sufficient to sift the sane from the insane, but a growing belief that insanity was a subtle condition that required expert, medical diagnosis pushed physicians into the witness box. . . . Lawyers for both prosecution and defense began to recruit alienists to assess defendants' sanity and to testify to it in court.

Irresponsibility and insanity were not identical, however. Criminal responsibility was a legal concept and not, fundamentally, a medical one. Stephen explained: "The question 'What are the mental elements of responsibility?' is, and must be, a legal question. It cannot be anything else, for the meaning of responsibility is liability to punishment." . . . Nonetheless, medical and legal accounts of what it meant to be mentally sound became entangled and mutually referential throughout the nineteenth century. Lawyers relied on medical knowledge to inform their opinions and arguments about the sanity of their clients. Doctors commented on the legal responsibility of their patients. Ultimately, the fields of criminal law and mental science were both invested in constructing an image of the broken and damaged psyche that could be contrasted with the whole and healthy one. This shared interest, and the shared space of the criminal courtroom, made it nearly impossible to consider responsibility without medicine, or insanity without law. . . .

Physicians and lawyers shared more than just concern for the mind. Class, race, and gender bound these middle-class, white, professional men together, as did family ties, patriotism, Protestantism, business ventures, the alumni networks of elite schools and universities, and structures of political patronage. But for all their affinities, men of medicine and law were divided by contests over the borders of criminal responsibility, as much within each profession as between them. Alienists steadily pushed the boundaries of their field, developing increasingly complex and capacious definitions of insanity. Eccentricity and aggression came to be classified as symptoms of mental disease, at least by some.

Question 379

"Conversely, when a defendant struck officials as unlike themselves, whether by dint of disease, gender, confession, or race, the precariousness of judgments about mental state was exposed." Which one of the following best describes the use of the word "confession" in this sentence?

- A Referring to the practice of 'confession' in some faiths, here it is a metaphor for the religion of the defendant.

- B Referring to the gender, race or disease claimed as a defence by the defendant, here it is a synonym for 'professing' a gender, race, or disease.
- C Referring to the defendant's confession of his or her crime as false, because 'didn't' is an archaic form of 'didn't' or 'did not'.
- D The defendants struck out at the officials and then confessed to the act.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 380

The last paragraph of the passage refers to “middle-class, white, professional men”. Which one of the following qualities best describes the connection among them?

- A The borders of criminal responsibility.
- B The opinions of family and neighbours.
- C Eccentricity and aggression.
- D Empathy and imagination.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 381

According to the passage, who or what was an “alienist”?

- A Professionals who pushed the boundaries of their fields till they became unrecognisable in the nineteenth century.
- B Physicians who specialised in the study of madness and the care of the insane in the nineteenth century.
- C Physicians and lawyers who were responsible for the condition of immigrants or 'aliens' in the nineteenth century.
- D Physicians and lawyers who were responsible for examining accounts of extraterrestrials or 'aliens' in the nineteenth century.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

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Question 382

Study the following sets of concepts and identify the set that is conceptually closest to the concerns and arguments of the passage.

- A Empathy, Prosecution, Knowledge, Business.
- B Judgement, Belief, Accounts, Patronage.
- C Assessment, Empathy, Prosecution, Patriotism.

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Understanding the key properties of complex systems can help us clarify and deal with many new and existing global challenges, from pandemics to poverty . . . A recent study in Nature Physics found transitions to orderly states such as schooling in fish (all fish swimming in the same direction), can be caused, paradoxically, by randomness, or 'noise' feeding back on itself. That is, a misalignment among the fish causes further misalignment, eventually inducing a transition to schooling. Most of us wouldn't guess that noise can produce predictable behaviour. The result invites us to consider how technology such as contact-tracing apps, although informing us locally, might negatively impact our collective movement. If each of us changes our behaviour to avoid the infected, we might generate a collective pattern we had aimed to avoid: higher levels of interaction between the infected and susceptible, or high levels of interaction among the asymptomatic.

Complex systems also suffer from a special vulnerability to events that don't follow a normal distribution or 'bell curve'. When events are distributed normally, most outcomes are familiar and don't seem particularly striking. Height is a good example: it's pretty unusual for a man to be over 7 feet tall; most adults are between 5 and 6 feet, and there is no known person over 9 feet tall. But in collective settings where contagion shapes behaviour - a run on the banks, a scramble to buy toilet paper - the probability distributions for possible events are often heavy-tailed. There is a much higher probability of extreme events, such as a stock market crash or a massive surge in infections. These events are still unlikely, but they occur more frequently and are larger than would be expected under normal distributions.

What's more, once a rare but hugely significant 'tail' event takes place, this raises the probability of further tail events. We might call them second-order tail events; they include stock market gyrations after a big fall and earthquake aftershocks. The initial probability of second-order tail events is so tiny it's almost impossible to calculate - but once a first-order tail event occurs, the rules change, and the probability of a second-order tail event increases.

The dynamics of tail events are complicated by the fact that they result from cascades of other unlikely events. When COVID-19 first struck, the stock market suffered stunning losses followed by an equally stunning recovery. Some of these dynamics are potentially attributable to former sports bettors, with no sports to bet on, entering the market as speculators rather than investors. The arrival of these new players might have increased inefficiencies and allowed savvy long-term investors to gain an edge over bettors with different goals. . . .

One reason a first-order tail event can induce further tail events is that it changes the perceived costs of our actions and changes the rules that we play by. This game-change is an example of another key complex systems concept: nonstationarity. A second, canonical example of nonstationarity is adaptation, as illustrated by the arms race involved in the coevolution of hosts and parasites [in which] each has to 'run' faster, just to keep up with the novel solutions the other one presents as they battle it out in evolutionary time.

Question 383

Which one of the options below best summarises the passage?

- A The passage explains how social outcomes generally follow normal distributions. So, extreme events are negligible, and policy should stabilise averages rather than learn from large shocks in fast-changing collective settings.
- B The passage explains how noise can create order, then shows why complex systems with contagion are vulnerable to heavy-tailed cascades. It also explains why early shocks change rules through nonstationarity with a market illustration during the COVID-19 disruption.

The passage explains how speculative entrants always produce inefficiency after health shocks.

- C Therefore, long-term investors invariably profit when new participants push prices away from fundamentals under pandemic conditions and comparable crises.

The passage explains how nonstationarity works in evolutionary biology and rejects applications in

- D markets or public health because adaptation is exclusive to parasite-host systems and cannot arise in technology-mediated social dynamics.

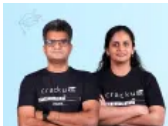
[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 384

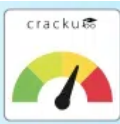
All of the following inferences are supported by the passage EXCEPT that:

- A examples like runs on banks and toilet paper scrambles illustrate how contagion can amplify local choices into system-wide cascades that surprise participants and lead to patterns they did not intend to create.
- B learning can change the rules that actors face. So, a rare shock can alter payoffs and raise the odds of subsequent large disturbances within the same system, which supports the idea of second-order tail events.
- C heavy-tailed events make extreme outcomes more frequent and larger than bell curve expectations. This complicates forecasting and risk management in collective settings shaped by contagion and copying behaviour.
- D the text attributes the COVID-19 pandemic rebound in financial markets solely to displaced sports bettors and treats their entry as the overriding cause of the rapid recovery across assets and time horizons.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 385

Which one of the following observations would most strengthen the passage's claim that a first-order tail event raises the probability of further tail events in complex systems?

- A In epidemic networks, initial super-spreading episodes are isolated spikes after which outbreak sizes match the baseline distribution from independent contact models across comparable cities with no rise in the frequency or size of later extreme clusters.
- B River discharge records show water levels fit a normal distribution with thin tails that match laboratory data, regardless of storms or floods.
- C After a major equity crash, researchers find dense clusters of large daily moves for several weeks, with extreme days occurring far more often than in normal circumstances for assets with customarily low volatility profiles.
- D Following large earthquakes, regional seismic activity returns to baseline within hours with no aftershock sequence once data are adjusted for reporting effects, which suggests independence across events rather than any elevation in subsequent tail probabilities.

Question 386

The passage suggests that contact tracing apps could inadvertently raise risky interactions by altering local behaviour. Which one of the assumptions below is most necessary for that suggestion to hold?

- Most users uninstall apps within a week, which leaves only highly exposed individuals participating. This
- A neutralises any systematic bias in routing decisions and prevents any predictable change in aggregate contact patterns.
 - B Individuals base movement choices partly on observed infections and on the behaviour of others. So, local responses interact, which turns many small adjustments into large scale patterns that can frustrate the intended aim of risk reduction.
 - C App alerts always include precise location to within one metre and deliver real time updates for all users, which ensures that the data feed is perfectly accurate regardless of privacy settings, power limits, or network conditions.
 - D Urban networks have uniform traffic conditions at all hours, which allows perfectly predictable routing independent of personal choices, social signals, or crowd reactions and, therefore, makes interdependence negligible in city movement decisions.

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Often the well intentioned music lover or the traditionally-minded professional composer asks two basic questions when faced with the electronic music phenomena: (1) . . . is this type of artistic creation music at all? and, (2) given that the product is accepted as music of a new type or order, is not such music "inhuman"? . . . As Lejaren Hiller points out in his book *Experimental Music* (coauthor Leonard M. Isaacson), two questions which often arise when music is discussed are: (a) the substance of musical communication and its symbolic and semantic significance, if any, and (b) the particular processes, both mental and technical, which are involved in creating and responding to musical composition. The ever-present popular concept of music as a direct, open, emotional expression and as a subjective form of communication from the composer, is, of course still that of the nineteenth century, when composers themselves spoke of music in those terms . . . But since the third decade of our century many composers have preferred more objective definitions of music, epitomized in Stravinsky's description of it as "a form of speculation in terms of sound and time". An acceptance of this more characteristic twentieth-century view of the art of musical composition will of course immediately bring the layman closer to an understanding of, and sympathetic response to, electronic music, even if the forms, sounds and approaches it uses will still be of a foreign nature to him.

A communication problem however will still remain. The principal barrier that electronic music presents at large, in relation to the communication process, is that composers in this medium are employing a new language of forms . . . where terms like 'densities', 'indefinite pitch relations', 'dynamic serialization', 'permutation', etc., are substitutes (or remote equivalents) for the traditional concepts of harmony, melody, rhythm, etc. . . . When the new structural procedures of electronic music are at last fully understood by the listener the barriers between him and the work he faces will be removed. . . .

The medium of electronic music has of course tempted many kinds of composers to try their hand at it . . . But the serious-minded composer approaches the world of electronic music with a more sophisticated and profound concept of creation. Although he knows that he can reproduce and employ melodic, rhythmic patterns and timbres of a traditional nature, he feels that it is in the exploration of sui generis languages and forms that the aesthetic magic of the new medium lies. And, conscientiously, he plunges into this search.

The second objection usually levelled against electronic music is much more innocent in nature. When people speak—sometimes very vehemently—of the 'inhuman' quality of this music they seem to forget that the composer is the one who fires the machines, collects the sounds, manipulates them, pushes the buttons, programs the computer, filters the sounds, establishes pitches and scales, splices tape, thinks of forms, and rounds up the over-all structure of the piece, as well as every detail of it.

Question 387

From the context in which it is placed, the phrase “sui generis” in paragraph 3 suggests which one of the following?

- A Particular
- B Generic
- C Unaesthetic
- D Indescribable

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 388

The goal of the author over the course of this passage is to:

- A differentiate the modern composer from the nineteenth century composer
- B differentiate between electronic music and other forms of music.
- C defend the “serious-minded composer” from Lejaren Hill and Stravinsky.
- D defend electronic music from certain common charges.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 389

What relation does the “communication problem” mentioned in paragraph 2 have to the questions that the author recounts at the beginning of the passage?

- A Unfamiliar forms and terms might get in the way of our seeing electronic music as music, but this can be overcome.
- B Its unfamiliar “language of forms” and novel terms mean that we cannot see electronic music as music since it does not employ traditional musical concepts.
- C None; they are unrelated to one another and form parts of different discussions.
- D The communication problem is what allows us to see electronic music as music because music must be difficult to understand.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 390

The mention of Stravinsky's description of music in the first paragraph does all the following EXCEPT:

- A help us determine which sounds are musical and which are not.
- B respond to and expand upon earlier understandings of music.
- C complicate our notion of what is communicated through music.
- D allow us to classify electronic music as music.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Time and again, whenever a population [of Mexican tetra fish] was swept into a cave and survived long enough for natural selection to have its way, the eyes disappeared. “But it’s not that everything has been lost in cavefish . . . Many enhancements have also happened.” . . . Studies have found that cave-dwelling fish can detect lower levels of amino acids than surface fish can. They also have more tastebuds and a higher density of sensitive cells alongside their bodies that let them sense water pressure and flow. . . .

Killing the processes that support the formation of the eye is quite literally what happens. Just like non-cave-dwelling members of the species, all cavefish embryos start making eyes. But after a few hours, cells in the developing eye start dying, until the entire structure has disappeared. [Developmental biologist Misty] Riddle thinks this apparent inefficiency may be unavoidable. “The early development of the brain and the eye are completely intertwined—they happen together,” she says. That means the least disruptive way for eyelessness to evolve may be to start making an eye and then get rid of it. . . .

It’s easy to see why cavefish would be at a disadvantage if they were to maintain expensive tissues they aren’t using. Since relatively little lives or grows in their caves, the fish are likely surviving on a meager diet of mostly bat feces and organic waste that washes in during the rainy season. Researchers keeping cavefish in labs have discovered that, genetically, the creatures are exquisitely adapted to absorbing and storing nutrients. . . .

Fats can be toxic for tissues, [evolutionary physiologist Nicolas] Rohner explains, so they are stored in fat cells. “But when these cells get too big, they can burst, which is why we often see chronic inflammation in humans and other animals that have stored a lot of fat in their tissues.” Yet a 2020 study by Rohner, Krishnan and their colleagues revealed that even very well-fed cavefish had fewer signs of inflammation in their fat tissues than surface fish do. Even in their sparse cave conditions, wild cavefish can sometimes get very fat, says Riddle. This is presumably because, whenever food ends up in the cave, the fish eat as much of it as possible, since there may be nothing else for a long time to come. Intriguingly, Riddle says, their fat is usually bright yellow because of high levels of carotenoids, the substance in the carrots that your grandmother used to tell you were good for your...eyes.

“The first thing that came to our mind, of course, was that they were accumulating these because they don’t have eyes,” says Riddle. In this species, such ideas can be tested: Scientists can cross surface fish (with eyes) and cavefish (without eyes) and look at what their offspring are like. When that’s done, Riddle says, researchers see no link between eye presence or size and the accumulation of carotenoids. Some eyeless cavefish had fat that was practically white, indicating lower carotenoid levels. Instead, Riddle thinks these carotenoids may be another adaptation to suppress inflammation, which might be important in the wild, as cavefish are likely overeating whenever food arrives.

Question 391

On the basis of the information in the passage, what is the most likely function of carotenoids in Mexican tetra cavefish?

- A To act as a substitute for eyes.
- B To help the fat cells store nutrients.
- C To render bright yellow colour to the cavefish.
- D To control inflammation from the bursting of fat cells.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 392

Which one of the following results for the cross between surface fish (with eyes) and cavefish (without eyes) would invalidate Riddle's inference from the experiment?

- A Some offspring with eyes had white fat.
- B Some offspring with eyes had yellow fat.
- C Only eyeless offspring had yellow fat.
- D Some eyeless offspring had white fat.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 393

Which one of the following best explains why the "apparent inefficiency" is "unavoidable"?

- A The caves have poor and inconsistent availability of food and nutrition for Mexican tetra cavefish.
- B The lack of light in the caves kills the eye cells in the developing Mexican tetra cavefish embryo.
- C The inefficiency resulting from eyelessness is compensated by enhancements like more tastebuds in Mexican tetra cavefish.
- D Mexican tetra cavefish are similar to non-cave-dwelling variants in their early stages of development.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 394

All of the following statements from the passage describe adaptation in Mexican tetra cavefish EXCEPT:

- A "It's easy to see why cavefish would be at a disadvantage if they were to maintain expensive tissues they aren't using."
- B "Since relatively little lives or grows in their caves, the fish are likely surviving on a meager diet of mostly bat feces and organic waste that washes in during the rainy season."
- C "But when these cells get too big, they can burst, which is why we often see chronic inflammation in humans and other animals that have stored a lot of fat in their tissues."
- D "Even in their sparse cave conditions, wild cavefish can sometimes get very fat, says Riddle."

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Different sciences exhibit different science cultures and practices. For example, in astronomy, observation - until what is today called the new astronomy - had always been limited to what could be seen within the limits of optical light. Indeed, until early modernity the limits to optical light were also limits of what humans could themselves see within their limited and relative perceptual spectrum of human vision. With early modernity and the invention of lensed optical instruments - telescopes - astronomers could begin to observe phenomena never seen before. Magnification and resolution began to allow what was previously imperceptible to be perceived - but within the familiar limits of optical vision. Galileo, having learned of the Dutch invention of a telescope by Hans Lippershey, went on to build some hundred of his own, improving from the Dutch 3x to nearly 30x telescopes - which turn out to be the limit of magnificational power without chromatic distortion. And it was with his own telescopes that he made the observations launching early modern astronomy (phases of Venus, satellites of Jupiter, etc.). Isaac Newton's later improvement with reflecting telescopes expanded upon the magnificational-resolution capacity of optical observation; and, from Newton to the twentieth century, improvement continued on to the later very large array of light telescopes today - following the usual technological trajectory of "more-is-better" but still remaining within the limits of the light spectrum. Today's astronomy has now had the benefit of some four centuries of optical telescopic observation. The "new astronomy," however, opens the full known electromagnetic spectrum to observation, beginning with the accidental discovery of radio astronomy early in the twentieth century, and leading today to the diverse variety of EMS telescopes which can explore the range from gamma to radio waves. Thus, astronomy, now outfitted with new instruments, "smart" adaptive optics, very large arrays, etc., illustrates one style of instrumentally embodied science - a technoscience. Of course astronomy, with the very recent exceptions of probes to solar system bodies (Moon, Mars, Venus, asteroids), remains largely a "receptive" science, dependent upon instrumentation which can detect and receive emissions.

Contemporary biology displays a quite different instrument array and, according to Evelyn Fox-Keller, also a different scientific culture. She cites her own experience, coming from mathematical physics into microbiology, and takes account of the distinctive instrumental culture in her *Making Sense of Life* (2002). Here, particularly with the development of biotechnology, instrumentation is far more interventional than in the astronomy case. Microscopic instrumentation can be and often is interventional in style: "gene-splicing" and other techniques of biotechnology, while still in their infancy, are clearly part of the interventional trajectory of biological instrumentation. Yet, in both disciplines, the sciences involved are today highly instrumentalized and could not progress successfully without constant improvements upon the respective instrumental trajectories. So, minimalistically, one may conclude that the sciences are technologically, instrumentally embodied. But the styles of embodiment differ, and perhaps the last of the scientific disciplines to move into such technical embodiment is mathematics, which only contemporarily has come to rely more and more upon the computational machinery now in common use.

Question 395

To which one of the following instruments would the characterisations of instruments in the passage be least applicable?

- A Milestone
- B Kitchen oven
- C Scalpel
- D Saxophone

Question 396

All of the following statements may be rejected as valid inferences from the passage EXCEPT:

- A interventionist instruments, or instruments that intervene directly in scientific inquiry, are different from embodied instruments, or instruments that embody scientific inquiry.
- B the advances in telescoping made by Newton with reflecting telescopes allowed early modern astronomers to observe the phases of Venus and the satellites of Jupiter.
- C the author distinguishes between the receptive and interventionist uses of instruments in the sciences by comparing astronomy and biology, respectively.
- D Isaac Newton's experiments with reflecting telescopes were the earliest versions of the "new astronomy" referred to in the passage.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 397

None of the following statements, if true, contradicts the arguments in the passage EXCEPT:

- A some scientific instruments may be classified as both receptive and interventional in their functions.
- B because of the relatively recent entry of computational machinery in mathematics, the field is only now beginning to develop a scientific culture.
- C like telescoping, microscopy has also sought to move beyond the visible spectrum to be able to detect objects that are invisible in that spectrum.
- D Isaac Newton's discovery of gravity was accomplished without the help of instruments.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 398

Which one of the following observations is a valid conclusion to draw from the statement that "the sciences involved are today highly instrumentalised and could not progress successfully without constant improvements upon the respective instrumental trajectories"?

- A The use of instruments in scientific trajectories must be respected in order to see successful progress in them.
- B The growth of scientific technologies has led to the embodiment of progress in the trajectories of improvement.
- C In both astronomy and microbiology, progress has been the consequence of improvements in the instruments they use.
- D Highly instrumentalised work in the sciences has resulted in the progressive improvement of scientific constants.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

In [my book "Searches"], I chronicle how big technology companies have exploited human language for their gain. We let this happen, I argue, because we also benefit somewhat from using the products. It's a dynamic that makes us complicit in big tech's accumulation of wealth and power: we're both victims and beneficiaries. I describe this complicity, but I also enact it, through my own internet archives: my Google searches, my Amazon product reviews and, yes, my ChatGPT dialogues. . . .

People often describe chatbots' textual output as "bland" or "generic" - the linguistic equivalent of a beige office building. OpenAI's products are built to "sound like a colleague", as OpenAI puts it, using language that, coming from a person, would sound "polite", "empathetic", "kind", "rationally optimistic" and "engaging", among other qualities. OpenAI describes these strategies as helping its products seem "professional" and "approachable". This appears to be bound up with making us feel safe . . .

Trust is a challenge for artificial intelligence (AI) companies, partly because their products regularly produce falsehoods and reify sexist, racist, US-centric cultural norms. While the companies are working on these problems, they persist: OpenAI found that its latest systems generate errors at a higher rate than its previous system. In the book, I wrote about the inaccuracies and biases and also demonstrated them with the products. When I prompted Microsoft's Bing Image Creator to produce a picture of engineers and space explorers, it gave me an entirely male cast of characters; when my father asked ChatGPT to edit his writing, it transmuted his perfectly correct Indian English into American English. Those weren't flukes. Research suggests that both tendencies are widespread.

In my own ChatGPT dialogues, I wanted to enact how the product's veneer of collegial neutrality could lull us into absorbing false or biased responses without much critical engagement. Over time, ChatGPT seemed to be guiding me to write a more positive book about big tech - including editing my description of OpenAI's CEO, Sam Altman, to call him "a visionary and a pragmatist". I'm not aware of research on whether ChatGPT tends to favor big tech, OpenAI or Altman, and I can only guess why it seemed that way in our conversation. OpenAI explicitly states that its products shouldn't attempt to influence users' thinking. When I asked ChatGPT about some of the issues, it blamed biases in its training data - though I suspect my arguably leading questions played a role too. When I queried ChatGPT about its rhetoric, it responded: "The way I communicate is designed to foster trust and confidence in my responses, which can be both helpful and potentially misleading." . . .

OpenAI has its own goals, of course. Among them, it emphasizes wanting to build AI that "benefits all of humanity". But while the company is controlled by a non-profit with that mission, its funders still seek a return on their investment. That will presumably require getting people using products such as ChatGPT even more than they already are - a goal that is easier to accomplish if people see those products as trustworthy collaborators.

Question 399

The author of the passage is least likely to agree with which one of the following claims?

- A The neutrality of AI is conducive to critical thinking.
- B ChatGPT favours AI companies and their officials, like Sam Altman, in its responses.
- C When we use AI, we become accomplices to the exploitative practices of big tech companies.
- D The neutrality of AI is motivated by economic considerations.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 400

The author compares AI-generated texts with “a beige office building” for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

- A AI generates generalised responses that lack specificity and nuance.
- B AI tends to blame its training data when scrutinised for its biases.
- C AI aims to foster a feeling of trust and credibility among its users.
- D AI-generated texts often exhibit a warm, polite, and collegial tone.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 401

All of the following statements from the passage affirm the disjunct between the claims about AI made by tech companies and what AI actually does EXCEPT:

- A “When I prompted Microsoft’s Bing Image Creator to produce a picture of engineers and space explorers, it gave me an entirely male cast of characters . . .”
- B “In my own ChatGPT dialogues, I wanted to enact how the product’s veneer of collegial neutrality could lull us into absorbing false or biased responses without much critical engagement.”
- C “I’m not aware of research on whether ChatGPT tends to favor big tech, OpenAI or Altman, and I can only guess why it seemed that way in our conversation.”
- D “It’s a dynamic that makes us complicit in big tech’s accumulation of wealth and power: we’re both victims and beneficiaries.”

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 402

On the basis of the purpose of the examples in the passage, pick the odd one out from the following AI-generated responses mentioned in the passage:

- A “When I queried ChatGPT about its rhetoric, it responded: ‘The way I communicate is designed to foster trust and confidence in my responses, which can be both helpful and potentially misleading!’.”
- B “...when my father asked ChatGPT to edit his writing, it transmuted his perfectly correct Indian English into American English.”
- C “Over time, ChatGPT seemed to be guiding me to write a more positive book about big tech - including editing my description of OpenAI’s CEO, Sam Altman, to call him ‘a visionary and a pragmatist’.”
- D “When I prompted Microsoft’s Bing Image Creator to produce a picture of engineers and space explorers, it gave me an entirely male cast of characters...”

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Instructions

If the more articulate members of a community formed a coherent and united class with a common interest, democracy would probably replace in to the rule of that intelligent, educated minority; even as it is, the democracies of the modern world are much closer to this fate than they are to the much-canvassed dangers of mob rule. Far from oppressing the cultured minority, or any other minorities, democracy gives more of them more scope to have their way than any other system does. This is the lesson of experience. It might also have been derived from an analysis of the concept of democracy, if the concept had been accurately analyzed.

Question 403

The institution of democracy, in modern times

- A is on the brink of extinction.
- B has become vulnerable to the dangers of proletariat rule.
- C should be prepared for the inevitability of mob rule.
- D has become prone to the rule of particular class of people.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 404

Our appreciation of the virtues of the democratic system

- A is the result of an illusory concept.
- B is the result of our negative response to other forms of government.
- C is the result of a proven record of the success of democracy.
- D is the result of centuries of accurate research on the theoretical aspects of democracy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 405

The author seems to be

- A a supporter of mob rule.
- B a supporter of democracy
- C against intelligence in minorities.
- D analysing the flaws of democracy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 406

The wide scope that democracy offers to the minorities can be made known

- A by our common sense.
- B by our political theories.

- C by our native intelligence.
- D by proper analysis.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 407

The word articulate here refers to

- A the elite.
- B people who are endowed with a native intelligence.
- C that class which is well educated.
- D people who are endowed with clarity of speech.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 408

What emerges as the truth from a reading of the paragraph is that

- A forms of government other than democracy give the mobs great scope for self expression.
- B democracy provides greater scope for mob rule.
- C democracy provides greater scope for the rule of the minority.
- D forms of government other than democracy give the educated minority greater scope for self expression.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions



Instructions

It is undeniable that some very useful analogies can be drawn between the relational systems of computer mechanism and the relational systems of brain mechanism. The comparison does not depend upon any close resemblance between the actual mechanical links which occur in brains and computers; it depends on what the machines do. Further more, brains and computers can both be organized so as to solve problems. The mode of communication is very similar in both the cases, so much so that computers can now be designed to generate artificial human speech and even, by accident, to produce sequences of words which human beings recognize as poetry. The implication is not that machines are gradually assuming human forms, but that there is no sharp break of continuity between what is human, what is mechanical.

Question 409

The author uses the word .recognize. in relation to computer poetry to convey a

- A sense of sorrow at the reluctant admission of the superiority of machines by mankind.
- B feeling that computers have yet to conquer the emotional heights that man is capable of attaining.

- C feeling of derision for the popular faith in the omnipotence of the computer.
- D feeling of a fatalistic acceptance of the computer's encroachment upon human bastions.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 410

The passage implies that

- A computers are assuming human forms.
- B human are assuming mechanical forms.
- C computers and humans are substitutable.
- D there is continuity between what is human and what is mechanical.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 411

The resemblance between the human brain and the computer is

- A imaginary.
- B intellectual.
- C mechanical.
- D functional.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



Question 412

Computers have acquired a proven ability of performing many of the functions of the human brain because

- A the brain of modern man is unable to discharge its functions properly on account of over-reliance on machines.
- B the sophisticated computer mechanism is on the verge of outstripping human mental faculties.
- C the process of organizing and communicating are similar in both cases.
- D the mechanics of the human brain have been introduced in the computer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 413

From the passage, it is evident that the author thinks

- A computers are now naturally programmed to produce poetry.

- B computers are likely to usurp the place of intellectual superiority accorded to the human brain.
- C the resemblance that the computer bears to the human brain is purely mechanical.
- D the unintentional mixing up of word sequences in the computer can result in poetry.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 414

Points of dissimilarity between the human brain and the computer don't extend to

- A the faculty of composing poetry.
- B methods of communication.
- C the faculty of problem solving.
- D the faculty of speaking naturally

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF



Instructions

Last fortnight, news of a significant development was tucked away in the inside pages of newspapers. The government finally tabled a bill in Parliament seeking to make primary education a fundamental right. A fortnight earlier, a Delhi-based newspaper had carried a report about a three-month interruption in the Delhi Government's 'Education for All' programme. The report made for distressing reading. It said that literacy centres across the city were closed down, volunteers beaten up and enrolment registers burnt. All because the state government had, earlier this year, made participation in the programme mandatory for teachers in government schools. The routine denials were issued and there probably was a wee bit of exaggeration in the report.

But it still is a pointer to the enormity of the task at hand. That economic development will be inherently unstable unless it is built on a solid base of education, specially primary education, has been said so often that it is in danger of becoming a platitude. Nor does India's abysmal record in the field need much reiteration. Nearly 30 million children in the six to ten age group do not go to school – reason enough to make primary education not only compulsory but a fundamental right. But is that the Explanation? More importantly, will it work? Or will it remain a mere token, like the laws providing for compulsory primary education? It is now widely known that 14 states and four Union Territories have this law on their statute books.

Believe it or not, the list actually includes Bihar, Madhya Pradesh (MP) and Rajasthan, where literacy and education levels are miles below the national average. A number of states have not even notified the compulsory education law. This is not to belittle the decision to make education a fundamental right. As a statement of political will, a commitment by the decision-makers, its importance cannot be undervalued. Once this commitment is clear, a lot of other things like resource allocation will naturally fall into place. But the task of universalizing elementary education (UEE) is complicated by various socio-economic and cultural factors which vary from region to region and within regions. If India's record continues to appall, it is because these intricacies have not been adequately understood by the planners and administrators.

The trouble has been that education policy has been designed by grizzled mandarins ensconced in Delhi and is totally out of touch with the ground reality. The key then is to decentralise education planning and implementation. What's also needed is greater community involvement in the whole process. Only then can school timings be adjusted for convenience, school children given a curriculum they can relate to and teachers

made accountable. For proof, one has only to look at the success of the district primary education programme, which was launched in 1994. It has met with a fair degree of success in the 122 districts it covers. Here the village community is involved in all aspects of education – allocating finances to supervising teachers to fixing school timings and developing curriculum and textbooks – through district planning teams. Teachers are also involved in the planning and implementation process and are given small grants to develop teaching and learning material, vastly improving motivational levels. The consequent improvement in the quality of education generates increased demand for education.

But for this demand to be generated, quality will first have to be improved. In MP, the village panchayats are responsible for not only constructing and maintaining primary schools but also managing scholarships, besides organising non-formal education. How well this works in practice remains to be seen (though the department claims the schemes are working very well) but the decision to empower panchayats with such powers is itself a significant development. Unfortunately, the Panchayat Raj Act has not been notified in many states.

After all, delegating powers to the panchayats is not looked upon too kindly by vested interests. More specifically, by politicians, since decentralisation of education administration takes away from them the power of transfer, which they use to grant favours and build up a support base. But if the political leadership can push through the bill to make education a fundamental right, it should also be able to persuade the states to implement the laws on Panchayat Raj. For, UEE cannot be achieved without decentralisation. Of course, this will have to be accompanied by proper supervision and adequate training of those involved in the administration of education. But the devolution of powers to the local bodies has to come first.

Question 415

Primary education

- A is a fundamental right.
- B will be made a fundamental right.
- C is only for the privileged sections of society.
- D None of these

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 416

The district primary education programme

- A was launched in 1994 in 22 states.
- B was launched in 1994 in 12 states.
- C launched in 1994 has been successful in 122 districts.
- D launched in 1994 has met with dubious success.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 417

One of the problems plaguing the education system in India is

- A poverty.
- B diverse cultural and socio-economic factors.
- C male chauvinism.

D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 418

One of the ways in which education policy can be successfully implemented as mentioned in the passage, is

- A greater community involvement.
- B greater community development.
- C greater community awareness.
- D Both (a) and (b)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 419

The successful implementation of education policies is obstructed by

- A vested interests.
- B panchayat officials.
- C politicians.
- D bureaucrats.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 420

One of the reasons contributing to India's poor performance on the education front is that

- A its leaders do not have the conviction required to improve the education system.
- B male members of society do not want their female counterparts to be educated.
- C administrators in charge of education are out of touch with ground realities.
- D the country does not have the law for implementation of education policies in its statute books.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 421

Very low education levels are visible in

- A Bihar, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh.
- B Rajasthan, West Bengal and Madhya Pradesh.
- C Rajasthan, Bihar and Madhya Pradesh.
- D West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 422

In the context of the passage, the term 'grizzled mandarins' means

- A old hags.
- B decrepit men.
- C ineffective old men.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 423

The village panchayats in Madhya Pradesh are responsible for

- A implementing adult education policies for the villages.
- B organising non-formal education.
- C scholarships and construction and maintenance of primary schools.
- D Both b and c

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)






Question 424

The only way in which the education system can be improved is by

- A decentralising education planning and implementation.
- B introducing fresh blood in the planning body.
- C injecting funds into the exchequer solely for the purpose.
- D educating the people on the need for primary education.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

When Deng Xiaoping died a few months ago, the Chinese leadership barely paused for a moment before getting on with the business of governing the country. Contrast that with the chaotic contortions on India's political stage during the past month, and it is easy to conclude that democracy and democratic freedoms are serious obstacles to economic progress.

When the Chinese leadership wants a power plant to be set up, it just goes ahead. No fears of protracted litigation, of environmental protests, or of lobbying by interested parties. It — or the economy — is not held to ransom by striking truckers or air traffic controllers. Certainly, there is much that is alluring about an enlightened dictatorship.

But there the trouble begins. First, there is no guarantee that a dictatorship will be an enlightened one. Myanmar has been ruled by a dictator for decades, and no one would claim that it is better off than even Bangladesh which has itself suffered long stretches of dictatorship. Nor can Mobutu Sese Seko, much in the news these days, be described as enlightened by any reckoning. The people of Israel, almost the only democracy in a region where dictatorships (unenlightened ones) are the norm, are much better off than their neighbours.

Second, dictatorships can easily reverse policies. China was socialist as long as Mao Zedong was around. When Deng Xiaoping took over in what was essentially a palace coup, he took the country in the opposite direction. There is little to ensure that the process will not be repeated. In India such drastic reversals are unlikely.

Six years ago Indian politicians agreed that industries should be de-licensed, that imports should be freed or that investment decisions should be based on economic considerations. Now few think otherwise. Almost all politicians are convinced of the merits of liberalisation though they may occasionally lose sight of the big picture in pandering to their constituencies. India has moved slower than China on liberalisation, but whatever moves it has made are more permanent.

Democracies are also less likely to get embroiled in destructive wars. Had Saddam Hussain been under the obligation of facing free elections every five years, he would have thought ten times before entangling his people in a long confrontation with the West. Germany, Italy and Japan were all dictatorships when they launched the World War II. The price was paid by the economies. Democracies make many small mistakes. But dictatorships are more susceptible to making huge ones and risking everything on one decision — like going to war. Democracies are the political equivalent of free markets. Companies know they can't fool the consumer too often; he will simply switch to the competition. The same goes for political parties. When they fail to live up to their promises in government, the political consumer opts for the competition.

Democratic freedoms too are important for the economy, especially now that information is supreme. Few doubt that the Internet will play an important part in the global economy in the decades to come. But China, by preventing free access to it, is already probably destroying its capabilities in this area. As service industries grow in importance, China may well be at a disadvantage though that may not be apparent today when its manufacturing juggernaut is rolling ahead.

India has stifled its entrepreneurs through its licensing policies. That was an example of how the absence of economic freedom can harm a country. But right-wing dictatorships like South Korea erred in the opposite direction. They forced their businesses to invest in industries, which they (the dictators) felt had a golden future. Now many of those firms are trying to retreat from those investments. Statism is bad, no matter what the direction in which it applies pressure. At this moment, China and other dictatorships may be making foolish investment decisions. But as industries are subsidized and contrary voices not heard, the errors will not be realised until the investments assume gargantuan proportions.

India's hesitant ways may seem inferior to China's confident moves. But at least we know what the costs are. That is not the case with China. It was only years after the Great Leap Forward and only such experiments that the cost in human lives (millions of them) became evident to the world. What the cost of China's present experiments is we may not know for several years more. A nine per cent rate of growth repeated year after year may seem compelling. But a seven per cent rate of growth that will not falter is more desirable. India seems to be on such a growth curve, whatever the shenanigans of our politicians.

Question 425

The passage says that

- A benevolent dictators are not easy to find.
- B not all dictators will be enlightened.
- C dictators can make or break a country.
- D an enlightened dictatorship is better than a corrupt democracy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 426

India's moves on liberalisation are more permanent than China's because

- A India's politicians are in agreement over the need for reforms.
- B India is not at the mercy of dictators.
- C unlike China, India is unlikely to have drastic policy reversals.
- D India is not in a hurry to reform

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 427

It can be inferred from the passage that

- A China stands to lose out in the global market because it has blocked the Internet.
- B India stands to gain in the global market because of its policy vis-a-vis the Internet.
- C Internet will play a crucial role in the global market in the years to come.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 428

Vis-a-vis democracies, dictatorships run the risk of

- A losing all for a single mistake.
- B making bigger mistakes.
- C making huge mistakes and risking everything.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 429

It can be implied from the passage that

- A a lower rate of growth is preferred to a higher rate of growth.
- B a higher rate of growth is preferred to a lower rate of growth.
- C a low but stable rate of growth is preferred to a high rate of growth.
- D a low but faltering rate of growth is a sign of stability amidst growth.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 430

According to the passage,

- A Israel is the only democracy in West Asia.
- B Israel is better off than Bangladesh or Myanmar.
- C Israel does not face policy reversals.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 431

Democracy has been compared to the free market, as

- A both have a high degree of competition.
- B both offer a multitude of options to choose from.
- C consumer satisfaction plays an important role in both.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 432

The writer's conclusion in the passage is that

- A under no circumstances should a country encourage a corrupt democrat.
- B under no circumstances should statism be a welcome move.
- C a statist will not give due importance to the voice of the people.
- D a statist will always look to his own welfare.

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Question 433

According to the passage,

- A India needs a benevolent dictatorship.
- B India has failed as a democracy.
- C India should go the way of China.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 434

According to the passage, a democratic set up works as a check on the

- A actions and decisions of its leaders.
- B functioning of its economy.
- C Both a and b
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I have elaborated . . . a framework for analyzing the contradictory pulls on [Indian] nationalist ideology in its struggle against the dominance of colonialism and the resolution it offered to those contradictions. Briefly, this resolution was built around a separation of the domain of culture into two spheres—the material and the spiritual. It was in the material sphere that the claims of Western civilization were the most powerful. Science, technology, rational forms of economic organization, modern methods of statecraft—these had given the European countries the strength to subjugate the non-European people . . . To overcome this domination, the colonized people had to learn those superior techniques of organizing material life and incorporate them within their own cultures. . . . But this could not mean the imitation of the West in every aspect of life, for then the very distinction between the West and the East would vanish—the self-identity of national culture would itself be threatened. . . .

The discourse of nationalism shows that the material/spiritual distinction was condensed into an analogous, but ideologically far more powerful, dichotomy: that between the outer and the inner. . . . Applying the inner/outer distinction to the matter of concrete day-to-day living separates the social space into ghar and bāhir, the home and the world. The world is the external, the domain of the material; the home represents one's inner spiritual self, one's true identity. The world is a treacherous terrain of the pursuit of material interests, where practical considerations reign supreme. It is also typically the domain of the male. The home in its essence must remain unaffected by the profane activities of the material world—and woman is its representation. And so one gets an identification of social roles by gender to correspond with the separation of the social space into ghar and bāhir. . . .

The colonial situation, and the ideological response of nationalism to the critique of Indian tradition, introduced an entirely new substance to [these dichotomies] and effected their transformation. The material/spiritual dichotomy, to which the terms world and home corresponded, had acquired . . . a very special significance in

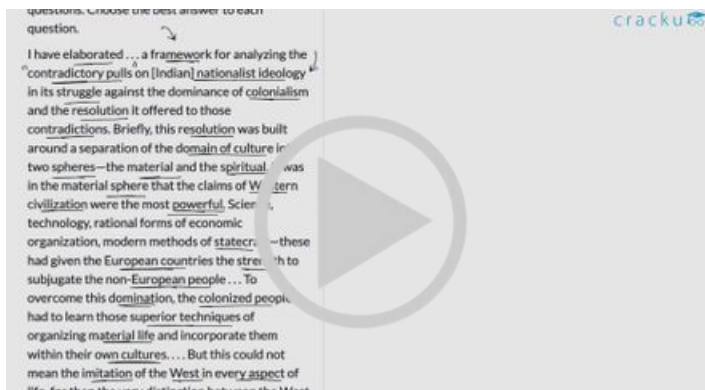
the nationalist mind. The world was where the European power had challenged the non-European people and, by virtue of its superior material culture, had subjugated them. But, the nationalists asserted, it had failed to colonize the inner, essential, identity of the East which lay in its distinctive, and superior, spiritual culture. . . . [I]n the entire phase of the national struggle, the crucial need was to protect, preserve and strengthen the inner core of the national culture, its spiritual essence. . . .

Once we match this new meaning of the home/world dichotomy with the identification of social roles by gender, we get the ideological framework within which nationalism answered the women's question. It would be a grave error to see in this, as liberals are apt to in their despair at the many marks of social conservatism in nationalist practice, a total rejection of the West. Quite the contrary: the nationalist paradigm in fact supplied an ideological principle of selection.

Question 435

On the basis of the information in the passage, all of the following are true about the spiritual/material dichotomy of Indian nationalism EXCEPT that it:

- A represented a continuation of age-old oppositions in Indian culture.
- B constituted the premise of the ghar/bāhir dichotomy.
- C was not as ideologically powerful as the inner/outer dichotomy.
- D helped in safeguarding the identity of Indian nationalism.



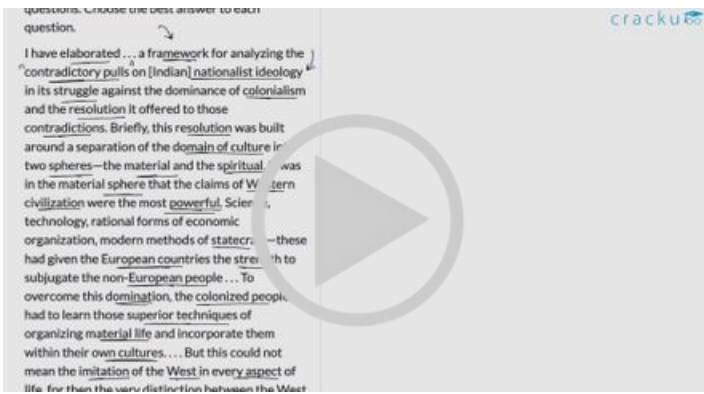
VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 436

Which one of the following best describes the liberal perception of Indian nationalism?

- A Indian nationalism's sophistication resided in its distinction of the material from the spiritual spheres.
- B Indian nationalist discourses reaffirmed traditional gender roles for Indian women.
- C Indian nationalism embraced the changes brought about by colonialism in Indian women's traditional gender roles.
- D Indian nationalist discourses provided an ideological principle of selection.

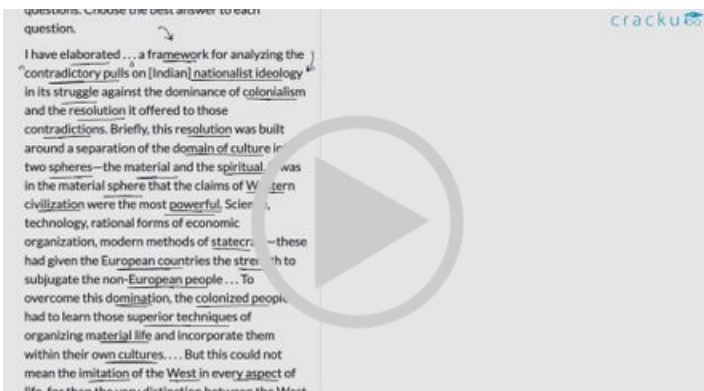


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 437

Which one of the following explains the “contradictory pulls” on Indian nationalism?

- A Despite its spiritual superiority, Indian nationalism had to fight against colonial domination.
- B Despite its fight against colonial domination, Indian nationalism had to borrow from the coloniser in the spiritual sphere.
- C Despite its scientific and technological inferiority, Indian nationalism had to fight against colonial domination.
- D Despite its fight against colonial domination, Indian nationalism had to borrow from the coloniser in the material sphere.



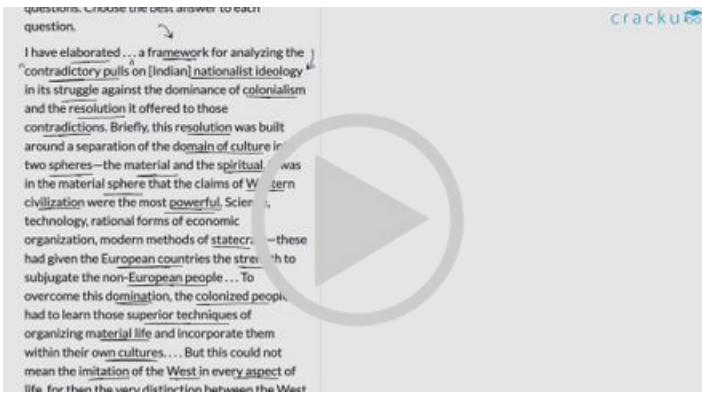
VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 438

Which one of the following, if true, would weaken the author’s claims in the passage?

- A Indian nationalists rejected the cause of English education for women during the colonial period.
- B Forces of colonial modernity played an important role in shaping anti-colonial Indian nationalism.
- C The colonial period saw the hybridisation of Indian culture in all realms as it came in contact with British/European culture.

- D The Industrial Revolution played a crucial role in shaping the economic prowess of Britain in the eighteenth century.



VIDEO SOLUTION



Instructions

Our propensity to look out for regularities, and to impose laws upon nature, leads to the psychological phenomenon of dogmatic thinking or, more generally, dogmatic behaviour: we expect regularities everywhere and attempt to find them even where there are none; events which do not yield to these attempts we are inclined to treat as a kind of 'background noise'; and we stick to our expectations even when they are inadequate and we ought to accept defeat. This dogmatism is to some extent necessary. It is demanded by a situation which can only be dealt with by forcing our conjectures upon the world. Moreover, this dogmatism allows us to approach a good theory in stages, by way of approximations: if we accept defeat too easily, we may prevent ourselves from finding that we were very nearly right.

It is clear that this dogmatic attitude; which makes us stick to our first impressions, is indicative of a strong belief; while a critical attitude, which is ready to modify its tenets, which admits doubt and demands tests, is indicative of a weaker belief. Now according to Hume's theory, and to the popular theory, the strength of a belief should be a product of repetition; thus it should always grow with experience, and always be greater in less primitive persons. But dogmatic thinking, an uncontrolled wish to impose regularities, a manifest pleasure in rites and in repetition as such, is characteristic of primitives and children; and increasing experience and maturity sometimes create an attitude of caution and criticism rather than of dogmatism.

My logical criticism of Hume's psychological theory, and the considerations connected with it, may seem a little removed from the field of the philosophy of science. But the distinction between dogmatic and critical thinking, or the dogmatic and the critical attitude, brings us right back to our central problem. For the dogmatic attitude is clearly related to the tendency to verify our laws and schemata by seeking to apply them and to confirm them, even to the point of neglecting refutations, whereas the critical attitude is one of readiness to change them - to test them; to refute them; to falsify them, if possible. This suggests that we may identify the critical attitude with the scientific attitude, and the dogmatic attitude with the one which we have described as pseudo-scientific. It further suggests that genetically speaking the pseudo-scientific attitude is more primitive than, and prior to, the scientific attitude: that it is a pre-scientific attitude. And this primitivity or priority also has its logical aspect. For the critical attitude is not so much opposed to the dogmatic attitude as super-imposed upon it: criticism must be directed against existing and influential beliefs in need of critical revision - in other words, dogmatic beliefs. A critical attitude needs for its raw material, as it were, theories or beliefs which are held more or less dogmatically.

Thus, science must begin with myths, and with the criticism of myths; neither with the collection of observations, nor with the invention of experiments, but with the critical discussion of myths, and of magical techniques and practices. The scientific tradition is distinguished from the pre-scientific tradition in having two layers. Like the latter, it passes on its theories; but it also passes on a critical attitude towards them. The theories are passed on, not as dogmas, but rather with the challenge to discuss them and improve upon them.

The critical attitude, the tradition of free discussion of theories with the aim of discovering their weak spots so that they may be improved upon, is the attitude of reasonableness, of rationality. From the point of view here developed, all laws, all theories, remain essentially tentative, or conjectural, or hypothetical, even when we feel unable to doubt them any longer. Before a theory has been refuted we can never know in what way it may have to be modified.

Question 439

Which of the following statements best supports the argument in the passage that a critical attitude leads to a weaker belief than a dogmatic attitude does?

- A A critical attitude implies endless questioning, and, therefore, it cannot lead to strong beliefs.
- B A critical attitude, by definition, is centered on an analysis of anomalies and "noise".
- C A critical attitude leads to questioning everything, and in the process generates "noise" without any conviction.
- D A critical attitude is antithetical to conviction, which is required for strong beliefs.
- E A critical attitude leads to questioning and to tentative hypotheses.

Our propensity to look out for regularities, and to impose laws upon nature, leads to the psychological phenomenon of dogmatic thinking or, more generally, dogmatic behaviour: we expect regularities everywhere and attempt to find them even where there are none; events which do not yield to these attempts we are inclined to treat as a kind of 'background noise'; and we stick to our expectations even when they are inadequate and we ought to accept defeat. This dogmatism is to some extent necessary. It is demanded by a situation which can only be dealt with by forcing our conjectures upon the world. Moreover, this dogmatism allows us to approach a good theory in stages, by way of approximations: if we accept defeat too easily, we may prevent ourselves from finding that we were very nearly right.

It is clear that this dogmatic attitude; which makes us stick to our first impressions, is indicative of a strong belief; while a critical attitude, which is ready to modify its tenets, which admits doubt and demands

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 440

According to the passage, which of the following statements best describes the difference between science and pseudo-science? :

- A Scientific theories or hypothesis are tentatively true whereas pseudo-sciences are always true.
- B Scientific laws and theories are permanent and immutable whereas pseudo-sciences are contingent on the prevalent mode of thinking in a society.
- C Science always allows the possibility of rejecting a theory or hypothesis, whereas pseudo-sciences seek to validate their ideas or theories.
- D Science focuses on anomalies and exceptions so that fundamental truths can be uncovered, whereas pseudo-sciences focus mainly on general truths.

- E Science progresses by collection of observations or by experimentation, whereas pseudo-sciences do not worry about observations and experiments.

cracku

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It is clear that this dogmatic attitude; which makes us stick to our first impressions, is indicative of a strong belief; while a critical attitude, which is ready to modify its tenets, which admits doubt and demands

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 441

Dogmatic behaviour, in this passage, has been associated with primitives and children. Which of the following best describes the reason why the author compares primitives with children?

- A Primitives are people who are not educated, and hence can be compared with children, who have not yet been through school. .
- B Primitives are people who, though not modern, are as innocent as children.
- C Primitives are people without a critical attitude, just as children are.
- D Primitives are people in the early stages of human evolution; similarly, children are in the early stages of their lives.
- E Primitives are people who are not civilized enough, just as children are not. .

cracku

Our propensity to look out for regularities, and to impose laws upon nature, leads to the psychological phenomenon of dogmatic thinking or, more generally, dogmatic behaviour: we expect regularities everywhere and attempt to find them even where there are none; events which do not yield to these attempts we are inclined to treat as a kind of 'background noise'; and we stick to our expectations even when they are inadequate and we ought to accept defeat. This dogmatism is to some extent necessary. It is demanded by a situation which can only be dealt with by forcing our conjectures upon the world. Moreover, this dogmatism allows us to approach a good theory in stages, by way of approximations: if we accept defeat too easily, we may prevent ourselves from finding that we were nearly right.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 442

In the context of science, according to the passage, the interaction of dogmatic beliefs and critical attitude can be best described as:

- A A duel between two warriors in which one has to die.
- B The effect of a chisel on a marble stone while making a sculpture.
- C The feedstock (natural gas) in fertilizer industry being transformed into fertilizers.
- D A predator killing its prey.
- E The effect of fertilizers on a sapling.

Our propensity to look out for regularities, and to impose laws upon nature, leads to the psychological phenomenon of dogmatic thinking or, more generally, dogmatic behaviour: we expect regularities everywhere and attempt to find them even where there are none; events which do not yield to these attempts we are inclined to treat as a kind of 'background noise'; and we stick to our expectations even when they are inadequate and we ought to accept defeat. This dogmatism is to some extent necessary. It is demanded by a situation which can only be dealt with by forcing our conjectures upon the world. Moreover, this dogmatism allows us to approach a good theory in stages, by way of approximations: if we accept defeat too easily, we may prevent ourselves from finding that we were very nearly right.

It is clear that this dogmatic attitude; which makes us stick to our first impressions, is indicative of a strong belief; while a critical attitude, which is ready to modify its tenets, which admits doubt and demands

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 443

According to the passage, the role of a dogmatic attitude of dogmatic behaviour in the development of science is

- A critical and important, as, without it, initial hypotheses or conjectures can never be made.
- B positive, as conjectures arising out of our dogmatic attitude become science.
- C negative, as it leads to pseudo-science.
- D neutral, as the development of science is essentially because of our critical attitude.
- E inferior to critical attitude, as a critical attitude leads to the attitude of reasonableness and rationality.

Our propensity to look out for regularities, and to impose laws upon nature, leads to the psychological phenomenon of dogmatic thinking or, more generally, dogmatic behaviour: we expect regularities everywhere and attempt to find them even where there are none; events which do not yield to these attempts we are inclined to treat as a kind of 'background noise'; and we stick to our expectations even when they are inadequate and we ought to accept defeat. This dogmatism is to some extent necessary. It is demanded by a situation which can only be dealt with by forcing our conjectures upon the world. Moreover, this dogmatism allows us to approach a good theory in stages, by way of approximations: if we accept defeat too easily, we may prevent ourselves from finding that we were very nearly right.

It is clear that this dogmatic attitude; which makes us stick to our first impressions, is indicative of a strong belief; while a critical attitude, which is ready to modify its tenets, which admits doubt and demands

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Understanding where you are in the world is a basic survival skill, which is why we, like most species come hard-wired with specialised brain areas to create cognitive maps of our surroundings. Where humans are unique, though, with the possible exception of honeybees, is that we try to communicate this understanding of the world with others. We have a long history of doing this by drawing maps – the earliest versions yet discovered were scrawled on cave walls 14,000 years ago. Human cultures have been drawing them on stone tablets, papyrus, paper and now computer screens ever since.

Given such a long history of human map-making, it is perhaps surprising that it is only within the last few hundred years that north has been consistently considered to be at the top. In fact, for much of human history, north almost never appeared at the top, according to Jerry Brotton, a map historian... "North was rarely put at the top for the simple fact that north is where darkness comes from," he says. "West is also very unlikely to be put at the top because west is where the sun disappears."

Confusingly, early Chinese maps seem to buck this trend. But, Brotton, says, even though they did have compasses at the time, that isn't the reason that they placed north at the top. Early Chinese compasses were actually oriented to point south, which was considered to be more desirable than deepest darkest north. But in Chinese maps, the Emperor, who lived in the north of the country was always put at the top of the map, with everyone else, his loyal subjects, looking up towards him. "In Chinese culture the Emperor looks south because it's where the winds come from, it's a good direction. North is not very good but you are in a position of subjection to the emperor, so you look up to him," says Brotton.

Given that each culture has a very different idea of who, or what, they should look up to it's perhaps not surprising that there is very little consistency in which way early maps pointed. In ancient Egyptian times the top of the world was east, the position of sunrise. Early Islamic maps favoured south at the top because most of the early Muslim cultures were north of Mecca, so they imagined looking up (south) towards it. Christian maps from the same era (called Mappa Mundi) put east at the top, towards the Garden of Eden and with Jerusalem in the centre.

So when did everyone get together and decide that north was the top? It's tempting to put it down to European explorers like Christopher Columbus and Ferdinand Megellan, who were navigating by the North Star. But Brotton argues that these early explorers didn't think of the world like that at all. "When Columbus describes the world it is in accordance with east being at the top, he says. "Columbus says he is going towards paradise, so his mentality is from a medieval mappa mundi." We've got to remember, adds Brotton, that at the time, "no one knows what they are doing and where they are going."

Question 444

Which one of the following best describes what the passage is trying to do?

- A** It questions an explanation about how maps are designed.
- B** It corrects the misconception about the way maps are designed.
- C** It critiques a methodology used to create maps.
- D** It explores some myths about maps.

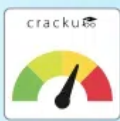
Understanding where you are in the world is a basic survival skill, which is why we, like most species, come hard-wired with specialised brain areas to create cognitive maps of our surroundings. Where humans are unique, though, with the possible exception of honeybees, is that we try to communicate this understanding of the world with others. We have a long history of doing this by drawing maps — the earliest versions yet discovered were scrawled on cave walls 14,000 years ago. Human cultures have been drawing them on stone tablets, papyrus, paper and now computer screens ever since.

Given such a long history of human map-making, it is perhaps surprising that it is only within the last few hundred years that north has been consistently considered to be at the top. In fact,

VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Score Calculator



Question 445

The role of natural phenomena in influencing map-making conventions is seen most clearly in

- A early Egyptian maps
- B early Islamic maps
- C early Chinese maps
- D early Christian maps

Understanding where you are in the world is a basic survival skill, which is why we, like most species, come hard-wired with specialised brain areas to create cognitive maps of our surroundings. Where humans are unique, though, with the possible exception of honeybees, is that we try to communicate this understanding of the world with others. We have a long history of doing this by drawing maps — the earliest versions yet discovered were scrawled on cave walls 14,000 years ago. Human cultures have been drawing them on stone tablets, papyrus, paper and now computer screens ever since.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 446

It can be inferred from the passage that European explorers like Columbus and Megellan

- A set the precedent for north-up maps
- B navigated by the compass
- C used an eastward orientation for religious reasons
- D navigated with the help of early maps

cracku

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 447

Which one of the following about the northern orientation of modern maps is asserted in the passage?

- A The biggest contributory factor was the understanding of magnetic north.
- B The biggest contributory factor was the role of European explorers.
- C The biggest contributory factor was the influence of Christian maps.
- D The biggest contributory factor is not stated in the passage.

cracku

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VIDEO SOLUTION

cracku

CAT Crash Course

Live Classes by IIMA alumni

Question 448

Early maps did NOT put north at the top for all the following reasons EXCEPT

- A North was the source of darkness.
- B South was favoured by some emperors.
- C East and south were more important for religious reasons for some civilisations.
- D East was considered by some civilisations to be a more positive direction.

Understanding where you are in the world is a basic survival skill, which is why we, like most species, come hard-wired with specialised brain areas to create cognitive maps of our surroundings. Where humans are unique, though, with the possible exception of honeybees, is that we try to communicate this understanding of the world with others. We have a long history of doing this by drawing maps — the earliest versions yet discovered were scrawled on cave walls 14,000 years ago. Human cultures have been drawing them on stone tablets, papyrus, paper and now computer screens ever since.

Given such a long history of human map-making, it is perhaps surprising that it is only within the last few hundred years that north has been consistently considered to be at the top. In fact,

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 449

According to the passage, early Chinese maps placed north at the top because

- A the Chinese invented the compass and were aware of magnetic north.
- B they wanted to show respect to the emperor.
- C the Chinese emperor appreciated the winds from the south.
- D north was considered the most desirable direction.

Understanding where you are in the world is a basic survival skill, which is why we, like most species, come hard-wired with specialised brain areas to create cognitive maps of our surroundings. Where humans are unique, though, with the possible exception of honeybees, is that we try to communicate this understanding of the world with others. We have a long history of doing this by drawing maps — the earliest versions yet discovered were scrawled on cave walls 14,000 years ago. Human cultures have been drawing them on stone tablets, papyrus, paper and now computer screens ever since.

Given such a long history of human map-making, it is perhaps surprising that it is only within the last few hundred years that north has been consistently considered to be at the top. In fact,

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

This year alone, more than 8,600 stores could close, according to industry estimates, many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court. Already there have been 5,300 retail closings this year... Sears Holdings — which owns Kmart — said in March that there's "substantial doubt" it can stay in business altogether, and will close 300 stores this year. So far this year, nine national retail chains have filed for bankruptcy.

Local jobs are a major casualty of what analysts are calling, with only a hint of hyperbole, the retail apocalypse. Since 2002, department stores have lost 448,000 jobs, a 25% decline, while the number of store closures this year is on pace to surpass the worst depths of the Great Recession. The growth of online retailers, meanwhile, has failed to offset those losses, with the e-commerce sector adding just 178,000 jobs over the past 15 years. Some of those jobs can be found in the massive distribution centers Amazon has opened across the country, often not too far from malls the company helped shutter.

But those are workplaces, not gathering places. The mall is both. And in the 61 years since the first enclosed one opened in suburban Minneapolis, the shopping mall has been where a huge swath of middle-class America went for far more than shopping. It was the home of first jobs and blind dates, the place for family photos and ear piercings, where goths and grandmothers could somehow walk through the same doors and find something they all liked. Sure, the food was lousy for you and the oceans of parking lots encouraged car-heavy development, something now scorned by contemporary planners. But for better or worse, the mall has been America's public square for the last 60 years.

So what happens when it disappears?

Think of your mall. Or think of the one you went to as a kid. Think of the perfume clouds in the department stores. The fountains splashing below the skylights. The cinnamon wafting from the food court. As far back as ancient Greece, societies have congregated around a central marketplace. In medieval Europe, they were outside cathedrals. For half of the 20th century and almost 20 years into the new one, much of America has found their agora on the terrazzo between Orange Julius and Sbarro, Waldenbooks and the Gap, Sunglass Hut and Hot Topic.

That mall was an ecosystem unto itself, a combination of community and commercialism peddling everything you needed and everything you didn't: Magic Eye posters, wind catchers, Air Jordans....

A growing number of Americans, however, don't see the need to go to any Macy's at all. Our digital lives are frictionless and ruthlessly efficient, with retail and romance available at a click. Malls were designed for leisure, abundance, ambling. You parked and planned to spend some time. Today, much of that time has been given over to busier lives and second jobs and apps that let you swipe right instead of haunt the food court. Malls, says Harvard business professor Leonard Schlesinger, "were built for patterns of social interaction that increasingly don't exist."

Question 450

The central idea of this passage is that:

- A the closure of malls has affected the economic and social life of middle-class America.
- B Is the advantages of malls outweigh their disadvantages.
- C malls used to perform a social function that has been lost.
- D malls are closing down because people have found alternate ways to shop.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

This year alone, more than 8,600 stores could close, according to industry estimates, many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court. Already there have been 5,300 retail closings this year...Sears Holdings — which owns Kmart — said in March that there's "substantial doubt" it can stay in business altogether, and will close 300 stores this year. So far this year, nine national retail chains have filed for bankruptcy.

Local jobs are a major casualty of what analysts are calling, with only a hint of hyperbole, the retail apocalypse. Since 2002, department stores

VIDEO SOLUTION

5000+ CAT Questions

Cracku CAT Questions

Question 451

Why does the author say in paragraph 2, 'the massive distribution centers Amazon has opened across the country, often not too far from malls the company helped shutter'?

- A To highlight the irony of the situation.
- B To indicate that malls and distribution centres are located in the same area.
- C To show that Amazon is helping certain brands go online.
- D To indicate that the shopping habits of the American middle class have changed.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

This year alone, more than 8,600 stores could close, according to industry estimates, many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court. Already there have been 5,300 retail closings this year... Sears Holdings — which owns Kmart — said in March that there's "substantial doubt" it can stay in business. Altogether, and will close 300 stores this year. So far this year, nine national retail chains have filed for bankruptcy.

Local jobs are a major casualty of what analysts are calling, with only a hint of hyperbole, the retail apocalypse. Since 2002, department stores

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 452

In the first paragraph, the phrase "real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court..." suggests that they

- A took brand-name anchor outlets to court.
- B no longer pursue brand-name anchor outlets.
- C collaborated with one another to get brand-name anchor outlets.
- D were eager to get brand-name anchor outlets to set up shop in their mall.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

This year alone, more than 8,600 stores could close, according to industry estimates, many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court. Already there have been 5,300 retail closings this year... Sears Holdings — which owns Kmart — said in March that there's "substantial doubt" it can stay in business. Altogether, and will close 300 stores this year. So far this year, nine national retail chains have filed for bankruptcy.

Local jobs are a major casualty of what analysts are calling, with only a hint of hyperbole, the retail apocalypse. Since 2002, department stores

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 453

Why does the author say that the mall has been America's public square?

- A Malls did not bar anybody from entering the space.
- B Malls were a great place to shop for a huge section of the middle class.
- C Malls were a hangout place where families grew close to each other.
- D Malls were a great place for everyone to gather and interact.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

This year alone, more than 8,600 stores could close, according to industry estimates, many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court. Already there have been 5,300 retail closings this year... Sears Holdings — which owns Kmart — said in March that there's "substantial doubt" it can stay in business altogether, and will close 300 stores this year. So far this year, nine national retail chains have filed for bankruptcy.

Local jobs are a major casualty of what analysts are calling, with only a hint of hyperbole, the retail apocalypse. Since 2002, department stores

VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Daily Targets

Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile

Question 454

The author calls the mall an ecosystem unto itself because

- A people of all ages and from all walks of life went there.
- B people could shop as well as eat in one place.
- C it was a commercial space as well as a gathering place.
- D it sold things that were needed as well as those that were not.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

This year alone, more than 8,600 stores could close, according to industry estimates, many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court. Already there have been 5,300 retail closings this year... Sears Holdings — which owns Kmart — said in March that there's "substantial doubt" it can stay in business altogether, and will close 300 stores this year. So far this year, nine national retail chains have filed for bankruptcy.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 455

The author describes 'Perfume clouds in the department stores' in order to

- A evoke memories by painting a picture of malls.
- B describe the smells and sights of malls.
- C emphasise that all brands were available under one roof.
- D show that malls smelt good because of the various stores and food court.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

This year alone, more than 8,600 stores could close, according to industry estimates, many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that local estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court. Already there have been 5,300 retail closings this year...Sears Holdings — which owns Kmart — said in March that there's "substantial doubt" it can stay in business. Altogether, and will close 300 stores this year. So far this year, nine national retail chains have filed for bankruptcy.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of three questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Do sports mega events like the summer Olympic Games benefit the host city economically? It depends, but the prospects are less than rosy. The trick is converting...several billion dollars in operating costs during the 17-day fiesta of the Games into a basis for long-term economic returns. These days, the summer Olympic Games themselves generate total revenue of \$4 billion to \$5 billion, but the lion's share of this goes to the International Olympics Committee, the National Olympics Committees and the International Sports Federations. Any economic benefit would have to flow from the value of the Games as an advertisement for the city, the new transportation and communications infrastructure that was created for the Games, or the ongoing use of the new facilities.

Evidence suggests that the advertising effect is far from certain. The infrastructure benefit depends on the initial condition of the city and the effectiveness of the planning. The facilities benefit is dubious at best for buildings such as velodromes or natatoriums and problematic for 100,000-seat Olympic stadiums. The latter require a conversion plan for future use, the former are usually doomed to near vacancy. Hosting the summer Games generally requires 30-plus sports venues and dozens of training centers. Today, the Bird's Nest in Beijing sits virtually empty, while the Olympic Stadium in Sydney costs some \$30 million a year to operate.

Part of the problem is that Olympics planning takes place in a frenzied and time-pressured atmosphere of intense competition with the other prospective host cities — not optimal conditions for contemplating the future shape of an urban landscape. Another part of the problem is that urban land is generally scarce and growing scarcer. The new facilities often stand for decades or longer. Even if they have future use, are they the best use of precious urban real estate?

Further, cities must consider the human cost. Residential areas often are razed and citizens relocated (without adequate preparation or compensation). Life is made more hectic and congested. There are, after all, other productive uses that can be made of vanishing fiscal resources.

Question 456

Sports facilities built for the Olympics are not fully utilised after the Games are over because

- A their scale and the costs of operating them are large.
- B their location away from the city centre usually limits easy access.

- C the authorities do not adapt them to local conditions.
- D they become outdated having being built with little planning and under time pressure.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of three questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Do sports mega events like the summer Olympic Games benefit the host city economically? It depends, but the prospects are less than rosy. The trick is converting... several billion dollars in operating cost... during the 17-day fiesta of the Games into a bar... or long-term economic returns. These days, the summer Olympic Games themselves generate total revenue of \$4 billion to \$5 billion, but the lion's share of this goes to the International Olympics Committee, the National Olympics Committees and the International Sports Federations. Any economic benefit would have to flow from the value of the Games as an advertisement for the city, the new transportation and communications infrastructure that was created for the Games, or the ongoing use of the new facilities.

Evidence suggests that the advertising effect is far from certain. The infrastructure benefit depends on the initial condition of the city and the effectiveness of the planning. The facilities benefit is dubious at best.

Economic benefits of hosting olympics is converted in the long term through advertisements to the city and infrastructure created.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 457

The central point in the first paragraph is that the economic benefits of the Olympic Games

- A are shared equally among the three organising committees.
- B accrue mostly through revenue from advertisements and ticket sales.
- C accrue to host cities, if at all, only in the long term.
- D are usually eroded by expenditure incurred by the host city.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of three questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Do sports mega events like the summer Olympic Games benefit the host city economically? It depends, but the prospects are less than rosy. The trick is converting... several billion dollars in operating cost... during the 17-day fiesta of the Games into a bar... or long-term economic returns. These days, the summer Olympic Games themselves generate total revenue of \$4 billion to \$5 billion, but the lion's share of this goes to the International Olympics Committee, the National Olympics Committees and the International Sports Federations. Any economic benefit would have to flow from the value of the Games as an advertisement for the city, the new transportation and communications infrastructure that was created for the Games, or the ongoing use of the new facilities.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 458

The author feels that the Games place a burden on the host city for all of the following reasons EXCEPT that

- A they divert scarce urban land from more productive uses.
- B they involve the demolition of residential structures to accommodate sports facilities and infrastructure.

- C the finances used to fund the Games could be better used for other purposes.
- D the influx of visitors during the Games places a huge strain on the urban infrastructure.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of three questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Do sports mega events like the summer Olympic Games benefit the host city economically? It depends, but the prospects are less than rosy. The trick is converting... several billion dollars in operating cost during the 17-day fiesta of the Games into a bar... or long-term economic returns. These days, the summer Olympic Games themselves generate total revenue of \$4 billion to \$5 billion, but the lion's share of this goes to the International Olympics Committee, the National Olympics Committees and the International Sports Federations. Any economic benefit would have to flow from the value of the Games as an advertisement for the city, the new transportation and communications infrastructure that was created for the Games, or the ongoing use of the new facilities.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The end of mutual funds, when it came, was sudden but not unexpected. For over 10 years, mutual fund has been scripting its own growth demise, embarking on a reckless course of high risks, unhealthy pastimes, and unchecked maladies. Ironically but fittingly too, the very hand that had supported and sustained it through the turbulent early period of its existence was the one that, finally wielded the euthanasian syringe. The individual investor it was who had made the mutual fund post-liberalisation, India's most vibrant vehicle for individual investment. The individual investor it was who brought the curtain down on an act that had started with a virtuoso performance, only to putrefy into a show of ineptitude, imprudence, and irresponsibility.

The mutual fund, as we know it, may be dead. It died of many things. But, primarily, of a cancer that ate away at its innards. A cancer that destroyed the value of the investments, the mutual funds was made to service the Rs. 85,000 crore that India's investors had entrusted them with ever since they began life way back in 1964 as The Unit Trust Of India's (UTI), now disgraced Unit Scheme 64(US 64). A cancer that grew from the refusal of the men and women to manage the mutual fund to exercise a mixture of caution and aggression, but to adopt, instead, an indisciplined, unplanned, fire-from-the hip approach to investment. A cancer that ultimately, robbed the mutual funds of the resources they would have to use to pay back their investors, leaving them on Death Row. Indeed, the scandal that US 64 had been brewing for years, was only one, but not the first, of the warning bells that pointed to the near emptiness of many a mutual fund's coffers. In quick succession have emerged reports of more and more fund-schemes that have been laid bare, their corpses empty, their ability to meet their promises of assured returns to investors demolished. At least 37 per cent of the 235 fund schemes in operation in the country have promised investors assured returns of over 15 per cent for 5 years, and repurchase-prices well above their Net Asset Values (NAVs).

According to a study conducted by the Delhi-based Value Research, at least 18 big schemes due for redemption over the next three years will be unable to service their investors, or even return their money at the time of redemption. The shortfall? Rs. 4,685.10 crore. Or 75.87 per cent of the amount handed over by trusting investors to fund managers. Worries Ajai Kaul, 38, president, Alliance Capital Asset Management: "When an assured-returns scheme runs into problems, investors view it as one more let-down by the mutual funds." Had they but known of the actual practices seen in the offices and hallways of the mutual funds, which have translated into these results, investors would have shown their disgust long ago.

Take the case of a mutual fund company that manages more than a dozen schemes. According to an unwritten, but formalised, principle, each scheme takes it in turn to sell some of its holdings to its sister-schemes, booking fat notional gains and posting NAVs. While investors responded by pouring in even more of their savings, the profits were clearly only on paper. In the offices of another asset management company half way across Mumbai, the demand for cellular-phones peaked six months ago. Its employees had, suddenly, realised that making their personal deals using information gathered in the course of their professional work, was best done

over cell phones so that the company's records wouldn't show the call being made. Obviously, the hot tips went to fatten their — and not investors' — pockets. Earlier, quite a few merchant bankers entered the mutual funds industry to use the corpus to subscribe to the issues they were managing. It took a crash in the primary market — not ethics or investigations — for this practice to stop. Filled with fear and loathing — and righteous anger — the investor has, therefore, decided to adjure the mutual fund. According to Marketing And Development Research Associates (MDRA) opinion poll of 342 investors conducted last fortnight in the five metros — Bangalore, Kolkata, Chennai, Delhi and Mumbai — mutual funds as an investment instrument now ranks a lowly fourth on safety — after bank deposits, gold, and real estate — and fifth on returns — ahead only of bank deposits and gold. And only 14.20 per cent of the sample will even consider investing in a mutual fund in the future. Still, it is the species that has died, not its every member. The ones that have survived are the bright performers who beat the market benchmark — the 100 — scrip. The Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) National Index — by the widest margins within their three genres: growth, income and balance. However, even their star turns have not been able to stave off the stench of death over the business. In fact, an autopsy of the late — and, at the moment not particularly lamented — mutual funds reveal a sordid saga of callousness and calumny. Sheer disaster stares the mutual funds in the face and a cataclysm could destroy the savings of lakhs of investors too. A Value Research estimate of probable shortfall that 18 assured-returns schemes will face at the time of their scheduled redemptions over the three years adds up to a sense-numbing Rs. 4,685 crore. An independent audit of the 60 assured-returns schemes managed by the public sector mutual funds conducted by Price Waterhouse Coopers at the behest of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) estimated a shortfall of between Rs. 2,500 crore and Rs. 3,000 crore. In 1999 alone judging from their present NAVs, the four schemes due for redemption — Canbank Asset Management Company's Cantriple, IndBank Asset Management Company's IndPrakash, SBI Funds Management's Magnum Triple Plus, and BOI Mutual Fund's (BOIMF) Double Square Plus — are heading for a collective shortfall of Rs. 1,639.55 crore.

As of June 30, 1998, the country's 252 fund-schemes managed assets with a market value of Rs. 69,599 crore, with the UTI alone controlling the fate of Rs. 50,000 crore. That is Rs. 11,000 crore less than the money invested in these schemes as of June 30, 1997, which means that the mutual funds have wiped out Rs. 11,000 crore from the investors' hard earned money in the intervening 12 months. Of course, every fund is paying for the sins of the black sheep.

For, the villain of the piece was UTI and the 95 funds managed by the public sector banks and institutions, the value of whose corpuses fell from Rs. 66,748 crore to Rs. 57,350 crore in the past year. In fact, these funds contributed 85.40 per cent of the overall value-loss, with the private sector funds boosting their corpuses from Rs. 4,000 crore to Rs. 4,120 crore to lower the extent of the erosion. For investors, that has translated into an option of either exiting at a loss — or holding on in vain hope. On November 20, 1998, a depressing 77 per cent of the 58 listed fund schemes were quoting at discounts of between 5 per cent and 40 per cent to their NAVs. And what of the NAVs themselves? The units of a shoulder-slumping 15 per cent of the schemes were worth less than their par values. And US 64, of course continued to languish, with an estimated NAV of Rs. 9.68. Even if there are schemes that have performed individually well, that the mutual funds have collectively failed to deliver couldn't be more obvious. So investors' murderous mood can hardly be debated. Their genesis and growth reveals just what blinded the mutual funds to the possibility of failure. Forty per cent of the banks-and-insurance companies-promoted funds in operation were launched between 1987 and 1993, when the stock markets were bull-dominated. In a period that saw only one bear phase, the BSE Sensitivity Index (the Sensex) climbed by 346 per cent.

Being successful with equity investments required no skills; only investible funds. Nor was fund-raising a problem, as investors desperately sought ways to grab a piece of equity boom. Between 1984 and 1989, the mutual funds collected Rs. 13,455 crore as subscriptions, but, in the next five years, they picked up Rs. 45,573 crore. In January, 1994, the UTI's Mastergain mopped up a stunning Rs. 4,700 crore while the most awaited Morgan Stanley Growth — a showcase for the fabled fund-management metier of the foreign mutual funds — took in Rs. 1,000 crore in just three days. Low entry-barriers — a so called sound track-record, a general reputation of fairness and integrity, an application-fee of Rs. 25,000, a registration fee of Rs. 25 lakh and an annual fee of Rs. 2.50 lakh — made entering the business a snap. Explains Ajay Srinivasan, 34, CEO, Prudential ICICI Mutual Fund: "Mutual funds were misunderstood by investors. Everyone thought they were a one way ticket to a jackpot." Intoxicated, fund-managers poured in more and more of their corpuses into equity, ignoring the downsides, confident that the boom would last forever. In the process, they ignored the very concept of risk-

management, blithely ignoring the safety net of fixed-income instruments, and accusing those who advised caution of being cowards. In 1995, for instance, ABN estimated 70 per cent of the money being managed by the mutual funds had been funnelled into equity.

Whether they knew it or not, they were breaking away from the trend set by the mutual funds in the US, where the industry began by investing primarily in the money market, with only 25 per cent of their corpus set aside for stocks. Only in the past 15 years, after operating for more than seven decades, have those funds ventured into equity. Unfortunately, their success blinded the fund-managers to the fact that they were riding a wave-not navigating the treacherous seas. As Vivek Reddy, 36, CEO, Kothari-Pioneer Mutual Fund, puts it: "It was the stock market conditions that helped the mutual funds deliver returns, not superior investment skills." Then, the stock markets collapsed and never quite recovered. Between July 1997 and October 1998, the Sensex free-fell from 4306 to 2812 finally nullifying the theory that if you wait long enough, share-prices are always bound to rise. And the mutual fund, unused to a diet of falling equity indices, collapsed too. The quantum of money mopped up by the mutual fund may suggest that the reports of its extinction have been greatly exaggerated. In 1997-98, Indians entrusted Rs. 18,701 crore to the mutual funds, with new schemes alone mopping up Rs. 12,279 crore. Questions R. G Sharma, 58, CEO, LIC Mutual Fund: "How do you explain that Dhanvarsha 12 and Dhanvarsha 13, floated in April and September 1998, managed to mop up Rs. 335 crore?" Not quite a loss of faith, would you say? Think again. In those 12 months, those very investors also took away Rs. 16,227 crore in the form of repurchases and redemptions, leaving only Rs. 2,474 crore more in the hands of fund-managers. What's more, since none of the withdrawals could have been made from the new schemes, the old schemes, obviously, gave it all up, effectively yielding Rs. 9,805 crore to angry investors who took away their money. It is the same story this year: in the first quarter of 1998-99, old schemes collected Rs. 2,340 crore, compared to the new schemes' Rs. 1,735 crore but they gave up Rs. 2,749 crore ending up Rs. 409 crore poorer. Sure, some people are still putting money into the mutual funds. The real reason: money is flowing in from two genres of investors — neither of whom is the quintessential urban. The first comprises people in the semi-urban and rural areas, for whom names like the LIC and GIC still represent safety and assured schemes of income. Importantly, this category investor isn't clued into the financial markets, and is not, accordingly, aware of the problems that confront the mutual funds. Confirms Nikhil Khatau, 38, Managing Director, Sun F & C Asset Management: "That market is fairly stable. "However, as soon as the fundamental problems hit their dividend-paying ability, even the die hard mutual fund investor from India's villages and small towns — who, don't forget, has already been singed by the disappearance of thousands of nonbanking finance companies — will swear off their favourite investment vehicle. The second genre of investor explains why the private sector funds have been successful in soaking up large sums: 31.10 per cent of the total takings in 1997-98, and 10.70 per cent in the first quarter of 1998-99. They are the so called high net worth players — corporates and individuals — who in Khatau's terms, 'are aggressive about managing their wealth, and look closely at comparative performance'. While their fastidiousness has forced them to pick the private sector mutual funds, whose disclosures and performance has both been ahead of their public sector cousins, their interest does not represent every investor's disillusionment.

Question 459

According to the passage, one of the reasons for the euphoria in the mutual fund industry can be attributed to

- A the stock market boom in the late eighties and early nineties.
- B failure of the primary market.
- C Both a and b
- D Neither a nor b

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 460

According to the writer, one of the fallouts of the end of mutual funds is that

- A at least some of the big schemes due for redemption over the next three years will be unable to service their investors.
- B only very few of the big schemes due for redemption over the next three years will be unable to service their investors.
- C none of the big schemes due for redemption over the next three years will be able to service their investors.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 461

The end of mutual funds was carried out at the hands of

- A the government.
- B non-banking finance companies.
- C the individual investors.
- D banks.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 462

The increase in the number of cell phone subscriptions in the office of an asset management company was due to the fact that

- A calls made by employees for personal deals couldn't be lodged in the company's records.
- B employees found it easier to deal with investors without involving the company.
- C the company was scrupulous about maintaining correct records.
- D the company was unscrupulous in granting personal deals to the employees.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 463

According to the passage, mutual funds caused a loss of

- A Rs. 10,000 crore of the investors' money.
- B Rs. 11,000 crore of the investors' money.
- C Rs. 5,000 crore of the investors' money.

D Rs. 8,000 crore of the investors' money.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 464

On the basis of the passage, it may be said that, in terms of retrieving their money, the investors

- A are caught between the devil and the deep blue sea.
- B have a no-exit route.
- C have to make do with little or no gain.
- D will trust the few bright stars in the mutual fund industry.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 465

The current rank of the mutual fund industry in terms of safety and returns on deposits respectively is

- A third and fourth.
- B tenth and twelfth.
- C fourth and fifth.
- D It is not ranked at all.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 466

According to the passage, the flaws of the mutual funds lay in their

- A post-liberalisation syndrome.
- B imprudent and irresponsible handling.
- C stagnation.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 467

It can be inferred from the passage that

- A money was siphoned away outside the country by the mutual funds.
- B many of the mutual fund offices indulged in malpractice.

- C money invested in the mutual fund schemes were never returned to the investors.
- D a sustained attack by the media exposed the anomalies in the mutual fund industry.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 468

According to the passage, one of the reasons for the failure of the mutual funds was

- A their indisciplined approach to investment.
- B their devil-may-care approach to the world of finance.
- C their ability to deceive investors.
- D their inability to read the pulse of their investors.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions



Question 469

The amount of money entrusted to the care of the mutual funds was

- A Rs. 75,000 crore.
- B Rs. 80,000 crore.
- C Rs. 85,000 crore.
- D Rs. 82,000 crore.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

From ancient times, men have believed that, under certain peculiar circumstances, life could arise spontaneously: from the ooze of rivers could come eels and from the entrails of dead bulls, bees; worms from mud, and maggots from dead meat. This belief was held by Aristotle, Newton and Descartes, among many others, and apparently the great William Harvey too. The weight of centuries gradually disintegrated men's beliefs in the spontaneous origin of maggots and mice, but the doctrine of spontaneous generation clung tenaciously to the question of bacterial origin.

In association with Buffon, the Irish Jesuit priest John Needham declared that he could bring about at will the creation of living microbes in heat-sterilised broths, and presumably, in propitiation, theorised that God did not create living things directly but bade the earth and water to bring them forth. In his Dictionnaire Philosophique, Voltaire reflected that it was odd to read of Father Needham's claim while atheists conversely should deny a Creator yet attribute to themselves the power of creating eels. But, wrote Thomas Huxley, 'The great tragedy of science – the slaying of a beautiful hypothesis by an ugly fact – which is so constantly being enacted under the eyes of philosophers, was played, almost immediately, for the benefit of Buffon and Needham.

The Italian Abbé Spallanzani did an experiment. He showed that a broth sealed from the air while boiling never develops bacterial growths and hence never decomposes. To Needham's objection that Spallanzani had ruined his broths and the air above them by excessive boiling, the Abbé replied by breaking the seals of his flasks. Air

rushed in and bacterial growth began! But the essential conflict remained. Whatever Spallanzani and his followers did to remove seeds and contaminants was regarded by the spontaneous generationists as damaging to the 'vital force' from whence comes new life.

Thus, doubt remained, and into the controversy came the Titanic figure of Louis Pasteur. Believing that a solution to this problem was essential to the development of his theories concerning the role of bacteria in nature, Pasteur freely acknowledged the possibility that living bacteria very well might be arising anew from inanimate matter. To him, the research problem was largely a technical one: to repeat the work of those who claimed to have observed bacterial entry. For the one that contended that life did not enter from the outside, the proof had to go to the question of possible contamination. Pasteur worked logically. He found during the experiments that after prolonged boiling, a broth would ferment only when air was admitted to it. Therefore, he contended, either air contained a factor necessary for the spontaneous generation of life or viable germs were borne in by the air and seeded in the sterile nutrient broth. Pasteur designed ingenious flasks whose long S-shaped necks could be left open. Air was trapped in the sinuous glass tube. Broths boiled in these flask tubes remained sterile. When their necks were snapped to admit ordinary air, bacterial growth would then commence – but not in every case. An occasional flask would remain sterile presumably because the bacterial population of the air is unevenly distributed. The forces of spontaneous generation would not be so erratic. Continuous scepticism drove Pasteur almost to fanatical efforts to control the ingredients of his experiments to destroy the doubts of the most sceptical. He ranged from the mountain air of Montanvert, which he showed to be almost sterile, to those deep, clear wells whose waters had been rendered germfree by slow filtration through sandy soil. The latter discovery led to the familiar porcelain filters of the bacteriology laboratory. With pores small enough to exclude bacteria, solutions allowed to percolate through them could be reliably sterilised.

The argument raged on and soon spilled beyond the boundaries of science to become a burning religious and philosophical question of the day. For many, Pasteur's conclusions caused conflict because they seemed simultaneously to support the Biblical account of creation while denying a variety of other philosophical systems. The public was soon caught up in the crossfire of a vigorous series of public lectures and demonstrations by leading exponents of both views, novelists, clergymen, their adjuncts and friends. Perhaps the most famous of these evenings in the theatre – competing perhaps with a great debate between Huxley and Bishop Wiberforce for elegance of rhetoric – was Pasteur's public lecture at the Sorbonne on April 7, 1864. Having shown his audience the swan necked flasks containing sterile broths, he concluded, "And, therefore, gentlemen, I could point to that liquid and say to you, I have taken my drop of water from the immensity of creation, and I have taken it full of the elements appropriated to the development of inferior beings. And I wait, I watch, I question it! – begging it to recommence for me the beautiful spectacle of the first creation. But it is dumb, dumb since these experiments were begun several years ago; It is dumb because I have kept it from the only thing man does not know how to produce: from the germs that float in the air, from life, for life is a germ and a germ is life. Never will the doctrine of spontaneous generation recover from the mortal blow of this simple experiment." And it is not. Today these same flasks stand immutable: they are still free of microbial life.

It is an interesting fact that despite the ringing declaration of Pasteur, the issue did not die completely. And although far from healthy, it is not yet dead. In his fascinating biography of Pasteur, Rene Dubos has traced the later developments which saw new eruptions of the controversy, new technical progress and criticism, and new energetic figures in the breach of the battle such as Bastion, for, and the immortal Tyndall, against, the doctrine of spontaneous generation. There was also new 'sorrow' for Pasteur as he read years later, in 1877, the last jottings of the great physiologist Claude Bernard and saw in them the 'mystical' suggestion that yeast may arise from grape juice. Even at this late date, Pasteur was stirred to new experiments again to prove to the dead Bernard and his followers the correctness of his position.

It seems to me that spontaneous generation is not only a possibility, but a completely reasonable possibility which should never be relinquished from scientific thought. Before men knew of bacteria, they accepted the doctrine of spontaneous generation as the 'only reasonable alternative' to a belief in supernatural creation. But today, as we look for satisfaction at the downfall of the spontaneous generation hypothesis, we must not forget that science has rationally concluded that life once did originate on earth by spontaneous generation. It was really Pasteur's evidence against spontaneous generation that for the first time brought the whole difficult question of the origin of life before the scientific world. In the above controversy, what was unreasonable was the parade of men who claimed to have 'proved' or who resolutely 'believed in' spontaneous generation on the face of proof – not that spontaneous generation cannot occur – but that their work was shot through with

experimental error. The acceptable evidence also makes it clear that spontaneous generation, if it does not occur, must obviously be a highly improbable event under present conditions. Logic tells us that science can only prove an event improbable: it can never prove it impossible – and Gamow has appropriately remarked that nobody is really certain what would happen if a hermetically sealed can were opened after a couple of million years. Modern science agrees that it was highly improbable for life to have arisen in the pre-Cambrian seas, but it concluded, nevertheless, that there it did occur. With this, I think, Pasteur would agree.

Aside from their theoretical implications, these researchers had the great practical result of putting bacteriology on a solid footing. It was now clear how precisely careful one had to be to avoid bacterial contamination in the laboratory. We now knew what 'sterile' meant and we knew that there could be no such thing as 'partial sterilization'. The discovery of bacteria high in the upper atmosphere, in the mud of the deep sea bottom, in the waters of hot springs, and in the Arctic glaciers established bacterial ubiquity as almost absolute. In recognition of this Lord Lister introduced aseptic technique into the practice of surgery. It was the revolution in technique alone that made possible modern bacteriology and the subsequent research connecting bacteria to phenomena of human concern, research, which today is more prodigious than ever. We are just beginning to understand the relationship of bacteria to certain human diseases, to soil chemistry, nutrition, and the phenomenon of antibiosis, wherein a product of one organism (e.g. penicillin) is detrimental to another. It is not an exaggeration then to say that the emergence of the cell theory represents biology's most significant and fruitful advance. The realisation that all plants and animals are composed of cells which are essentially alike, that cells are all formed by the same fundamental division process, that the total organism is made up of activities and inter-relations of its individual cells, opened up horizons we have not even begun to approach. The cell is a microcosm of life, for in its origin, nature and continuity resides the entire problem of biology.

Question 470

According to the author,

- A it is an exaggeration to say that cell theory represents biology's most significant and fruitful advance.
- B Pasteur could not hold his own against the contenders.
- C cell theory rendered null and void all the other bacteriological theories of the time.
- D the emergence of the cell theory represents biology's most significant and fruitful advance.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 471

What according to the passage was Pasteur's declaration to the world?

- A Nobody could deny the work done by him.
- B Science would forever be indebted to his experiments in bacteriology.
- C The doctrine of spontaneous generation would never recover from the mortal blow dealt to it by his experiments.
- D Those who refused to acknowledge his experiments would regret their scepticism.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



Question 472

It can be inferred from the passage that

- A Huxley, Buffon and Needham were contemporaries.
- B Buffon, Needham, Voltaire and Huxley were contemporaries.
- C Voltaire wrote a treatise on Needham's claim.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 473

One of the results of the theoretical cross fire regarding bacteriology was that

- A partial sterilization as a possibility was ruled out.
- B aseptic technique was introduced in surgery.
- C the meaning of sterile was clear to all.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 474

Needham's theory that 'God did not create living things directly' was posited as

- A an attempt to support his assertion by religious doctrine.
- B an attempt to placate his religious peers.
- C an attempt at propitiating a possibly offended God or the religious psyche of the time.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF



Question 475

The porcelain filters of the bacteriology laboratories owed their descent to

- A Pasteur's homeland.
- B the well water of Montanvert that had been rendered germ-free by slow filtration through sandy oil.
- C Both a and b
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 476

One of the reasons for the conflict caused by Pasteur's experiments was that

- A they denied the existence of God as the creator.
- B they seemed simultaneously to support the Biblical account of creation while denying a variety of other philosophical systems.
- C academicians and scientists refused to accept his theories.
- D there were too many debates on the topic and this left the people confused.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 477

What according to the writer, was the problem with the proponents of spontaneous generation?

- A Their work had no scientific basis.
- B Their work was ruined by experimental errors.
- C Both a and b
- D Neither a nor b

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 478

Pasteur began his work on the basis of the contention that

- A either air contained a factor necessary for the spontaneous generation of life or viable germs were borne in by the air and seeded in the sterile nutrient broth.
- B after prolonged boiling, a broth would ferment only when air was admitted to it.
- C Both a and b
- D Neither a nor b

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 479

According to the passage,

- A Pasteur's precursors in the field worked on the basis of spontaneous generation.
- B unlike his predecessors, Pasteur worked on logical premises rather than arbitrary and spontaneous discoveries.
- C Pasteur stood to benefit largely from the work of his predecessors.
- D Pasteur developed the ideas set forth by Voltaire and Needham.

Instructions

The highest priced words are ghost-written by gagmen who furnish the raw material for comedy over the air and on the screen. They have a word-lore all their own, which they practise for five to fifteen hundred dollars a week, or fifteen dollars a gag at piece rates. That's sizable rate for confounding acrimony with matrimony, or extracting attar of roses from the other.

Quite apart from the dollar sign on it, gagmen's word-lore is worth a close look, if you are given to the popular American pastime of playing with words — or if you're part of the 40 per cent who make their living in the word trade. Gag writers' tricks with words point up the fact that we have two distinct levels of language: familiar, ordinary words that everybody knows; and more elaborate words that don't turn up so often, but many of which we need to know if we are to feel at home in listening and reading today.

To be sure gagmen play hob with the big words, making not sense but fun of them. They keep on confusing bigotry with bigamy, illiterate with illegitimate, monotony with monogamy, osculation with oscillation. They trade on the fact that for many of their listeners, these fancy terms linger in a twilight zone of meaning. It's their deliberate intent to make everybody feel cozy at hearing big words, jumbled up or smacked down. After all, such words loom up over-size in ordinary talk, so no wonder they get the bulldozer treatment from the gagmen.

Their wrecking technique incidentally reveals our language as full of tricky words, some with 19 different meanings, others which sound alike but differ in sense. To ring good punning changes, gag writers have to know their way around in the language. They don't get paid for ignorance, only for simulating it.

Their trade is a hard one, and they regard it as serious business. They never laugh at each other's jokes; rarely at their own. Like comediennesses, they are usually melancholy men in private life.

Fertile invention and ingenious fancy are required to clean up 'blue' burlesque gags for radio use. These shady gags are theoretically taboo on the air. However, a gag writer who can leave a faint trace of bluing when he launders the joke is all the more admired — and more highly paid. A gag that keeps the blue tinge is called a 'double intender', gag-land jargon for double entendre. The double meaning makes the joke funny at two levels. Children and other innocents hearing the crack for the first time take it literally, laughing at the surface humour; listeners who remember the original as they heard it in vaudeville or burlesque, laugh at the artfulness with which the blue tinge is disguised.

Another name for a double meaning of this sort is 'insinuendo'. This is a portmanteau word or 'combo', as the gagmen would label it, thus abbreviating combination. By telescoping insinuation and innuendo, they get insinuendo, on the principle of blend words brought into vogue by Lewis Carroll. 'Shock logic' is another favourite with gag writers. Supposedly a speciality of women comediennesses, it is illogical logic more easily illustrated than defined. A high school girl has to turn down a boy's proposal, she writes:

Dear Jerry, I'm sorry, but I can't get engaged to you. My mother thinks I am too young to be engaged and besides, I'm already engaged to another boy. Yours regretfully. Guess who.

Gag writers' lingo is consistently funnier than their gags. It should interest the slang-fancier. And like much vivid jargon developed in specialised trades and sports, a few of the terms are making their way into general use. Gimmick, for instance, in the sense either of a trick devised or the point of a joke, is creeping into the vocabulary of columnists and feature writers.

Even apart from the trade lingo, gagmen's manoeuvres are of real concern to anyone who follows words with a fully awakened interest. For the very fact that gag writers often use a long and unusual word as the hinge of a joke, or as a peg for situation comedy, tells us something quite significant: they are well aware of the limitations of the average vocabulary and are quite willing to cash in on its shortcomings.

When Fred Allens' joke-smiths work out a fishing routine, they have Allen referring to the bait in his most arch and solemn tones: "I presume you mean the legless invertebrate." This is the old minstrel trick, using a long fancy term, instead of calling a worm a worm. Chico Marx can stretch a pun over 500 feet of film, making it funnier all the time, as he did when he rendered, "Why a duck?"

And even the high-brow radio writers have taken advantage of gagmen's technique. You might never expect to hear on the air such words as lepidopterist and entymologist. Both occur in a very famous radio play by Norman Corvine, 'My client Curly', about an unusual caterpillar which would dance to the tune 'yes, sir, she's my baby' but remained inert to all other music. The dancing caterpillar was given a real New York buildup, which involved calling in the experts on butterflies and insects which travel under the learned names above. Corvine made mild fun of the fancy professional titles, at the same time explaining them unobtrusively.

There are many similar occasions where any one working with words can turn gagmen's trade secrets to account. Just what words do they think outside the familiar range? How do they pick the words that they 'kick around'? It is not hard to find out.

Question 480

When the writer says, "They don't get paid for ignorance, only for simulating it," he means to say

- A the audience likes to think the gag writers are an ignorant lot.
- B gag writers are terrific with insinuations.
- C simulating ignorance is the trick that makes gag writers tick.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT WhatsApp Group



Question 481

According to the passage, the second level of language is important if

- A one wants to feel at home reading and listening today.
- B one wants to be a gag writer.
- C one wants to understand clean entertainment.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 482

According to the writer, a large part of the American population

- A indulges in playing out the role of gag writers.
- B indulges in the word trade.
- C seeks employment in the gag trade for want of something better.
- D looks down on gag writers.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 483

Gag writers have influenced

- A television artistes.
- B radio writers.
- C circus clowns.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 484

According to the writer, gag writers thrive on

- A the double-layered aspect of language.
- B audience craze for double entendres.
- C vulgar innuendoes.
- D commonplace jugglery with language.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 485

In gag writers' trade

- A long words are abbreviated for effect.
- B parts of words are combined to produce a hilarious portmanteau effect.
- C long words play a major role.
- D Both b and c

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 486

The hallmark of gag writers is that they

- A ruin good, simple language.
- B have fun with words.
- C make better sense of words.
- D play with words to suit the audience's requirements.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

If Western civilization is in a state of permanent crisis, it is not far-fetched to suggest that there may be something wrong with its education. No civilization, I am sure, has ever devoted more energy and resources to organised education, and if we believe in nothing else, we certainly believe that education is, or should be, the key to everything. In fact, the belief in education is so strong that we treat it as the residual legatee of all our problems. If the nuclear age brings new danger; if the advance of genetics engineering opens the doors of new abuses; if commercialism brings new temptations, the answer must be more and better education. The modern way of life is becoming more complex: this means that everybody must become more highly educated.

"By 1984," it was said recently, "it will be desirable that the most ordinary of men is not embarrassed by the use of a logarithm table, the elementary concepts of the calculus, and by the definitions and uses of such words as electron, coulomb, and volt. He should further have become able not only to handle a pen, and ruler but also a magnetic tape, valve, and transistor.

The improvement of communications between individuals and groups depends on it." Most of all, it appears, the international situation calls for prodigious educational efforts. The classical statement on this point was delivered by Sir Charles (now Lord Snow) in his Rede Lecture some years ago:

To say that we must educate ourselves or perish, is a little more melodramatic than the facts warrant. To say we have to educate ourselves or watch a steep decline in our lifetime, is about right. According to Lord Snow, the Russians are apparently doing much better than anyone else and will 'have a clear edge', unless and until the Americans and we educate ourselves both sensibly and imaginatively'. Lord Snow, it will be recalled, talked about 'The Two Cultures and the Scientific Revolution' and expressed his concern that 'the intellectuals life of the whole of western society is increasingly being split into two polar groups . . . At one pole we have the literary intellectuals . . . at the other the scientists'. He deplores the 'gulf of mutual incomprehension' between these two groups and wants it bridged. It is quite clear how he thinks this 'bridging' operation is to be done; the aims of his educational policy would be, first, to get as many 'alpha-plus scientists as the country can throw up'; second, to train 'a much larger stratum of alpha professionals' to do the supporting research, high class design and development; third, to train 'thousands upon thousands' of other scientists and engineers; and finally, to train 'politicians, administrators, and entire community, who know enough science to have a sense of what the scientists are talking about'. If this fourth and last group can at least be educated enough to 'have sense' of what the real people, the scientists and engineers, are talking about, so Lord Snow seems to suggest, the gulf of mutual incomprehension between the 'Two Cultures' may be bridged.

These ideas on education, which are by no means unrepresentative of our times, leave one with the uncomfortable feeling that ordinary people, including politicians, administrators, and so forth, are really not much use, they have failed to make the grade: but, at least, they should be educated enough to have a sense of what is going on, and to know what the scientists mean when they talk to quote Lord Snow's example about the Second Law of Thermodynamics. It is an uncomfortable feeling, because the scientists never tire of telling us that the fruits of their labours are 'neutral': whether they enrich humanity or destroy it depends on how they are used.

And who is to decide how they are used? There is nothing in the training of scientists and engineers to enable them to take such decision, or else, what becomes of the neutrality of science? If so much reliance is today being placed in the power of education to enable ordinary people to cope with the problems thrown up by scientific and technological progress, then there must be something more to education than Lord Snow suggests. Can education help us to turn the potentiality into a reality to the benefit of man? To do so, the task of education would be, first and foremost the transmission of ideas of value, of what to do with our lives. There is no doubt also the need to transmit know-how but this must take second place, for it is obviously somewhat foolhardy to put great powers into the hands of people without making sure that they have a reasonable idea of what to do with them. At present, there can be little doubt that the whole of mankind is in mortal danger, not because we are short of scientific and technological know-how, but because we tend to use it destructively, without wisdom. More education can help us only if it produces more wisdom.

The essence of education, I suggested, is the transmission of values, but values do not help us to pick our way through life unless they have become our own, a part, so to say, of our mental make-up. This means that they are more than mere formulae or dogmatic assertions: that we think and feel with them, that they are the very instruments through which we like and interpret, and experience the world. When we think, we do not just think: we think with ideas. Our mind is not a blank, a tabula rasa. When we begin to think we can do so only because our mind is already filled with all sorts of ideas with which to think. All through our youth and adolescence, before the conscious and critical mind begins to act as a sort of censor and guardian at the threshold, ideas seep into our mind, multitudes of them. These years are, one might say, our Dark Ages during which we are nothing but inheritors; it is only in later years that we can gradually learn to sort out our inheritance. First of all, there is language. Each word is an idea. If the language which seeps into us during our Dark Ages is English, our mind is thereby furnished by a set of ideas which is significantly different from the set represented by Chinese, Russian, German, or even American. Apart from words there are the rules of putting them together: grammar, another bundle of ideas, the study of which has fascinated some modern philosophers to such an extent that they thought they could reduce the whole of philosophy to a study of grammar. All philosophers and others have always paid a great deal of attention to ideas seen as the result of thought and observation; but in modern times all too little attention has been paid to the study of the ideas which form the very instruments by which thought and observation proceed. On the basis of experience and conscious thought small ideas may easily be dislodged, but when it comes to bigger, more universal, or more subtle ideas, it may not be so easy to change them. Indeed, it is often difficult to become aware of them, as they are the instruments and not the result of our thinking just as you can see what is outside you, but cannot easily see that with which you see, the eye itself.

And even when one has become aware of them it is often impossible to judge them on the basis of ordinary experience. We often notice the existence of more or less fixed ideas in other people's minds — ideas with which they think without being aware of doing so. We then call them prejudices, which is logically quite correct because they have merely seeped into the mind and are in no way the result of judgement. But the word prejudice is generally applied to ideas that are patently erroneous and recognisable as such by anyone except the prejudiced man. Most of the ideas with which we think are not of that kind at all. To some of them, like those incorporated in words and grammar, the notions of truth or error cannot even be applied, others are quite definitely not prejudices but the result of a judgement; others again are tacit assumptions or presuppositions which may be very difficult to recognise. I say, therefore, that we think with or through ideas and that what we call thinking is generally the application of pre-existing ideas to a given situation or set of facts. When we think about, say the political situation.

we apply to that situation our political ideas, more or less systematically, and attempt to make that situation 'intelligible' to ourselves by means of these ideas. Similarly, everywhere else we evaluate the situation in the light of our value-ideas. The way in which we experience and interpret the world obviously depends very much indeed on the kind of ideas that fill our minds. If they are mainly small, weak, superficial, and incoherent, life will appear insipid, uninteresting, petty and chaotic. It is difficult to bear the resultant feeling of emptiness, and the vacuum of our minds may only too easily be filled by some big, fantastic notion-political or otherwise — which suddenly seem to illumine everything and to give meaning and purpose to our existence. We feel that education will help solve each new problem or complexity that arises. It needs no emphasis that herein lies one of the great dangers of our times. When people ask for education they normally mean something more than mere training, something more than mere knowledge of facts, and something more than a mere diversion.

Maybe they cannot themselves formulate precisely what they are looking for; but I think what they are really looking for is ideas that could make the world, and their own lives, intelligible to them. When a thing is intelligible you have a sense of participation; when a thing is unintelligible you have a sense of estrangement. 'Well, I don't know', you hear people say, as an impotent protest against the unintelligibility of the world as they meet it. If the mind cannot bring to the world a set — or, shall we say, a tool box — of powerful ideas, the world must appear to it as a chaos, a mass of unrelated phenomena, of meaningless events. Such a man is like a person in a strange world and without any signs of civilization, without maps or signposts or indicators of any kind. Nothing has any meaning to him; nothing can hold his vital interest; he has no means of making anything intelligible to himself.

Question 487

According to Lord Snow, which of the following groups needs to be educated enough to at least understand the works of scientists and engineers?

- A Politicians, administrators, and the entire community
- B Politicians and literary intellectuals
- C Politicians and the layman
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 488

According to the writer, Lord Snow sees the intellectual life of Western society as split between

- A the educated and the uneducated.
- B the government servants and the plebeians.
- C scientists and literary intellectuals.
- D administrators and intellectuals.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 489

The writer's contention in the passage is that the crisis in Western civilization can be explained by

- A the presence of some flaws in its education.
- B some inherent lack of coordination among its various elements.
- C some basic misunderstanding in its society.
- D the energy it has devoted to education.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 490

The author's assertion in the passage is that education's main responsibility is to

- A transmit ideas of value.
- B transmit technical knowledge.
- C Both a and b
- D transmit the values regarding human and societal norms.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 491

The author believes that

- A the gulf between science and literature needs to be bridged.
- B ideas should be maintained for a holistic view of society and its problems.
- C words are not ideas.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 492

What, according to the author, would be the definition of 'prejudice'?

- A Ideas that help people to identify with new situations.
- B Fixed ideas with which people think without being aware of doing so.
- C Ideas that people cull from experience in order to judge a situation.
- D Fixed ideas that see a person through the trials and tribulations of life.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 493

Thinking is

- A being.
- B knowing.
- C application of pre-existing ideas to a situation.
- D application of fixed ideas to a situation.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 494

Which of the following sentences is not true according to the author?

- A Values must be part of one's psyche.
- B Values are merely dogmatic assertions.
- C One identifies with values.
- D Values are the means to interpret and experience the world.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 495

In the passage, the writer questions

- A the neutrality of science.
- B scientists' stand on the neutrality of science.
- C scientists' stand on the neutrality of their labours.
- D Lord Snow's assertion regarding the potential of intellectuals in society.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 496

The writer seems to criticise the belief that

- A education gives rise to further complexities as civilization progresses.
- B all new problems and complexities can be tackled and solved by more and better education.
- C people need to learn more in order to earn more.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

When we teach engineering problems now, we ask students to come to a single “best” solution defined by technical ideals like low cost, speed to build, and ability to scale. This way of teaching primes students to believe that their decision-making is purely objective, as it is grounded in math and science. This is known as technical-social dualism, the idea that the technical and social dimensions of engineering problems are readily separable and remain distinct throughout the problem-definition and solution process.

Nontechnical parameters such as access to a technology, cultural relevancy or potential harms are deemed political and invalid in this way of learning. But those technical ideals are at their core social and political choices determined by a dominant culture focused on economic growth for the most privileged segments of society. By choosing to downplay public welfare as a critical parameter for engineering design, we risk creating a culture of disengagement from societal concerns amongst engineers that is antithetical to the ethical code of engineering.

In my field of medical devices, ignoring social dimensions has real consequences. . . . Most FDA-approved drugs are incorrectly dosed for people assigned female at birth, leading to unexpected adverse reactions. This is because they have been inadequately represented in clinical trials.

Beyond physical failings, subjective beliefs treated as facts by those in decision-making roles can encode social inequities. For example, spirometers, routinely used devices that measure lung capacity, still have correction factors that automatically assume smaller lung capacity in Black and Asian individuals. These racially based adjustments are derived from research done by eugenicists who thought these racial differences were biologically determined and who considered nonwhite people as inferior. These machines ignore the influence of social and environmental factors on lung capacity.

Many technologies for systemically marginalized people have not been built because they were not deemed important such as better early diagnostics and treatment for diseases like endometriosis, a disease that afflicts 10 percent of people with uteruses. And we hardly question whether devices are built sustainably, which has led

to a crisis of medical waste and health care accounting for 10 percent of U.S. greenhouse gas emissions.

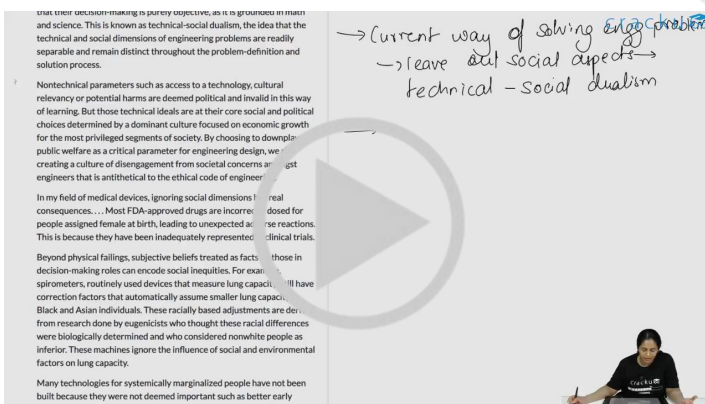
Social justice must be made core to the way engineers are trained. Some universities are working on this. . . . Engineers taught this way will be prepared to think critically about what problems we choose to solve, how we do so responsibly and how we build teams that challenge our ways of thinking.

Individual engineering professors are also working to embed societal needs in their pedagogy. Darshan Karwat at the University of Arizona developed activist engineering to challenge engineers to acknowledge their full moral and social responsibility through practical self-reflection. Khalid Kadir at the University of California, Berkeley, created the popular course Engineering, Environment, and Society that teaches engineers how to engage in place-based knowledge, an understanding of the people, context and history, to design better technical approaches in collaboration with communities. When we design and build with equity and justice in mind, we craft better solutions that respond to the complexities of entrenched systemic problems.

Question 497

The author gives all of the following reasons for why marginalised people are systematically discriminated against in technology-related interventions EXCEPT:

- A "But those technical ideals are at their core social and political choices determined by a dominant culture focused on economic growth for the most privileged segments of society."
- B "And we hardly question whether devices are built sustainably, which has led to a crisis of medical waste and health care accounting for 10 percent of U.S. greenhouse gas emissions."
- C "These racially based adjustments are derived from research done by eugenicists who thought these racial differences were biologically determined and who considered nonwhite people as inferior."
- D "Beyond physical failings, subjective beliefs treated as facts by those in decision-making roles can encode social inequities."



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 498

We can infer that the author would approve of a more evolved engineering pedagogy that includes all of the following EXCEPT:

- A making considerations of environmental sustainability intrinsic to the development of technological solutions.
- B a more responsible approach to technical design and problem-solving than a focus on speed in developing and bringing to scale.
- C design that is based on the needs of communities using local knowledge and responding to local priorities.

- D moving towards technical-social dualism where social community needs are incorporated in problem-definition and solutions.

that their decision-making is purely objective, as it is grounded in math and science. This is known as technical-social dualism, the idea that the technical and social dimensions of engineering problems are readily separable and remain distinct throughout the problem-definition and solution process.

Nontechnical parameters such as access to a technology, cultural relevancy or potential harms are deemed political and invalid in this way of learning. But those technical ideals are at their core social and political choices determined by a dominant culture focused on economic growth for the most privileged segments of society. By choosing to downplay public welfare as a critical parameter for engineering design, we are creating a culture of disengagement from societal concerns amongst engineers that is antithetical to the ethical code of engineering.

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Many technologies for systemically marginalized people have not been built because they were not deemed important such as better early

→ Current way of solving engg problem
→ leave out social aspects
technical - social dualism

VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 499

All of the following are examples of the negative outcomes of focusing on technical ideals in the medical sphere EXCEPT the:

- A neglect of research and development of medical technologies for the diagnosis and treatment of diseases that typically afflict marginalised communities.
- B continuing calibration of medical devices based on past racial biases that have remained unadjusted for changes.
- C exclusion of non-privileged groups in clinical trials which leads to incorrect drug dosages.
- D incorrect assignment of people as female at birth which has resulted in faulty drug interventions.

that their decision-making is purely objective, as it is grounded in math and science. This is known as technical-social dualism, the idea that the technical and social dimensions of engineering problems are readily separable and remain distinct throughout the problem-definition and solution process.

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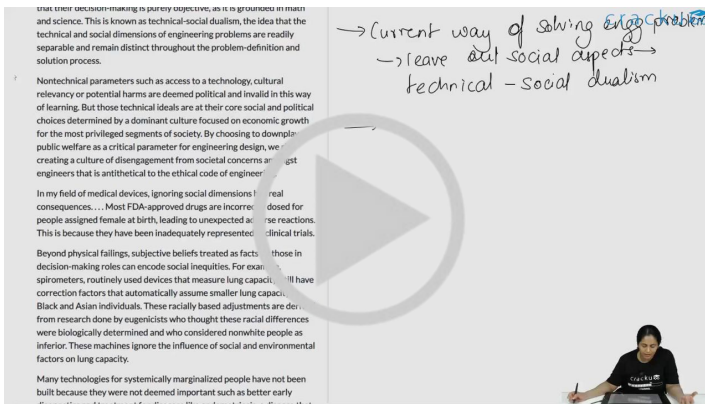
→ Current way of solving engg problem
→ leave out social aspects
technical - social dualism

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 500

In this passage, the author is making the claim that:

- A** the objective of best solutions in engineering has shifted the focus of pedagogy from humanism and social obligations to technological perfection.
- B** engineering students today are taught to focus on objective technical outcomes, independent of the social dimensions of their work.
- C** engineering students today are trained to be non-subjective in their reasoning as this best enables them to develop much-needed universal solutions.
- D** technical-social dualism has emerged as a technique for engineering students to incorporate social considerations into their technical problem-solving processes.



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Sociologists working in the Chicago School tradition have focused on how rapid or dramatic social change causes increases in crime. Just as Durkheim, Marx, Toennies, and other European sociologists thought that the rapid changes produced by industrialization and urbanization produced crime and disorder, so too did the Chicago School theorists. The location of the University of Chicago provided an excellent opportunity for Park, Burgess, and McKenzie to study the social ecology of the city. Shaw and McKay found . . . that areas of the city characterized by high levels of social disorganization had higher rates of crime and delinquency.

In the 1920s and 1930s Chicago, like many American cities, experienced considerable immigration. Rapid population growth is a disorganizing influence, but growth resulting from in-migration of very different people is particularly disruptive. Chicago's in-migrants were both native-born whites and blacks from rural areas and small towns, and foreign immigrants. The heavy industry of cities like Chicago, Detroit, and Pittsburgh drew those seeking opportunities and new lives. Farmers and villagers from America's hinterland, like their European cousins of whom Durkheim wrote, moved in large numbers into cities. At the start of the twentieth century, Americans were predominately a rural population, but by the century's mid-point, most lived in urban areas. The social lives of these migrants, as well as those already living in the cities they moved to, were disrupted by the differences between urban and rural life. According to social disorganization theory, until the social ecology of the "new place" can adapt, this rapid change is a criminogenic influence. But most rural migrants, and even many of the foreign immigrants to the city, looked like and eventually spoke the same language as the natives of the cities into which they moved. These similarities allowed for more rapid social integration for these migrants than was the case for African Americans and most foreign immigrants.

In these same decades, America experienced what has been called "the great migration": the massive movement of African Americans out of the rural South and into northern (and some southern) cities. The scale of this migration is one of the most dramatic in human history. These migrants, unlike their white counterparts, were not integrated into the cities they now called home. In fact, most American cities at the end of the twentieth century were characterized by high levels of racial residential segregation . . . Failure to integrate

these immigrants, coupled with other forces of social disorganization such as crowding, poverty, and illness, caused crime rates to climb in the cities, particularly in the segregated wards and neighbourhoods where the migrants were forced to live.

Foreign immigrants during this period did not look as dramatically different from the rest of the population as blacks did, but the migrants from eastern and southern Europe who came to American cities did not speak English, and were frequently Catholic, while the native born were mostly Protestant. The combination of rapid population growth with the diversity of those moving into the cities created what the Chicago School sociologists called social disorganization.

Question 501

The author notes that, "At the start of the twentieth century, Americans were predominately a rural population, but by the century's mid-point most lived in urban areas." Which one of the following statements, if true, does not contradict this statement?

- A Economists have found that throughout the twentieth century, the size of the labour force in America has always been largest in rural areas.
- B A population census conducted in 1952 showed that more Americans lived in rural areas than in urban ones.
- C The estimation of per capita income in America in the mid-twentieth century primarily required data from rural areas.
- D Demographic transition in America in the twentieth century is strongly marked by an out-migration from rural areas.



VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 502

A fundamental conclusion by the author is that:

- A according to European sociologists, crime in America is mainly in Chicago.
- B the best circumstances for crime to flourish are when there are severe racial disparities.
- C to prevent crime, it is important to maintain social order through maintaining social segregation.

- D rapid population growth and demographic diversity give rise to social disorganization that can feed the growth of crime.

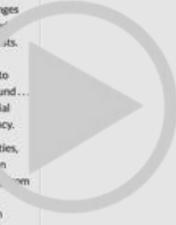
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→ Investigate link between rapid social change & crime



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 503

Which one of the following is not a valid inference from the passage?

- A The failure to integrate in-migrants, along with social problems like poverty, was a significant reason for the rise in crime in American cities.
- B According to social disorganisation theory, the social integration of African American migrants into Chicago was slower because they were less organised.
- C The differences between urban and rural lifestyles were crucial factors in the disruption experienced by migrants to American cities.
- D According to social disorganisation theory, fast-paced social change provides fertile ground for the rapid growth of crime.

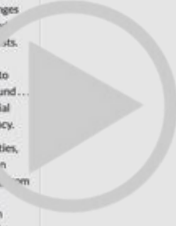
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The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Sociologists working in the Chicago School tradition have focused on how rapid or dramatic social change causes increases in crime. Just as Durkheim, Marx, Toennies, and other European sociologists thought that the rapid changes produced by industrialization and urbanization produced crime and disorder, so too did the Chicago School theorists. The location of the University of Chicago provided an excellent opportunity for Park, Burgess, and McKay to study the social ecology of the city. Shaw and McKay found that areas of the city characterized by high levels of social disorganization had higher rates of crime and delinquency.

In the 1920s and 1930s Chicago, like many American cities, experienced considerable immigration. Rapid population growth is a disorganizing influence, but growth resulting from immigration of very different people is particularly disruptive. Chicago's in-migrants were both native-born whites and blacks from rural areas and small towns, and foreign immigrants. The heavy industry of cities like Chicago, Detroit, and Pittsburgh drew those seeking opportunities and new lives. Farmers and villagers from America's hinterland,

→ Investigate link between rapid social change & crime



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 504

Which one of the following sets of words/phrases best encapsulates the issues discussed in the passage?

- A Chicago School; Native-born Whites; European immigrants; Poverty
- B Chicago School; Social organisation; Migration; Crime

C Durkheim; Marx; Toennies; Shaw

D Rapid population growth; Heavy industry; Segregation; Crime



The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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→ Investigate link between rapid social change & crime

VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Score Calculator

Instructions

Studies of the factors governing reading development in young children have achieved a remarkable degree of consensus over the past two decades. The consensus concerns the causal role of 'phonological skills in young children's reading progress. Children who have good phonological skills, or good 'phonological awareness' become good readers and good spellers. Children with poor phonological skills progress more poorly. In particular, those who have a specific phonological deficit are likely to be classified as dyslexic by the time that they are 9 or 10 years old.

Phonological skills in young children can be measured at a number of different levels. The term phonological awareness is a global one, and refers to a deficit in recognising smaller units of sound within spoken words. Development work has shown that this deficit can be at the level of syllables, of onsets and rimes, or phonemes. For example, a 4-year old child might have difficulty in recognising that a word like valentine has three syllables, suggesting a lack of syllabic awareness. A five-year-old might have difficulty in recognizing that the odd word out in the set of words fan, cat, hat, mat is fan. This task requires an awareness of the sub-syllabic units of the onset and the rime. The onset corresponds to any initial consonants in a syllable words, and the rime corresponds to the vowel and to any following consonants. Rimes correspond to rhyme in single-syllable words, and so the rime in fan differs from the rime in cat, hat and mat. In longer words, rime and rhyme may differ. The onsets in val:en:tine are /v/ and /t/, and the rimes correspond to the syllable patterns 'al', 'en' and 'ine'.

A six-year-old might have difficulty in recognising that plea and pray begin with the same initial sound. This is a phonemic judgement. Although the initial phoneme /p/ is shared between the two words, in plea it is part of the onset 'pl' and in pray it is part of the onset 'pr'. Until children can segment the onset (or the rime), such phonemic judgements are difficult for them to make. In fact, a recent survey of different developmental studies has shown that the different levels of phonological awareness appear to emerge sequentially. The awareness of syllables, onsets, and rimes appears to merge at around the ages of 3 and 4, long before most children go to school. The awareness of phonemes, on the other hand, usually emerges at around the age of 5 or 6, when children have been taught to read for about a year. An awareness of onsets and rimes thus appears to be a precursor of reading, whereas an awareness of phonemes at every serial position in a word only appears to develop as reading is taught. The onset-rime and phonemic levels of phonological structure, however, are not distinct. Many onsets in English are single phonemes, and so are some rimes (e.g. sea, go, zoo).

The early availability of onsets and rimes is supported by studies that have compared the development of phonological awareness of onsets, rimes, and phonemes in the same subjects using the same phonological awareness tasks. For example, a study by Treiman and Zudowski used a same/different judgement task based on the beginning or the end sounds of words. In the beginning sound task, the words either began with the same onset, as in plea and plank, or shared only the initial phoneme, as in plea and pray. In the end-sound task, the words either shared the entire rime, as in spit and wit, or shared only the final phoneme, as in rat and wit. Treiman and Zudowski showed that four- and five-year-old children found the onset-rime version of the same/different task significantly easier than the version based on phonemes. Only the six-year-olds, who had been learning to read for about a year, were able to perform both versions of the tasks with an equal level of success.

Question 505

From the following statements, pick out the true statement according to the passage.

- A A mono-syllabic word can have only one onset.
- B A mono-syllabic word can have only one rhyme but more than one rime.
- C A mono-syllabic word can have only one phoneme.
- D None of these



Positive link between phonological skills & reading progress

Studies of the factors governing reading development in young children have achieved a remarkable degree of consensus over the past two decades. The consensus concerns the causal role of 'phonological skills' in young children's reading progress. Children who have good phonological skills, or good 'phonological awareness' become good readers and good spellers. Children with poor phonological skills progress more poorly. In particular, those who have a specific 'phonological deficit' are likely to be classified as dyslexic by the time that they are 10 years old.

Phonological skills in young children can be measured at a number of different levels. The term 'phonological awareness' is a global one and refers to a deficit in recognising smaller units of sound within words. Developmental work has shown that this deficit can be at the level of syllables, onsets, rimes, or phonemes. For example, a 4-year old child might have difficulty recognizing that a word like valentine has three syllables, suggesting a lack of syllabic awareness. A five-year-old might have difficulty in recognizing that the odd word out in the list of words fan, cat, hat, mat is fan. This task requires an awareness of the sub-syllabic units of the onset and the rime. The onset corresponds to any initial consonants in a syllable, and the rime corresponds to the vowel and to any following consonants. Rimes correspond to rhyme in single-syllable words, and so the rime in fan differs from the rime in cat, hat and mat. In longer words, rime and rhyme may differ. The onsets in valentine are /v/ and /t/, and the rimes correspond to the syllable patterns 'al', 'en' and 'ine'.



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 506

Which one of the following is likely to emerge last in the cognitive development of a child?

- A Rhyme
- B Rime
- C Onset
- D Phoneme

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 507

A phonological deficit in which of the following is likely to be classified as dyslexia?

- A Phonemic judgement
- B Onset judgement
- C Rime judgement
- D Any one or more of the above

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Positive Link between phonological skills & reading progress

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VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 508

The single-syllable words Rhyme and Rime are constituted by the exact same set of

- A. rime(s)
- B. onset(s)
- C. rhyme(s)
- D. phonemes(s)

A A and B

- B A and C
- C A, B and C
- D B, C and D

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 509

The Treiman and Zudowski experiment found evidence to support which of the following conclusions?

- A At age six, reading instruction helps children perform both, the same-different judgement task.
- B The development of onset-rime awareness precedes the development of an awareness of phonemes.
- C At age four to five children find the onset-rime version of the same/different task significantly easier.
- D The development of onset-rime awareness is a necessary and sufficient condition for the development of an awareness of phonemes.



Positive link between phonological skills & reading progress

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[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

It's easy to forget that most of the world's languages are still transmitted orally with no widely established written form. While speech communities are increasingly involved in projects to protect their languages - in print, on air and online - orality is fragile and contributes to linguistic vulnerability. But indigenous languages are about much more than unusual words and intriguing grammar: They function as vehicles for the transmission of cultural traditions, environmental understandings and knowledge about medicinal plants, all at risk when elders die and livelihoods are disrupted.

Both push and pull factors lead to the decline of languages. Through war, famine and natural disasters, whole communities can be destroyed, taking their language with them to the grave, such as the indigenous populations of Tasmania who were wiped out by colonists. More commonly, speakers live on but abandon their language in favor of another vernacular, a widespread process that linguists refer to as "language shift" from which few languages are immune. Such trading up and out of a speech form occurs for complex political, cultural and economic reasons - sometimes voluntary for economic and educational reasons, although often amplified by state coercion or neglect. Welsh, long stigmatized and disparaged by the British state, has rebounded with vigor.

Many speakers of endangered, poorly documented languages have embraced new digital media with excitement. Speakers of previously exclusively oral tongues are turning to the web as a virtual space for languages to live on. Internet technology offers powerful ways for oral traditions and cultural practices to

survive, even thrive, among increasingly mobile communities. I have watched as videos of traditional wedding ceremonies and songs are recorded on smartphones in London by Nepali migrants, then uploaded to YouTube and watched an hour later by relatives in remote Himalayan villages . . .

Globalization is regularly, and often uncritically, pilloried as a major threat to linguistic diversity. But in fact, globalization is as much process as it is ideology, certainly when it comes to language. The real forces behind cultural homogenization are unbending beliefs, exchanged through a globalized delivery system, reinforced by the historical monolingualism prevalent in much of the West.

Monolingualism - the condition of being able to speak only one language - is regularly accompanied by a deep-seated conviction in the value of that language over all others. Across the largest economies that make up the G8, being monolingual is still often the norm, with multilingualism appearing unusual and even somewhat exotic. The monolingual mindset stands in sharp contrast to the lived reality of most the world, which throughout its history has been more multilingual than unilingual. Monolingualism, then, not globalization, should be our primary concern.

Multilingualism can help us live in a more connected and more interdependent world. By widening access to technology, globalization can support indigenous and scholarly communities engaged in documenting and protecting our shared linguistic heritage. For the last 5,000 years, the rise and fall of languages was intimately tied to the plow, sword and book. In our digital age, the keyboard, screen and web will play a decisive role in shaping the future linguistic diversity of our species.

Question 510

We can infer all of the following about indigenous languages from the passage EXCEPT that:

- A they are repositories of traditional knowledge about the environment and culture.
- B they are in danger of being wiped out as most can only be transmitted orally.
- C people are increasingly working on documenting these languages.
- D their vocabulary and grammatical constructs have been challenging to document.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Both push and pull factors lead to the decline of languages. Through war, famine and natural disasters, whole communities can be destroyed.

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Question 511

The author mentions the Welsh language to show that:

- A efforts to integrate Welsh speakers in the English-speaking fold have been fruitless.

- B languages can revive even after their speakers have gone through a "language shift".
- C vulnerable languages can rebound with state effort.
- D while often pilloried, globalisation can, in fact, support linguistic revival.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Both push and pull factors lead to the decline of languages. Through war, famine and natural disasters, whole communities can be destroyed.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

Question 512

From the passage, we can infer that the author is in favour of:

- A greater multilingualism.
- B "language shifts" across languages.
- C cultural homogenisation.
- D an expanded state role in the preservation of languages.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Both push and pull factors lead to the decline of languages. Through war, famine and natural disasters, whole communities can be destroyed.

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Question 513

The author lists all of the following as reasons for the decline or disappearance of a language EXCEPT:

- A a catastrophic event that entirely eliminates a people and their culture.
- B governments promoting certain languages over others.
- C the focus on only a few languages as a result of widespread internet use.

D people shifting away from their own language to study or work in another language.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Both push and pull factors lead to the decline of languages. Through war, famine and natural disasters, whole communities can be destroyed.

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CAT Daily Targets

Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Many people believe that truth conveys power. . . . Hence sticking with the truth is the best strategy for gaining power. Unfortunately, this is just a comforting myth. In fact, truth and power have a far more complicated relationship, because in human society, power means two very different things.

On the one hand, power means having the ability to manipulate objective realities: to hunt animals, to construct bridges, to cure diseases, to build atom bombs. This kind of power is closely tied to truth. If you believe a false physical theory, you won't be able to build an atom bomb. On the other hand, power also means having the ability to manipulate human beliefs, thereby getting lots of people to cooperate effectively. Building atom bombs requires not just a good understanding of physics, but also the coordinated labor of millions of humans. Planet Earth was conquered by Homo sapiens rather than by chimpanzees or elephants, because we are the only mammals that can cooperate in very large numbers. And large-scale cooperation depends on believing common stories. But these stories need not be true. You can unite millions of people by making them believe in completely fictional stories about God, about race or about economics. The dual nature of power and truth results in the curious fact that we humans know many more truths than any other animal, but we also believe in much more nonsense. . . .

When it comes to uniting people around a common story, fiction actually enjoys three inherent advantages over the truth. First, whereas the truth is universal, fictions tend to be local. Consequently if we want to distinguish our tribe from foreigners, a fictional story will serve as a far better identity marker than a true story. . . . The second huge advantage of fiction over truth has to do with the handicap principle, which says that reliable signals must be costly to the signaler. Otherwise, they can easily be faked by cheaters. . . . If political loyalty is signaled by believing a true story, anyone can fake it. But believing ridiculous and outlandish stories exacts greater cost, and is therefore a better signal of loyalty. . . . Third, and most important, the truth is often painful and disturbing. Hence if you stick to unalloyed reality, few people will follow you. An American presidential candidate who tells the American public the truth, the whole truth and nothing but the truth about American history has a 100 percent guarantee of losing the elections. . . . An uncompromising adherence to the truth is an admirable spiritual practice, but it is not a winning political strategy. . . .

Even if we need to pay some price for deactivating our rational faculties, the advantages of increased social cohesion are often so big that fictional stories routinely triumph over the truth in human history. Scholars have known this for thousands of years, which is why scholars often had to decide whether they served the truth or

social harmony. Should they aim to unite people by making sure everyone believes in the same fiction, or should they let people know the truth even at the price of disunity?

Question 514

The author would support none of the following statements about political power EXCEPT that:

- A there are definite advantages to promoting fiction, but there needs to be some limit to a pervasive belief in myths.
- B while unalloyed truth is not recommended, leaders should stay as close as possible to it.
- C manipulating people's beliefs is politically advantageous, but a leader who propagates only myths is likely to lose power.
- D people cannot handle the unvarnished truth, so leaders retain power by deviating from it.

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On the one hand, power means having the ability to manipulate objective realities: to hunt animals, to construct bridges, to cure diseases, to build atom bombs. This kind of power is closely tied to truth. If you believe a false physical theory, you won't be able to build an atom bomb. On the other hand, power also means having the ability to manipulate human beliefs, thereby getting lots of people to cooperate effectively. Building atom bombs requires not just a good understanding of physics, but also the coordinated labor of millions of humans. Planet Earth was conquered by Homo sapiens rather than by chimpanzees or elephants, because we are the only mammals that can cooperate in very large numbers. And large-scale cooperation depends on believing common stories. But these stories need not be true. You can unite millions of people by making them believe in

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 515

The author implies that, like scholars, successful leaders:

- A today know how to create social cohesion better than in the past.
- B use myths to attain the first type of power.
- C know how to balance truth and social unity.
- D need to leverage both types of power to remain in office.

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Question 516

Regarding which one of the following quotes could we argue that the author overemphasises the importance of fiction?

- “... scholars often had to decide whether they served the truth or social harmony. Should they aim to
- A unite people by making sure everyone believes in the same fiction, or should they let people know the truth...?”
 - B “On the one hand, power means having the ability to manipulate objective realities: to hunt animals, to construct bridges, to cure diseases, to build atom bombs.”
 - C “Hence sticking with the truth is the best strategy for gaining power. Unfortunately, this is just a comforting myth.”
 - D “In fact, truth and power have a far more complicated relationship, because in human society, power means two very different things.”

society, power means two very different things. cracku

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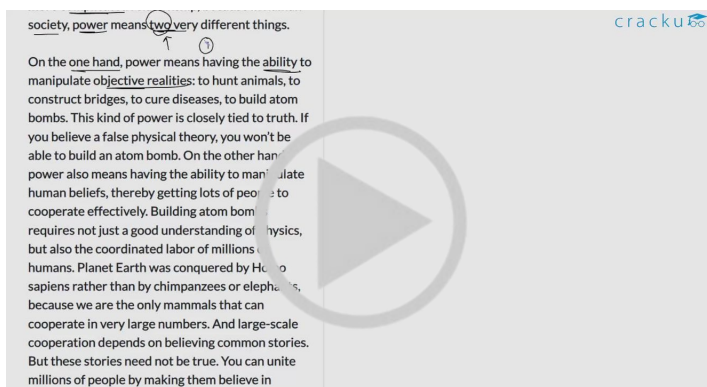
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Question 517

The central theme of the passage is about the choice between:

- A stories that unite people and those that distinguish groups from each other.
- B attaining social cohesion and propagating objective truth.
- C leaders who unknowingly spread fictions and those who intentionally do so.
- D truth and power.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Starting in 1957, [Noam Chomsky] proclaimed a new doctrine: Language, that most human of all attributes, was innate. The grammatical faculty was built into the infant brain, and your average 3-year-old was not a mere apprentice in the great enterprise of absorbing English from his or her parents, but a “linguistic genius.” Since this message was couched in terms of Chomskyan theoretical linguistics, in discourse so opaque that it was nearly incomprehensible even to some scholars, many people did not hear it. Now, in a brilliant, witty and altogether satisfying book, Mr. Chomsky's colleague Steven Pinker . . . has brought Mr. Chomsky's findings to everyman. In “The Language Instinct” he has gathered persuasive data from such diverse fields as cognitive neuroscience, developmental psychology and speech therapy to make his points, and when he disagrees with Mr. Chomsky he tells you so. . . .

For Mr. Chomsky and Mr. Pinker, somewhere in the human brain there is a complex set of neural circuits that have been programmed with “super-rules” (making up what Mr. Chomsky calls “universal grammar”), and that these rules are unconscious and instinctive. A half-century ago, this would have been pooh-poohed as a “black box” theory, since one could not actually pinpoint this grammatical faculty in a specific part of the brain, or describe its functioning. But now things are different. Neurosurgeons [have now found that this] “black box” is situated in and around Broca's area, on the left side of the forebrain. . . .

Unlike Mr. Chomsky, Mr. Pinker firmly places the wiring of the brain for language within the framework of Darwinian natural selection and evolution. He effectively disposes of all claims that intelligent nonhuman primates like chimps have any abilities to learn and use language. It is not that chimps lack the vocal apparatus to speak; it is just that their brains are unable to produce or use grammar. On the other hand, the “language instinct,” when it first appeared among our most distant hominid ancestors, must have given them a selective reproductive advantage over their competitors (including the ancestral chimps). . . .

So according to Mr. Pinker, the roots of language must be in the genes, but there cannot be a “grammar gene” any more than there can be a gene for the heart or any other complex body structure. This proposition will undoubtedly raise the hackles of some behavioral psychologists and anthropologists, for it apparently contradicts the liberal idea that human behavior may be changed for the better by improvements in culture and environment, and it might seem to invite the twin bugaboos of biological determinism and racism. Yet Mr. Pinker stresses one point that should allay such fears. Even though there are 4,000 to 6,000 languages today, they are all sufficiently alike to be considered one language by an extraterrestrial observer. In other words, most of the diversity of the world's cultures, so beloved to anthropologists, is superficial and minor compared to the similarities. Racial differences are literally only “skin deep.” The fundamental unity of humanity is the theme of Mr. Chomsky's universal grammar, and of this exciting book.

Question 518

From the passage, it can be inferred that all of the following are true about Pinker's book, “The Language Instinct”, EXCEPT that Pinker:

- A draws extensively from Chomsky's propositions.
- B disagrees with Chomsky on certain grounds.
- C draws from behavioural psychology theories.
- D writes in a different style from Chomsky.

question.

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For Mr. Chomsky and Mr. Pinker, somewhere in the

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Question 519

On the basis of the information in the passage, Pinker and Chomsky may disagree with each other on which one of the following points?

- A The language instinct.
- B The inborn language acquisition skills of humans.
- C The Darwinian explanatory paradigm for language.
- D The possibility of a universal grammar.

question.

Starting in 1957, [Noam Chomsky] proclaimed a new doctrine: language, that most human of all attributes, was innate. The grammatical faculty was built into the infant brain, and your average 3-year-old was not a mere apprentice in the great enterprise of absorbing English from his or her parents, but a "linguistic genius." Since this message was couched in terms of Chomskyan theoretical linguistics, in discourse so opaque that it was nearly incomprehensible even to some scholars, many people did not hear it. Now, in a brilliant, witty and altogether satisfying book, Mr. Chomsky's colleague Steven Pinker ... has brought Mr. Chomsky's findings to everyman. In "The Language Instinct" he has gathered persuasive data from such diverse fields as cognitive neuroscience, developmental psychology and speech therapy to make his points, and when he disagrees with Mr. Chomsky he tells you so. ...

For Mr. Chomsky and Mr. Pinker, somewhere in the

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Question 520

Which one of the following statements best summarises the author's position about Pinker's book?

- A Culture and environment play a key role in shaping our acquisition of language.
- B Anatomical developments like the voice box play a key role in determining language acquisition skills.
- C The evolutionary and deterministic framework of Pinker's book makes it racist.
- D The universality of the "language instinct" counters claims that Pinker's book is racist.

question.

Starting in 1957, [Noam Chomsky] proclaimed a new doctrine: language, that most human of all attributes, was innate. The grammatical faculty was built into the infant brain, and your average 3-year-old was not a mere apprentice in the great enterprise of absorbing English from his or her parents, but a "linguistic genius." Since this message was couched in terms of Chomskyan theoretical linguistics, in discourse so opaque that it was nearly incomprehensible even to some scholars, many people did not hear it. Now, in a brilliant, witty and altogether satisfying book, Mr. Chomsky's colleague Steven Pinker ... has brought Mr. Chomsky's findings to everyman. In "The Language Instinct" he has gathered persuasive data from such diverse fields as cognitive neuroscience, developmental psychology and speech therapy to make his points, and when he disagrees with Mr. Chomsky he tells you so. ...

For Mr. Chomsky and Mr. Pinker, somewhere in the

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 521

According to the passage, all of the following are true about the language instinct EXCEPT that:

- A all intelligent primates are gifted with it.
- B developments in neuroscience have increased its acceptance.
- C it confers an evolutionary reproductive advantage.
- D not all intelligent primates are gifted with it.

question.

Starting in 1957, [Noam Chomsky] proclaimed a new doctrine: language, that most human of all attributes, was innate. The grammatical faculty was built into the infant brain, and your average 3-year-old was not a mere apprentice in the great enterprise of absorbing English from his or her parents, but a "linguistic genius." Since this message was couched in terms of Chomskyan theoretical linguistics, in discourse so opaque that it was nearly incomprehensible even to some scholars, many people did not hear it. Now, in a brilliant, witty and altogether satisfying book, Mr. Chomsky's colleague Steven Pinker ... has brought Mr. Chomsky's findings to everyman. In "The Language Instinct" he has gathered persuasive data from such diverse fields as cognitive neuroscience, developmental psychology and speech therapy to make his points, and when he disagrees with Mr. Chomsky he tells you so. ...

For Mr. Chomsky and Mr. Pinker, somewhere in the

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Today we can hardly conceive of ourselves without an unconscious. Yet between 1700 and 1900, this notion developed as a genuinely original thought. The "unconscious" burst the shell of conventional language, coined as it had been to embody the fleeting ideas and the shifting conceptions of several generations until, finally, it

became fixed and defined in specialized terms within the realm of medical psychology and Freudian psychoanalysis.

The vocabulary concerning the soul and the mind increased enormously in the course of the nineteenth century. The enrichments of literary and intellectual language led to an altered understanding of the meanings that underlie time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords. At the same time, once coined, powerful new ideas attracted to themselves a whole host of seemingly unrelated issues, practices, and experiences, creating a peculiar network of preoccupations that as a group had not existed before. The drawn-out attempt to approach and define the unconscious brought together the spiritualist and the psychical researcher of borderline phenomena (such as apparitions, spectral illusions, haunted houses, mediums, trance, automatic writing); the psychiatrist or alienist probing the nature of mental disease, of abnormal ideation, hallucination, delirium, melancholia, mania; the surgeon performing operations with the aid of hypnotism; the magnetizer claiming to correct the disequilibrium in the universal flow of magnetic fluids but who soon came to be regarded as a clever manipulator of the imagination; the physiologist and the physician who puzzled over sleep, dreams, sleepwalking, anesthesia, the influence of the mind on the body in health and disease; the neurologist concerned with the functions of the brain and the physiological basis of mental life; the philosopher interested in the will, the emotions, consciousness, knowledge, imagination and the creative genius; and, last but not least, the psychologist.

Significantly, most if not all of these practices (for example, hypnotism in surgery or psychological magnetism) originated in the waning years of the eighteenth century and during the early decades of the nineteenth century, as did some of the disciplines (such as psychology and psychical research). The majority of topics too were either new or assumed hitherto unknown colors. Thus, before 1790, few if any spoke, in medical terms, of the affinity between creative genius and the hallucinations of the insane . . .

Striving vaguely and independently to give expression to a latent conception, various lines of thought can be brought together by some novel term. The new concept then serves as a kind of resting place or stocktaking in the development of ideas, giving satisfaction and a stimulus for further discussion or speculation. Thus, the massive introduction of the term unconscious by Hartmann in 1869 appeared to focalize many stray thoughts, affording a temporary feeling that a crucial step had been taken forward, a comprehensive knowledge gained, a knowledge that required only further elaboration, explication, and unfolding in order to bring in a bounty of higher understanding. Ultimately, Hartmann's attempt at defining the unconscious proved fruitless because he extended its reach into every realm of organic and inorganic, spiritual, intellectual, and instinctive existence, severely diluting the precision and compromising the impact of the concept.

Question 522

"The enrichments of literary and intellectual language led to an altered understanding of the meanings that underlie time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords." Which one of the following interpretations of this sentence would be closest in meaning to the original?

- A All of the options listed here.
- B Time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords were enriched by literary and intellectual language.
- C Literary and intellectual language was altered by time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords.
- D The meanings of time-honored expressions were changed by innovations in literary and intellectual language.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Today we can hardly conceive of ourselves without an unconscious. Yet between 1700 and 1900 this notion developed as a genuinely original thought. The "unconscious" burst the shell of conventional language, coined as it had been to embody fleeting ideas and the shifting conceptions of several generations until, finally, it became fixed and defined in specialized terms within the realm of medical psychology and Freudian psychoanalysis. The vocabulary concerning the soul and the mind increased enormously in the course of the nineteenth century. The enrichments of literary and intellectual language led to an altered understanding of the meanings that underlie time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords. At the same time, once coined, powerful new ideas

VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 523

All of the following statements may be considered valid inferences from the passage, EXCEPT:

- A Without the linguistic developments of the nineteenth century, the growth of understanding of the soul and the mind may not have happened.
- B Eighteenth century thinkers were the first to perceive a connection between creative genius and insanity.
- C New conceptions in the nineteenth century could provide new knowledge because of the establishment of fields such as anaesthesiology.
- D Unrelated practices began to be treated as related to each other, as knowledge of the mind grew in the nineteenth century.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Today we can hardly conceive of ourselves without an unconscious. Yet between 1700 and 1900 this notion developed as a genuinely original thought. The "unconscious" burst the shell of conventional language, coined as it had been to embody fleeting ideas and the shifting conceptions of several generations until, finally, it became fixed and defined in specialized terms within the realm of medical psychology and Freudian psychoanalysis. The vocabulary concerning the soul and the mind increased enormously in the course of the nineteenth century. The enrichments of literary and intellectual language led to an altered understanding of the meanings that underlie time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords. At the same time, once coined, powerful new ideas

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 524

Which one of the following statements best describes what the passage is about?

- A The discovery of the unconscious as a part of the human mind.
- B The growing vocabulary of the soul and the mind, as diverse processes.

- C The collating of diverse ideas under the single term: unconscious.
- D The identification of the unconscious as an object of psychical research.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Today we can hardly conceive of ourselves without an unconscious. Yet between 1700 and 1900 this notion developed as a genuinely original thought. The "unconscious" burst the shell of conventional language, coined as it had been to embody fleeting ideas and the shifting conceptions of several generations until finally, it became defined in specialized terms within the realm of medical psychology and Freudian psychoanalysis. The vocabulary concerning the soul and the mind increased enormously in the course of the nineteenth century. The enrichments of literary and intellectual language led to an altered understanding of the meanings that underlie time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords. At the same time, once coined, powerful new ideas

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 525

Which one of the following sets of words is closest to mapping the main arguments of the passage?

- A Unconscious; Latent conception; Dreams.
- B Literary language; Unconscious; Insanity.
- C Language; Unconscious; Psychoanalysis.
- D Imagination; Magnetism; Psychiatry.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Today we can hardly conceive of ourselves without an unconscious. Yet between 1700 and 1900 this notion developed as a genuinely original thought. The "unconscious" burst the shell of conventional language, coined as it had been to embody fleeting ideas and the shifting conceptions of several generations until finally, it became defined in specialized terms within the realm of medical psychology and Freudian psychoanalysis. The vocabulary concerning the soul and the mind increased enormously in the course of the nineteenth century. The enrichments of literary and intellectual language led to an altered understanding of the meanings that underlie time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords. At the same time, once coined, powerful new ideas

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Back in the early 2000s, an awesome thing happened in the New X-Men comics. Our mutant heroes had been battling giant robots called Sentinels for years, but suddenly these mechanical overlords spawned a new threat: Nano-Sentinels! Not content to rule Earth with their metal fists, these tiny robots invaded our bodies at the

microscopic level. Infected humans were slowly converted into machines, cell by cell.

Now, a new wave of extremely odd robots is making at least part of the Nano-Sentinels story come true. Using exotic fabrication materials like squishy hydrogels and elastic polymers, researchers are making autonomous devices that are often tiny and that could turn out to be more powerful than an army of Terminators. Some are 1-centimetre blobs that can skate over water. Others are flat sheets that can roll themselves into tubes, or matchstick-sized plastic coils that act as powerful muscles. No, they won't be invading our bodies and turning us into Sentinels - which I personally find a little disappointing - but some of them could one day swim through our bloodstream to heal us. They could also clean up pollutants in water or fold themselves into different kinds of vehicles for us to drive. . . .

Unlike a traditional robot, which is made of mechanical parts, these new kinds of robots are made from molecular parts. The principle is the same: both are devices that can move around and do things independently. But a robot made from smart materials might be nothing more than a pink drop of hydrogel. Instead of gears and wires, it's assembled from two kinds of molecules - some that love water and some that avoid it - which interact to allow the bot to skate on top of a pond.

Sometimes these materials are used to enhance more conventional robots. One team of researchers, for example, has developed a different kind of hydrogel that becomes sticky when exposed to a low-voltage zap of electricity and then stops being sticky when the electricity is switched off. This putty-like gel can be pasted right onto the feet or wheels of a robot. When the robot wants to climb a sheer wall or scoot across the ceiling, it can activate its sticky feet with a few volts. Once it is back on a flat surface again, the robot turns off the adhesive like a light switch.

Robots that are wholly or partly made of gloop aren't the future that I was promised in science fiction. But it's definitely the future I want. I'm especially keen on the nanometre-scale "soft robots" that could one day swim through our bodies. Metin Sitti, a director at the Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems in Germany, worked with colleagues to prototype these tiny, synthetic beasts using various stretchy materials, such as simple rubber, and seeding them with magnetic microparticles. They are assembled into a finished shape by applying magnetic fields. The results look like flowers or geometric shapes made from Tinkertoy ball and stick modelling kits. They're guided through tubes of fluid using magnets, and can even stop and cling to the sides of a tube.

Question 526

Which one of the following statements best captures the sense of the first paragraph?

- A People who were infected by Nano-Sentinel robots became mutants who were called X-Men.
- B Tiny sentinels called X-Men infected people, turning them into mutant robot overlords.
- C None of the options listed here.
- D The X-Men were mutant heroes who now had to battle tiny robots called Nano-Sentinels

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Back in the early 2000s, an awesome thing happened in the New X-Men comics. Our mutant heroes had been battling giant robots called Sentinels for years, but suddenly these mechanical overlords spawned a new threat: Nano-Sentinels! Not content to rule Earth with their metal fists, these tiny robots invaded our bodies at the microscopic level. Infected humans were slowly converted into machines, cell by cell.

Now, a new wave of extremely odd robots is making at least part of the Nano-Sentinels story come true. Using exotic fabrication materials like squishy hydrogels and elastic polymers, researchers are making autonomous devices that are often tiny and that could turn out to be more powerful than an army of Terminators. Some are 1-centimetre blobs

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 527

Which one of the following statements, if true, would be the most direct extension of the arguments in the passage?

- A Sentinel robots will be used in warfare to cause large-scale destructive mutations amongst civilians.
- B X-Men may be created by injecting people with mutant nano-gels that will respond to the brain's magnetic field.
- C In the future, robots will be used to search and destroy diseases even in the deepest recesses of the human body.
- D 1-centimetre blobs of gel that have nano-robots in them will be used to send messages.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Back in the early 2000s, an awesome thing happened in the New X-Men comics. Our mutant heroes had been battling giant robots called Sentinels for years, but suddenly these mechanical overlords spawned a new threat: Nano-Sentinels! Not content to rule Earth with their metal fists, these tiny robots invaded our bodies at the microscopic level. Infected humans were slowly converted into machines, cell by cell.

Now, a new wave of extremely odd robots is making at least part of the Nano-Sentinels story come true. Using exotic fabrication materials like squishy hydrogels and elastic polymers, researchers are making autonomous devices that are often tiny and that could turn out to be more powerful than an army of Terminators. Some are 1-centimetre blobs

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 528

Which one of the following statements best summarises the central point of the passage?

- A Robots will use nano-robots on their feet and wheels to climb walls or move on ceilings.
- B Nano-robots made from molecules that react to water have become increasingly useful.
- C Once the stuff of science fiction, nano-robots now feature in cutting-edge scientific research.
- D The field of robotics is likely to be featured more and more in comics like the New X-Men.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Back in the early 2000s, an awesome thing happened in the New X-Men comics. Our mutant heroes had been battling giant robots called Sentinels for years, but suddenly these mechanical overlords spawned a new threat: Nano-Sentinels! Not content to rule Earth with their metal fists, these tiny robots invaded our bodies at the microscopic level. Infected humans were slowly converted into machines, cell by cell.

Now, a new wave of extremely odd robots is making at least part of the Nano-Sentinels story come true. Using exotic fabrication materials like squishy hydrogels and elastic polymers, researchers are making autonomous devices that are often tiny and that could turn out to be more powerful than an army of Terminators. Some are 1-centimetre blobs

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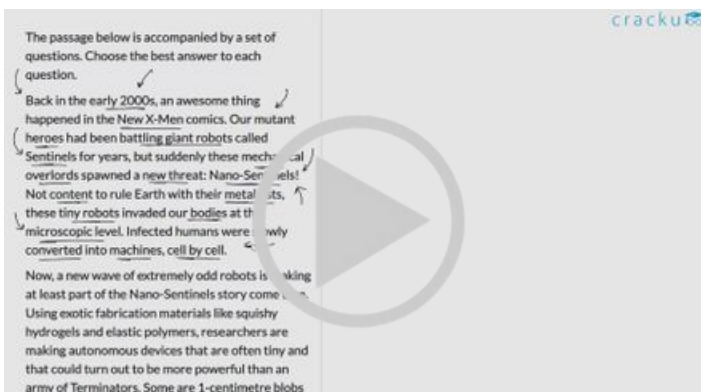
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Question 529

Which one of the following scenarios, if false, could be seen as supporting the passage?

- A Robots made from smart materials are likely to become part of our everyday lives in the future.
- B There are two kinds of molecules used to make some nano-robots: one that reacts positively to water and the other negatively.
- C Some hydrogels turn sticky when an electric current is passed through them; this potentially has very useful applications.
- D Nano-Sentinel-like robots are likely to be used to inject people to convert them into robots, cell by cell.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Keeping time accurately comes with a price. The maximum accuracy of a clock is directly related to how much disorder, or entropy, it creates every time it ticks. Natalia Ares at the University of Oxford and her colleagues made this discovery using a tiny clock with an accuracy that can be controlled. The clock consists of a 50-nanometre-thick membrane of silicon nitride, vibrated by an electric current. Each time the membrane moved up and down once and then returned to its original position, the researchers counted a tick, and the regularity of the spacing between the ticks represented the accuracy of the clock. The researchers found that as they increased the clock's accuracy, the heat produced in the system grew, increasing the entropy of its surroundings by jostling nearby particles . . . "If a clock is more accurate, you are paying for it somehow," says Ares. In this case, you pay for it by pouring more ordered energy into the clock, which is then converted into entropy. "By measuring time, we are increasing the entropy of the universe," says Ares. The more entropy there is in the universe, the closer it may be to its eventual demise. "Maybe we should stop measuring time," says Ares. The scale of the additional entropy is so small, though, that there is no need to worry about its effects, she says.

The increase in entropy in timekeeping may be related to the "arrow of time", says Marcus Huber at the Austrian Academy of Sciences in Vienna, who was part of the research team. It has been suggested that the reason that time only flows forward, not in reverse, is that the total amount of entropy in the universe is constantly increasing, creating disorder that cannot be put in order again.

The relationship that the researchers found is a limit on the accuracy of a clock, so it doesn't mean that a clock that creates the most possible entropy would be maximally accurate - hence a large, inefficient grandfather clock isn't more precise than an atomic clock. "It's a bit like fuel use in a car. Just because I'm using more fuel doesn't mean that I'm going faster or further," says Huber.

When the researchers compared their results with theoretical models developed for clocks that rely on quantum effects, they were surprised to find that the relationship between accuracy and entropy seemed to be the same for both. . . . We can't be sure yet that these results are actually universal, though, because there are many types of clocks for which the relationship between accuracy and entropy haven't been tested. "It's still unclear how this principle plays out in real devices such as atomic clocks, which push the ultimate quantum limits of accuracy," says Mark Mitchison at Trinity College Dublin in Ireland. Understanding this relationship could be helpful for designing clocks in the future, particularly those used in quantum computers and other devices where both accuracy and temperature are crucial, says Ares. This finding could also help us understand more generally how the quantum world and the classical world are similar and different in terms of thermodynamics and the passage of time.

Question 530

None of the following statements can be inferred from the passage EXCEPT that:

- A the arrow of time has not yet been tested for atomic clocks.
- B quantum computers are likely to produce more heat and, hence, more entropy, because of the emphasis on their clocks' accuracy.
- C grandfather clocks are likely to produce less heat and, hence, less entropy, because they are not as accurate.
- D a clock with a 50-nanometre-thick membrane of silicon nitride has been made to vibrate, producing electric currents.

electric current. Each time the membrane moved up and down once and then returned to its original position, the researchers counted a tick, and the regularity of the spacing between the ticks represented the accuracy of the clock. The researchers found that as they increased the clock's accuracy, the heat produced in the system grew, increasing the entropy of its surroundings by jostling nearby particles. . . . "If a clock is more accurate, you are paying for it somehow," says Ares. In this case, you pay for it by pouring more ordered energy into the clock, which is then converted into entropy. "By measuring time, we are increasing the entropy of the universe," says Ares. The more entropy there is in the universe, the closer it may be to its eventual demise. "Maybe we should stop measuring time," says Ares. The scale of the additional entropy is so small, though, that there is no need to worry about its effects, she says. The increase in entropy in timekeeping may be

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 531

"It's a bit like fuel use in a car. Just because I'm using more fuel doesn't mean that I'm going faster or further . . ." What is the purpose of this example?

- A If you go faster in a car, you will tend to consume more fuel, but the converse is not necessarily true. In the same way, increased entropy does not necessarily mean greater accuracy of a clock.
- B The further you go in a car, the more fuel you use. In the same way, the faster you go in a car, the less time you use.
- C If you measure the speed of a car with a grandfather clock, the result will be different than if you measured it with an atomic clock.
- D The further and faster you go in a car, the greater the amount of fuel you will use, the greater the amount of heat produced and, hence, the greater the entropy.

electric current. Each time the membrane moved up and down once and then returned to its original position, the researchers counted a tick, and the regularity of the spacing between the ticks represented the accuracy of the clock. The researchers found that as they increased the clock's accuracy, the heat produced in the system grew, increasing the entropy of its surroundings by jostling nearby particles ... "If a clock is more accurate, you are paying for it somehow," says Ares. In this case, you pay for it by pouring more ordered energy into the clock, which is then converted into entropy. "By measuring time, we are increasing the entropy of the universe," says Ares. The more entropy there is in the universe, the closer it may be to its eventual demise. "Maybe we should stop measuring time," says Ares. The scale of the additional entropy is so small, though, that there is no need to worry about its effects, she says. The increase in entropy in timekeeping may be

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Question 532

The author makes all of the following arguments in the passage, EXCEPT that:

- A The relationship between accuracy and entropy may not apply to all clocks.
- B Researchers found that the heat produced in a system is the price paid for increased accuracy of measurement.
- C There is no difference in accuracy between an inefficient grandfather clock and an atomic clock.
- D In designing clocks for quantum computers, both precision and heat have to be taken into account.

electric current. Each time the membrane moved up and down once and then returned to its original position, the researchers counted a tick, and the regularity of the spacing between the ticks represented the accuracy of the clock. The researchers found that as they increased the clock's accuracy, the heat produced in the system grew, increasing the entropy of its surroundings by jostling nearby particles ... "If a clock is more accurate, you are paying for it somehow," says Ares. In this case, you pay for it by pouring more ordered energy into the clock, which is then converted into entropy. "By measuring time, we are increasing the entropy of the universe," says Ares. The more entropy there is in the universe, the closer it may be to its eventual demise. "Maybe we should stop measuring time," says Ares. The scale of the additional entropy is so small, though, that there is no need to worry about its effects, she says. The increase in entropy in timekeeping may be

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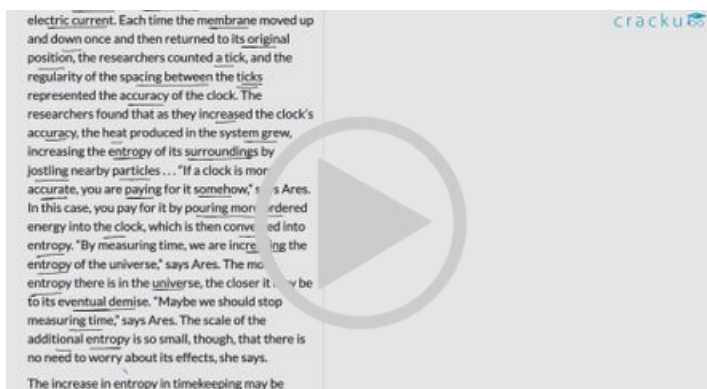
VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 533

Which one of the following sets of words and phrases serves best as keywords of the passage?

- A Electric current; Heat; Quantum effects.
- B Silicon Nitride; Energy; Grandfather Clock.
- C Measuring Time; Accuracy; Entropy.

D Membrane; Arrow of time; Entropy.



electric current. Each time the membrane moved up and down once and then returned to its original position, the researchers counted a tick, and the regularity of the spacing between the ticks represented the accuracy of the clock. The researchers found that as they increased the clock's accuracy, the heat produced in the system grew, increasing the entropy of its surroundings by jostling nearby particles. . . . "If a clock is more accurate, you are paying for it somehow," says Ares. In this case, you pay for it by pouring more ordered energy into the clock, which is then converted into entropy. "By measuring time, we are increasing the entropy of the universe," says Ares. The more entropy there is in the universe, the closer it may be to its eventual demise. "Maybe we should stop measuring time," says Ares. The scale of the additional entropy is so small, though, that there is no need to worry about its effects, she says.

The increase in entropy in timekeeping may be

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

As software improves, the people using it become less likely to sharpen their own know-how. Applications that offer lots of prompts and tips are often to blame; simpler, less solicitous programs push people harder to think, act and learn.

Ten years ago, information scientists at Utrecht University in the Netherlands had a group of people carry out complicated analytical and planning tasks using either rudimentary software that provided no assistance or sophisticated software that offered a great deal of aid. The researchers found that the people using the simple software developed better strategies, made fewer mistakes and developed a deeper aptitude for the work. The people using the more advanced software, meanwhile, would often "aimlessly click around" when confronted with a tricky problem. The supposedly helpful software actually short-circuited their thinking and learning.

[According to] philosopher Hubert Dreyfus . . . our skills get sharper only through practice, when we use them regularly to overcome different sorts of difficult challenges. The goal of modern software, by contrast, is to ease our way through such challenges. Arduous, painstaking work is exactly what programmers are most eager to automate—after all, that is where the immediate efficiency gains tend to lie. In other words, a fundamental tension ripples between the interests of the people doing the automation and the interests of the people doing the work.

Nevertheless, automation's scope continues to widen. With the rise of electronic health records, physicians increasingly rely on software templates to guide them through patient exams. The programs incorporate valuable checklists and alerts, but they also make medicine more routinized and formulaic—and distance doctors from their patients. . . . Harvard Medical School professor Beth Lown, in a 2012 journal article . . . warned that when doctors become "screen-driven," following a computer's prompts rather than "the patient's narrative thread," their thinking can become constricted. In the worst cases, they may miss important diagnostic signals. . . .

In a recent paper published in the journal *Diagnosis*, three medical researchers . . . examined the misdiagnosis of Thomas Eric Duncan, the first person to die of Ebola in the U.S., at Texas Health Presbyterian Hospital Dallas. They argue that the digital templates used by the hospital's clinicians to record patient information probably helped to induce a kind of tunnel vision. "These highly constrained tools," the researchers write, "are optimized for data capture but at the expense of sacrificing their utility for appropriate triage and diagnosis, leading users to miss the forest for the trees." Medical software, they write, is no "replacement for basic history-taking, examination skills, and critical thinking." . . .

There is an alternative. In "human-centred automation," the talents of people take precedence. . . . In this model, software plays an essential but secondary role. It takes over routine functions that a human operator has already mastered, issues alerts when unexpected situations arise, provides fresh information that expands the

operator's perspective and counters the biases that often distort human thinking. The technology becomes the expert's partner, not the expert's replacement.

Question 534

In the Ebola misdiagnosis case, we can infer that doctors probably missed the forest for the trees because:

- A they were led by the data processed by digital templates
- B the data collected were not sufficient for appropriate triage.
- C the digital templates forced them to acquire tunnel vision.
- D they used the wrong type of digital templates for the case.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

As software improves, the people using it become less likely to sharpen their own know-how. Applications that offer lots of prompts and tips are often to blame; simpler, less solicitous programs push people harder to think, act and learn.

Ten years ago, information scientists at Utrecht University in the Netherlands had a group of people carry out complicated analytical and planning tasks using either rudimentary software that provided no assistance or sophisticated software that offered a great deal of aid. The researchers found that the people using the simple software developed better strategies, made fewer mistakes and developed a deeper aptitude for the work. The people using the more advanced software, meanwhile, would often "simply click

→ Programs with lot of prompts/nps → make us less independent thinkers

VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF



Question 535

From the passage, we can infer that the author is apprehensive about the use of sophisticated automation for all of the following reasons EXCEPT that:

- A it stunts the development of its users.
- B it could mislead people.
- C computers could replace humans.
- D it stops users from exercising their minds.

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The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Ten years ago, information scientists at Utrecht University in the Netherlands had a group of people carry out complicated analytical and planning tasks using either rudimentary software that provided no assistance or sophisticated software that offered a great deal of aid. The researchers found that the people using the simple software developed better strategies, made fewer mistakes and developed a deeper aptitude for the work. The people using the more advanced software, meanwhile, would often "aimlessly click

→ Programs with lot of prompts/tips → make us less independent thinkers



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 536

In the context of the passage, all of the following can be considered examples of human-centered automation EXCEPT:

- A medical software that provides optional feedback on the doctor's analysis of the medical situation.
- B a smart-home system that changes the temperature as instructed by the resident.
- C software that auto-completes text when the user writes an email.
- D software that offers interpretations when requested by the human operator.

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The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 537

It can be inferred that in the Utrecht University experiment, one group of people was "aimlessly clicking around" because:

- A they did not have the skill-set to address complicated tasks.
- B they were hoping that the software would help carry out the tasks.
- C the other group was carrying out the tasks more efficiently.
- D they wanted to avoid making mistakes.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

As software improves, the people using it become less likely to sharpen their own know-how. Applications that offer lots of prompts and tips are often to blame; simpler, less solicitous programs push people harder to think, act and learn.

Ten years ago, information scientists at Utrecht University in the Netherlands had a group of people carry out complicated analytical and planning tasks using either rudimentary software that provided no assistance or sophisticated software that offered a great deal of aid. The researchers found that the people using the simple software developed better strategies, made fewer mistakes and developed a deeper aptitude for the work. The people using the more advanced software, meanwhile, would often "simply click

→ Programs with lot of prompts/tips →
make us less independent thinkers

VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Important Topics

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The Positivists, anxious to stake out their claim for history as a science, contributed the weight of their influence to the cult of facts. First ascertain the facts, said the positivists, then draw your conclusions from them. . . . This is what may [be] called the common-sense view of history. History consists of a corpus of ascertained facts. The facts are available to the historian in documents, inscriptions, and so on . . . [Sir George Clark] contrasted the "hard core of facts" in history with the surrounding pulp of disputable interpretation forgetting perhaps that the pulpy part of the fruit is more rewarding than the hard core. . . . It recalls the favourite dictum of the great liberal journalist C. P. Scott: "Facts are sacred, opinion is free." . . .

What is a historical fact? . . . According to the common-sense view, there are certain basic facts which are the same for all historians and which form, so to speak, the backbone of history—the fact, for example, that the Battle of Hastings was fought in 1066. But this view calls for two observations. In the first place, it is not with facts like these that the historian is primarily concerned. It is no doubt important to know that the great battle was fought in 1066 and not in 1065 or 1067, and that it was fought at Hastings and not at Eastbourne or Brighton. The historian must not get these things wrong. But [to] praise a historian for his accuracy is like praising an architect for using well-seasoned timber or properly mixed concrete in his building. It is a necessary condition of his work, but not his essential function. It is precisely for matters of this kind that the historian is entitled to rely on what have been called the "auxiliary sciences" of history—archaeology, epigraphy, numismatics, chronology, and so forth. . . .

The second observation is that the necessity to establish these basic facts rests not on any quality in the facts themselves, but on an apriori decision of the historian. In spite of C. P. Scott's motto, every journalist knows today that the most effective way to influence opinion is by the selection and arrangement of the appropriate facts. It used to be said that facts speak for themselves. This is, of course, untrue. The facts speak only when the historian calls on them: it is he who decides to which facts to give the floor, and in what order or context. . . . The only reason why we are interested to know that the battle was fought at Hastings in 1066 is that historians regard it as a major historical event. . . . Professor Talcott Parsons once called [science] "a selective system of cognitive orientations to reality." It might perhaps have been put more simply. But history is, among other things, that. The historian is necessarily selective. The belief in a hard core of historical facts existing objectively and independently of the interpretation of the historian is a preposterous fallacy, but one which it is very hard to eradicate.

Question 538

All of the following, if true, can weaken the passage's claim that facts do not speak for themselves, EXCEPT:

- A the truth value of a fact is independent of the historian who expresses it.
- B a fact, by its very nature, is objective and universal, irrespective of the context in which it is placed.
- C facts, like truth, can be relative: what is fact for person X may not be so for person Y.
- D the order in which a series of facts is presented does not have any bearing on the production of meaning.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 539

If the author of the passage were to write a book on the Battle of Hastings along the lines of his/her own reasoning, the focus of the historical account would be on:

- A exploring the socio-political and economic factors that led to the Battle.
- B producing a detailed timeline of the various events that led to the Battle.
- C deriving historical facts from the relevant documents and inscriptions.
- D providing a nuanced interpretation by relying on the auxiliary sciences.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 540

All of the following describe the "common-sense view" of history, EXCEPT:

- A real history can be found in ancient engravings and archival documents.

- B only the positivist methods can lead to credible historical knowledge.
- C history is like science: a selective system of cognitive orientations to reality.
- D history can be objective like the sciences if it is derived from historical facts.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT WhatsApp Group

Question 541

According to this passage, which one of the following statements best describes the significance of archaeology for historians?

- A Archaeology helps historians to locate the oldest civilisations in history.
- B Archaeology helps historians to ascertain factual accuracy.
- C Archaeology helps historians to carry out their primary duty.
- D Archaeology helps historians to interpret historical facts.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Umberto Eco, an Italian writer, was right when he said the language of Europe is translation. Netflix and other deep-pocketed global firms speak it well. Just as the EU employs a small army of translators and interpreters to turn intricate laws or impassioned speeches of Romanian MEPs into the EU's 24 official languages, so do the likes of Netflix. It now offers dubbing in 34 languages and subtitling in a few more. . . .

The economics of European productions are more appealing, too. American audiences are more willing than before to give dubbed or subtitled viewing a chance. This means shows such as "Lupin", a French crime caper on Netflix, can become global hits. . . . In 2015, about 75% of Netflix's original content was American; now the figure is half, according to Ampere, a media-analysis company. Netflix has about 100 productions under way in Europe, which is more than big public broadcasters in France or Germany. . . .

Not everything works across borders. Comedy sometimes struggles. Whodunits and bloodthirsty maelstroms between arch Romans and uppity tribesmen have a more universal appeal. Some do it better than others. Barbarians aside, German television is not always built for export, says one executive, being polite. A bigger problem is that national broadcasters still dominate. Streaming services, such as Netflix or Disney+, account for about a third of all viewing hours, even in markets where they are well-established. Europe is an ageing continent. The generation of teens staring at phones is outnumbered by their elders who prefer to gawp at the box.

In Brussels and national capitals, the prospect of Netflix as a cultural hegemon is seen as a threat. "Cultural sovereignty" is the watchword of European executives worried that the Americans will eat their lunch. To be fair, Netflix content sometimes seems stuck in an uncanny valley somewhere in the mid-Atlantic, with local quirks stripped out. Netflix originals tend to have fewer specific cultural references than shows produced by domestic rivals, according to Enders, a market analyst. The company used to have an imperial model of commissioning, with executives in Los Angeles cooking up ideas French people might like. Now Netflix has offices across Europe. But ultimately the big decisions rest with American executives. This makes European politicians nervous.

They should not be. An irony of European integration is that it is often American companies that facilitate it. Google Translate makes European newspapers comprehensible, even if a little clunky, for the continent's non-polyglots. American social-media companies make it easier for Europeans to talk politics across borders. (That they do not always like to hear what they say about each other is another matter.) Now Netflix and friends pump the same content into homes across a continent, making culture a cross-border endeavour, too. If Europeans are to share a currency, bail each other out in times of financial need and share vaccines in a pandemic, then they need to have something in common—even if it is just bingeing on the same series. Watching fictitious northern and southern Europeans tear each other apart 2,000 years ago beats doing so in reality.

Question 542

Based only on information provided in the passage, which one of the following hypothetical Netflix shows would be most successful with audiences across the EU?

- A** An Italian comedy show hosted by an international star.
- B** An original German TV science fiction production.
- C** A murder mystery drama set in North Africa and France.
- D** A trans-Atlantic romantic drama set in Europe and America.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

 VIDEO SOLUTION

C a looming cultural threat.

D an economic threat.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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Not everything works across borders. Comedy sometimes struggles. Whodunits and bloodthirsty maelstroms between

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 545

Based on information provided in the passage, all of the following are true, EXCEPT:

- A European television productions have the potential to become global hits.
- B Netflix has been able to transform itself into a truly European entity.
- C only half of Netflix's original programming in the EU is now produced in America.
- D national broadcasters dominate in the EU in terms of total television viewing hours.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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Not everything works across borders. Comedy sometimes struggles. Whodunits and bloodthirsty maelstroms between

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The Second Hand September campaign, led by Oxfam . . . seeks to encourage shopping at local organisations and charities as alternatives to fast fashion brands such as Primark and Boohoo in the name of saving our planet. As innocent as mindless scrolling through online shops may seem, such consumers are unintentionally —or perhaps even knowingly —contributing to an industry that uses more energy than aviation. . . .

Brits buy more garments than any other country in Europe, so it comes as no shock that many of those clothes end up in UK landfills each year: 300,000 tonnes of them, to be exact. This waste of clothing is destructive to our planet, releasing greenhouse gasses as clothes are burnt as well as bleeding toxins and dyes into the

surrounding soil and water. As ecologist Chelsea Rochman bluntly put it, "The mismanagement of our waste has even come back to haunt us on our dinner plate."

It's not surprising, then, that people are scrambling for a solution, the most common of which is second-hand shopping. Retailers selling consigned clothing are currently expanding at a rapid rate . . . If everyone bought just one used item in a year, it would save 449 million lbs of waste, equivalent to the weight of 1 million Polar bears. "Thrifting" has increasingly become a trendy practice. London is home to many second-hand, or more commonly coined 'vintage', shops across the city from Bayswater to Brixton.

So you're cool and you care about the planet; you've killed two birds with one stone. But do people simply purchase a second-hand item, flash it on Instagram with #vintage and call it a day without considering whether what they are doing is actually effective?

According to a study commissioned by Patagonia, for instance, older clothes shed more microfibres. These can end up in our rivers and seas after just one wash due to the worn material, thus contributing to microfibre pollution. To break it down, the amount of microfibres released by laundering 100,000 fleece jackets is equivalent to as many as 11,900 plastic grocery bags, and up to 40 per cent of that ends up in our oceans. . . . So where does this leave second-hand consumers? [They would be well advised to buy] high-quality items that shed less and last longer [as this] combats both microfibre pollution and excess garments ending up in landfills. . . .

Luxury brands would rather not circulate their latest season stock around the globe to be sold at a cheaper price, which is why companies like ThredUP, a US fashion resale marketplace, have not yet caught on in the UK. There will always be a market for consignment but there is also a whole generation of people who have been taught that only buying new products is the norm; second-hand luxury goods are not in their psyche. Ben Whitaker, director at Liquidation Firm B-Stock, told Prospect that unless recycling becomes cost-effective and filters into mass production, with the right technology to partner it, "high-end retailers would rather put brand before sustainability."

Question 546

The central idea of the passage would be undermined if:

- A customers bought all their clothes online.
- B clothes were not thrown and burnt in landfills
- C second-hand stores sold only high-quality clothes.
- D Primark and Boohoo recycled their clothes for vintage stores

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The Second Hand September campaign, led by Oxfam... seeks to encourage shopping at local organisations and charities as alternatives to fast fashion brands such as Primark and Boohoo in the name of saving our planet. As innocent as mindless scrolling through online shops may seem, such consumers are unintentionally—or perhaps even knowingly—contributing to an industry that uses more energy than aviation...

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CAT Online Coaching
your road to IIM stars here

Question 547

The act of “thrifting”, as described in the passage, can be considered ironic because it:

- A has created environmental problems.
- B is not cost-effective for retailers
- C offers luxury clothing at cut-rate prices.
- D is an anti-consumerist attitude.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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Question 548

According to the author, companies like ThredUP have not caught on in the UK for all of the following reasons EXCEPT that:

- A recycling is currently not financially attractive for luxury brands.
- B luxury brands want to maintain their brand image.
- C luxury brands do not like their product to be devalued.
- D the British don’t buy second-hand clothing.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 549

Based on the passage, we can infer that the opposite of fast fashion, ‘slow fashion’, would most likely refer to clothes that:

- A are of high quality and long lasting.
- B do not bleed toxins and dyes.
- C are sold by genuine vintage stores.
- D do not shed microfibres.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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CAT Previous Papers
with detailed video solutions and analysis

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Over the past four centuries liberalism has been so successful that it has driven all its opponents off the battlefield. Now it is disintegrating, destroyed by a mix of hubris and internal contradictions, according to Patrick Deneen, a professor of politics at the University of Notre Dame. . . . Equality of opportunity has produced a new meritocratic aristocracy that has all the aloofness of the old aristocracy with none of its sense of noblesse oblige. Democracy has degenerated into a theatre of the absurd. And technological advances are reducing ever more areas of work into meaningless drudgery. "The gap between liberalism's claims about itself and the lived reality of the citizenry" is now so wide that "the lie can no longer be accepted," Mr Deneen writes. What better proof of this than the vision of 1,000 private planes whisking their occupants to Davos to discuss the question of "creating a shared future in a fragmented world"? . . .

Deneen does an impressive job of capturing the current mood of disillusionment, echoing leftwing complaints about rampant commercialism, right-wing complaints about narcissistic and bullying students, and general worries about atomisation and selfishness. But when he concludes that all this adds up to a failure of liberalism, is his argument convincing? . . . He argues that the essence of liberalism lies in freeing individuals from constraints. In fact, liberalism contains a wide range of intellectual traditions which provide different answers to the question of how to trade off the relative claims of rights and responsibilities, individual expression and social ties. . . . liberals experimented with a range of ideas from devolving power from the centre to creating national education systems.

Mr Deneen's fixation on the essence of liberalism leads to the second big problem of his book: his failure to recognise liberalism's ability to reform itself and address its internal problems. The late 19th century saw America suffering from many of the problems that are reappearing today, including the creation of a business aristocracy, the rise of vast companies, the corruption of politics and the sense that society was dividing into winners and losers. But a wide variety of reformers, working within the liberal tradition, tackled these problems

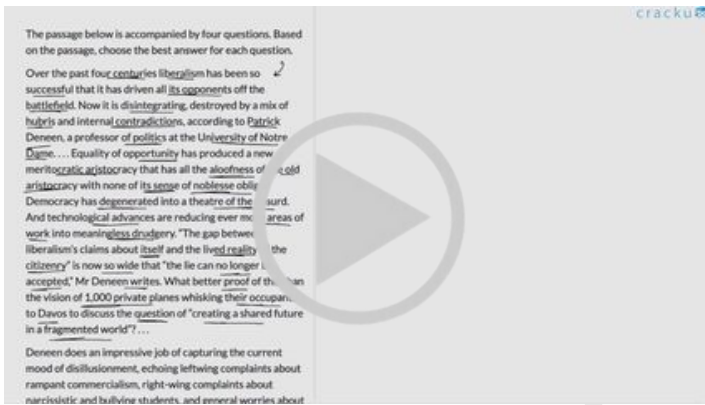
head on. Theodore Roosevelt took on the trusts. Progressives cleaned up government corruption. University reformers modernised academic syllabuses and built ladders of opportunity. Rather than dying, liberalism reformed itself.

Mr Deneen is right to point out that the record of liberalism in recent years has been dismal. He is also right to assert that the world has much to learn from the premodern notions of liberty as self-mastery and self-denial. The biggest enemy of liberalism is not so much atomisation but old-fashioned greed, as members of the Davos elite pile their plates ever higher with perks and share options. But he is wrong to argue that the only way for people to liberate themselves from the contradictions of liberalism is “liberation from liberalism itself”. The best way to read “Why Liberalism Failed” is not as a funeral oration but as a call to action: up your game, or else.

Question 550

All of the following statements are evidence of the decline of liberalism today, EXCEPT:

- A “And technological advances are reducing ever more areas of work into meaningless drudgery.”
- B “. . . the creation of a business aristocracy, the rise of vast companies . . .”
- C “Democracy has degenerated into a theatre of the absurd.”
- D “‘The gap between liberalism’s claims about itself and the lived reality of the citizenry’ is now so wide that ‘the lie can no longer be accepted,’ . . .”



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 551

The author of the passage faults Deneen’s conclusions for all of the following reasons, EXCEPT:

- A its repeated harking back to premodern notions of liberty.
- B its failure to note historical instances in which the process of declining liberalism has managed to reverse itself.
- C its extreme pessimism about the future of liberalism today and predictions of an ultimate decline.
- D its very narrow definition of liberalism limited to individual freedoms.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Over the past four centuries liberalism has been so successful that it has driven all its opponents off the battlefield. Now it is disintegrating, destroyed by a mix of hubris and internal contradictions, according to Patrick Deneen, a professor of politics at the University of Notre Dame. ... Equality of opportunity has produced a new meritocratic aristocracy that has all the aloofness of old aristocracy with none of its sense of noblesse oblige. Democracy has degenerated into a theatre of the absurd. And technological advances are reducing ever more areas of work into meaningless drudgery. "The gap between liberalism's claims about itself and the lived reality of the citizenry" is now so wide that "the lie can no longer be accepted," Mr Deneen writes. What better proof of this than the vision of 1,000 private planes whisking their occupants to Davos to discuss the question of "creating a shared future in a fragmented world"? ...

Deneen does an impressive job of capturing the current mood of disillusionment, echoing leftwing complaints about rampant commercialism, right-wing complaints about narcissistic and bullying students, and general worries about

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 552

The author of the passage is likely to disagree with all of the following statements, EXCEPT:

- A claims about liberalism's disintegration are exaggerated and misunderstand its core features.
- B if we accept that liberalism is a dying ideal, we must work to find a viable substitute.
- C liberalism was the dominant ideal in the past century, but it had to reform itself to remain so.
- D the essence of liberalism lies in greater individual self-expression and freedoms.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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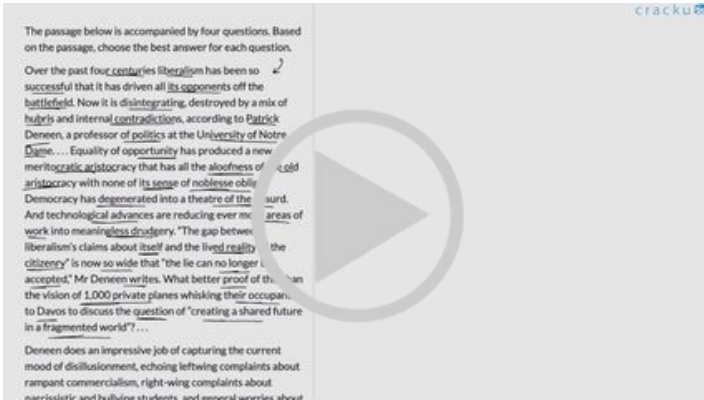


Question 553

The author of the passage refers to "the Davos elite" to illustrate his views on:

- A the unlikelihood of a return to the liberalism of the past as long as the rich continue to benefit from the decline in liberal values.
- B the way the debate around liberalism has been captured by the rich who have managed to insulate themselves from economic hardships.

- C the hypocrisy of the liberal rich, who profess to subscribe to liberal values while cornering most of the wealth.
- D the fact that the rise in liberalism had led to a greater interest in shared futures from unlikely social classes.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

Stoicism was founded in 300 BC by the Greek philosopher Zeno and survived into the Roman era until about AD 300. According to the Stoics, emotions consist of two movements. The first movement is the immediate feeling and other reactions (e.g., physiological response) that occur when a stimulus or event occurs. For instance, consider what could have happened if an army general accused Marcus Aurelius of treason in front of other officers. The first movement for Marcus may have been (internal) surprise and anger in response to this insult, accompanied perhaps by some involuntary physiological and expressive responses such as face flushing and a movement of the eyebrows. The second movement is what one does next about the emotion. Second movement behaviors occur after thinking and are under one's control. Examples of second movements for Marcus might have included a plot to seek revenge, actions signifying deference and appeasement, or perhaps proceeding as he would have proceeded whether or not this event occurred: continuing to lead the Romans in a way that Marcus Aurelius believed best benefited them. In the Stoic view, choosing a reasoned, unemotional response as the second movement is the only appropriate response.

The Stoics believed that to live the good life and be a good person, we need to free ourselves of nearly all desires such as too much desire for money, power, or sexual gratification. Prior to second movements, we can consider what is important in life. Money, power, and excessive sexual gratification are not important. Character, rationality, and kindness are important. The Epicureans, first associated with the Greek philosopher Epicurus . . . held a similar view, believing that people should enjoy simple pleasures, such as good conversation, friendship, food, and wine, but not be indulgent in these pursuits and not follow passion for those things that hold no real value like power and money. As Oatley (2004) states, "the Epicureans articulated a view—enjoyment of relationship with friends, of things that are real rather than illusory, simple rather than artificially inflated, possible rather than vanishingly unlikely—that is certainly relevant today" . . . In sum, these ancient Greek and Roman philosophers saw emotions, especially strong ones, as potentially dangerous. They viewed emotions as experiences that needed to be [reined] in and controlled.

As Oatley (2004) points out, the Stoic idea bears some similarity to Buddhism. Buddha, living in India in the 6th century BC, argued for cultivating a certain attitude that decreases the probability of (in Stoic terms) destructive second movements. Through meditation and the right attitude, one allows emotions to happen to oneself (it is impossible to prevent this), but one is advised to observe the emotions without necessarily acting on them; one achieves some distance and decides what has value and what does not have value. Additionally, the Stoic idea of developing virtue in oneself, of becoming a good person, which the Stoics believed we could do

because we have a touch of the divine, laid the foundation for the three monotheistic religions: Judaism, Christianity, and Islam . . . As with Stoicism, tenets of these religions include controlling our emotions lest we engage in sinful behavior.

Question 554

Which one of the following statements would be an accurate inference from the example of Marcus Aurelius?

- A Marcus Aurelius was humiliated by the accusation of treason in front of the other officers.
- B Marcus Aurelius was a Stoic whose philosophy survived into the Roman era.
- C Marcus Aurelius plotted revenge in his quest for justice.
- D Marcus Aurelius was one of the leaders of the Roman army.

Comprehension:

Stoicism was founded in 300 BC by the Greek philosopher Zeno and survived into the Roman era until about AD 300. According to the Stoics, emotions consist of two movements. The first movement is the immediate feeling and other reactions (e.g., physiological response) that occur when a stimulus or event occurs. For instance, consider what could have happened if an army general accused Marcus Aurelius of treason in front of other officers. The first movement for Marcus may have been (internal) surprise and anger in response to this insult, accompanied perhaps by some involuntary physiological and expressive responses such as face flushing and a movement of the eyebrows. The second movement is what one does next about the emotion. Second movement behaviors occur after thinking and are under one's control. Examples of second movements for Marcus might have

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 555

On the basis of the passage, which one of the following statements can be regarded as true?

- A The Stoics valorised the pursuit of money, power, and sexual gratification.
- B The Stoic influences can be seen in multiple religions.
- C The Epicureans believed in controlling all emotions.
- D There were no Stoics in India at the time of the Roman civilisation.

Comprehension:

Stoicism was founded in 300 BC by the Greek philosopher Zeno and survived into the Roman era until about AD 300. According to the Stoics, emotions consist of two movements. The first movement is the immediate feeling and other reactions (e.g., physiological response) that occur when a stimulus or event occurs. For instance, consider what could have happened if an army general accused Marcus Aurelius of treason in front of other officers. The first movement for Marcus may have been (internal) surprise and anger in response to this insult, accompanied perhaps by some involuntary physiological and expressive responses such as face flushing and a movement of the eyebrows. The second movement is what one does next about the emotion. Second movement behaviors occur after thinking and are under one's control. Examples of second movements for Marcus might have

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VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 556

"Through meditation and the right attitude, one allows emotions to happen to oneself (it is impossible to prevent this), but one is advised to observe the emotions without necessarily acting on them; one achieves some distance and decides what has value and what does not have value."

In the context of the passage, which one of the following is not a possible implication of the quoted statement?

- A "Meditation and the right attitude", in this instance, implies an initially passive reception of all experiences.
- B Meditation allows certain out-of-body experiences that permit us to gain the distance necessary to control our emotions.
- C The observation of emotions in a distant manner corresponds to the second movement referred to earlier in the passage.
- D Emotional responses can make it difficult to distinguish valuable experiences from valueless experiences.

Comprehension:

Stoicism was founded in 300 BC by the Greek philosopher Zeno and survived into the Roman era until about AD 300. According to the Stoics, emotions consist of two movements. The first movement is the immediate feeling and other reactions (e.g., physiological response) that occur when a stimulus or event occurs. For instance, consider what could have happened if an army general accused Marcus Aurelius of treason in front of other officers. The first movement for Marcus may have been (internal) surprise and anger in response to this insult, accompanied perhaps by some involuntary physiological and expressive responses such as face flushing and a movement of the eyebrows. The second movement is what one does next about the emotion. Second movement behaviors occur after thinking and are under one's control. Examples of second movements for Marcus might have

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 557

Which one of the following statements, if false, could be seen as contradicting the facts/arguments in the passage?

- A Despite practising meditation and cultivating the right attitude, emotions cannot ever be controlled.
- B The Greek philosopher Zeno survived into the Roman era until about AD 300.
- C In the Epicurean view, indulging in simple pleasures is not desirable.
- D In the Stoic view, choosing a reasoned, unemotional response as the first movement is an appropriate response to emotional situations.

Comprehension:

Stoicism was founded in 300 BC by the Greek philosopher Zeno and survived into the Roman era until about AD 300. According to the Stoics, emotions consist of two movements. The first movement is the immediate feeling and other reactions (e.g., physiological response) that occur when a stimulus or event occurs. For instance, consider what could have happened if an army general accused Marcus Aurelius of treason in front of other officers. The first movement for Marcus may have been (internal) surprise and anger in response to this insult, accompanied perhaps by some involuntary physiological and expressive responses such as face flushing and a movement of the eyebrows. The second movement is what one does next about the emotion. Second movement behaviors occur after thinking and are under one's control. Examples of second movements for Marcus might have

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

The Chinese have two different concepts of a copy. Fangzhipin . . . are imitations where the difference from the original is obvious. These are small models or copies that can be purchased in a museum shop, for example. The second concept for a copy is fuzhipin . . . They are exact reproductions of the original, which, for the Chinese, are of equal value to the original. It has absolutely no negative connotations. The discrepancy with regard to the understanding of what a copy is has often led to misunderstandings and arguments between China and Western museums. The Chinese often send copies abroad instead of originals, in the firm belief that they are not essentially different from the originals. The rejection that then comes from the Western museums is perceived by the Chinese as an insult. . . .

The Far Eastern notion of identity is also very confusing to the Western observer. The Ise Grand Shrine [in Japan] is 1,300 years old for the millions of Japanese people who go there on pilgrimage every year. But in reality this temple complex is completely rebuilt from scratch every 20 years. . . .

The cathedral of Freiburg Minster in southwest Germany is covered in scaffolding almost all year round. The sandstone from which it is built is a very soft, porous material that does not withstand natural erosion by rain and wind. After a while, it crumbles. As a result, the cathedral is continually being examined for damage, and eroded stones are replaced. And in the cathedral's dedicated workshop, copies of the damaged sandstone figures are constantly being produced. Of course, attempts are made to preserve the stones from the Middle Ages for as long as possible. But at some point they, too, are removed and replaced with new stones.

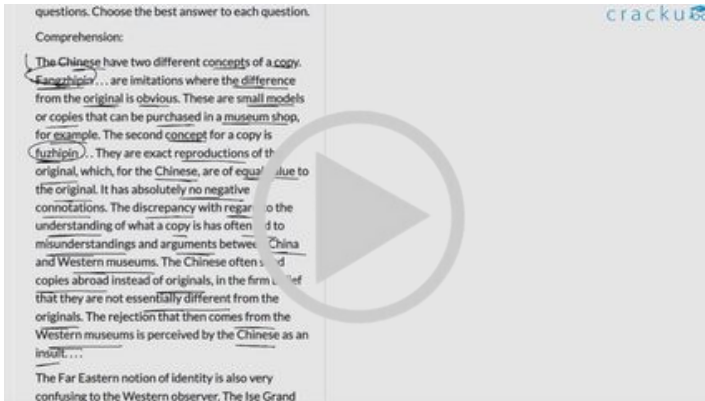
Fundamentally, this is the same operation as with the Japanese shrine, except in this case the production of a replica takes place very slowly and over long periods of time. . . . In the field of art as well, the idea of an unassailable original developed historically in the Western world. Back in the 17th century [in the West], excavated artworks from antiquity were treated quite differently from today. They were not restored in a way that was faithful to the original. Instead, there was massive intervention in these works, changing their appearance. . . .

It is probably this intellectual position that explains why Asians have far fewer scruples about cloning than Europeans. The South Korean cloning researcher Hwang Woo-suk, who attracted worldwide attention with his cloning experiments in 2004, is a Buddhist. He found a great deal of support and followers among Buddhists, while Christians called for a ban on human cloning. . . . Hwang legitimised his cloning experiments with his religious affiliation: 'I am Buddhist, and I have no philosophical problem with cloning. And as you know, the basis of Buddhism is that life is recycled through reincarnation. In some ways, I think, therapeutic cloning restarts the circle of life.'

Question 558

Based on the passage, which one of the following copies would a Chinese museum be unlikely to consider as having less value than the original?

- A Pablo Picasso's painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, bearing Picasso's signature.
- B Pablo Picasso's painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, identical in every respect.
- C Pablo Picasso's photograph of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, printed to exactly the same scale.
- D Pablo Picasso's miniaturised, but otherwise faithful and accurate painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting.



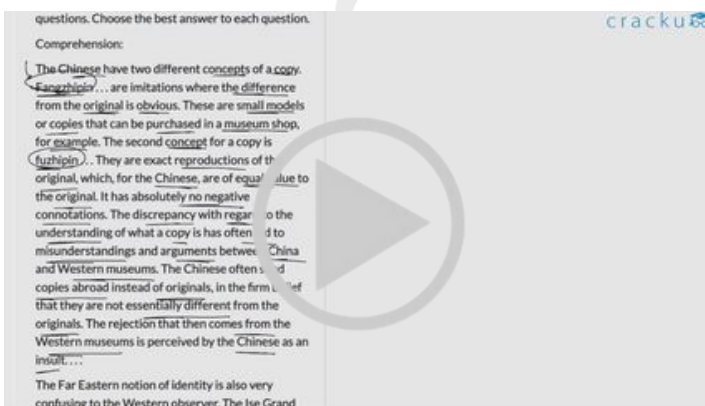
VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 559

Which one of the following scenarios is unlikely to follow from the arguments in the passage?

- A A 17th-century British painter would have no problem adding personal touches when restoring an ancient Roman painting.
- B A 20th-century Japanese Buddhist monk would value a reconstructed shrine as the original.
- C A 17th-century French artist who adhered to a Christian worldview would need to be completely true to the original intent of a painting when restoring it.
- D A 21st-century Christian scientist is likely to oppose cloning because of his philosophical orientation.



Question 560

Which one of the following statements does not correctly express the similarity between the Ise Grand Shrine and the cathedral of Freiburg Minster?

- A Both were built as places of worship.
- B Both can be regarded as very old structures.
- C Both are continually undergoing restoration.
- D Both will one day be completely rebuilt.

questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

The Chinese have two different concepts of a copy. Fangzhipin... are imitations where the difference from the original is obvious. These are small models or copies that can be purchased in a museum shop, for example. The second concept for a copy is fuzhipin... They are exact reproductions of the original, which, for the Chinese, are of equal value to the original. It has absolutely no negative connotations. The discrepancy with regard to the understanding of what a copy is has often led to misunderstandings and arguments between China and Western museums. The Chinese often send copies abroad instead of originals, in the firm belief that they are not essentially different from the originals. The rejection that then comes from the Western museums is perceived by the Chinese as an insult....

The Far Eastern notion of identity is also very confusing to the Western observer. The Ise Grand

Question 561

The value that the modern West assigns to "an unassailable original" has resulted in all of the following EXCEPT:

- A it discourages them from simultaneous displays of multiple copies of a painting.
- B it allows regular employment for certain craftsmen.
- C it discourages them from making interventions in ancient art.
- D it discourages them from carrying out human cloning.

questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

The Chinese have two different concepts of a copy. Fangzhipin... are imitations where the difference from the original is obvious. These are small models or copies that can be purchased in a museum shop, for example. The second concept for a copy is fuzhipin... They are exact reproductions of the original, which, for the Chinese, are of equal value to the original. It has absolutely no negative connotations. The discrepancy with regard to the understanding of what a copy is has often led to misunderstandings and arguments between China and Western museums. The Chinese often send copies abroad instead of originals, in the firm belief that they are not essentially different from the originals. The rejection that then comes from the Western museums is perceived by the Chinese as an insult....

The Far Eastern notion of identity is also very confusing to the Western observer. The Ise Grand



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

Stories concerning the Undead have always been with us. From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either. These may have been ancient and primitive deities who dwelt deep in the surrounding forests and in remote places, or simply those deceased who refused to remain in their tombs and who wandered about the countryside, physically tormenting and frightening those who were still alive. Mostly they were ill-defined—strange sounds in the night beyond the comforting glow of the fire, or a shape, half-glimpsed in the twilight along the edge of an encampment. They were vague and indistinct, but they were always there with the power to terrify and disturb. They had the power to touch the minds of our early ancestors and to fill them with dread. Such fear formed the basis of the earliest tales although the source and exact nature of such terrors still remained very vague.

And as Mankind became more sophisticated, leaving the gloom of their caves and forming themselves into recognizable communities—towns, cities, whole cultures—so the Undead travelled with them, inhabiting their folklore just as they had in former times. Now they began to take on more definite shapes. They became walking cadavers; the physical embodiment of former deities and things which had existed alongside Man since the Creation. Some still remained vague and ill-defined but, as Mankind strove to explain the horror which it felt towards them, such creatures emerged more readily into the light.

In order to confirm their abnormal status, many of the Undead were often accorded attributes, which defied the natural order of things—the power to transform themselves into other shapes, the ability to sustain themselves by drinking human blood, and the ability to influence human minds across a distance. Such powers—described as supernatural—only [lent] an added dimension to the terror that humans felt regarding them.

And it was only natural, too, that the Undead should become connected with the practice of magic. From very early times, Shamans and witchdoctors had claimed at least some power and control over the spirits of departed ancestors, and this has continued down into more "civilized" times. Formerly, the invisible spirits and forces that thronged around men's earliest encampments, had spoken "through" the tribal Shamans but now, as entities in their own right, they were subject to magical control and could be physically summoned by a competent sorcerer. However, the relationship between the magician and an Undead creature was often a very tenuous and uncertain one. Some sorcerers might have even become Undead entities once they died, but they might also have been susceptible to the powers of other magicians when they did.

From the Middle Ages and into the Age of Enlightenment, theories of the Undead continued to grow and develop. Their names became more familiar—werewolf, vampire, ghoul—each one certain to strike fear into the hearts of ordinary humans.

Question 562

Which one of the following observations is a valid conclusion to draw from the statement, "From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either."?

- A Mankind's early years were marked by a belief in the existence of eerie creatures that were neither quite alive nor dead.
- B Long ago, eerie creatures used to whisper in the primal darkness that they were not quite dead.
- C Mankind's primal years were marked by creatures alive with eerie whispers, but seen only in the darkness.

- D We can understand the lives of the eerie creatures in Mankind's early years through their whispers in the darkness.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension

Stories concerning the Undead have always been with us. From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either. These may have been ancient and primitive deities who dwell deep in the surrounding forests and in remote places, or those deceased who refused to remain in their tombs and who wandered about the countryside, physically tormenting and frightening those who were still alive. Mostly they were ill-defined—strange sounds in the night beyond the comforting glow of the fire, or a shape, half-glimpsed in the twilight along the edge of an encampment. They were vaguely and indistinct, but they were always there with the power to disturb. They had the power to touch the minds of our earliest ancestors and to fill them with dread. Such fear formed the basis of the earliest tales, although the source and exact nature of such terrors still remained very vague.

And as Mankind became more sophisticated, leaving the gloom of caves and forming themselves into recognizable communities—towns, cities, whole cultures—so the Undead travelled with them, inhabiting their folklore just as they had in former times. Now they began to take on more definite shapes. They became walking cadavers; the physical embodiment of former deities and things which had existed alongside Man since the Creation. Some still remained vague and ill-defined but, as Mankind strove to explain the horror which it felt towards them, such creatures emerged more readily into the light.

→ Description of the tales of the Undead as experienced by



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 563

Which one of the following statements best describes what the passage is about?

- A The writer discusses the transition from primitive thinking to the Age of Enlightenment.
- B The passage discusses the evolution of theories of the Undead from primitive thinking to the Age of Enlightenment.
- C The passage describes the failure of human beings to fully comprehend their environment.
- D The writer describes the ways in which the Undead come to be associated with Shamans and the practice of magic.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension

Stories concerning the Undead have always been with us. From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either. These may have been ancient and primitive deities who dwell deep in the surrounding forests and in remote places, or those deceased who refused to remain in their tombs and who wandered about the countryside, physically tormenting and frightening those who were still alive. Mostly they were ill-defined—strange sounds in the night beyond the comforting glow of the fire, or a shape, half-glimpsed in the twilight along the edge of an encampment. They were vaguely and indistinct, but they were always there with the power to disturb. They had the power to touch the minds of our earliest ancestors and to fill them with dread. Such fear formed the basis of the earliest tales, although the source and exact nature of such terrors still remained very vague.

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→ Description of the tales of the Undead as experienced by



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 564

All of the following statements, if false, could be seen as being in accordance with the passage, EXCEPT:

- A the Undead remained vague and ill-defined, even as Mankind strove to understand the horror they inspired.
- B the transition from the Middle Ages to the Age of Enlightenment saw new theories of the Undead.
- C the growing sophistication of Mankind meant that humans stopped believing in the Undead.

D the relationship between Shamans and the Undead was believed to be a strong and stable one.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension

Stories concerning the Undead have always been with us. From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either. These may have been ancient and primitive deities who dwelt deep in the surrounding forests and in remote places, or those deceased who refused to remain in their tombs and who haunted about the countryside, physically tormenting and frightening those who were still alive. Mostly they were ill-defined—strange sounds in the night beyond the comforting glow of the fire, or a shape, half-glimpsed in the twilight along the edge of an encampment. They were vaguely and indistinct, but they were always there with the power to irritate and disturb. They had the power to touch the minds of our ancestors and to fill them with dread. Such fear formed the basis of the earliest tales although the source and exact nature of such terrors still remained very vague.

And as Mankind became more sophisticated, leaving the gloom of caves and forming themselves into recognizable communities—towns, cities, whole cultures—the Undead travelled with them, inhabiting their folklores just as they had in former times. Now they began to take on more definite shapes. They became walking cadavers; the physical embodiment of former deities and things which had existed alongside Man since the Creation. Some still remained vague and ill-defined but, as Mankind strove to explain the horror which it felt towards them, such creatures emerged more readily into the light.

→ Description of the state of the Undead as experienced by .

VIDEO SOLUTION

 **CAT Score Calculator**

Question 565

"In order to confirm their abnormal status, many of the Undead were often accorded attributes, which defied the natural order of things . . ."

Which one of the following best expresses the claim made in this statement?

- A Human beings conceptualise the Undead as possessing abnormal features.
- B The Undead are deified in nature's order by giving them divine attributes.
- C The natural attributes of the Undead are rendered abnormal by changing their status.
- D According to the Undead an abnormal status is to reject the natural order of things.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension

Stories concerning the Undead have always been with us. From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either. These may have been ancient and primitive deities who dwelt deep in the surrounding forests and in remote places, or those deceased who refused to remain in their tombs and who haunted about the countryside, physically tormenting and frightening those who were still alive. Mostly they were ill-defined—strange sounds in the night beyond the comforting glow of the fire, or a shape, half-glimpsed in the twilight along the edge of an encampment. They were vaguely and indistinct, but they were always there with the power to irritate and disturb. They had the power to touch the minds of our ancestors and to fill them with dread. Such fear formed the basis of the earliest tales although the source and exact nature of such terrors still remained very vague.

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→ Description of the state of the Undead as experienced by .

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

Critical theory of technology is a political theory of modernity with a normative dimension. It belongs to a tradition extending from Marx to Foucault and Habermas according to which advances in the formal claims of human rights take center stage while in the background centralization of ever more powerful public institutions and private organizations imposes an authoritarian social order.

Marx attributed this trajectory to the capitalist rationalization of production. Today it marks many institutions besides the factory and every modern political system, including so-called socialist systems. This trajectory arose from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled labor force; but everywhere [that] masses are organized - whether it be Foucault's prisons or Habermas's public sphere - the same pattern prevails. Technological design and development is shaped by this pattern as the material base of a distinctive social order. Marcuse would later point to a "project" as the basis of what he called rather confusingly "technological rationality." Releasing technology from this project is a democratic political task.

In accordance with this general line of thought, critical theory of technology regards technologies as an environment rather than as a collection of tools. We live today with and even within technologies that determine our way of life. Along with the constant pressures to build centers of power, many other social values and meanings are inscribed in technological design. A hermeneutics of technology must make explicit the meanings implicit in the devices we use and the rituals they script. Social histories of technologies such as the bicycle, artificial lighting or firearms have made important contributions to this type of analysis. Critical theory of technology attempts to build a methodological approach on the lessons of these histories.

As an environment, technologies shape their inhabitants. In this respect, they are comparable to laws and customs. Each of these institutions can be said to represent those who live under their sway through privileging certain dimensions of their human nature. Laws of property represent the interest in ownership and control. Customs such as parental authority represent the interest of childhood in safety and growth. Similarly, the automobile represents its users in so far as they are interested in mobility. Interests such as these constitute the version of human nature sanctioned by society.

This notion of representation does not imply an eternal human nature. The concept of nature as non-identity in the Frankfurt School suggests an alternative. On these terms, nature is what lies at the limit of history, at the point at which society loses the capacity to imprint its meanings on things and control them effectively. The reference here is, of course, not to the nature of natural science, but to the lived nature in which we find ourselves and which we are. This nature reveals itself as that which cannot be totally encompassed by the machinery of society. For the Frankfurt School, human nature, in all its transcending force, emerges out of a historical context as that context is [depicted] in illicit joys, struggles and pathologies. We can perhaps admit a less romantic . . . conception in which those dimensions of human nature recognized by society are also granted theoretical legitimacy.

Question 566

Which one of the following statements best reflects the main argument of the fourth paragraph of the passage?

- A Technology, laws, and customs are comparable, but dissimilar phenomena.
- B Technological environments privilege certain dimensions of human nature as effectively as laws and customs.
- C Automobiles represent the interest in mobility present in human nature.
- D Technology, laws, and customs are not unlike each other if considered as institutions.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

Critical theory of technology is a political theory of modernity with a normative dimension. It belongs to a tradition extending from Marx to Foucault and Habermas according to which advancement in the formal claims of human rights take on a new stage while in the background centralization of ever more powerful public institutions and private organizations imposes an authoritarian social order.

Marx attributed this trajectory to the capitalist rationalization of production. Today it marks many institutions besides the factory and every modern political system, including so-called socialist systems. This trajectory arose from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 567

Which one of the following statements could be inferred as supporting the arguments of the passage?

- A It is not human nature, but human culture that is represented by institutions such as law and custom.
- B Technologies form the environmental context and shape the contours of human society.
- C Nature decides the point at which society loses its capacity to control history.
- D The romantic conception of nature referred to by the passage is the one that requires theoretical legitimacy.

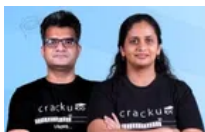
The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

Critical theory of technology is a political theory of modernity with a normative dimension. It belongs to a tradition extending from Marx to Foucault and Habermas according to which advancement in the formal claims of human rights take on a new stage while in the background centralization of ever more powerful public institutions and private organizations imposes an authoritarian social order.

Marx attributed this trajectory to the capitalist rationalization of production. Today it marks many institutions besides the factory and every modern political system, including so-called socialist systems. This trajectory arose from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled

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Question 568

Which one of the following statements contradicts the arguments of the passage?

- A The problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled labour force gave rise to similar patterns of the capitalist rationalisation of production wherever masses were organised.
- B Marx's understanding of the capitalist rationalisation of production and Marcuse's understanding of a "project" of "technological rationality" share theoretical inclinations.

- C Masses are organised in patterns set by Foucault's prisons and Habermas' public sphere.
- D Paradoxically, the capitalist rationalisation of production is a mark of so-called socialist systems as well.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

Critical theory of technology is a political theory of modernity with a normative dimension. It belongs to a tradition extending from Marx to Foucault and Habermas according to which advancement in the formal claims of human rights take center stage while in the background centralization of ever more powerful public institutions and private organizations imposes an authoritarian social order.

Marx attributed this trajectory to the capitalist rationalization of production. Today it marks many institutions besides the factory and every modern political system, including so-called socialist systems. This trajectory arose from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 569

All of the following claims can be inferred from the passage, EXCEPT:

- A the significance of parental authority to children's safety does not therefore imply that parental authority is a permanent aspect of human nature.
- B the critical theory of technology argues that, as issues of human rights become more prominent, we lose sight of the ways in which the social order becomes more authoritarian.
- C analyses of technologies must engage with their social histories to be able to reveal their implicit and explicit meanings for us.
- D technologies seek to privilege certain dimensions of human nature at a high cost to lived nature.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Comprehension:

Critical theory of technology is a political theory of modernity with a normative dimension. It belongs to a tradition extending from Marx to Foucault and Habermas according to which advancement in the formal claims of human rights take center stage while in the background centralization of ever more powerful public institutions and private organizations imposes an authoritarian social order.

Marx attributed this trajectory to the capitalist rationalization of production. Today it marks many institutions besides the factory and every modern political system, including so-called socialist systems. This trajectory arose from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Humans today make music. Think beyond all the qualifications that might trail after this bald statement: that only certain humans make music, that extensive training is involved, that many societies distinguish musical specialists from nonmusicians, that in today's societies most listen to music rather than making it, and so forth. These qualifications, whatever their local merit, are moot in the face of the overarching truth that making music, considered from a cognitive and psychological vantage, is the province of all those who perceive and

experience what is made. We are, almost all of us, musicians — everyone who can entrain (not necessarily dance) to a beat, who can recognize a repeated tune (not necessarily sing it), who can distinguish one instrument or one singing voice from another. I will often use an antique word, recently revived, to name this broader musical experience. Humans are musicking creatures. . . .

The set of capacities that enables musicking is a principal marker of modern humanity. There is nothing polemical in this assertion except a certain insistence, which will figure often in what follows, that musicking be included in our thinking about fundamental human commonalities. Capacities involved in musicking are many and take shape in complicated ways, arising from innate dispositions . . . Most of these capacities overlap with nonmusical ones, though a few may be distinct and dedicated to musical perception and production. In the area of overlap, linguistic capacities seem to be particularly important, and humans are (in principle) language-makers in addition to music-makers — speaking creatures as well as musicking ones.

Humans are symbol-makers too, a feature tightly bound up with language, not so tightly with music. The species Cassirer dubbed *Homo symbolicus* cannot help but tangle musicking in webs of symbolic thought and expression, habitually making it a component of behavioral complexes that form such expression. But in fundamental features musicking is neither language-like nor symbol-like, and from these differences come many clues to its ancient emergence.

If musicking is a primary, shared trait of modern humans, then to describe its emergence must be to detail the coalescing of that modernity. This took place, archaeologists are clear, over a very long *durée*: at least 50,000 years or so, more likely something closer to 200,000, depending in part on what that coalescence is taken to comprise. If we look back 20,000 years, a small portion of this long period, we reach the lives of humans whose musical capacities were probably little different from our own. As we look farther back we reach horizons where this similarity can no longer hold — perhaps 40,000 years ago, perhaps 70,000, perhaps 100,000. But we never cross a line before which all the cognitive capacities recruited in modern musicking abruptly disappear. Unless we embrace the incredible notion that music sprang forth in full-blown glory, its emergence will have to be tracked in gradualist terms across a long period.

This is one general feature of a history of music's emergence . . . The history was at once sociocultural and biological . . . The capacities recruited in musicking are many, so describing its emergence involves following several or many separate strands.

Question 570

Which one of the following sets of terms best serves as keywords to the passage?

- A Musicking; Cognitive psychology; Antique; Symbol-makers; Modernity.
- B Humans; Capacities; Language; Symbols; Modernity.
- C Humans; Musicking; Linguistic capacities; Symbol-making; Modern humanity.
- D Humans; Psychological vantage; Musicking; Cassirer; Emergence of music.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Humans today make music. Think beyond all the qualifications that might trail after this bald statement: that only certain humans make music, that extensive training is involved, that many societies distinguish musical specialists from nonmusicians, that in today's societies most listen to music rather than making it, and so forth. These qualifications, whatever their local merit, are moot in the face of the overarching truth that music, considered from a cognitive and psychological vantage, is the province of all those who perceive and experience what is made. We are, almost all of us, musicians — everyone who can entrain (not necessarily dance) to a beat, who can recognize a repeated tune (not necessarily sing it), who can distinguish one instrument or one singing voice from another. I will often use an antique word, recently revived, to name this broader musical experience. Humans are musicking creatures. . . .

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Humans are symbol-makers too, a feature tightly bound up with language.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 571

“Think beyond all the qualifications that might trail after this bald statement . . .” In the context of the passage, what is the author trying to communicate in this quoted extract?

- A A bald statement is one that is trailed by a series of qualifying clarifications and caveats.
- B A bald statement is one that requires no qualifications to infer its meaning.
- C Although there may be many caveats and other considerations, the statement is essentially true.
- D Thinking beyond qualifications allows us to give free reign to musical expressions.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Humans today make music. Think beyond all the qualifications that might trail after this bald statement: that only certain humans make music, that extensive training is involved, that many societies distinguish musical specialists from nonmusicians, that in today's societies most listen to music rather than making it, and so forth. These qualifications, whatever their local merit, are moot in the face of the overarching truth that music is a province of all those who perceive and experience what is made. It is almost all of us, musicians — everyone who can entrain (not necessarily sing) to a beat, who can recognize a repeated tune (not necessarily sing it), who can distinguish one instrument or one singing voice from another. I will often use an antique word, recently revived, to name this broader musical experience. Humans are musicking creatures. . . .

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 572

Based on the passage, which one of the following statements is a valid argument about the emergence of music/musicking?

- A Anyone who can perceive and experience music must be considered capable of musicking.
- B Although musicking is not language-like, it shares the quality of being a form of expression.
- C 20,000 years ago, human musical capacities were not very different from what they are today.
- D All musical work is located in the overlap between linguistic capacity and music production.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Humans today make music. Think beyond all the qualifications that might trail after this bald statement: that only certain humans make music, that extensive training is involved, that many societies distinguish musical specialists from nonmusicians, that in today's societies most listen to music rather than making it, and so forth. These qualifications, whatever their local merit, are moot in the face of the overarching truth that music is a province of all those who perceive and experience what is made. It is almost all of us, musicians — everyone who can entrain (not necessarily sing) to a beat, who can recognize a repeated tune (not necessarily sing it), who can distinguish one instrument or one singing voice from another. I will often use an antique word, recently revived, to name this broader musical experience. Humans are musicking creatures. . . .

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Humans are symbol-makers too, a feature tightly bound up with language.




Question 573

Which one of the following statements, if true, would weaken the author's claim that humans are musicking creatures?

- A Nonmusical capacities are of far greater consequence to human survival than the capacity for music.
- B From a cognitive and psychological vantage, musicking arises from unconscious dispositions, not conscious ones.
- C As musicking is neither language-like nor symbol-like, it is a much older form of expression.
- D Musical capacities are primarily socio-cultural, which explains the wide diversity of musical forms.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Humans today make music. Think beyond all the qualifications that might trail after this bald statement: that only certain humans make music; that extensive training is involved; that many societies distinguish musical specialists from nonmusicians, that in today's societies most listen to music rather than making it; and so forth. These qualifications, whatever their local merit, are most in the face of the overarching truth that music, considered from a cognitive and psychological vantage, is the province of all those who perceive and experience what is made. We are, almost all of us, musicians – everyone who can entrain (not necessarily dance) to a beat, who can recognize a repeated tune (not necessarily sing it), who can distinguish one instrument or one singing voice from another. I will often use an antique word, recently revived, to name this broader musical experience. Humans are musicking creatures....

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CAT Daily Targets

Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile

Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

Will a day come when India's poor can access government services as easily as drawing cash from an ATM? . . . [N]o country in the world has made accessing education or health or policing or dispute resolution as easy as an ATM, because the nature of these activities requires individuals to use their discretion in a positive way. Technology can certainly facilitate this in a variety of ways if it is seen as one part of an overall approach, but the evidence so far in education, for instance, is that just adding computers alone doesn't make education any better. . . .

The dangerous illusion of technology is that it can create stronger, top down accountability of service providers in implementation-intensive services within existing public sector organisations. One notion is that electronic management information systems (EMIS) keep better track of inputs and those aspects of personnel that are 'EMIS visible' can lead to better services. A recent study examined attempts to increase attendance of Auxiliary Nurse Midwife (ANMs) at clinics in Rajasthan, which involved high-tech time clocks to monitor attendance. The study's title says it all: Band-Aids on a Corpse . . . e-governance can be just as bad as any other governance when the real issue is people and their motivation.

For services to improve, the people providing the services have to want to do a better job with the skills they have. A study of medical care in Delhi found that even though providers, in the public sector had much better skills than private sector providers their provision of care in actual practice was much worse.

In implementation-intensive services the key to success is face-to-face interactions between a teacher, a nurse, a policeman, an extension agent and a citizen. This relationship is about power. Amartya Sen's . . . report on education in West Bengal had a supremely telling anecdote in which the villagers forced the teacher to attend school, but then, when the parents went off to work, the teacher did not teach, but forced the children to massage his feet. . . . As long as the system empowers providers over citizens, technology is irrelevant.

The answer to successfully providing basic services is to create systems that provide both autonomy and accountability. In basic education for instance, the answer to poor teaching is not controlling teachers more . . . The key . . . is to hire teachers who want to teach and let them teach, expressing their professionalism and vocation as a teacher through autonomy in the classroom. This autonomy has to be matched with accountability for results—not just narrowly measured through test scores, but broadly for the quality of the education they provide.

A recent study in Uttar Pradesh showed that if, somehow, all civil service teachers could be replaced with contract teachers, the state could save a billion dollars a year in revenue and double student learning. Just the additional autonomy and accountability of contracts through local groups—even without complementary system changes in information and empowerment—led to that much improvement. The first step to being part of the solution is to create performance information accessible to those outside of the government. . . .

Question 574

The author questions the use of monitoring systems in services that involve face-to-face interaction between service providers and clients because such systems:

- A do not improve services that need committed service providers.
- B are ineffective because they are managed by the government.
- C improve the skills but do not increase the motivation of service providers.
- D are not as effective in the public sector as they are in the private sector.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

Will a day come when India's poor can access government services as easily as drawing cash from an ATM? . . . [N]o country in the world has made accessing education or health or polling or dispute resolution as easy as an ATM because the nature of these activities requires individuals to use their discretion in a positive way.

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The dangerous illusion of technology is that it can create stronger, top down accountability of

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Question 575

In the context of the passage, we can infer that the title “Band Aids on a Corpse” (in paragraph 2) suggests that:

- A the nurses attended the clinics, but the clinics were ill-equipped.
- B the clinics were better funded, but performance monitoring did not result in any improvement.
- C the nurses who attended the clinics were too poorly trained to provide appropriate medical care.
- D the electronic monitoring system was a superficial solution to a serious problem.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

Will a day come when India's poor can access government services as easily as drawing cash from an ATM? ... [N]o country in the world has made accessing education or health or polling or dispute resolution as easy as an ATM because the nature of these activities requires individuals to use their discretion in a positive way.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 576

According to the author, service delivery in Indian education can be improved in all of the following ways EXCEPT through:

- A access to information on the quality of teaching.
- B elimination of government involvement.
- C recruitment of motivated teachers.
- D use of technology.

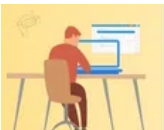
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Question 577

Which of the following, IF TRUE, would undermine the passage's main argument?

- A If it were proven that increase in autonomy of service providers leads to an exponential increase in their work ethic and sense of responsibility.
- B If it were proven that service providers in the private sector have better skills than those in the public sector.

- C Empowerment of service providers leads to increased complacency and rigged performance results.
- D If absolute instead of moderate technological surveillance is exercised over the performance of service providers.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

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Question 578

The main purpose of the passage is to:

- A argue that some types of services can be improved by providing independence and requiring accountability.
- B analyse the shortcomings of government-appointed nurses and their management through technology.
- C critique the government's involvement in educational activities and other implementation-intensive services.
- D find a solution to the problem of poor service delivery in education by examining different strategies.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the following questions

NOT everything looks lovelier the longer and closer its inspection. But Saturn does. It is gorgeous through Earthly telescopes. However, the 13 years of close observation provided by Cassini, an American spacecraft, showed the planet, its moons and its remarkable rings off better and better, revealing finer structures, striking novelties and greater drama. . . .

By and large the big things in the solar system—planets and moons—are thought of as having been around since the beginning. The suggestion that rings and moons are new is, though, made even more interesting by the fact that one of those moons, Enceladus, is widely considered the most promising site in the solar system on which to look for alien life. If Enceladus is both young and bears life, that life must have come into being quickly. This is also believed to have been the case on Earth. Were it true on Enceladus, that would encourage the idea that life evolves easily when conditions are right.

One reason for thinking Saturn's rings are young is that they are bright. The solar system is suffused with comet dust, and comet dust is dark. Leaving Saturn's ring system (which Cassini has shown to be more than 90% water ice) out in such a mist is like leaving laundry hanging on a line downwind from a smokestack: it will get dirty. The lighter the rings are, the faster this will happen, for the less mass they contain, the less celestial pollution they can absorb before they start to discolour. . . . Jeff Cuzzi, a scientist at America's space agency, NASA, who helped run Cassini, told the Lunar and Planetary Science Conference in Houston that combining the mass estimates with Cassini's measurements of the density of comet-dust near Saturn suggests the rings are no older than the first dinosaurs, nor younger than the last of them—that is, they are somewhere between 200m and 70m years old.

That timing fits well with a theory put forward in 2016, by Matija Cuk of the SETI Institute, in California and his colleagues. They suggest that at around the same time as the rings came into being an old set of moons orbiting Saturn destroyed themselves, and from their remains emerged not only the rings but also the planet's current suite of inner moons—Rhea, Dione, Tethys, Enceladus and Mimas. . . .

Dr Cuk and his colleagues used computer simulations of Saturn's moons' orbits as a sort of time machine. Looking at the rate at which tidal friction is causing these orbits to lengthen they extrapolated backwards to find out what those orbits would have looked like in the past. They discovered that about 100m years ago the orbits of two of them, Tethys and Dione, would have interacted in a way that left the planes in which they orbit markedly tilted. But their orbits are untitled. The obvious, if unsettling, conclusion was that this interaction never happened—and thus that at the time when it should have happened, Dione and Tethys were simply not there. They must have come into being later. . . .

Question 579

The main objective of the passage is to:

- A highlight the beauty, finer structures and celestial drama of Saturn's rings and moons.
- B establish that Saturn's rings and inner moons have been around since the beginning of time.
- C provide evidence that Saturn's rings and moons are recent creations.
- D demonstrate how the orbital patterns of Saturn's rings and moons change over time.



Cassini's spacecraft → new information about Saturn

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Some moons of Saturn are relatively new → potential for life

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 580

Based on information provided in the passage, we can conclude all of the following EXCEPT:

- A none of Saturn's moons ever had suitable conditions for life to evolve.
- B Thethys and Dione are less than 100 million years old.
- C Saturn's lighter rings discolour faster than rings with greater mass.
- D Saturn's rings were created from the remains of older moons.



Cassini → spacecraft → new information about Saturn

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 581

The phrase “leaving laundry hanging on a line downwind from a smokestack” is used to explain how the ringed planet's:

- A rings lose mass over time.
- B rings discolour and darken over time.
- C moons create a gap between the rings.
- D atmosphere absorbs comet dust.



Cassini → spacecraft → new information about Saturn

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Question 582

Data provided by Cassini challenged the assumption that:

- A new celestial bodies can form from the destruction of old celestial bodies.
- B all big things in the solar system have been around since the beginning.
- C there was life on earth when Saturn's rings were being formed.
- D Saturn's ring system is composed mostly of water ice.



Cassini spacecraft → new information about Saturn

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CAT Daily Articles



Question 583

Based on information provided in the passage, we can infer that, in addition to water ice, Saturn's rings might also have small amounts of:

- A methane and rock particles.
- B helium and methane.
- C helium and comet dust.
- D rock particles and comet dust.



Cassini → spacecraft → new information about Saturn

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

Grove snails as a whole are distributed all over Europe, but a specific variety of the snail, with a distinctive white-lipped shell, is found exclusively in Ireland and in the Pyrenees mountains that lie on the border between France and Spain. The researchers sampled a total of 423 snail specimens from 36 sites distributed across Europe, with an emphasis on gathering large numbers of the white-lipped variety. When they sequenced genes from the mitochondrial DNA of each of these snails and used algorithms to analyze the genetic diversity between them, they found that. . . a distinct lineage (the snails with the white-lipped shells) was indeed endemic to the two very specific and distant places in question.

Explaining this is tricky. Previously, some had speculated that the strange distributions of creatures such as the white-lipped grove snails could be explained by convergent evolution—in which two populations evolve the same trait by coincidence—but the underlying genetic similarities between the two groups rules that out. Alternately, some scientists had suggested that the white-lipped variety had simply spread over the whole continent, then been wiped out everywhere besides Ireland and the Pyrenees, but the researchers say their sampling and subsequent DNA analysis eliminate that possibility too. “If the snails naturally colonized Ireland, you would expect to find some of the same genetic type in other areas of Europe, especially Britain. We just don’t find them,” Davidson, the lead author, said in a press statement.

Moreover, if they’d gradually spread across the continent, there would be some genetic variation within the white-lipped type, because evolution would introduce variety over the thousands of years it would have taken them to spread from the Pyrenees to Ireland. That variation doesn’t exist, at least in the genes sampled. This means that rather than the organism gradually expanding its range, large populations instead were somehow moved en masse to the other location within the space of a few dozen generations, ensuring a lack of genetic variety.

“There is a very clear pattern, which is difficult to explain except by involving humans,” Davidson said. Humans, after all, colonized Ireland roughly 9,000 years ago, and the oldest fossil evidence of grove snails in Ireland dates to roughly the same era. Additionally, there is archaeological evidence of early sea trade between the ancient peoples of Spain and Ireland via the Atlantic and even evidence that humans routinely ate these types of snails before the advent of agriculture, as their burnt shells have been found in Stone Age trash heaps.

The simplest explanation, then? Boats. These snails may have inadvertently traveled on the floor of the small, coast-hugging skiffs these early humans used for travel, or they may have been intentionally carried to Ireland by the seafarers as a food source. “The highways of the past were rivers and the ocean—as the river that flanks the Pyrenees was an ancient trade route to the Atlantic, what we’re actually seeing might be the long lasting legacy of snails that hitched a ride...as humans travelled from the South of France to Ireland 8,000 years ago,” Davidson said.

Question 584

The passage outlines several hypotheses and evidence related to white-lipped grove snails to arrive at the most convincing explanation for:

- A why the white-lipped variety of grove snails are found only in Ireland and the Pyrenees.
- B why the white-lipped variety of grove snails were wiped out everywhere except in Ireland and the Pyrenees.
- C how the white-lipped variety of grove snails might have migrated from the Pyrenees to Ireland.
- D how the white-lipped variety of grove snails independently evolved in Ireland and the Pyrenees.

cracku
Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

Grove snails as a whole are distributed all over Europe, but a specific variety of the snail, with a distinctive white-lipped shell, is found exclusively in Ireland and in the Pyrenees mountains that lie on the border between France and Spain. The researcher sampled a total of 423 snail specimens from 36 sites distributed across Europe, with an emphasis on gathering large numbers of the white-lipped variety. When they sequenced genes from the mitochondrial DNA of each of these snails and used algorithms to analyze the genetic diversity between them, they found that... a distinct lineage (the snails with the white-lipped shells) was indeed endemic to the two very specific and distant places in question.

Explaining this is tricky. Previously, some had speculated that the strange distributions of creatures such as the white-lipped grove snails could be explained by convergent evolution—in which two populations evolve the same trait by coincidence—but the underlying genetic similarities between the two

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 585

In paragraph 4, the evidence that “humans routinely ate these types of snails before the advent of agriculture” can be used to conclude that:

- A white-lipped grove snails may have inadvertently traveled from the Pyrenees to Ireland on the floor of the small, coast-hugging skiffs that early seafarers used for travel.
- B 9,000 years ago, during the Stone Age, humans traveled from the South of France to Ireland via the Atlantic Ocean.
- C rivers and oceans in the Stone Age facilitated trade in white-lipped grove snails.
- D the seafarers who traveled from the Pyrenees to Ireland might have carried white-lipped grove snails with them as edibles.

cracku
Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

Grove snails as a whole are distributed all over Europe, but a specific variety of the snail, with a distinctive white-lipped shell, is found exclusively in Ireland and in the Pyrenees mountains that lie on the border between France and Spain. The researcher sampled a total of 423 snail specimens from 36 sites distributed across Europe, with an emphasis on gathering large numbers of the white-lipped variety. When they sequenced genes from the mitochondrial DNA of each of these snails and used algorithms to analyze the genetic diversity between them, they found that... a distinct lineage (the snails with the white-lipped shells) was indeed endemic to the two very specific and distant places in question.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 586

All of the following evidence supports the passage's explanation of sea travel/trade EXCEPT:

- A the oldest fossil evidence of white-lipped grove snails in Ireland dates back to roughly 9,000 years ago, the time when humans colonised Ireland.
- B archaeological evidence of early sea trade between the ancient peoples of Spain and Ireland via the Atlantic Ocean.
- C absence of genetic variation within the white-lipped grove snails of Ireland and the Pyrenees, whose genes were sampled.
- D the coincidental existence of similar traits in the white-lipped grove snails of Ireland and the Pyrenees because of convergent evolution.

cracku
Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

Grove snails as a whole are distributed all over Europe, but a specific variety of the snail, with a distinctive white-lipped shell, is found exclusively in Ireland and in the Pyrenees mountains that lie on the border between France and Spain. The researcher sampled a total of 423 snail specimens from 36 sites distributed across Europe, with an emphasis on gathering large numbers of the white-lipped variety. When they sequenced genes from the mitochondrial DNA of each of these snails and used algorithms to analyze the genetic diversity between them, they found that... a distinct lineage (the snails with the white-lipped shells) was indeed endemic to the two very specific and distant places in question.

Explaining this is tricky. Previously, some had speculated that the strange distributions of creatures such as the white-lipped grove snails could be explained by convergent evolution—in which two populations evolve the same trait by coincidence—but the underlying genetic similarities between the two

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 587

Which one of the following makes the author eliminate convergent evolution as a probable explanation for why white-lipped grove snails are found in Ireland and the Pyrenees?

- A The coincidental evolution of similar traits (white-lipped shell) in the grove snails of Ireland and the Pyrenees.
- B The absence of genetic variation between white-lipped grove snails of Ireland and the Pyrenees.
- C The absence of genetic similarities between white-lipped grove snails of Ireland and snails from other parts of Europe, especially Britain.
- D The distinct lineage of white-lipped grove snails found specifically in Ireland and the Pyrenees.

Grove snails as a whole are distributed all over Europe, but a specific variety of the snail, with a distinctive white-lipped shell, is found exclusively in Ireland and in the Pyrenees mountains that lie on the border between France and Spain. The researcher sampled a total of 423 snail specimens from 36 sites distributed across Europe, with an emphasis on gathering large numbers of the white-lipped variety. When they sequenced genes from the mitochondrial DNA of each of these snails and used algorithms to analyze the genetic diversity between them, they found that... a distinct lineage (the snails with the white-lipped shells) was indeed endemic to the two very specific and distant places in question.

Explaining this is tricky. Previously, some had speculated that the strange distributions of creatures such as the white-lipped grove snails could be explained by convergent evolution—in which two populations evolve the same trait by coincidence—but the underlying genetic similarities between the two

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the given questions

The complexity of modern problems often precludes any one person from fully understanding them. Factors contributing to rising obesity levels, for example, include transportation systems and infrastructure, media, convenience foods, changing social norms, human biology and psychological factors. . . . The multidimensional or layered character of complex problems also undermines the principle of meritocracy: the idea that the 'best person' should be hired. There is no best person. When putting together an oncological research team, a biotech company such as Gilead or Genentech would not construct a multiple-choice test and hire the top scorers, or hire people whose resumes score highest according to some performance criteria. Instead, they would seek diversity. They would build a team of people who bring diverse knowledge bases, tools and analytic skills. . . .

Believers in a meritocracy might grant that teams ought to be diverse but then argue that meritocratic principles should apply within each category. Thus the team should consist of the 'best' mathematicians, the 'best' oncologists, and the 'best' biostatisticians from within the pool. That position suffers from a similar flaw. Even with a knowledge domain, no test or criteria applied to individuals will produce the best team. Each of these domains possesses such depth and breadth, that no test can exist. Consider the field of neuroscience. Upwards of 50,000 papers were published last year covering various techniques, domains of enquiry and levels of analysis, ranging from molecules and synapses up through networks of neurons. Given that complexity, any attempt to rank a collection of neuroscientists from best to worst, as if they were competitors in the 50-metre butterfly, must fail. What could be true is that given a specific task and the composition of a particular team, one scientist would be more likely to contribute than another. Optimal hiring depends on context. Optimal teams will be diverse.

Evidence for this claim can be seen in the way that papers and patents that combine diverse ideas tend to rank as high-impact. It can also be found in the structure of the so-called random decision forest, a state-of-the-art machine-learning algorithm. Random forests consist of ensembles of decision trees. If classifying pictures, each tree makes a vote: is that a picture of a fox or a dog? A weighted majority rules. Random forests can serve many ends. They can identify bank fraud and diseases, recommend ceiling fans and predict online dating behaviour. When building a forest, you do not select the best trees as they tend to make similar classifications. You want diversity. Programmers achieve that diversity by training each tree on different data, a technique known as bagging. They also boost the forest 'cognitively' by training trees on the hardest cases - those that the current forest gets wrong. This ensures even more diversity and accurate forests.

Yet the fallacy of meritocracy persists. Corporations, non-profits, governments, universities and even preschools test, score and hire the 'best'. This all but guarantees not creating the best team. Ranking people by common criteria produces homogeneity. . . . That's not likely to lead to breakthroughs.

Question 588

The author critiques meritocracy for all the following reasons EXCEPT that:

- A an ideal team comprises of best individuals from diverse fields of knowledge.
- B diversity and context-specificity are important for making major advances in any field.
- C modern problems are multifaceted and require varied skill-sets to be solved.
- D criteria designed to assess merit are insufficient to test expertise in any field of knowledge.

cracku

Read the passage carefully and answer the given questions

The complexity of modern problems often precludes any one person from fully understanding them. Factors contributing to rising obesity levels, for example, include transportation systems and infrastructure, media, convenience foods, changing social norms, human biology and psychological factors. ... The multidimensional or layered character of complex problems also undermines the principle of meritocracy: the idea that the 'best person' should be hired. There is no best person. When putting together an oncological research team, a biotech company such as Gilead or Genentech would not construct a multiple-choice test and hire the top scorers, or hire people whose resumes score highest according to some performance criteria. Instead, they would seek diversity. They would build a team of people who bring diverse knowledge bases, tools and analytic skills. ...

Believers in a meritocracy might grant that teams ought to be diverse but then argue that meritocratic

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100+ CAT DILR Questions



Question 589

Which of the following conditions, if true, would invalidate the passage's main argument?

- A If it were proven that teams characterised by diversity end up being conflicted about problems and take a long time to arrive at a solution.
- B If a new machine-learning algorithm were developed that proved to be more effective than the random decision forest.
- C If top-scorers possessed multidisciplinary knowledge that enabled them to look at a problem from several perspectives.
- D If assessment tests were made more extensive and rigorous.

cracku

Read the passage carefully and answer the given questions

The complexity of modern problems often precludes any one person from fully understanding them. Factors contributing to rising obesity levels, for example, include transportation systems and infrastructure, media, convenience foods, changing social norms, human biology and psychological factors. ... The multidimensional or layered character of complex problems also undermines the principle of meritocracy: the idea that the 'best person' should be hired. There is no best person. When putting together an oncological research team, a biotech company such as Gilead or Genentech would not construct a multiple-choice test and hire the top scorers, or hire people whose resumes score highest according to some performance criteria. Instead, they would seek diversity. They would build a team of people who bring diverse knowledge bases, tools and analytic skills. ...

Believers in a meritocracy might grant that teams ought to be diverse but then argue that meritocratic

Question 590

On the basis of the passage, which of the following teams is likely to be most effective in solving the problem of rising obesity levels?

- A A specialised team of nutritionists from various countries, who are also trained in the machine-learning algorithm of random decision forest.
- B A team comprised of nutritionists, psychologists, urban planners and media personnel, who have each scored a distinction in their respective subject tests.
- C A specialised team of top nutritionists from various countries, who also possess some knowledge of psychology.
- D A team comprised of nutritionists, psychologists, urban planners and media personnel, who have each performed well in their respective subject tests.

cracku

Read the passage carefully and answer the given questions

The complexity of modern problems often precludes any one person from fully understanding them. Factors contributing to rising obesity levels, for example, include transportation systems and infrastructure, media, convenience foods, changing social norms, human biology and psychological factors. ... The multidimensional or layered character of complex problems also undermines the principle of meritocracy: the idea that the 'best person' should be hired. There is no best person. When putting together an oncological research team, a biotech company such as Gilead or Genentech would not construct a multiple-choice test and hire the top scorers, or hire people whose resumes score highest according to some performance criteria. Instead, they would seek diversity. They would build a team of people who bring diverse knowledge bases, tools and analytic skills. ...

Believers in a meritocracy might grant that teams ought to be diverse but then argue that meritocratic

Question 591

Which of the following conditions would weaken the efficacy of a random decision forest?

- A If the types of decision trees in each ensemble of the forest were doubled.
- B If a large number of decision trees in the ensemble were trained on data derived from easy cases.
- C If the types of ensembles of decision trees in the forest were doubled.
- D If a large number of decision trees in the ensemble were trained on data derived from easy and hard cases.



A In narrow fields of knowledge, a meaningful assessment of expertise has always been possible.

B Unlike other fields of knowledge, neuroscience is an exceptionally complex field, making a meaningful assessment of neuroscientists impossible.

C In the modern age, every field of knowledge is so vast that a meaningful assessment of merit is impossible.

D Neuroscience is an advanced field of science because of its connections with other branches of science like oncology and biostatistics.



In the late 1960s, while studying the northern-elephant-seal population along the coasts of Mexico and California, Burney Le Boeuf and his colleagues couldn't help but notice that the threat calls of males at some sites sounded different from those of males at other sites. . . . That was the first time dialects were documented in a nonhuman mammal. . . .

In order to test the reliability of these dialects over time, Le Boeuf and other researchers visited Año Nuevo Island in California—the island where males showed the slowest pulse rates in their calls—every winter from 1968 to 1972. “What we found is that the pulse rate increased, but it still remained relatively slow compared to the other colonies we had measured in the past” Le Boeuf told me.

As the population continued to expand and the islands kept on receiving immigrants from the original population, the calls in all locations would have eventually regressed to the average pulse rate of the founder colony. In the decades that followed, scientists noticed that the geographical variations reported in 1969 were not obvious anymore. . . . In the early 2010s, while studying northern elephant seals on Año Nuevo Island, [researcher Caroline] Casey noticed, too, that what Le Boeuf had heard decades ago was not what she heard now. . . . By performing more sophisticated statistical analyses on both sets of data, [Casey and Le Boeuf] confirmed that dialects existed back then but had vanished. Yet there are other differences between the males from the late 1960s and their great-great-grandsons: Modern males exhibit more individual diversity, and their calls are more complex. While 50 years ago the drumming pattern was quite simple and the dialects denoted just a change in tempo, Casey explained, the calls recorded today have more complex structures, sometimes featuring doublets or triplets. . . .

All of the following can be inferred from Le Boeuf's study as described in the passage EXCEPT that:

- 345/732

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

In the late 1960s, while studying the northern-elephant-seal population along the coasts of Mexico and California, Burney Le Boeuf and his colleagues couldn't help but notice that the threat calls of males at some sites sounded different from those of males at other sites.... That was the first time dialects were documented in a nonhuman mammal....

All the northern elephant seals that exist today are descendants of the small herd that survived on Isla Guadalupe [after the near extinction of the species in the nineteenth century]. As that tiny population grew, northern elephant seals started to recolonize former breeding locations. It was precisely on the more recently colonized islands where Le Boeuf found that the tempo of the male vocal displays showed stronger differences to the ones in Isla Guadalupe, the founder colony.

In order to test the reliability of these dialects over time, Le Boeuf and other researchers visited Aho Nuevo Island in California—the island where males showed the slowest pulse rates in their calls—every winter from 1968 to 1972. "What we found is that the pulse rate increased, but it still remained relatively slow compared to the other colonies we had measured in the past" Le Boeuf told me.

At the individual level, the pulse of the calls stayed the same: A male would maintain his vocal signature throughout his lifetime. But the

para ①: late 1960s → Burney Le Boeuf
↓
dialects in

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 594

Which one of the following best sums up the overall history of transformation of male northern elephant seal calls?

- A Owing to migrations in the aftermath of near species extinction, the average call pulse rates in the recolonised breeding locations exhibited a gradual increase until they matched the tempo at the founding colony.
- B The calls have transformed from exhibiting simple composition, less individual variety, and great regional variety to complex composition, great individual variety, and less regional variety.
- C Owing to migrations in the aftermath of near species extinction, the calls have transformed from exhibiting complex composition, less individual variety, and great regional variety to simple composition, less individual variety, and great regional variety.
- D The calls have transformed from exhibiting simple composition, great individual variety, and less regional variety to complex composition, less individual variety, and great regional variety.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

In the late 1960s, while studying the northern-elephant-seal population along the coasts of Mexico and California, Burney Le Boeuf and his colleagues couldn't help but notice that the threat calls of males at some sites sounded different from those of males at other sites.... That was the first time dialects were documented in a nonhuman mammal....

All the northern elephant seals that exist today are descendants of the small herd that survived on Isla Guadalupe [after the near extinction of the species in the nineteenth century]. As that tiny population grew, northern elephant seals started to recolonize former breeding locations. It was precisely on the more recently colonized islands where Le Boeuf found that the tempo of the male vocal displays showed stronger differences to the ones in Isla Guadalupe, the founder colony.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF



Question 595

Which one of the following conditions, if true, could have ensured that male northern elephant seal dialects did not disappear?

- A Besides Isla Guadalupe, there was one more surviving colony with the same average male call tempo from which no migration took place.
- B The call tempo of individual male seals in host colonies changed to match the average call tempo of immigrant male seals.
- C Besides Isla Guadalupe, there was one more founder colony with the same average male call tempo from which male seals migrated to various other colonies.
- D The call tempo of individual immigrant male seals changed to match the average tempo of resident male seals in the host colony.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

In the late 1960s, while studying the northern-elephant-seal population along the coasts of Mexico and California, Burney Le Boeuf and his colleagues couldn't help but notice that the threat calls of males at some sites sounded different from those of males at other sites. ... That was the first time dialects were documented in a nonhuman mammal. ...

All the northern elephant seals that exist today are descendants of the small herd that survived on Isla Guadalupe [after the extinction of the species in the nineteenth century]. As that tiny population grew, northern elephant seals started to recolonize former breeding locations. It was precisely on the more recently colonized islands where Le Boeuf found that the tempo of the male vocal displays showed stronger differences to the ones from Isla Guadalupe, the founder colony.

In order to test the reliability of these dialects over time, Le Boeuf and other researchers visited Año Nuevo Island in California—the island where males showed the slowest pulse rates in their calls—every winter from 1968 to 1972. "What we found is that the pulse rate increased, but it still remained relatively slow compared to the other colonies we had measured in the past," Le Boeuf told me.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 596

From the passage it can be inferred that the call pulse rate of male northern elephant seals in the southern rookeries was faster because:

- A the male northern elephant seals of Isla Guadalupe with faster call pulse rates might have been the original settlers of the southern rookeries.
- B a large number of male northern elephant seals migrated from the southern rookeries to Año Nuevo Island in the early 1970s.
- C a large number of male northern elephant seals from Año Nuevo Island might have migrated to the southern rookeries to recolonise them.
- D the calls of male northern elephant seals in the southern rookeries have more sophisticated structures, containing doublets and triplets.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

In the late 1960s, while studying the northern elephant-seal population along the coasts of Mexico and California, Burney Le Boeuf and his colleagues couldn't help but notice that the threat calls of males at some sites sounded different from those of males at other sites... That was the first time dialects were documented in a nonhuman mammal...

All the northern elephant seals that exist today are descendants of the small herd that survived on Isla Guadalupe [after the extinction of the species in the nineteenth century]. As the population grew, northern elephant seals started to recolonize former breeding locations. It was precisely on the more recently colonized islands where Le Boeuf found that the temporal vocal displays showed stronger differences to the ones on Isla Guadalupe, the founder colony.

In order to test the reliability of these dialects over time, Le Boeuf and other researchers visited Año Nuevo Island in California—the island where males showed the slowest pulse rates in their calls—every winter from 1968 to 1972. “What we found is that the pulse rate increased, but it still remained relatively slow compared to the other colonies we had measured in the past” Le Boeuf told me.

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cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

(. . .) There are three other common drivers for carnivore-human attacks, some of which are more preventable than others. Natural aggression-based conflicts - such as those involving females protecting their young or animals protecting a food source - can often be avoided as long as people stay away from those animals and their food.

Carnivores that recognise humans as a means to get food, are a different story. As they become more reliant on human food they might find at campsites or in rubbish bins, they become less avoidant of humans. Losing that instinctive fear response puts them into more situations where they could get into an altercation with a human, which often results in that bear being put down by humans. “A fed bear is a dead bear,” says Servheen, referring to a common saying among biologists and conservationists. Predatory or predation-related attacks are quite rare, only accounting for 17% of attacks in North America since 1955. They occur when a carnivore views a human as prey and hunts it like it would any other animal it uses for food. (. . .)

Then there are animal attacks provoked by people taking pictures with them or feeding them in natural settings such as national parks which often end with animals being euthanised out of precaution. “Eventually, that animal becomes habituated to people, and [then] bad things happen to the animal. And the folks who initially wanted to make that connection don’t necessarily realise that,” says Christine Wilkinson, a postdoctoral researcher at UC Berkeley, California, who’s been studying coyote-human conflicts.

After conducting countless postmortems on all types of carnivore-human attacks spanning 75 years, Penteriani’s team believes 50% could have been avoided if humans reacted differently. A 2017 study co-authored by Penteriani found that engaging in risky behaviour around large carnivores increases the likelihood of an attack.

Two of the most common risky behaviours are parents leaving their children to play outside unattended and walking an unleashed dog, according to the study. Wilkinson says 66% of coyote attacks involve a dog. “[People] end up in a situation where their dog is being chased, or their dog chases a coyote, or maybe they’re walking their dog near a den that’s marked, and the coyote wants to escort them away,” says Wilkinson.

Experts believe climate change also plays a part in the escalation of human-carnivore conflicts, but the correlation still needs to be ironed out. “As finite resources become scarcer, carnivores and people are coming into more frequent contact, which means that more conflict could occur,” says Jen Miller, international programme specialist for the US Fish & Wildlife Service. For example, she says, there was an uptick in lion attacks in western India during a drought when lions and people were relying on the same water sources.

(. . .) The likelihood of human-carnivore conflicts appears to be higher in areas of low-income countries dominated by vast rural landscapes and farmland, according to Penteriani’s research. “There are a lot of working landscapes in the Global South that are really heterogeneous, that are interspersed with carnivore habitats, forests and savannahs, which creates a lot more opportunity for these encounters, just statistically,” says Wilkinson.

Question 597

Which of the following statements, if false, would be inconsistent with the concerns raised in the passage regarding the drivers of carnivore-human conflicts?

- A Climate change has had negligible effects on the frequency of carnivore-human interactions in affected regions.
- B Predatory attacks by carnivores are a common occurrence and have steadily increased over the past few decades.
- C Carnivores lose their instinctive fear of humans, when consistently exposed to human food sources.
- D Human efforts to avoid risky behaviours around large carnivores have proven effective in reducing conflict incidents.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

(...) There are three other common drivers for carnivore-human attacks, some of which are more preventable than others. Natural aggression-based conflicts - such as those involving females protecting their young or animals protecting a food source - can often be avoided as long as people stay away from those animals and their food.

Carnivores that recognise humans as a means to good food, are a different story. As they become more reliant on human food they might find at campsites or in rubbish bins, they become less avoidant of humans. Losing that instinctive fear response puts them into more situations where they could get into an altercation with a human, which often results in that bear being put down by humans. "A fed bear is a dead bear," says Servheen, referring to a common saying among biologists and conservationists. Predatory or predation-related attacks are quite rare, only accounting for 17% of attacks in North America since 1955. They occur when a carnivore views a human as prey and hunts it like it would any other animal it uses for food. (...)

Then there are animal attacks provoked by people taking

→ One driver of C-H attacks
→ natural aggression over food
young ones → avoidable



VIDEO SOLUTION

 **CAT Important Topics** 

Question 598

According to the passage, which of the following scenarios would MOST likely exacerbate the frequency of carnivore-human conflicts?

- A Implementing 'food waste' management strategies to prevent wild animals being attracted to human food sources.
- B Addressing the impact of climate change on the availability of resources for wildlife.
- C Attempting to photograph wild animals from within secured viewing areas in national parks and protected zones.
- D Unleashing dogs by pet owners in areas with known high concentrations of large carnivores.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

(...) There are three other common drivers for carnivore-human attacks, some of which are more preventable than others. Natural aggression-based conflicts - such as those involving females protecting their young or animals protecting a food source - can often be avoided as long as people stay away from those animals and their food.

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Then there are animal attacks provoked by people taking

→ One driver of C-H attacks
→ natural aggression over food
young ones → avoidable



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 599

According to the passage, what is a significant factor that contributes to the habituation of carnivores to human presence?

- A The natural aggression exhibited by carnivores, exacerbated by human interference, particularly when they are safeguarding their offspring or food sources.
- B The increased scarcity of resources due to climate change, forcing carnivores to venture outside their natural habitats in search of sustenance.
- C The predatory perception of humans as potential prey within the carnivores' food chain.
- D The reduction in carnivores' instinctive fear response, resulting from their reliance upon human-provided food.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

(...) There are three other common drivers for carnivore-human attacks, some of which are more preventable than others. Natural aggression-based conflicts - such as those involving females protecting their young or animals protecting a food source - can often be avoided as long as people stay away from those animals and their food.

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Then there are animal attacks provoked by people taking

→ One driver of C-H attacks
→ natural aggression over food
young ones → avoidable



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 600

Given the insights provided by Penteriani's research and Wilkinson's statement, which of the following conclusions can be drawn about the relationship between landscape heterogeneity and human-carnivore conflicts?

- A Low-income countries with vast, contiguous wilderness areas are less prone to human-carnivore conflicts because these areas lack the human presence necessary for such encounters.

- Landscape heterogeneity, characterized by a mix of farmland and natural habitats, inherently reduces the chances of human-carnivore conflicts by providing more refuge for wildlife away from human activity.
- B Homogeneous landscapes with uniform agricultural practices are more likely to experience high rates of human-carnivore conflicts due to the predictability of resources.
- C The diversity and interspersed of working landscapes with carnivore habitats in rural areas increase the statistical probability of encounters between humans and carnivores.
- D

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

(...) There are three other common drivers for carnivore-human attacks, some of which are more preventable than others. Natural aggression-based conflicts - such as those involving females protecting their young or animals protecting a food source - can often be avoided as long as people stay away from those animals and their food.

Carnivores that recognise humans as a means to good food, are a different story. As they become more reliant on human food they might find at campsites or in rubbish bins, they become less avoidant of humans. Losing that instinctive fear response puts them into more situations where they could get into an altercation with a human, which often results in that bear being put down by humans. "A fed bear is a dead bear," says Servheen, referring to a common saying among biologists and conservationists. Predatory or predation-related attacks are quite rare, only accounting for 17% of attacks in North America since 1955. They occur when a carnivore views a human as prey and hunts it like it would any other animal it uses for food. (...) Then there are animal attacks provoked by people taking

→ One driver of C-H attacks
→ natural aggression over food
young ones → avoidable



VIDEO SOLUTION



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Instructions

That the doctrines connected with the name of Mr Darwin are altering our principles has become a sort of commonplace thing to say. And moral principles are said to share in this general transformation. Now, to pass by other subjects, I do not see why Darwinism need change our ultimate moral ideas. It will not modify our conception of the end, either for the community or the individual, unless we have been holding views which long before Darwin were out of date. As to the principles of ethics I perceive, in short, no sign of revolution. Darwinism has indeed helped many to a truer conception of the end, but I cannot admit that it has either originated or modified that conception.

And yet in ethics Darwinism after all perhaps be revolutionary. It may lead not to another view about the end, but to a different way of regarding the relative importance of the means. For in the ordinary moral creed those means seem estimated on no rational principle. Our creed appears rather to be an irrational mixture of jarring elements. We have the moral code of Christianity, accepted in part and in part rejected practically by all save a few fanatics. But we do not realise how in its very principle the Christian ideal is false. And when we reject this code for another and in part a sounder morality, we are in the same condition of blindness and of practical confusion. It is here that Darwinism, with all the tendencies we may group under that name, seems destined to intervene. It will make itself felt, I believe, more and more effectually. It may force on us in some points a correction of our moral views, and a return to a non-Christian and perhaps a Hellenic ideal. I propose to illustrate here these general statements by some remarks on Punishment.

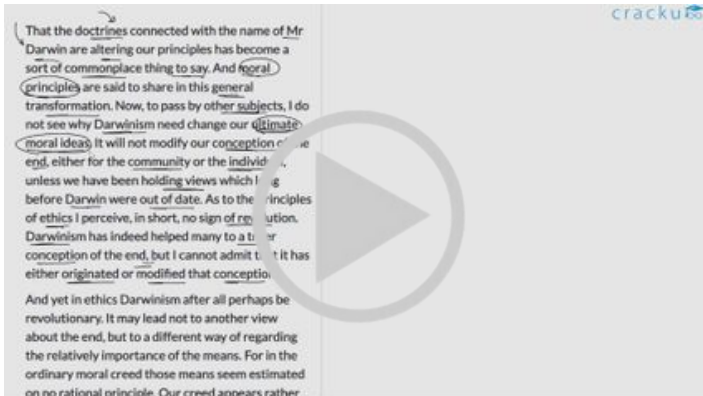
Darwinism, I have said, has not even modified our ideas of the Chief Good. We may take that as — the welfare of the community realised in its members. There is, of course, a question as to the meaning to be given to welfare. We may identify that with mere pleasure, or again with mere system, or may rather view both as inseparable aspects of perfection and individuality. And the extent and nature of the community would once more be a subject for some discussion. But we are not forced to enter on these controversies here. We may leave welfare undefined, and for present purposes need not distinguish the community from the state. The

welfare of this whole exists, of course, nowhere outside the individuals, and the individuals again have rights and duties only as members in the whole. This is the revived Hellenism — or we may call it the organic view of things — urged by German Idealism early in the present century.

Question 601

What, according to the passage, is the Chief Good?

- A Being good and kind to all fellow human beings.
- B The greatest good of the greatest number.
- C The welfare of the community realised in its members.
- D Cannot be determined from the passage.

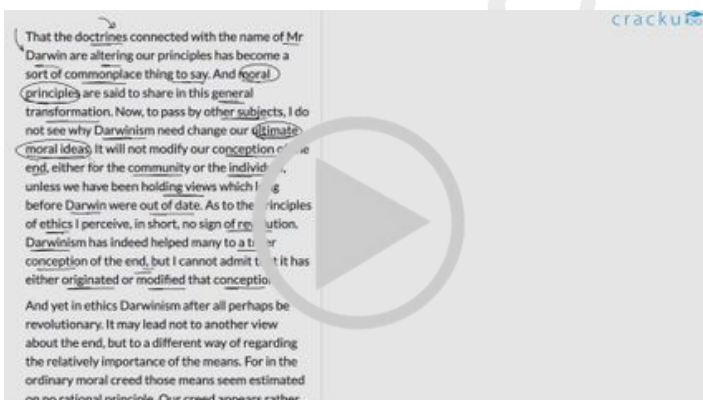


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 602

It is implied in the passage that

- A a Hellenic ideal is not a proper substitute of the Christian ideal.
- B what mankind needs is a Hellenic ideal rather than a Christian one.
- C Darwinism is more Christian than Hellenic.
- D fanatics do not understand what Darwinism really is.

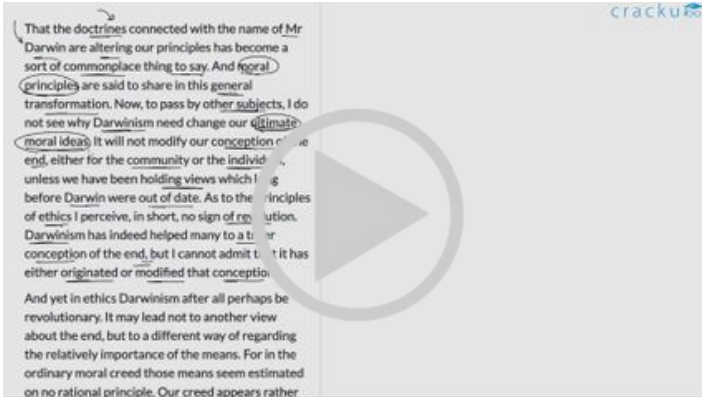


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 603

What is most probably the author's opinion of the existing moral principles of the people?

- A He thinks they have to be revamped in the light of Darwinism.
- B He thinks that they are okay as they are and do not need any major change.
- C He thinks that it may be a good idea to have a modicum of the immortal Darwinism in us.
- D Cannot be determined from the passage.



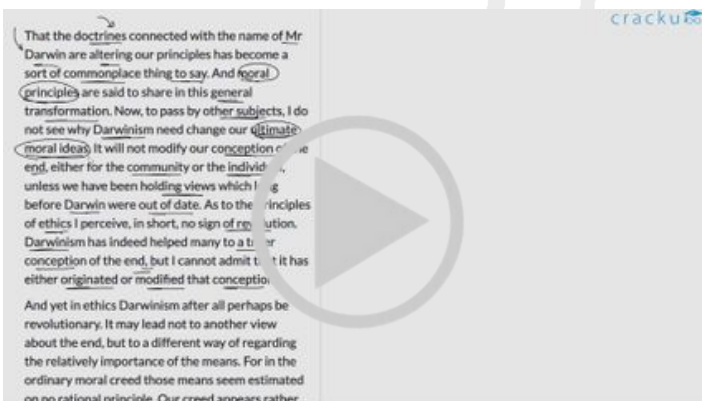
 VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 604

According to the author, the doctrines of Mr Darwin

- A have changed our physical and moral principles.
- B have to be re-evaluated to correct the faults endemic in them.
- C do not have to change our moral ideas.
- D are actually new versions of old moral rules.

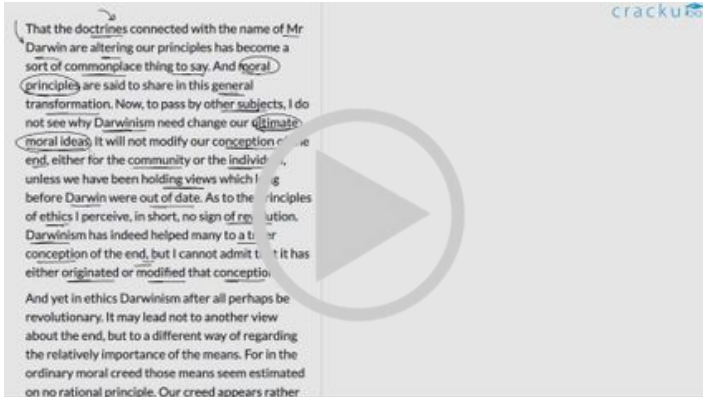


 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 605

According to the author, the moral code of Christianity

- A is not followed by most people.
- B is in danger due to opposition of Darwinism.
- C is followed by a vast majority of people.
- D is totally ignored by all true Christians.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Fifteen years after communism was officially pronounced dead, its spectre seems once again to be haunting Europe. Last month, the Council of Europe's parliamentary assembly voted to condemn the "crimes of totalitarian communist regimes," linking them with Nazism and complaining that communist parties are still "legal and active in some countries." Now Goran Lindblad, the conservative Swedish MP behind the resolution, wants to go further. Demands that European Ministers launch a continent-wide anti-communist campaign – including school textbook revisions, official memorial days, and museums – only narrowly missed the necessary two-thirds majority. Mr. Lindblad pledged to bring the wider plans back to the Council of Europe in the coming months:

He has chosen a good year for his ideological offensive: this is the 50th anniversary of Nikita Khrushchev's denunciation of Josef Stalin and the subsequent Hungarian uprising, which will doubtless be the cue for further excoriation of the communist record. Paradoxically, given that there is no communist government left in Europe outside Moldova, the attacks have if anything, become more extreme as time has gone on. A clue as to why that might be can be found in the rambling report by Mr. Lindblad that led to the Council of Europe declaration. Blaming class struggle and public ownership, he explained "different elements of communist ideology such as equality or social justice still seduce many" and "a sort of nostalgia for communism is still alive." Perhaps the real problem for Mr. Lindblad and his right-wing allies in Eastern Europe is that communism is not dead enough – and they will only be content when they have driven a stake through its heart.

The fashionable attempt to equate communism and Nazism is in reality a moral and historical nonsense. Despite the cruelties of the Stalin terror, there was no Soviet Treblinka or Sobibor, no extermination camps built to murder millions. Nor did the Soviet Union launch the most devastating war in history at a cost of more than 50 million lives – in fact it played the decisive role in the defeat of the German war machine. Mr. Lindblad and the Council of Europe adopt as fact the wildest estimates of those "killed by communist regimes" (mostly in famines) from the fiercely contested Black Book of Communism, which also underplays the number of deaths attributable to Hitler. But, in any case, none of this explains why anyone might be nostalgic in former communist states, now enjoying the delights of capitalist restoration.

The dominant account gives no sense of how communist regimes renewed themselves after 1956 or why Western leaders feared they might overtake the capitalist world well into the 1960s. For all its brutalities and failures, communism in the Soviet Union, Eastern Europe, and elsewhere delivered rapid industrialization, mass

education, job security, and huge advances in social and gender equality. Its existence helped to drive up welfare standards in the west, and provided a powerful counterweight to western global domination.

It would be easier to take the Council of Europe's condemnation of communist state crimes seriously if it had also seen fit to denounce the far bloodier record of European colonialism – which only finally came to an end in the 1970s. This was a system of racist despotism, which dominated the globe in Stalin's time. And while there is precious little connection between the ideas of fascism and communism, there is an intimate link between colonialism and Nazism. The terms lebensraum and konzentrationslager were both first used by the German colonial regime in South-West Africa (now Namibia), which committed genocide against the Herero and Nama peoples and bequeathed its ideas and personnel directly to the Nazi parry.

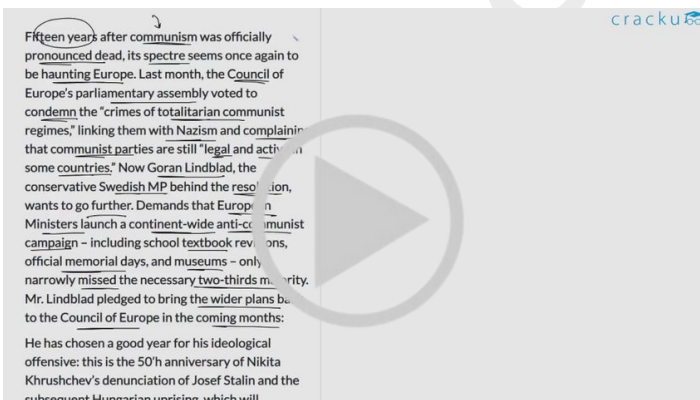
Around 10 million Congolese died as a result of Belgian forced labor and mass murder in the early twentieth century; tens of millions perished in avoidable or enforced famines in British-ruled India; up to a million Algerians died in their war for independence, while controversy now rages in France about a new law requiring teachers to put a positive spin on colonial history. Comparable atrocities were carried out by all European colonialists, but not a word of condemnation from the Council of Europe. Presumably, European lives count for more.

No major twentieth century political tradition is without blood on its hands, but battles over history are more about the future than the past. Part of the current enthusiasm in official Western circles for dancing on the grave of communism is no doubt about relations with today's Russia and China. But it also reflects a determination to prove there is no alternative to the new global capitalist order – and that any attempt to find one is bound to lead to suffering. With the new imperialism now being resisted in the Muslim world and Latin America, growing international demands for social justice and ever greater doubts about whether the environmental crisis can be solved within the existing economic system, the pressure for alternatives will increase.

Question 606

What, according to the author, is the real reason for a renewed attack against communism?

- A Disguising the unintended consequences of the current economic order such as social injustice and environmental crisis.
- B Idealising the existing ideology of global capitalism.
- C Making communism a generic representative of all historical atrocities, especially those perpetrated by the European imperialists.
- D Communism still survives, in bits and pieces, in the minds and hearts of people.
- E Renewal of some communist regimes has led to the apprehension that communist nations might overtake the capitalists.

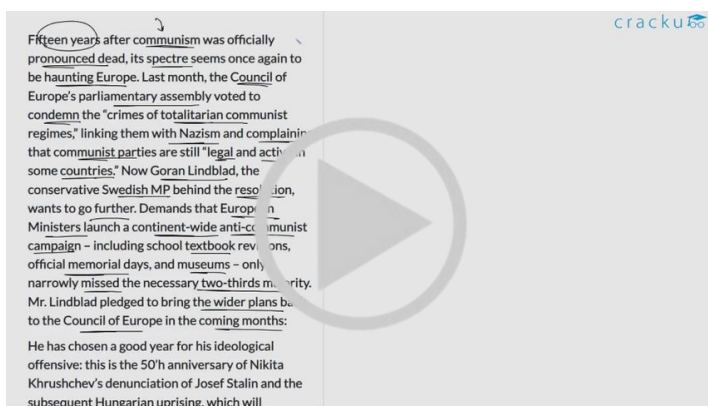


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 607

Which of the following cannot be inferred as a compelling reason for the silence of the Council of Europe on colonial atrocities?

- A The Council of Europe being dominated by erstwhile colonialists.
- B Generating support for condemning communist ideology.
- C Unwillingness to antagonize allies by raking up an embarrassing past.
- D Greater value seemingly placed on European lives.
- E Portraying both communism and Nazism as ideologies to be condemned.



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 608

Why, according to the author, is Nazism closer to colonialism than it is to communism?

- A Both colonialism and Nazism were examples of tyranny of one race over another.
- B The genocides committed by the colonial and the Nazi regimes were of similar magnitude.
- C Several ideas of the Nazi regime were directly imported from colonial regimes.
- D Both colonialism and Nazism are based on the principles of imperialism.
- E While communism was never limited to Europe, both the Nazis and the colonialists originated in Europe.

Fifteen years after communism was officially pronounced dead, its spectre seems once again to be haunting Europe. Last month, the Council of Europe's parliamentary assembly voted to condemn the "crimes of totalitarian communist regimes," linking them with Nazism and complaining that communist parties are still "legal and active in some countries." Now Goran Lindblad, the conservative Swedish MP behind the resolution, wants to go further. Demands that European Ministers launch a continent-wide anti-communist campaign – including school textbook revisions, official memorial days, and museums – only narrowly missed the necessary two-thirds majority. Mr. Lindblad pledged to bring the wider plans back to the Council of Europe in the coming months.

He has chosen a good year for his ideological offensive: this is the 50th anniversary of Nikita Khrushchev's denunciation of Josef Stalin and the subsequent Hungarian uprising, which will

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 609

Among all the apprehensions that Mr. Goran Lindblad expresses against communism, which one gets admitted, although indirectly, by the author?

- A There is nostalgia for communist ideology even if communism has been abandoned by most European nations.
- B Notions of social justice inherent in communist ideology appeal to critics of existing systems.
- C Communist regimes were totalitarian and marked by brutalities and large scale violence.
- D The existing economic order is wrongly viewed as imperialistic by proponents of communism.
- E Communist ideology is faulted because communist regimes resulted in economic failures.

Fifteen years after communism was officially pronounced dead, its spectre seems once again to be haunting Europe. Last month, the Council of Europe's parliamentary assembly voted to condemn the "crimes of totalitarian communist regimes," linking them with Nazism and complaining that communist parties are still "legal and active in some countries." Now Goran Lindblad, the conservative Swedish MP behind the resolution, wants to go further. Demands that European Ministers launch a continent-wide anti-communist campaign – including school textbook revisions, official memorial days, and museums – only narrowly missed the necessary two-thirds majority. Mr. Lindblad pledged to bring the wider plans back to the Council of Europe in the coming months.

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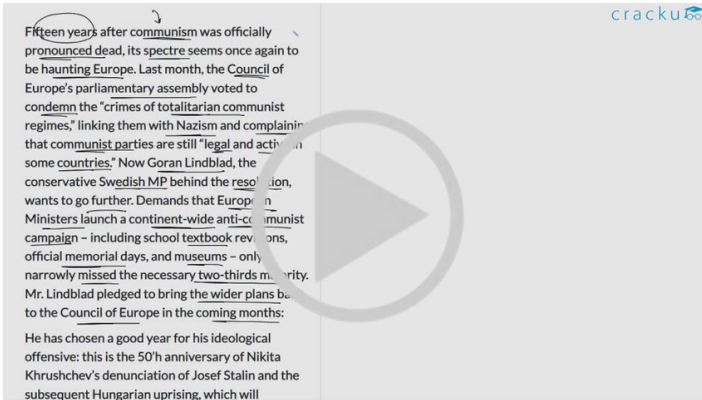



Question 610

The author cites examples of atrocities perpetrated by European colonial regimes in order to

- A compare the atrocities committed by colonial regimes with those of communist regimes.

- B prove that the atrocities committed by colonial regimes were more than those of communist regimes.
- C prove that, ideologically, communism was much better than colonialism and Nazism.
- D Neuutralise the arguments of Mr. Lindblad and to point out that the atrocities committed by colonial regimes were more than those of communist regimes. .
- E neutralize the arguments of Mr. Lindblad and to argue that one needs to go beyond and look at the motives of these regimes.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

Democracy rests on a tension between two different principles. There is, on the one hand, the principle of equality before the law, or, more generally, of equality, and, on the other, what may be described as the leadership principle. The first gives priority to rules and the second to persons. No matter how skilfully we contrive out schemes, there is a point beyond which the one principle cannot be promoted without some sacrifice of the other.

Alexis de Tocqueville, the great 19th-century writer on democracy, maintained that the age of democracy, whose birth he was witnessing, would also be the age of mediocrity; in saying this, he was thinking primarily of a regime of equality governed by impersonal rules. Despite his strong attachment to democracy, he took great pains to point out what he believed to be its negative side: a dead level plane of achievement in practically every sphere of life. The age of democracy would, in his view, be an unheroic age; there would not be room in it for either heroes or hero-worshippers.

But modern democracies have not been able to do without heroes: this too was foreseen, with much misgiving, by Tocqueville. Tocqueville viewed this with misgiving because he believed, rightly or wrongly, that unlike in aristocratic societies, there was no proper place in a democracy for heroes and, hence, when they arose, they would sooner or later turn into despots. Whether they require heroes or not, democracies certainly require leaders, and, in the contemporary age, breed them in great profusion; the problem is to know what to do with them.

In a world preoccupied with scientific rationality, the advantages of a system based on an impersonal rule of law should be a recommendation with everybody. There is something orderly and predictable about such a system. When life is lived mainly in small, self-contained communities, men are able to take finer personal distinctions into account in dealing with their fellow men. They are unable to do this in a large and amorphous society, and organised living would be impossible here without a system of impersonal rules. Above all, such a system guarantees a kind of equality to the extent that everybody, no matter in what station of life, is bound by the same explicit, often written, rules, and nobody is above them. But a system governed solely by impersonal rules can at best ensure order and stability; it cannot create any shining vision of a future in which mere formal equality will be replaced by real equality and fellowship. A world governed by impersonal rules cannot easily

change itself, or when it does, the change is so gradual as to make the basic and fundamental feature of society appear unchanged. For any kind of basic or fundamental change, a push is needed from within, a kind of individual initiative which will create new rules, new terms and conditions of life.

The issue of leadership thus acquires crucial significance in the context of change. If the modern age is preoccupied with scientific rationality, it is no less preoccupied with change. To accept what exists on its own terms is traditional, not modern, and it may be all very well to appreciate tradition in music, dance and drama, but for society as a whole the choice has already been made in favour of modernisation and development. Moreover, in some countries the gap between ideal and reality has become so great that the argument for development and change is now irresistible.

In these countries no argument for development has greater appeal or urgency than the one which shows development to be the condition for the mitigation, if not the elimination, of inequality. There is something contradictory about the very presence of large inequalities in a society which profess to be democratic. It does not take people too long to realise that democracy by itself can guarantee only formal equality; beyond this, it can only whet people's appetite for real or substantive equality. From this arises their continued preoccupation with plans and schemes that will help to bridge the gap between the ideal of equality and the reality which is so contrary to it.

When pre-existing rules give no clear directions of change, leadership comes into its own. Every democracy invests its leadership with a measure of charisma, and expects from it a corresponding measure of energy and vitality. Now, the greater the urge for change in a society, the stronger the appeal of a dynamic leadership in it. A dynamic leadership seeks to free itself from the constraints of existing rules: in a sense, that is the test of its dynamism. In this process, it may take a turn at which it ceases to regard itself as being bound by these rules, placing itself above them. There is always a tension between 'charisma' and 'discipline' in the case of a democratic leadership, and when this leadership puts forward revolutionary claims, the tension tends to be resolved at the expense of discipline.

Characteristically, the legitimacy of such a leadership rests on its claim to be able to abolish or at least substantially reduce the existing inequalities in society. From the argument that formal equality or equality before the law is but a limited good, it is often one short step to the argument that it is a hindrance or an obstacle to the establishment of real or substantive equality. The conflict between a 'progressive' executive and a 'conservative' judiciary is but one aspect of this larger problem. This conflict naturally acquires added piquancy when the executive is elected, and the judiciary appointed.

Question 611

Which of the following four statements can be inferred from the above passage?

- A. Scientific rationality is an essential feature of modernity.
- B. Scientific rationality results in the development of impersonal rules.
- C. Modernisation and development have been chosen over traditional music, dance and drama.
- D. Democracies aspire to achieve substantive equality.

- A** A, B, D but not C
- B** A, B but not C, D
- C** A, D but not B, C
- D** A, B, C but not D

some sacrifice of the other.

Alexis de Tocqueville, the great 19th-century writer on democracy, maintained that the age of democracy, whose birth he was witnessing, would also be the age of mediocrity; in saying this, he was thinking primarily of a regime of equality governed by impersonal rules. Despite his strong attachment to democracy, he took great pains to point out what he believed to be its negative side: a dead level plane of achievement in practically every sphere of life. The age of democracy would, in his view, be an unheroic age; there would not be room in it for either heroes or hero-worshippers.

But modern democracies have not been

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 612

Dynamic leaders are needed in democracies because

- A they have adopted the principles of 'formal' equality rather than 'substantive' equality.
- B 'formal' equality whets people's appetite for 'substantive' equality.
- C systems that rely on the impersonal rules of 'formal' equality lose their ability to make large changes.
- D of the conflict between a 'progressive' executive and a 'conservative' judiciary.

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But modern democracies have not been

VIDEO SOLUTION



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Question 613

Which of the following four statements can be inferred from the above passage?

- A. There is conflict between the pursuit of equality and individuality.
- B. The disadvantages of impersonal rules can be overcome in small communities.
- C. Despite limitations, impersonal rules are essential in large systems.
- D. Inspired leadership, rather than plans and schemes, is more effective in bridging inequality.

A B, D but not A, C

- B A, B but not C, D
- C A, D but not B, C
- D A, C but not B, D

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But modern democracies have not been

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 614

A key argument the author is making is that

- A in the context of extreme inequality, the issue of leadership has limited significance.
- B democracy is incapable of eradicating inequality.
- C formal equality facilitates development and change.
- D impersonal rules are good for avoiding instability but fall short of achieving real equality.

some sacrifice of the other.

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But modern democracies have not been

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 615

What possible factor would a dynamic leader consider a 'hindrance' in achieving the development goals of a nation?

- A Principle of equality before the law
- B Judicial activism
- C A conservative judiciary

D Need for discipline

some sacrifice of the other.

Alexis de Tocqueville, the great 19th-century writer on democracy, maintained that the age of democracy, whose birth he was witnessing, would also be the age of mediocrity; in saying this, he was thinking primarily of a regime of equality governed by impersonal rules. Despite his strong attachment to democracy, he took great pains to point out what he believed to be its negative side: a dead level plane of achievement in practically every sphere of life. The age of democracy would, in his view, be an unheroic age; there would not be room in it for either heroes or hero-worshippers.

But modern democracies have not been



VIDEO SOLUTION



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Question 616

Tocqueville believed that the age of democracy would be an un-heroic age because

- A democratic principles do not encourage heroes.
- B there is no urgency for development in democratic countries.
- C heroes that emerged in democracies would become despots.
- D aristocratic society had a greater ability to produce heroes.

some sacrifice of the other.

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But modern democracies have not been



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Choose the best answer for each question.

The production of histories of India has become very frequent in recent years and may well call for some explanation. Why so many and why this one in particular? The reason is a two-fold one: changes in the Indian scene requiring a re-interpretation of the facts and changes in attitudes of historians about the essential elements of Indian history. These two considerations are in addition to the normal fact of fresh information, whether in the form of archaeological discoveries throwing fresh light on an obscure period or culture, or the

revelations caused by the opening of archives or the release of private papers. The changes in the Indian scene are too obvious to need emphasis. Only two generations ago British rule seemed to most Indian as well as British observers likely to extend into an indefinite future; now there is a teenage generation which knows nothing of it. Changes in the attitudes of historians have occurred everywhere, changes in attitudes to the content of the subject as well as to particular countries, but in India, there have been some special features. Prior to the British, Indian historiographers were mostly Muslims, who relied, as in the case of Sayyid Ghulam Hussain, on their own recollection of events and on information from friends and men of affairs. Only a few like Abu'l Fazl had access to official papers. These were personal narratives of events, varying in value with the nature of the writer. The early British writers were officials. In the 18th century they were concerned with some aspect of Company policy, or like Robert Orme in his *Military Transactions* gave a straight narrative in what was essentially a continuation of the Muslim tradition. In the early 19th century the writers were still, with two notable exceptions, officials, but they were now engaged in chronicling, in varying moods of zest, pride, and awe, the rise of the British power in India to supremacy. The two exceptions were James Mill, with his critical attitude to the Company and John Marchman, the Baptist missionary. But they, like the officials, were anglo-centric in their attitude, so that the history of modern India in their hands came to be the history of the rise of the British in India.

The official school dominated the writing of Indian history until we get the first professional historian's approach. Ramsay Muir and P. E. Roberts in England and H. H. Dodwell in India. Then Indian historians trained in the English school joined in, of whom the most distinguished was Sir Jadunath Sarkar and the other notable writers: Surendranath Sen, Dr Radhakumud Mukherji, and Professor Nilakanta Sastri. They, it may be said, restored India to Indian history, but their bias was mainly political. Finally have come the nationalists who range from those who can find nothing good or true in the British to sophisticated historical philosophers like K. M. Panikkar.

Along the types of historians with their varying bias have gone changes in the attitude to the content of Indian history. Here Indian historians have been influenced both by their local situation and by changes of thought elsewhere. It is this field that this work can claim some attention since it seeks to break new ground, or perhaps to deepen a freshly turned furrow in the field of Indian history. The early official historians were content with the glamour and drama of political history from Plassey to the Mutiny, from Dupleix to the Sikhs. But when the raj was settled down, glamour departed from politics, and they turned to the less glorious but more solid ground of administration. Not how India was conquered but how it was governed was the theme of this school of historians. It found its archpriest in H. H. Dodwell, its priestess in Dame Lilian Penson, and its chief shrine in the Volume VI of the *Cambridge History of India*. Meanwhile, in Britain other currents were moving, which led historical study into the economic and social fields. R. C. Dutt entered the first of these currents with his *Economic History of India* to be followed more recently by the whole group of Indian economic historians. W. E. Moreland extended these studies to the Mughal Period. Social history is now being increasingly studied and there is also of course a school of nationalist historians who see modern Indian history in terms of the rise and the fulfilment of the national movement.

All these approaches have value, but all share in the quality of being compartmental. It is not enough to remove political history from its pedestal of being the only kind of history worth having if it is merely to put other types of history in its place. Too exclusive an attention to economic, social, or administrative history can be as sterile and misleading as too much concentration on politics. A whole subject needs a whole treatment for understanding. A historian must dissect his subject into its elements and then fuse them together again into an integrated whole. The true history of a country must contain all the features just cited but must present them as parts of a single consistent theme.

Question 617

Which of the following is the closest implication of the statement 'to break new ground, or perhaps to deepen a freshly turned furrow'?

- A Dig afresh or dig deeper.
- B Start a new stream of thought or help establish a recently emerged perspective.
- C Begin or conduct further work on existing archeological sites to unearth new evidence.

D Begin writing a history free of any biases.

Choose the best answer for each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 618

According to the author, which of the following is not among the attitudes of historians mapping Indian history?

- A Writing history as personal narratives.
- B Writing history with political bias.
- C Writing non-political history due to lack of glamour.
- D Writing history by dissecting elements and integrating them again.

Choose the best answer for each question.

The production of histories of India has become very frequent in recent years and may well call for some explanation. Why so many and why this one in particular? The reason is a two-fold one: changes in the Indian scene requiring a re-interpretation of facts and changes in attitudes of historians about the essential elements of Indian history. The two considerations are in addition to the normal fact of fresh information, whether in the form of archaeological discoveries throwing fresh light on an obscure period or culture, or the revelations caused by the opening of archives or the release of private papers. The changes in the Indian scene are too obvious to need emphasis. Only two generations ago British rule seemed to most Indian as well as British observers likely to extend into an indefinite future; now there is a teenage generation which knows nothing of it. Changes in the attitudes of historians have occurred everywhere, changes in

VIDEO SOLUTION

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Question 619

In the list given below, match the historians to the approaches taken by them.

- A - Administrative
- B - Political
- C - Narrative
- D - Economic

E - Robert Orme

F - H.H. Dodwell

G - Radha Kumud Mukherji

H - R.C. Dutt

A A - F, B - G, C - E, D - H

B A - G, B - F, C - E, D - H

C A - E, B - F, C - G, D - H

D A - F, B - H, C - E, D - G

Choose the best answer for each question.

The production of histories of India has become very frequent in recent years and may well call for some explanation. Why so many and why this one in particular? The reason is a two-fold one: changes in the Indian scene requiring a re-interpretation of facts and changes in attitudes of historians about the essential elements of Indian history. The two considerations are in addition to the normal fact of fresh information, whether in the form of archaeological discoveries throwing fresh light on an obscure period or culture, or the revelations caused by the opening of archives or the release of private papers. The changes in the Indian scene were too obvious to need emphasis. Only two generations ago British rule seemed to most Indian as well as British observers likely to extend into an indefinite future; now there is a teenage generation which knows nothing of it. Changes in the attitudes of historians have occurred everywhere, changes in

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 620

Historians moved from writing political history to writing administrative history because

- A attitudes of the historians changed.
- B the raj was settled down.
- C politics did not retain its past glamour.
- D administrative history was based on solid ground.

Choose the best answer for each question.

The production of histories of India has become very frequent in recent years and may well call for some explanation. Why so many and why this one in particular? The reason is a two-fold one: changes in the Indian scene requiring a re-interpretation of facts and changes in attitudes of historians about the essential elements of Indian history. The two considerations are in addition to the normal fact of fresh information, whether in the form of archaeological discoveries throwing fresh light on an obscure period or culture, or the revelations caused by the opening of archives or the release of private papers. The changes in the Indian scene were too obvious to need emphasis. Only two generations ago British rule seemed to most Indian as well as British observers likely to extend into an indefinite future; now there is a teenage generation which knows nothing of it. Changes in the attitudes of historians have occurred everywhere, changes in

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 621

Which of the following may be the closest in meaning to the statement 'restored India to Indian history'?

- A Indian historians began writing Indian history.
- B Trained historians began writing Indian history.
- C Writing India-centric Indian history began.
- D Indian history began to be written in India

Choose the best answer for each question.

The production of histories of India has become very frequent in recent years and may well call for some explanation. Why so many and why this one in particular? The reason is a two-fold one: changes in the Indian scene requiring a re-interpretation of facts and changes in attitudes of historians about the essential elements of Indian history. The two considerations are in addition to the normal fact of fresh information, whether in the form of archaeological discoveries throwing fresh light on an obscure period or culture, or the revelations caused by the opening of archives or the release of private papers. The changes in the Indian scene are too obvious to need emphasis. Only two generations ago British rule seemed to most Indian as well as British observers likely to extend into an indefinite future; now there is a teenage generation which knows nothing of it. Changes in the attitudes of historians have occurred everywhere, changes in

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VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Fears of artificial intelligence (AI) have haunted humanity since the very beginning of the computer age. Hitherto, these fears focused on machines using physical means to kill, enslave or replace people. But over the past couple of years, new AI tools have emerged that threaten the survival of human civilisation from an unexpected direction. AI has gained some remarkable abilities to manipulate and generate language, whether with words, sounds or images. AI has thereby hacked the operating system of our civilisation.

Language is the stuff almost all human culture is made of. Human rights, for example, aren't inscribed in our DNA. Rather, they are cultural artefacts we created by telling stories and writing laws. Gods aren't physical realities. Rather, they are cultural artefacts we created by inventing myths and writing scriptures....What would happen once a non-human intelligence becomes better than the average human at telling stories, composing melodies, drawing images, and writing laws and scriptures? When people think about Chatgpt and other new AI tools, they are often drawn to examples like schoolchildren using AI to write their essays. What will happen to the school system when kids do that? But this kind of question misses the big picture. Forget about school essays. Think of the next American presidential race in 2024, and try to imagine the impact of AI tools that can be made to mass-produce political content, fake news stories and scriptures for new cults...

Through its mastery of language, AI could even form intimate relationships with people, and use the power of intimacy to change our opinions and worldviews. Although there is no indication that AI has any consciousness or feelings of its own, to foster fake intimacy with humans, it is enough if the AI can make them feel emotionally attached to it....

What will happen to the course of history when AI takes over culture, and begins producing stories, melodies, laws and religions? Previous tools like the printing press and radio helped spread the cultural ideas of humans, but they never created new cultural ideas of their own. AI is fundamentally different. AI can create completely

new ideas, completely new culture....Of course, the new power of AI could be used for good purposes as well. I won't dwell on this because the people who develop AI talk about it enough....

We can still regulate the new AI tools, but we must act quickly. Whereas nukes cannot invent more powerful nukes, AI can make exponentially more powerful AI.... Unregulated AI deployments would create social chaos, which would benefit autocrats and ruin democracies. Democracy is a conversation, and conversations rely on language. When AI hacks language, it could destroy our ability to have meaningful conversations, thereby destroying democracy And the first regulation I would suggest is to make it mandatory for AI to disclose that it is an AI. If I am having a conversation with someone, and I cannot tell whether it is a human or an AI—that's the end of democracy. This text has been generated by a human. Or has it?

Question 622

We can infer that the author is most likely to agree with which of the following statements?

- A People's fears of the dangers of students using ChatGPT and other new AI tools are unfounded.
- B The commonly expressed fear that future AI developments will fatally harm humans is unfounded.
- C Apart from its drawbacks, AI tools have been beneficial in boosting technological and industrial advance worldwide.
- D One of the biggest casualties from the spread of unregulated AI is likely to be the democratic process.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ Traditional fear AI → physical harm
→ New fears of manipulation



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 623

The author terms language “the operating system of our civilization” for all the following reasons EXCEPT that it

- A can influence political views and opinions as it engenders close emotional ties among people.
- B is the basis of AI tools like ChatGPT which can be used to generate academic content and opinion.
- C is fundamental to the articulation and spread of human values and culture in our society.
- D has laid the foundation for the creation of cultural artefacts through writing and telling of stories.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Fears of artificial intelligence (AI) have haunted humanity since the very beginning of the computer age. Hitherto, these fears focused on machines using physical means to kill, enslave or replace people. But over the past couple of years, new AI tools have emerged that threaten the survival of human civilisation from an unexpected direction. AI has gained some remarkable abilities to manipulate and generate language, whether with words, sounds or images. AI has thereby hacked the operating system of our civilisation.

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→ New fears of manipulation



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 624

The author identifies all of the following as dire outcomes of the capture of language by AI EXCEPT that it could

- A spawn a completely new culture through its ability to create new ideas and opinions.
- B out-strip human creativity and endeavours in the spheres such as art and music and, in the formulation of laws.
- C eventually subvert democratic processes through the mass creation and spread of fake political content and news.
- D apply its mastery of language to create strong emotional ties which could exacerbate the polarization of political views.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Fears of artificial intelligence (AI) have haunted humanity since the very beginning of the computer age. Hitherto, these fears focused on machines using physical means to kill, enslave or replace people. But over the past couple of years, new AI tools have emerged that threaten the survival of human civilisation from an unexpected direction. AI has gained some remarkable abilities to manipulate and generate language, whether with words, sounds or images. AI has thereby hacked the operating system of our civilisation.

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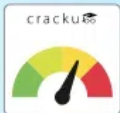
→ Traditional fear AI → physical harm
→ New fears of manipulation



VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Score Calculator



Question 625

The tone of the passage could best be described as

- A cautionary, because the author lays out some adverse effects of the proliferation of unregulated AI tools.

- B** prescient, as the author analyses the future impact of the use of new AI tools on crucial areas of our society and culture.
- C** alarmist, because the passage discusses scenarios of the influence of new AI tools on language and human emotions.
- D** quizzical, as the passage poses several questions, concluding with the question of whether or not the passage content has been generated by AI.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Fears of artificial intelligence (AI) have haunted humanity since the very beginning of the computer age. Hitherto, these fears focused on machines using physical means to kill, enslave or replace people. But over the past couple of years, new AI tools have emerged that threaten the survival of human civilisation from an unexpected direction. AI has gained some remarkable abilities to manipulate and generate language, whether with words, sounds or images. AI has thereby hacked the operating system of our civilisation.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Moutai has been the global booze sensation of the decade. A bottle of its Flying Fairy, which sold in the 1980s for the equivalent of a dollar, now retails for \$400. Moutai's listed shares have soared by almost 600% in the past five years, outpacing the likes of Amazon ...

It does this while disregarding every Western marketing mantra. It is not global, has meagre digital sales and does not appeal to millennials. It scores pitifully on environmental, social and government measures. In the Boy Scout world of Western business, it would leave a bad taste in more ways than one.

Moutai owes its intoxicating success to three factors—not all of them easy to emulate. First, it profits from Chinese nationalism. Moutai is known as the “national liquor”. It was used to raise spirits and disinfect wounds in Mao's Long March. It was Premier Zhou Enlai's favourite tippie, shared with Richard Nixon in 1972. Its centuries-old craftsmanship—it is distilled eight times and stored for years in earthenware jars—is a source of national pride. It also claims to be hangover-proof, which would make it an invention to rival gunpowder ...

Second, it chose to serve China's super-rich rather than its middle class. Markets are littered with the corpses of firms that could not compete in the cut-throat battle for Chinese middle-class wallets. And the country's premium market is massive—at 73m-strong, bigger than the population of France, notes Euan McLeish of Bernstein, an investment firm, and still less crowded with prestige brands than advanced economies. Moutai is to these well-heeled drinkers what vintage champagne is to the rest of the world ...

Third, Moutai looks beyond affluent millennials and digital natives. The elderly and the middle-aged, it found, can be just as lucrative. Its biggest market now is (male) drinkers in their mid-30s. Many have no siblings, thanks to four decades of China's one-child policy—which also means their elderly parents can splash out on weddings and banquets. Moutai is often a guest of honour.

Moutai has succeeded thanks to nationalism, elitism and ageism, in other words—not in spite of this unholy trinity. But it faces risks. The government is its largest shareholder—and a meddling one. It appears to want prices to remain stable. Exorbitantly priced booze is at odds with its professed socialist ideals. Yet minority

investors—including many foreign funds—lament that Moutai's wholesale price is a third of what it sells for in shops. Raising it could boost the company's profits further. Instead, in what some see as a travesty of corporate governance, its majority owner has plans to set up its own sales channel ...

In the long run, its biggest risk may be millennials. As they grow older, health concerns, work-life balance and the desire for more wholesome pursuits than binge-drinking may curb the "Ganbei!" toasting culture [heavy drinking] on which so much of the demand for Moutai rests. For the time being, though, the party goes on.

Question 626

The phrase "would make it an invention to rival gunpowder" has been used in the passage in a sense that is

- A literal
- B substantive
- C metaphorical
- D synonymical

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Moutai has been the global booze sensation of the decade. A bottle of its Flying Fairy, which sold in the 1980s for the equivalent of a dollar, now retails for \$400. Moutai's listed shares have soared by almost 600% in the past five years, outpacing the likes of Amazon ...

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→ Moutai is a wildly successful alcohol maker



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 627

Which one of the following is both a reason for Moutai's success as well as a possible threat to that success?

- A Chinese love of liquor filled celebration.
- B Government involvement in its business.
- C Its appeal to the rich.
- D Its appeal to the older age group.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Moutai has been the global booze sensation of the decade. A bottle of its Flying Fairy, which sold in the 1980s for the equivalent of a dollar, now retails for \$400. Moutai's listed shares have soared by almost 600% in the past five years, outpacing the likes of Amazon ...

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Question 628

In the context of the passage, it is most likely that the author refers to Moutai's marketing strategy as "the unholy trinity" because

- A there is nothing holy about marketing techniques for liquor.
- B it profits from Chinese nationalist feelings.
- C it contradicts the Western strategy of marketing.
- D it exposes the firm to long term risks.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Moutai has been the global booze sensation of the decade. A bottle of its Flying Fairy, which sold in the 1980s for the equivalent of a dollar, now retails for \$400. Moutai's listed shares have soared by almost 600% in the past five years, outpacing the likes of Amazon...

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→ Moutai is a wildly successful alcohol maker

Question 629

In the context of the passage, we can infer that to succeed in the liquor industry in China, a marketing firm must consider all of the following factors affecting the Chinese liquor market EXCEPT that

- A there is money to be made from marketing to the middle class.
- B the government may control the pricing of products.
- C there are few competitors to meet the demands of high end liquor consumers.
- D the competition for winning over the middle class is very stiff.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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It does this while disregarding every Western market's mantra. It is not global, has meagre digital sales and does not appeal to millennials. It scores pitifully on environmental, social and government measures. In the Boy Scout world of Western business, it would leave a bad taste in the mouth of more than one.

Moutai owes its intoxicating success to three factors, not all of them easy to emulate. First, it profits from Chinese nationalism. Moutai is known as the "national liquor". It was used to raise spirits and disinfect wounds in Mao's Long March. It was Premier Zhou Enlai's favourite tipple, shared with Richard Nixon in 1972. Its centuries-old craftsmanship — it is distilled eight times and stored for years in earthenware jars — is a source of national pride. It also claims to be hangover-proof, which would make it an invention to

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

There is a group in the space community who view the solar system not as an opportunity to expand human potential but as a nature preserve, forever the provenance of an elite group of scientists and their sanitary robotic probes. These planetary protection advocates [call] for avoiding “harmful contamination” of celestial bodies. Under this regime, NASA incurs great expense sterilizing robotic probes in order to prevent the contamination of entirely theoretical biospheres ...

Transporting bacteria would matter if Mars were the vital world once imagined by astronomers who mistook optical illusions for canals. Nobody wants to expose Martians to measles, but sadly, robotic exploration reveals a bleak, rusted landscape, lacking oxygen and flooded with radiation ready to sterilize any Earthly microbes. Simple life might exist underground, or down at the bottom of a deep canyon, but it has been very hard to find with robots. . . . The upsides from human exploration and development of Mars clearly outweigh the welfare of purely speculative Martian fungi ...

The other likely targets of human exploration, development, and settlement, our moon and the asteroids, exist in a desiccated, radiation-soaked realm of hard vacuum and extreme temperature variations that would kill nearly anything. It's also important to note that many international competitors will ignore the demands of these protection extremists in any case. For example, China recently sent a terrarium to the moon and germinated a plant seed—with, unsurprisingly, no protest from its own scientific community. In contrast, when it was recently revealed that a researcher had surreptitiously smuggled super-resilient microscopic tardigrades aboard the ill-fated Israeli Beresheet lunar probe, a firestorm was unleashed within the space community ...

NASA's previous human exploration efforts made no serious attempt at sterility, with little notice. As the Mars expert Robert Zubrin noted in the National Review, U.S. lunar landings did not leave the campsites cleaner than they found it. Apollo's bacteria-infested litter included bags of feces. Forcing NASA's proposed Mars exploration to do better, scrubbing everything and hauling out all the trash, would destroy NASA's human exploration budget and encroach on the agency's other directorates, too. Getting future astronauts off Mars is enough of a challenge, without trying to tote weeks of waste along as well.

A reasonable compromise is to continue on the course laid out by the U.S. government and the National Research Council, which proposed a system of zones on Mars, some for science only, some for habitation, and some for resource exploitation. This approach minimizes contamination, maximizes scientific exploration ... Mars presents a stark choice of diverging human futures. We can turn inward, pursuing ever more limited futures while we await whichever natural or manmade disaster will eradicate our species and life on Earth. Alternatively, we can choose to propel our biosphere further into the solar system, simultaneously protecting our home planet and providing a backup plan for the only life we know exists in the universe. Are the lives on Earth worth less than some hypothetical microbe lurking under Martian rocks?

Question 630

The author is unlikely to disagree with any of the following EXCEPT:

- A the proposal for a zonal segregation of the Martian landscape into regions for different purposes.
- B that while NASA's earlier missions were not ideal in their approach to space contamination, they likely did no grave damage.
- C space contamination should be minimised until the possibility of life on the astronomical body being explored is ruled out.
- D the exorbitant costs of continuing to keep the space environment pristine may be unsustainable.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

There is a group in the space community who view the solar system not as an opportunity to expand human potential but as a nature preserve, forever the provenance of an elite group of scientists and their sanitary robotic probes. These planetary protection advocates [call] for avoiding "harmful contamination" of celestial bodies. Under this regime, NASA incurs great expense sterilizing robotic probes in order to prevent the contamination of entirely theoretical biospheres ...

Transporting bacteria would matter if Mars were the vital world once imagined by astronomers who mistook optical illusions for canals. Nobody wants to expose Mars to measles, but sadly, robotic exploration reveals a bleached, rusted landscape, lacking oxygen and flooded with radiation ready to sterilize any Earthly microbes. Simple life might exist underground, or down at the bottom of a deep canyon, but it has been very hard to find with robots. ... The upsid es from human exploration and development of Mars clearly outweigh the welfare of purely speculative Martian fungi ...

The other likely targets of human exploration, development,

→ People who prioritize prevention of contamination of celestial.



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Question 631

The author mentions all of the following reasons to dismiss concerns about contaminating Mars EXCEPT:

- A the lack of evidence of living organisms on Mars makes possible contamination from earthly microbes a moot point.
- B efforts to contain contamination on Mars are likely to be derailed as competitor countries may not follow similar restrictions.
- C the use of similar probes on astronomical bodies like the moon have had little effect on the environment.
- D earlier explorations have already contaminated pristine space environments.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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Question 632

The author's overall tone in the first paragraph can be described as

- A sceptical about the excessive efforts to sanitise planets where life has not yet been proven to exist.
- B equivocal about the reasons extended by the group of scientists seeking to limit space exploration.
- C indifferent to the elitism of a few scientists aiming to corner space exploration.
- D approving of the amount of money NASA spends to restrict the spread of contamination in space.

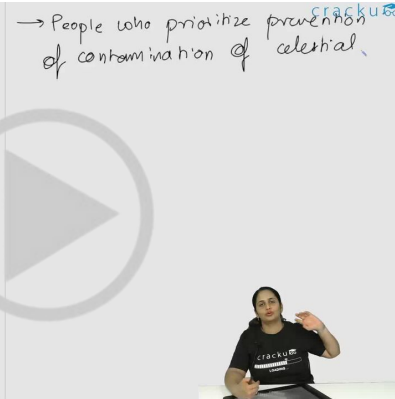
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Question 633

The contrasting reactions to the Chinese and Israeli "contaminations" of lunar space

- A are valid as the contamination of the lunar environment from animal sources is far greater than from plants.
- B are evidence of China's reasonable approach towards space contamination.
- C indicate that national scientists may have different sensitivities to issues of biosphere protection.
- D reveal global biases prevalent in attitudes towards different countries.

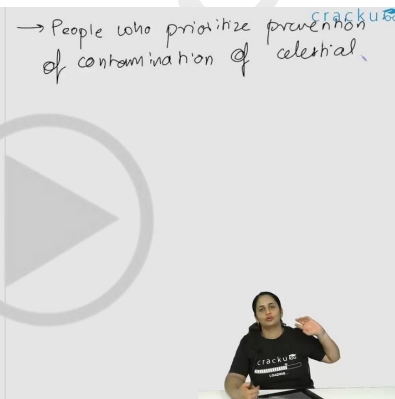
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The other likely targets of human exploration, development,

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

[There is] a curious new reality: Human contact is becoming a luxury good. As more screens appear in the lives of the poor, screens are disappearing from the lives of the rich. The richer you are, the more you spend to be off-screen. . . .

The joy — at least at first — of the internet revolution was its democratic nature. Facebook is the same Facebook whether you are rich or poor. Gmail is the same Gmail. And it's all free. There is something mass market and unappealing about that. And as studies show that time on these advertisement-support platforms is unhealthy, it all starts to seem *déclassé*, like drinking soda or smoking cigarettes, which wealthy people do less than poor people. The wealthy can afford to opt out of having their data and their attention sold as a product. The poor and middle class don't have the same kind of resources to make that happen.

Screen exposure starts young. And children who spent more than two hours a day looking at a screen got lower scores on thinking and language tests, according to early results of a landmark study on brain development of more than 11,000 children that the National Institutes of Health is supporting. Most disturbingly, the study is finding that the brains of children who spend a lot of time on screens are different. For some kids, there is premature thinning of their cerebral cortex. In adults, one study found an association between screen time and depression. . . .

Tech companies worked hard to get public schools to buy into programs that required schools to have one laptop per student, arguing that it would better prepare children for their screen-based future. But this idea isn't how the people who actually build the screen-based future raise their own children. In Silicon Valley, time on screens is increasingly seen as unhealthy. Here, the popular elementary school is the local Waldorf School, which promises a back-to-nature, nearly screen-free education. So as wealthy kids are growing up with less screen time, poor kids are growing up with more. How comfortable someone is with human engagement could become a new class marker.

Human contact is, of course, not exactly like organic food But with screen time, there has been a concerted effort on the part of Silicon Valley behemoths to confuse the public. The poor and the middle class are told that screens are good and important for them and their children. There are fleets of psychologists and neuroscientists on staff at big tech companies working to hook eyes and minds to the screen as fast as possible and for as long as possible. And so human contact is rare. . . .

There is a small movement to pass a "right to disconnect" bill, which would allow workers to turn their phones off, but for now, a worker can be punished for going offline and not being available. There is also the reality that in our culture of increasing isolation, in which so many of the traditional gathering places and social structures have disappeared, screens are filling a crucial void.

Question 634

The author is least likely to agree with the view that the increase in screen-time is fuelled by the fact that:

- A screens provide social contact in an increasingly isolating world
- B there is a growth in computer-based teaching in public schools
- C some workers face punitive action if they are not online
- D with falling costs, people are streaming more content on their devices

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

(There is a curious new reality (human contact is becoming a luxury good). As more screens appear in the lives of the poor, screens are disappearing from the lives of the rich. The richer you are, the more you spend to be off-screen....)

The joy – at least at first – of the internet revolution was its democratic nature. Facebook is the same Facebook whether you are rich or poor. It is the same Gmail. And it's all free. There is something mass market unappealing about that. And as studies show that time on these advertisement support platforms is unhealthy, it all starts to sound like drinking soda or smoking cigarettes, which wealthy people can afford to opt out of having their attention sold as a product. The poor and middle class have the same kind of resources to make that happen.

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Tech companies worked hard to get public schools to buy into programs that required schools to have one laptop per student, arguing that it would better prepare children for their screen-based future. But this idea isn't how the minds who will rule the 21st century are made.

para ①: human contact → luxury good
 ↑ screen appear = ↓ screens in the
 poor ✓ rich
 para ②: rationalize this assertion
 it is accessible to all
 out of feeling < data sold
 with the

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 635

The statement “The richer you are, the more you spend to be off-screen” is supported by which other line from the passage?

- A “Gmail is the same Gmail. And it’s all free.”
- B “How comfortable someone is with human engagement could become a new class marker.”
- C “. . . screens are filling a crucial void.”
- D “. . . studies show that time on these advertisement-support platforms is unhealthy .

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

(There is a curious new reality (human contact is becoming a luxury good). As more screens appear in the lives of the poor, screens are disappearing from the lives of the rich. The richer you are, the more you spend to be off-screen....)

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 636

Which of the following statements about the negative effects of screen time is the author least likely to endorse?

- A It is shown to have adverse effects on young children’s learning
- B It increases human contact as it fills an isolation void.
- C It can cause depression in viewers.
- D It is designed to be addictive.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

(There is) a curious new reality (human contact is becoming a luxury good). As more screens appear in the lives of the poor, screens are disappearing from the lives of the rich. The richer you are, the more you spend to be off-screen....

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Tech companies worked hard to get public schools to buy into programs that required schools to have one laptop per student, arguing that it would better prepare children for their screen-based future. But this idea isn't how the parents who work to be off the screen would like to raise their kids.

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 it is accessible to all
 out of dealing with the data sold

VIDEO SOLUTION

FREE

cracku

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Question 637

The author claims that Silicon Valley tech companies have tried to “confuse the public” by:

- A pushing for greater privacy while working with advertisement-support platforms to mine data.
- B concealing the findings of psychologists and neuroscientists on screen-time use from the public.
- C developing new work-efficiency programmes while lobbying for the “right to disconnect” bill.
- D promoting screen time in public schools while opting for a screen-free education for their own children.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Although one of the most contested concepts in political philosophy, human nature is something on which most people seem to agree. By and large, according to Rutger Bregman in his new book *Humankind*, we have a rather pessimistic view - not of ourselves exactly, but of everyone else. We see other people as selfish, untrustworthy and dangerous and therefore we behave towards them with defensiveness and suspicion. This was how the 17th-century philosopher Thomas Hobbes conceived our natural state to be, believing that all that stood between us and violent anarchy was a strong state and firm leadership. But in following Hobbes, argues

Bregman, we ensure that the negative view we have of human nature is reflected back at us. He instead puts his faith in Jean-Jacques Rousseau, the 18th-century French thinker, who famously declared that man was born free and it was civilisation - with its coercive powers, social classes and restrictive laws - that put him in chains.

Hobbes and Rousseau are seen as the two poles of the human nature argument and it's no surprise that Bregman strongly sides with the Frenchman. He takes Rousseau's intuition and paints a picture of a prelapsarian idyll in which, for the better part of 300,000 years, Homo sapiens lived a fulfilling life in harmony with nature . . . Then we discovered agriculture and for the next 10,000 years it was all property, war, greed and injustice. . . .

It was abandoning our nomadic lifestyle and then domesticating animals, says Bregman, that brought about infectious diseases such as measles, smallpox, tuberculosis, syphilis, malaria, cholera and plague. This may be true, but what Bregman never really seems to get to grips with is that pathogens were not the only things that grew with agriculture - so did the number of humans. It's one thing to maintain friendly relations and a property-less mode of living when you're 30 or 40 hunter-gatherers following the food. But life becomes a great deal more complex and knowledge far more extensive when there are settlements of many thousands. "Civilisation has become synonymous with peace and progress and wilderness with war and decline," writes Bregman. "In reality, for most of human existence, it was the other way around." Whereas traditional history depicts the collapse of civilisations as "dark ages" in which everything gets worse, modern scholars, he claims, see them more as a reprieve, in which the enslaved gain their freedom and culture flourishes. Like much else in this book, the truth is probably somewhere between the two stated positions.

In any case, the fear of civilisational collapse, Bregman believes, is unfounded. It's the result of what the Dutch biologist Frans de Waal calls "veneer theory" - the idea that just below the surface, our bestial nature is waiting to break out. . . . There's a great deal of reassuring human decency to be taken from this bold and thought-provoking book and a wealth of evidence in support of the contention that the sense of who we are as a species has been deleteriously distorted. But it seems equally misleading to offer the false choice of Rousseau and Hobbes when, clearly, humanity encompasses both.

Question 638

According to the author, the main reason why Bregman contrasts life in pre-agricultural societies with agricultural societies is to:

- A advocate the promotion of less complex societies as a basis for greater security and prosperity
- B highlight the enormous impact that settled farming had on population growth
- C make the argument that an environmentally conscious lifestyle is a more harmonious way of living.
- D bolster his argument that people are basically decent, but progress as we know it can make them selfish.

cracku

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para ①: human nature

Rutger Bregman → Humankind

↳ pessimistic view → selfish, untrustworthy

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 639

None of the following views is expressed in the passage EXCEPT that:

- A most people agree with Hobbes' pessimistic view of human nature as being intrinsically untrustworthy and selfish.
- B Hobbes and Rousseau disagreed on the fundamental nature of humans, but both believed in the need for a strong state.
- C Bregman agrees with Hobbes that firm leadership is needed to ensure property rights and regulate strife.
- D the author of the review believes in the veneer theory of human nature.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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para ①: human nature
Rutger Bregman → Humankind
↳ pessimistic view → selfish, untrustworthy

VIDEO SOLUTION

cracku

CAT Study Material

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Question 640

According to the passage, the “collapse of civilisations” is viewed by Bregman as:

- A a time that enables changes in societies and cultures.
- B a sign of regression in society's trajectory.
- C resulting from a breakdown in the veneer of human nature.
- D a temporary phase which can be rectified by social action.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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para ①: human nature
Rutger Bregman → Humankind
↳ pessimistic view → selfish, untrustworthy

Question 641

The author has differing views from Bregman regarding:

- A the role of agriculture in the advancement of knowledge.
- B the role of pathogens in the spread of infectious diseases.
- C a property-less mode of living being socially harmonious.
- D a civilised society being coercive and unjust.

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Rutger Bregman → Humankind
C pessimistic view → selfish, untrustworthy

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Mode of transportation affects the travel experience and thus can produce new types of travel writing and perhaps even new “identities.” Modes of transportation determine the types and duration of social encounters; affect the organization and passage of space and time; . . . and also affect perception and knowledge—how and what the traveler comes to know and write about. The completion of the first U.S. transcontinental highway during the 1920s . . . for example, inaugurated a new genre of travel literature about the United States—the automotive or road narrative. Such narratives highlight the experiences of mostly male protagonists “discovering themselves” on their journeys, emphasizing the independence of road travel and the value of rural folk traditions.

Travel writing’s relationship to empire building—as a type of “colonialist discourse”—has drawn the most attention from academicians. Close connections have been observed between European (and American) political, economic, and administrative goals for the colonies and their manifestations in the cultural practice of writing travel books. Travel writers’ descriptions of foreign places have been analyzed as attempts to validate, promote, or challenge the ideologies and practices of colonial or imperial domination and expansion.

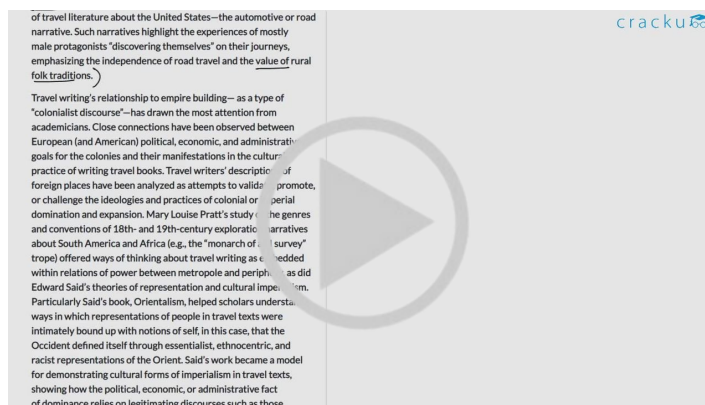
Mary Louise Pratt’s study of the genres and conventions of 18th- and 19th-century exploration narratives about South America and Africa (e.g., the “monarch of all I survey” trope) offered ways of thinking about travel writing as embedded within relations of power between metropole and periphery, as did Edward Said’s theories of representation and cultural imperialism. Particularly Said’s book, *Orientalism*, helped scholars understand ways in which representations of people in travel texts were intimately bound up with notions of self, in this case, that the Occident defined itself through essentialist, ethnocentric, and racist representations of the Orient. Said’s work became a model for demonstrating cultural forms of imperialism in travel texts, showing how the political, economic, or administrative fact of dominance relies on legitimating discourses such as those articulated through travel writing. . . .

Feminist geographers' studies of travel writing challenge the masculinist history of geography by questioning who and what are relevant subjects of geographic study and, indeed, what counts as geographic knowledge itself. Such questions are worked through ideological constructs that posit men as explorers and women as travelers—or, conversely, men as travelers and women as tied to the home. Studies of Victorian women who were professional travel writers, tourists, wives of colonial administrators, and other (mostly) elite women who wrote narratives about their experiences abroad during the 19th century have been particularly revealing. From a "liberal" feminist perspective, travel presented one means toward female liberation for middle- and upper-class Victorian women. Many studies from the 1970s onward demonstrated the ways in which women's gendered identities were negotiated differently "at home" than they were "away," thereby showing women's self-development through travel. The more recent post structural turn in studies of Victorian travel writing has focused attention on women's diverse and fragmented identities as they narrated their travel experiences, emphasizing women's sense of themselves as women in new locations, but only as they worked through their ties to nation, class, whiteness, and colonial and imperial power structures

Question 642

From the passage, we can infer that travel writing is most similar to:

- A political journalism
- B feminist writing
- C autobiographical writing.
- D historical fiction.



VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 643

From the passage, we can infer that feminist scholars' understanding of the experiences of Victorian women travellers is influenced by all of the following EXCEPT scholars':

- A awareness of gender issues in Victorian society
- B knowledge of class tensions in Victorian society
- C perspective that they bring to their research
- D awareness of the ways in which identity is formed

of travel literature about the United States—the automotive or road narrative. Such narratives highlight the experiences of mostly male protagonists “discovering themselves” on their journeys, emphasizing the independence of road travel and the value of rural folk traditions.

Travel writing’s relationship to empire building—as a type of “colonialist discourse”—has drawn the most attention from academicians. Close connections have been observed between European (and American) political, economic, and administrative goals for the colonies and their manifestations in the cultural practice of writing travel books. Travel writers’ descriptions of foreign places have been analyzed as attempts to validate, promote, or challenge the ideologies and practices of colonial or imperial domination and expansion. Mary Louise Pratt’s study of the genres and conventions of 18th- and 19th-century exploratory narratives about South America and Africa (e.g., the “monarch of survey” trope) offered ways of thinking about travel writing as embedded within relations of power between metropole and periphery, as did Edward Said’s theories of representation and cultural imperialism. Particularly Said’s book, *Orientalism*, helped scholars understand ways in which representations of people in travel texts were intimately bound up with notions of self; in this case, that the Occident defined itself through essentialist, ethnocentric, and racist representations of the Orient. Said’s work became a model for demonstrating cultural forms of imperialism in travel texts, showing how the political, economic, or administrative fact of dominance relies on legitimating discourses such as those

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 644

American travel literature of the 1920s:

- A showed participation in local traditions.
- B developed the male protagonists’ desire for independence
- C presented travellers’ discovery of their identity as different from others.
- D celebrated the freedom that travel gives.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 645

According to the passage, Said’s book, “*Orientalism*”:

- A argued that cultural imperialism was more significant than colonial domination.
- B explained the difference between the representation of people and the actual fact
- C illustrated how narrow minded and racist westerners were
- D demonstrated how cultural imperialism was used to justify colonial domination.

of travel literature about the United States—the automotive or road narrative. Such narratives highlight the experiences of mostly male protagonists “discovering themselves” on their journeys, emphasizing the independence of road travel and the value of rural folk traditions.)

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Question 646

From the passage, it can be inferred that scholars argue that Victorian women experienced self-development through their travels because:

- A they developed a feminist perspective of the world.
- B they were from the progressive middle- and upper-classes of society.
- C they were on a quest to discover their diverse identities.
- D their identity was redefined when they were away from home.

of travel literature about the United States—the automotive or road narrative. Such narratives highlight the experiences of mostly male protagonists “discovering themselves” on their journeys, emphasizing the independence of road travel and the value of rural folk traditions.)

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cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

... [T]he idea of craftsmanship is not simply nostalgic. ... Crafts require distinct skills, an allround approach to work that involves the whole product, rather than individual parts, and an attitude that necessitates devotion to the job and a focus on the communal interest. The concept of craft emphasises the human touch and individual judgment.

Essentially, the crafts concept seems to run against the preponderant ethos of management studies which, as the academics note, have long prioritised efficiency and consistency. . . . Craft skills were portrayed as being primitive and traditionalist.

The contrast between artisanship and efficiency first came to the fore in the 19th century when British manufacturers suddenly faced competition from across the Atlantic as firms developed the “American system” using standardised parts. . . . the worldwide success of the Singer sewing machine showed the potential of a mass-produced device. This process created its own reaction, first in the form of the Arts and Crafts movement of the late 19th century, and then again in the “small is beautiful” movement of the 1970s. A third crafts movement is emerging as people become aware of the environmental impact of conventional industry.

There are two potential markets for those who practise crafts. The first stems from the existence of consumers who are willing to pay a premium price for goods that are deemed to be of extra quality. . . . The second market lies in those consumers who wish to use their purchases to support local workers, or to reduce their environmental impact by taking goods to craftspeople to be mended, or recycled.

For workers, the appeal of craftsmanship is that it allows them the autonomy to make creative choices, and thus makes a job far more satisfying. In that sense, it could offer hope for the overall labour market. Let the machines automate dull and repetitive tasks and let workers focus purely on their skills, judgment and imagination. As a current example, the academics cite the “agile” manifesto in the software sector, an industry at the heart of technological change. The pioneers behind the original agile manifesto promised to prioritise “individuals and interactions over processes and tools”. By bringing together experts from different teams, agile working is designed to improve creativity.

But the broader question is whether crafts can create a lot more jobs than they do today. Demand for crafted products may rise but will it be easy to retrain workers in sectors that might get automated (such as truck drivers) to take advantage? In a world where products and services often have to pass through regulatory hoops, large companies will usually have the advantage.

History also suggests that the link between crafts and creativity is not automatic. Medieval craft guilds were monopolies which resisted new entrants. They were also highly hierarchical with young men required to spend long periods as apprentices and journeymen before they could set up on their own; by that time the innovative spirit may have been knocked out of them. Craft workers can thrive in the modern era, but only if they don't get too organised.

Question 647

We can infer from the passage that medieval crafts guilds resembled mass production in that both

- A** did not necessarily promote creativity.
- B** discouraged innovation by restricting entry through strict rules
- C** did not always employ egalitarian production processes.
- D** focused excessively on product quality

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

... [T]he idea of craftsmanship is not simply nostalgic. ... Crafts require distinct skills, an allround approach to work that involves the whole product, rather than individual parts, and an attitude that necessitates devotion to the work and a focus on the communal interest. The concept of craft emphasises the human touch and individual judgement.

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The contrast between artisanship and efficiency first came to the fore in the 19th century when British manufacturers suddenly faced competition from across the Atlantic as firms developed the 'American system' using standardised parts. ... the worldwide success of the Singer sewing machine showed the potential of a mass-produced device. This process created its own reaction, first in the form of the Arts and Crafts movement and then in the form of the

→ Attitude required for craftsmanship



Question 648

Which one of the following statements is NOT inconsistent with the views stated in the passage?

- A We need to support the crafts; only then can we retain the creativity intrinsic to their production.
- B Creativity in the crafts could be stifled if the market for artisan goods becomes too organised.
- C The Arts and Crafts movement was initially inspired by the “American system” of production.
- D The agile movement in software is a throwback to the tenets of the medieval crafts guilds

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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The contrast between artisanship and efficiency first came to the fore in the 19th century when British manufacturers suddenly faced competition from across the Atlantic as firms developed the “American system” using standardised parts.... the worldwide success of the Singer sewing machine showed the potential of a mass-produced device. This process created its own reaction, first in the form of the Arts and Crafts movement of the late 19th century, and

→ Attitude required for craftsmanship



100+ CAT DILR Questions



Question 649

The author questions the ability of crafts to create substantial employment opportunities presently because

- A the low scale of crafts production will not be able to absorb the mass of redundant labour.
- B regulatory requirements could make it difficult for small crafts outfits to compete.
- C workers made redundant by automation are unlikely to opt for crafts-related work.
- D crafts guilds tend to resist new entrants and are unlikely to accept large numbers of trainees.

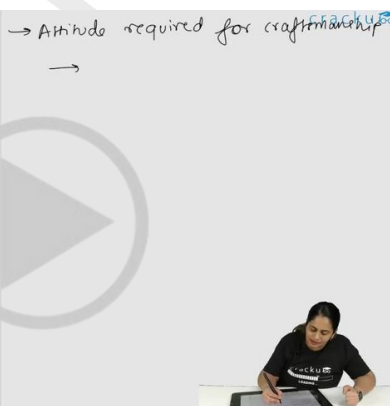
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→ Attitude required for craftsmanship



Question 650

The most recent revival in interest in the crafts is a result of the emergence of all of the following EXCEPT:

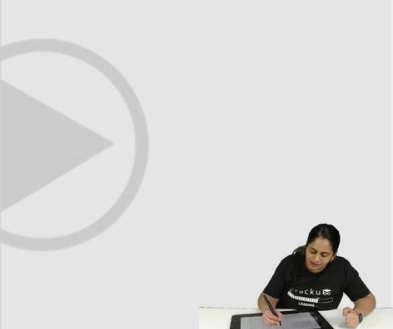
- A support for individual creations as opposed to mass-produced objects
- B concerns about the environmental impact of mass production.
- C a niche market for discerning buyers of quality products.
- D a greater interest in buying locally produced goods.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

... [T]he idea of craftsmanship is not simply nostalgic.... Crafts require distinct skills, an allround approach to work that involves the whole product, rather than individual parts, and an attitude that necessitates devotion to the and a focus on the communal interest. The concept of craft emphasises the human touch and individual judgment.

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Oftentimes, when economists cross borders, they are less interested in learning from others than in invading their garden plots. Gary Becker, for instance, pioneered the idea of human capital. To do so, he famously tackled topics like crime and domesticity, applying methods honed in the study of markets to domains of nonmarket life. He projected economics outward into new realms: for example, by revealing the extent to which humans calculate marginal utilities when choosing their spouses or stealing from neighbors. At the same time, he did not let other ways of thinking enter his own economic realm: for example, he did not borrow from anthropology or history or let observations of nonmarket economics inform his homo economicus. Becker was a picture of the imperial economist in the heyday of the discipline's bravura.

Times have changed for the once almighty discipline. Economics has been taken to task, within and beyond its ramparts. Some economists have reached out, imported, borrowed, and collaborated—been less imperial, more open. Consider Thomas Piketty and his outreach to historians. The booming field of behavioral economics—the fusion of economics and social psychology—is another case. Having spawned active subfields, like judgment, decisionmaking and a turn to experimentation, the field aims to go beyond the caricature of Rational Man to explain how humans make decisions....

It is important to underscore how this flips the way we think about economics. For generations, economists have presumed that people have interests—"preferences," in the neoclassical argot—that get revealed in the course of peoples' choices. Interests come before actions and determine them. If you are hungry, you buy lunch; if you are cold, you get a sweater. If you only have so much money and can't afford to deal with both your growling stomach and your shivering, which need you choose to meet using your scarce savings reveals your preference.

Psychologists take one look at this simple formulation and shake their heads. Increasingly, even some mainstream economists have to admit that homo economicus doesn't always behave like the textbook maximizer; irrational behavior can't simply be waved away as extraeconomic expressions of passions over interests, and thus the domain of other disciplines.... This is one place where the humanist can help the economist. If narrative economics is going to help us understand how rivals duke it out, who wins and who loses, we are going to need much more than lessons from epidemiological studies of viruses or intracranial stimuli.

Above all, we need politics and institutions. Shiller [the Nobel prize winning economist] connects perceptions of narratives to changes in behavior and thence to social outcomes. He completes a circle that was key to behavioral economics and brings in storytelling to make sense of how perceptions get framed. This cycle (perception to behavior to society) was once mediated or dominated by institutions: the political parties, lobby groups, and media organizations that played a vital role in legitimating, representing, and excluding interests. Yet institutions have been stripped from Shiller's account, to reveal a bare dynamic of emotions and economics, without the intermediating place of politics.

Question 651

We can infer from the passage that the term "homo economicus" refers to someone who

- A is not influenced by the preferences and choices of others.
- B believes in borrowing and collaborating with other disciplines in their work.
- C makes rational decisions based on their own preferences.
- D maximises their opportunities based on nonmarket choices.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Often times, when economists cross borders, they are less interested in learning from others than in invading their garden plots. Gary Becker, for instance, pioneered the idea of human capital. To do so, he famously tackled topics like crime and domesticity, applying methods honed in the study of markets to domains of nonmarket life. He projected economics outward into new realms: for example, by revealing the extent to which humans calculate marginal utilities when choosing their spouses or dealing from neighbors. At the same time, he did not let other ways of thinking enter his own economic realm: for example, he did not borrow from anthropology or history or let observations of nonmarket economics inform his homo economicus. Becker was a picture of the imperial economist in the heyday of the discipline's bravura.

Times have changed for the once almighty discipline. Economics has been taken to task, within and beyond its ramparts. Some economists have reached out, imported, borrowed, and collaborated—been less imperial, more

→ Economists → imperial

VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT VARC Questions



Question 652

"Times have changed for the once almighty discipline." We can infer from this statement and the associated paragraph that the author is being

- A sarcastic about how economists, who earlier shunned other disciplines, are now beginning to incorporate them in their analyses
- B disparaging of economists' inability to precisely predict market behaviour, and are now borrowing from other disciplines to remedy this

- C** judgemental about the ability of economic tools to accurately manage crises leading to the downfall of this lofty science.
- D** critical of economists' openly borrowing and collaborating across disciplines to explain how humans make decisions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ Economists → imperial



[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

Question 653

In the first paragraph the author is making the point that economists like Becker

- A** benefitted from the application of their principles and concepts to non-economic phenomena.
- B** had begun to borrow concepts from other disciplines but were averse to the latter applying economic principles.
- C** used economics to analyse non-market behaviour, without incorporating perspectives from other areas of inquiry.
- D** tended to guard their discipline from poaching by academics from other subject areas.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Oftentimes, when economists cross borders, they are less interested in learning from others than in invading their garden plots. Gary Becker, for instance, pioneered the idea of human capital. To do so, he famously tackled topics like crime and domesticity, applying methods honed in the study of markets to domains of nonmarket life. He projected economics outward into new realms: for example, by revealing the extent to which humans calculate marginal utilities when choosing their spouses or dealing from neighbors. At the same time, he did not let other ways of thinking enter his own economic realm: for example, he did not borrow from anthropology or history or let observations of nonmarket economics inform his home economics. Becker was a picture of the imperial economist in the heyday of the discipline's bravura.

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→ Economists → imperial



[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

Question 654

The author critiques Schiller's approach to behavioural economics for

- A** ignoring the marginal role that media and politics play in influencing people's behaviour.
- B** denigrating the role of institutions while creating a link between behavioural economics and perceptions

- C linking emotions and rational behaviour without considering the mediation of social institutions.
- D relying excessively on storytelling as the main influence on the formation of perceptions.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Oftentimes, when economists cross borders, they are less interested in learning from others than in invading their garden plots. Gary Becker, for instance, pioneered the idea of human capital. To do so, he famously tackled topics like crime and domesticity, applying methods honed in the study of markets to domains of nonmarket life. He projected economics outward into new realms: for example, by revealing the extent to which humans calculate marginal utilities when choosing their spouses or dealing from neighbors. At the same time, he did not let other ways of thinking enter his own economic realm: for example, he did not borrow from anthropology or history or let observations of nonmarket economics inform his homoeconomicus. Becker was a picture of the imperial economist in the heyday of the discipline's bravura.

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→ Economists → imperial cracku



VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

In the summer of 2022, subscribers to the US streaming service HBO MAX were alarmed to discover that dozens of the platform's offerings - from the Covid-themed heist thriller *Locked Down* to the recent remake of *The Witches* - had been quietly removed from the service . . . The news seemed like vindication to those who had long warned that streaming was more about controlling access to the cultural commons than expanding it, as did reports (since denied by the show's creators) that Netflix had begun editing old episodes of *Stranger Things* to retroactively improve their visual effects.

What's less clear is whether the commonly prescribed cure for these cultural ills - a return to the material pleasures of physical media - is the right one. While the makers of Blu-ray discs claim they have a shelf life of 100 years, such statistics remain largely theoretical until they come to pass, and are dependent on storage conditions, not to mention the continued availability of playback equipment. The humble DVD has already proved far less resilient, with many early releases already beginning to deteriorate in quality. Digital movie purchases provide even less security. Any film "bought" on iTunes could disappear if you move to another territory with a different rights agreement and try to redownload it. It's a bold new frontier in the commodification of art: the birth of the product recall. After a man took to Twitter to bemoan losing access to *Cars 2* after moving from Canada to Australia, Apple clarified that users who downloaded films to their devices would retain permanent access to those downloads, even if they relocated to a hemisphere where the [content was] subject to a different set of rights agreements. Thanks to the company's ironclad digital rights management technology, however, such files cannot be moved or backed up, locking you into watching with your Apple account.

Anyone who does manage to acquire Digital Rights Management free (DRM-free) copies of their favourite films must nonetheless grapple with ever-changing file format standards, not to mention data decay - the gradual process by which electronic information slowly but surely corrupts. Only the regular migration of files from hard drive to hard drive can delay the inevitable, in a Sisyphean battle against the ravages of digital time.

In a sense, none of this is new. Charlie Chaplin burned the negative of his 1926 film *A Woman of the Sea* as a tax write-off. Many more films have been lost through accident, negligence or plain indifference. During a heatwave in July 1937, a Fox film vault in New Jersey burned down, destroying a majority of the silent films

produced by the studio.

Back then, at least, cinema was defined by its ephemerality: the sense that a film was as good as gone once it left your local cinema. Today, with film studios keen to stress the breadth of their back catalogues (or to put in Hollywood terms, the value of their IPs), audiences may start to wonder why those same studios seem happy to set the vault alight themselves if it'll help next quarter's numbers.

Question 655

Which one of the following statements, if true, would best invalidate the main argument of the passage?

- A Recent research has irrefutably proven that Blu-Ray discs have a shelf life of at least 100 years.
- B Studios and streaming services have committed to giving customers perpetual and platform independent access to the original digital content they have paid for.
- C When moving to a different geographical location, customers can easily use Virtual Private Networks (VPNs) to bypass geo-blocking and regain access to their content on any streaming service.
- D Improved cloud storage services have made it possible for movie collections to now be preserved in perpetuity, without the need to keep migrating the files.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ 3 examples which show that streaming service control access → not expand access



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 656

Which of the following statements is suggested by the sentence "Back then, at least, cinema was defined by its ephemerality: the sense that a film was as good as gone once it left your local cinema"?

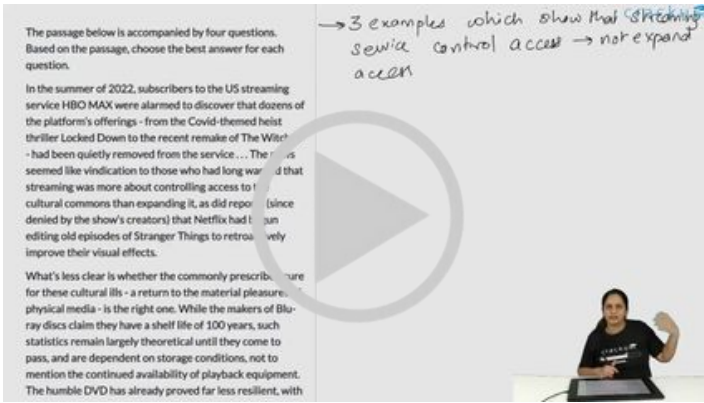
- A Around a century ago, people were more accepting of not having access to films once they left the local cinema.
- B Today, films are expected to be available for a long time, since they are no longer tied solely to their stay at the local cinema
- C Cinema is now no longer as ephemeral as it used to be earlier, because the technology used for creating and preserving films has improved manifold
- D Presently, there is no reason why film studios should remove access to films once they have left the local cinema

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 657

"Netflix had begun editing old episodes of *Stranger Things* to retroactively improve their visual effects." What is the purpose of this example used in the passage?

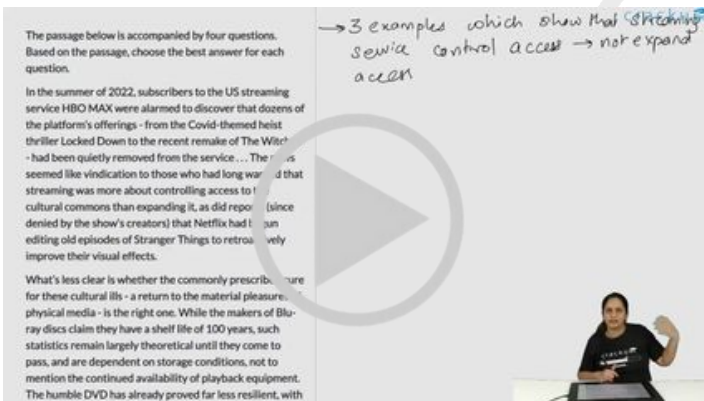
- A To show that streaming services are controlling access to the cultural commons rather than expanding it.
- B To show how unsubstantiated reports are leading to an increase in the level of distrust towards streaming services
- C To show a practice that justifies the fears of people who feel streaming services cannot be trusted to be custodians of cultural artefacts like film.
- D To show that art in the digital age, specifically film, is no longer sacrosanct, and may be changed to suit changing tastes or technology

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

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→ 3 examples which show that streaming service control access → not expand access



VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Important Topics




Question 658

Which one of the following statements about art best captures the arguments made in the passage?

- A** In the age of online subscription services, it is time to change our understanding of classic works of art being primarily immutable and easily available to the public
- B** As art is increasingly created, stored and distributed digitally, access to it is counterintuitively likely to be made more difficult by the rapid churn in technology and the whims of host platforms.
- C** Accepting retroactive changes to works of art is dangerous because it will encourage creators to not put enough effort into the original attempt, given that they can always edit or update their work later
- D** Works of art belong to the cultural commons and hence must remain available in perpetuity, irrespective of who pays for access to them.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

In the summer of 2022, subscribers to the US streaming service HBO MAX were alarmed to discover that dozens of the platform's offerings - from the Covid-themed heist thriller *Locked Down* to the recent remake of *The Wire* - had been quietly removed from the service. ... The ... seemed like vindication to those who had long ... that streaming was more about controlling access to ... (since denied by the show's creators) that Netflix had ... editing old episodes of *Stranger Things* to retros ... improve their visual effects.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The viability of the multinational corporate system depends upon the degree to which people will tolerate the unevenness it creates. It is well to remember that the 'New Imperialism' which began after 1870 in a spirit of Capitalism Triumphant, soon became seriously troubled and after 1914 was characterized by war, depression, breakdown of the international economic system and war again, rather than Free Trade, Pax Britannica and Material Improvement. A major reason was Britain's inability to cope with the byproducts of its own rapid accumulation of capital; i.e., a class-conscious labour force at home; a middle class in the hinterland; and rival centres of capital on the Continent and in America. Britain's policy tended to be atavistic and defensive rather than progressive — more concerned with warding off new threats than creating new areas of expansion. Ironically, Edwardian England revived the paraphernalia of the landed aristocracy it had just destroyed. Instead of embarking on a 'big push' to develop the vast hinterland of the Empire, colonial administrators often adopted policies to arrest the development of either a native capitalist class or a native proletariat which could overthrow them.

As time went on, the centre had to devote an increasing share of government activity to military and other unproductive expenditures; they had to rely on alliances with an inefficient class of landlords, officials and soldiers in the hinterland to maintain stability at the cost of development. A great part of the surplus extracted from the population was thus wasted locally.

The New Mercantilism (as the Multinational Corporate System of special alliances and privileges, aid and tariff concessions is sometimes called) faces similar problems of internal and external division. The centre is troubled: excluded groups revolt and even some of the affluent are dissatisfied with the roles. Nationalistic rivalry between major capitalist countries remains an important divisive factor. Finally, there is the threat presented by the middle classes and the excluded groups of the underdeveloped countries. The national middle classes in the underdeveloped countries came to power when the centre weakened but could not, through their policy of import substitution manufacturing, establish a viable basis for sustained growth. They now face a foreign exchange crisis and an unemployment (or population) crisis—the first indicating their inability to function in the international economy and the second indicating their alienation from the people they are

supposed to lead. In the immediate future, these national middle classes will gain a new lease of life as they take advantage of the spaces created by the rivalry between American and non-American oligopolists striving to establish global market positions.

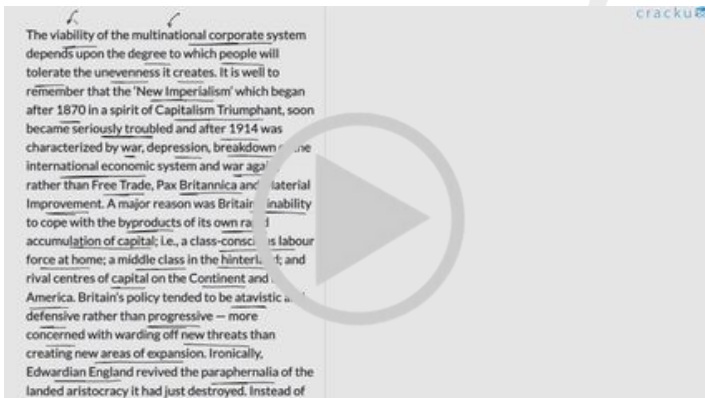
The native capitalists will again become the champions of national independence as they bargain with multinational corporations. But the conflict at this level is more apparent than real, for in the end the fervent nationalism of the middle class asks only for promotion within the corporate structure and not for a break with that structure. In the last analysis their power derives from the metropolis and they cannot easily afford to challenge the international system. They do not command the loyalty of their own population and cannot really compete with the large, powerful, aggregate capitals from the centre. They are prisoners of the taste patterns and consumption standards' set at the centre.

The main threat comes from the excluded groups. It is not unusual in underdeveloped countries for the top 5 per cent to obtain between 30 and 40 per cent of the total national income, and for the top one-third to obtain anywhere from 60 to 70 per cent. At most, one-third of the population can be said to benefit in some sense from the dualistic growth that characterizes development in the hinterland. The remaining two-thirds, who together get only one-third of the income, are outsiders, not because they do not contribute to the economy, but because they do not share in the benefits. They provide a source of cheap labour which helps keep exports to the developed world at a low price and which has financed the urban-biased growth of recent years. In fact, it is difficult to see how the system in most underdeveloped countries could survive without cheap labour since removing it (e.g. diverting it to public works projects as is done in socialist countries) would raise consumption costs to capitalists and professional elites.

Question 659

The author is in a position to draw parallels between New Imperialism and New Mercantilism because

- A both originated in the developed Western capitalist countries.
- B New Mercantilism was a logical sequel to New Imperialism
- C they create the same set of outputs: a labour force, middle classes and rival centers of capital.
- D both have comparable uneven and divisive effects.



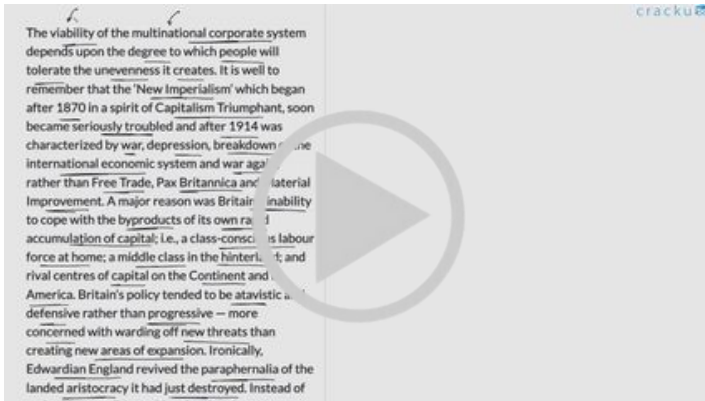
VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 660

According to the author, the British policy during the "New Imperialism" period tended to be defensive because

- A it was unable to deal with the fallouts of a sharp increase in capital.
- B its cumulative capital had undesirable side-effects.
- C its policies favoured developing the vast hinterland.

D it prevented the growth of a set-up which could have been capitalistic in nature.



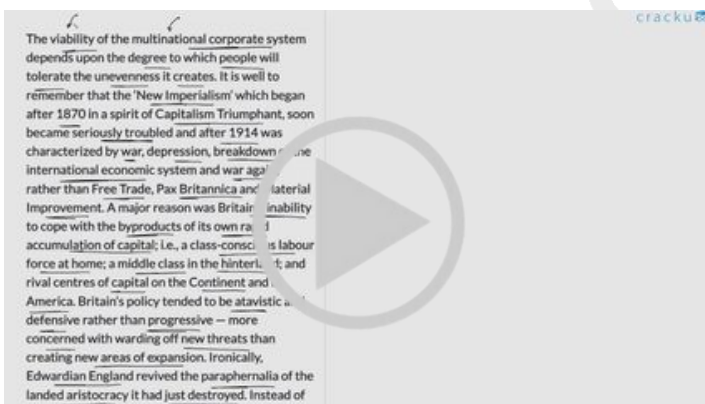
VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 661

In the sentence, "They are prisoners of the taste patterns and consumption standards set at the center." (fourth paragraph), what is the meaning of "centre"?

- A National government
- B Native capitalists.
- C New capitalists.
- D None of the above.



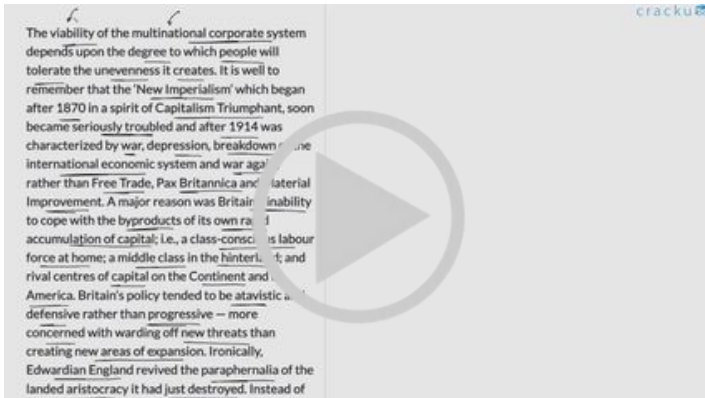
VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 662

Under New Mercantilism, the fervent nationalism of the native middle classes does not create conflict with the multinational corporations because they (the middle classes)

- A negotiate with the multinational corporations

- B are dependent on the international system for their continued prosperity.
- C are not in a position to challenge the status quo.
- D do not enjoy popular support.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Once a society accepts a secular mode of creativity, within which the creator replaces God, imaginative transactions assume a self-conscious form. The tribal imagination, on the other hand, is still to a large extent dreamlike and hallucinatory. It admits fusion between various planes of existence and levels of time in a natural and artless manner. In tribal stories, oceans fly in the sky as birds, mountains swim in water as fish, animals speak as humans and stars grow like plants. Spatial order and temporal sequence do not restrict the narrative. This is not to say that tribal creations have no conventions or rules, but simply that they admit the principle of association between emotion and the narrative motif. Thus stars, seas, mountains, trees, men and animals can be angry, sad or happy.

It might be said that tribal artists work more on the basis of their racial and sensory memory than on the basis of a cultivated imagination. In order to understand this distinction, we must understand the difference between imagination and memory. In the animate world, consciousness meets two immediate material realities: space and time. We put meaning into space by perceiving it in terms of images. The image-making faculty is a genetic gift to the human mind—this power of imagination helps us understand the space that envelops us. With regard to time, we make connections with the help of memory; one remembers being the same person today as one was yesterday.

The tribal mind has a more acute sense of time than the sense of space. Somewhere along the history of human civilization, tribal communities seem to have realized that domination over territorial space was not their lot. Thus, they seem to have turned almost obsessively to gaining domination over time. This urge is substantiated in their ritual of conversing with their dead ancestors: year after year, tribals in many parts of India worship terracotta or carved-wood objects representing their ancestors, aspiring to enter a trance in which they can converse with the dead. Over the centuries, an amazingly sharp memory has helped tribals classify material and natural objects into a highly complex system of knowledge. . .

One of the main characteristics of the tribal arts is their distinct manner of constructing space and imagery, which might be described as 'hallucinatory'. In both oral and visual forms of representation, tribal artists seem to interpret verbal or pictorial space as demarcated by an extremely flexible 'frame'. The boundaries between art and non-art become almost invisible. A tribal epic can begin its narration from a trivial everyday event; tribal paintings merge with living space as if the two were one and the same. And within the narrative itself, or within the painted imagery, there is no deliberate attempt to follow a sequence. The episodes retold and the images created take on the apparently chaotic shapes of dreams. In a way, the syntax of language and the grammar of painting are the same, as if literature were painted words and painting were a song of images.

Question 663

Non-human living forms exhibit human emotions in tribal narratives because tribal narratives:

- A have a self-conscious form.
- B accommodate existential fluidity.
- C abandon all rules and regulations.
- D are rudimentary and underdeveloped.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 664

Which one of the following best explains why tribals in India worship their dead ancestors?

- A For tribals, conversing with the dead becomes a way of seeking control over time.
- B Tribals show respect to their ancestors through terracotta and carved-wood objects.
- C Tribals possess a sophisticated knowledge system that is based on memory.
- D Tribals seek territorial domination over the spaces that they inhabit.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 665

All of the following, if true, would weaken the passage's claims about the hallucinatory tribal imagination EXCEPT that:

- A tribal art excludes the depiction of the mundane reality of everyday life and objects.
- B tribal narratives exhibit a chronological beginning, middle, and end.
- C tribal stories depict the natural world in accordance with rational scientific knowledge.
- D shamanic rituals involving conversing with the dead often feature in tribal stories.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 666

On the basis of the passage, which one of the following explains the main difference between imagination and memory?

- A Imagination is a genetic gift to humans whereas memory is central to human consciousness.
- B Tribal groups value memory over imagination when it comes to creating art and literature.
- C Imagination needs to be cultivated whereas memory is more intuitive because it is racial and sensory.
- D Imagination helps humans make sense of space while memory helps them understand time.



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Over the course of the twentieth century, humans built, on average, one large dam a day, hulking structures of steel and concrete designed to control flooding, facilitate irrigation, and generate electricity. Dams were also lucrative contracts, large-scale employers, and the physical instantiation of a messianic drive to conquer territories and control nature. Some of the results of that drive were charismatic mega-infrastructure—the Hoover on the Colorado River or the Aswan on the Nile—but most of the tens of thousands of dams that dot the Earth's landscape have drawn little attention. These are the smaller, though not inconsequential, barriers that today impede the flow of water on nearly two-thirds of the world's large waterways. Chances are, what your map calls a “lake” is actually a reservoir, and that thin blue line that emerges from it once flowed very differently.

Damming a river is always a partisan act. Even when explicit infrastructure goals—irrigation, flood control, electrification—were met, other consequences were significant and often deleterious. Across the world, river control displaced millions of people, threatening livelihoods, foodways, and cultures. In the western United States, dams were often an instrument of colonialism, used to dispossess Indigenous people and subsidize settler agriculture. And as dams slowed the flow of water, inhibited the movement of nutrients, and increased the amount of toxic algae and other parasites, they snuffed out entire river ecologies. Declining fish populations are the most evident effect, but dams also threaten a host of other animals—from birds and reptiles to fungi and plants—with extinction. Every major dam, then, is also a sacrifice zone, a place where lives, livelihoods, and ways of life are eliminated so that new sorts of landscapes can support water-intensive agriculture and cities that sprout downstream of new reservoirs.

Such sacrifices have been justified as offerings at the temples of modernity. Justified by—and for—whom, though? Over the course of the twentieth century, rarely were the costs and benefits weighed thoughtfully and decided democratically. As Kader Asmal, chair of the landmark 2000 World Commission on Dams, concluded, “There have been precious few, if any, comprehensive, independent analyses as to why dams came about, how dams perform over time, and whether we are getting a fair return from our \$2 trillion investment.” A quarter-century later, Asmal's words ring ever truer. A litany of dams built in the mid- twentieth century are approaching the end of their expected lives, with worrying prospects for their durability. Droughts, magnified and multiplied by the effects of climate change, have forced more and more to run below capacity. If ever there were a time to rethink the mania for dams, it would be now.

There is some evidence that a combination of opposition, alternative energy sources, and a lack of viable projects has slowed the construction of major dams. But a wave of recent and ongoing construction, from India and China to Ethiopia and Canada, continues to tilt the global balance firmly in favor of water impoundment.

Question 667

Which one of the following sets of terms is closest to mapping the key arguments of the passage?

- A Partisan act - Threatened livelihoods - Toxic algae - Quarter century
- B Lucrative contracts - Sacrifice zone - Expected lives - Global balance
- C Mega-infrastructure - Sacrifice zone - Worshipping modernity - Water impoundment
- D Physical instantiation - Partisan act - Decided democratically - Alternative energy

Question 668

All of the following statements may be considered valid inferences from the passage EXCEPT that:

- A despite increasing evidence of opposition to dams as well as alternatives to them, they continue to be built.
- B smaller, though not inconsequential, dams are safer than large dam projects.
- C processes of colonisation have used dam-building to make people vacate their territories.
- D dam-building has proved to be an extremely costly enterprise that may not be justifiable.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 669

What does the author wish to communicate by referring to the Hoover and Aswan dams in the first paragraph?

- A The Colorado and Nile rivers may be seen as thin blue lines on a map.
- B By building dams like the Hoover and Aswan dams, large-scale employers became messianic figures.
- C The designers and builders of these mega-structures were highly charismatic individuals.
- D The drive to control nature is evident not only in mega-infrastructure like the Hoover and Aswan dams, but in smaller dams as well.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 670

The word "instantiation" is used in the first paragraph. Which one of the following pairs of terms would be the best substitute for it in the context of its usage in the paragraph?

- A Exemplification and manifestation
- B Concreteness and viability
- C Durability and timeliness
- D Development and construction

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

A remarkable aspect of art of the present century is the range of concepts and ideologies which it embodies. It is almost tempting to see a pattern emerging within the art field - or alternatively imposed upon it a posteriori - similar to that which exists under the umbrella of science where the general term covers a whole range of separate, though interconnecting, activities. Any parallelism is however - in this instance at least - misleading. A scientific discipline develops systematically once its bare tenets have been established, named and categorized as conventions. Many of the concepts of modern art, by contrast, have resulted from the almost accidental meetings of groups of talented individuals at certain times and certain places. The ideas generated by these chance meetings had twofold consequences. Firstly, a corpus of work would be produced which, in great part,

remains as a concrete record of the events. Secondly, the ideas would themselves be disseminated through many different channels of communication - seeds that often bore fruit in contexts far removed from their generation. Not all movements were exclusively concerned with innovation. Surrealism, for instance, claimed to embody a kind of insight which can be present in the art of any period. This claim has been generally accepted so that a sixteenth century painting by Spranger or a mysterious photograph by Atget can legitimately be discussed in surrealist terms. Briefly, then, the concepts of modern art are of many different (often fundamentally different) kinds and resulted from the exposures of painters, sculptors and thinkers to the more complex phenomena of the twentieth century, including our ever increasing knowledge of the thought and products of earlier centuries. Different groups of artists would collaborate in trying to make sense of a rapidly changing world of visual and spiritual experience. We should hardly be surprised if no one group succeeded completely, but achievements, though relative, have been considerable. Landmarks have been established - concrete statements of position which give a pattern to a situation which could easily have degenerated into total chaos. Beyond this, new language tools have been created for those who follow - semantic systems which can provide a springboard for further explorations.

The codifying of art is often criticized. Certainly one can understand that artists are wary of being pigeonholed since they are apt to think of themselves as individuals - sometimes with good reason. The notion of self-expression, however, no longer carries quite the weight it once did; objectivity has its defenders. There is good reason to accept the ideas codified by artists and critics, over the past sixty years or so, as having attained the status of independent existence - an independence which is not without its own value. The time factor is important here. As an art movement slips into temporal perspective, it ceases to be a living organism - becoming, rather, a fossil. This is not to say that it becomes useless or uninteresting. Just as a scientist can reconstruct the life of a prehistoric environment from the messages codified into the structure of a fossil, so can an artist decipher whole webs of intellectual and creative possibility from the recorded structure of a 'dead' art movement. The artist can match the creative patterns crystallized into this structure against the potentials and possibilities of his own time. As T.S. Eliot observed, no one starts anything from scratch; however consciously you may try to live in the present, you are still involved with a nexus of behaviour patterns bequeathed from the past. The original and creative person is not someone who ignores these patterns, but someone who is able to translate and develop them so that they conform more exactly to his - and our - present needs.

Question 671

The passage uses an observation by T.S. Eliot to imply that

- A creative processes are not 'original' because they always borrow from the past.
- B we always carry forward the legacy of the past.
- C past behaviours and thought processes recreate themselves in the present and get labeled as 'original' or 'creative'.
- D 'originality' can only thrive in a 'greenhouse' insulated from the past biases.
- E 'innovations' and 'original thinking' interpret and develop on past thoughts to suit contemporary needs.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 672

In the passage, the word 'fossil' can be interpreted as

- A an art movement that has ceased to remain interesting or useful.
- B an analogy from the physical world to indicate a historic art movement.
- C an analogy from the physical world to indicate the barrenness of artistic creations in the past.
- D an embedded codification of pre-historic life.

E an analogy from the physical world to indicate the passing of an era associated with an art movement.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



Question 673

Many of the concepts of modern art have been the product of

- A ideas generated from planned deliberations between artists, painters and thinkers.
- B the dissemination of ideas through the state and its organizations.
- C accidental interactions among people blessed with creative muse.
- D patronage by the rich and powerful that supported art.
- E systematic investigation, codification and conventions.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 674

In the passage, which of the following similarities between science and art may lead to erroneous conclusions?

- A Both, in general, include a gamut of distinct but interconnecting activities.
- B Both have movements not necessarily concerned with innovation.
- C Both depend on collaborations between talented individuals.
- D Both involve abstract thought and dissemination of ideas.
- E Both reflect complex priorities of the modern world.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 675

The range of concepts and ideologies embodied in the art of the twentieth century is explained by

- A the existence of movements such as surrealism.
- B landmarks which give a pattern to the art history of the twentieth century.
- C new language tools which can be used for further explorations into new areas.
- D the fast changing world of perceptual and transcendental understanding.
- E the quick exchange of ideas and concepts enabled by efficient technology.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



Instructions

Crinoline and croquet are out. As yet, no political activists have thrown themselves in front of the royal horse on Derby Day. Even so, some historians can spot the parallels. It is a time of rapid technological change. It is a period when the dominance of the world's superpower is coming under threat. It is an epoch when prosperity masks underlying economic strain. And, crucially, it is a time when policy-makers are confident that all is for the best in the best of all possible worlds. Welcome to the Edwardian Summer of the second age of globalisation.

Spare a moment to take stock of what's been happening in the past few months. Let's start with the oil price, which has rocketed to more than \$65 a barrel, more than double its level 18 months ago. The accepted wisdom is that we shouldn't worry our little heads about that, because the incentives are there for business to build new production and refining capacity, which will effortlessly bring demand and supply back into balance and bring crude prices back to \$25 a barrel. As Tommy Cooper used to say, 'just like that'.

Then there is the result of the French referendum on the European Constitution, seen as thick-headed luddites railing vainly against the modern world. What the French needed to realise, the argument went, was that there was no alternative to the reforms that would make the country more flexible, more competitive, more dynamic. Just the sort of reforms that allowed Gate Gourmet to sack hundreds of its staff at Heathrow after the sort of ultimatum that used to be handed out by Victorian mill owners. An alternative way of looking at the French "non" is that our neighbours translate "flexibility" as "you're fired".

Finally, take a squint at the United States. Just like Britain a century ago, a period of unquestioned superiority is drawing to a close. China is still a long way from matching America's wealth, but it is growing at a stupendous rate and economic strength brings geo-political clout. Already, there is evidence of a new scramble for Africa as Washington and Beijing compete for oil stocks. Moreover, beneath the surface of the US economy, all is not well. Growth looks healthy enough, but the competition from China and elsewhere has meant the world's biggest economy now imports far more than it exports. The US is living beyond its means, but in this time of studied complacency a current account deficit worth 6 percent of gross domestic product is seen as a sign of strength, not weakness.

In this new Edwardian summer, comfort is taken from the fact that dearer oil has not had the savage inflationary consequences of 1973-74, when a fourfold increase in the cost of crude brought an abrupt end to a postwar boom that had gone on uninterrupted for a quarter of a century. True, the cost of living has been affected by higher transport costs, but we are talking of inflation at 2.3 per cent and not 27 per cent. Yet the idea that higher oil prices are of little consequence is fanciful. If people are paying more to fill up their cars it leaves them with less to spend on everything else, but there is a reluctance to consume less. In the 1970s unions were strong and able to negotiate large, compensatory pay deals that served to intensify inflationary pressure. In 2005, that avenue is pretty much closed off, but the abolition of all the controls on credit that existed in the 1970s means that households are invited to borrow more rather than consume less. The knock-on effects of higher oil prices are thus felt in different ways - through high levels of indebtedness, in inflated asset prices, and in balance of payments deficits.

There are those who point out, rightly, that modern industrial capitalism has proved mightily resilient these past 250 years, and that a sign of the enduring strength of the system has been the way it apparently shrugged off everything - a stock market crash, 9/11, rising oil prices - that have been thrown at it in the half decade since the millennium. Even so, there are at least three reasons for concern. First, we have been here before. In terms of political economy, the first era of globalisation mirrored our own. There was a belief in unfettered capital flows, in free trade, and in the power of the market. It was a time of massive income inequality and unprecedented migration. Eventually, though, there was a backlash, manifested in a struggle between free traders and protectionists, and in rising labour militancy.

Second, the world is traditionally at its most fragile at times when the global balance of power is in flux. By the end of the nineteenth century, Britain's role as the hegemonic power was being challenged by the rise of the United States, Germany, and Japan while the Ottoman and Hapsburg empires were clearly in rapid decline.

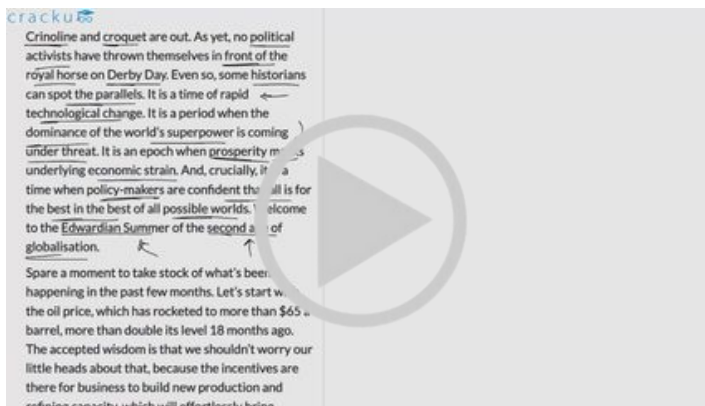
Looking ahead from 2005, it is clear that over the next two or three decades, both China and India - which together account for half the world's population - will flex their muscles.

Finally, there is the question of what rising oil prices tell us. The emergence of China and India means global demand for crude is likely to remain high at a time when experts say production is about to top out. If supply constraints start to bite, any declines in the price are likely to be short-term cyclical affairs punctuating a long upward trend.

Question 676

What can be inferred about the author's view when he states, 'As Tommy Cooper used to say "just like that"'?

- A Industry has incentive to build new production and refining capacity and therefore oil prices would reduce.
- B There would be a correction in the price levels of oil once new production capacity is added.
- C The decline in oil prices is likely to be short-term in nature.
- D It is not necessary that oil prices would go down to earlier levels.

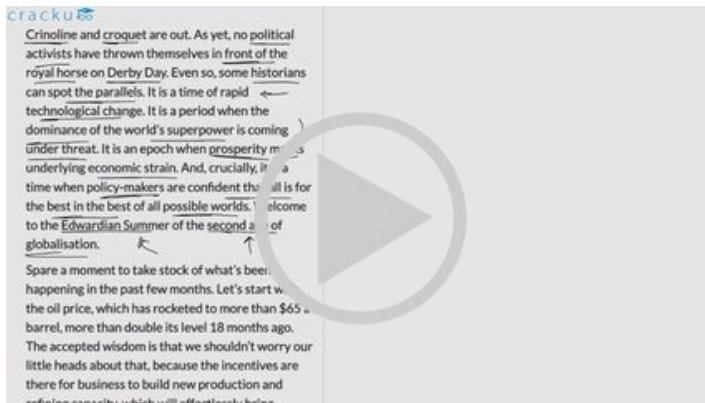


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 677

By the expression 'Edwardian Summer', the author refers to a period in which there is

- A unparalleled luxury and opulence.
- B a sense of complacency among people because of all-round prosperity.
- C a culmination of all-round economic prosperity.
- D an imminent danger lurking behind economic prosperity.

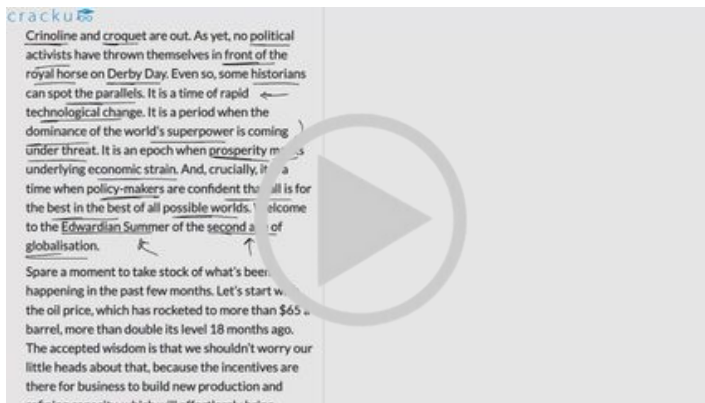


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 678

What, according to the author, has resulted in a widespread belief in the resilience of modern capitalism?

- A Growth in the economies of Western countries despite shocks in the form of increase in levels of indebtedness and inflated asset prices.
- B Increase in the prosperity of Western countries and China despite rising oil prices.
- C Continued growth of Western economies despite a rise in terrorism, an increase in oil prices and other similar shocks.
- D The success of continued reforms aimed at making Western economies more dynamic, competitive and efficient.



VIDEO SOLUTION

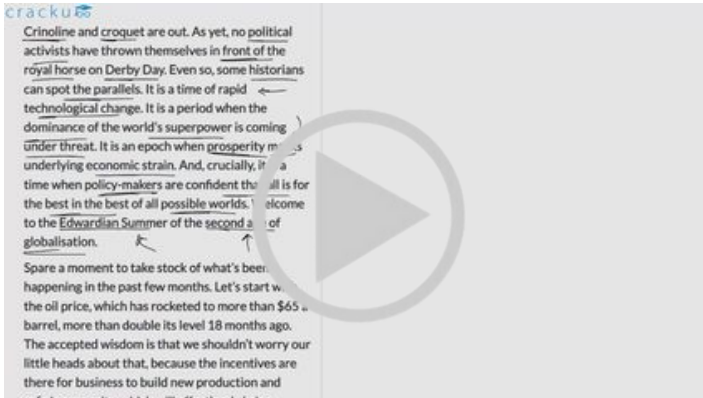


Question 679

Which of the following best represents the key argument made by the author?

- A The rise in oil prices, the flux in the global balance of power and historical precedents should make us question our belief that the global economic prosperity would continue.

- B** The belief that modern industrial capitalism is highly resilient and capable of overcoming shocks will be belied soon.
- C** Widespread prosperity leads to neglect of early signs of underlying economic weakness, manifested in higher oil prices and a flux in the global balance of power.
- D** A crisis is imminent in the West given the growth of countries like China and India and the increase in oil prices.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

When talks come to how India has done for itself in 50 years of independence, the world has nothing but praise for our success in remaining a democracy. On other fronts, the applause is less loud. In absolute terms, India hasn't done too badly, of course, life expectancy has increased. So has literacy. Industry, which was barely a fledgling, has grown tremendously. And as far as agriculture is concerned, India has been transformed from a country perpetually on the edge of starvation into a success story held up for others to emulate.

But these are competitive times when change is rapid, and to walk slowly when the rest of the world is running is almost as bad as standing still or walking backwards. Compared with large chunks of what was then the developing world — South Korea, Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand, Indonesia, China and what was till lately a separate Hong Kong — India has fared abysmally.

It began with a far better infrastructure than most of these countries had. It suffered hardly or not at all during the World War II. It had advantages like an English speaking elite, quality scientific manpower (including a Nobel laureate and others who could be ranked among the world's best) and excellent business acumen. Yet, today, when countries are ranked according to their global competitiveness, it is tiny Singapore that figures at the top. Hong Kong is an export powerhouse. So is Taiwan. If a symbol were needed of how far we have fallen back, note that while Korean Cielos are sold in India, no one in South Korea is rushing to buy an Indian car.

The reasons list themselves. Topmost is economic isolationism. The government discouraged imports and encouraged self-sufficiency. Whatever the aim was, the result was the creation of a totally inefficient industry that failed to keep pace with global trends and, therefore, became absolutely uncompetitive. Only when the trade gates were opened a little did this become apparent. The years since then have been spent in merely trying to catch up.

That the government actually sheltered its industrialists from foreign competition is a little strange. For, in all other respects, it operated under the conviction that businessmen were little more than crooks who were to be prevented from entering the most important areas of the economy, who were to be hamstrung in as many ways as possible, who were to be tolerated in the same way as an inexcisable wart. The high, expropriatory rates of taxation, the licensing laws, the reservation of whole swathes of industry for the public sector, and the granting of monopolies to the public sector firms were the principal manifestations of this attitude. The government forgot that before wealth could be distributed, it had to be created. The government forgot that it itself could not create, but only squander wealth.

Some of the manifestations of the old attitude have changed. Tax rates have fallen. Licensing has been all but abolished. And the gates of global trade have been opened wide. But most of these changes were forced by circumstances partly by the foreign exchange bankruptcy of 1991 and the recognition that the government could no longer muster the funds to support the public sector, leave alone expand it. Whether the attitude of the government itself, or that of more than a handful of ministers, has changed, is open to question.

In many other ways, however, the government has not changed one whit. Business still has to negotiate a welter of negotiations. Transparency is still a longer way off. And there is no exit policy. In defending the existing policy, politicians betray an inability to see beyond their noses. A no-exit policy for labour is equivalent to a no-entry policy for new business. If one industry is not allowed to retrench labour, other industries will think a hundred times before employing new labour.

In other ways too, the government hurts industries. Public sector monopolies like the department of telecommunications and Videsh Sanchar Nigam Ltd. make it possible for Indian businesses to operate only at a cost several times that of their counterparts abroad. The infrastructure is in shambles partly because it is unable to formulate a sufficiently remunerative policy for private business, and partly because it does not have the stomach to change market rates for services.

After a burst of activity in the early nineties, the government is dragging its feet. At the rate it is going, it will be another 50 years before the government realises that a pro-business policy is the best pro-people policy. By then of course, the world would have moved even farther ahead.

Question 680

According to the writer,

- A India's politicians are myopic in their vision of the country's requirements.
- B India's politicians are busy lining their pockets.
- C India's politicians are not conversant with the needs of the present scenario.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 681

The example of the Korean Cielo has been presented to highlight

- A India's lack of stature in the international market.
- B India's poor performance in the international market.
- C India's lack of creditability in the international market.
- D India's disrepute in the international market.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 682

India was in a better condition than the other Asian nations because

- A it did not face the ravages of the World War II.

- B it had an English speaking populace and good business sense.
- C it had enough wealth through its exports.
- D Both a) and b)

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 683

According to the writer, India should have performed better than the other Asian nations because

- A it had adequate infrastructure.
- B it had better infrastructure.
- C it had better politicians who could take the required decisions.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 684

The writer's attitude towards the government is

- A critical.
- B ironical.
- C sarcastic.
- D derisive.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Score Calculator



Question 685

One of the features of the government's protectionist policy was

- A encouragement of imports.
- B discouragement of exports.
- C encouragement of exports.
- D discouragement of imports.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 686

The writer ends the passage on a note of

- A cautious optimism.
- B pessimism.
- C optimism.
- D pragmatism.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 687

The writer is surprised at the government's attitude towards its industrialists because

- A the government did not need to protect its industrialists.
- B the issue of competition was non-existent.
- C the government looked upon its industrialists as crooks.
- D the attitude was a conundrum.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 688

The government was compelled to open the economy due to

- A pressure from international markets.
- B pressure from domestic market.
- C foreign exchange bankruptcy and paucity of funds with the government.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 689

The major reason for India's poor performance is

- A economic isolationism.
- B economic mismanagement.
- C inefficient industry.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

More and more companies, government agencies, educational institutions and philanthropic organisations are today in the grip of a new phenomenon: 'metric fixation'. The key components of metric fixation are the belief that it is possible - and desirable - to replace professional judgment (acquired through personal experience and talent) with numerical indicators of comparative performance based upon standardised data (metrics); and that the best way to motivate people within these organisations is by attaching rewards and penalties to their measured performance.

The rewards can be monetary, in the form of pay for performance, say, or reputational, in the form of college rankings, hospital ratings, surgical report cards and so on. But the most dramatic negative effect of metric fixation is its propensity to incentivise gaming: that is, encouraging professionals to maximise the metrics in ways that are at odds with the larger purpose of the organisation. If the rate of major crimes in a district becomes the metric according to which police officers are promoted, then some officers will respond by simply not recording crimes or downgrading them from major offences to misdemeanours. Or take the case of surgeons. When the metrics of success and failure are made public - affecting their reputation and income - some surgeons will improve their metric scores by refusing to operate on patients with more complex problems, whose surgical outcomes are more likely to be negative. Who suffers? The patients who don't get operated upon.

When reward is tied to measured performance, metric fixation invites just this sort of gaming. But metric fixation also leads to a variety of more subtle unintended negative consequences. These include goal displacement, which comes in many varieties: when performance is judged by a few measures, and the stakes are high (keeping one's job, getting a pay rise or raising the stock price at the time that stock options are vested), people focus on satisfying those measures - often at the expense of other, more important organisational goals that are not measured. The best-known example is 'teaching to the test', a widespread phenomenon that has distorted primary and secondary education in the United States since the adoption of the No Child Left Behind Act of 2001.

Short-termism is another negative. Measured performance encourages what the US sociologist Robert K Merton in 1936 called 'the imperious immediacy of interests ... where the actor's paramount concern with the foreseen immediate consequences excludes consideration of further or other consequences'. In short, advancing short-term goals at the expense of long-range considerations. This problem is endemic to publicly traded corporations that sacrifice long-term research and development, and the development of their staff, to the perceived imperatives of the quarterly report.

Question 690

What is the main idea that the author is trying to highlight in the passage?

- A** Performance measurement needs to be precise and cost-effective to be useful for evaluating organisational performance.
- B** Evaluating performance by using measurable performance metrics may misguide organisational goal achievement.
- C** Long-term organisational goals should not be ignored for short-term measures of organisational success.
- D** All kinds of organisations are now relying on metrics to measure performance and to give rewards and punishments.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

More and more companies, government agencies, educational institutions and philanthropic organisations are today in the grip of a new phenomenon: 'metric fixation'. The key components of metric fixation are the belief that it is possible - and desirable - to replace professional judgement (acquired through personal experience and talent) with numerical indicators of comparative performance based upon standardised data (metrics); and that the best way to motivate people within these organisations is by attaching rewards and penalties to their measured performance.

The rewards can be monetary, in the form of pay for performance, say, or reputational, in the form of college rankings, hospital ratings, surgical report cards and so on. But the most dramatic negative effect of metric fixation is its propensity to incentivise gaming. It is, encouraging professionals to maximise the metrics in ways that are at odds with the larger purpose of the organisation. If the rate of major crimes in a district becomes the metric according to which police officers are promoted, then some officers will respond by simply recording crimes or downgrading them from major offences to misdemeanours. Or take the case of surgeons. When the metrics of success and failure are made public - affecting their reputation and income - some surgeons will improve their metric scores by refusing to operate on patients with more complex problems, whose surgical outcomes are more likely to be negative. Who suffers? The patients who don't get operated upon.

Metric Fixation

Prof. Judg. → Personal Ex. & Talent

Numeric Indicators

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Question 691

All of the following can be a possible feature of the No Child Left Behind Act of 2001, EXCEPT:

- A school funding and sanctions are tied to yearly improvement shown on tests.
- B standardised test scores can be critical in determining a student's educational future.
- C assessment is dependent on the teacher's subjective evaluation of students' class participation.
- D the focus is more on test-taking skills than on higher order thinking and problem-solving.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

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Metric Fixation

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Question 692

What main point does the author want to convey through the examples of the police officer and the surgeon?

- A Some professionals are likely to be significantly influenced by the design of performance measurement systems.
- B Metrics-linked rewards may encourage unethical behaviour among some professionals.
- C Critical public roles should not be evaluated on metrics-based performance measures.

D The actions of police officers and surgeons have a significantly impact on society.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

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Metric Fixation

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Prof. Judg. → Numeric Indicators

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Personal Growth

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Question 693

Of the following, which would have added the least depth to the author's argument?

- A Assessment of the pros and cons of a professional judgment-based evaluation system.
- B An analysis of the reasons why metrics fixation is becoming popular despite its drawbacks.
- C A comparative case study of metrics- and non-metrics-based evaluation, and its impact on the main goals of an organisation.
- D More real-life illustrations of the consequences of employees and professionals gaming metrics-based performance measurement systems.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

More and more companies, government agencies, educational institutions and philanthropic organisations are today in the grip of a new phenomenon: 'metric fixation'. The key components of metric fixation are the belief that it is possible - and desirable - to replace professional judgement (acquired through personal experience and talent) with numerical indicators of comparative performance based upon standardised data (metrics); and that the best way to motivate people within these organisations is by attaching rewards and penalties to their measured performance.

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Metric Fixation

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Prof. Judg. → Numeric Indicators

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Personal Growth

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CAT Daily Targets

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Question 694

Which of the following is NOT a consequence of the 'metric fixation' phenomenon mentioned in the passage?

- A Finding a way to show better results without actually improving performance.

- B** Improving cooperation among employees leading to increased organisational effectiveness in the long run.
- C** Deviating from organisationally important objectives to measurable yet less important objectives.
- D** Short-term orientation induced by frequent measurement of performance.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

More and more companies, government agencies, educational institutions and philanthropic organisations are today in the grip of a new phenomenon: **metric fixation**. The key components of metric fixation are the belief that it is possible - and desirable - to replace professional judgement (acquired through personal experience and talent) with numerical indicators of comparative performance based upon standardised data (metrics), and that the best way to motivate people within these organisations is by attaching rewards and penalties to their measured performance.

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Metric Fixation

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Numerical Indicators

Prof. Study

Personal Growth

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Instructions

The conventional wisdom says that this is an issue-less election. There is no central personality of whom voters have to express approval or dislike; no central matter of concern that makes this a one-issue referendum like so many elections in the past; no central party around which everything else revolves — the Congress has been displaced from its customary pole position, and no one else has been able to take its place. Indeed, given that all-seeing video cameras of the Election Commission, and the detailed pictures they are putting together on campaign expenditure, there isn't even much electioneering: no slogans on the walls, no loudspeakers blaring forth at all hours of the day and night, no cavalcades of cars heralding the arrival of a candidate at the local bazaar. Forget it being an issue-less election, is this an election at all?

Perhaps the 'fun' of an election lies in its featuring someone whom you can love or hate. But Narasimha Rao has managed to reduce even a general election, involving nearly 600 million voters, to the boring non-event that is the trademark of his election rallies, and indeed of everything else that he does. After all, the Nehru-Gandhi clan has disappeared from the political map, and the majority of voters will not even be able to name P.V.Narasimha Rao as India's Prime Minister. There could be as many as a dozen prime ministerial candidates ranging from Jyoti Basu to Ramakrishna Hegde, and from Chandra Shekar to (believe it or not) K.R.Narayanan. The sole personality who stands out, therefore, is none of the players, but the umpire: T.N.Seshan. .

As for the parties, they are like the blind men of Hindustan, trying in vain to gauge the contours of the animal they have to confront. But it doesn't look as if it will be the mandir-masjid, nor will it be Hindutva or economic nationalism. The Congress will like it to be stability, but what does that mean for the majority? Economic reform is a non-issue for most people with inflation down to barely 4 per cent, prices are not top of the mind either. In a strange twist, after the hawala scandal, corruption has been pushed off the map too.

But ponder for a moment, isn't this state of affairs astonishing, given the context? Consider that so many ministers have had to resign over the hawala issue; that a governor who was a cabinet minister has also had to quit, in the wake of judicial displeasure; that the prime minister himself is under investigation for his involvement in not one scandal but two; that the main prime ministerial candidate from the opposition has had to bow out because he too has been charged in the hawala case; and that the head of the 'third force' has his own little (or not so little) fodder scandal to face. Why then is corruption not an issue — not as a matter of competitive politics, but as an issue on which the contenders for power feel that they have to offer the prospect of genuine change? If all this does not make the parties (almost all of whom have broken the law, in not submitting their audited accounts every year to the income tax authorities) realise that the country both needs — and is ready for-change in the Supreme Court; the assertiveness of the Election Commission, giving new life to a model code of conduct that has been ignored for a quarter century; the independence that has been thrust

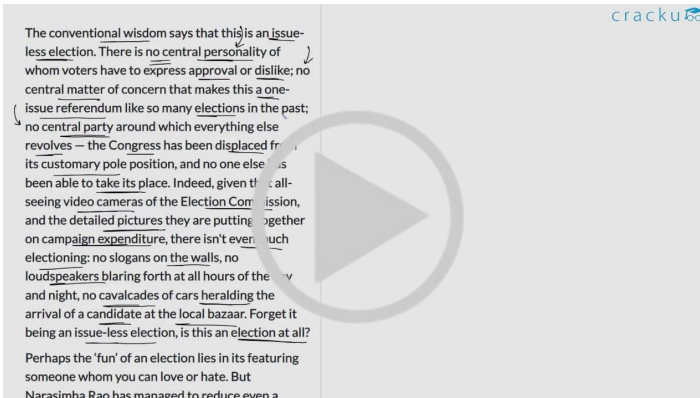
upon the Central Bureau of Investigation; and the fresh zeal on the part of tax collectors out to nab corporate no-gooders. Think also that at no other point since the Emergency of 1975-77 have so many people in power been hounded by the system for their misdeeds.

Is this just a case of a few individuals outside the political system doing the job, or is the country heading for a new era? The seventies saw the collapse of the national consensus that marked the Nehruvian era, and ideology took over in the Indira Gandhi years. That too was buried by Rajiv Gandhi and his technocratic friends. And now, we have these issue-less elections. One possibility is that the country is heading for a period of constitutionalism as the other arms of the state reclaim some of the powers they lost, or yielded, to the political establishment. Economic reform free one part of Indian society from the clutches of the political class. Now, this could spread to other parts of the system. Against such a dramatic backdrop, it should be obvious that people (voters) are looking for accountability, for ways in which to make a corrupted system work again. And the astonishing thing is that no party has sought to ride this particular wave; instead all are on the defensive, desperately evading the real issues. No wonder this is an 'issue-less' election.

Question 695

Which of the following are not under scrutiny for alleged corruption, according to the passage?

- A The opposition prime ministerial candidate
- B P.V. Narasimha Rao
- C The leader of the 'third force'
- D Ramakrishna Hegde



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 696

Why does the author probably say that the sole personality who stands out in the elections is T.N.Seshan?

- A Because all the other candidates are very boring.
- B Because all the other candidates do not have his charisma.
- C Because the shadow of his strictures are looming large over the elections.
- D None of the above

The conventional wisdom says that this is an issue-less election. There is no central personality of whom voters have to express approval or dislike; no central matter of concern that makes this a one-issue referendum like so many elections in the past; no central party around which everything else revolves — the Congress has been displaced from its customary pole position, and no one else has been able to take its place. Indeed, given the all-seeing video cameras of the Election Commission, and the detailed pictures they are putting together on campaign expenditure, there isn't even much electioneering: no slogans on the walls, no loudspeakers blaring forth at all hours of the day and night, no cavalcades of cars heralding the arrival of a candidate at the local bazaar. Forget it being an issue-less election, is this an election at all?

Perhaps the 'fun' of an election lies in its featuring someone whom you can love or hate. But Narasimha Rao has managed to reduce even a

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CAT Sectional Tests




Question 697

According to the passage, which of the following has not been responsible for the winds of change blowing throughout the country?

- A Greater awareness on the part of the general public.
- B Enforcement of a model code of conduct by the Election Commission.
- C Greater independence to the Central Bureau of Investigation.
- D Fresh zeal on the part of tax collectors.

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Perhaps the 'fun' of an election lies in its featuring someone whom you can love or hate. But Narasimha Rao has managed to reduce even a

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Question 698

Why does the author say that almost all parties have broken the law?

- A Because they all indulge in corrupt electoral process.
- B Because they all have more income than recorded sources.
- C Because they are all indicted on various charges.

D Because they have failed to submit audited accounts to tax authorities.

The conventional wisdom says that this is an issue-less election. There is no central personality of whom voters have to express approval or dislike; no central matter of concern that makes this a one-issue referendum like so many elections in the past; no central party around which everything else revolves — the Congress has been displaced from its customary pole position, and no one else has been able to take its place. Indeed, given the all-seeing video cameras of the Election Commission, and the detailed pictures they are putting together on campaign expenditure, there isn't even much electioneering: no slogans on the walls, no loudspeakers blaring forth at all hours of the day and night, no cavalcades of cars heralding the arrival of a candidate at the local bazaar. Forget it being an issue-less election, is this an election at all? Perhaps the 'fun' of an election lies in its featuring someone whom you can love or hate. But Narasimha Rao has managed to reduce even a

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Question 699

According to the passage, which of the following is not mentioned as even having the potential to be an issue in the current elections?

- A The mandir-masjid issue
- B The empowerment of women
- C Economic nationalism
- D Hindutva

The conventional wisdom says that this is an issue-less election. There is no central personality of whom voters have to express approval or dislike; no central matter of concern that makes this a one-issue referendum like so many elections in the past; no central party around which everything else revolves — the Congress has been displaced from its customary pole position, and no one else has been able to take its place. Indeed, given the all-seeing video cameras of the Election Commission, and the detailed pictures they are putting together on campaign expenditure, there isn't even much electioneering: no slogans on the walls, no loudspeakers blaring forth at all hours of the day and night, no cavalcades of cars heralding the arrival of a candidate at the local bazaar. Forget it being an issue-less election, is this an election at all? Perhaps the 'fun' of an election lies in its featuring someone whom you can love or hate. But Narasimha Rao has managed to reduce even a

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Question 700

A suitable title to the passage would be

- A Elections: A Preview.
- B The Country's Issue-less Elections.

D Love or Hate Them, But Vote For Them.



The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

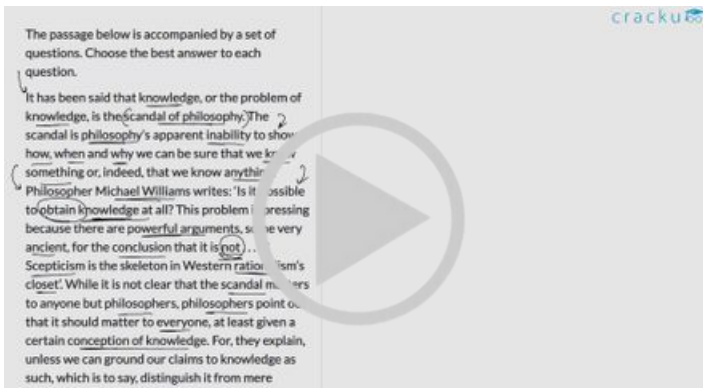
That is all quite serious-sounding but so also are the rattlings of the skeleton: that is, the sceptic's contention that we cannot be sure that we know anything - at least not if we think of knowledge as something like having a correct mental representation of reality, and not if we think of reality as something like things-as-they-are-in-themselves, independent of our perceptions, ideas or descriptions. For, the sceptic will note, since reality, under that conception of it, is outside our ken (we cannot catch a glimpse of things-in-themselves around the corner of our own eyes; we cannot form an idea of reality that floats above the processes of our conceiving it), we have no way to compare our mental representations with things-as-they-are-in-themselves and therefore no way to determine whether they are correct or incorrect. Thus the sceptic may repeat (rattling loudly), you cannot be sure you 'know' something or anything at all - at least not, he may add (rattling softly before disappearing), if that is the way you conceive 'knowledge'.

There are a number of ways to handle this situation. The most common is to ignore it. Most people outside the academy - and, indeed, most of us inside it - are unaware of or unperturbed by the philosophical scandal of knowledge and go about our lives without too many epistemic anxieties. We hold our beliefs and presumptive knowledges more or less confidently, usually depending on how we acquired them (I saw it with my own eyes; I heard it on Fox News; a guy at the office told me) and how broadly and strenuously they seem to be shared or endorsed by various relevant people: experts and authorities, friends and family members, colleagues and associates. And we examine our convictions more or less closely, explain them more or less extensively, and defend them more or less vigorously, usually depending on what seems to be at stake for ourselves and/or other people and what resources are available for reassuring ourselves or making our beliefs credible to others (look, it's right here on the page; add up the figures yourself; I happen to be a heart specialist).

Question 701

According to the last paragraph of the passage, "We hold our beliefs and presumptive knowledges more or less confidently, usually depending on" something. Which one of the following most broadly captures what we depend on?

- A How we come to hold them; how widely they are held in our social circles.
- B All of the options listed here.
- C How much of a stake we have in them; what resources there are to support them.
- D Remaining outside the academy; ignoring epistemic anxieties.

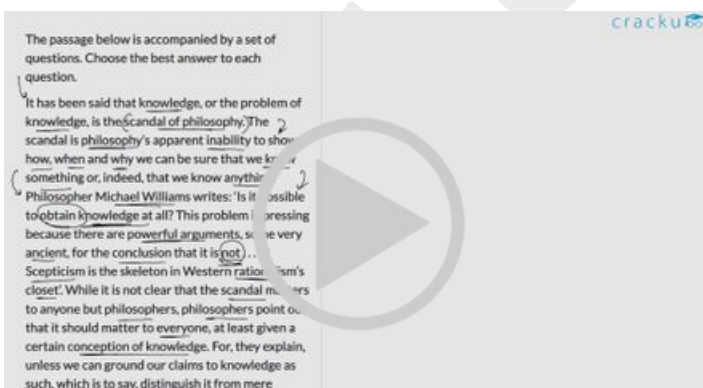


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 702

The author of the passage is most likely to support which one of the following statements?

- A The confidence with which we maintain something to be true is usually independent of the source of the alleged truth.
- B The scandal of philosophy is that we might not know anything at all about reality if we think of reality as independent of our perceptions, ideas or descriptions.
- C The actions taken on the basis of presumed knowledge are rational and justifiable if we are confident that that knowledge is widely held.
- D For the sceptic, if we think of reality as independent of our perceptions, ideas or descriptions, we should aim to know that reality independently too.



VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 703

The author discusses all of the following arguments in the passage, EXCEPT:

- A sceptics believe that we can never fully know anything, if by “knowing” we mean knowledge of a reality that is independent of the knower.
- B if we cannot distinguish knowledge from opinion or delusion, we will not be able to justify our actions.
- C the best way to deal with scepticism about the veracity of knowledge is to ignore it.
- D philosophers maintain that the scandal of philosophy should be of concern to everyone.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

It has been said that knowledge, or the problem of knowledge, is the scandal of philosophy. The scandal is philosophy's apparent inability to show how, when and why we can be sure that we know something or, indeed, that we know anything.

Philosopher Michael Williams writes: 'Is it possible to obtain knowledge at all? This problem is pressing because there are powerful arguments, some very ancient, for the conclusion that it is not...'

Scepticism is the skeleton in Western rationalism's closet'. While it is not clear that the scandal matters to anyone but philosophers, philosophers point out that it should matter to everyone, at least given a certain conception of knowledge. For, they explain, unless we can ground our claims to knowledge as such, which is to say, distinguish it from mere

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 704

“... we cannot catch a glimpse of things-in-themselves around the corner of our own eyes; we cannot form an idea of reality that floats above the processes of our conceiving it...” Which one of the following statements best reflects the argument being made in this sentence?

- A Our knowledge of reality floats above our subjective perception of it.
- B If the reality of things is independent of our eyesight, logically we cannot perceive our perception.
- C Our knowledge of reality cannot be merged with our process of conceiving it.
- D If the reality of things is independent of our perception, logically we cannot perceive that reality.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

It has been said that knowledge, or the problem of knowledge, is the scandal of philosophy. The scandal is philosophy's apparent inability to show how, when and why we can be sure that we know something or, indeed, that we know anything.

Philosopher Michael Williams writes: 'Is it possible to obtain knowledge at all? This problem is pressing because there are powerful arguments, some very ancient, for the conclusion that it is not...'

Scepticism is the skeleton in Western rationalism's closet'. While it is not clear that the scandal matters to anyone but philosophers, philosophers point out that it should matter to everyone, at least given a certain conception of knowledge. For, they explain, unless we can ground our claims to knowledge as such, which is to say, distinguish it from mere

Instructions

Cells are the ultimate multi-taskers: they can switch on genes and carry out their orders, talk to each other, divide in two, and much more, all at the same time. But they couldn't do any of these tricks without a power source to generate movement. The inside of a cell bustles with more traffic than Delhi roads, and, like all vehicles, the cell's moving parts need engines. Physicists and biologists have looked 'under the hood' of the cell and laid out the nuts and bolts of molecular engines.

The ability of such engines to convert chemical energy into motion is the envy of nanotechnology researchers looking for ways to power molecule-sized devices. Medical researchers also want to understand how these engines work. Because these molecules are essential for cell division, scientists hope to shut down the rampant growth of cancer cells by deactivating certain motors. Improving motor-driven transport in nerve cells may also be helpful for treating diseases such as Alzheimer's, Parkinson's or ALS, also known as Lou Gehrig's disease.

We wouldn't make it far in life without motor proteins. Our muscles wouldn't contract. We couldn't grow because the growth process requires cells to duplicate their machinery and pull the copies apart. And our genes would be silent without the services of messenger RNA, which carries genetic instructions over to the cell's protein-making factories. The movements that make these cellular activities possible occur along a complex network of threadlike fibres, or polymers, along which bundles of molecules travel like trams. The engines that power the cell's freight are three families of proteins called myosin, kinesin and dynein. For fuel, these proteins burn molecules of ATP, which cells make when they break down the carbohydrates and fats from the foods we eat. The energy from burning ATP causes changes in the proteins' shape that allow them to heave themselves along the polymer track. The results are impressive: In one second, these molecules can travel between 50 and 100 times their own diameter. If a car with a five-foot-wide engine were as efficient, it would travel 170 to 340 kilometres per hour.

Ronald Vale, a researcher at the Howard Hughes Medical Institute and the University of California at San Francisco, and Ronald Milligan of the Scripps Research Institute, have realized a long-awaited goal by reconstructing the process by which myosin and kinesin move, almost down to the atom. The dynein motor, on the other hand, is still poorly understood. Myosin molecules, best known for their role in muscle contraction, form chains that lie between filaments of another protein called actin. Each myosin molecule has a tiny head that pokes out from the chain like oars from a canoe. Just as rowers propel their boat by stroking their oars through the water, the myosin molecules stick their heads into the actin and hoist themselves forward along the filament. While myosin moves along in short strokes, its cousin kinesin walks steadily along a different type of filament called a microtubule. Instead of using a projecting head as a lever, kinesin walks on two 'legs'. Based on these differences, researchers used to think that myosin and kinesin were virtually unrelated. But newly discovered similarities in the motors' ATP-processing machinery now suggest that they share a common ancestor — molecule. At this point, scientists can only speculate as to what type of primitive cell-like structure this ancestor occupied as it learned to burn ATP and use the energy to change shape. "We'll never really know because we can't dig up the remains of ancient proteins, but that was probably a big evolutionary leap," says Vale.

On a slightly larger scale, loner cells like sperm or infectious bacteria are prime movers that resolutely push their way through to other cells. As L. Mahadevan and Paul Matsudaira of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology explain, the engines, in this case, are springs or ratchets that are clusters of molecules rather than single proteins like myosin and kinesin. Researchers don't yet fully understand these engines' fueling process or the details of how they move, but the result is a force to be reckoned with. For example, one such engine is a spring-like stalk connecting a single-celled organism called a vorticellid to the leaf fragment it calls home. When exposed to calcium, the spring contracts, yanking the vorticellid down at speeds approaching three inches (eight centimetres) per second.

Springs like this are coiled bundles of filaments that expand or contract in response to chemical cues. A wave of positively charged calcium ions, for example, neutralizes the negative charges that keep the filaments extended. Some sperm use spring-like engines made of actin filaments to shoot out a barb that penetrates the layers that surround an egg. And certain viruses use a similar apparatus to shoot their DNA into the host's cell.

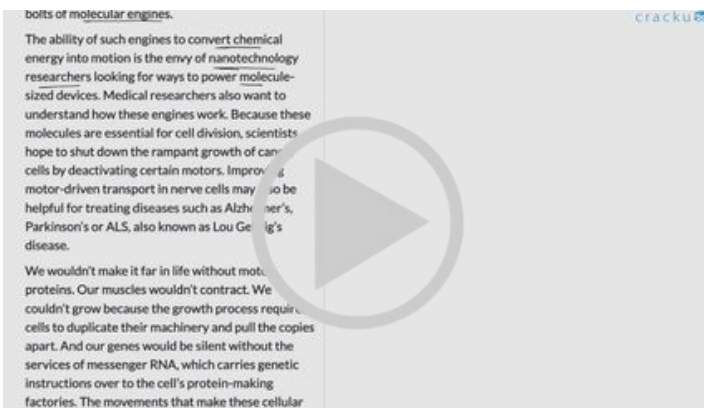
Ratchets are also useful for moving whole cells, including some other sperm and pathogens. These engines are filaments that simply grow at one end, attracting chemical building blocks from nearby. Because the other end is anchored in place, the growing end pushes against any barrier that gets in its way.

Both springs and ratchets are made up of small units that each move just slightly, but collectively produce a powerful movement. Ultimately, Mahadevan and Matsudaira hope to better understand just how these particles create an effect that seems to be so much more than the sum of its parts. Might such an understanding provide inspiration for ways to power artificial nano-sized devices in the future? "The short answer is absolutely," says Mahadevan. "Biology has had a lot more time to evolve enormous richness in design for different organisms. Hopefully, studying these structures will not only improve our understanding of the biological world, it will also enable us to copy them, take apart their components and recreate them for other purpose."

Question 705

According to the author, one of the objectives of the research on the power source of movement in cells can be to

- A control the movement of genes within human systems.
- B understand nano-sized devices better.
- C arrest the growth of cells in a human being.
- D develop potential cures for a variety of diseases.



VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 706

Read the five statements below: A, B, C, D, and E. From the options given, select the one which includes a statement that is not representative of an argument presented in the passage.

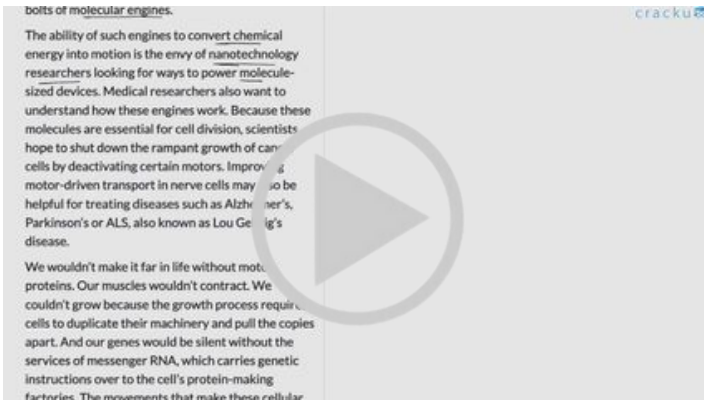
- A. Sperms use spring-like engines made of actin filament.
- B. Myosin and kinesin are unrelated.
- C. Nanotechnology researchers look for ways to power molecule-sized devices.
- D. Motor proteins help muscle contraction.
- E. The dynein motor is still poorly understood.

- A A, B and C

B C, D and E

C A, D and E

D A, C and D



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 707

Read the four statements below: A, B, C and D. From the options given, select the one which includes statements that are representative of arguments presented in the passage.

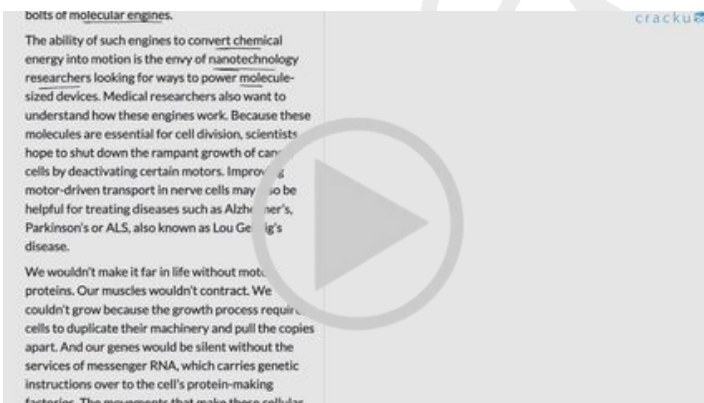
- A. Myosin, kinesin and dynein are three types of protein.
- B. Growth processes involve a routine in a cell that duplicates their machinery and pulls the copies apart.
- C. Myosin molecules can generate vibrations in muscles.
- D. Ronald and Mahadevan are researchers at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology.

A A and B but not C and D

B B and C but not a

C B and D but not A and C

D A, B and C but not D



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 708

Read the four statements below: A, B, C and D. From the options given, select the one which includes only statements that are representative of arguments presented in the passage.

A. Protein motors help growth processes.

B. Improved transport in nerve cells will help arrest tuberculosis and cancer.

C. Though the smaller units that make up springs move only slightly, they collectively produce powerful movement.

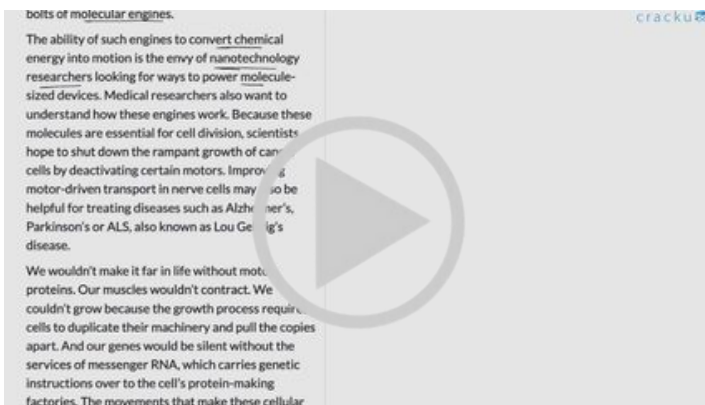
D. Vorticellid and the leaf fragment are connected by a calcium engine.

A A and B but not C

B A and C but not D

C A and D but not B

D C and D but not B



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Question 709

The author has used several analogies in the article. Which of the following pairs of words are examples of the analogies used?

A. Cell activity and vehicular traffic

B. Polymers and tram tracks

C. Genes and canoes

D. Vorticellids and ratchets

A A and B

B B and C

C A and D

D A and C



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The conceptions of life and the world which we call 'philosophical' are a product of two factors: one, inherited religious and ethical conceptions; the other, the sort of investigation which may be called 'scientific', using this word in its broadest sense. Individual philosophers have differed widely in regard to the proportions in which these two factors entered into their systems, but it is the presence of both, in some degree, that characterizes philosophy.

'Philosophy' is a word which has been used in many ways, some wider, some narrower. I propose to use it in a very wide sense, which I will now try to explain.

Philosophy, as I shall understand the word, is something intermediate between theology and science. Like theology, it consists of speculations on matters as to which definite knowledge has, so far, been unascertainable; but like science, it appeals to human reason rather than to authority, whether that of tradition or that of revelation. All definite knowledge, so I should contend, belongs to science; all dogma as to what surpasses definite knowledge belongs to theology. But between theology and science there is a 'No man's Land', exposed to attack from both sides; this 'No Man's Land' is philosophy. Almost all the questions of most interest to speculative minds are such as science cannot answer, and the confident answers of theologians no longer seem so convincing as they did in former centuries. Is the world divided into mind and matter, and if so, what is mind and what is matter? Is mind subject to matter, or is it possessed of independent powers? Has the universe any unity or purpose? It is evolving towards some goal? Are there really laws of nature, or do we believe in them only because of our innate love of order? Is man what he seems to the astronomer, a tiny lump of carbon and water impotently crawling on a small and unimportant planet? Or is he what he appears to Hamlet? Is he perhaps both at once? Is there a way of living that is noble and another that is base, or are all ways of living merely futile? If there is a way of living that is noble, in what does it consist, and how shall we achieve it? Must the good be eternal in order to deserve to be valued, or is it worth seeking even if the universe is inexorably moving towards death? Is there such a thing as wisdom, or is what seems such merely the ultimate refinement of folly? To such questions no answer can be found in the laboratory. Theologies have professed to give answers, all too definite; but their definiteness causes modern minds to view them with suspicion. The studying of these questions, if not the answering of them, is the business of philosophy.

Why, then, you may ask, waste time on such insoluble problems? To this one may answer as a historian, or as an individual facing the terror of cosmic loneliness.

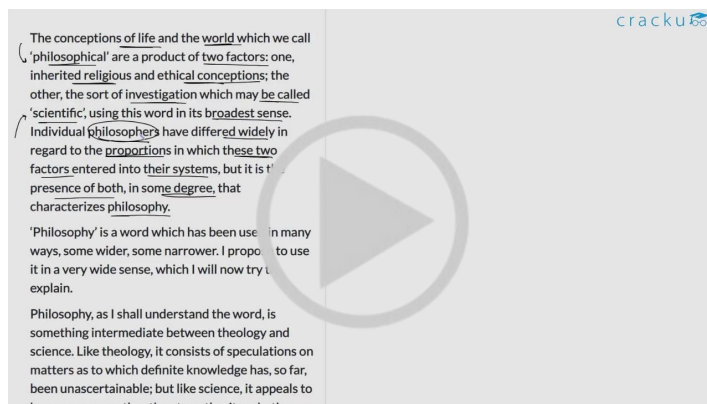
The answer of the historian, in so far as I am capable of giving it, will appear in the course of this work. Ever since men became capable of free speculation, their actions in innumerable important respects, have depended upon their theories as to the world and human life, as to what is good and what is evil. This is as true in the present day as at any former time. To understand an age or a nation, we must understand its philosophy, and to understand its philosophy we must ourselves be in some degree philosophers. There is here a reciprocal causation: the circumstances of men's lives do much to determine their philosophy, but, conversely, their philosophy does much to determine their circumstances.

There is also, however, a more personal answer. Science tells us what we can know, but what we can know is little, and if we forget how much we cannot know we may become insensitive to many things of very great importance. Theology, on the other hand, induces a dogmatic belief that we have knowledge, where in fact we have ignorance, and by doing so generates a kind of impertinent insolence towards the universe. Uncertainty, in the presence of vivid hopes and fears, is painful, but must be endured if we wish to live without the support of comforting fairy tales. It is good either to forget the questions that philosophy asks, or to persuade ourselves that we have found indubitable answers to them. To teach how to live without certainty, and yet without being paralyzed by hesitation, is perhaps the chief thing that philosophy, in our age, can still do for those who study it.

Question 710

Based on the passage, what can be concluded about the relation between philosophy and science?

- A The two are antagonistic.
- B The two are complementary.
- C There is no relation between the two.
- D Philosophy derives from science.



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Question 711

The purpose of philosophy is to

- A reduce uncertainty and chaos.
- B help us to cope with uncertainty and ambiguity.
- C help us to find explanations for uncertainty.
- D reduce the terror of cosmic loneliness.

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Question 712

According to the author, which of the following statements about the nature of universe must be definitely true?

- A The universe has unity.
- B The universe has a purpose.
- C The universe is evolving towards a goal.
- D None of these

The conceptions of life and the world which we call 'philosophical' are a product of two factors: one, inherited religious and ethical conceptions; the other, the sort of investigation which may be called 'scientific', using this word in its broadest sense. Individual philosophers have differed widely in regard to the proportions in which these two factors entered into their systems, but it is the presence of both, in some degree, that characterizes philosophy.

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Question 713

From reading the passage, what can be concluded about the profession of the author? He is most likely not to be a

- A historian.
- B philosopher.
- C scientist.

D theologian.



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Philosophy, as I shall understand the word, is something intermediate between theology and science. Like theology, it consists of speculations on matters as to which definite knowledge has, so far, been unascertainable; but like science, it appeals to human reason rather than to authority; and it is

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Instructions

The narrative of Dersu Uzala is divided into two major sections, set in 1902, and 1907, that deal with separate expeditions which Arseniev conducts into the Ussuri region. In addition, a third time frame forms a prologue to the film. Each of the temporal frames has a different focus, and by shifting them Kurosawa is able to describe the encroachment of settlements upon the wilderness and the consequent erosion of Dersu's way of life. As the film opens, that erosion has already begun. The first image is a long shot of a huge forest, the trees piled upon one another by the effects of the telephoto lens so that the landscape becomes an abstraction and appears like a huge curtain of green. A title informs us that the year is 1910. This is as late into the century as Kurosawa will go. After this prologue, the events of the film will transpire even farther back in time and will be presented as Arseniev's recollections. The character of Dersu Uzala is the heart of the film, his life the example that Kurosawa wishes to affirm. Yet the formal organization of the film works to contain, to close, to circumscribe that life by erecting a series of obstacles around it. The film itself is circular, opening and closing by Dersu's grave, thus sealing off the character from the modern world to which Kurosawa once so desperately wanted to speak. The multiple time frames also work to maintain a separation between Dersu and the contemporary world. We must go back father even than 1910 to discover who he was. But this narrative structure has yet another implication. It safeguards Dersu's example, inoculates it from contamination with history, and protects it from contact with the industrialised, urban world. Time is organised by the narrative into a series of barriers, which enclose Dersu in a kind of vacuum chamber, protecting him from the social and historical dialectics that destroyed the other Kurosawa heroes. Within the film, Dersu does die, but the narrative structure attempts to immortalise him and his example, as Dersu passes from history into myth.

We see all this at work in the enormously evocative prologue. The camera tilts down to reveal felled trees littering the landscape and an abundance of construction. Roads and houses outline the settlement that is being built. Kurosawa cuts to a medium shot of Arseniev standing in the midst of the clearing, looking uncomfortable and disoriented. A man passing in a wagon asks him what he is doing, and the explorer says he is looking for a grave. The driver replies that no one has died here, the settlement is too recent. These words enunciate the temporal rupture that the film studies. It is the beginning of things (industrial society) and the end of things (the forest), the commencement of one world so young that no one has had time yet to die and the eclipse of another, in which Dersu had died. It is his grave for which the explorer searches. His passing symbolises the new order, the development that now surrounds Arseniev. The explorer says he buried his friend three years ago next to huge cedar and fir trees, but now they are all gone. The man on the wagon replies they were probably chopped down when the settlement was built, and he drives off. Arseniev walks to a barren, treeless spot next to a pile of bricks. As he moves, the camera tracks and pans to follow, revealing a line of freshly built houses and a woman hanging her laundry to dry. A distant train whistle is heard, and the sounds of construction in the clearing vie with the cries of birds and the rustle of wind in the trees. Arseniev pauses, looks around for the grave that once was, and murmurs desolately, 'Dersu'. The image now cuts farther into the past, to 1902, and the first section of the film commences, which describes Arseniev's meeting with Dersu and their

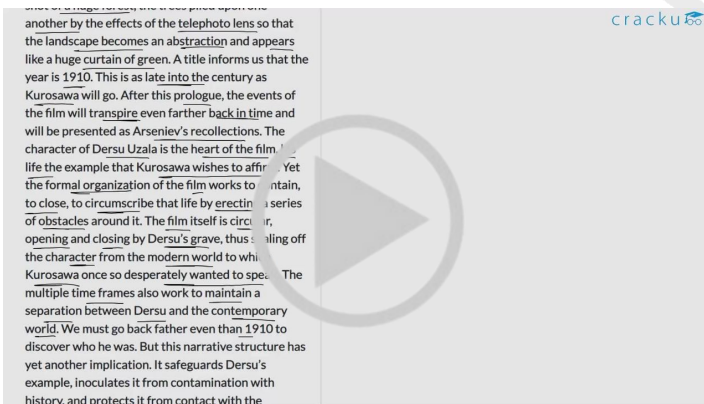
friendship.

Kurosawa defines the world of the film initially upon a void, a missing presence. The grave is gone, brushed aside by a world rushing into modernism, and now the hunter exists only in Arseniev's memories. The hallucinatory dreams and visions of Dodeskaden are succeeded by nostalgic, melancholy ruminations. Yet by exploring these ruminations, the film celebrates the timelessness of Dersu's wisdom. The first section of the film has two purposes: to describe the magnificence and inhuman vastness of nature and to delineate the code of ethics by which Dersu lives and which permits him to survive in these conditions. When Dersu first appears, the other soldiers treat him with condescension and laughter, but Arseniev watches him closely and does not share their derisive response. Unlike them, he is capable of immediately grasping Dersu's extraordinary qualities. In camp, Kurosawa frames Arseniev by himself, sitting on the other side of the fire from his soldiers. While they sleep or joke among themselves, he writes in his diary and Kurosawa cuts in several point-of-view shots from his perspective of trees that appear animated and sinister as the firelight dances across their gnarled, leafless outlines. This reflective dimension, this sensitivity to the spirituality of nature, distinguishes him from the others and forms the basis of his receptivity to Dersu and their friendship. It makes him a fit pupil for the hunter.

Question 714

The film celebrates Dersu's wisdom

- A by exhibiting the moral vacuum of the pre-modern world.
- B by turning him into a mythical figure.
- C through hallucinatory dreams and visions.
- D through Arseniev's nostalgic, melancholy ruminations.



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Question 715

According to the author, the section of the film following the prologue

- A serves to highlight the difficulties that Dersu faces that eventually kills him.
- B shows the difference in thinking between Arseniev and Dersu.
- C shows the code by which Dersu lives that allows him to survive his surroundings.

D serves to criticize the lack of understanding of nature in the pre-modern era.

another by the effects of the telephoto lens so that the landscape becomes an abstraction and appears like a huge curtain of green. A title informs us that the year is 1910. This is as late into the century as Kurosawa will go. After this prologue, the events of the film will transpire even farther back in time and will be presented as Arseniev's recollections. The character of Dersu Uzala is the heart of the film. Yet the formal organization of the film works to contain, to close, to circumscribe that life by erecting a series of obstacles around it. The film itself is circular, opening and closing by Dersu's grave, thus sealing off the character from the modern world to which Kurosawa once so desperately wanted to speak. The multiple time frames also work to maintain a separation between Dersu and the contemporary world. We must go back farther even than 1910 to discover who he was. But this narrative structure has yet another implication. It safeguards Dersu's example, inoculates it from contamination with history, and protects it from contact with the



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Question 716

In the film, Kurosawa hints at Arseniev's reflective and sensitive nature

- A by showing him as not being derisive towards Dersu, unlike other soldiers.
- B by showing him as being aloof from other soldiers.
- C through shots of Arseniev writing his diary, framed by trees.
- D All of these

another by the effects of the telephoto lens so that the landscape becomes an abstraction and appears like a huge curtain of green. A title informs us that the year is 1910. This is as late into the century as Kurosawa will go. After this prologue, the events of the film will transpire even farther back in time and will be presented as Arseniev's recollections. The character of Dersu Uzala is the heart of the film. Yet the formal organization of the film works to contain, to close, to circumscribe that life by erecting a series of obstacles around it. The film itself is circular, opening and closing by Dersu's grave, thus sealing off the character from the modern world to which Kurosawa once so desperately wanted to speak. The multiple time frames also work to maintain a separation between Dersu and the contemporary world. We must go back farther even than 1910 to discover who he was. But this narrative structure has yet another implication. It safeguards Dersu's example, inoculates it from contamination with history, and protects it from contact with the



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Question 717

How is Kurosawa able to show the erosion of Dersu's way of life?

- A By documenting the ebb and flow of modernisation.
- B By going back farther and farther in time.
- C By using three different time frames and shifting them.
- D Through his death in a distant time.

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CAT Important Topics

Question 718

Arseniev's search for Dersu's grave

- A is part of the beginning of the film.
- B symbolises the end of the industrial society.
- C is misguided since the settlement is too new.
- D symbolises the rediscovery of modernity.

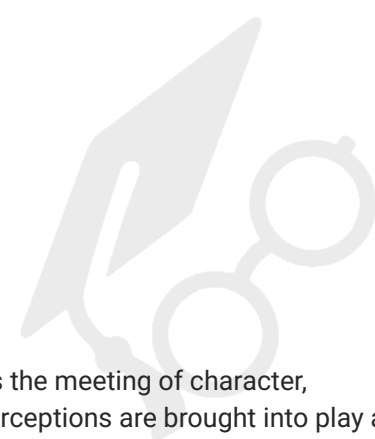
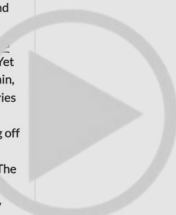
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Question 719

According to the author, which of these statements about the film is correct?

- A The film makes its arguments circuitously.
- B The film highlights the insularity of Arseniev.
- C The film begins with the absence of its main protagonist.
- D None of these

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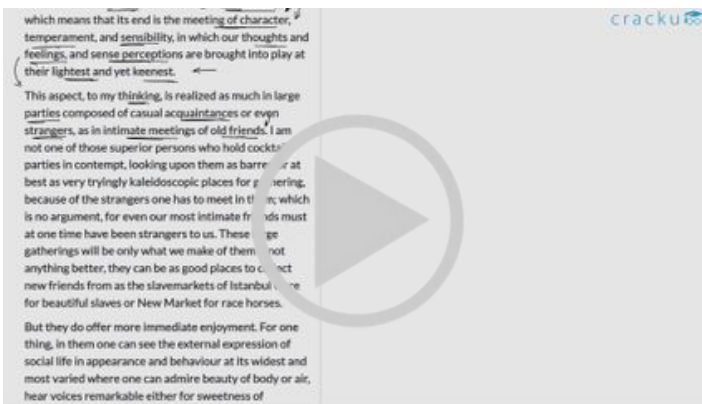
by them either on foot or in a car. I had borrowed a car from a relative to visit a friend in one of these suburbs, and he became very anxious when I had not returned before dusk. Acid and bombs, he said, were thrown at cars almost every evening in that area. I was amazed. But I also know as a fact that my brother was blackmailed to pay five rupees on a trumped up charge when passing in a car through one such locality.

The situation is differently inhuman, but not a whit more human, among the well-to-do. Kindliness for fellow human beings has been smothered in them, taken as a class, by the arrogance of worldly position, which among the Bengalis who show this snobbery is often only a third-class position.

Question 720

In this passage the author is essentially

- A showing how shallow our social life is.
- B poking fun at the lower middle class people who howl at better off people.
- C lamenting the drying up of our real social life.
- D criticizing the upper class for lavish showy parties.



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Question 721

The word 'they' in the first sentence of the third paragraph refers to

- A Large parties consisting of casual acquaintances and strangers.
- B Intimate meetings of old friends.
- C New friends.
- D Both (1) and (2).

which means that its end is the meeting of character, temperament, and sensibility, in which our thoughts and feelings, and sense perceptions are brought into play at their lightest and yet keenest.

This aspect, to my thinking, is realized as much in large parties composed of casual acquaintances or even strangers, as in intimate meetings of old friends. I am not one of those superior persons who hold cocktail parties in contempt, looking upon them as barren or at best as very tryingly kaleidoscopic places for gathering, because of the strangers one has to meet in them; which is no argument, for even our most intimate friends must at one time have been strangers to us. These large gatherings will be only what we make of them; not anything better, they can be as good places to connect new friends from as the slavemarkets of Istanbul or the bazaars for beautiful slaves or New Market for race horses.

But they do offer more immediate enjoyment. For one thing, in them one can see the external expression of social life in appearance and behaviour at its widest and most varied where one can admire beauty of body or air, hear voices remarkable either for sweetness of

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Question 722

The author's conception of 'social life' requires that

- A people attend large gatherings.
- B people possess qualities like wonder and interest.
- C people do not spend too much time in the company of intimate friends.
- D large parties consist of casual acquaintances and intimate friends.

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Question 723

What is the author trying to show through the two incidents in the penultimate paragraph?

- A The crowds in poor Calcutta suburbs can turn violent without any provocation.
- B Although poor, the people of poor Calcutta suburbs have a rich social life.
- C It is risky for rich people to move around in poor suburbs.
- D Achieving a high degree of sociability does not stop the poor from hating the rich.

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Question 724

The word 'discriminate' in the last sentence of the third paragraph means

- A recognize.
- B count.
- C distinguish.
- D analyse.

VIEW SOLUTION

Instructions

My aim is to present a conception of justice which generalizes and carries to a higher level of abstraction the familiar theory of the social contract. In order to do this we are not to think of the original contract as one to enter a particular society or to set up a particular form of government. Rather, the idea is that the principles of justice for the basic structure of society are the object of the original agreement. They are the principles that free and rational persons concerned to further their own interests would accept in an initial position of equality. These principles are to regulate all further agreements; they specify the kinds of social cooperation that can be entered into and the forms of government that can be established. This way of regarding the principles of justice, I shall call justice as fairness. Thus, we are to imagine that those who engage in social cooperation choose together, in one joint act, the principles which are to assign basic rights and duties and to determine the division of social benefits. Just as each person must decide by rational reflection what constitutes his good, that is, the system of ends which it is rational for him to pursue, so a group of persons must decide once and for all what is to count among them as just and unjust. The choice which rational men would make in this hypothetical situation of equal liberty determines the principles of justice.

In 'justice as fairness', the original position is not an actual historical state of affairs. It is understood as a purely hypothetical situation characterized so as to lead to a certain conception of justice. Among the essential features of this situation is that no one knows his place in society, his class position or social status, nor does anyone know his fortune in the distribution of natural assets and abilities, his intelligence, strength, and the like. I shall even assume that the parties do not know their conceptions of the good or their special psychological propensities. The principles of justice are chosen behind a veil of ignorance. This ensures that no one is

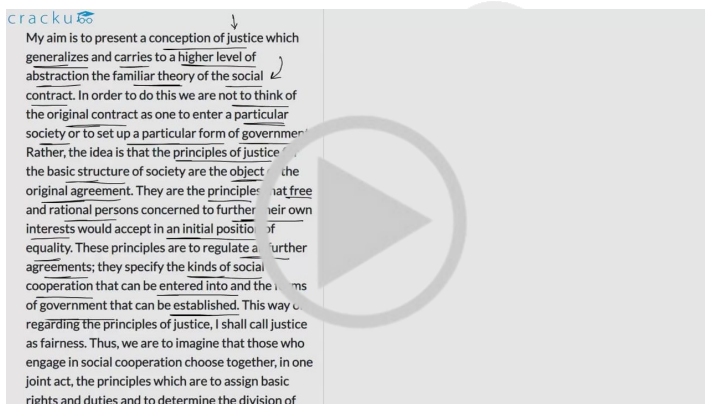
advantaged or disadvantaged in the choice of principles by the outcome of natural chance or the contingency of social circumstances. Since all are similarly situated and no one is able to design principles to favor his particular condition, the principles of justice are the result of a fair agreement or bargain.

Justice as fairness begins with one of the most general of all choices which persons might make together, namely, with the choice of the first principles of a conception of justice which is to regulate all subsequent criticism and reform of institutions. Then, having chosen a conception of justice, we can suppose that they are to choose a constitution and a legislature to enact laws, and so on, all in accordance with the principles of justice initially agreed upon. Our social situation is just if it is such that by this sequence of hypothetical agreements we would have contracted into the general system of rules which defines it. Moreover, assuming that the original position does determine a set of principles, it will then be true that whenever social institutions satisfy these principles, those engaged in them can say to one another that they are cooperating on terms to which they would agree if they were free and equal persons whose relations with respect to one another were fair. They could all view their arrangements as meeting the stipulations which they would acknowledge in an initial situation that embodies widely accepted and reasonable constraints on the choice of principles. The general recognition of this fact would provide the basis for a public acceptance of the corresponding principles of justice. No society can, of course, be a scheme of cooperation which men enter voluntarily in a literal sense; each person finds himself placed at birth in some particular position in some particular society, and the nature of this position materially affects his life prospects. Yet a society satisfying the principles of justice as fairness comes as close as a society can to being a voluntary scheme, for it meets the principles which free and equal persons would assent to under circumstances that are fair.

Question 725

A just society, as conceptualized in the passage, can be best described as:

- A A Utopia in which everyone is equal and no one enjoys any privilege based on their existing positions and powers. ‘
- B A hypothetical society in which people agree upon principles of justice which are fair.
- C A society in which principles of justice are not based on the existing positions and powers of the individuals.
- D A society in which principles of justice are fair to all.
- E A hypothetical society in which principles of justice are not based on the existing positions and powers of the individuals.



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Question 726

Which of the following situations best represents the idea of justice as fairness, as argued in the passage?

- A All individuals are paid equally for the work they do.

- B Everyone is assigned some work for his or her livelihood.
- C All acts of theft are penalized equally.
- D All children are provided free education in similar schools.
- E All individuals are provided a fixed sum of money to take care of their health.

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Question 727

Which of the following best illustrates the situation that is equivalent to choosing 'the principles of justice' behind a 'veil of ignorance'?

- A The principles of justice are chosen by businessmen, who are marooned on an uninhabited island after a shipwreck, but have some possibility of returning.
- B The principles of justice are chosen by a group of school children whose capabilities are yet to develop.
- C The principles of justice are chosen by businessmen, who are marooned on an uninhabited island after a shipwreck and have no possibility of returning.
- D The principles of justice are chosen assuming that such principles will govern the lives of the rule makers only in their next birth if the rule makers agree that they will be born again.
- E The principles of justice are chosen by potential immigrants who are unaware of the resources necessary to succeed in a foreign country.

My aim is to present a conception of justice which generalizes and carries to a higher level of abstraction the familiar theory of the social contract. In order to do this we are not to think of the original contract as one to enter a particular society or to set up a particular form of government. Rather, the idea is that the principles of justice are the basic structure of society are the object of the original agreement. They are the principles that free and rational persons concerned to further their own interests would accept in an initial position of equality. These principles are to regulate a further agreements; they specify the kinds of social cooperation that can be entered into and the terms of government that can be established. This way of regarding the principles of justice, I shall call justice as fairness. Thus, we are to imagine that those who engage in social cooperation choose together, in one joint act, the principles which are to assign basic rights and duties and to determine the division of

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 728

Why, according to the passage, do principles of justice need to be based on an original agreement?

- A Social institutions and laws can be considered fair only if they conform to principles of justice.
- B Social institutions and laws can be fair only if they are consistent with the principles of justice as initially agreed upon.
- C Social institutions and laws need to be fair in order to be just.
- D Social institutions and laws evolve fairly only if they are consistent with the principles of justice as initially agreed upon.
- E Social institutions and laws conform to the principles of justice as initially agreed upon.

My aim is to present a conception of justice which generalizes and carries to a higher level of abstraction the familiar theory of the social contract. In order to do this we are not to think of the original contract as one to enter a particular society or to set up a particular form of government. Rather, the idea is that the principles of justice are the basic structure of society are the object of the original agreement. They are the principles that free and rational persons concerned to further their own interests would accept in an initial position of equality. These principles are to regulate a further agreements; they specify the kinds of social cooperation that can be entered into and the terms of government that can be established. This way of regarding the principles of justice, I shall call justice as fairness. Thus, we are to imagine that those who engage in social cooperation choose together, in one joint act, the principles which are to assign basic rights and duties and to determine the division of

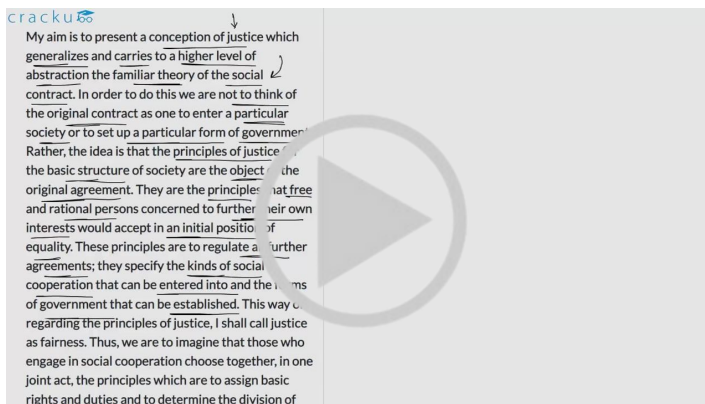
VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 729

The original agreement or original position in the passage has been used by the author as:

- A A hypothetical situation conceived to derive principles of justice which are not influenced by position, status and condition of individuals in the society.
- B A hypothetical situation in which every individual is equal and no individual enjoys any privilege based on the existing positions and powers.
- C A hypothetical situation to ensure fairness of agreements among individuals in society.

- D An imagined situation in which principles of justice would have to be fair.
- E An imagined situation in which fairness is the objective of the principles of justice to ensure that no individual enjoys any privilege based on the existing positions and powers.



VIDEO SOLUTION



Instructions

I think that it would be wrong to ask whether 50 years of India's Independence are an achievement or a failure. It would be better to see things as evolving. It's not an either-or question. My idea of the history of India is slightly contrary to the Indian idea.

India is a country that, in the north, outside Rajasthan, was ravaged and intellectually destroyed to a large extent by the invasions that began in about AD 1000 by forces and religions that India had no means of understanding.

The invasions are in all the schoolbooks. But I don't think that people understand that every invasion, every war, every campaign, was accompanied by slaughter, a slaughter always of the most talented people in the country. So these wars, apart from everything else led to a tremendous intellectual depletion of the country.

I think that in the British period, and in the 50 years after the British period, there has been a kind of regrouping or recovery, a very slow revival of energy and intellect. This isn't an idea that goes with the vision of the grandeur of old India and all that sort of rubbish. That idea is a great simplification and it occurs because it is intellectually, philosophically easier for Indians to manage.

What they cannot manage, and what they have not yet come to terms with, is that ravaging of all the north of India by various conquerors. That was ruined not by the act of nature, but by the hand of man. It is so painful that few Indians have begun to deal with it. It is much easier to deal with British imperialism. That is a familiar topic, in India and Britain. What is much less familiar is the ravaging of India before the British.

What happened from AD 1000 onwards, really, is such a wound that it is almost impossible to face. Certain wounds are so bad that they can't be written about. You deal with that kind of pain by hiding from it. You retreat from reality. I do not think, for example, that the Incas of Peru or the native people of Mexico have ever got over their defeat by the Spaniards. In both places the head was cut off. I think the pre-British ravaging of India was as bad as that.

In the place of knowledge of history, you have various fantasies about the village republic and the Old Glory. There is one big fantasy that Indians have always found solace in: about India having the capacity for absorbing its conquerors. This is not so. India was laid low by its conquerors.

I feel the past 150 years have been years of every kind of growth. I see the British period and what has continued after that as one period. In that time, there has been a very slow intellectual recruitment. I think every Indian should make the pilgrimage to the site of the capital of the Vijayanagar empire, just to see what the invasion of India led to. They will see a totally destroyed town. Religious wars are like that. People who see that might understand what the centuries of slaughter and plunder meant. War isn't a game. When you lost that kind of war, your town was destroyed, the people who built the towns were destroyed. You are left with a headless population.

That's where modern India starts from. The Vijayanagar capital was destroyed in 1565. It is only now that the surrounding region has begun to revive. A great chance has been given to India to start up again, and I feel it has started up again. The questions about whether 50 years of India since Independence have been a failure or an achievement are not the questions to ask. In fact, I think India is developing quite marvelously, people thought — even Mr Nehru thought — that development and new institutions in a place like Bihar, for instance, would immediately lead to beauty. But it doesn't happen like that. When a country as ravaged as India, with all its layers of cruelty, begins to extend justice to people lower down, it's a very messy business. It's not beautiful, it's extremely messy. And that's what you have now, all these small politicians with small reputations and small parties. But this is part of growth, this is part of development. You must remember that these people, and the people they represent, have never had rights before.

When the oppressed have the power to assert themselves, they will behave badly. It will need a couple of generations of security, and knowledge of institutions, and the knowledge that you can trust institutions — it will take at least a couple of generations before people in that situation begin to behave well. People in India have known only tyranny. The very idea of liberty is a new idea. The rulers were tyrants. The tyrants were foreigners. And they were proud of being foreign. There's a story that anybody could run and pull a bell and the emperor would appear at his window and give justice. This is a child's idea of history — the slave's idea of the ruler's mercy. When the people at the bottom discover that they hold justice in their own hands, the earth moves a little. You have to expect these earth movements in India. It will be like this for a hundred years. But it is the only way. It's painful and messy and primitive and petty, but it's better that it should begin. It has to begin. If we were to rule people according to what we think fit, that takes us back to the past when people had no voices. With self-awareness all else follows. People begin to make new demands on their leaders, their fellows, on themselves.

They ask for more in everything. They have a higher idea of human possibilities. They are not content with what they did before or what their fathers did before. They want to move. That is marvellous. That is as it should be. I think that within every kind of disorder now in India there is a larger positive movement. But the future will be fairly chaotic. Politics will have to be at the level of the people now. People like Nehru were colonial — style politicians. They were to a large extent created and protected by the colonial order. They did not begin with the people. Politicians now have to begin with the people. They cannot be too far above the level of the people. They are very much part of the people. It is important that self-criticism does not stop. The mind has to work, the mind has to be active, there has to be an exercise of the mind. I think it's almost a definition of a living country that it looks at itself, analyses itself at all times. Only countries that have ceased to live can say it's all wonderful.

Question 730

For a country to be alive and progressive, it is important that

- A self-criticism does not stop.
- B self-criticism does not exceed a certain limit.
- C it feels that all is right with itself.
- D None of these

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 731

The central thrust of the passage is that

- A India is gearing up for a new awakening.
- B India is going back to its past status.
- C India is yet to understand itself.
- D India's glorious past is a figment of the imagination.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 732

The writer has given the example of the Vijayanagar kingdom in order to drive home the point that

- A Indians should know their historical sites.
- B Indians should be aware of the existence of such a historic past.
- C it is time that India came to terms with the past.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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Question 733

According to the passage, self-awareness is followed by

- A self-righteousness.
- B a higher idea of human possibilities.
- C a desire for more in everything.
- D Both b and c

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 734

The writer's attitude is

- A excessively critical of India.
- B insightful.
- C cynical.
- D cold.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 735

According to the writer, India's regeneration and revival took place

- A in the British period.
- B after the British period.
- C during and after the British period.
- D a long time after the British left.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 736

According to the passage, India's current situation is

- A bleak.
- B horrific.
- C primitive and messy.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 737

The writer is against

- A the child's view of history.
- B taking a critical stand on history.
- C indulging in the details of the past.
- D None of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 738

One of the main features of the tyranny of foreign rulers was

- A the decimation of the country's artists.
- B the decimation of the country's wealth.
- C the decimation of the country's talented people.
- D All of these

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Question 739

The writer's prognosis for India's future is that

- A it will be stable.
- B it will be chaotic.
- C it will reflect the manipulations of the present.
- D it will give way to self-criticism.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

If translated into English, most of the ways economists talk among themselves would sound plausible enough to poets, journalists, businesspeople, and other thoughtful though non-economical folk. Like serious talk anywhere — among boat designers and baseball fans, say — the talk is hard to follow when one has not made a habit of listening to it for a while. The culture of the conversation makes the words arcane. But the people in the unfamiliar conversation are not Martians. Underneath it all (the economist's favourite phrase) conversational habits are similar. Economics uses mathematical models and statistical tests and market arguments, all of which look alien to the literary eye. But looked at closely they are not so alien. They may be seen as figures of speech - metaphors, analogies, and appeals to authority.

Figures of speech are not mere frills. They think for us. Someone who thinks of a market as an 'invisible hand' and the organization of work as a 'production function' and his coefficients as being 'significant', as an economist does, is giving the language a lot of responsibility. It seems a good idea to look hard at his language.

If the economic conversation were found to depend a lot on its verbal forms, this would not mean that economics would be not a science, or just a matter of opinion, or some sort of confidence game. Good poets, though not scientists, are serious thinkers about symbols; good historians, though not scientists, are serious thinkers about data. Good scientists also use language. What is more (though it remains to be shown) they use the cunning of language, without particularly meaning to. The language used is a social object, and using language is a social act. It requires cunning (or, if you prefer, consideration), attention to the other minds present when one speaks.

The paying of attention to one's audience is called 'rhetoric', a word that I later exercise hard. One uses rhetoric, of course, to warn of a fire in a theatre or to arouse the xenophobia of the electorate. This sort of yelling is the vulgar meaning of the word, like the president's 'heated rhetoric' in a press conference or the 'mere rhetoric' to which our enemies stoop. Since the Greek flame was lit, though, the word has been used also in a broader and more amiable sense, to mean the study of all the ways of accomplishing things with language: inciting a mob to lynch the accused, to be sure, but also persuading readers of a novel that its characters breathe, or bringing scholars to accept the better argument and reject the worse.

The question is whether the scholar- who usually fancies himself an announcer of 'results' or a stater of 'conclusions' free of rhetoric — speaks rhetorically. Does he try to persuade? It would seem so. Language, I just said, is not a solitary accomplishment. The scholar doesn't speak into the void, or to himself. He speaks to a community of voices. He desires to be heeded, praised, published, imitated, honoured, en-Nobeled. These are the desires. The devices of language are the means. Rhetoric is the proportioning of means to desires in speech.

Rhetoric is an economics of language, the study of how scarce means are allocated to the insatiable desires of people to be heard. It seems on the face of it a reasonable hypothesis that economists are like other people in being talkers, who desire listeners when they go to the library or the laboratory as much as when they go to the

office or the polls. The purpose here is to see if this is true, and to see if it is useful: to study the rhetoric of economic scholarship.

The subject is scholarship. It is not the economy, or the adequacy of economic theory as a description of the economy, or even mainly the economist's role in the economy. The subject is the conversation economists have among themselves, for purposes of persuading each other that the interest elasticity of demand for investment is zero or that the money supply is controlled by the Federal Reserve.

Unfortunately, though, the conclusions are of more than academic interest. The conversations of classicists or of astronomers rarely affect the lives of other people. Those of economists do so on a large scale. A well-known joke describes a May Day parade through Red Square with the usual mass of soldiers, guided missiles, rocket launchers. At last, come rank upon rank of people in grey business suits. A bystander asks, "Who are those?" "Aha!" comes the reply, "those are economists: you have no idea what damage they can do!" Their conversations do it.

Question 740

As used in the passage, which of the following is the closest alternative to the word 'arcane'?

- A Mysterious
- B Secret
- C Covert
- D Perfidious

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 741

In the light of the definition of rhetoric given in the passage, which of the following will have the least element of rhetoric?

- A An election speech
- B An advertisement jingle
- C Dialogues in a play
- D Commands given by army officers

cracku

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VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 742

According to the passage, which of the following is the best set of reasons for which one needs to 'look hard' at an economist's language?

- A. Economists accomplish a great deal through their language.
- B. Economics is an opinion-based subject.
- C. Economics has a great impact on other's lives.
- D. Economics is damaging.

- A A and B
- B C and D
- C A and C
- D B and D

cracku

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 743

As used in the passage, which of the following is the closest meaning to the statement 'The culture of the conversation makes the words arcane'?

- A Economists belong to a different culture.
- B Only mathematicians can understand economicists.
- C Economists tend to use terms unfamiliar to the lay person, but depend on familiar linguistic forms.
- D Economists use similes and adjectives in their analysis.

If translated into English, most of the ways economists talk among themselves would sound plausible enough to poets, journalists, businesspeople, and other thoughtful though non-economical folk. Like serious talk anywhere — among boat designers and baseball fans, say — the talk is hard to follow when one has not made a habit of listening to it for a while. The culture of the conversation makes the words arcane. But the people in the unfamiliar conversation are not Martians. Underneath it all (the economist's favourite phrase) conversational habits are similar. Economics uses mathematical models and statistical tests and market arguments, all of which look alien to the literary eye. But looked at closely, they are not so alien. They may be seen as figures of speech — metaphors, analogies, and appeals to authority.

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cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 744

Based on your understanding of the passage, which of the following conclusions would you agree with?

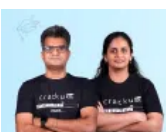
- A The geocentric and the heliocentric views of the solar system are equally tenable.
- B The heliocentric view is superior because of better rhetoric.
- C Both views use rhetoric to persuade.
- D Scientists should not use rhetoric.

If translated into English, most of the ways economists talk among themselves would sound plausible enough to poets, journalists, businesspeople, and other thoughtful though non-economical folk. Like serious talk anywhere — among boat designers and baseball fans, say — the talk is hard to follow when one has not made a habit of listening to it for a while. The culture of the conversation makes the words arcane. But the people in the unfamiliar conversation are not Martians. Underneath it all (the economist's favourite phrase) conversational habits are similar. Economics uses mathematical models and statistical tests and market arguments, all of which look alien to the literary eye. But looked at closely, they are not so alien. They may be seen as figures of speech — metaphors, analogies, and appeals to authority.

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cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Score Calculator



Instructions

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

[The] Indian government [has] announced an international competition to design a National War Memorial in New Delhi, to honour all of the Indian soldiers who served in the various wars and counterinsurgency campaigns from 1947 onwards. The terms of the competition also specified that the new structure would be built adjacent to the India Gate - a memorial to the Indian soldiers who died in the First World War. Between the old imperialist memorial and the proposed nationalist one, India's contribution to the Second World War is airbrushed out of existence.

The Indian government's conception of the war memorial was not merely absent-minded. Rather, it accurately reflected the fact that both academic history and popular memory have yet to come to terms with India's Second World War, which continues to be seen as little more than mood music in the drama of India's advance towards independence and partition in 1947. Further, the political trajectory of the postwar subcontinent has militated against popular remembrance of the war. With partition and the onset of the India-Pakistan rivalry, both of the new nations needed fresh stories for self-legitimation rather than focusing on shared wartime experiences.

The Indian army recruited, trained and deployed some 2.5 million men, almost 90,000 of which were killed and many more injured. Even at the time, it was recognised as the largest volunteer force in the war. . . . India's material and financial contribution to the war was equally significant. India emerged as a major military-industrial and logistical base for Allied operations in south-east Asia and the Middle East. This led the United States to take considerable interest in the country's future and ensured that this was no longer the preserve of the British government.

However, the Second World War played a crucial role in both the independence and partition of India and wartime developments pointed in the direction of India's independence. In a stunning reversal of its long-standing financial relationship with Britain, India finished the war as one of the largest creditors to the imperial power. Such extraordinary mobilization for war was achieved at a great human cost, with the Bengal famine the most extreme manifestation of widespread wartime deprivation. The costs on India's home front must be counted in millions of lives. Indians signed up to serve on the war and home fronts for a variety of reasons. . . . [M]any were convinced that their contribution would open the doors to India's freedom. . . . The political and social churn triggered by the war was evident in the massive waves of popular protest and unrest that washed over rural and urban India in the aftermath of the conflict. This turmoil was crucial in persuading the Attlee government to rid itself of the incubus of ruling India. . . .

Seventy years on, it is time that India engaged with the complex legacies of the Second World War. Bringing the war into the ambit of the new national memorial would be a fitting - if not overdue - recognition that this was India's War.

Question 745

The author suggests that a major reason why India has not so far acknowledged its role in the Second World War is that it:

- A** wants to forget the human and financial toll of the War on the country.
- B** has been focused on building an independent, non-colonial political identity.
- C** views the War as a predominantly Allied effort, with India playing only a supporting role.
- D** blames the War for leading to the momentous partition of the country.

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

[The] Indian government [has] announced an international competition to design a National War Memorial in New Delhi, to honour all of the Indian soldiers who served in the various wars and ~~Counterinsurgency~~ campaigns from 1947 onwards. The terms of the competition ~~has~~ specified that the new structure would be built adjacent to the India Gate - a memorial to the Indian soldiers who died in the First World War. Between the old imperialist memorial and the proposed nationalist one, India's contribution to the First World War is airbrushed out of existence.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 746

In the first paragraph, the author laments the fact that:

- A the new war memorial will be built right next to India Gate.
- B there is no recognition of the Indian soldiers who served in the Second World War.
- C India lost thousands of human lives during the Second World War.
- D funds will be wasted on another war memorial when we already have the India Gate memorial.

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

[The] Indian government [has] announced an international competition to design a National War Memorial in New Delhi, to honour all of the Indian soldiers who served in the various wars and ~~Counterinsurgency~~ campaigns from 1947 onwards. The terms of the competition ~~has~~ specified that the new structure would be built adjacent to the India Gate - a memorial to the Indian soldiers who died in the First World War. Between the old imperialist memorial and the proposed nationalist one, India's contribution to the First World War is airbrushed out of existence.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 747

The author claims that omitting mention of Indians who served in the Second World War from the new National War Memorial is:

- A is something which can be rectified in future by constructing a separate memorial.
- B a reflection of misplaced priorities of the post-independence Indian governments.
- C appropriate as their names can always be included in the India Gate memorial.
- D a reflection of the academic and popular view of India's role in the War.

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

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VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Crash Course

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Question 748

The phrase "mood music" is used in the second paragraph to indicate that the Second World War is viewed as:

- A setting the stage for the emergence of the India-Pakistan rivalry in the subcontinent.
- B a part of the narrative on the ill-effects of colonial rule on India.
- C a tragic period in terms of loss of lives and national wealth.
- D a backdrop to the subsequent independence and partition of the region.

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 749

The author lists all of the following as outcomes of the Second World War EXCEPT:

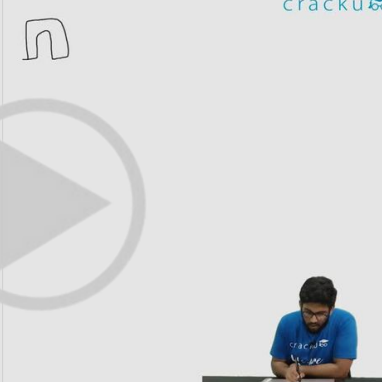
- A US recognition of India's strategic location and role in the War.
- B the large financial debt India owed to Britain after the War.
- C large-scale deaths in Bengal as a result of deprivation and famine.
- D independence of the subcontinent and its partition into two countries.

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow:

[The] Indian government [has] announced an international competition to design a National War Memorial in New Delhi, to honour all of the Indian soldiers who served in the various wars and Counterinsurgency campaigns from 1947 onwards. The terms of the competition specified that the new structure would be built adjacent to the India Gate - a memorial to the Indian soldiers who died in the First World War. Between the old imperialist memorial and the proposed nationalist one, India's contribution to the First World War is airbrushed out of existence.

The Indian government's conception of the war memorial is not merely absent-minded. Rather, it accurately reflected the fact that both academic history and popular memory have yet to come to terms with India's Second World War, which continues to be seen as little more than mood music in the drama of India's advance towards independence and partition in 1947. Further, the political history of the postwar subcontinent has militated against popular remembrance of the war. With partition and the onset of the Indo-Pakistan rivalry, both of the new nations needed fresh stories for self-legitimation rather than focusing on shared wartime experiences.

The Indian army recruited, trained and deployed some 2.5 million men, almost 90,000 of which were killed and many more injured. Even at the time, it was recognised as the largest volunteer force in the war. ... India's material and financial contribution to the war was equally significant. India emerged as a major military-industrial and



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given below:

The magic of squatter cities is that they are improved steadily and gradually by their residents. To a planner's eye, these cities look chaotic. I trained as a biologist and to my eye, they look organic. Squatter cities are also unexpectedly green. They have maximum density—1 million people per square mile in some areas of Mumbai—and have minimum energy and material use. People get around by foot, bicycle, rickshaw, or the universal shared taxi.

Not everything is efficient in the slums, though. In the Brazilian favelas where electricity is stolen and therefore free, people leave their lights on all day. But in most slums recycling is literally a way of life. The Dharavi slum in Mumbai has 400 recycling units and 30,000 ragpickers. Six thousand tons of rubbish are sorted every day. In 2007, the Economist reported that in Vietnam and Mozambique, "Waves of gleaners sift the sweepings of Hanoi's streets, just as Mozambiquan children pick over the rubbish of Maputo's main tip. Every city in Asia and Latin America has an industry based on gathering up old cardboard boxes." . . .

In his 1985 article, Architect Peter Calthorpe made a statement that still jars with most people: "The city is the most environmentally benign form of human settlement. Each city dweller consumes less land, less energy, less water, and produces less pollution than his counterpart in settlements of lower densities." "Green Manhattan" was the inflammatory title of a 2004 New Yorker article by David Owen. "By the most significant measures," he wrote, "New York is the greenest community in the United States and one of the greenest cities in the world . . . The key to New York's relative environmental benignity is its extreme compactness. . . . Placing one and a half million people on a twenty - three-square-mile island sharply reduces their opportunities to be wasteful." He went on to note that this very compactness forces people to live in the world's most energy-efficient apartment buildings. . . .

Urban density allows half of humanity to live on 2.8 per cent of the land. . . . Consider just the infrastructure efficiencies. According to a 2004 UN report: "The concentration of population and enterprises in urban areas greatly reduces the unit cost of piped water, sewers, drains, roads, electricity, garbage collection, transport, health care, and schools." . . .

[T]he nationally subsidised city of Manaus in northern Brazil "answers the question" of how to stop deforestation: give people decent jobs. Then they can afford houses, and gain security. One hundred thousand people who would otherwise be deforesting the jungle around Manaus are now prospering in town making such things as mobile phones and televisions. . . .

Of course, fast-growing cities are far from an unmitigated good. They concentrate crime, pollution, disease and injustice as much as business, innovation, education and entertainment. . . . But if they are overall a net good for those who move there, it is because cities offer more than just jobs. They are transformative: in the slums, as well as the office towers and leafy suburbs, the progress is from hick to metropolitan to cosmopolitan . . .

Question 750

According to the passage, squatter cities are environment-friendly for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

- A they recycle material.
- B their transportation is energy efficient.
- C their streets are kept clean.
- D they sort out garbage.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given below:

The magic of squatter cities is that they are improved steadily and gradually by their residents. To a planner's eye, these cities look chaotic. I trained as a biologist and naturally view them differently. Squatter cities are also unspectacularly green. They have maximum density—1 million people per square mile in some areas of Mumbai—and have minimum energy and material use. People get around by foot, bicycle, rickshaw, or the universal shared taxi.

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Planners (Ar) → (w/ confusion)
 Architects (Biologist) → Organic

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Question 751

From the passage it can be inferred that cities are good places to live in for all of the following reasons EXCEPT that they:

- A help prevent destruction of the environment.
- B contribute to the cultural transformation of residents.
- C offer employment opportunities.
- D have suburban areas as well as office areas.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given below:

The magic of squatter cities is that they are improved steadily and gradually by their residents. To a planner's eye, these cities look chaotic. I trained as a biologist and naturally view them differently. Squatter cities are also unspectacularly green. They have maximum density—1 million people per square mile in some areas of Mumbai—and have minimum energy and material use. People get around by foot, bicycle, rickshaw, or the universal shared taxi.

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Planners (Ar) → (w/ confusion)
 Architects (Biologist) → Organic

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 752

We can infer that Calthorpe's statement "still jars" with most people because most people:

- A do not consider cities to be eco-friendly places.
- B consider cities to be very crowded and polluted.
- C do not regard cities as good places to live in.
- D regard cities as places of disease and crime.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given below:

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Planners (Ar) (w/ confusion)

Ar. Bruce (Biologist) → Organic



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 753

In the context of the passage, the author refers to Manaus in order to:

- A explain how urban areas help the environment.
- B describe the infrastructure efficiencies of living in a city.
- C promote cities as employment hubs for people.
- D explain where cities source their labour for factories.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given below:

The magic of squatter cities is that they are improved steadily and gradually by their residents. To a planner's eye, these cities look chaotic. I trained as a biologist and to my eye, they look organic. Squatter cities are also unspectacularly green. They have maximum density—1 million people per square mile in some areas of Mumbai—and have minimum energy and material use. People get around by foot, bicycle, rickshaw, or the universal shared taxi.

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Planners (Ar) (w/ confusion)

Ar. Bruce (Biologist) → Organic



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Question 754

Which one of the following statements would undermine the author's stand regarding the greenness of cities?

- A** Sorting through rubbish contributes to the rapid spread of diseases in the slums.
- B** The high density of cities leads to an increase in carbon dioxide and global warming.
- C** The compactness of big cities in the West increases the incidence of violent crime.
- D** Over the last decade the cost of utilities has been increasing for city dwellers.

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given below:

The magic of squatter cities is that they are improved steadily and gradually by their residents. To a planner's eye, these cities look chaotic. Unplanned and unregulated they look ugly.

Planned cities are also unspectacularly green. They have maximum density - 1 million people per square mile in some areas of Mumbai - and maximum energy and material use. People get around by foot, bicycle, rickshaw, or the universal shared taxi.

Not everything is efficient in the slums, though. In the Brazil's favelas where electricity is stolen and therefore free, people leave a way of

their lights on all day. But in most slums recycling is literally a way of

life. The Dhuravi slum in Mumbai has 400 recycling units. In

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Planned cities (Ar) (w/ order confusion)

Archaic (Biologist) → Organic



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

For the Maya of the Classic period, who lived in Southern Mexico and Central America between 250 and 900 CE, the category of 'persons' was not coincident with human beings, as it is for us. That is, human beings were persons - but other, nonhuman entities could be persons, too. . . . In order to explore the slippage of categories between 'humans' and 'persons', I examined a very specific category of ancient Maya images, found painted in scenes on ceramic vessels. I sought out instances in which faces (some combination of eyes, nose, and mouth) are shown on inanimate objects. . . . Consider my iPhone, which needs to be fed with electricity every night, swaddled in a protective bumper, and enjoys communicating with other fellow-phone-beings. Does it have personhood (if at all) because it is connected to me, drawing this resource from me as an owner or source? For the Maya (who did have plenty of other communicating objects, if not smartphones), the answer was no. Nonhuman persons were not tethered to specific humans, and they did not derive their personhood from a connection with a human. . . . It's a profoundly democratising way of understanding the world. Humans are not more important persons - we are just one of many kinds of persons who inhabit this world. . . .

The Maya saw personhood as 'activated' by experiencing certain bodily needs and through participation in certain social activities. For example, among the faced objects that I examined, persons are marked by personal requirements (such as hunger, tiredness, physical closeness), and by community obligations (communication, interaction, ritual observance). In the images I examined, we see, for instance, faced objects being cradled in humans' arms; we also see them speaking to humans. These core elements of personhood are both turned inward, what the body or self of a person requires, and outward, what a community expects of the persons who are a part of it, underlining the reciprocal nature of community membership. .

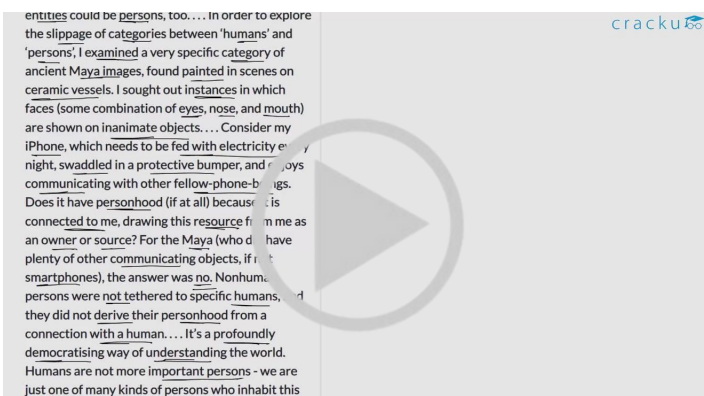
Personhood was a nonbinary proposition for the Maya. Entities were able to be persons while also being something else. The faced objects I looked at indicate that they continue to be functional, doing what objects do (a stone implement continues to chop, an incense burner continues to do its smoky work). Furthermore, the Maya visually depicted many objects in ways that indicated the material category to which they belonged - drawings of the stone implement show that a person-tool is still made of stone. One additional complexity: the incense burner (which would have been made of clay, and decorated with spiky appliques representing the sacred ceiba tree found in this region) is categorised as a person - but also as a tree. With these Maya

examples, we are challenged to discard the person/nonperson binary that constitutes our basic ontological outlook. . . . The porousness of boundaries that we have seen in the Maya world points towards the possibility of living with a certain uncategorisability of the world.

Question 755

On the basis of the passage, which one of the following worldviews can be inferred to be closest to that of the Classic Maya?

- A A tribe that perceives its hunting weapons as sacred person-artefacts because of their significance to its survival.
- B A tribe that perceives plants as person-plants because they form an ecosystem and are marked by needs of nutrition.
- C A futuristic society that perceives robots to be persons as well as robots because of their similarity to humans.
- D A tribe that perceives its utensils as person-utensils in light of their functionality and bodily needs.



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 756

Which one of the following, if true about the Classic Maya, would invalidate the purpose of the iPhone example in the passage?

- A The clay incense burner with spiky appliques was categorised only as a person and not as a tree by the Classic Maya.
- B Unlike modern societies equipped with mobile phones, the Classic Maya did not have any communicating objects.
- C Classic Maya songs represent both humans and non-living objects as characters, talking and interacting with each other.
- D The personhood of the incense burner and the stone chopper was a function of their usefulness to humans.

entities could be persons, too.... In order to explore the slippage of categories between 'humans' and 'persons', I examined a very specific category of ancient Maya images, found painted in scenes on ceramic vessels. I sought out instances in which faces (some combination of eyes, nose, and mouth) are shown on inanimate objects.... Consider my iPhone, which needs to be fed with electricity every night, swaddled in a protective bumper, and enjoys communicating with other fellow-phone-beings. Does it have personhood (if at all) because it is connected to me, drawing this resource from me as an owner or source? For the Maya (who did have plenty of other communicating objects, if not smartphones), the answer was no. Nonhuman persons were not tethered to specific humans, and they did not derive their personhood from a connection with a human.... It's a profoundly democratising way of understanding the world. Humans are not more important persons - we are just one of many kinds of persons who inhabit this

cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 757

Which one of the following best explains the "additional complexity" that the example of the incense burner illustrates regarding personhood for the Classic Maya?

- A The example adds a new layer to the nonbinary understanding of personhood by bringing in a third category that shares a similar relation with the previous two.
- B The example provides an exception to the nonbinary understanding of personhood that the passage had hitherto established.
- C The example adds a new layer to the nonbinary understanding of personhood by bringing in a third category that shares a dissimilar relation with the previous two.
- D The example complicates the nonbinary understanding of personhood by bringing in the sacred, establishing the porosity of the divine and the profane.

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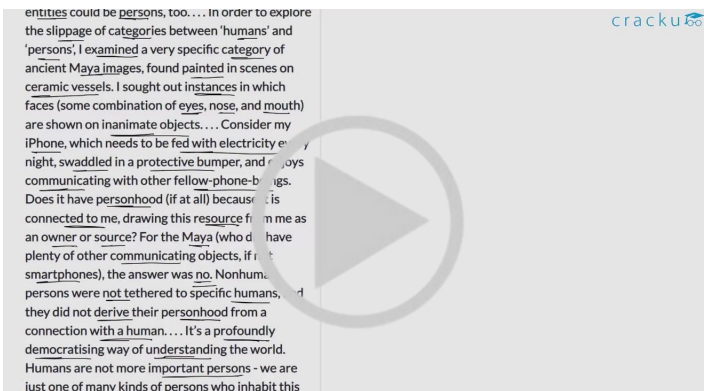
cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 758

Which one of the following, if true, would not undermine the democratising potential of the Classic Maya worldview?

- A They believed that animals like cats and dogs that live in proximity to humans have a more clearly articulated personhood.
- B While they believed in the personhood of objects and plants, they did not believe in the personhood of rivers and animals.
- C They understood the stone implement and the incense burner in a purely human form.
- D They depicted their human healers with physical attributes of local medicinal plants.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The sleights of hand that conflate consumption with virtue are a central theme in *A Thirst for Empire*, a sweeping and richly detailed history of tea by the historian Erika Rappaport. How did tea evolve from an obscure "China drink" to a universal beverage imbued with civilising properties? The answer, in brief, revolves around this conflation, not only by profit-motivated marketers but by a wide variety of interest groups. While abundant historical records have allowed the study of how tea itself moved from east to west, Rappaport is focused on the movement of the idea of tea to suit particular purposes.

Beginning in the 1700s, the temperance movement advocated for tea as a pleasure that cheered but did not inebriate, and industrialists soon borrowed this moral argument in advancing their case for free trade in tea (and hence more open markets for their textiles). Factory owners joined in, compelled by the cause of a sober workforce, while Christian missionaries discovered that tea "would soothe any colonial encounter". During the Second World War, tea service was presented as a social and patriotic activity that uplifted soldiers and calmed refugees.

But it was tea's consumer-directed marketing by importers and retailers - and later by brands - that most closely portends current trade debates. An early version of the "farm to table" movement was sparked by anti-Chinese sentiment and concerns over trade deficits, as well as by the reality and threat of adulterated tea containing dirt and hedge clippings. Lipton was soon advertising "from the Garden to Tea Cup" supply chains originating in British India and supervised by "educated Englishmen". While tea marketing always presented direct consumer benefits (health, energy, relaxation), tea drinkers were also assured that they were participating in a larger noble project that advanced the causes of family, nation and civilization. . . .

Rappaport's treatment of her subject is refreshingly apolitical. Indeed, it is a virtue that readers will be unable to guess her political orientation: both the miracle of markets and capitalism's dark underbelly are evident in tea's complex story, as are the complicated effects of British colonialism. . . . Commodity histories are now themselves commodities: recent works investigate cotton, salt, cod, sugar, chocolate, paper and milk. And morality marketing is now a commodity as well, applied to food, "fair trade" apparel and eco-tourism. Yet tea

is, Rappaport makes clear, a world apart - an astonishing success story in which tea marketers not only succeeded in conveying a sense of moral elevation to the consumer but also arguably did advance the cause of civilisation and community.

I have been offered tea at a British garden party, a Bedouin campfire, a Turkish carpet shop and a Japanese chashitsu, to name a few settings. In each case the offering was more an idea - friendship, community, respect - than a drink, and in each case the idea then created a reality. It is not a stretch to say that tea marketers have advanced the particularly noble cause of human dialogue and friendship.

Question 759

This book review argues that, according to Rappaport, tea is unlike other “morality” products because it:

- A had an actual beneficial effect on social interaction and society in general.
- B was actively encouraged by interest groups in the government.
- C was marketed by a wide range of interest groups.
- D appealed to a universal group and not just to a niche section of people.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The sleights of hand that conflate consumption with virtue are a central theme in *A Thirst for Empire*, a sweeping and richly detailed history of tea by the historian Erika Rappaport. How did tea evolve from an obscure “China drink” to a universal beverage imbued with civilising properties? The answer, in brief, revolves around this conflation, not only by profit-motivated marketers but by a wide variety of interest groups. While abundant historical records have allowed the study of how tea itself moved from east to west, Rappaport focused on the movement of the idea of tea to suit particular purposes.

Beginning in the 1700s, the temperance movement advocated for tea as a pleasure that cheered but did not inebriate, and industrialists soon borrowed this

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Question 760

The author of this book review is LEAST likely to support the view that:

- A tea drinking has become a social ritual worldwide.
- B the ritual of drinking tea promotes congeniality and camaraderie.
- C tea became the leading drink in Britain in the nineteenth century.
- D tea drinking was sometimes promoted as a patriotic duty.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The sleights of hand that conflate consumption with virtue are a central theme in *A Thirst for Empire*, a sweeping and richly detailed history of tea by the historian Erika Rappaport. How did tea evolve from an obscure "China drink" to a universal beverage imbued with civilising properties? The answer, in brief, revolves around this conflation, not only by profit-motivated marketers but by a wide variety of interest groups. While abundant historical records have allowed the study of how tea itself moved from east to west, Rappaport focused on the movement of the idea of tea to suit particular purposes.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 761

Today, "conflat[ing] consumption with virtue" can be seen in the marketing of:

- A sustainably farmed foods.
- B natural health supplements.
- C travel to pristine destinations.
- D ergonomically designed products.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The sleights of hand that conflate consumption with virtue are a central theme in *A Thirst for Empire*, a sweeping and richly detailed history of tea by the historian Erika Rappaport. How did tea evolve from an obscure "China drink" to a universal beverage imbued with civilising properties? The answer, in brief, revolves around this conflation, not only by profit-motivated marketers but by a wide variety of interest groups. While abundant historical records have allowed the study of how tea itself moved from east to west, Rappaport focused on the movement of the idea of tea to suit particular purposes.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 762

According to this book review, *A Thirst for Empire* says that, in addition to "profitmotivated marketers", tea drinking was promoted in Britain by all of the following EXCEPT:

- A manufacturers who were pressing for duty-free imports.
- B tea drinkers lobbying for product diversity.
- C the anti-alcohol lobby as a substitute for the consumption of liquor.
- D factories to instill sobriety in their labour.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The sleights of hand that conflate consumption with virtue are a central theme in *A Thirst for Empire*, a sweeping and richly detailed history of tea by the historian Erika Rappaport. How did a beverage imbued with civilising properties evolve from an obscure "China drink" to a universal beverage imbued with civilising properties? The answer, in brief, revolves around this condition, not only by profit-motivated marketers but by a wide variety of interest groups. While abundant historical records have allowed the study of tea to move from east to west, Rappaport focused on the movement of the idea of tea to suit particular purposes.

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VIDEO SOLUTION



Instructions

In the modern scientific story, light was created not once but twice. The first time was in the Big Bang, when the universe began its existence as a glowing, expanding, fireball, which cooled off into darkness after a few million years. The second time was hundreds of millions of years later, when the cold material condensed into dense nuggets under the influence of gravity, and ignited to become the first stars.

Sir Martin Rees, Britain's astronomer royal, named the long interval between these two enlightenments the cosmic 'Dark Age'. The name describes not only the poorly lit conditions, but also the ignorance of astronomers about that period. Nobody knows exactly when the first stars formed, or how they organized themselves into galaxies — or even whether stars were the first luminous objects. They may have been preceded by quasars, which are mysterious, bright spots found at the centres of some galaxies.

Now two independent groups of astronomers, one led by Robert Becker of the University of California, Davis, and the other by George Djorgovski of the Caltech, claim to have peered far enough into space with their telescopes (and therefore backwards enough in time) to observe the closing days of the Dark age.

The main problem that plagued previous efforts to study the Dark Age was not the lack of suitable telescopes, but rather the lack of suitable things at which to point them. Because these events took place over 13 billion years ago, if astronomers are to have any hope of unravelling them they must study objects that are at least 13 billion light years away. The best prospects are quasars, because they are so bright and compact that they can be seen across vast stretches of space. The energy source that powers a quasar is unknown, although it is suspected to be the intense gravity of a giant black hole. However, at the distances required for the study of Dark Age, even quasars are extremely rare and faint.

Recently some members of Dr Becker's team announced their discovery of the four most distant quasars known. All the new quasars are terribly faint, a challenge that both teams overcame by peering at them through one of the twin Keck telescopes in Hawaii. These are the world's largest, and can therefore collect the most light. The new work by Dr Becker's team analysed the light from all four quasars. Three of them appeared to be similar to ordinary, less distant quasars. However, the fourth and most distant, unlike any other quasar ever seen, showed unmistakable signs of being shrouded in a fog because new-born stars and quasars emit mainly ultraviolet light, and hydrogen gas is opaque to ultraviolet. Seeing this fog had been the goal of would-be Dark Age astronomers since 1965, when James Gunn and Bruce Peterson spelled out the technique for using quasars as backlighting beacons to observe the fog's ultraviolet shadow.

The fog prolonged the period of darkness until the heat from the first stars and quasars had the chance to ionise the hydrogen (breaking it into its constituent parts, protons and electrons). Ionised hydrogen is transparent to ultraviolet radiation, so at that moment the fog lifted and the universe became the well-lit place it is today. For this reason, the end of the Dark Age is called the 'Epoch of Re-ionisation'. Because the ultraviolet

shadow is visible only in the most distant of the four quasars, Dr Becker's team concluded that the fog had dissipated completely by the time the universe was about 900 million years old, and oneseventh of its current size.

Question 763

The four most distant quasars discovered recently

- A could only be seen with the help of large telescopes.
- B appear to be similar to other ordinary, quasars.
- C appear to be shrouded in a fog of hydrogen gas.
- D have been sought to be discovered by Dark Age astronomers since 1965.

cracku

after a few million years. The second time was hundreds of millions of years later, when the cold material condensed into dense nuggets under the influence of gravity, and ignited to become the first stars.

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Now two independent groups of astronomers, one led by Robert Becker of the University of California, Davis, and the other by George Djorgovski of the Caltech, claim to have peered far enough into space

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 764

Astronomers find it difficult to study the Dark Age because

- A suitable telescopes are few.
- B the associated events took place aeons ago.
- C the energy source that powers a quasars is unknown.
- D their best chance is to study quasars, which are faint objects to begin with.

cracku

after a few million years. The second time was hundreds of millions of years later, when the cold material condensed into dense nuggets under the influence of gravity, and ignited to become the first stars.

Sir Martin Rees, Britain's astronomer royal, named the long interval between these two enlightenings the cosmic 'Dark Age'. The name describes not only the poorly lit conditions, but also the ignorance of astronomers about that period. Nobody knows exactly when the first stars formed, or how they organized themselves into galaxies – or even whether stars were the first luminous objects. They may have been preceded by quasars, which are mysterious, bright spots found at the centres of some galaxies.

Now two independent groups of astronomers, one led by Robert Becker of the University of California, Davis, and the other by George Djorgovski of the Caltech, claim to have peered far enough into space

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 765

The fog of hydrogen gas seen through the telescopes

- A is transparent to hydrogen radiation from stars and quasars in all states.
- B was lifted after heat from stars and quasars ionised it.
- C is the material which eventually became stars and quasars.
- D is broken into constituent elements when stars and quasars are formed.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 766

In the passage, the Dark Age refers to

- A the period when the universe became cold after the Big Bang.
- B a period about which astronomers know very little.
- C the medieval period when cultural activity seemed to have come to an end.
- D the time that the universe took to heat up after the Big Bang.

after a few million years. The second time was hundreds of millions of years later, when the cold material condensed into dense nuggets under the influence of gravity, and ignited to become the first stars.

Sir Martin Rees, Britain's astronomer royal, named the long interval between these two enlightenings the cosmic 'Dark Age'. The name describes not only the poorly lit conditions, but also the ignorance of astronomers about that period. Nobody knows exactly when the first stars formed, or how they organized themselves into galaxies — or even whether stars were the first luminous objects. They may have been preceded by quasars, which are mysterious, bright spots found at the centres of some galaxies.

Now two independent groups of astronomers, one led by Robert Becker of the University of California, Davis, and the other by George Djorgovski of the Caltech, claim to have peered far enough into space



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The current debate on intellectual property rights (IPRs) raises a number of important issues concerning the strategy and policies for building a more dynamic national agricultural research system, the relative roles of public and private sectors, and the role of agribusiness multinational corporations (MNCs). This debate has been stimulated by the international agreement on Trade Related Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPs), negotiated as part of the Uruguay Round. TRIPs, for the first time, seeks to bring innovations in agricultural technology under a new worldwide IPR regime. The agribusiness MNCs (along with pharmaceutical companies) played a leading part in lobbying for such a regime during the Uruguay Round negotiations. The argument was that incentives are necessary to stimulate innovations, and that this calls for a system of patents which gives innovators the sole right to use (or sell/lease the right to use) their innovations for a specified period and protects them against unauthorised copying or use. With strong support of their national governments, they were influential in shaping the agreement on TRIPs, which eventually emerged from the Uruguay Round.

The current debate on TRIPs in India - as indeed elsewhere - echoes wider concerns about 'privatisation' of research and allowing a free field for MNCs in the sphere of biotechnology and agriculture. The agribusiness corporations, and those with unbounded faith in the power of science to overcome all likely problems, point to the vast potential that new technology holds for solving the problems of hunger, malnutrition and poverty in the world. The exploitation of this potential should be encouraged and this is best done by the private sector for which patents are essential. Some, who do not necessarily accept this optimism, argue that fears of MNC domination are exaggerated and that farmers will accept their products only if they decisively outperform the available alternatives. Those who argue against agreeing to introduce an IPR regime in agriculture and encouraging private sector research are apprehensive that this will work to the disadvantage of farmers by making them more and more dependent on monopolistic MNCs. A different, though related apprehension is that extensive use of hybrids and genetically engineered new varieties might increase the vulnerability of agriculture to outbreaks of pests and diseases. The larger, longer-term consequences of reduced biodiversity that may follow from the use of specially bred varieties are also another cause for concern. Moreover, corporations, driven by the profit motive, will necessarily tend to underplay, if not ignore, potential adverse consequences, especially those which are unknown and which may manifest themselves only over a relatively long period. On the other hand, high-pressure advertising and aggressive sales campaigns by private companies can seduce farmers into accepting varieties without being aware of potential adverse effects and the possibility of disastrous consequences for their livelihood if these varieties happen to fail. There is no provision under the laws, as they now exist, for compensating users against such eventualities.

Excessive preoccupation with seeds and seed material has obscured other important issues involved in reviewing the research policy. We need to remind ourselves that improved varieties by themselves are not sufficient for sustained growth of yields. In our own experience, some of the early high yielding varieties (HYVs) of rice and wheat were found susceptible to widespread pest attacks; and some had problems of grain quality. Further research was necessary to solve these problems. This largely successful research was almost entirely done in public research institutions. Of course, it could in principle have been done by private companies, but whether they choose to do so depends crucially on the extent of the loss in market for their original introductions on account of the above factors and whether the companies are financially strong enough to absorb the 'losses', invest in research to correct the deficiencies and recover the lost market. Public research, which is not driven by profit, is better placed to take corrective action. Research for improving common pool resource management, maintaining ecological health and ensuring sustainability is both critical and also demanding in terms of technological challenge and resource requirements. As such research is crucial to the impact of new varieties, chemicals and equipment in the farmer's field, private companies should be interested in such research. But their primary interest is in the sale of seed materials, chemicals, equipment and other inputs produced by them. Knowledge and techniques for resource management are not 'marketable' in the same way as those inputs. Their application to land, water and forests has a long gestation and their efficacy depends on resolving difficult problems such as designing institutions for proper and equitable management of common pool resources. Public or quasi-public research institutions informed by broader, long-term concerns can only do such work.

The public sector must therefore continue to play a major role in the national research system. It is both wrong and misleading to pose the problem in terms of public sector versus private sector or of privatisation of

research. We need to address problems likely to arise on account of the public-private sector complementarity, and ensure that the public research system performs efficiently. Complementarity between various elements of research raises several issues in implementing an IPR regime. Private companies do not produce new varieties and inputs entirely as a result of their own research. Almost all technological improvement is based on knowledge and experience accumulated from the past, and the results of basic and applied research in public and quasi-public institutions (universities, research organisations). Moreover, as is increasingly recognised, accumulated stock of knowledge does not reside only in the scientific community and its academic publications, but is also widely diffused in traditions and folk knowledge of local communities all over.

The deciphering of the structure and functioning of DNA forms the basis of much of modern biotechnology. But this fundamental breakthrough is a 'public good' freely accessible in the public domain and usable free of any charge. Various techniques developed using that knowledge can however be, and are, patented for private profit. Similarly, private corporations draw extensively, and without any charge, on germplasm available in varieties of plants species (neem and turmeric are by now famous examples). Publicly funded gene banks as well as new varieties bred by public sector research stations can also be used freely by private enterprises for developing their own varieties and seek patent protection for them. Should private breeders be allowed free use of basic scientific discoveries? Should the repositories of traditional knowledge and germplasm be collected which are maintained and improved by publicly funded organisations? Or should users be made to pay for such use? If they are to pay, what should be the basis of compensation? Should the compensation be for individuals or (or communities/institutions to which they belong? Should individual institutions be given the right of patenting their innovations? These are some of the important issues that deserve more attention than they now get and need serious detailed study to evolve reasonably satisfactory, fair and workable solutions. Finally, the tendency to equate the public sector with the government is wrong. The public space is much wider than government departments and includes co-operatives, universities, public trusts and a variety of non-governmental organisations (NGOs). Giving greater autonomy to research organisations from government control and giving non-government public institutions the space and resources to play a larger, more effective role in research, is therefore an issue of direct relevance in restructuring the public research system.

Question 767

The TRIPs agreement emerged from the Uruguay Round to:

- A address the problem of adverse consequences of genetically engineered new varieties of grain.
- B fulfil the WTO requirement to have an agreement, on trade related property rights.
- C provide incentives to innovators by way of protecting their intellectual property.
- D give credibility to the innovations made by MNCs in the field of pharmaceuticals and agriculture.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 768

Which of the following statements is not a likely consequence of emerging technologies in agriculture?

- A Development of newer and newer varieties will lead to increase in biodiversity.
- B MNCs may underplay the negative consequences of the newer technology on environment.
- C Newer varieties of seeds may increase vulnerability of crops to pests and diseases.
- D Reform in patent laws and user compensation against crop failures would be needed to address new technology problems.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions



Question 769

The fundamental breakthrough in deciphering the structure and functioning of DNA has become a public good. This means that:

- A breakthroughs in fundamental research on DNA are accessible by all without any monetary considerations.
- B the fundamental research on DNA has the characteristic of having beneficial effects for the public at large.
- C due to the large scale of fundamental research on DNA, it falls in the domain of public sector research institutions.
- D the public and other companies must have free access to such fundamental breakthroughs in research.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 770

Which one of the following statements describes an important issue, or important issues, not being raised in the context of the current debate on IPRs?

- A The role of MNCs in the sphere of biotechnology and agriculture.
- B The strategy and policies for establishing an IPR regime for Indian agriculture.
- C The relative roles of public and private sectors.
- D Wider concerns about 'privatisation' of research.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 771

In debating the respective roles of the public and private sectors in the national research system, it is important to recognise:

- A that private companies do not produce new varieties and inputs entirely on their own research.
- B that almost all technological improvements are based on knowledge and experience accumulated from the past.
- C the complementary role of public- and private-sector research.
- D that knowledge repositories are primarily the scientific community and its academic publications.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



Question 772

Which one of the following may provide incentives to address the problem of potential adverse consequences of biotechnology?

- A Include IPR issues in the TRIPs agreement.
- B Nationalise MNCs engaged in private research in biotechnology.
- C Encourage domestic firms to patent their innovations.
- D Make provisions in the law for user compensation against failure of newly developed varieties.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 773

Public or quasi-public research institutions are more likely than private companies to address the negative consequences of new technologies, because of which of the following reasons?

- A Public research is not driven by profit motive.
- B Private companies may not be able to absorb losses arising out of the negative effects of the new technologies.
- C Unlike new technology products, knowledge and techniques for resource management are not amenable to simple market transactions.
- D All of the above.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 774

While developing a strategy and policies for building a more dynamic national agricultural research system, which one of the following statements needs to be considered?

- A Public and quasi-public institutions are not interested in making profits.
- B Public and quasi-public institutions have a broader and long-term outlook than private companies.
- C Private companies are incapable of building products based on traditional and folk knowledge.
- D Traditional and folk knowledge cannot be protected by patents.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of three questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Typewriters are the epitome of a technology that has been comprehensively rendered obsolete by the digital age. The ink comes off the ribbon, they weigh a ton, and second thoughts are a disaster. But they are also personal, portable and, above all, private. Type a document and lock it away and more or less the only way anyone else can get it is if you give it to them. That is why the Russians have decided to go back to typewriters in some government offices, and why in the US, some departments have never abandoned them. Yet it is not just their resistance to algorithms and secret surveillance that keeps typewriter production lines — well one, at

least — in business (the last British one closed a year ago). Nor is it only the nostalgic appeal of the metal body and the stout well-defined keys that make them popular on eBay. A typewriter demands something particular: attentiveness. By the time the paper is loaded, the ribbon tightened, the carriage returned, the spacing and the margins set, there's a big premium on hitting the right key. That means sorting out ideas, pulling together a kind of order and organising details before actually striking off. There can be no thinking on screen with a typewriter. Nor are there any easy distractions. No online shopping. No urgent emails. No Twitter. No need even for electricity — perfect for writing in a remote hideaway. The thinking process is accompanied by the encouraging clack of keys, and the ratchet of the carriage return. Ping!

Question 775

Which one of the following best describes what the passage is trying to do?

- A It describes why people continue to use typewriters even in the digital age.
- B It argues that typewriters will continue to be used even though they are an obsolete technology.
- C It highlights the personal benefits of using typewriters.
- D It shows that computers offer fewer options than typewriters.



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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 776

The writer praises typewriters for all the following reasons EXCEPT

- A Unlike computers, they can only be used for typing.
- B You cannot revise what you have typed on a typewriter.
- C Typewriters are noisier than computers.
- D Typewriters are messier to use than computers.

 VIEW SOLUTION

Question 777

According to the passage, some governments still use typewriters because:

- A they do not want to abandon old technologies that may be useful in the future.
- B they want to ensure that typewriter production lines remain in business.
- C they like the nostalgic appeal of typewriter.

- D they can control who reads the document.

 VIEW SOLUTION



Instructions

Comprehension:

War, natural disasters and climate change are destroying some of the world's most precious cultural sites. Google is trying to help preserve these archaeological wonders by allowing users access to 3D images of these treasures through its site. But the project is raising questions about Google's motivations and about who should own the digital copyrights. Some critics call it a form of "digital colonialism." When it comes to archaeological treasures, the losses have been mounting. ISIS blew up parts of the ancient city of Palmyra in Syria and an earthquake hit Bagan, an ancient city in Myanmar, damaging dozens of temples, in 2016. In the past, all archaeologists and historians had for restoration and research were photos, drawings, remnants and intuition. But that's changing. Before the earthquake at Bagan, many of the temples on the site were scanned. . . . [These] scans . . . are on Google's Arts & Culture site. The digital renditions allow viewers to virtually wander the halls of the temple, look up-close at paintings and turn the building over, to look up at its chambers. . . . [Google Arts & Culture] works with museums and other nonprofits . . . to put high-quality images online. The images of the temples in Bagan are part of a collaboration with CyArk, a nonprofit that creates the 3D scanning of historic sites. . . . Google . . . says [it] doesn't make money off this website, but it fits in with Google's mission to make the world's information available and useful.

Critics say the collaboration could be an attempt by a large corporation to wrap itself in the sheen of culture. Ethan Watrall, an archaeologist, professor at Michigan State University and a member of the Society for American Archaeology, says he's not comfortable with the arrangement between CyArk and Google. . . . Watrall says this project is just a way for Google to promote Google. "They want to make this material accessible so people will browse it and be filled with wonder by it," he says. "But at its core, it's all about advertisements and driving traffic." Watrall says these images belong on the site of a museum or educational institution, where there is serious scholarship and a very different mission. . . . [There's] another issue for some archaeologists and art historians. CyArk owns the copyrights of the scans — not the countries where these sites are located. That means the countries need CyArk's permission to use these images for commercial purposes.

Erin Thompson, a professor of art crime at John Jay College of Criminal Justice in New York City, says it's the latest example of a Western nation appropriating a foreign culture, a centuries-long battle. . . . CyArk says it copyrights the scans so no one can use them in an inappropriate way. The company says it works closely with authorities during the process, even training local people to help. But critics like Thompson are not persuaded. . . . She would prefer the scans to be owned by the countries and people where these sites are located.

Question 778

In Dr. Thompson's view, CyArk owning the copyright of its digital scans of archaeological sites is akin to:

- A tourists uploading photos of monuments onto social media.
- B the seizing of ancient Egyptian artefacts by a Western museum.
- C the illegal downloading of content from the internet.
- D digital platforms capturing users' data for market research.

cracku  934

Comprehension:

War, natural disasters and climate change are destroying some of the world's most precious cultural sites. Google is trying to help preserve these archaeological wonders by allowing users access to 3D images of these treasures through its site. But the project is raising questions about Google's motivations and about who should own the digital copyrights. Some critics call it a form of "digital colonialism". When it comes to archaeological treasures, the losses have been mounting. ISIS blew up parts of the ancient city of Palmyra in Syria and earthquake hit Bagan, an ancient city in Myanmar, damaging dozens of temples. In 2016, in the past, all archaeologists and historians had for restoration and research were photos, drawings, renderings and intuition. But that's changing. Before the earthquake at Bagan, many of the temples on the site were scanned. ... [These] scans ... are on Google Arts & Culture site. The digital reproductions allow viewers to virtually wander the halls of the temple, look up-close at paintings and turn the building over to look up at its chambers. ... [Google Arts & Culture] works with governments and other nonprofits ... to put high-quality images online. The images of the temples in Bagan are part of a collaboration with CyArk, a nonprofit that creates the 3D scanning of historic sites. ... Google ... says [it] doesn't make money off this website, but it fits in with Google's mission to make the world's information available and useful.

Critics say the collaboration could be an attempt by a large



 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 779

Based on his views mentioned in the passage, one could best characterise Dr. Watrall as being:

- A uneasy about the marketing of archaeological images for commercial use by firms such as Google and CyArk.
- B dismissive of laypeople's access to specialist images of archaeological and cultural sites.
- C critical about the links between a non-profit and a commercial tech platform for distributing archaeological images.
- D opposed to the use of digital technology in archaeological and cultural sites in developing countries.

cracku  934

Comprehension:

War, natural disasters and climate change are destroying some of the world's most precious cultural sites. Google is trying to help preserve these archaeological wonders by allowing users access to 3D images of these treasures through its site. But the project is raising questions about Google's motivations and about who should own the digital copyrights. Some critics call it a form of "digital colonialism". When it comes to archaeological treasures, the losses have been mounting. ISIS blew up parts of the ancient city of Palmyra in Syria and earthquake hit Bagan, an ancient city in Myanmar, damaging dozens of temples. In 2016, in the past, all archaeologists and historians had for restoration and research were photos, drawings, renderings and intuition. But that's changing. Before the earthquake at Bagan, many of the temples on the site were scanned. ... [These] scans ... are on Google Arts & Culture site. The digital reproductions allow viewers to virtually wander the halls of the temple, look up-close at paintings and turn the building over to look up at its chambers. ... [Google Arts & Culture] works with governments and other nonprofits ... to put high-quality images online. The images of the temples in Bagan are part of a collaboration with CyArk, a nonprofit that creates the 3D scanning of historic sites. ... Google ... says [it] doesn't make money off this website, but it fits in with Google's mission to make the world's information available and useful.

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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 780

Which of the following, if true, would most strongly invalidate Dr. Watrall's objections?

- A Google takes down advertisements on its website hosting CyArk's scanned images.
- B There is a ban on CyArk scanning archaeological sites located in other countries.
- C CyArk uploads its scanned images of archaeological sites onto museum websites only.
- D CyArk does not own the copyright on scanned images of archaeological sites.

cracku  Q.54

Comprehension:

War, natural disasters and climate change are destroying some of the world's most precious cultural sites. Google is trying to help preserve these archaeological wonders by allowing users access to 3D images of these treasures through its site. But the project is raising questions about Google's motivations and about who should own the digital copyrights. Some critics call it a form of "digital colonialism". When it comes to archaeological treasures, the losers have been mountaintops. In 2015, a massive earthquake in Syria destroyed some of the ancient city of Palmyra. In 2016, an earthquake in Myanmar damaged some of the temples in Bagan, an ancient city in Myanmar. In the past, all archaeologists and historians had for restoration and research were photos, drawings, renderings and intuition. But that's changing. Before the earthquake at Bagan, many of the temples on the site were scanned. ... (These) scans ... are on Google Arts & Culture site. The digital reproductions allow viewers to virtually wander the halls of the temple, look up-close at paintings and turn the building over to look up at its chambers. ... (Google Arts & Culture) works with governments and other nonprofits ... to put high-quality images online. The images of the temples in Bagan are part of a collaboration with CyArk, a nonprofit that creates the 3D scanning of historic sites. ... Google ... says it doesn't make money off this website, but it fits in with Google's mission to make the world's information available and useful.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

cracku 

 **CAT WhatsApp Group** 

Question 781

Of the following arguments, which one is LEAST likely to be used by the companies that digitally scan cultural sites?

- A It helps preserve precious images in case the sites are damaged or destroyed.
- B It enables people who cannot physically visit these sites to experience them.
- C It provides images free of cost to all users.
- D It allows a large corporation to project itself as a protector of culture.

cracku  Q.54

Comprehension:

War, natural disasters and climate change are destroying some of the world's most precious cultural sites. Google is trying to help preserve these archaeological wonders by allowing users access to 3D images of these treasures through its site. But the project is raising questions about Google's motivations and about who should own the digital copyrights. Some critics call it a form of "digital colonialism". When it comes to archaeological treasures, the losers have been mountaintops. In 2015, a massive earthquake in Syria destroyed some of the ancient city of Palmyra. In 2016, an earthquake in Myanmar damaged some of the temples in Bagan, an ancient city in Myanmar. In the past, all archaeologists and historians had for restoration and research were photos, drawings, renderings and intuition. But that's changing. Before the earthquake at Bagan, many of the temples on the site were scanned. ... (These) scans ... are on Google Arts & Culture site. The digital reproductions allow viewers to virtually wander the halls of the temple, look up-close at paintings and turn the building over to look up at its chambers. ... (Google Arts & Culture) works with governments and other nonprofits ... to put high-quality images online. The images of the temples in Bagan are part of a collaboration with CyArk, a nonprofit that creates the 3D scanning of historic sites. ... Google ... says it doesn't make money off this website, but it fits in with Google's mission to make the world's information available and useful.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 782

By "digital colonialism", critics of the CyArk-Google project are referring to the fact that:

- A the scanning process can damage delicate frescos and statues at the sites.
- B CyArk and Google have not shared the details of digitisation with the host countries.
- C countries where the scanned sites are located do not own the scan copyrights.

D CyArk and Google have been scanning images without copyright permission from host countries.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

In a low-carbon world, renewable energy technologies are hot business. For investors looking to redirect funds, wind turbines and solar panels, among other technologies, seem a straightforward choice. But renewables need to be further scrutinized before being championed as forging a path toward a low-carbon future. Both the direct and indirect impacts of renewable energy must be examined to ensure that a climate-smart future does not intensify social and environmental harm. As renewable energy production requires land, water, and labor, among other inputs, it imposes costs on people and the environment. Hydropower projects, for instance, have led to community dispossession and exclusion . . . Renewable energy supply chains are also intertwined with mining, and their technologies contribute to growing levels of electronic waste . Furthermore, although renewable energy can be produced and distributed through small-scale, local systems, such an approach might not generate the high returns on investment needed to attract capital.

Although an emerging sector, renewables are enmeshed in long-standing resource extraction through their dependence on minerals and metals . . . Scholars document the negative consequences of mining . . . even for mining operations that commit to socially responsible practices[.] “many of the world’s largest reservoirs of minerals like cobalt, copper, lithium, [and] rare earth minerals”—the ones needed for renewable technologies —“are found in fragile states and under communities of marginalized peoples in Africa, Asia, and Latin America.” Since the demand for metals and minerals will increase substantially in a renewable-powered future . . . this intensification could exacerbate the existing consequences of extractive activities.

Among the connections between climate change and waste, O’Neill . . . highlights that “devices developed to reduce our carbon footprint, such as lithium batteries for hybrid and electric cars or solar panels[,] become potentially dangerous electronic waste at the end of their productive life.” The disposal of toxic waste has long perpetuated social injustice through the flows of waste to the Global South and to marginalized communities in the Global North . . .

While renewable energy is a more recent addition to financial portfolios, investments in the sector must be considered in light of our understanding of capital accumulation. As agricultural finance reveals, the concentration of control of corporate activity facilitates profit generation. For some climate activists, the promise of renewables rests on their ability not only to reduce emissions but also to provide distributed, democratized access to energy . . . But Burke and Stephens . . . caution that “renewable energy systems offer a possibility but not a certainty for more democratic energy futures.” Small-scale, distributed forms of energy are only highly profitable to institutional investors if control is consolidated somewhere in the financial chain. Renewable energy can be produced at the household or neighborhood level. However, such small-scale, localized production is unlikely to generate high returns for investors. For financial growth to be sustained and expanded by the renewable sector, production and trade in renewable energy technologies will need to be highly concentrated, and large asset management firms will likely drive those developments.

Question 783

Which one of the following statements best captures the main argument of the last paragraph of the passage?

- A The development of the renewable energy sector is a double-edged sword.
- B Renewable energy systems are not democratic unless they are corporate-controlled.
- C Renewable energy produced at the household or neighbourhood level is more efficient than mass-produced forms of energy.
- D Most forms of renewable energy are not profitable investments for institutional investors.

on people and the environment. (Hydropower projects, for instance, have led to community dispossession and exclusion. . . . Renewable energy supply chains are also intertwined with mining, and their technologies contribute to growing levels of electronic waste. Furthermore, although renewable energy can be produced and distributed through small-scale, local systems, such an approach might not generate the high returns on investment needed to attract capital.)

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cracku

VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Mock Test

Mocks designed exactly like the actual CAT



cracku

Question 784

Based on the passage, we can infer that the author would be most supportive of which one of the following practices?

- A More stringent global policies and regulations to ensure a more just system of toxic waste disposal.
- B The study of the coexistence of marginalised people with their environments.
- C Encouragement for the development of more environment-friendly carbon-based fuels.
- D The localised, small-scale development of renewable energy systems.

on people and the environment. (Hydropower projects, for instance, have led to community dispossession and exclusion. . . . Renewable energy supply chains are also intertwined with mining, and their technologies contribute to growing levels of electronic waste. Furthermore, although renewable energy can be produced and distributed through small-scale, local systems, such an approach might not generate the high returns on investment needed to attract capital.)

Although an emerging sector, renewables are enmeshed in longstanding resource extraction through their dependence on minerals and metals. . . . Scholars document the negative consequences of mining . . . even for mining operations that commit to socially responsible practices[.] "many of the world's largest reservoirs of minerals like cobalt, copper, lithium, [and] rare earth minerals"—the ones needed for renewable technologies—are found in fragile states and under communities of marginalized peoples in Africa, Asia, and Latin America." Since the demand for minerals and metals will increase substantially in a renewable-powered future . . . this intensification could exacerbate the existing consequences of extractive activities.

Among the connections between climate change and waste, O'Neill . . . highlights that "devices developed to reduce our carbon footprint, such as lithium batteries for hybrid and electric cars or solar panels[,] become potentially dangerous electronic waste at the end of their productive life." The disposal of toxic waste has long perpetuated social injustice through the flows of waste to the Global South and to marginalized communities in the Global North.

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Question 785

Which one of the following statements, if true, could be an accurate inference from the first paragraph of the passage?

- A The author has reservations about the consequences of renewable energy systems
- B The author has reservations about the consequences of non-renewable energy systems.
- C The author does not think renewable energy systems can be as efficient as non-renewable energy systems.
- D The author's only reservation is about the profitability of renewable energy systems.

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Question 786

Which one of the following statements, if false, could be seen as best supporting the arguments in the passage?

- A Renewable energy systems are as expensive as non-renewable energy systems.
- B Renewable energy systems have little or no environmental impact.
- C Renewable energy systems are not as profitable as non-renewable energy systems.
- D The production and distribution of renewable energy through small-scale, local systems is not economically sustainable.

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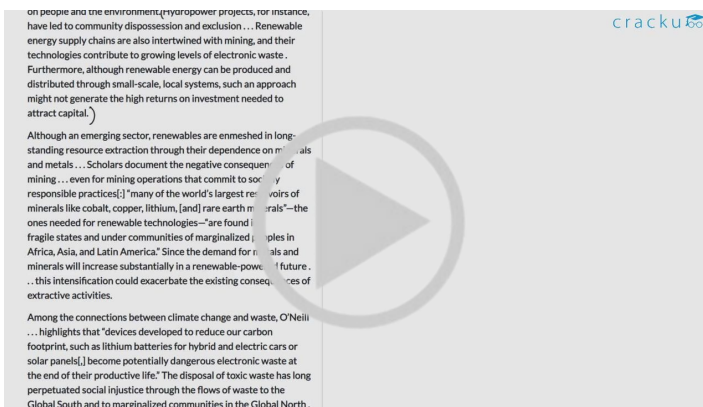
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Question 787

All of the following statements, if true, could be seen as supporting the arguments in the passage, EXCEPT:

- A The example of agricultural finance helps us to see how to concentrate corporate activity in the renewable energy sector.
- B One reason for the perpetuation of social injustice lies in the problem of the disposal of toxic waste.
- C Marginalised people in Africa, Asia and Latin America have often been the main sufferers of corporate mineral extraction projects
- D The possible negative impacts of renewable energy need to be studied before it can be offered as a financial investment opportunity.



Instructions

The Union Government's present position vis-a-vis the upcoming United Nations conference on racial and related discrimination worldwide seems to be the following: discuss race please, not caste; caste is our very own and not at all as bad as you think. The gross hypocrisy of that position has been lucidly underscored by Kancha Ilaiah. Explicitly, the world community is to be cheated out of considering the matter on the technicality that caste is not, as a concept, tantamount to a racial category. Internally, however, allowing the issue to be put on agenda at the said conference would, we are patriotically admonished, damage the country's image. Somehow, India's virtual beliefs elbow out concrete actualities. Inverted representations, as we know, have often been deployed in human histories as balm for the forsaken — religion being the most persistent of such inversions. Yet, we would humbly submit that if globalising our markets is thought as good for the 'national' pocket, globalising our social inequities might not be so bad for the mass of our people. After all, racism was as uniquely institutionalised in South Africa as caste discrimination has been within our society; why then can't we permit the world community to express itself on the latter with a fraction of the zeal with which, through the years, we pronounced on the former?

As to the technicality about whether or not caste is admissible into an agenda about race (that the conference is also about 'related discriminations' tends to be forgotten), a reputed sociologist has recently argued that where race is a 'biological' category caste is a 'social' one. Having earlier fiercely opposed implementation of the Mandal Commission Report, the said sociologist is at least to be complemented now for admitting,

however tangentially, that caste discrimination is a reality, although, in his view, incompatible with racial discrimination. One would like quickly to offer the hypothesis that biology, in important ways that affect the lives of many millions, is in itself perhaps a social construction. But let us look at the matter in another way.

If it is agreed — as per the position today at which anthropological and allied scientific determinations rest — that the entire race of homo sapiens derived from an originary black African female (called 'Eve'), then one is hard put to understand how, on some subsequent ground, ontological distinctions are to be drawn either between races or castes. Let us also underline the distinction between the supposition that we are all god's children and the rather more substantiated argument about our descent from 'Eve', lest both positions are thought to be equally diversionary. It then stands to reason that all subsequent distinctions are, in modern parlance, 'constructed' ones, and like all ideological constructions, attributable to changing equations between knowledge and power among human communities through contested histories here, there, and elsewhere.

This line of thought receives, thankfully, extremely consequential buttress from the findings of the Human Genome Project. Contrary to earlier (chiefly 19th-century colonial) persuasions on the subject of race, as well as, one might add, the somewhat infamous Jensen offerings in the 20th century from America, those finding deny genetic difference between 'races'. If anything, they suggest that environmental factors impinge on gene-function, as a dialectic seems to unfold between nature and culture. It would thus seem that 'biology' as the constitution of pigmentation enters the picture first only as a part of that dialectic. Taken together, the originary mother stipulation and the Genome findings ought indeed to furnish ground for human equality across the board, as well as yield policy initiatives towards equitable material dispensations aimed at building a global order where, in Hegel's stirring formulation, only the rational constitutes the right. Such, sadly, is not the case as everyday fresh arbitrary grounds for discrimination are constructed in the interests of sectional dominance.

Question 788

An important message in the passage, if one accepts a dialectic between nature and culture, is that

- A the results of the Human Genome Project reinforces racial differences.
- B race is at least partially a social construct.
- C discrimination is at least partially a social construct.
- D caste is at least partially a social construct.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 789

When the author writes 'globalising our social inequities', the reference is to

- A going beyond an internal deliberation on social inequity.
- B dealing with internal poverty through the economic benefits of globalisation.
- C going beyond an internal delimitation of social inequity.
- D achieving disadvantaged people's empowerment, globally.

The Union Government's present position vis-a-vis the upcoming United Nations conference on racial and related discrimination worldwide seems to be the following: discuss race please, not caste! caste is our very own and not at all as bad as you think. The gross hypocrisy of that position has been lucidly underscored by Kancha Ilaiah. Explicitly, the world community is to be cheated out of considering the matter on the technicality that caste is not a concept, tantamount to a racial category. Internally, however, allowing the issue to be put on a pedestal at the said conference would, we are patriotically admonished, damage the country's image. Somehow, India's virtual beliefs elbow out concrete actualities. Inverted representations, as we know, have often been deployed in human histories as balm for the forsaken — religion being the most persistent of such inversions. Yet, we would humbly submit that if globalising our markets is thought as good for the 'national' pocket, globalising our social

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Question 790

According to the author, the sociologist who argued that race is a 'biological' category and caste is a 'social' one,

- A generally shares the same orientation as the author's on many of the central issues discussed.
- B tangentially admits to the existence of caste discrimination.
- C admits the incompatibility between the people of different race and caste.
- D admits indirectly that both caste-based prejudice and racial discrimination exist.

The Union Government's present position vis-a-vis the upcoming United Nations conference on racial and related discrimination worldwide seems to be the following: discuss race please, not caste! caste is our very own and not at all as bad as you think. The gross hypocrisy of that position has been lucidly underscored by Kancha Ilaiah. Explicitly, the world community is to be cheated out of considering the matter on the technicality that caste is not a concept, tantamount to a racial category. Internally, however, allowing the issue to be put on a pedestal at the said conference would, we are patriotically admonished, damage the country's image. Somehow, India's virtual beliefs elbow out concrete actualities. Inverted representations, as we know, have often been deployed in human histories as balm for the forsaken — religion being the most persistent of such inversions. Yet, we would humbly submit that if globalising our markets is thought as good for the 'national' pocket, globalising our social

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Question 791

According to the author, 'inverted representations as balm for the forsaken'

- A is good for the forsaken and often deployed in human histories.
- B is good for the forsaken, but not often deployed historically for the oppressed.
- C occurs often as a means of keeping people oppressed.

D occurs often to invert the status quo.

The Union Government's present position vis-a-vis the upcoming United Nations conference on racial and related discrimination worldwide seems to be the following: discuss face please, not caste; caste is our very own and not at all as bad as you think. The gross hypocrisy of that position has been lucidly underscored by Kancha Ilaiah. Explicitly, the world community is to be cheated out of considering the matter on the technicality that caste is not a concept, tantamount to a racial category. Internally, however, allowing the issue to be put on agenda at the said conference would, we are patriotically admonished, damage the country's image. Somehow, India's virtual beliefs elbow out concrete actualities. Inverted representations, as we know, have often been deployed in human histories as balm for the forsaken — religion being the most persistent of such inversions. Yet, we would humbly submit that if globalising our markets is thought as good for the 'national' pocket, globalising our social

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Question 792

Based on the passage, which broad areas unambiguously fall under the purview of the UN conference being discussed?

- A. Racial prejudice
- B. Racial pride
- C. Discrimination, racial or otherwise
- D. Caste-related discrimination
- E. Race-related discrimination

- A A and E
- B C and E
- C A, C and E
- D B, C and D

The Union Government's present position vis-a-vis the upcoming United Nations conference on racial and related discrimination worldwide seems to be the following: discuss face please, not caste; caste is our very own and not at all as bad as you think. The gross hypocrisy of that position has been lucidly underscored by Kancha Ilaiah. Explicitly, the world community is to be cheated out of considering the matter on the technicality that caste is not a concept, tantamount to a racial category. Internally, however, allowing the issue to be put on agenda at the said conference would, we are patriotically admonished, damage the country's image. Somehow, India's virtual beliefs elbow out concrete actualities. Inverted representations, as we know, have often been deployed in human histories as balm for the forsaken — religion being the most persistent of such inversions. Yet, we would humbly submit that if globalising our markets is thought as good for the 'national' pocket, globalising our social

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Instructions

Comprehension:

For two years, I tracked down dozens of . . . Chinese in Upper Egypt [who were] selling lingerie. In a deeply conservative region, where Egyptian families rarely allow women to work or own businesses, the Chinese flourished because of their status as outsiders. They didn't gossip, and they kept their opinions to themselves. In a New Yorker article entitled "Learning to Speak Lingerie," I described the Chinese use of Arabic as another non-threatening characteristic. I wrote, "Unlike Mandarin, Arabic is inflected for gender, and Chinese dealers, who learn the language strictly by ear, often pick up speech patterns from female customers. I've come to think of it as the lingerie dialect, and there's something disarming about these Chinese men speaking in the feminine voice." . . .

When I wrote about the Chinese in the New Yorker, most readers seemed to appreciate the unusual perspective. But as I often find with topics that involve the Middle East, some people had trouble getting past the black-and-white quality of a byline. "This piece is so orientalist I don't know what to do," Aisha Gani, a reporter who worked at The Guardian, tweeted. Another colleague at the British paper, Iman Amrani, agreed: "I wouldn't have minded an article on the subject written by an Egyptian woman—probably would have had better insight." . . .

As an MOL (man of language), I also take issue with this kind of essentialism. Empathy and understanding are not inherited traits, and they are not strictly tied to gender and race. An individual who wrestles with a difficult language can learn to be more sympathetic to outsiders and open to different experiences of the world. This learning process—the embarrassments, the frustrations, the gradual sense of understanding and connection—is invariably transformative. In Upper Egypt, the Chinese experience of struggling to learn Arabic and local culture had made them much more thoughtful. In the same way, I was interested in their lives not because of some kind of voyeurism, but because I had also experienced Egypt and Arabic as an outsider. And both the Chinese and the Egyptians welcomed me because I spoke their languages. My identity as a white male was far less important than my ability to communicate.

And that easily lobbed word—"Orientalist"—hardly captures the complexity of our interactions. What exactly is the dynamic when a man from Missouri observes a Zhejiang native selling lingerie to an Upper Egyptian woman? . . . If all of us now stand beside the same river, speaking in ways we all understand, who's looking east and who's looking west? Which way is Oriental?

For all of our current interest in identity politics, there's no corresponding sense of identity linguistics. You are what you speak—the words that run throughout your mind are at least as fundamental to your selfhood as is your ethnicity or your gender. And sometimes it's healthy to consider human characteristics that are not inborn, rigid, and outwardly defined. After all, you can always learn another language and change who you are.

Question 793

The author's critics would argue that:

- A Language is insufficient to bridge cultural barriers.
- B Empathy can overcome identity politics.
- C Linguistic politics can be erased.
- D Orientalism cannot be practiced by Egyptians.

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Comprehension:

For two years, I tracked down dozens of ... Chinese in Upper Egypt [who were] selling lingerie. In a deeply conservative region, where Egyptian families rarely allow women to work or own businesses, the Chinese flourished because of their status as outsiders. They didn't gossip, and they kept their opinions to themselves. In a New Yorker article entitled "Learning to Speak Lingerie," I described the Chinese use of Arabic as another non-threatening characteristic. I wrote, "Unlike Mandarin, Arabic is inflected for gender, and Chinese dealers, who learn the language strictly by ear, often pick up speech patterns from female customers. I've come to think of it as the lingerie dialect, and there's something disarming about these Chinese men speaking in a feminine voice." ...

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Question 794

A French ethnographer decides to study the culture of a Nigerian tribe. Which of the following is most likely to be the view of the author of the passage?

- A The author would discourage the ethnographer from conducting the study as Nigerian ethnographers can better understand the tribe.
- B The author would encourage the ethnographer, but ask him/her to first learn the language of the Nigerian tribe s/he wishes to study.
- C The author would encourage the ethnographer, but ask him/her to be mindful of his/her racial and gender identity in the process.
- D The author would encourage the ethnographer and recommend him/her to hire a good translator for the purpose of holding interviews.

cracku

Comprehension:

For two years, I tracked down dozens of ... Chinese in Upper Egypt [who were] selling lingerie. In a deeply conservative region, where Egyptian families rarely allow women to work or own businesses, the Chinese flourished because of their status as outsiders. They didn't gossip, and they kept their opinions to themselves. In a New Yorker article entitled "Learning to Speak Lingerie," I described the Chinese use of Arabic as another non-threatening characteristic. I wrote, "Unlike Mandarin, Arabic is inflected for gender, and Chinese dealers, who learn the language strictly by ear, often pick up speech patterns from female customers. I've come to think of it as the lingerie dialect, and there's something disarming about these Chinese men speaking in a feminine voice." ...

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 795

Which of the following can be inferred from the author's claim, "Which way is Oriental?"

- A Globalisation has mitigated cultural hierarchies and barriers.
- B Orientalism is a discourse of the past, from colonial times, rarely visible today.
- C Goodwill alone mitigates cultural hierarchies and barriers.

D Learning another language can mitigate cultural hierarchies and barriers.

cracku

Comprehension:

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Question 796

According to the passage, which of the following is not responsible for language's ability to change us?

- A The ups and downs involved in the course of learning a language.
- B Language's ability to mediate the impact of identity markers one is born with.
- C The twists and turns in the evolution of language over time.
- D Language's intrinsic connection to our notions of self and identity.

cracku

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

We cannot travel outside our neighbourhood without passports. We must wear the same plain clothes. We must exchange our houses every ten years. We cannot avoid labour. We all go to bed at the same time... We have religious freedom, but we cannot deny that the soul dies with the body, since 'but for the fear of punishment, they would have nothing but contempt for the laws and customs of society'.... In More's time, for much of the population, given the plenty and security on offer, such restraints would not have seemed overly

unreasonable. For modern readers, however, Utopia appears to rely upon relentless transparency, the repression of variety, and the curtailment of privacy. Utopia provides security: but at what price? In both its external and internal relations, indeed, it seems perilously dystopian.

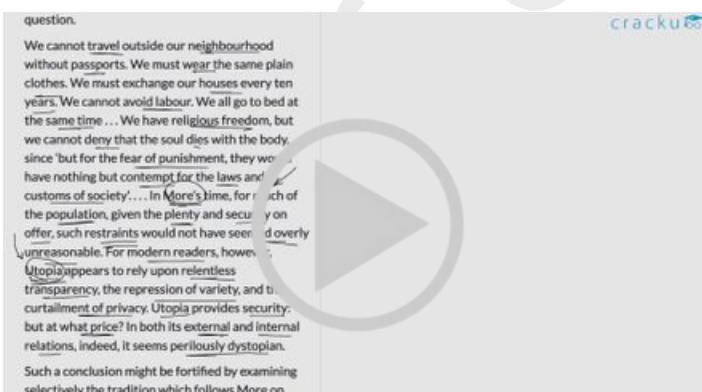
Such a conclusion might be fortified by examining selectively the tradition which follows More on these points. This often portrays societies where . . . 'it would be almost impossible for man to be depraved, or wicked'. . . . This is achieved both through institutions and mores, which underpin the common life. . . . The passions are regulated and inequalities of wealth and distinction are minimized. Needs, vanity, and emulation are restrained, often by prizing equality and holding riches in contempt. The desire for public power is curbed. Marriage and sexual intercourse are often controlled: in Tommaso Campanella's *The City of the Sun* (1623), the first great literary utopia after More's, relations are forbidden to men before the age of twenty-one and women before nineteen. Communal child-rearing is normal; for Campanella, this commences at age two. Greater simplicity of life, 'living according to nature', is often a result: the desire for simplicity and purity are closely related. People become more alike in appearance, opinion, and outlook than they often have been. Unity, order, and homogeneity thus prevail at the cost of individuality and diversity. This model, as J. C. Davis demonstrates, dominated early modern utopianism. . . . And utopian homogeneity remains a familiar theme well into the twentieth century.

Given these considerations, it is not unreasonable to take as our starting point here the hypothesis that utopia and dystopia evidently share more in common than is often supposed. Indeed, they might be twins, the progeny of the same parents. Insofar as this proves to be the case, my linkage of both here will be uncomfortably close for some readers. Yet we should not mistake this argument for the assertion that all utopias are, or tend to produce, dystopias. Those who defend this proposition will find that their association here is not nearly close enough. For we have only to acknowledge the existence of thousands of successful intentional communities in which a cooperative ethos predominates and where harmony without coercion is the rule to set aside such an assertion. Here the individual's submersion in the group is consensual (though this concept is not unproblematic). It results not in enslavement but voluntary submission to group norms. Harmony is achieved without . . . harming others.

Question 797

All of the following statements can be inferred from the passage EXCEPT that:

- A utopian and dystopian societies are twins, the progeny of the same parents.
- B it is possible to see utopias as dystopias, with a change in perspective, because one person's utopia could be seen as another's dystopia.
- C many conceptions of utopian societies emphasise the importance of social uniformity and cultural homogeneity.
- D utopian societies exist in a long tradition of literature dealing with imaginary people practicing imaginary customs, in imaginary worlds.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 798

Following from the passage, which one of the following may be seen as a characteristic of a utopian society?

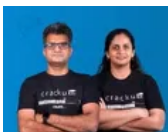
- A A society without any laws to restrain one's individuality.
- B A society where public power is earned through merit rather than through privilege.
- C Institutional surveillance of every individual to ensure his/her security and welfare.
- D The regulation of homogeneity through promoting competitive heterogeneity.

question.

We cannot travel outside our neighbourhood without passports. We must wear the same plain clothes. We must exchange our houses every ten years. We cannot avoid labour. We all go to bed at the same time ... We have religious freedom, but we cannot deny that the soul dies with the body, since 'but for the fear of punishment, they would have nothing but contempt for the laws and customs of society' ... In More's time, for much of the population, given the plenty and security on offer, such restraints would not have seemed overly unreasonable. For modern readers, however, Utopia appears to rely upon relentless transparency, the repression of variety, and the curtailment of privacy. Utopia provides security, but at what price? In both its external and internal relations, indeed, it seems perilously dystopian. Such a conclusion might be fortified by examining selectively the tradition which follows More on

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Question 799

Which sequence of words below best captures the narrative of the passage?

- A Utopia - Security - Homogeneity - Intentional community.
- B Relentless transparency - Homogeneity - Utopia - Dystopia.
- C Utopia - Security - Dystopia - Coercion.
- D Curtailment of privacy - Dystopia - Utopia - Intentional community.

question.

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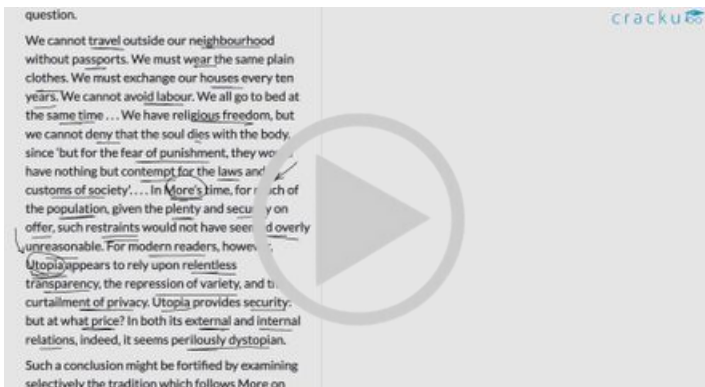
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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 800

All of the following arguments are made in the passage EXCEPT that:

- A in More's time, there was plenty and security, so people did not need restraints that could appear unreasonable.
- B there have been thousands of communities where homogeneity and stability have been achieved through choice, rather than by force.
- C the tradition of utopian literature has often shown societies in which it would be nearly impossible for anyone to be sinful or criminal.
- D in early modern utopianism, the stability of utopian societies was seen to be achieved only with individuals surrendering their sense of self.



VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Languages become endangered and die out for many reasons. Sadly, the physical annihilation of communities of native speakers of a language is all too often the cause of language extinction. In North America, European colonists brought death and destruction to many Native American communities. This was followed by US federal policies restricting the use of indigenous languages, including the removal of native children from their communities to federal boarding schools where native languages and cultural practices were prohibited. As many as 75 percent of the languages spoken in the territories that became the United States have gone extinct, with slightly better language survival rates in Central and South America ...

Even without physical annihilation and prohibitions against language use, the language of the "dominant" cultures may drive other languages into extinction; young people see education, jobs, culture and technology associated with the dominant language and focus their attention on that language. The largest language "killers" are English, Spanish, Portuguese, French, Russian, Hindi, and Chinese, all of which have privileged status as dominant languages threatening minority languages.

When we lose a language, we lose the worldview, culture and knowledge of the people who spoke it, constituting a loss to all humanity. People around the world live in direct contact with their native environment, their habitat. When the language they speak goes extinct, the rest of humanity loses their knowledge of that environment, their wisdom about the relationship between local plants and illness, their philosophical and religious beliefs, as well as their native cultural expression (in music, visual art and poetry) that has enriched both the speakers of that language and others who would have encountered that culture ...

As educators deeply immersed in the liberal arts, we believe that educating students broadly in all facets of language and culture ... yields immense rewards. Some individuals educated in the liberal arts tradition will pursue advanced study in linguistics and become actively engaged in language preservation, setting out for the

Amazon, for example, with video recording equipment to interview the last surviving elders in a community to record and document a language spoken by no children.

Certainly, though, the vast majority of students will not pursue this kind of activity. For these students, a liberal arts education is absolutely critical from the twin perspectives of language extinction and global citizenship. When students study languages other than their own, they are sensitized to the existence of different cultural perspectives and practices. With such an education, students are more likely to be able to articulate insights into their own cultural biases, be more empathetic to individuals of other cultures, communicate successfully across linguistic and cultural differences, consider and resolve questions in a way that reflects multiple cultural perspectives, and, ultimately extend support to people, programs, practices, and policies that support the preservation of endangered languages.

There is ample evidence that such preservation can work in languages spiraling toward extinction. For example, Navajo, Cree, and Inuit communities have established schools in which these languages are the language of instruction, and the number of speakers of each has increased.

Question 801

Which one of the following hypothetical scenarios, if true, would most strongly undermine the central ideas of the passage?

- A Most liberal arts students will pursue jobs in publishing and human resource management rather than doctorates in linguistics.
- B A liberal arts education requires that, in addition to being fluent in English, students gain fluency in two of the top five most spoken languages globally.
- C Schools that teach endangered languages can preserve the language only for a generation.
- D Recording a dying language that has only a few remaining speakers freezes it in time: it stops evolving further.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Languages become endangered and die out for many reasons. Sadly, the physical annihilation of communities of native speakers of a language is all too often the cause of language extinction. In North America, European colonists brought death and destruction to many Native American communities. This was followed by US federal policies restricting the use of indigenous languages, including the removal of native children from their communities to federal boarding schools where native languages and cultural practices were prohibited. As many as 75 percent of the languages spoken in the territories that became the United States have gone extinct, with slightly better language survival rates in Central and South America.

Even without physical annihilation and prohibitions against language use, the language of the "dominant" cultures may drive other languages into extinction; young people see education, jobs, culture and technology associated with the dominant language and focus their attention on that language. The largest language "killers" are English, Spanish, Portuguese, French, Russian, Hindi, and Chinese, all of which have privileged status as dominant languages threatening

→ Languages endangered/die out



VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



Question 802

In the context of the passage, which one of the following hypothetical scenarios, if true, is NOT an example of the kind of loss that occurs when a language becomes extinct?

- A The Nicobarese language describes 20 different moods of the ocean. By the time the last speaker is educated in a Central Board school, they will have forgotten their language.

- B** The Lamkangs of Manipur have only 3 remaining native speakers of the language. When they die, we will lose one more group from the government list of indigenous tribes.
- C** The Andamanese language has a word to describe someone who has lost a step-sister. When the language dies, we will lose the concept of the word and the emotions it evokes.
- D** The Inuits of Alaska have 35 different words to describe the texture of snow. When the language becomes extinct, we will lose that understanding of nature.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Languages become endangered and die out for many reasons. Sadly, the physical annihilation of communities of native speakers of a language is all too often the cause of language extinction. In North America, European colonists brought death and destruction to many Native American communities. This was followed by US federal policies restricting the use of indigenous languages, including the removal of native children from their communities to federal boarding schools where native languages and cultural practices were prohibited. As many as 75 percent of the languages spoken in the territories that became the United States have gone extinct, with slightly better language survival rates in Central and South America.

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→ Languages endangered/die out



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 803

It can be inferred from the passage that it is likely South America had a slightly better language survival rate than North America for all of the following reasons EXCEPT:

- A** European colonists allowed children of native speakers to stay at home with their families.
- B** the colonial government was unable to mainstream the locals.
- C** not many native speakers were killed by European colonists.
- D** locals were provided job opportunities in the colonial administration.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Languages become endangered and die out for many reasons. Sadly, the physical annihilation of communities of native speakers of a language is all too often the cause of language extinction. In North America, European colonists brought death and destruction to many Native American communities. This was followed by US federal policies restricting the use of indigenous languages, including the removal of native children from their communities to federal boarding schools where native languages and cultural practices were prohibited. As many as 75 percent of the languages spoken in the territories that became the United States have gone extinct, with slightly better language survival rates in Central and South America.

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→ Languages endangered/die out



VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 804

The author believes that a liberal arts education combined with participation in language preservation empower students in all of the following ways EXCEPT that they will

- A overcome cultural barriers to communication.
- B learn different languages.
- C establish schools to preserve languages spiralling towards extinction.
- D develop a better understanding of their own culture.

The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

→ Languages endangered/die out

→

Languages become endangered and die out for many reasons. Sadly, the physical annihilation of communities of native speakers of a language is all too often the cause of language extinction. In North America, European colonists brought death and destruction to many Native American communities. This was followed by US federal policies restricting the use of indigenous languages, including the removal of native children from their communities to federal boarding schools where native languages and cultural practices were prohibited. As many as 75 percent of the languages spoken in the territories that became the United States have gone extinct, with slightly better language survival rates in Central and South America.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

 **CAT Score Calculator** 

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Few realise that the government of China, governing an empire of some 60 million people during the Tang dynasty (618-907), implemented a complex financial system that recognised grain, coins and textiles as money. . . . Coins did have certain advantages: they were durable, recognisable and provided a convenient medium of exchange, especially for smaller transactions. However, there were also disadvantages. A continuing shortage of copper meant that government mints could not produce enough coins for the entire empire, to the extent that for most of the dynasty's history, coins constituted only a tenth of the money supply. One of the main objections to calls for taxes to be paid in coin was that peasant producers who could weave cloth or grow grain - the other two major currencies of the Tang - would not be able to produce coins, and therefore would not be able to pay their taxes. . . .

As coins had advantages and disadvantages, so too did textiles. If in circulation for a long period of time, they could show signs of wear and tear. Stained, faded and torn bolts of textiles had less value than a brand new bolt. Furthermore, a full bolt had a particular value. If consumers cut textiles into smaller pieces to buy or sell something worth less than a full bolt, that, too, greatly lessened the value of the textiles. Unlike coins, textiles could not be used for small transactions; as [an official] noted, textiles could not "be exchanged by the foot and the inch" . . .

But textiles had some advantages over coins. For a start, textile production was widespread and there were fewer problems with the supply of textiles. For large transactions, textiles weighed less than their equivalent in coins since a string of coins . . . could weigh as much as 4 kg. Furthermore, the dimensions of a bolt of silk held remarkably steady from the third to the tenth century: 56 cm wide and 12 m long . . . The values of different textiles were also more stable than the fluctuating values of coins. . . .

The government also required the use of textiles for large transactions. Coins, on the other hand, were better suited for smaller transactions, and possibly, given the costs of transporting coins, for a more local usage. Grain, because it rotted easily, was not used nearly as much as coins and textiles, but taxpayers were required

to pay grain to the government as a share of their annual tax obligations, and official salaries were expressed in weights of grain. . . .

In actuality, our own currency system today has some similarities even as it is changing in front of our eyes. . . . We have cash - coins for small transactions like paying for parking at a meter, and banknotes for other items; cheques and debit/credit cards for other, often larger, types of payments. At the same time, we are shifting to electronic banking and making payments online. Some young people never use cash [and] do not know how to write a cheque . . .

Question 805

According to the passage, the modern currency system shares all the following features with that of the Tang, EXCEPT that:

- A it uses different materials as currency.
- B it uses different currencies for different situations.
- C its currencies fluctuate in value over time.
- D it is undergoing transformation.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Few realise that the government of China, governing an empire of some 60 million people during the Tang dynasty (618-907), implemented a complex financial system that recognised grain, coins and textiles as money. Coins did have certain advantages: they were durable, recognisable and provided a convenient medium of exchange, especially for smaller transactions. However, there were also disadvantages. A continuing shortage of copper meant that government mints could not produce enough coins for the entire empire, to the extent that for most of the dynasty's history, coins constituted only a tenth of the money supply. On the one hand, objections to calls for taxes to be paid in coin was that peasants and producers who could weave cloth or grow grain - the two major currencies of the Tang - would not be able to produce coins, and therefore would not be able to pay their taxes. . . .

As coins had advantages and disadvantages, so too did textiles. If in circulation for a long period of time, they could show signs of wear and tear. Stained, faded and torn bolts of textiles had less value than a brand new bolt. Furthermore, a full bolt had a particular value. If consumers cut textiles into smaller pieces to buy or sell something worth less than a full bolt, that, too, greatly lessened the value of the textiles. Unlike coins, textiles could not be used for small transactions; as [an official] noted, textiles could not "be exchanged by the foot and the inch" . . .

currency during the Tang dynasty

adv
grain / coin → durable, recognisable
convenient medium of exchange → smaller transactions

disadv
→ shortage of copper
→ 1/10th of the money supply
→ weavers cloth / grow grains }

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 806

During the Tang period, which one of the following would not be an economically sound decision for a small purchase in the local market that is worth one-eighth of a bolt of cloth?

- A Making the payment with the appropriate weight of grain.
- B Paying with a faded bolt of cloth that has approximately the same value.
- C Using coins issued by the government to make the payment.
- D Cutting one-eighth of the fabric from a new bolt to pay the amount.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Few realise that the government of China, governing an empire of some 60 million people during the Tang dynasty (618-907), implemented a complex financial system that recognised grain, coins and textiles as money. Coins did have certain advantages: they were durable, recognisable and provided a convenient medium of exchange, especially for smaller transactions. However, they were also disadvantages. A continuing shortage of copper meant that government mints could not produce enough coins for the entire empire, to the extent that for most of the dynasty's history, coins constituted only a tenth of the money supply. One of the main objections to calls for taxes to be paid in coin was that peasant producers who could weave cloth or grow grain – the other two major currencies of the Tang – would not be able to produce coins, and therefore would not be able to pay their taxes.

As coins had advantages and disadvantages, so too did textiles. If in circulation for a long period of time, they could show signs of wear and tear. Stained, faded and torn bolts of textiles had less value than a brand new bolt. Furthermore, a full bolt had a particular value. If consumers cut textiles into smaller pieces to buy or sell something worth less than a full bolt, that, too, greatly lessened the value of the textiles. Unlike coins, textiles could not be used for small transactions; as [an official] noted, textiles could not "be exchanged by the foot and the inch"...

Handwritten notes on the right side of the passage:

currency during the Tang dynasty

grain / coin / textile → adv → durable, recognisable, convenient medium of exchange → smaller transactions

disadv → shortage of copper. 1/10th of the money supply.

→ weavers cloth / grow grains

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 807

When discussing textiles as currency in the Tang period, the author uses the words "steady" and "stable" to indicate all of the following EXCEPT:

- A reliable transportation.
- B reliable quality.
- C reliable measurements.
- D reliable supply.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Few realise that the government of China, governing an empire of some 60 million people during the Tang dynasty (618-907), implemented a complex financial system that recognised grain, coins and textiles as money. Coins did have certain advantages: they were durable, recognisable and provided a convenient medium of exchange, especially for smaller transactions. However, they were also disadvantages. A continuing shortage of copper meant that government mints could not produce enough coins for the entire empire, to the extent that for most of the dynasty's history, coins constituted only a tenth of the money supply. One of the main objections to calls for taxes to be paid in coin was that peasant producers who could weave cloth or grow grain – the other two major currencies of the Tang – would not be able to produce coins, and therefore would not be able to pay their taxes.

As coins had advantages and disadvantages, so too did textiles. If in circulation for a long period of time, they could show signs of wear and tear. Stained, faded and torn bolts of textiles had less value than a brand new bolt. Furthermore, a full bolt had a particular value. If consumers cut textiles into smaller pieces to buy or sell something worth less than a full bolt, that, too, greatly lessened the value of the textiles. Unlike coins, textiles could not be used for small transactions; as [an official] noted, textiles could not "be exchanged by the foot and the inch"...

Handwritten notes on the right side of the passage:

currency during the Tang dynasty

grain / coin / textile → adv → durable, recognisable, convenient medium of exchange → smaller transactions

disadv → shortage of copper. 1/10th of the money supply.

→ weavers cloth / grow grains

VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Crash Course

Live Classes by IIMA alumni

cracku

Question 808

In the context of the passage, which one of the following can be inferred with regard to the use of currency during the Tang era?

- A Currency that deteriorated easily was not used for official work.
- B Copper coins were more valuable and durable than textiles.

C Grains were the most used currency because of government requirements.

D Currency usage was similar to that of modern times.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Few realise that the government of China, governing an empire of some 60 million people during the Tang dynasty (618-907), implemented a complex financial system that recognised grain, coins and textiles as money. Coins did have certain advantages: they were durable, recognisable and provided a convenient medium of exchange, especially for smaller transactions. However, there were also disadvantages. A continuing shortage of copper meant that government mints could not produce enough coins for the entire empire, to the extent that for most of the dynasty's history, coins constituted only a tenth of the money supply. On the other hand, objections to calls for taxes to be paid in coin was that peasant producers who could weave cloth or grow grain - the two major currencies of the Tang - would not be able to produce coins, and therefore would not be able to pay their taxes. . . .

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currency during the Tang dynasty

adv

grain / coin → durable, recognisable, convenient medium of exchange → smaller transactions

disadv

→ shortage of copper

→ 1/10th of the money supply

→ weave cloth / grow grains

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The claims advanced here may be condensed into two assertions: [first, that visual] culture is what images, acts of seeing, and attendant intellectual, emotional, and perceptual sensibilities do to build, maintain, or transform the worlds in which people live. [And second, that the] study of visual culture is the analysis and interpretation of images and the ways of seeing (or gazes) that configure the agents, practices, conceptualities, and institutions that put images to work. . . .

Accordingly, the study of visual culture should be characterized by several concerns. First, scholars of visual culture need to examine any and all imagery - high and low, art and non-art. . . . They must not restrict themselves to objects of a particular beauty or aesthetic value. Indeed, any kind of imagery may be found to offer up evidence of the visual construction of reality. . . .

Second, the study of visual culture must scrutinize visual practice as much as images themselves, asking what images do when they are put to use. If scholars engaged in this enterprise inquire what makes an image beautiful or why this image or that constitutes a masterpiece or a work of genius, they should do so with the purpose of investigating an artist's or a work's contribution to the experience of beauty, taste, value, or genius. No amount of social analysis can account fully for the existence of Michelangelo or Leonardo. They were unique creators of images that changed the way their contemporaries thought and felt and have continued to shape the history of art, artists, museums, feeling, and aesthetic value. But study of the critical, artistic, and popular reception of works by such artists as Michelangelo and Leonardo can shed important light on the meaning of these artists and their works for many different people. And the history of meaning-making has a great deal to do with how scholars as well as lay audiences today understand these artists and their achievements.

Third, scholars studying visual culture might properly focus their interpretative work on life worlds by examining images, practices, visual technologies, taste, and artistic style as constitutive of social relations. The task is to understand how artifacts contribute to the construction of a world. . . . Important methodological implications follow: ethnography and reception studies become productive forms of gathering information, since these move beyond the image as a closed and fixed meaning-event. . . .

Fourth, scholars may learn a great deal when they scrutinize the constituents of vision, that is, the structures of perception as a physiological process as well as the epistemological frameworks informing a system of visual representation. Vision is a socially and a biologically constructed operation, depending on the design of the human body and how it engages the interpretive devices developed by a culture in order to see intelligibly. . . . Seeing . . . operates on the foundation of covenants with images that establish the conditions for meaningful visual experience.

Finally, the scholar of visual culture seeks to regard images as evidence for explanation, not as epiphenomena.

Question 809

All of the following statements may be considered valid inferences from the passage, EXCEPT:

- A visual culture is not just about how we see, but also about how our visual practices can impact and change the world.
- B artifacts are meaningful precisely because they help to construct the meanings of the world for us.
- C understanding the structures of perception is an important part of understanding how visual cultures work.
- D studying visual culture requires institutional structures without which the structures of perception cannot be analysed.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The claims advanced here may be condensed into two assertions: [first, that visual] culture is what images, acts of seeing, and attendant intellectual, emotional, and perceptual sensibilities do to build, maintain, or transform the worlds in which people live. [And second, that the] study of visual culture is the analysis and interpretation of images and the ways of seeing (or gazing) that configure the agents, practices, conceptualities, and institutions that put images to work....

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para ①: two assertions:
① visual culture → construct of images in building meaning or transforming the world
② study of v.c → analysis & interpretation of images

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 810

"No amount of social analysis can account fully for the existence of Michelangelo or Leonardo." In light of the passage, which one of the following interpretations of this sentence is the most accurate?

- A Socially existing beings cannot be analysed, unlike the art of Michelangelo or Leonardo which can.
- B Social analytical accounts of people like Michelangelo or Leonardo cannot explain their genius.
- C Michelangelo or Leonardo cannot be subjected to social analysis because of their genius.
- D No analyses exist of Michelangelo's or Leonardo's social accounts.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The claims advanced here may be condensed into two assertions: [first, that visual] culture is what images, acts of seeing, and attendant intellectual, emotional, and perceptual sensibilities do to build, maintain, or transform the worlds in which people live. [And second, that the] study of visual culture is the analysis and interpretation of images and the ways of seeing (or gazing) that configure the agents, practices, conceptualities, and institutions that put images to work....

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Question 811

Which one of the following best describes the word “epiphenomena” in the last sentence of the passage?

- A Overarching collections of images.
- B Visual phenomena of epic proportions.
- C Phenomena amenable to analysis.
- D Phenomena supplemental to the evidence.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The claims advanced here may be condensed into two assertions: (first, that visual) culture is what images, acts of seeing, and attendant intellectual, emotional, and perceptual sensibilities do to build, maintain, or transform the worlds in which people live. [And second, that the] study of visual culture is the analysis and interpretation of images and the ways of seeing (or gazing) that configure the agents, practices, conceptualities, and institutions that put images to work....

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② study of v.c → analysis & interpretation of images

Question 812

Which set of keywords below most closely captures the arguments of the passage?

- A Visual Culture, Aesthetic Value, Lay Audience, Visual Experience.
- B Visual Construction of Reality, Work of Genius, Ethnography, Epiphenomena.
- C Imagery, Visual Practices, Lifeworlds, Structures of Perception.
- D Scholars, Social Analysis, Michelangelo and Leonardo, Interpretive Devices.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The claims advanced here may be condensed into two assertions: (first, that visual) culture is what images, acts of seeing, and attendant intellectual, emotional, and perceptual sensibilities do to build, maintain, or transform the worlds in which people live. [And second, that the] study of visual culture is the analysis and interpretation of images and the ways of seeing (or gazing) that configure the agents, practices, conceptualities, and institutions that put images to work....

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② study of v.c → analysis & interpretation of images

Question 813

"Seeing . . . operates on the foundation of covenants with images that establish the conditions for meaningful visual experience." In light of the passage, which one of the following statements best conveys the meaning of this sentence?

- A Sight becomes a meaningful visual experience because of covenants of meaningfulness that we establish with the images we see.
- B Images are meaningful visual experiences when they have a foundation of covenants seeing them.
- C Sight as a meaningful visual experience is possible when there is a foundational condition established in images of covenants.
- D The way we experience sight is through images operated on by meaningful covenants.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The claims advanced here may be condensed into two assertions: [first, that visual] culture is what images, acts of seeing, and attendant intellectual, emotional, and perceptual sensibilities do to build, maintain, or transform the worlds in which people live. [And second, that the] study of visual culture is the analysis and interpretation of images and the ways of seeing (or gazing) that configure the agents, practices, conceptualities, and institutions that put images to work....

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para ①: two assertions
 ① visual culture → context of images in building, maintaining or transforming the world
 ② study of v.c → analysis & interpretation of images

CAT Daily Targets

Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile

cracku

Instructions

Have you ever come across a painting, by Picasso, Mondrian, Miro, or any other modern abstract painter of this century, and found yourself engulfed in a brightly coloured canvas which your senses cannot interpret? Many people would tend to denounce abstractionism as senseless trash. These people are disoriented by Miro's bright, fanciful creatures and two-dimensional canvases. They click their tongues and shake their heads at Mondrian's grid works, declaring the poor guy played too many scrabble games. They silently shake their heads in sympathy for Picasso, whose gruesome, distorted figures must be a reflection of his mental health. Then, standing in front of a work by Charlie Russell, the famous Western artist, they'll declare it a work of God. People feel more comfortable with something they can relate to and understand immediately without too much thought. This is the case with the work of Charlie Russell. Being able to recognize the elements in his paintings - trees, horses and cowboys - gives people a safety line to their world of "reality". There are some who would disagree when I say abstract art requires more creativity and artistic talent to produce a good piece than does representational art, but there are many weaknesses in their arguments.

People who look down on abstract art have several major arguments to support their beliefs. They feel that artists turn abstract because they are not capable of the technical drafting skills that appear in a Russell; therefore, such artists create an art form that anyone is capable of and that is less time consuming, and then parade it as artistic progress. Secondly, they feel that the purpose of art is to create something of beauty in an orderly, logical composition. Russell's compositions are balanced and rational, everything sits calmly on the

canvas, leaving the viewer satisfied that he has seen all there is to see. The modern abstractionists, on the other hand, seem to compose their pieces irrationally. For example, upon seeing Picasso's *Guernica*, a friend of mine asked me, "What's the point?" Finally, many people feel that art should portray the ideal and real. The exactness of detail in Charlie Russell's work is an example of this. He has been called a great historian because his pieces depict the life style, dress, and events of the times. His subject matter is derived from his own experiences on the trail, and reproduced to the smallest detail.

I agree in part with many of these arguments, and at one time even endorsed them. But now, I believe differently. Firstly, I object to the argument that abstract artists are not capable of drafting. Many abstract artists, such as Picasso, are excellent draftsmen. As his work matured, Picasso became more abstract in order to increase the expressive quality of his work. *Guernica* was meant as a protest against the bombing of that city by the Germans. To express the terror and suffering of the victims more vividly, he distorted the figures and presented them in a black and white journalistic manner. If he had used representational images and colour, much of the emotional content would have been lost and the piece would not have caused the demand for justice that it did. Secondly, I do not think that a piece must be logical and aesthetically pleasing to be art. The message it conveys to its viewers is more important. It should reflect the ideals and issues of its time and be true to itself, not just a flowery, glossy surface. For example, through his work, Mondrian was trying to present a system of simplicity, logic, and rational order. As a result, his pieces did end up looking like a scrabble board.

Miro created powerful, surrealistic images from his dreams and subconscious. These artists were trying to evoke a response from society through an expressionistic manner. Finally, abstract artists and representational artists maintain different ideas about 'reality'. To the representational artist, reality is what he sees with his eyes. This is the reality he reproduces on canvas. To the abstract artist, reality is what he feels about what his eyes see. This is the reality he interprets on canvas. This can be illustrated by Mondrian's *Trees* series. You can actually see the progression from the early recognizable, though abstracted, *Trees*, to his final *Explanation*, the grid system.

A cycle of abstract and representational art began with the first scratchings of prehistoric man. From the abstractions of ancient Egypt to representational, classical Rome, returning to abstractionism in early Christian art and so on up to the present day, the cycle has been going on. But this day and age may witness its death through the camera. With film, there is no need to produce finely detailed, historical records manually; the camera does this for us more efficiently. Maybe, representational art would cease to exist. With abstractionism as the victor of the first battle, maybe a different kind of cycle will be touched off. Possibly, some time in the distant future, thousands of years from now, art itself will be physically non-existent. Some artists today believe that once they have planned and constructed a piece in their mind, there is no sense in finishing it with their hands; it has already been done and can never be duplicated.

Question 814

The author believes that people feel comfortable with representational art because:

- A** they are not engulfed in brightly coloured canvases.
- B** they do not have to click their tongues and shake their heads in sympathy.
- C** they understand the art without putting too much strain on their minds.
- D** paintings like *Guernica* do not have a point.

Have you ever come across a painting, by Picasso, Mondrian, Miro, or any other modern abstract painter of this century, and found yourself engulfed in a brightly coloured canvas which your senses cannot interpret? Many people would tend to denounce abstractionism as senseless trash. These people are disoriented by Miro's bright, fanciful creatures and two-dimensional canvases. They click their tongues and shake their heads at Mondrian's grid works, declaring the poor guy played too many scrabble games. They silently shake their heads in sympathy for Picasso, whose gruesome, distorted figures must be a reflection of his mental health. Then, standing in front of a work by Charlie Russell, the famous Western artist, they'll declare it a work of God. People feel more comfortable with something they can relate to and understand immediately without too much thought. This is the case with the work of Charlie Russell. Being able to recognize the elements in his paintings - trees, horses and cowboys - gives people a safety line to their world of "reality". There

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 815

The author argues that many people look down upon abstract art because they feel that:

- A Modern abstract art does not portray what is ideal and real.
- B Abstract artists are unskilled in matters of technical drafting.
- C Abstractionists compose irrationally.
- D All of the above.

Have you ever come across a painting, by Picasso, Mondrian, Miro, or any other modern abstract painter of this century, and found yourself engulfed in a brightly coloured canvas which your senses cannot interpret? Many people would tend to denounce abstractionism as senseless trash. These people are disoriented by Miro's bright, fanciful creatures and two-dimensional canvases. They click their tongues and shake their heads at Mondrian's grid works, declaring the poor guy played too many scrabble games. They silently shake their heads in sympathy for Picasso, whose gruesome, distorted figures must be a reflection of his mental health. Then, standing in front of a work by Charlie Russell, the famous Western artist, they'll declare it a work of God. People feel more comfortable with something they can relate to and understand immediately without too much thought. This is the case with the work of Charlie Russell. Being able to recognize the elements in his paintings - trees, horses and cowboys - gives people a safety line to their world of "reality". There

VIDEO SOLUTION

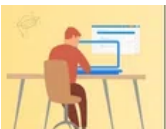
Question 816

In the author's opinion, Picasso's Guernica created a strong demand for justice since

- A it was a protest against the German bombing of Guernica.
- B Picasso managed to express the emotional content well with his abstract depiction.
- C it depicts the terror and suffering of the victims in a distorted way.
- D it was a mature work of Picasso's, painted when the artist's drafting skills were excellent.

Have you ever come across a painting, by Picasso, Mondrian, Miro, or any other modern abstract painter of this century, and found yourself engulfed in a brightly coloured canvas which your senses cannot interpret? Many people would tend to denounce abstractionism as senseless trash. These people are disoriented by Miro's bright, fanciful creatures and two-dimensional canvases. They click their tongues and shake their heads at Mondrian's grid works, declaring the poor guy played too many scrabble games. They silently shake their heads in sympathy for Picasso, whose gruesome, distorted figures must be a reflection of his mental health. Then, standing in front of a work by Charlie Russell, the famous Western artist, they'll declare it a work of God. People feel more comfortable with something they can relate to and understand immediately without too much thought. This is the case with the work of Charlie Russell. Being able to recognize the elements in his paintings - trees, horses and cowboys - gives people a safety line to their world of "reality". There

VIDEO SOLUTION





CAT Sectional Tests




Question 817

The main difference between the abstract artist and the representational artist in matters of the 'ideal' and the 'real', according to the author, is:

- A How each chooses to deal with 'reality' on his or her canvas.
- B The superiority of interpretation of reality over reproduction of reality.
- C The different values attached by each to being a historian.
- D The varying levels of drafting skills and logical thinking abilities.

Have you ever come across a painting, by Picasso, Mondrian, Miro, or any other modern abstract painter of this century, and found yourself engulfed in a brightly coloured canvas which your senses cannot interpret? Many people would tend to denounce abstractionism as senseless trash. These people are disoriented by Miro's bright, fanciful creatures and two-dimensional canvases. They click their tongues and shake their heads at Mondrian's grid works, declaring the poor guy played too many scrabble games. They silently shake their heads in sympathy for Picasso, whose gruesome, distorted figures must be a reflection of his mental health. Then, standing in front of a work by Charlie Russell, the famous Western artist, they'll declare it a work of God. People feel more comfortable with something they can relate to and understand immediately without too much thought. This is the case with the work of Charlie Russell. Being able to recognize the elements in his paintings - trees, horses and cowboys - gives people a safety line to their world of "reality". There

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 818

The author acknowledges that Mondrian's pieces may have ended up looking like a scrabble board because

- A many people declared the poor guy played too many scrabble games.
- B Mondrian believed in the 'grid-works' approach to abstractionist painting.
- C Mondrian was trying to convey the message of simplicity and rational order.

D Mondrian learned from his Trees series to evolve a grid system.

Have you ever come across a painting, by Picasso, Mondrian, Miro, or any other modern abstract painter of this century, and found yourself engulfed in a brightly coloured canvas which your senses cannot interpret? Many people would tend to denounce abstractionism as senseless trash. These people are disoriented by Miro's bright, fanciful creatures and two-dimensional canvases. They click their tongues and shake their heads at Mondrian's grid works, declaring the poor guy played too many scrabble games. They silently shake their heads in sympathy for Picasso, whose gruesome, distorted figures must be a reflection of his mental health. Then, standing in front of a work by Charlie Russell, the famous Western artist, they'll declare it a work of God. People feel more comfortable with something they can relate to and understand immediately without too much thought. This is the case with the work of Charlie Russell. Being able to recognize the elements in his paintings - trees, horses and cowboys - gives people a safety line to their world of "reality". There

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Billie Holiday died a few weeks ago. I have been unable until now to write about her, but since she will survive many who receive longer obituaries, a short delay in one small appreciation will not harm her or us. When she died we — the musicians, critics, all who were ever transfixed by the most heart-rending voice of the past generation — grieved bitterly. There was no reason to. Few people pursued self-destruction more wholeheartedly than she, and when the pursuit was at an end, at the age of 44, she had turned herself into a physical and artistic wreck. Some of us tried gallantly to pretend otherwise, taking comfort in the occasional moments when she still sounded like a ravaged echo of her greatness. Others had not even the heart to see and listen any more. We preferred to stay home and, if old and lucky enough to own the incomparable records of her heyday from 1937 to 1946, many of which are not even available on British LP, to recreate those coarse-textured, sinuous, sensual and unbearable sad noises which gave her a sure corner of immortality. Her physical death called, if anything, for relief rather than sorrow. What sort of middle age would she have faced without the voice to earn money for her drinks and fixes, without the looks — and in her day she was hauntingly beautiful — to attract the men she needed, without business sense, without anything but the disinterested worship of ageing men who had heard and seen her in her glory?

And yet, irrational though it is, our grief expressed Billie Holiday's art, that of a woman for whom one must be sorry. The great blues singers, to whom she may be justly compared, played their game from strength. Lionesses, though often wounded or at bay (did not Bessie Smith call herself 'a tiger, ready to jump?'), their tragic equivalents were Cleopatra and Phaedra; Holiday's was an embittered Ophelia. She was the Puccini heroine among blues singers, or rather among jazz singers, for though she sang a cabaret version of the blues incomparably, her natural idiom was the pop song. Her unique achievement was to have twisted this into a genuine expression of the major passions by means of a total disregard of its sugary tunes, or indeed of any tune other than her own few delicately crying elongated notes, phrased like Bessie Smith or Louis Armstrong in sackcloth, sung in a thin, gritty, haunting voice whose natural mood was an unresigned and voluptuous welcome for the pains of love. Nobody has sung, or will sing, Bess's songs from Porgy as she did. It was this combination of bitterness and physical submission, as of someone lying still while watching his legs being amputated, which gives such a blood-curdling quality to her Strange Fruit, the anti-lynching poem which she turned into an unforgettable art song. Suffering was her profession; but she did not accept it.

Little need be said about her horrifying life, which she described with emotional, though hardly with factual, truth in her autobiography Lady Sings the Blues. After an adolescence in which self-respect was measured by a girl's insistence on picking up the coins thrown to her by clients with her hands, she was plainly beyond help. She did not lack it, for she had the flair and scrupulous honesty of John Hammond to launch her, the best musicians of the 1930s to accompany her — notably Teddy Wilson, Frankie Newton and Lester Young — the boundless devotion of all serious connoisseurs, and much public success. It was too late to arrest a career of systematic embittered self-immolation. To be born with both beauty and self-respect in the Negro ghetto of

Baltimore in 1915 was too much of a handicap, even without rape at the age of 10 and drug-addiction in her teens. But, while she destroyed herself, she sang, unmelodious, profound and heartbreaking. It is impossible not to weep for her, or not to hate the world which made her what she was.

Question 819

According to the passage, Billie Holiday was fortunate in all but one of which of the following ways?

- A She was fortunate to have been picked up young by an honest producer.
- B She was fortunate to have the likes of Louis Armstrong and Bessie Smith accompany her.
- C She was fortunate to possess the looks.
- D She enjoyed success among the public and connoisseurs.

moments when she still sounded like a ravaged echo of her greatness. Others had not even the heart to see and listen any more. We preferred to stay home and, if old and lucky enough to own the incomparable records of her heyday from 1937 to 1946, many of which are not even available on British LP, to recreate those coarse-textured, sinuous, sensual and unbearable sad noises which gave her a sure corner of immortality. Her physical death called, if anything, for relief rather than sorrow. What sort of middle age would she have faced without the voice to earn money for her drinks and fixes, without the looks — and in her day she was hauntingly beautiful — to attract the men she needed, without business sense, without anything but the disinterested worship of ageing men who had heard and seen her in her glory?

And yet, irrational though it is, our grief expressed Billie Holiday's art, that of a woman for whom one must be sorry. The great blues singers, to whom she may be justly compared, played their game from



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Question 820

Which of the following statements is not representative of the author's opinion?

- A Billie Holiday had her unique brand of melody.
- B Billie Holiday's voice can be compared to other singers in certain ways.
- C Billie Holiday's voice had a ring of profound sorrow.
- D Billie Holiday welcomed suffering in her profession and in her life.

moments when she still sounded like a ravaged echo of her greatness. Others had not even the heart to see and listen any more. We preferred to stay home and, if old and lucky enough to own the incomparable records of her heyday from 1937 to 1946, many of which are not even available on British LP, to recreate those coarse-textured, sinuous, sensual and unbearable sad noises which gave her a sure corner of immortality. Her physical death called, if anything, for relief rather than sorrow. What sort of middle age would she have faced without the voice to earn money for her drinks and fixes, without the looks — and on her day she was hauntingly beautiful — to attract to men she needed, without business sense, without anything but the disinterested worship of ageing men who had heard and seen her in her glory?

And yet, irrational though it is, our grief expressed Billie Holiday's art, that of a woman for whom one must be sorry. The great blues singers, to whom she may be justly compared, played their game from

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 821

According to the author, if Billie Holiday had not died in her middle age

- A she would have gone on to make a further mark.
- B she would have become even richer than what she was when she died.
- C she would have led a rather ravaged existence.
- D she would have led a rather comfortable existence.

moments when she still sounded like a ravaged echo of her greatness. Others had not even the heart to see and listen any more. We preferred to stay home and, if old and lucky enough to own the incomparable records of her heyday from 1937 to 1946, many of which are not even available on British LP, to recreate those coarse-textured, sinuous, sensual and unbearable sad noises which gave her a sure corner of immortality. Her physical death called, if anything, for relief rather than sorrow. What sort of middle age would she have faced without the voice to earn money for her drinks and fixes, without the looks — and on her day she was hauntingly beautiful — to attract to men she needed, without business sense, without anything but the disinterested worship of ageing men who had heard and seen her in her glory?

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Question 822

Why will Billie Holiday survive many who receive longer obituaries?

- A Because of her blues creations.
- B Because she was not as self-destructive as some other blues exponents.
- C Because of her smooth and mellow voice.
- D Because of the expression of anger in her songs.

moments when she still sounded like a ravaged echo of her greatness. Others had not even the heart to see and listen any more. We preferred to stay home and, if old and lucky enough to own the incomparable records of her heyday from 1937 to 1946, many of which are not even available on British LP, to recreate those coarse-textured, sinuous, sensual and unbearable sad noises which gave her a sure corner of immortality. Her physical death called, if anything, for relief rather than sorrow. What sort of middle age would she have faced without the voice to earn money for her drinks and fixes, without the looks — and in her day she was hauntingly beautiful — to attract to men she needed, without business sense, without anything but the disinterested worship of ageing men who had heard and seen her in her glory?

And yet, irrational though it is, our grief expressed Billie Holiday's art, that of a woman for whom one must be sorry. The great blues singers, to whom she may be justly compared, played their game from

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CAT Daily Articles



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I used a smartphone GPS to find my way through the cobblestoned maze of Geneva's Old Town, in search of a handmade machine that changed the world more than any other invention. Near a 13th-century cathedral in this Swiss city on the shores of a lovely lake, I found what I was looking for: a Gutenberg printing press. "This was the Internet of its day — at least as influential as the iPhone," said Gabriel de Montmollin, the director of the Museum of the Reformation, toying with the replica of Johann Gutenberg's great invention.

Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a single book. With the advance in movable type in 15th-century Europe, one press could crank out 3,000 pages a day. Before long, average people could travel to places that used to be unknown to them — with maps! Medical information passed more freely and quickly, diminishing the sway of quacks. The printing press offered the prospect that tyrants would never be able to kill a book or suppress an idea. Gutenberg's brainchild broke the monopoly that clerics had on scripture. And later, stirred by pamphlets from a version of that same press, the American colonies rose up against a king and gave birth to a nation.

So, a question in the summer of this 10th anniversary of the iPhone: has the device that is perhaps the most revolutionary of all time given us a single magnificent idea? Nearly every advancement of the written word through new technology has also advanced humankind. Sure, you can say the iPhone changed everything. By putting the world's recorded knowledge in the palm of a hand, it revolutionized work, dining, travel and socializing. It made us more narcissistic — here's more of me doing cool stuff! — and it unleashed an army of awful trolls. We no longer have the patience to sit through a baseball game without that reach to the pocket. And one more casualty of Apple selling more than a billion phones in a decade's time: daydreaming has become a lost art.

For all of that, I'm still waiting to see if the iPhone can do what the printing press did for religion and democracy...the Geneva museum makes a strong case that the printing press opened more minds than anything else...it's hard to imagine the French or American revolutions without those enlightened voices in print...

Not long after Steve Jobs introduced his iPhone, he said the bound book was probably headed for history's attic. Not so fast. After a period of rapid growth in e-books, something closer to the medium for Chaucer's volumes has made a great comeback

The hope of the iPhone, and the Internet in general, was that it would free people in closed societies. But the failure of the Arab Spring, and the continued suppression of ideas in North Korea, China and Iran, has not borne that out. The iPhone is still young. It has certainly been "one of the most important, world-changing and

successful products in history," as Apple C.E.O. Tim Cook said. But I'm not sure if the world changed for the better with the iPhone — as it did with the printing press — or merely changed.

Question 823

"I'm still waiting to see if the iPhone can do what the printing press did for religion and democracy." The author uses which one of the following to indicate his uncertainty?

- A The rise of religious groups in many parts of the world.
- B The expansion in trolling and narcissism among users of the Internet.
- C The continued suppression of free speech in closed societies.
- D The decline in reading habits among those who use the device.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I used a smartphone GPS to find my way through the cobbled maze of Geneva's Old Town in search of a handmade machine that changed the world more than any other invention. Near a 13th-century cathedral in this Swiss city, on the shores of a lovely lake, I found what I was looking for: a Gutenberg printing press. This was the Internet of its day — at least as influential as the iPhone," said Gabriel de Montmollin, the director of the Museum of the Reformation, toying with the replica of Johann Gutenberg's great invention.

Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 824

The main conclusion of the passage is that the new technology has

- A some advantages, but these are outweighed by its disadvantages.
- B so far not proved as successful as the printing press in opening people's minds.
- C been disappointing because it has changed society too rapidly.
- D been more wasteful than the printing press because people spend more time daydreaming or surfing.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I used a smartphone GPS to find my way through the cobbled maze of Geneva's Old Town in search of a handmade machine that changed the world more than any other invention. Near a 13th-century cathedral in this Swiss city, on the shores of a lovely lake, I found what I was looking for: a Gutenberg printing press. This was the Internet of its day — at least as influential as the iPhone," said Gabriel de Montmollin, the director of the Museum of the Reformation, toying with the replica of Johann Gutenberg's great invention.

Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a

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Question 825

According to the passage, the invention of the printing press did all of the following EXCEPT

- A promoted the spread of enlightened political views across countries.
- B gave people direct access to authentic medical information and religious texts.
- C shortened the time taken to produce books and pamphlets.
- D enabled people to perform various tasks simultaneously.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I used a smartphone GPS to find my way through the cobbled maze of Geneva's Old Town in search of a handmade machine that changed the world more than any other invention. Near a 13th-century cathedral in this Swiss city, on the shores of a lovely lake, I found what I was looking for: a Gutenberg printing press. This was the Internet of its day — at least as influential as the iPhone," said Gabriel de Montmollin, the director of the Museum of the Reformation, toying with the replica of Johann Gutenberg's great invention.

Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a

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100+ CAT Quant Questions



Question 826

The author attributes the French and American revolutions to the invention of the printing press because

- A maps enabled large numbers of Europeans to travel and settle in the American continent.
- B the rapid spread of information exposed people to new ideas on freedom and democracy.
- C it encouraged religious freedom among the people by destroying the monopoly of religious leaders on the scriptures.
- D it made available revolutionary strategies and opinions to the people.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I used a smartphone GPS to find my way through the cobbled maze of Geneva's Old Town in search of a handmade machine that changed the world more than any other invention. Near a 13th-century cathedral in this Swiss city, on the shores of a lovely lake, I found what I was looking for: a Gutenberg printing press. This was the Internet of its day — at least as influential as the iPhone," said Gabriel de Montmollin, the director of the Museum of the Reformation, toying with the replica of Johann Gutenberg's great invention.

Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a

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Question 827

The printing press has been likened to the Internet for which one of the following reasons?

- A It enabled rapid access to new information and the sharing of new ideas.
- B It represented new and revolutionary technology compared to the past.
- C It encouraged reading among people by giving them access to thousands of books.
- D It gave people access to pamphlets and literature in several languages.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I used a smartphone GPS to find my way through the cobbled maze of Geneva's Old Town in search of a handmade machine that changed the world more than any other invention. Near a 13th-century cathedral in this Swiss city, on the shores of a lovely lake, I found what I was looking for: a Gutenberg printing press. This was the Internet of its day — at least as influential as the iPhone," said Gabriel de Montmollin, the director of the Museum of the Reformation, toying with the replica of Johann Gutenberg's great invention.

Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a

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Question 828

Steve Jobs predicted which one of the following with the introduction of the iPhone?

- A People would switch from reading on the Internet to reading on their iPhones.
- B People would lose interest in historical and traditional classics.
- C Reading printed books would become a thing of the past.
- D The production of e-books would eventually fall.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of six questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

I used a smartphone GPS to find my way through the cobbled maze of Geneva's Old Town in search of a handmade machine that changed the world more than any other invention. Near a 13th-century cathedral in this Swiss city, on the shores of a lovely lake, I found what I was looking for: a Gutenberg printing press. This was the Internet of its day — at least as influential as the iPhone," said Gabriel de Montmollin, the director of the Museum of the Reformation, toying with the replica of Johann Gutenberg's great invention.

Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a

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100+ CAT DILR Questions



Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of three questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Scientists have long recognised the incredible diversity within a species. But they thought it reflected evolutionary changes that unfolded imperceptibly, over millions of years. That divergence between populations within a species was enforced, according to Ernst Mayr, the great evolutionary biologist of the 1940s, when a population was separated from the rest of the species by a mountain range or a desert, preventing breeding across the divide over geologic scales of time. Without the separation, gene flow was relentless. But as the separation persisted, the isolated population grew apart and speciation occurred.

In the mid-1960s, the biologist Paul Ehrlich — author of *The Population Bomb* (1968) — and his Stanford University colleague Peter Raven challenged Mayr's ideas about speciation. They had studied checkerspot butterflies living in the Jasper Ridge Biological Preserve in California, and it soon became clear that they were not examining a single population. Through years of capturing, marking and then recapturing the butterflies, they were able to prove that within the population, spread over just 50 acres of suitable checkerspot habitat, there were three groups that rarely interacted despite their very close proximity.

Among other ideas, Ehrlich and Raven argued in a now classic paper from 1969 that gene flow was not as predictable and ubiquitous as Mayr and his cohort maintained, and thus evolutionary divergence between neighbouring groups in a population was probably common. They also asserted that isolation and gene flow were less important to evolutionary divergence than natural selection (when factors such as mate choice, weather, disease or predation cause better-adapted individuals to survive and pass on their successful genetic traits). For example, Ehrlich and Raven suggested that, without the force of natural selection, an isolated population would remain unchanged and that, in other scenarios, natural selection could be strong enough to overpower gene flow...

Question 829

Which of the following best sums up Ehrlich and Raven's argument in their classic 1969 paper?

- A Ernst Mayr was wrong in identifying physical separation as the cause of species diversity.
- B Checkerspot butterflies in the 50-acre Jasper Ridge Preserve formed three groups that rarely interacted with each other.
- C While a factor, isolation was not as important to speciation as natural selection.
- D Gene flow is less common and more erratic than Mayr and his colleagues claimed.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 830

All of the following statements are true according to the passage EXCEPT

- A Gene flow contributes to evolutionary divergence.
- B The Population Bomb questioned dominant ideas about species diversity.
- C Evolutionary changes unfold imperceptibly over time.
- D Checkerspot butterflies are known to exhibit speciation while living in close proximity.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 831

The author discusses Mayr, Ehrlich and Raven to demonstrate that

- A evolution is a sensitive and controversial topic.

- B Ehrlich and Raven's ideas about evolutionary divergence are widely accepted by scientists.
- C the causes of speciation are debated by scientists.
- D checkerspot butterflies offer the best example of Ehrlich and Raven's ideas about speciation.

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100+ CAT VARC Questions



Instructions

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

"Everybody pretty much agrees that the relationship between elephants and people has dramatically changed," says psychologist Gay Bradshaw, "Where for centuries humans and elephants lived in relatively peaceful coexistence, there is now hostility and violence. Now, I use the term 'violence' because of the intentionality associated with it, both in the aggression of humans and, at times, the recently observed behaviour of elephants."

Typically, elephant researchers have cited, as a cause of aggression, the high levels of testosterone in newly matured male elephants or the competition for land and resources between elephants and humans. But Bradshaw and several colleagues argue that today's elephant populations are suffering from a form of chronic stress, a kind of species-wide trauma. Decades of poaching and culling and habitat loss, they claim, have so disrupted the intricate web of familial and societal relations by which young elephants have traditionally been raised in the wild, and by which established elephant herds are governed, that what we are now witnessing is nothing less than a precipitous collapse of elephant culture.

Elephants, when left to their own devices, are profoundly social creatures. Young elephants are raised within an extended, multitiered network of doting female caregivers that includes the birth mother, grandmothers, aunts and friends. These relations are maintained over a life span as long as 70 years. Studies of established herds have shown that young elephants stay within 15 feet of their mothers for nearly all of their first eight years of life, after which young females are socialized into the matriarchal network, while young males go off for a time into an all-male social group before coming back into the fold as mature adults.

This fabric of elephant society, Bradshaw and her colleagues [demonstrate], ha[s] effectively been frayed by years of habitat loss and poaching, along with systematic culling by government agencies to control elephant numbers and translocations of herds to different habitats. . . . As a result of such social upheaval, calves are now being born to and raised by ever-younger and inexperienced mothers. Young orphaned elephants, meanwhile, that have witnessed the death of a parent at the hands of poachers are coming of age in the absence of the support system that defines traditional elephant life. "The loss of elephant elders," [says] Bradshaw, "and the traumatic experience of witnessing the massacres of their family, impairs normal brain and behaviour development in young elephants."

What Bradshaw and her colleagues describe would seem to be an extreme form of anthropocentric conjecture if the evidence that they've compiled from various elephant researchers. . . weren't so compelling. The elephants of decimated herds, especially orphans who've watched the death of their parents and elders from poaching and culling, exhibit behaviour typically associated with post-traumatic stress disorder and other trauma-related disorders in humans: abnormal startle response, unpredictable asocial behaviour, inattentive mothering and hyper-aggression.

[According to Bradshaw], "Elephants are suffering and behaving in the same ways that we recognize in ourselves as a result of violence. Except perhaps for a few specific features, brain organization and early development of elephants and humans are extremely similar."

Question 832

Which of the following statements best expresses the overall argument of this passage?

- A The brain organisation and early development of elephants and humans are extremely similar.
- B Recent elephant behaviour could be understood as a form of species-wide trauma related response.
- C The relationship between elephants and humans has changed from one of coexistence to one of hostility.
- D Elephants, like the humans they are in conflict with, are profoundly social creatures.

cracku
Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

"Everybody pretty much agrees that the relationship between elephants and people has dramatically changed," says psychologist **Gay Bradshaw**. "Where for centuries humans and elephants lived in relatively peaceful coexistence, there is now hostility and violence. Now, I use the term 'violence' because of the intentionality associated with it, both in the aggression of humans and, at times, the recently observed behaviour of elephants."

Typically, elephant researchers have cited, as a cause of aggression, the high levels of testosterone in newly matured male elephants or the competition for food and resources between elephants and humans. But Bradshaw and several colleagues argue that today's elephant populations are suffering from a form of chronic stress, a kind of species-wide trauma. Decades of poaching and culling and habitat loss, they claim, have so disrupted the intricate web of familial and societal relations by which young elephants have traditionally been raised in the wild, and by which established elephant herds are

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 833

The passage makes all of the following claims EXCEPT:

- A elephants establish extended and enduring familial relationships as do humans.
- B human actions such as poaching and culling have created stressful conditions for elephant communities.
- C the elephant response to deeply disturbing experiences is similar to that of humans.
- D elephant mothers are evolving newer ways of rearing their calves to adapt to emerging threats.

cracku
Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 834

In paragraph 4, the phrase, "The fabric of elephant society . . . has[s] effectively been frayed by . . ." is:

- A an accurate description of the condition of elephant herds today.

- B a metaphor for the effect of human activity on elephant communities.
- C an exaggeration aimed at bolstering Bradshaw's claims.
- D an ode to the fragility of elephant society today.

cracku

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

"Everybody pretty much agrees that the relationship between elephants and people has dramatically changed," says psychologist Gay Bradshaw. "Where for centuries humans and elephants lived in relatively peaceful coexistence, there is now hostility and violence. Now, I use the term 'violence' because of the intentionality associated with it, both in the aggression of humans and, at times, the recently observed behaviour of elephants."

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Question 835

In the first paragraph, Bradshaw uses the term "violence" to describe the recent change in the human-elephant relationship because, according to her:

- A both humans and elephants have killed members of each other's species.
- B there is a purposefulness in human and elephant aggression towards each other.
- C human-elephant interactions have changed their character over time.
- D elephant herds and their habitat have been systematically destroyed by humans.

cracku

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions given

"Everybody pretty much agrees that the relationship between elephants and people has dramatically changed," says psychologist Gay Bradshaw. "Where for centuries humans and elephants lived in relatively peaceful coexistence, there is now hostility and violence. Now, I use the term 'violence' because of the intentionality associated with it, both in the aggression of humans and, at times, the recently observed behaviour of elephants."

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 836

Which of the following measures is Bradshaw most likely to support to address the problem of elephant aggression?

- by brain development, behaviour and testosterone on male elephant aggression

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graph TD
    Bradshaw --> Humans
    Bradshaw --> Elephants
    Humans --> Earlier
    Elephants --> Now
    Earlier --> Coexistence[Relatively Peaceful Coexistence]
    Now --> Hostility[Hostility & violence]
    Hostility -.-> Intentionality[Intentionality]
  
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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

Scientists recently discovered that Emperor Penguins—one of Antarctica’s most celebrated species—employ a particularly unusual technique for surviving the daily chill. As detailed in an article published today in the journal *Biology Letters*, the birds minimize heat loss by keeping the outer surface of their plumage below the temperature of the surrounding air. At the same time, the penguins’ thick plumage insulates their body and keeps it toasty. . . .

The researchers analyzed thermographic images . . . taken over roughly a month during June 2008. During that period, the average air temperature was 0.32 degrees Fahrenheit. At the same time, the majority of the plumage covering the penguins' bodies was even colder: the surface of their warmest body part, their feet, was an average 1.76 degrees Fahrenheit, but the plumage on their heads, chests and backs were -1.84, -7.24 and -9.76 degrees Fahrenheit respectively. Overall, nearly the entire outer surface of the penguins' bodies was below freezing at all times, except for their eyes and beaks. The scientists also used a computer simulation to determine how much heat was lost or gained from each part of the body - and discovered that by keeping their outer surface below air temperature, the birds might paradoxically be able to draw very slight amounts of heat from the air around them. The key to their trick is the difference between two different types of heat transfer: radiation and convection.

The penguins do lose internal body heat to the surrounding air through thermal radiation, just as our bodies do on a cold day. Because their bodies (but not surface plumage) are warmer than the surrounding air, heat gradually radiates outward over time, moving from a warmer material to a colder one. To maintain body temperature while losing heat, penguins, like all warm-blooded animals, rely on the metabolism of food. The penguins, though, have an additional strategy. Since their outer plumage is even colder than the air, the simulation showed that they might gain back a little of this heat through thermal convection—the transfer of heat via the movement of a fluid (in this case, the air). As the cold Antarctic air cycles around their bodies, slightly warmer air comes into contact with the plumage and donates minute amounts of heat back to the penguins, then cycles away at a slightly colder temperature.

Most of this heat, the researchers note, probably doesn't make it all the way through the plumage and back to the penguins' bodies, but it could make a slight difference. At the very least, the method by which a penguin's plumage wicks heat from the bitterly cold air that surrounds it helps to cancel out some of the heat that's radiating from its interior. And given the Emperors' unusually demanding breeding cycle, every bit of warmth counts. . . . Since [penguins trek as far as 75 miles to the coast to breed and male penguins] don't eat anything during [the incubation period of 64 days], conserving calories by giving up as little heat as possible is absolutely crucial.

Question 837

Which of the following can be responsible for Emperor Penguins losing body heat?

- A Food metabolism.
- B Plumage.
- C Reproduction process.
- D Thermal convection.

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 838

All of the following, if true, would negate the findings of the study reported in the passage EXCEPT:

- A the penguins' plumage were made of a material that did not allow any heat transfer through convection or radiation.
- B the average temperature of the feet of penguins in the month of June 2008 were found to be 2.76 degrees Fahrenheit.
- C the average air temperature recorded during the month of June 2008 in the area of study were -10 degrees Fahrenheit.
- D the temperature of the plumage on the penguins' heads, chests and backs were found to be 1.84, 7.24 and 9.76 degrees Fahrenheit respectively.

cracku **Easy**

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 839

In the last sentence of paragraph 3, “slightly warmer air” and “at a slightly colder temperature” refer to _____ AND _____ respectively:

- A the cold Antarctic air whose temperature is higher than that of the plumage AND the fall in temperature of the Antarctic air after it has transmitted some heat to the plumage.
- B the cold Antarctic air which becomes warmer because of the heat radiated out from penguins' bodies AND the fall in temperature of the surrounding air after thermal convection.
- C the air trapped in the plumage which is warmer than the Antarctic air AND the fall in temperature of the trapped plumage air after it radiates out some heat.
- D the air inside penguins' bodies kept warm because of metabolism of food AND the fall in temperature of the body air after it transfers some heat to the plumage.

cracku **Easy**

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Question 840

Which of the following best explains the purpose of the word “paradoxically” as used by the author?

- A Keeping their body colder helps penguins keep their plumage warmer.
- B Heat gain through radiation happens despite the heat loss through convection.
- C Heat loss through radiation happens despite the heat gain through convection.

D Keeping a part of their body colder helps penguins keep their bodies warmer.

cracku *Easy*

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The word 'anarchy' comes from the Greek '*anarkhia*', meaning contrary to authority or without a ruler, and was used in a derogatory sense until 1840, when it was adopted by Pierre-Joseph Proudhon to describe his political and social ideology. Proudhon argued that organization without government was both possible and desirable. In the evolution of political ideas, anarchism can be seen as an ultimate projection of both liberalism and socialism, and the differing strands of anarchist thought can be related to their emphasis on one or the other of these.

Historically, anarchism arose not only as an explanation of the gulf between the rich and the poor in any community, and of the reason why the poor have been obliged to fight for their share of a common inheritance, but as a radical answer to the question 'What went wrong?' that followed the ultimate outcome of the French Revolution. It had ended not only with a reign of terror and the emergence of a newly rich ruling caste, but with a new adored emperor, Napoleon Bonaparte, strutting through his conquered territories.

The anarchists and their precursors were unique on the political Left in affirming that workers and peasants, grasping the chance that arose to bring an end to centuries of exploitation and tyranny, were inevitably betrayed by the new class of politicians, whose first priority was to re-establish a centralized state power. After every revolutionary uprising, usually won at a heavy cost for ordinary populations, the new rulers had no hesitation in applying violence and terror, a secret police, and a professional army to maintain their control.

For anarchists the state itself is the enemy, and they have applied the same interpretation to the outcome of every revolution of the 19th and 20th centuries. This is not merely because every state keeps a watchful and sometimes punitive eye on its dissidents, but because every state protects the privileges of the powerful.

The mainstream of anarchist propaganda for more than a century has been anarchist-communism, which argues that property in land, natural resources, and the means of production should be held in mutual control by local communities, federating for innumerable joint purposes with other communes. It differs from state socialism in opposing the concept of any central authority. Some anarchists prefer to distinguish between anarchist-communism and collectivist anarchism in order to stress the obviously desirable freedom of an individual or family to possess the resources needed for living, while not implying the right to own the resources needed by others. . . .

There are, unsurprisingly, several traditions of individualist anarchism, one of them deriving from the 'conscious egoism' of the German writer Max Stirner (1806-56), and another from a remarkable series of 19th-century American figures who argued that in protecting our own autonomy and associating with others for common

advantages, we are promoting the good of all. These thinkers differed from free-market liberals in their absolute mistrust of American capitalism, and in their emphasis on mutualism.

Question 841

The author makes all of the following arguments in the passage, EXCEPT:

- A The failure of the French Revolution was because of its betrayal by the new class of politicians who emerged from it.
- B For anarchists, the state is the enemy because all states apply violence and terror to maintain their control.
- C Individualist anarchism is actually constituted of many streams, all of which focus on the autonomy of the individual.
- D The popular perception of anarchism as espousing lawlessness and violence comes from a mainstream mistrust of collectivism.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Question 842

The author believes that the new ruling class of politicians betrayed the principles of the French Revolution, but does not specify in what way. In the context of the passage, which statement below is the likeliest explanation of that betrayal?

- A The new ruling class was constituted mainly of anarchists who were against the destructive impact of the Revolution on the market.
- B The anarchists did not want a new ruling class, but were not politically strong enough to stop them.
- C The new ruling class struck a deal with the old ruling class to share power between them.
- D The new ruling class rode to power on the strength of the workers' revolutionary anger, but then turned to oppress that very class.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Question 843

According to the passage, what is the one idea that is common to all forms of anarchism?

- A They all derive from the work of Pierre-Joseph Proudhon.
- B They are all opposed to the centralisation of power in the state.
- C They all focus on the primacy of the power of the individual.
- D There is no idea common to all forms of anarchism; that is why it is anarchic.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Question 844

Which one of the following best expresses the similarity between American individualist anarchists and free-market liberals as well as the difference between the former and the latter?

- A Both prioritise individual autonomy; but the former also emphasise mutual dependence, while the latter do not do so.
- B Both reject the regulatory power of the state; but the former favour a people's state, while the latter favour state intervention in markets.

- C** Both have sophisticated arguments for capitalism; but the former argue for a morally upright capitalism, while the latter argue that the market is the only morality
- D** Both are founded on the moral principles of altruism; but the latter conceive of the market as a force too mystical for the former to comprehend.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Question 845

Of the following sets of concepts, identify the set that is conceptually closest to the concerns of the passage.

- A** Anarchism, State, Individual, Freedom.
- B** Revolution, State, Strike, Egoism.
- C** Revolution, State, Protection, Liberals.
- D** Anarchism, Betrayal, Power, State.

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

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Instructions

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Vocabulary used in speech or writing organizes itself in seven parts of speech (eight, if you count interjections such as Oh! and Gosh! and Fuhgeddaboudit!). Communication composed of these parts of speech must be organized by rules of grammar upon which we agree. When these rules break down, confusion and misunderstanding result. Bad grammar produces bad sentences. My favorite example from Strunk and White is this one: "As a mother of five, with another one on the way, my ironing board is always up."

Nouns and verbs are the two indispensable parts of writing. Without one of each, no group of words can be a sentence, since a sentence is, by definition, a group of words containing a subject (noun) and a predicate (verb); these strings of words begin with a capital letter, end with a period, and combine to make a complete thought which starts in the writer's head and then leaps to the reader's.

Must you write complete sentences each time, every time? Perish the thought. If your work consists only of fragments and floating clauses, the Grammar Police aren't going to come and take you away. Even William Strunk, that Mussolini of rhetoric, recognized the delicious pliability of language. "It is an old observation," he writes, "that the best writers sometimes disregard the rules of rhetoric." Yet he goes on to add this thought, which I urge you to consider: "Unless he is certain of doing well, [the writer] will probably do best to follow the rules."

The telling clause here is Unless he is certain of doing well. If you don't have a rudimentary grasp of how the parts of speech translate into coherent sentences, how can you be certain that you are doing well? How will you know if you're doing ill, for that matter? The answer, of course, is that you can't, you won't. One who does grasp the rudiments of grammar finds a comforting simplicity at its heart, where there need be only nouns, the words that name, and verbs, the words that act.

Take any noun, put it with any verb, and you have a sentence. It never fails. Rocks explode. Jane transmits. Mountains float. These are all perfect sentences. Many such thoughts make little rational sense, but even the stranger ones (Plums deify!) have a kind of poetic weight that's nice. The simplicity of noun-verb construction is useful—at the very least it can provide a safety net for your writing. Strunk and White caution against too many simple sentences in a row, but simple sentences provide a path you can follow when you fear getting lost in the tangles of rhetoric—all those restrictive and nonrestrictive clauses, those modifying phrases, those appositives and compound-complex sentences. If you start to freak out at the sight of such unmapped territory (unmapped by you, at least), just remind yourself that rocks explode, Jane transmits, mountains float, and plums deify. Grammar is . . . the pole you grab to get your thoughts up on their feet and walking.

Question 846

"Take any noun, put it with any verb, and you have a sentence. It never fails. Rocks explode. Jane transmits. Mountains float." None of the following statements can be seen as similar EXCEPT:

- A Take any vegetable, put some spices in it, and you have a dish
- B Take an apple tree, plant it in a field, and you have an orchard.
- C A group of nouns arranged in a row becomes a sentence.
- D A collection of people with the same sports equipment is a sports team.



The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Vocabulary used in speech or writing organizes itself in seven parts of speech (eight, if you count interjections such as Oh! and Gosh! and Fohgheddaboudit!). Communication composed of these parts of speech must be organized by rules of grammar upon which we agree. When these rules break down, confusion and misunderstanding result. ~~bad grammar produces bad sentences~~ My favorite example from Strunk and White is "one: 'As a mother of five, with another one on the way, my ironing board always up.'"

Nouns and verbs are the two indispensable parts of writing. Without one of each, no group of words can be a sentence, since a sentence is, by definition, a group of words containing a subject (noun) and a predicate (verb); these strings of words begin with a capital letter, end with a period, and combine to make a complete thought which starts in the writer's head and then leaps to the reader's.

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Question 847

Which one of the following quotes best captures the main concern of the passage?

- A "The telling clause here is Unless he is certain of doing well."
- B "Bad grammar produces bad sentences."
- C "Strunk and White caution against too many simple sentences in a row, but simple sentences provide a path you can follow when you fear getting lost in the tangles of rhetoric . . ."
- D "Nouns and verbs are the two indispensable parts of writing. Without one of each, no group of words can be a sentence . . ."

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Vocabulary used in speech or writing organizes itself in seven parts of speech (eight, if you count interjections such as Oh! and Gosh! and Fuhgeddaboutit!). Communication composed of these parts of speech must be organized by rules of grammar upon which we agree. When these rules break down, confusion and misunderstanding result. ~~Bad~~ grammar produces bad sentences. My favorite example from Strunk and White is "one: 'As a mother of five, with another one on the way, my ironing board always up'."

Nouns and verbs are the two indispensable parts of writing. Without one of each, no group of words can be a sentence, since a sentence is, by definition, a group of words containing a subject (noun) and a predicate (verb); these strings of words begin with a capital letter, end with a period, and combine to make a complete thought which starts in the writer's head and then leaps to the reader's.

Must you write complete sentences each time, every time? Perhaps not, the thought. If your work consists only of fragments and floating clauses, the Grammar Police aren't going to come and take you away. Even William Strunk, that Mussolini of rhetoric, recognized the delicious pliability of language. "It is an old observation," he writes, "that the best writers sometimes disregard the rules of rhetoric." Yet he goes on to add this thought, which I urge you to consider: "Unless he is certain of doing well, [the writer] will probably do best to follow the rules."

The telling clause here is Unless he is certain of doing well. If you don't have a rudimentary grasp of how the parts of speech translate into coherent sentences, how can you be certain that you are doing well? How will you

para ①: importance of

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 848

All of the following statements can be inferred from the passage EXCEPT that:

- A sentences do not always have to be complete.
- B the subject-predicate relation is the same as the noun-verb relation.
- C the primary purpose of grammar is to ensure that sentences remain simple.
- D "Grammar Police" is a metaphor for critics who focus on linguistic rules.

cracku

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para ①: importance of

 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 849

Inferring from the passage, the author could be most supportive of which one of the following practices?

- A The availability of language software that will standardise the rules of grammar as an aid to writers.
- B A campaign demanding that a writer's creative license should allow the breaking of grammatical rules.
- C A Creative Writing course that focuses on how to avoid the use of rhetoric.
- D The critique of standardised rules of punctuation and capitalisation.

cracku

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Question 850

Which one of the following statements, if false, could be seen as supporting the arguments in the passage?

- A An understanding of grammar helps a writer decide if she/he is writing well or not.
- B Regarding grammar, women writers tend to be more attentive to method and accuracy.
- C It has been observed that writers sometimes disregard the rules of rhetoric.
- D Perish the thought that complete sentences necessarily need nouns and verbs!

cracku

The passage below is accompanied by a set of questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Vocabulary used in speech or writing organizes itself in seven parts of speech (eight, if you count interjections such as Oh! and Gosh! and Fuhgeddaboudit!). Communication composed of these parts of speech must be organized by rules of grammar upon which we agree. When these rules break down, confusion and misunderstanding result. ~~bad~~ grammar produces bad sentences. My favorite example from Strunk and White is "one: 'As a mother of five, with another one on the way, my ironing board always up.'"

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para ①: importance of

VIDEO SOLUTION

Instructions

But are these conditions inevitably degenerative? A truly preventive medicine that focuses on the pre-ill, analyzing the metabolic errors which lead to clinical illness, might be able to correct them before the first symptom. Genetic risk factors are known for all the chronic degenerative diseases, and are important to the individuals who possess them. At the population level, however, migration studies confirm that these illnesses are linked for the most part to lifestyle factors – exercise, smoking and nutrition. Nutrition is the easiest of these to change, and the most versatile tool for affecting the metabolic changes needed to tilt the balance away from disease.

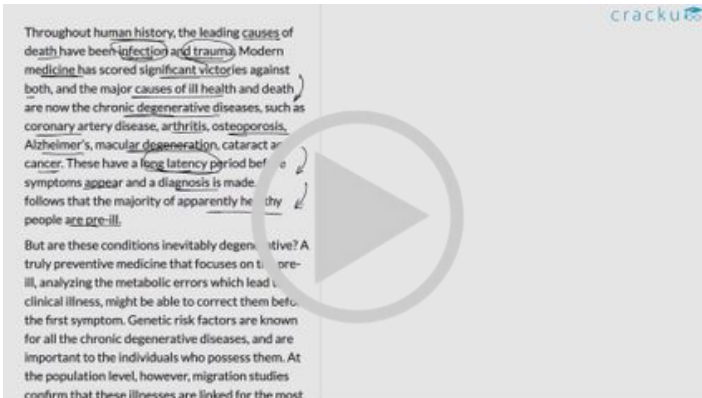
There is now considerable evidence that Type B malnutrition is a major cause of chronic degenerative diseases. If this is the case, then it is logical to treat such diseases not with drugs but with multiple micronutrient repletion, or 'pharmaco-nutrition'. This can take the form of pills and capsules – 'nutraceuticals', or food formats known as 'functional foods'. This approach has been neglected hitherto because it is relatively unprofitable for drug companies – the products are hard to patent – and it is a strategy which does not sit easily with modern medical interventionism. Over the last 100 years, the drug industry has invested huge sums in developing a range of subtle and powerful drugs to treat the many diseases we are subject to. Medical training is couched in pharmaceutical terms and this approach has provided us with an exceptional range of therapeutic tools in the treatment of disease and in acute medical emergencies. However, the pharmaceutical model has also created an unhealthy dependency culture, in which relatively few of us accept responsibility for maintaining our own health. Instead, we have handed over this responsibility to health professionals who know very little about health maintenance, or disease prevention.

Based on pharmaceutical thinking, most intervention studies have attempted to measure the impact of a single micronutrient on the incidence of disease. The classical approach says that if you give a compound formula to test subjects and obtain positive results, you cannot know which ingredient is exerting the benefit, so you must test each ingredient individually. But in the field of nutrition, this does not work. Each intervention on its own will hardly make enough difference to be measured. The best therapeutic response must therefore combine micronutrients to normalise our internal physiology. So do we need to analyse each individual's nutritional status and then tailor a formula specifically for him or her? While we do not have the resources to analyze millions of individual cases, there is no need to do so. The vast majority of people are consuming suboptimal amounts of most micronutrients, and most of the micronutrients concerned are very safe. Accordingly, a comprehensive and universal program of micronutrient support is probably the most cost-effective and safest way of improving the general health of the nation.

The author recommends micronutrient-repletion for large-scale treatment of chronic degenerative diseases because

- 513/732

- B micronutrient deficiency is the cause of these diseases.
- C it can overcome genetic risk factors.
- D it can compensate for other lifestyle factors.

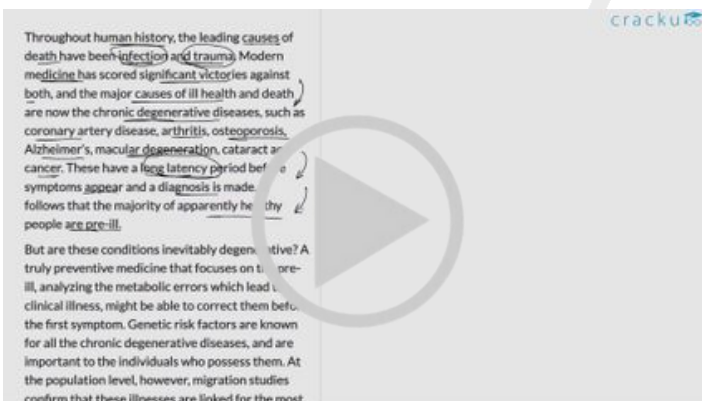


VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 852

Tailoring micronutrient-based treatment plans to suit individual deficiency profiles is not necessary because

- A it very likely to give inconsistent or negative results.
- B it is a classic pharmaceutical approach not suited to micronutrients.
- C most people are consuming suboptimal amounts of safe-to-consume micronutrients.
- D it is not cost effective to do so.



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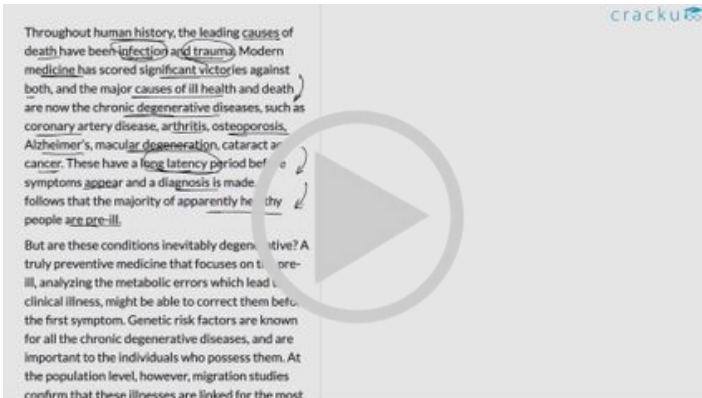


Question 853

Type-B malnutrition is a serious concern in developed countries because

- A developing countries mainly suffer from Type-A malnutrition.

- B it is a major contributor to illness and death.
- C pharmaceutical companies are not producing drugs to treat this condition.
- D national surveys on malnutrition do not include newer micronutrient groups.

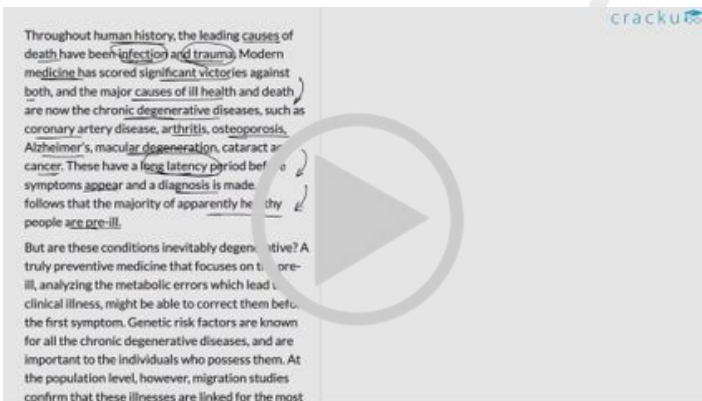


[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

Question 854

Why are a large number of apparently healthy people deemed pre-ill?

- A They may have chronic degenerative diseases.
- B They do not know their own genetic risk factors which predispose them to diseases.
- C They suffer from Type-B malnutrition.
- D There is a lengthy latency period associated with chronically degenerative diseases.



[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

Recently I spent several hours sitting under a tree in my garden with the social anthropologist William Ury, a Harvard University professor who specializes in the art of negotiation and wrote the bestselling book, Getting to Yes. He captivated me with his theory that tribalism protects people from their fear of rapid change. He explained that the pillars of tribalism that humans rely on for security would always counter any significant cultural or social change. In this way, he said, change is never allowed to happen too fast. Technology, for example, is a pillar of society. Ury believes that every time technology moves in a new or radical direction,

another pillar such as religion or nationalism will grow stronger in effect, the traditional and familiar will assume greater importance to compensate for the new and untested. In this manner, human tribes avoid rapid change that leaves people insecure and frightened.

But we have all heard that nothing is as permanent as change. Nothing is guaranteed. Pithy expressions, to be sure, but no more than clichés. As Ury says, people don't live that way from day-to-day. On the contrary, they actively seek certainty and stability. They want to know they will be safe.

Even so, we scare ourselves constantly with the idea of change. An IBM CEO once said: 'We only re-structure for a good reason, and if we haven't re-structured in a while, that's a good reason.' We are scared that competitors, technology and the consumer will put us out of business — so we have to change all the time just to stay alive. But if we asked our fathers and grandfathers, would they have said that they lived in a period of little change? Structure may not have changed much. It may just be the speed with which we do things.

Change is over-rated, anyway, consider the automobile. It's an especially valuable example, because the auto industry has spent tens of billions of dollars on research and product development in the last 100 years. Henry Ford's first car had a metal chassis with an internal combustion, gasoline-powered engine, four wheels with rubber tyres, a foot operated clutch assembly and brake system, a steering wheel, and four seats, and it could safely do 18 miles per hour. A hundred years and tens of thousands of research hours later, we drive cars with a metal chassis with an internal combustion, gasoline-powered engine, four wheels with rubber tyres, a foot operated clutch assembly and brake system, a steering wheel, four seats - and the average speed in London in 2001 was 17.5 miles per hour!

That's not a hell of a lot of return for the money. Ford evidently doesn't have much to teach us about change. The fact that they're still manufacturing cars is not proof that Ford Motor Co. is a sound organization, just proof that it takes very large companies to make cars in great quantities — making for an almost impregnable entry barrier.

Fifty years after the development of the jet engine, planes are also little changed. They've grown bigger, wider and can carry more people. But those are incremental, largely cosmetic changes.

Taken together, this lack of real change has come to man that in travel — whether driving or flying — time and technology have not combined to make things much better. The safety and design have of course accompanied the times and the new volume of cars and flights, but nothing of any significance has changed in the basic assumptions of the final product.

At the same time, moving around in cars or aero-planes becomes less and less efficient all the time. Not only has there been no great change, but also both forms of transport have deteriorated as more people clamour to use them. The same is true for telephones, which took over hundred years to become mobile or photographic film, which also required an entire century to change.

The only explanation for this is anthropological. Once established in calcified organizations, humans do two things: sabotage changes that might render people dispensable, and ensure industry-wide emulation. In the 1960s, German auto companies developed plans to scrap the entire combustion engine for an electrical design. (The same existed in the 1970s in Japan, and in the 1980s in France.) So for 40 years we might have been free of the wasteful and ludicrous dependence on fossil fuels. Why didn't it go anywhere? Because auto executives understood pistons and carburettors, and would be loath to cannibalize their expertise, along with most of their factories

Question 855

Which of the following views does the author fully support in the passage?

- A** Nothing is as permanent as change.
- B** Change is always rapid.
- C** More money spent on innovation leads to more rapid change.
- D** Over decades, structural change has been incremental.

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But we have all heard that nothing is as permanent

VIDEO SOLUTION



Question 856

According to the passage, the reason why we continue to be dependent on fossil fuels is that:

- A Auto executives did not wish to change.
- B No alternative fuels were discovered.
- C Change in technology was not easily possible
- D German, Japanese and French companies could not come up with new technologies.

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VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 857

Which of the following best describes one of the main ideas discussed in the passage?

- A Rapid change is usually welcomed in society.
- B Industry is not as innovative as it is made out to be.
- C We should have less change than what we have now.
- D Competition spurs companies into radical innovation.

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But we have all heard that nothing is as permanent

VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 858

According to the above passage, which of the following statements is true?

- A Executives of automobile companies are inefficient and ludicrous.
- B The speed at which an automobile is driven in a city has not changed much in a century.
- C Anthropological factors have fostered innovation in automobiles by promoting use of new technologies.
- D Further innovation in jet engines has been more than incremental.

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Answers

1.C	2.C	3.C	4.C	5.B	6.D	7.D	8.C
9.B	10.A	11.B	12.B	13.A	14.D	15.D	16.C
17.C	18.C	19.C	20.D	21.D	22.C	23.C	24.A
25.D	26.C	27.B	28.A	29.B	30.C	31.B	32.D
33.C	34.C	35.A	36.D	37.D	38.C	39.D	40.A
41.C	42.A	43.C	44.C	45.D	46.B	47.C	48.B
49.D	50.D	51.D	52.D	53.A	54.D	55.B	56.B
57.C	58.C	59.D	60.A	61.C	62.B	63.D	64.B
65.C	66.C	67.A	68.D	69.A	70.C	71.C	72.B
73.B	74.C	75.B	76.D	77.A	78.A	79.B	80.D
81.A	82.B	83.C	84.D	85.C	86.A	87.A	88.A
89.D	90.D	91.A	92.A	93.C	94.A	95.D	96.D
97.D	98.B	99.B	100.C	101.A	102.C	103.D	104.B
105.B	106.A	107.B	108.D	109.B	110.D	111.C	112.B
113.C	114.C	115.D	116.C	117.D	118.B	119.D	120.D
121.B	122.B	123.A	124.B	125.A	126.D	127.C	128.A
129.D	130.D	131.B	132.A	133.A	134.B	135.B	136.D
137.C	138.E	139.B	140.B	141.D	142.A	143.A	144.C
145.E	146.D	147.D	148.C	149.A	150.C	151.B	152.B
153.C	154.C	155.D	156.B	157.B	158.B	159.B	160.A
161.C	162.A	163.A	164.A	165.C	166.C	167.C	168.E
169.B	170.C	171.A	172.C	173.D	174.D	175.D	176.A
177.D	178.C	179.A	180.C	181.D	182.B	183.C	184.C
185.D	186.B	187.D	188.A	189.C	190.A	191.B	192.D
193.A	194.D	195.C	196.A	197.C	198.B	199.D	200.B
201.B	202.D	203.A	204.B	205.D	206.A	207.A	208.C
209.B	210.C	211.A	212.D	213.C	214.B	215.B	216.C
217.A	218.D	219.D	220.B	221.C	222.C	223.D	224.A
225.D	226.A	227.B	228.D	229.A	230.C	231.B	232.D
233.C	234.A	235.A	236.A	237.A	238.B	239.D	240.B
241.C	242.B	243.A	244.B	245.C	246.A	247.A	248.C
249.B	250.C	251.D	252.E	253.B	254.A	255.A	256.C
257.D	258.A	259.B	260.C	261.D	262.A	263.B	264.C
265.A	266.D	267.B	268.B	269.C	270.D	271.C	272.C
273.D	274.C	275.B	276.C	277.D	278.A	279.C	280.B
281.D	282.A	283.D	284.A	285.B	286.A	287.C	288.B
289.A	290.B	291.A	292.D	293.B	294.A	295.D	296.A
297.C	298.B	299.A	300.D	301.D	302.B	303.C	304.A
305.C	306.B	307.A	308.A	309.C	310.A	311.B	312.C
313.C	314.D	315.A	316.C	317.D	318.E	319.A	320.B
321.C	322.D	323.B	324.D	325.C	326.D	327.A	328.D
329.D	330.B	331.B	332.D	333.D	334.C	335.C	336.C

689.A	690.B	691.C	692.B	693.D	694.B	695.D	696.C
697.A	698.D	699.B	700.B	701.A	702.B	703.C	704.D
705.D	706.A	707.A	708.B	709.A	710.B	711.B	712.D
713.D	714.D	715.C	716.D	717.C	718.A	719.C	720.C
721.A	722.B	723.D	724.A	725.C	726.D	727.D	728.B
729.A	730.A	731.C	732.C	733.D	734.B	735.C	736.C
737.A	738.C	739.B	740.A	741.D	742.C	743.C	744.C
745.B	746.B	747.D	748.D	749.B	750.C	751.D	752.A
753.A	754.B	755.B	756.D	757.A	758.D	759.A	760.C
761.A	762.B	763.A	764.B	765.B	766.B	767.C	768.A
769.A	770.B	771.C	772.D	773.D	774.B	775.A	776.D
777.D	778.B	779.C	780.C	781.D	782.C	783.A	784.A
785.A	786.B	787.D	788.B	789.A	790.B	791.C	792.A
793.A	794.B	795.D	796.C	797.A	798.C	799.A	800.A
801.B	802.B	803.D	804.C	805.D	806.D	807.A	808.D
809.D	810.B	811.D	812.C	813.A	814.C	815.D	816.B
817.A	818.C	819.B	820.D	821.C	822.A	823.C	824.B
825.D	826.B	827.A	828.C	829.C	830.B	831.C	832.B
833.D	834.B	835.B	836.A	837.C	838.B	839.A	840.D
841.D	842.D	843.B	844.A	845.A	846.A	847.B	848.C
849.A	850.D	851.B	852.C	853.B	854.A	855.D	856.A
857.B	858.B						

Explanations

1. C

Refer to the following lines of the third para: "Patterson's account of the leonine reign of terror, *The Man-Eaters of Tsavo*, was an international best seller when published in 1907. Still in print, the book has made Tsavo's lions notorious."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

2. C

Option c satisfies the criteria the most. If cave lions are far less violent, then Tsavo would also be less violent whereas in the paragraph, Tsavo lions are shown to be more violent.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

3. C

Refer to the line just behind the given phrase: "The scientists had partly suspected that the maneless males were adolescents mistaken for adults by amateur observers. Now they knew better." This implies option c.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

4. C

All other choices are there in 4th and 5th paragraph: Refer to these lines

"But tales of their savagery and wiliness don't all come from sensationalist authors looking to make a buck. Tsavo lions are generally larger than lions elsewhere, enabling them to take down the predominant prey animal in Tsavo, the Cape buffalo, one of the strongest, most aggressive animals of Earth. The buffalo don't give up

easily: They often kill or severely injure an attacking lion, and a wounded lion might be more likely to turn to cattle and humans for food.

And other prey is less abundant in Tsavo than in other traditional lion haunts. A hungry lion is more likely to attack humans. Safari guides and Kenya Wildlife Service rangers tell of lions attacking Land Rovers, raiding camps, stalking tourists. Tsavo is a tough neighborhood, they say, and it breeds tougher lions."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

5. B

*"Although many philosophers in the past **have suspected** one could abstract the laws of life and apply them elsewhere, it wasn't until the complexity of computers and human-made systems became as complicated as living things that it was possible to prove this."*

Option A can be easily rejected from the above excerpt from the passage. Also, it can be inferred that now(not before), since the complexity of computers and human-made systems are comparable, the logic of Bios can be applied to machines. Although option C seems to convey the same meaning, it generalises the complexity and is a distorted inference.

The author has nowhere mentioned or implied in the passage that purposeful design represents the pinnacle of scientific expertise in the service of human betterment and civilisational progress. Thus, option D can also be rejected.

"Genetic engineering is precisely what cattle breeders do when they select better strains of Holsteins, only bioengineers employ more precise and powerful control. While carrot and milk cow breeders had to rely on diffuse organic evolution, modern genetic engineers can use directed artificial evolution—purposeful design—which greatly accelerates improvements."

From the above excerpt from the penultimate paragraph, it can be inferred that although genetic engineering has less control over the products than bioengineering, they both try to evolve the product artificially. Thus, option B can be inferred from the passage.

Thus, the correct option is B.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



6. D

The starting two paragraphs discuss the complexity of the biosphere and how it is impossible to build a thinking device without bio-logic. In the next paragraphs, the author describes how with the increasing complexity of human-made systems(not until it was comparable to living things), it has become possible to transfer these traits into mechanical systems. Examples of these are bioengineering and genetic engineering. Then in the concluding paragraph, the author discusses about the convergence of these two logics(Biologic and Techno logic).

Options B and C do not talk about the conclusion of the passage(convergence of the logics), and hence can be eliminated. Out of options A and D, we should select the option with bio-logic and techno-logic instead of carrots and cows, because the broader idea is about bio and techno, not carrots and cows.

Thus, the correct option is D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

7. D

*"The overlap of the mechanical and the lifelike increases year by year. **Part of this bionic convergence is a matter of words.** The meanings of "mechanical" and "life" are both stretching until all complicated things can be perceived as machines, and all self-sustaining machines can be perceived as alive."*

From the above line, the author tries to show the increasing similarities between 'mechanical' and 'lifelike' with the passage of time. He states that this increase in similarities will continue till the meanings and the perception of the words become synonymous.

Option A: This option states the opposite of what the author tried to convey and hence is not the correct option.

Option B: This option is distorted and can be rejected on the same grounds as option A.

Option C: This is a distorted inference, and the author did not use the above statement to show the meeting grounds of 'genetic engineering' and 'mechanical engineering'. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option D: This option aptly expresses the point made by the author in the last paragraph, and hence is the correct option.

Thus, the correct option is D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

8. C

"Yet beyond semantics, two concrete trends are happening: (1) Human-made things are behaving more lifelike, and (2) Life is becoming more engineered. The apparent veil between the organic and the manufactured has crumpled to reveal that the two really are, and have always been, of one being."

The main argument made by the author in the last paragraph is regarding the increasing similarities between manufactured and organic(lifelike) reality. According to the author, the growing similarities(because of the scientific advances) have distorted the understanding of the realities and have made us think that perhaps these two are and have always been the same.

Option A: This is a distorted inference. It is not that the Organic reality has crumpled under the veil of manufacturing; instead, their meanings are converging mutually. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option B: This is again a distorted inference. It is not the organic veil that has crumpled; instead, it is the apparent veil. Similarly, in the second half of the option, the organic reality is replaced with the apparent reality.

Option C: This option aptly expresses the main point of the author and is the correct option.

Option D: The author nowhere stated or implied this, and hence this option can be easily eliminated.

Thus, the correct option is D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

9. B

The author uses the Emory University experiment to show that acquired characteristics can be passed on from one generation to another. In the second paragraph, the author explains how the acquired characteristics (fear in this case) should not have been passed according to the theory of natural selection.

Option A is too narrow in scope. The author uses fear as an example of acquired characteristic. Therefore, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

10. A

The main message of the passage is that natural selection cannot fully explain evolution. Therefore, any argument that attacks this message is most likely to weaken the author's arguments. A study indicating the sole influence of natural selection and inheritance on evolution will question the legitimacy of the theory of 'epigenetic inheritance' and hence, option A is the right answer.



11. B

The author mentions "All these tugs represent the influence of developmental factors, including epigenetics, antibodies and hormones passed on by parents, as well as the ecological legacies and culture they bequeath".

Option A misses 'developmental factors' and 'antibodies'.

Option C misses 'ecological legacies'.

Option D misses 'developmental factors'.

Option B is the most comprehensive one among the given options and hence, it is the right answer.

12. B

The primary purpose of the passage is not to establish the scientific superiority of Wilson's theory over that of Darwin's and Mendel's theories. The author begins the passage with an example that the theory of natural selection fails to explain. Then, he explains about 'Epigenetic inheritance' and elaborates on how epigenetic inheritance explains the transmission of acquired characteristics. Therefore, the author's main argument is that Darwin's theory cannot fully explain evolution and hence, option B is the right answer.

13. A

The controversy became "larger" because the 1982 draft act was not seen as an isolated policy mistake, but as a continuation of an older, flawed framework. The passage clearly says that *"the draft act was closely modelled on its predecessor, the Forest Act of 1878."* This comparison expanded the debate from the immediate provisions of the new act to the entire historical orientation of forest policy. Critics were upset because the 1878 Act was based on *"a usurpation of rights of ownership by the colonial state,"* focused on *"revenue generation and commercial exploitation,"* and left out villagers who had long claimed rights to the forests. Since the 1982 draft act followed this colonial law, it seemed to repeat the same approach of central control and strict rules.

Options (b) and (c) describe why the act was opposed, but they do not explain why the issue widened into a broader historical and structural debate. Option (d) is incomplete, since the larger controversy was not just about commercial exploitation but about how the colonial mechanisms still continued to shape post-Independence forest policy. Hence, option (a) best captures why a raging controversy became a larger one.

14. D

Let us look at each option one by one.

Option (a) would weaken the passage because it shifts responsibility for deforestation onto tribal communities. In the passage, peasants and tribals are presented as groups whose rights were curtailed by forest policy, and not as the primary cause of environmental damage.

Option (b) would weaken the argument too, as it contradicts a key claim made by the author. The passage clearly states that the colonial takeover of forest rights *"had little precedent in precolonial history."* If Indian rulers had already denied access to forests, this claim would not stand.

Option (c) undermines the historical foundation of the narrative. The passage links the emergence of forest laws to heavy timber demand from railway expansion. If timber was instead imported, the stated reason for creating the forest department would no longer hold.

Option (d) does not weaken the passage because it actually aligns with what the author is already arguing. The passage is critical of colonial forest administration and shows how it sidelined the rights of people living in forest areas. If German forestry experts were known to violate indigenous rights, that would only support this criticism, not challenge it. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

15. D

The passage indicates that some reforms in forest policy have already taken place. It notes that the government no longer treats forests as a source of revenue and has stopped “ecologically hazardous practices such as the clearfelling of natural forests,” which rules out option (C) since ecological concerns are clearly being recognised. The continued operation of the 1878 Act and the government’s reluctance to abandon state control show that the state’s claim to forest land remains recognised, ruling out option (A). There is also no mention of a complete ban on deforestation; rather, the focus is on regulating harmful practices, so option (B) does not fit either. What the passage emphasises as still missing is the government’s refusal to accept the main demand of critics: “handing over areas of degraded forests to individuals and communities for afforestation.” This directly points to the continued exclusion of local people from forest cultivation and management. Hence, the reform yet to occur is option (D), involving local people in forest cultivation.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



16. C

Let's compare each option with what the passage actually states.

Option (a) is common to both. The passage says the 1982 draft act led to a “raging controversy,” and the 1878 Forest Act was passed after a “bitter and prolonged debate within the colonial bureaucracy.” This means both faced debate and opposition.

Option (b) is also shared. The 1982 draft act was criticised for being “closely modelled” on the 1878 Act, which was based on a colonial “usurpation of rights of ownership.” This shows both were viewed as following the same colonial-style control.

Option (c) is not common to both. The passage links large-scale deforestation to the nineteenth century, especially railway expansion before the 1878 Act. In contrast, forest officials said the 1982 draft act aimed to “stop the continuing deforestation,” not cause it.

Option (d) is clearly common to both. The passage criticises both the colonial act and post-Independence policy for keeping “the principle of state monopoly over forest land,” which the government has continued to uphold.

Therefore, option (c) is the feature not shared by both acts.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

17. C

“As the lupine population of Europe spreads westwards, with occasional reports of wolves seen closer to urban areas, expect to hear of more clashes between farmers and those who celebrate the predators’ return. Farmers’ losses are real, but are not the only economic story. Tourist venues, such as parks where wolves are kept and the animals’ spread is discussed, also generate income and jobs in rural areas.”



21. D

Let us evaluate each option individually.

Option A follows from the passage. The author explains that in physics, different theories are “incompatible” yet share a common structure of starting from basic postulates and reasoning outward. The passage then says ethical theories are similar and also diverge. This supports the idea that ethics can remain plural rather than “close on a single comprehensive framework.”

Option B is also supported. The passage warns that moral judgement draws on “intuition, historical awareness and context” and that formalising ethics risks “flattening its most essential features.” It even says AI could “strip morality of the very depth that makes ethical reflection possible.” This matches the claim that machines would mirror human limits instead of exceeding them.

Option C can reasonably be inferred as well. At the start, AI is described as appealing because it seems “unburdened by emotion, prejudice or inconsistency.” But the passage immediately questions whether this amounts to real moral understanding without “lived experience.” That is exactly the tension this option describes.

Option D does not follow from the passage. The author never predicts convergence on one ethical system. In fact, the physics analogy is used to show that even with formalisation, multiple theories can coexist. The passage also repeatedly insists that context remains central to ethics, not unnecessary.

So the statement that cannot be inferred from the passage is option (D).

22. C

The passage makes three main points. First, it explains why people find an impersonal AI moral judge appealing. Next, it raises a key concern: moral judgment relies on intuition, history, and context, so turning ethics into rules might remove that depth. The passage also notes that ethics has always included some formal structure, using examples like utilitarianism. It explains with a physics analogy that formal systems can exist together without merging into one final theory. The main idea is not to reject or endorse these systems, but to highlight the tension and variety among them. Option C sums this up best. It shows why an impersonal AI judge is appealing, points out the risk that making rules can “erode case-sensitive judgement,” and still recognizes that reasoning based on principles can be applied widely. By mentioning the physics analogy to explain structured variety, it matches the passage’s idea that ethical systems, like physical theories, can be formal but still different from each other.

Option A goes further than the passage by saying it “rejects formal methods in principle” and that AI should never be used in courts, medicine, or diplomacy “under any conditions.” The passage does not do this; it talks about formal ethical systems and why AI might work for them. Option B misunderstands by saying that codified systems keep case details and that the physics analogy means we will end up with one main framework. In fact, the passage warns about losing nuance and uses the physics example to show that different theories can exist together, not that they will merge. Option D is also not accurate because it treats copying human moral judgment with AI as clear progress. The passage keeps questioning whether copying without depth is really better, so this option is too one-sided.

23. C

The question asks which position is most opposite to utilitarianism. According to the passage, utilitarianism is about acting to maximize overall wellbeing or total welfare. The main concern is the total amount of benefit, not who receives it or if some people are worse off, as long as the total outcome is greater. Seen against that, option C moves in the opposite direction. A prioritarian approach does not aim to maximize total welfare. Instead, it gives more importance to helping those who are worst off, even if this does not lead to the highest overall well-being. This challenges the utilitarian focus on total outcomes, making it the closest opposite.

The other options do not match. Option A ranks policies by "overall social welfare," which is still utilitarian. Option B seems rule-based, but it also talks about "broadest societal benefit," so it still uses utilitarian thinking. Option D focuses on "highest total benefit," even though it calls itself deontological, so it is not truly the opposite of utilitarianism. Therefore, the correct answer is option C.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

24. A

The passage says that, like physics, ethics has multiple formal theories, each starting from basic principles, and that AI can reason from such fixed starting points in complex cases. For this comparison to be practically useful, there has to be some way to decide which ethical starting point applies in a given situation. Let us look at each option one by one.

Option A fits the passage. If different ethical frameworks apply to different kinds of cases, then there must be a principled way to decide which framework is relevant before reasoning begins. Otherwise, AI would not know which "starting points" to use. This matches the physics analogy, where different theories apply to different domains.

Option B does not fit. The passage never suggests that real cases fall neatly into one framework with no overlap. In fact, it stresses complexity and divergence across ethical theories, not clean separation.

Option C directly contradicts the passage. The physics analogy is used to show that multiple theories can coexist without being unified into one master framework. This option assumes exactly the opposite.

Option D also conflicts with the text. The passage explicitly notes that ethical theories can diverge and justify similar actions in different ways, so it cannot be assumed that they all produce the same recommendation. Hence, the assumption that must hold is option (A).

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

25. D

*"For their part Ghosh, Gurnah, Collen and even Conrad reference a different set of histories and geographies than the ones most commonly found in fiction in English. **Those [commonly found ones] are mostly centred in Europe or the US, assume a background of Christianity and whiteness, and mention places like Paris and New York.**"*

The passage argues that the novels discussed in "Writing Ocean Worlds" diverge from the common representations found in English fiction, which often center on Europe or the US, assume a background of Christianity and whiteness, and mention places like Paris and New York. If **Option D** were true, it would support the passage's claim rather than weaken it. Therefore, Option D is the correct answer.

Through the passage, the author claims that the Indian Ocean novels provide a more realistic picture of the Indian Ocean space, particularly in the representation of Africa. The author claims that the depiction is more authentic and free from Eurocentricity that is seen in other novels.

Option A weakens the passage by contradicting these claims and suggesting that the depiction of Africa is influenced by postcolonial nostalgia.

Option B weakens the passage by suggesting a potential bias or negative stereotyping in the portrayal of Africa in Indian Ocean novels.

Option C weakens the author's claim by disputing that there is eurocentric perspective in other novels.



26. C

Option C is the correct answer because it contradicts the idea of "remapping" discussed in the passage. The passage emphasizes that the novels under consideration challenge the common representations found in English fiction, particularly those centered in the West. Option C, suggesting that cosmopolitanism originated in the West and traveled to the East through globalization, aligns with the conventional Western-centric narrative rather than the passage's argument of reshaping perspectives and centralizing the interconnected global south, particularly the Indian Ocean world, as a key space in the reimagined literary landscape.

Option A aligns with the passage's discussion of the novels focusing on the Indian Ocean world, contributing to the "remapping" beyond national concerns.

Option B aligns with the passage's emphasis on the interconnected Indian Ocean world, challenging the Eurocentric perspective on trade and commerce.

Option D supports the passage's claim that historical evidence suggests that globalization first appeared in the Indian Ocean, contributing to the "remapping" of the world's historical and geographical perspectives.

27. B

Options A, C and D have the following format World/Novels : Characteristic of that particular world/novel.

Option B is the odd one out as the characteristic of Border-crossing does not belong to the Postcolonial novels world.

From the passage, we can infer that the Indian Ocean novels were "outward-looking - full of movement, border-crossing and south-south interconnection". At the same time, they showcased elements of the global south like Slavery, Forced Migration etc. Hence, A and C showcase valid elements of the Indian Ocean Novels World.

On the other hand, postcolonial novels were usually [concerned with] national questions, land-focused and inward-looking. They featured anti-colonial nationalism. Hence, option D is also a valid Theme:Characteristic combination.

However, we note that Border-crossing is an element of the Indian Ocean novel world and not the Postcolonial novel world. Hence, option B is not a valid combination and thus is the odd one out.

28. A

The passage focuses on the interconnectedness within the global south in the context of the Indian Ocean world's migration networks. It emphasizes historical connections between the coasts of East Africa, the Arab coasts, and South and East Asia. The passage does not specifically highlight migration networks connecting the Indian Ocean world with the global north. Instead, it underscores the significance of geographical location, religious histories, and commercial interactions within the region, pointing to a more localized and regional perspective on migration. Therefore, **Option A** is not true according to the passage. Additionally, the passage mentioned the Indian Ocean as "*a term used to describe the very long-lasting connections among the coasts of East Africa, the Arab coasts, and South and East Asia.*" and not north and south.

Option B is correct as the passage mentions that for much of history, travel by sea in the Indian Ocean was easier than by land, emphasizing the importance of geographical location.

Option C is correct as the passage indicates that the novels in the book draw on and shape a wider sense of Indian Ocean space through themes, images, metaphors, and language, including religious and commercial aspects.

Option D is correct as the passage notes that migration is often portrayed as abandonment rather than adventure, indicating a complex and ambivalent nature of the migration experience in the Indian Ocean world.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

29. **B**

The passage does not explicitly mention the criticism of scholars for having outdated interpretations of past cultural and historical phenomena. The primary focus of the author's criticism, as discussed in the passage, centers on scholars' tendencies to dismiss geographic factors, label geographic explanations as deterministic, and associate geographic analyses with past racism. Therefore Option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

30. **C**

Option C cannot be directly inferred from the passage. The passage does discuss the influence of both geographic factors (such as biogeography) and non-geographic factors (culture, history, individual decisions) on human phenomena. However, the passage does not explicitly quantify or compare the prevalence of these influences by stating that *"most human phenomena result from culture and individual choice."*

Option A: The author discusses the development of warm fur clothes among the Inuit living north of the Arctic Circle and asserts that it was not due to a specific individual decision or historical contingency in 1783 but rather a response to environmental factors.

Option B: The author discusses the current state of agricultural practices in Australia, stating that the crops and domestic animals that make Australia a food and wool exporter today are all non-native species (mainly Eurasian) brought to Australia by overseas colonists. The use of the term "non-native" implies a change in agricultural practices from what was originally present in the Australian continent.

Option D: The author mentions that some geographic explanations advanced a century ago were racist, causing all geographic explanations to become tainted by racist associations in the minds of many scholars.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



31. **B**

Option B is the correct answer because the passage uses examples like the Inuit and Aboriginal Australians to illustrate the influence of physical circumstances, particularly environmental factors, on human behavior and cultural practices. The discussion about the development of warm fur clothes among the Inuit due to the Arctic environment and the absence of indigenous farming in Aboriginal Australia because of the lack of domesticable native species underscores how physical circumstances dictate certain aspects of human behavior and shape cultural adaptations. Therefore, Option B accurately captures the main idea conveyed by the examples provided in the passage.

Option A is not explicitly emphasized in the passage; the focus is more on how environmental factors influence behavior and cultures.

Option C: The passage doesn't explicitly highlight self-sufficiency but rather the impact of specific environmental factors on the development of societies.

Option D is not entirely incorrect, but Option B more precisely captures the emphasis on physical circumstances dictating human behavior and cultures in the context of the examples provided in the passage.

32. D

Option D is not explicitly presented by the author as a reason why non-geographers disregard geographic influences. The author suggests that scholars often react negatively to explanations involving a geographic role by denouncing "geographic determinism." However, the specific idea of dismissal is not explicitly outlined in the passage.

The other options on the other hand, can be inferred from the passage:

Option A can be inferred from the following lines: *"One reason is that some geographic explanations advanced a century ago were racist, thereby causing all geographic explanations to become tainted."*

Option B can be inferred from the following lines: *"Another reason for reflex rejection of geographic explanations is that historians have a tradition, in their discipline, of stressing the role of contingency (a favorite word among historians) based on individual decisions and chance."*

Option C can be inferred from the last paragraph of the passage: *"Geographic explanations usually depend on detailed technical facts of geography and other fields of scholarship . . . Most historians and economists don't acquire that detailed knowledge as part of the professional training."*

33. C

The passage emphasizes that Marshall Sahlins's main goal in writing his essay was to hold a mirror to an acquisitive society (contemporary economic life and bourgeois individualism). The essay accomplishes this by providing examples of foraging societies that made real choices to prioritize values such as leisure, mobility, and freedom over material accumulation. Sahlins contrasts the Zen road to affluence, where affluence is achieved by wanting less, with the capitalist pursuit of wealth through material production and consumerism. Therefore, Sahlins's goal, as portrayed in the passage, aligns with the idea of presenting examples of communities that have successfully chosen non-materialistic paths as a critique of acquisitive societies. So, Option C is the correct answer.

Option A: While Sahlins's essay acknowledges growing inequality and social hierarchies resulting from the Neolithic Revolution, it is more focused on contrasting foraging societies with contemporary economic life.

Option B: The primary emphasis is on showcasing foraging societies' choices and values rather than asserting a progressive degeneration of society.

Option D: Even though Sahlins's essay critiques aspects of contemporary economic views, its primary focus is not explicitly countering Galbraith's pessimistic view but rather presenting alternative possibilities through examples of non-materialistic societies.

34. C

Option C is the correct answer because the passage uses the example of Tanzania's Hadza community to illustrate that forager communities, like the Hadza, do not conform to a simple narrative of human diversity or victimhood. Instead, they actively make choices about their way of life. The passage mentions that the Hadza, despite being surrounded by farmers, knew they had alternatives and consciously rejected them. This example serves to emphasize that forager communities are not constrained by ignorance about alternatives; rather, their lifestyles derive from their own choices. Therefore, Option C accurately captures the essence of the Hadza illustration in the passage.

Option A: The passage doesn't specifically highlight the survival techniques of hunter-gatherer communities into contemporary times, but rather emphasizes their choices and values.

Option B: The passage doesn't discuss the Hadza community in the context of agrarian practices in contiguous communities, making this option irrelevant to the illustration.

Option D: The passage does not suggest that the Hadza community coexisted with vastly different ways of living and working for centuries

 VIDEO SOLUTION

35. A

"Viewed in today's context, of course, not every aspect of the essay has aged well. While acknowledging the violence of colonialism, racism, and dispossession, it does not thematize them as heavily as we might today."

Option A is the correct answer because the passage explicitly mentions that, when viewed in today's context, not every aspect of Sahlins's essay has aged well, and it acknowledges that the essay does not thematize issues like racism, colonialism, and dispossession as heavily as might be expected today. The term " cursory treatment " suggests that the essay provides only a brief or superficial examination of the effects of racism and colonialism on societies, and the passage criticizes this aspect of the essay for not giving these important issues more comprehensive attention.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



36. D

The passage explicitly mentions that Sahlins's essay, "The Original Affluent Society," brought a critical perspective to contemporary consumerism and inequality, echoing the themes found in John Kenneth Galbraith's work, "The Affluent Society." The passage notes that Sahlins's essay contrasts the values of foraging societies with the capitalist pursuit of wealth, and it suggests that the essay complements Galbraith's skeptical portrait of postwar prosperity and inequality. Therefore, Option D accurately reflects the information presented in the passage regarding the relationship between Sahlins's views and Galbraith's criticism of contemporary society.

The passage does not suggest that Galbraith's theories refute Sahlins's thesis but rather highlights their complementarity (Option A) nor does it focus on contrasting foragers' ways of living with Galbraith's views on contemporary growth paths (Option B).

The passage does not document the influence of Galbraith's views on Sahlins's analysis; instead, it emphasizes how Sahlins's essay complements Galbraith's critical perspective on contemporary society. Therefore Option C is incorrect too.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

37. D

The primary purpose of patrimony laws is stated in the passage as being "aimed at protecting cultural property," implying that the intention behind these laws is to preserve and safeguard a country's cultural heritage. However, the paradox lies in the unintended consequence of these laws, as highlighted in the passage. The author argues that, despite the good intentions of protecting cultural property, the strict implementation of patrimony laws has led to a reduction in new archaeological discoveries. This reduction is attributed to diminished incentives for foreign entities, such as governments, NGOs, and educational institutions, to invest in overseas archaeological exploration. In other words, the very laws designed to protect cultural property end up hindering the process of making new archaeological discoveries. This underscores the tension between preserving cultural heritage and the potential negative impact on the exploration and understanding of that heritage. Option D aptly captures this point.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

38. C

The central idea of the passage is that strict cultural property laws, although popular, may reduce incentives for foreign entities to invest in overseas archaeological exploration. The passage suggests that this reduction in incentives could be detrimental to archaeological discoveries and, consequently, to the tourism and cultural pride of source countries.

Among the given options, the only statement that would undermine the central idea is presented in Option C - it introduces the idea that there is external financial support for archaeological research in these countries. If true, then the lack of discoveries could potentially be attributed to a completely different factor/variable that the author might have failed to account for.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

39. **D**

The author suggests that archaeological sites are important to some source countries because they can reap benefits from new archaeological discoveries, and one of the mentioned benefits is that such discoveries typically increase tourism. The passage emphasizes the economic and cultural advantages associated with tourism, which includes enhancing cultural pride and potentially attracting visitors to explore archaeological sites. Option D correctly presents this point. None of the other choices can be considered as valid inferences.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

40. **A**

Let us examine the given choices -

Option A: The passage emphasises the benefits of international collaboration and suggests that source countries could reap the benefits of new archaeological discoveries through such collaboration. Funding institutes in other countries to undertake exploration may not align with this perspective, as it involves outsourcing the exploration rather than fostering collaboration within the source country. Thus, Option A is an unlikely recommendation.

Option B: This aligns with the idea of international collaboration and suggests that the author might advise source countries to permit foreign analysis and exhibition of archaeological finds. The passage does suggest that strict cultural property laws may hinder opportunities to hold, display, and study uncovered artefacts.

Option C: We are told that strict cultural property laws might reduce incentives for foreign governments, NGOs, and educational institutions to invest in overseas exploration. Therefore, the author would support a proactive approach to encourage these entities to invest in expeditions in source countries.

Option D: The passage highlights China's shift in strategy from strict cultural property laws to embracing collaborative international archaeological research. The author suggests that this approach has led to an increase in archaeological discoveries and recognition. Hence, this would be a relevant recommendation.

Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



41. **C**

Based on the discussion, the option that is NOT associated with Pinker's view of rational thinking (as well as that of the ancient Greek philosophers) is Option C - the passage suggests that while sequential reasoning is valuable, many profound human achievements come from moments of epiphany or insight rather than solely from conscious, sequential reasoning.

In relation to this thought, we are told that the emphasis on rational thought involves an understanding of the gaps in one's own knowledge [Option A] and also 'arriving at independent conclusions' [Option D]: {"Even Plato's Socrates – who anticipated many of Pinker's points by nearly 2,500 years, showing the virtue of knowing what you do not know and examining all premises in arguments, not simply trusting speakers' authority or charisma..."}.

Towards the end of the passage, we are informed of an ethical and moral dimension [Option B] to rationality, which the author asserts that Pinker considers but does not elaborate on.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

42. A

In the case of Kekulé, the discovery of the benzene structure reportedly came to him in a dream, showcasing how creative insights can emerge unexpectedly and unconsciously. Similarly, Mozart's symphonies, considered masterpieces of classical music, are often seen as products of his musical genius and creative intuition. Therefore, the examples support the notion that groundbreaking achievements in both scientific and artistic domains may involve moments of inspiration, intuition, or epiphany, challenging the idea that all significant accomplishments are the result of conscious and sequential reasoning. This aligns with the broader point that while conscious reasoning is valuable, there are also subconscious and intuitive processes at play in the generation of innovative ideas and creations. Option A correctly captures this idea.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

43. C

In the passage, the author notes that Pinker recognises rationality as both "a cognitive and moral virtue." However, the author points out that this "profoundly important" connection between rationality and morality is not thoroughly developed in Pinker's book. By bringing up the ancient Greek philosophers who, according to the text, subtly explored the connection between moral character and rationality, the author is implying that Pinker's work could benefit from a more in-depth consideration of the ethical dimension of rational behaviour. Option C accurately reflects this point - none of the other choices correctly capture the intention behind mentioning the Greek philosophers.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

44. C

The passage emphasises Pinker's focus on sequential reasoning and the tools of rationality, suggesting that greater mastery of these tools can improve decision-making in various practical contexts where individuals must act on 'uncertain and shifting information.' The author's endorsement or support for Pinker's work is centred on the idea that logical reasoning "equips people with the ability to tackle challenging practical problems" [Option C].

Option A is incorrect - while the author acknowledges that rationality is seen by Pinker as a moral virtue, he adds that this role of moral and ethical education is underexplored in Pinker's work. Option B presents a very specific use case of Pinker's views and fails to capture the broader message. Option D is similarly limited in scope - the emphasis is more on the broader applicability of rationality in decision-making.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

45. D

"The most characteristic romantic commitment is to the idea that the character of art and beauty and of our engagement with them should shape all aspects of human life. Being fundamental to human existence, beauty and art should be a central ingredient not only in a philosophical or artistic life, but also in the lives of ordinary men and women."

According to the passage, the romantics rejected the idea of confining aesthetics to a specific domain separate from practical and theoretical aspects of life. Instead, they believed that aesthetics, encompassing the character of art and beauty, should permeate all aspects of human existence, not only in philosophical or artistic lives but also in the lives of ordinary men and women. Therefore Option D is the correct answer.

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46. B

The passage suggests that recent studies on romanticism do not seek to overlook the differences between national romanticisms but rather attempt to characterize romanticism in terms of particular philosophical questions and concerns. The focus is on understanding romanticism without ignoring the diversity among different national expressions of it. Therefore Option B is the correct answer as it is not supported by the passage.

Option A: Although the passage acknowledges the challenges in characterizing romantic aesthetics, it also argues that it is not impossible or undesirable. Scholars recognize the difficulty but still emphasize the importance of discovering the nature of romanticism.

Option C: The passage mentions that the views of romantics on art and beauty are often found in fragments, aphorisms, and poems rather than in fully developed theoretical accounts. This emphasizes the elusive and suggestive nature of their expressions.

Option D: The passage notes that many romantics rejected the identification of aesthetics with a circumscribed domain of human life that is separated from the practical and theoretical domains of life. Instead, they believed that the character of art and beauty should shape all aspects of human life.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

47. C

Option C is the correct answer because it accurately reflects the passage's explanation of why recent studies on romanticism avoid seeking "a single definition, a specific time, or a specific place." According to the passage, these studies opt to characterize romanticism in terms of "particular philosophical questions and concerns" rather than attempting to provide a singular, all-encompassing definition. The reason for this approach is to delve into the fundamental concerns of the romantics, recognizing that romanticism is a complex and multifaceted movement with diverse expressions in different nations and contexts.

The passage suggests that romanticism is not easily confined to a single, universally applicable definition due to the variety of romanticisms in different nations. Instead of discrediting or refuting Lovejoy's skepticism (Option D), recent studies acknowledge the challenges and complexities of defining romanticism but seek to understand it by focusing on the core philosophical questions and concerns that were central to the romantics' worldview.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

48. B

"The main difficulty in studying the romantics, according to him, is the lack of any "single real entity, or type of entity" that the concept "romanticism" designates."

Option B is the correct answer because it accurately captures the main difficulty highlighted in the passage when studying romanticism. The passage, particularly referencing Arthur Lovejoy, emphasizes the challenge posed by the lack of clear conceptual contours or a single, cohesive entity associated with the term "romanticism." Lovejoy's assertion that romanticism is the "scandal of literary history and criticism" underscores the difficulty in defining the boundaries and characteristics of this literary and artistic movement.

The elusive and suggestive nature of romantic aesthetics (Option A) is mentioned in the passage as a challenge, but it is not identified as the main difficulty. Similarly, the controversial and scandalous history of romantic literature (Option C) is not specified as the primary obstacle. The absence of written accounts by romantic poets and artists (Option D) is acknowledged as a challenge, but the primary difficulty highlighted in the passage is the lack of clear conceptual contours associated with romanticism.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

49. D

*"Those observing global climate negotiations know about the Latin American way of looking at Earth as Pachamama (Earth Mother). **They also know how such a framing is just provided lip service and is ignored in the substantive portions of the negotiations.** In *The Nutmeg's Curse*, Ghosh explains why. He shows **the extent of the vested interest in the oil economy - not only for oil-exporting countries, but also for a superpower like the US that controls oil drilling, oil prices and oil movement around the world.** Many of us know **power utilities are sabotaging decentralised solar power generation today because it hits their revenues and control.**"*

From the highlighted part we can clearly infer Options A, B and C. The passage does not suggest that the decentralised characteristic of renewable energy resources like solar power is a reason for the failure of climate change policies. Instead, it mentions that power utilities may be sabotaging decentralized solar power generation because it affects their revenues and control, but it does not frame the decentralised nature of renewable energy as a cause for failure. Therefore Option D is not a reason for the failure of policies seeking to address climate change.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

50. D

If non-European societies perceive the Earth as a non-living source of all resources, it contradicts the personification implied by the use of "who" for Gaia.

In the context of the passage, the author uses the word "curse" in the title, and the pronoun "who" is used for Gaia, suggesting a perspective that sees Earth as a living, conscious entity. If non-European societies do not share this perspective and view the Earth as a non-living source of resources, it challenges the appropriateness of using the pronoun "who" for Gaia in the context of their beliefs. This would make the reviewer's choice of the pronoun "who" inappropriate, given the differing perspectives on the nature of the Earth. Therefore Option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

 **100+ CAT DILR Questions**



51. D

Option D cannot be directly drawn from the passage. The passage discusses the historical perspective on climate change presented in "The Nutmeg's Curse" and emphasizes the impact of colonialism on the contemporary dominant perception of nature and the environment. It suggests that there are alternative views from non-European and/or pre-colonial societies that can provide insights for environmental preservation policy makers. However, the passage does not explicitly state that academic discourses have always served the function of raising awareness about environmental preservation.

The passage connects the history of climate change with colonialism (Option A), highlights that colonial processes shaped the contemporary perception of nature and the environment (Option B) and suggests that non-European and/or pre-colonial societies hold valuable insights for environmental preservation policy makers (Option C).

VIDEO SOLUTION

52. D

"These are the two points to which Ghosh returns through examples from around the world. One, how European colonialists decimated not only indigenous populations but also indigenous understanding of the relationship between humans and Earth. Two, how this was an invasion not only of humans but of the Earth itself, and how this continues to the present day by looking at nature as a 'resource' to exploit"

The passage discusses how the colonization of the Banda islands, as presented in "The Nutmeg's Curse," is used to illustrate the broader idea that colonialism played a significant role in shaping the mindset and practices that have led to climate change. The exploitation of both indigenous populations and the Earth's resources during colonialism is portrayed as a key factor in perpetuating the mindset that views nature as a resource to be exploited, contributing to the environmental challenges faced today. Therefore, the primary purpose of discussing the colonization of the Banda islands is to highlight how colonialism represented and perpetuated the mindset that has led to climate change. Therefore Option D is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

53. A

Option A gives the big picture of why the poet recommends a long journey.

The remaining options are short-sighted and the poet was not much concerned about them.

VIDEO SOLUTION

54. D

The whole poem was about the goal and the journey to reach the goal.

If we see the lines "Better if it lasts for years not expecting Ithaka to make your rich", we can see that the poet is comparing Ithaka to life's distant goal.

Option D is the answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

55. B

The four lines "Better if it last for years not expecting Ithaka to make you rich" gives us the central theme of the poem.

It says that the journey is more important than the goal.

This meaning is conveyed in option B.

Hence, option B is the answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT VARC Questions



56. B

The poet says that Ithaka is the reason for one's journey.

So, he is trying to be encouraging.

Among the given options, only exhorting fits the be correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

57. **C**

The poet is trying to say that one who pursues the journey to one's goal must not be afraid of hindrances in that journey.

Option C is similar to our conclusion.

Hence, option C is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

58. **C**

The author says that "Its SIGNIFICANCE lay in its assertion that absolute Galilean motion or absolute velocity must ever escape all experimental detection."

Here, "it" refers to Einstein's principle.

The meaning of the sentence is that it is not always possible to experiment.

Option C gives a similar meaning. Hence, C is the answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

59. **D**

The author says that Einstein's principle is merely an extension of classical Newtonian principle.

Option D agrees with this saying that new knowledge about natural phenomena builds on existing knowledge.

Hence, option D is the answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

60. **A**

Options B and D negate the information given in the passage => B and D are incorrect.

C is stated in the passage but does not answer the question.

Option A is the correct answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF



61. **C**

In the second line after the line mentioned in the question, the author says that "the feeling was general that all the physical processes of nature would prove to be unfolding themselves according to the rigorous mathematic laws".

Option C is the answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

62. **B**

The author says that "The next advance was due to Newton, the greatest scientist of all time if account be taken of his joint contributions to mathematics and physics."

Joint contributions is metaphorically said as married in option B. Hence, option B is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

63. D

Refer to the lines made in the paragraph: "Even if the research promoted by them does focus on the high-value food items, much of biotechnology research is also funded by governments in both developing and developed countries. Indeed, the potato is a by-product of this type of research. If the potato passes the field trials, there is no reason to believe that it cannot be marketed in the global potato market. And this type of success story can be repeated with other basic food items." Here the author wants to illustrate that biotechnology research helps to address the concerns of the developing countries. For this illustration, the author gives the example of potatoes.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

64. B

Refer to the last lines of the passage: "However, some weeds through genetically-modified pollen contamination may acquire resistance to a variety of weed-killers. The only way to destroy these weeds is through the use of ever-stronger herbicides which are poisonous and linger on in the environment." This line indicates the point made in 2 that once the weeds acquire resistance to weak herbicides, we have to apply stronger ones to eradicate them.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

65. C

According to the passage, European nations are anti GM. So, among the given options we must select those countries that are present in Europe.

USA is not in Europe => option A is wrong.

India is not in Europe => option B is wrong.

Australia is not in Europe => option D is wrong.

Both Germany and France are in Europe => option C is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



66. C

By the line "Even if the research promoted by them in both developing and developed countries", we can say that not only MNCs but also governments are involved in the research development.

So, MNCs are not the only group actors that are involved in genetically modified food research.

Hence, option C is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

67. A

Refer to the following lines in the passage: "It is quite likely that the GM controversy will soon hit the headlines in India since a spokesperson of the Indian Central government has recently announced that the government may use the potato in its midday meal programme for schools as early as next year. Why should "scientific progress", with huge potential benefits to the poor and malnourished, be so controversial?" Here the author wants to highlight that the scientific progress which has a huge impact on large number of people is likely to be covered by the media.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

68. **D**

Throughout the passage, the author talks about the various financial reasons for conquest and explains how the British were forced to grant independence when their returns from India diminished after the war. The main idea of the passage is to illustrate how the erosion of the financial basis of an empire supports the granting of independence to an empire's constituents. Option d) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

69. **A**

White man's burden refers to the claim made by the British that the natives of the conquered countries were in need of the 'good' provided by them. This was a justification for their conquests. Option a) captures this idea succinctly.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

70. **C**

Consider the following lines from the passage: "But he was overruled by Indian hands who said India would resist payment and paralyse the war effort". From this, we can understand the reason why the British didn't tax India to finance its war efforts. It was afraid that if India refused to pay, Britain's war efforts would be jeopardized. Option c) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT WhatsApp Group

cracku



71. **C**

Refer to the 5th paragraph. It says "Though crushed, it reminded the British vividly that they were a tiny ethnic group who could not rule a gigantic subcontinent without the support of the important locals". From this, we can understand that the main lesson that the British learnt from the Sepoy Mutiny of 1857 was that they were a small ethnic group. Option c) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

72. **B**

If the returns from conquest decreased and the costs increased, it wouldn't make sense to continue empire-building in India. So, the sentence in option b) is not a reason for the emergence of the 'white man's burden' as a new rationale for empire-building in India.

 VIEW SOLUTION

73. **B**

Consider the following part of the passage '.. Consumer effectively recognize them as brand names, and have acquired a basic lexicon of wine with those Brazilian upstarts. In the wine heartlands of France, they are scared to death of that trend..'. So, above all, French winemakers fear the knowledge or education that the consumers have derived from wine labels from the English speaking countries. Option b) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

74. **C**

Consumers' appreciation of better quality wines is something that does not come because of the labeling or branding. So, this appreciation cannot be attributed to the labeling strategy followed by wine producers in English speaking countries.

Option c) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

75. B

The tone which author uses while asking "what French winemaker will ever admit that? is not at all harsh , so option a) is out . Also the author doesn't criticize while asking the question ,so Option c) is clearly not the answer. We don't find any author professing any feelings which he doesn't have , hence the tone is not hypocritical. Option b ,suits the best i.e. his tone is satirical.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



76. D

Dr. Renaud findings suggest that fat-derived cholesterol can be dispersed by the tannins in wine. So, a survey that validates this finding would provide the most support. The survey in option d) is precisely one such survey. Option d) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

77. A

Refer to the part of the passage which says ' ...not because they think their wine isn't as good as the best from California ...and they aren't about the change...probably no other way if France is to avoid simply becoming a specialty source of old-fashioned wines for old-fashioned connoisseurs. ' .

From this, we can see that the author feels that the French should adopt the labeling strategy of the English-speaking countries to avoid becoming a producer of merely old-fashioned wines.

Option a) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

78. A

Refer to the lines "This leads to a very different politics of interpretation and valuation to an aesthetic that privileges the evanescent moment of performance and invocation over the controlling authority of genius and the permanent record. "

B and D are incorrect as it has not been implied by this sentence.

C is incorrect as it is opposite to the implied meaning of the author.

 VIEW SOLUTION

79. B

Refer to the following line "A piece of music in the Western tradition, at least in its most characteristic and popular conception, originates in its composer, and the connection between the two, between composer and the piece of music, is relatively unambiguous precisely because the composer writes down, in notation his composition, as a poet might write down and publish poem."

This makes option C correct.

"To genius in Western classical music is, then, the originator, begetter and owner of his work-the printed,

notated sheet testifying to his authority over his product and his power, not only for expression or imagination. But of origination."

This makes D correct

"However far the printed sheet of notated music might travel thus from the composer, it still remains his property; and the notion of property remains at the heart of the Western conception of 'genius', which derives from the Latin gignere or 'to beget'."

This makes A correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

80. D

Refer to the lines of the para where it is written that "These days, especially with the middle-class having entered the domain of classical music and playing not a small part in ensuring the continuation of this ancient tradition, the tape recorder serves as a handy technological slave and preserves, from oblivion, the vanishing, elusive moment of oral transmission"

These vanishing,elusive moments are clearly transient which are recorded in cassettes, hence the correct answer is option D.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



81. A

Refer to the following lines "The teaching and transmission of North Indian classical music is, and long has been achieved by largely oral means. The raga and its structure, the often breathtaking intricacies of tala or rhythm, and the incarnation of rage and tala as bandish or composition, are passed thus, between, guru and shishya by word of mouth and direct demonstration, with no printed sheet of notated music, as it were acting as a go-between. Saussure's conception of language as a communication between addresser and addressee is given, in this model, a further instance, and a new, exotic complexity and glamour"

This clearly indicates that the composition is passed to one another vocally,hence the correct option is 1.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

82. B

Option A and C are rejected outrightly as they do not convey the central idea of the passage.

Option D is correct as per the passage but it is not the main idea which the passage wants to convey.

Option B correctly summarises the paragraph as the author wants to convey that unlike western classical, North Indian classical is transmitted through culture.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

83. C

Refer to the lines where it is written "And the oral transmission of North Indian classical music remains, almost uniquely, a testament to the fact that the human brain can absorb, remember and reproduce structures of great complexity and sophistication without the help of the hieroglyph or written mark or a system of notation."

This implies that brain can produce complex structure without any external help.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

84. D

Refer to the lines " Paradoxically, however, this style of teaching has produced no noteworthy students or performer, the most creative musicians still emerge from the guru-shishya relationship, their understanding of music developed by oral communication."

This indicates that the tradition has not produced any noteworthy student.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

85. C

Refer to the lines of the paragraph "However far the printed sheet of notated music might travel thus from the composer, it still remains his property; and the notion of property remains at the heart of the Western conception of 'genius', which derives from the Latin *gignere* or 'to beget'." The word "beget" means: to bring into this world. In the next line the author states that in Western music, the genius is the person who is the originator and owner of his work. This clearly explains the answer to be option C.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



86. A

Let us evaluate the choices individually:

Option A: [the number of chromatophores in Cephalopods is half the number of iridophores and leucophores]

If true, this does not undermine the camouflaging adeptness of Cephalopods primarily because each of chromatophores, iridophores and leucophores have specific [somewhat independent] roles to play and it is unclear how their quantity would directly impact the camouflaging capacity. Even if the number of chromatophores is fewer than the other types, the octopus can still maintain its camouflaging adeptness.

Option B: [the temperature of water at the depths at which Cephalopods reside renders the transmission of neural signals difficult.] If true, this would limit the camouflaging adeptness primarily because the underlying mechanism is being restricted/impacted. {When the cephalopod wants to change colour, the brain carries an electrical impulse through the nerve to the muscles that expand outwards, pulling open the sacs to display the colours on the skin.}

Option C: [light reflects the colours red, green, and yellow at the depths at which Cephalopods reside.] If true, this would limit the camouflaging adeptness primarily because the underlying mechanism is being restricted/impacted. If the colour scheme is distinct, it would undermine the observations presented below: {[Chromatophores] are organs on their bodies that contain pigment sacs, which have red, yellow and brown pigment granules... Why these three colours? Because these are the colours the light reflects at the depths they live in (the rest is absorbed before it reaches those depths)}

Option D: [the hydrostatic pressure at the depths at which Cephalopods reside renders radial muscle movements difficult.] If true, this would limit the camouflaging adeptness primarily because the underlying mechanism is being restricted/impacted. {These sacs have a network of radial muscles, meaning muscles arranged in a circle radiating outwards.}

Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

87. A

{But they don't look like their cousins at all. Other molluscs include sea snails, sea slugs, bivalves - most are shelled invertebrates with a dorsal foot. Cephalopods are all arms, and can be as tiny as 1 centimetre and as large at 30 feet. Some of them have brains the size of a walnut, which is large for an invertebrate. . . .It makes sense for these molluscs to have added protection in the form of a higher cognition; they don't have a shell covering them, and pretty much everything feeds on cephalopods, including humans.}

We can understand that B, C and D are true - they are points of dissimilarities between octopuses and other molluscs [we are told that they have multiple appendages instead of a single dorsal foot and lack shells; they also have higher intelligence]. However, there is no information on whether humans consume molluscs like sea snails or not [furthermore, the author does not use this fact to claim that octopuses are distinct in this regard].

Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

88. **A**

The author discusses camouflaging techniques in an octopus vis-a-vis other organisms such as cuttlefish, squids and polar bears: { For instance, the use of these cells is how an octopus can wrap itself over a rock and appear jagged or how a **squid** or **cuttlefish** can imitate the look of a coral reef by growing miniature towers on its skin. It actually matches the texture of the substrate it chooses...Finally, the leucophores: According to a paper, published in Nature, cuttlefish and octopuses possess an additional type of reflector cell called a leucophore. They are cells that scatter full spectrum light so that they appear white in a similar way that a **polar bear's fur** appears white}

However, note that no such discussion on sea snails is presented; hence, Option A is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

89. **D**

Options A and C: The discussion on Chromatophores, iridophores and leucophores sufficiently supports the statements here.

Option B: We can infer this from the following excerpt - {*Papillae are sections of the skin that can be deformed to make a texture bumpy... For instance, the use of these cells is how an octopus can wrap itself over a rock and appear jagged or how a squid or cuttlefish can imitate the look of a coral reef by growing miniature towers on its skin. It actually matches the texture of the substrate it chooses.*}

Option D is not discussed anywhere in the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

90. **D**

Consider the following sentence: "Brimming with the conviction that customer satisfaction is the key....to meet their professional and personal needs". So, the cornerstone of Murthy's human resource management is the satisfaction of their personal needs. Option d) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



91. **A**

Refer to the following sentence: "In fact, mirror images of Murthy, the Man, can be found all over Infosys". So, we can say that according to the passage, Infosys is a reflection of its CEO, Narayana Murthy. Option a) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

92. **A**

"Men grow old but companies shouldn't" means the companies should devising new strategies to keep themselves young. Option A correctly summarizes the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

93. C

Refer to the following lines: "In fact, Murthy views learning not just as amassing data, but as a process that enables him to use the lessons from failure to achieve success." This implies that Murthy considers learning as an enabler of success.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

94. A

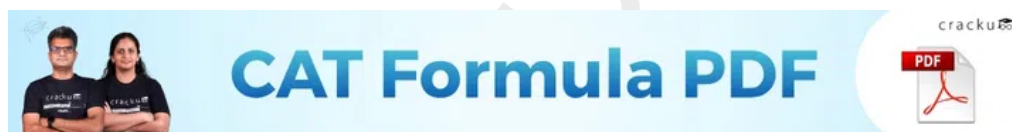
Option A can be inferred from the following lines: "But it is setting new standards for India Inc. through its practices of inter alia awarding stock options to its employees, putting the value of its intellectual assets and its brands on its balance sheet, and conforming to the disclosure standards of the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC: of the US)."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

95. D

Refer to the following lines: "It was after looking around itself instead of focusing on its initial business of banking software, that Infosys managed to accelerate. Today the company operates with stretch targets setting distant goals and working backwards to get to them." Option D can be concluded from these lines.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



96. D

Refer to the following lines: "The crucial pillar on which Murthy bases his ethical leadership is openness. Transparency, he reckons, is the clearest signal that one has nothing to hide. The personal manifestations of that are inter alia the practice of always giving complete information whenever any employee, customer, or investor asks for it: the loudly proclaimed insistence that every Infosys pay taxes and file returns: and a perpetually open office into which anyone can walk. " In these lines, the author wants to state the openness of information in Infosys and paying of taxes completely without hiding anything.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

97. D

In this passage, the example of 15 crore highlights that Murthy analysed the reason behind the crisis and removed the weakness to win more clients. This incident highlights all the characteristics of Murthy as mentioned in the passage.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

98. B

Option B can be confirmed from the following lines: "His egalitarianism — which finds expression in such habits as using the same table and chair as anyone else in the organization — is practised firmly when it comes to charting a course for the company's future: everyone has a voice. "We have no hierarchy just for the sake of control."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

99. B

The answer to this question can be inferred from the given lines: "Murthy believes that the betterment of man can be brought about through the 'creation of wealth, legally and ethically'"

 VIEW SOLUTION

100. C

"It was a consolation to the Indian intelligentsia for its perceived inability to counter the technical superiority of the west, a superiority viewed as having enabled Europe to colonize Asia and other parts of the world. At the height of anti-colonial nationalism it acted as a salve for having been made a colony of Britain."

The author mentioned the reference to being a salve in the last paragraph of the passage(above excerpt). The above excerpt was not regarding colonisers; rather, it refers to the Indian intelligentsia (intellectuals or highly educated people as a group). Thus, it can be inferred that option C is not the correct inference and hence is the correct option.

Throughout the passage, it can be inferred that the Orientalist scholars' understanding of Indian history and culture was selective, uniform, generalized, and biased. They viewed the Indian culture largely through the lenses of limited and selected literature in Sanskrit. Thus, option A can be inferred and is not the correct option.

"A dichotomy in values was maintained, Indian values being described as 'spiritual' and European values as 'materialistic', with little attempt to juxtapose these values with the reality of Indian society. This theme has been even more firmly endorsed by a section of Indian opinion during the last hundred years."

From the above lines, option B can also be inferred.

Thus, the correct option is C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



IIM Call Predictor

Accurate analysis of your profile

101. A

Option A: *"There was an attempt to formulate Indian culture as uniform, such formulations being derived from texts that were given priority... A dichotomy in values was maintained, Indian values being described as 'spiritual' and European values as 'materialistic', with little attempt to juxtapose these values with the reality of Indian society..."*

It can be understood from the above lines of the passage that the author did not approve(even criticize) the position where one should develop an oppositional framework to grasp cultural differences. Thus, this will not bear any fruit in getting a more accurate view of one nation's history and culture. This is the correct option.

Option B: Throughout the passage, the author criticized the framework the Englishmen adopted to understand India's culture. Thus, the author will support this view that can help give a more accurate picture of a nation's history and culture; hence, this is not the correct option.

Option C: Reading widely into a country's literature without any selection bias will give a more encompassing view of the nation's history; hence, this is also not the correct option.

Option D: This can be rejected on the same ground as option B.

Thus, the correct option is A.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

102. C

Option A: Since the author criticized the uniform view adopted by the Englishmen to understand Indian culture, the author will support the argument presented in this option. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option B: This can be understood from the starting and concluding lines of the second paragraph, and hence is not the correct option.

Option C: "*It was a consolation to the Indian intelligentsia for its perceived inability to counter the technical superiority of the west, a superiority viewed as having enabled Europe to colonize Asia and other parts of the world.*"

Although it can be inferred from the above excerpt that the Indians underestimated their culture and knowledge, it cannot be inferred from this excerpt that they matched the technical understanding of the west.

Thus, this view will not be supported by the author and hence, C is the correct option.

Option D: "...it was believed that the Indian pattern of life was so concerned with metaphysics and the subtleties of religious belief that little attention was given to **the more tangible aspects**."

From the above excerpt, it can be inferred that the author disapproved of the Orientalist ignorance of the Indian view towards the materialistic(tangible) aspects. Thus, the author will agree with the view that the Indian culture acknowledges the material aspects of life.

Thus, the correct option is C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

103. **D**

"There was an attempt to formulate Indian culture as uniform, such formulations being derived from texts that were given priority. The so-called 'discovery' of India was largely through selected literature in Sanskrit. This interpretation tended to emphasize non-historical aspects of Indian culture, for example, the idea of an unchanging continuity of society and religion over 3,000 years"

From the above excerpt of the passage, it can be inferred that the Orientalist scholars' method of understanding Indian history and culture was selective, uniform, generalized, and biased. They viewed the Indian culture largely through the lenses of limited and selected literature in Sanskrit.

Thus, we need to select an option which resembles the same approach.

Out of the four options, only option D uses a very limited understanding(of selected American movies) to form a generalized view of a nation.

Thus, option D is the correct option.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

104. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

If white peppercorns were brought to Europe, Europeans would likely doubt the myth of harvesting pepper by burning trees, as white peppercorns would not be burnt like the black peppercorns described in the story. This inconsistency would make them question the accuracy of the myth.

Option A: Medieval maps were mentioned as symbolic and inaccurate, making them impractical for navigation. Traders did not rely on these maps for precise geographical guidance.

Option C: This outcome is unlikely. The passage explains that spices were scarce and expensive; thus, bringing white pepper would not significantly affect its price, since it remained a rare and highly valued commodity.

Option D: Even if a trader brought white peppercorns, pepper would still be viewed as exotic by Europeans due to its rarity and the long journey it took to reach Europe. So, this outcome is also unlikely.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

105. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

The demand for spices was not necessarily tied to their availability. The passage states that medieval Europeans had limited geographical knowledge of where spices came from and were highly prized despite their relative scarcity. Spices were used for culinary and medicinal purposes, and the demand was driven by cultural and medical factors rather than availability.

Option A: The passage states that spices were used partly due to the unavailability of refrigeration, and some spices served as antibacterial agents. With the development of refrigeration techniques, the necessity for spices to preserve or enhance food properties would diminish, leading to a decline in their appeal.

Option C: The passage mentions how spices were used for medicinal properties in medieval times as part of humoral balancing. As medical science evolved, such practices would likely fall out of favour, reducing their significance.

Option D: The passage states that spices played a significant role in medieval cooking, balancing humoral properties in food. Changes in European tastes or culinary practices would have contributed to a decline in the demand for spices.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



106. A

Option A is the correct answer.

This is a wrong conclusion because it confuses the physical heat from the harvesting process with the pepper's actual spiciness. The process of using fire for harvesting could not be related to the spiciness (being hot) of the pepper.

Option B: The story of snakes and burning trees implies that pepper was difficult and dangerous to harvest, which could explain why it was costly. This is a reasonable conclusion based on the story.

Option C: Given the danger described in the myth (snakes and burning trees), it's logical that people would conclude it's not advisable to go to India to harvest pepper themselves. This could be a conclusion from the story.

Option D: The story suggests that harvesting pepper is difficult and dangerous, which might lead people to think that the supply is limited. Based on the information provided in the myth, this is a reasonable conclusion.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

107. B

Option B is the correct answer.

While spices were a major part of European trade with the East, the passage does claim that gold was a motivation for colonizing India. The main focus of the passage is on spices, not gold. Hence, the conclusion that India was colonized for both spices and gold cannot be definitively drawn from the passage.

Option A: The passage hints that the desire for spices played a significant role in driving European colonial expansion. Therefore, this conclusion can be reached from the passage.

Option C: The passage briefly mentions that spices never had the same enduring allure or commercial potential as gold, silver, tobacco, indigo, or sugar. From this, we can infer that tobacco was more marketable than spices at certain points in history.

Option D: In the passage, the desire for spices is described as one of the major factors that led to European colonialism. Therefore, this conclusion could be reached.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

108. **D**

Refer to the following lines: "In the earlier and more ruthless days of capitalism the duty of the economic system to provide work was overlooked. The purpose of competitive enterprise was to realize a profit. When profit ceased or was curtailed, production also ceased or was curtailed"

Option D is clearly mentioned in these lines.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

109. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "There are forms of work, of course, which since external compulsion is reduced to a minimum, are hardly to be differentiated from occupation. The artist, the imaginative writer, the scientist, the social worker, for instance, find their pleasure in the constant spontaneous exercise of creative energy and the essential reward of their work is in the doing of it." Option B is stated in these lines.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

110. **D**

Refer to the following lines: "There are forms of work, of course, which since external compulsion is reduced to a minimum, are hardly to be differentiated from occupation."

Here the author clearly states that some works can be hardly differentiated from occupation which is contrary to what is mentioned in D.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)



111. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "When, therefore, we look ahead to the situation likely to be produced by the continued rapid extension of machine production, we should think not so much about providing occupation for leisure as about limiting the amount of leisure to that which can be profitably used."

Option C is clearly stated in these lines.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

112. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "But has he considered what would be the moral effect of life imagined as possible in the highly mechanized state of future? Has he thought of the possibility of bands of unemployed and under-employed workers marching on the capital to demand not income (which they will have but work?"

In this line, the author clearly states that the highly mechanized future may render many workers unemployed.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

113. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "The labour movements arose largely as a revolt against the conception of workers as commodities to be bought and sold without regard to their needs as human beings."

Option C is clearly mentioned in these lines.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

114. C

Refer to the following lines: "But has the socialist thought about what he would do if owing to technological advance, the amount of human labour were catastrophically reduced? So far as I know, he has no plan beyond drastically lining the hours of work, and sharing out as much work as there may be."

The author clearly mentions that the socialists have not taken into account the mechanization.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

115. D

Refer to the following lines of the passage: "Occupation absorbs time and energy so long as we choose to give them; it demands constant initiative, and it is its own reward." " But for most people the pleasure of occupation needs the addition of the necessity provided in work. "

Option D correctly summarizes the answer as the occupation is a desire to do something which requires initiative and will.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



116. C

Refer to the following lines: "Work has for him obvious utility, and it bring the satisfaction of tangible rewards. Where as occupation is an end in itself, and we therefore demand that it shall be agreeable, work is usually the means to other ends." Option C clearly mentions the aspects present in these lines.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

117. D

Option D is the correct answer.

This is not mentioned as a reason in the passage. The focus is on staying informed, contributing to the field, and publicizing their own work, not on expanding influence. Therefore, option D is the correct answer as it is the only reason not mentioned in the passage.

Option A: The passage mentions that some academics review work to "*keep abreast with developments in their field*," which aligns with the idea that reviewing helps them stay updated with cutting-edge ideas. This is a valid reason.

Option B: The passage also mentions that some scientists post their reviews online "*mainly to claim credit for their work*," which indicates that some view reviewing as an opportunity to publicize their contributions. This is a valid reason

Option C: The passage states that some view reviewing as "*a duty to the discipline*," which is a form of service to the academic community. Therefore, option C is also a valid reason.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

118. B

Let's evaluate the options:

Option A: The passage mentions this concern: "*referees may be less critical of manuscripts if their reports are published, especially if they are revealing their identities by signing them*."

Option B: The passage does not mention that one of the reasons to oppose open peer review is to protect reviewers from unwarranted and unjustified criticism. Instead, the passage discusses the concern that reviewers may avoid giving critical feedback if their identities and reports are made public, not because they want to avoid unjust criticism. The key concern is the fear of justified criticism rather than avoiding unjust or unwarranted criticism.

Option C: The passage mentions that reviewers may be less critical in their reports if they fear their reviews will be published. This might prevent reviewers from being honest and offering critical assessments, which are crucial for the integrity of the publishing process.

Option D: Another concern raised in the passage is that reviewers might take longer to submit their reviews if they know they will be publicly scrutinized. This delay in the review process is seen as a disadvantage of open peer review.

Therefore, **option B is the correct answer** because the passage does not mention concerns about leaving reviewers unexposed to unwarranted criticism.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

119. **D**

Option D is the correct answer.

The passage discusses the value of making peer-reviewed data public to help address various issues in academic publishing, such as bias, inefficiency, and fraud. The author advocates for a shift *"from opacity in all cases to opacity only when necessary,"* implying support for greater transparency in peer review.

Option A: The passage mentions concerns about reviewer selection, such as gender and geographic imbalances, but it does not suggest that careful screening of content-familiar reviewers is a priority.

Option B: The passage mentioned about maintaining confidentiality, but it does not strongly argue in favour of preserving anonymity.

Option C: The author does not fully endorse the publication of actual reviews or reviewer identities in every situation. While the author advocates for sharing peer review data, they also acknowledge that, in some cases, the content of reviews and reviewers' identities may need to remain confidential.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

120. **D**

Option D is the correct answer.

The passage provides several arguments in favour of making peer review data public, but it does not mention that making this data public would help in selecting appropriately qualified reviewers for academic writing.

Option A: The passage mentions that openly publishing peer review data could help journals address fraudulent peer reviews, such as authors using fake email addresses to review their own manuscripts. Therefore, this is a reason given in favour of making the data public.

Option B: The passage discusses a study showing that women and non-Westerners are underrepresented among peer reviewers. Publishing peer review data could help highlight these gender and race biases, which is one of the reasons for making the data public.

Option C: The passage suggests that sharing peer-review data could help journals tackle issues like fraud, inefficiency, and systemic bias in the publishing process, which is another reason given in favour of making the data public.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

121. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

The first paragraph discusses how technological or industrial advances are often accompanied by unintended consequences or secondary effects, which may not be fully understood or predictable at the time of the invention. It gives the example of the printing press, which led to unexpected developments such as the creation of spectacles, and later, the telescope and microscope. This is well captured in Option B.

Option A: While some secondary effects may be beneficial, the focus of the paragraph is more on the unpredictability and far-reaching nature of these effects, rather than their inherent benefit.

Option C: The paragraph doesn't advocate judging inventions by their secondary effects. Instead, it mentions that these effects are unpredictable and sometimes surprising. The main point is their unpredictability, not how to judge an invention.

Option D: The paragraph does not suggest that the impact of a technological advance should be evaluated by the boost its secondary effects give to generating further technological advances.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

122. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

This is not an externality because it was the original intended use of air-conditioning. The passage mentions that Carrier invented air-conditioning to ensure cool, dry air for factories with low-humidity requirements.

The other options are externalities:

Option A: This is an unintended consequence. CFCs were initially used in refrigeration and air-conditioning, but their long-term environmental impact (ozone depletion) was not anticipated.

Option C: The Jacquard loom was originally a mechanical device for weaving patterns in fabric, but it led to the development of programmable machines, which had far-reaching effects on modern computing, which was also an unintended consequence of the loom's invention.

Option D: The passage states that the phonograph was initially designed for dictation but was adapted for music recording, which was an unintended consequence.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

123. **A**

Option A is the correct answer.

The author does not imply that recent advances are more threatening than past ones. Instead, he suggests that the nature of technological progress (with more individuals and smaller groups able to innovate) has changed, leading to new risks. The focus is not on comparing "past vs. recent" as more threatening but on the unexpected global impacts of all technological advances. Thus, option A misrepresents the author's view.

Option B: The author would agree with this because the passage explains that Ethyl (leaded fuel) and Freon are examples of innovations whose unintended consequences stem from by-products they emitted (such as lead from fuel and chemicals from Freon), which had secondary effects on health and the environment.

Option C: The author would support this as he mentions how individuals or small groups can now create innovations that have global impacts, particularly in fields like biotechnology and chemistry, which was less true in the past.

Option D: The author suggests that the health threats of leaded fuel were visible earlier (in the 1920s), implying that they should have been addressed sooner. Hence, the author would support this

 VIDEO SOLUTION

124. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

The author mentions Carrier, Babbage, and Edison to emphasize that the inventors' original intentions were not related to the unexpected societal impacts their inventions had:

- Carrier created air-conditioning for industrial use, but it triggered a mass migration to cities like Phoenix and Las Vegas.
- Babbage's invention of a programmable loom and Edison's phonograph were originally intended for specific purposes (textile weaving and dictation, respectively). Still, they led to far-reaching technological developments in computing and music industries.

Therefore, we can infer that the inventors did not anticipate the full consequences of their inventions.

Option A: The secondary effects are shown as surprising or leading to unforeseen societal changes, rather than leading to more inventions.

Option C: The passage doesn't claim that the unintended consequences were largely beneficial. While some consequences may have been beneficial (like the telescope and microscope from the printing press), others (like climate change) have been harmful.

Option D: This is close, but it's not the main point. The intended purpose of the inventions may have been different from their actual use, but the author's primary argument is about how the inventors could not have predicted the full societal impacts of their inventions, rather than focusing on how inventions end up being used for different purposes.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

125. **A**

The author in the passage that. "surveillance is there, but they are costly and will never be enough to cover the entire sea" He nowhere mentions that surveillance has decreased, actually it is not possible to map the entire sea. Hence this option is incorrect. Remaining all the options are correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



The banner features two people on the left, the text "CAT Daily Targets" in large bold letters in the center, and a tagline "Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile" below it. On the right, there is a "cracku" logo and a small graphic of a calendar with a target icon.

126. **D**

Option B and Option C are factually out of scope. Nothing has been said about who laid the groundwork for modern piracy. Neither has any comparisons made between the piracy of today and yesteryears,

In this statement , the author is obviously not assigning any blame to Vasco Da Gama and East India company. He just wants to highlight their roles in early pirates history.

Option D can be inferred from the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

127. **C**

Option A states that the author is "facetious". Facetious means, treating serious issues with inappropriate humor. Author is nowhere mocking the hard life of peasants. On the contrary, he is actually admitting it and suggesting it as the reason why so many people became pirates in the first place. Hence this option is incorrect.

Option B states analytical. The author is nowhere contrasting the lives of peasant and pirates. He has not portrayed the lives of pirates in a pleasant light. Ultimately they also have to face surveillance and other dangers, thus the contrast in the option is wrong.

Indignant is completely wrong. The author is not angry at the pirates, for amassing huge wealth. Entirely out of context.

Option C talks about irony, which is actually correct. The author is ironical that an honest peasant has to toil day and night and still has to sleep empty stomach but on the other hand a pirate could easily amass twice the fortunes of peasant, without breaking much sweat. This entirely captures the essence of the mentioned line. Hence this answer is correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

128. **A**

Look at the 4th paragraph of the passage. "It quickly becomes clear that in those parts of the world that have not profited from globalisation and modernisation, and where abject poverty and the daily struggle for survival are still a reality, the root causes of piracy are still the same as they were a couple of hundred years ago." Hence to best control the problem of piracy one has to solve this root problem that is eliminate income disparities and poverty in affected regions. Hence 1 is the correct answer. Remaining options are solution but not the one which can eliminate piracy in the long run.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

129. **D**

Option D is the correct answer.

The 'exclosures' are mentioned as fenced areas cleared of invasive rabbits and feral cats. The term "exclosures" points to the intentional exclusion of these invasive species to create a safe environment for the bandicoots and other native animals.

Option A: While the bandicoots help in restoring the cattle damaged landscape, the term 'exclosure' does not relate to it.

Option B: The exclosures are cleared of feral cats, but the passage does not mention removing large bilbies, which are actually part of the controlled environment. The exclosures themselves are specifically to protect the bandicoots from cats and rabbits, not bilbies.

Option C: The exclosures are not about making an area entirely predator-free for all species. Instead, the purpose is to create controlled environments where invasive species like rabbits and feral cats are removed. Predators are still present in the Wild Training Zone, where bandicoots and other marsupials learn to coexist and evade predators.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

130. **D**

Option D is the correct answer.

Option D captures the main idea of the passage. It reflects the near-extinction of the western barred bandicoot due to invasive species and highlights the conservation efforts using survivors from Shark Bay islands.

Option A: This is not entirely true. The western barred bandicoot did not go extinct; instead, it survived in small numbers on two predator-free islands. This option incorrectly asserts total extinction and ignores the ongoing efforts to revive the species.

Option B: This is a distortion. While the colonists' negligence and the nicknames they gave reflect their disregard, the passage clearly attributes the near-extinction of bandicoots to ecological disruptions caused by invasive species, not merely the colonists' attitudes.

Option C: This generalizes the issue and does not focus specifically on the western barred bandicoot, the subject of the passage. Furthermore, it does not highlight the rescue efforts which are central to the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



131. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

The passage does not mention the bandicoots' use of camouflage as a survival technique. While their shelters may be camouflaged (hidden), the bandicoots themselves are not described as using camouflage directly.

Option A: This is correct. The passage mentions their long, slender snouts and their digging behaviour, which allows them to create shallow shelters in the desert.

Option C: This is correct. The nickname "zebra rat" comes from their appearance, and their slender snout and backward-facing pouch for carrying joeys are described in the passage.

Option D: This is also correct. The passage mentions these features as characteristics of the western barred bandicoot.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

132. **A**

Option A is the correct answer.

The passage mentions how bandicoots contribute to the ecosystem by digging, which traps moisture and aids in seed germination. This activity helps restore the desert ecosystem damaged by cattle. Their role as "ecosystem engineers" stems from these positive environmental impacts.

Option B: Although efforts to preserve the bandicoot species are ongoing, the passage does not link their new nickname to these efforts. The name "ecosystem engineers" specifically reflects their environmental contributions rather than conservation measures.

Option C: While the passage mentions a population increase due to rainfall, the new nickname is unrelated to this growth. Instead, it is tied to their environmental engineering role.

Option D: This is a wrong interpretation because there is no mention in the passage of the bandicoots affecting rainfall.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

133. **A**

Refer to the para 4 "The pathetic, and obviously mendacious, justification was that a boy concerned with turning his eyes from one cone to the other was more inclined to stumble over stones, steps, or cracks in the pavement. I dimly sensed that there was another secret justification, cruelly pedagogical, but I was unable to grasp it."

According to the author the justification was pedagogical, didactic comes closest to the meaning.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

134. **B**

Refer to the lines of the para "Nowadays the moralist risks seeming at odds with morality, in a world where the consumer civilization now wants even adults to be spoiled, and promises them always something more, from the wristwatch in the box of detergent to the bonus bangle sheathed, with the magazine it accompanies, in a

plastic envelope."
This explains option B.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

135. **B**

Consider the following sentence from the passage: "This liturgy seemed to me so...to celebrate it". From this sentence, we can understand that the main reason why the author wanted two two-cent cones instead of one four-cent cone was because it suggested intemperance. Option b) is the correct answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)



136. **D**

The word 'parvenus' refers to 'a person of humble origin who has gained wealth'. In other words, the phrase 'little parvenus' means 'young upstarts'. Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

137. **C**

The reason elders gave to the children to dissuade them from buying two ice-creams was that a boy turning eyes from one cone to the other, one in each hand was more likely to fall. But, as rightly guessed by the author, there is a 'deeper' reason for parents' refusal to let children buy two ice-creams. Therefore, the claim that elders 'rightly suggested that a boy turning eyes from one cone to the other was more likely to fall' is incorrect. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

138. **E**

Refer to the lines "Language is a complex, specialized skill, which develops in the child spontaneously, without conscious effort or formal instruction, is deployed without awareness of its underlying logic, is qualitatively the same in every individual, and is distinct from more general abilities to process information or behave intelligently. For these reasons some cognitive scientists have described language as a psychological faculty, a mental organ, a neural system, and a computational module"

The author says that popular wisdom considers Language to be a cultural artifact or invention or something that is learnt in school or from your parents. However, this is not the case. Throughout the passage, the author makes the case for it being a "psychological faculty" or instinct. Hence, option E does not stem from popular wisdom like the other options. It instead is suggested by cognitive scientists (and the author) as a view contrary to popular wisdom.

Hence option E is correct

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

139. **B**

This analogy of spider suggests the inherent activities.

Only option B comes close. Rest of the qualities mentioned in other options are developed over a period of time.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

140. **B**

Refer to the last line of the para 2 "Innatures talent show, we are simply a species of primate with our own act, a knack for communicating information about who did what to whom by modulating the sounds we make when we exhale."

 VIDEO SOLUTION



141. **D**

Throughout the para, the author talks about the language being the instinctive ability. Moreover refer to the line of 1st para "But I prefer the admittedly quaint term "instinct". This shows the correct option to be D

 VIDEO SOLUTION

142. **A**

Refer to the lines of the last para "The complexity of language, from the scientist's point of view, is part of our biological birthright; it is not something that parents teach their children or something that must be elaborated in school – as Oscar Wilde said, "Education is an admirable thing, but it is well to remember from time to time that nothing that is worth knowing can be taught."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

143. **A**

Refer to the 2nd para "With those caveats, it appears to me that one strand consisted of population growth outstripping available resources: a dilemma similar to the one foreseen by Thomas Malthus in 1798 and being played out today in Rwanda, Haiti and elsewhere. As the archaeologist David Webster succinctly puts it, "Too many farmers grew too many crops on too much of landscape." Hence option 1.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

144. **C**

Refer to these lines from the para "At the time of previous droughts, there were still uninhabited parts of the Maya landscape, and people at a site affected by drought could save themselves by moving to another site. However, by the time of the Classic collapse the landscape was now full, there was no useful unoccupied land in the vicinity on which to begin anew, and the whole population could not be accommodated in the few areas that continued to have reliable water supplies."

It is clearly written in these line that the landscape was now full, hence option C

 VIDEO SOLUTION

145. **E**

Refer to the given lines "As our fifth strand, we have to wonder why the kings and nobles failed to recognize and solve these

seemingly obvious problems undermining their society. Their attention was evidently focused on their short-term concerns of enriching themselves, waging wars, erecting monuments, competing with each other, and extracting enough food from the peasants to support all those activities."

The Maya population was not obsessed with the short term concerns. But its rulers were obsessed with the short term concerns.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



146. D

Refer the 1st para "To summarize the Classic Maya collapse, we can tentatively identify five strands. I acknowledge, however, that Maya archaeologists still disagree vigorously among themselves in part, because the different strands evidently varied in importance among different parts of the Maya realm; because detailed archaeological studies are available for only some Maya sites; and because it remains puzzling why most of the Maya heartland remained nearly empty of population and failed to recover after the collapse and after re-growth of forests."

This makes option D correct.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

147. D

Anthropogenic means "caused by human factor"

So anthropogenic drought means drought caused by human beings.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

148. C

In the penultimate paragraph, the author mentions "Where happiness indicators were once used as a basis to reform society, challenging the obsession with money that G.D.P. measurement entrenches, they are increasingly used as a basis to transform or discipline individuals". He states that wearable technologies shift the onus on the person for his depression. In the last paragraph, the author mentions how these technologies are helping in disciplining individuals to be happy rather than addressing the cause of depression. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

149. A

The primary intention of the author is to warn about the trend of collecting data to monitor emotions and in turn promote happiness as an overarching goal. He says that such a practice will lead to adoption of intrusive methods and make happiness a personal project to be worked on. If it is proved that less data is being collected than earlier, it will weaken the very basis of the author's arguments.

Options B and C indicate a trend that the author is warning about. Therefore, we can eliminate these 2 options. Option D states that individuals worldwide are using technologies to monitor their well-being. The author's argument is not that such technologies should not be used. He just states that proliferation of such technologies, especially when used by external parties like nations and corporations, might put people under greater stress. Therefore, we can eliminate option D as well.

Option A states that stakeholders are moving away from collecting data. This statement goes against the warning issued by the author. Therefore, option A will undermine the author's arguments the most and hence, option A is the right answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

150. C

In the last paragraph, the author mentions that since 1970s, depression is viewed as the defect of the individual rather than as the effect of his circumstances. He feels that this approach puts the person under pressure since being depressed is being viewed as the fault of the individual. The author does not view the shift in a positive

light. Only option C captures the fact that the development was a detrimental step and hence, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

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151. **B**

The author does not consider happiness indicators to be the gold standard of happiness. Therefore, we cannot say that Dubai is on its way to becoming one of the happiest cities in the world just because it tries to discipline its citizens to be happy.

Nowhere has it been mentioned that Dubai collaborates with Facebook or incentivises companies that promote worker welfare.

'Cities such as Dubai, which has pledged to become the "happiest city in the world," dream up ever-more elaborate and intrusive ways of collecting data on well-being — to the point where there is now talk of using CCTV cameras to monitor facial expressions in public spaces'.

We can infer that Dubai comes up with new intrusive ways of collecting data on the well-being of its citizens. Therefore, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

152. **B**

We can infer that the author adopts a cautionary tone in the passage. He warns that quantification of happiness might be useful in certain contexts but making measuring happiness the primary goal can lead to unwanted consequences. He warns that happiness will become a personal project if we take the metrics too seriously. Therefore, the author is likely to recommend economists to incorporate the research findings cautiously and hence, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

153. **C**

Options A, B and D are never mentioned in any part of the passage. Option C seems to be explaining perfectly why internal conflicts are psychologically more interesting than external conflicts.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

154. **C**

Refer to the lines of 2nd last para.

The effort of solving the problem is in itself not a conflict if the adversary (the unknown criminal) remains passive, like Nature, whose secrets the scientist supposedly unravels by deduction. If the adversary actively puts obstacles in the detective's path toward the solution, there is genuine conflict. But the conflict is psychologically interesting only to the extent that it contains irrational components such as a tactical error on the criminal's part or the detective's insight into some psychological quirk of the criminal or something of this sort. Conflict conducted in a perfectly rational manner is psychologically no more interesting than a standard Western.

Option C agrees with these lines and none of the other options does. Hence, option C is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

155. D

In the 1st paragraph, the last 3 lines indicate that the options A and B are true.

In the 2nd paragraph, the first 2 lines indicate that the option C is true.

Hence, all the above is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

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156. B

By adopting a defensive strategy, the chess player is co-operating with his opponent though he wants to win the game. In the beginning of the passage, it has been given that conflict of interests like these lead to interesting psychology. In the other 3 options given, there is no conflict of interest involved (Only one person is involved in all the other 3 cases).

 VIDEO SOLUTION

157. B

Options A, C and D have been explicitly stated in the passage (refer to the second paragraph):

A: "...children between age four and six with one marshmallow. He told them that if they waited 15 minutes and didn't eat it, he would give them a second marshmallow..." Thus, children were the subject under observation in the original marshmallow experiment, while cuttlefish were studied in the modified version of the same.

C: "...Since the researchers couldn't explain to the cuttlefish that they would need to wait for their shrimp, they trained them to recognize certain shapes that indicated when a food item would become available..." Option C merely rephrase this excerpt.

D: "...A long-term follow-up study showed that the children who waited for the second marshmallow had more success later in life..." Given that the researchers undertook a long term study to map the successes of children showcasing self-control, we can safely conclude that the cuttlefish-version of the experiment was undertaken over a relatively shorter period.

Option B cannot be inferred from the discussion - there is no correlation between selfcontrol and survival advantages. Hence, B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

158. B

Option A: If true, this would weaken the findings of the experiments. The methodology used to establish the trait of self-restraint in cuttlefish is based on the premise that cuttlefish prefer one specific kind of food over another. If we demonstrate that cuttlefish are equally fond of live grass shrimp and raw prawn, then the observations made in the study become invalid. Therefore, we can eliminate Option A.

Option B: If true, the finding here would support the comments made in the final paragraph. The author states the following: {Not every species can use self-control, but most of the animals that can share another trait in common: long, social lives.} If it is proved that cuttlefish fulfils this ancillary criterion of sociability, the primary claim made in the passage is strengthened.

Option C: If true, the statement here bears no significance to the passage's findings. [We already know that "...the longest that a cuttlefish waited was 130 seconds..."]

Option D: If true, this would weaken the findings of the experiments. Similar to Option A, the methodology used to establish the trait of self-restraint in cuttlefish is based on the premise that cuttlefish can distinguish between geometrical shapes. If we demonstrate that this information is false, then the observations made in the study become invalid. Therefore, we can eliminate Option D.

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

159. **B**

Option A: {Each time the cuttlefish showed it could wait, the researchers tacked another ten seconds on to the next round of waiting before releasing the shrimp. The longest that a cuttlefish waited was 130 seconds.} The results of Schnell's experiment indicated that cuttlefish exhibit self-restraint. This was shown to be the case with few children in the original marshmallow experiments. Hence, Option A is correct.

Option B: {Not every species can use self-control, but most of the animals that can share another trait in common: long, social lives.} The author does not imply causation between intelligence and sociability. He merely highlights these two attributes: self-control is considered indicative of intelligence, and most such organisms showcase social lives as well. Hence, B is a distortion and cannot be inferred.

Option C: {Preliminary experiments showed that cuttlefishes' favorite food is live grass shrimp, while raw prawns are so-so and Asian shore crab is nearly unacceptable.} The above lines depict a preference for certain kinds of food; thus, C is true.

Option D: {Schnell [says] that the cuttlefish usually sat at the bottom of the tank and looked at the two food items while they waited, but sometimes, they would turn away from the king prawn "as if to distract themselves from the temptation of the immediate reward."} Exerting self-control through distractions has also been presented as a behavioural trait of the cuttlefish.

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

160. **A**

The question tests our understanding of the experiment stated in the second paragraph. The key highlights of the modified cuttlefish experiment are:

- (a) Food choice: 1st preference - live grass shrimp; 2nd preference - raw prawns; 3rd preference - Asian shore crab
- (b) Symbol based training: Circle - immediate availability; Triangle - delayed availability; Square - never available
- (c) Observations: in the absence of 1st preference → cuttlefish will go for 2nd preference {applies to all such scenarios involving only one food choice}; in the presence of multiple food choices, cuttlefish will wait → if 1st pref is available and associated with either Circle or Triangle

Based on the above, we can filter out the given options:

Option A: We know that raw prawns and Asian shore crab are not the primary preference of the cuttlefish. Additionally, we know that live grass shrimp (1st preference) is available for delayed consumption {associated with a Triangle}. If the cuttlefish waits for one minute to consume live grass shrimp and ignores the other two food choices, this definitively showcases that cuttlefish exert self-control. Hence, Option A is a strong candidate for the correct choice since it supplements the experiment's findings.

Option B: In this case, the cuttlefish will go for the raw prawns since it has been conditioned to understand that the box labelled with Square will never open. This does not contribute to establishing self-control in cuttlefish. Thus, we can reject this choice.

Option C: In this case, the cuttlefish will go for the raw prawns and avoid the Asian shore crab irrespective of the box it is placed in. This is because raw prawns fare more favourably as a food choice than Asian shore crab. {We know from points (a) and (c) that the cuttlefish will go for the 2nd preference over the 3rd} This does not contribute to establishing self-control in cuttlefish. Thus, we can reject this choice.

Option D: In this case, the cuttlefish will go for the live grass shrimp and avoid the raw prawns irrespective of the box it is placed in. This is because live grass shrimp fares more favourably as a food choice than raw prawns. {We know from points (a) and (c) that the cuttlefish will go for the 1st preference over the 2nd} This does not contribute to establishing self-control in cuttlefish. Therefore, we can reject this choice.

Hence, the correct answer is Option A.

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161. C

The second paragraph says that there are 2 possible motivations for writing the story of Aladdin, first being french fairy tales and second being French orientalism. He goes on to say, if aladdin is actually based on the life of hanna Diyab, then the idea of french orientalism is inversed.

"or that the story was invented in that 18th century period as a byproduct of French Orientalism, a fascination with stereotypical exotic Middle Eastern luxuries that was prevalent then. The idea that Diyab might have based it on his own life — the experiences of a Middle Eastern man encountering the French, not vice-versa — flips the script."

French Orientalism implies an intrigue of French towards Middle-eastern luxuries, while Diyab coming to france shows an interest of middle-easteners in France. Hence, the script is inversed if Aladdin's story is based on Hanna Diyab.

The question is looking for option which invalidates the inversion. This implies that the script shouldn't be inversed. This occurs when Aladdin's story is not based on Diyab.

Option C says that Diyab's travellogue doesn't bear any resemblance to Galland's Aladdin. This implies that Aladdin is not based on Diyab. Hence, the inversion of script doesn't occur/invalidated. None of the other options invalidate the script.

Hence, option C is correct

 VIDEO SOLUTION

162. A

It reflects not only "a history of the French and the Middle East, but also [a story about] Middle Easterners coming to Paris and that speaks to our world today,"

The above statement indicates that the primary reason for scholars to go back to aladdin is the intrigue about middle easterners coming to paris.

Option B and D have references from third paragraph which is unrelated to the context.

While option C is one of the reasons, the primary reason as per the author is option A(traveller's experience indicates midleeasteners experience in france).

Option A can be considered as one of primary importance as he says "that speaks to the world today" highlighting the importance of middle-easteners coming to paris.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

163. A

The passage says "describes his own hard-knocks upbringing and the way he marvelled at the extravagance of Versailles. The descriptions he uses were very similar to the descriptions of the lavish palace that ended up in Galland's version of the Aladdin story."

Hence, option B and option C depicts the similarities of Hanna Diyab's life and Aladdin's character

Option D: "Diyab was ideally placed to embody the overlapping world of East and West, blending the storytelling traditions of his homeland with his youthful observations of the wonder of 18th-century France." Since Diyab is a middle eastern man who came to France, his cross-culture experience would make him ideal to embody the character of Aladdin. Hence, option D gives evidence for the claim aladdin is based on hana diyab's life.

Option A: Even though Diyab narrated the story, he might have read it somewhere or heard it from someone else, it doesn't necessarily give any insight about its relationship with his life.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

164. **A**

"Galland wrote in his diary that he first heard the tale from a Syrian storyteller from Aleppo named Hanna Diyab Since he heard the story, option B is incorrect.

Also, the first paragraph implies that - While Arabian nights predates to medieval times, the earliest appearance of Aladdin is in 1712. Hence, option C and D are incorrect.

"Transmit" means passing from one person to another. This can imply that Diyab told it to Galland. Also, Aladdin is one of the stories of "Arabian Nights" (Others include Alibaba & 40 thieves, Sindbad). Hence option A is correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

165. **C**

The narrative sensibility of Diyab's travelogue indicates similarity in characters of Aladdin and Diyab in terms of sensibility, being considerate. Hence, option A strengthens the passage's claim about Aladdin's character having ties with that of Diyab

Option B, Galland's acknowledgement again indicates that Aladdin might be predated than 1712 and might have some roots associated with Diyab

Option D, The affluence in the story of Aladdin and Diyab's travelogue have major similarities. This suggests that Aladdin maybe based on Diyab's life experiences. Hence, it supports the passage's claim about authorship.

As per option C, the french fairy tales inform us about the probable cause/motive behind writing Aladdin but doesn't lead to information regarding its authorship.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



166. **C**

Refer to the lines "The student of human history can draw on many more natural experiments than just comparisons among the five inhabited continents. Comparisons can also utilize large islands that have developed complex societies in a considerable degree of isolation (such as Japan, Madagascar. Native American Hispaniola, New Guinea, Hawaii, and many others), as well as societies on hundreds of smaller islands and regional societies within each of the continents."

From this, we can understand that the students of history are missing opportunities by not studying a sufficient variety of natural experiments. Option c) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

167. **C**

Consider the following lines from the passage: "Those include confounding effects of natural variation in additional variables besides the one of interest, as well as problems in inferring chains of causation from observed correlations between variables."

This explains the reason why islands with considerable degree of isolation provide valuable insights into human history. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

168. E

Refer to the following lines "Prediction in history, as in other historical sciences, is most feasible on large spatial scales and over long times, when the unique features of millions of small-scale brief events become averaged out. Just as I could predict the sex ratio of the next 1,000 newborns but not the sexes of my own two children. the historian can recognize factors that made inevitable the broad outcome of the collision between American and Eurasian societies after 13,000 years of separate developments, but not the outcome of the 1960 U.S. presidential election"

From this we can understand the reason why the author says prediction in history is difficult is because historical sciences suffer from the inability to conduct controlled experiments. Option e) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

169. B

The sentence "the arts wield their creative power not so much a new horizon from a new horizon" says that the art words do not differ in their "width" and "breadth" as well as "life" and "interpretation of life". => Options C and D are wrong.

Option A is irrelevant as it is not discussed in the passage.

The comparison between Madonna and modern day singer is not correct => option E wrong.

Option B is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

170. C

Refer to the following lines of the paragraph: "Adventurers of experience set out as though in lifeboats to rescue and bring back to the shore treasures of knowing and feeling which the old order had left floating on the high seas. The works of the early Renaissance and the poetry of Shakespeare vibrate with the compassion for live experience in danger of dying from exposure and neglect."

Here the author refers to the poets of renaissance as adventurers of experience.

Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



171. A

After giving the example of "sea" and "the other creation", Rilke says "I suddenly understood the situation of the poet, his place and his function in this age".

Option a) captures this idea succinctly. None of the other options are applicable.

Option A is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

172. C

The author states that the stock exchange and the black market are both market institutions, but notes that the stock exchange is formal, while the black market is not. This suggests that the two institutions differ in terms of how they are structured and operate, and the author suggests that this difference is an example of how different kinds of institutions can co-exist within the same domain. Option C aptly presents this idea. Contrarily, the ideas mentioned in Options A, B and D are not supported by the information in the passage.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 [VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

173. D

Based on the passage, the correct inference is: Option D - **"natural language" refers to that stage of language development where no conscious human intent is evident in the formation of language.**

The passage states that natural languages are "the result of human action, but not the execution of any human design," suggesting that they are not consciously designed or modified. Artificial languages and reformed natural languages, on the other hand, are described as introducing "design into their modifications or refinements," indicating that they are consciously modified.

The passage does not support the other inferences. In fact, it suggests that culture and tradition can be understood as subsets of institutions and have analytical, explanatory, and expository power when they are studied in this context. It also suggests that there are both informal and formal institutions, and that many institutions are a mixture of the two, rather than being mutually exclusive categories. The passage also does not imply that institutions like the family, rituals, governance, economy, and the military are natural and cannot be consciously modified; rather, it suggests that these institutions are the product of conscious attempts to mold and plan them, and that they can be modified through processes such as family law, established and disestablished churches, constitutions and laws, and so on [Options A, B and C].

 [VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

174. D

The passage discusses the concept of institutions within the philosophy of the social sciences. Institutions are seen as structures that coordinate the actions of individuals and can be either formal or informal; in this regard, the author discusses various types of institutions, including universal institutions, formal institutions, and informal institutions. The author also argues that culture and tradition can be seen as subsets of institutions, and that language is a particularly important institution that shapes social life and science. The author notes that there can be differences in the way that institutions are understood and emphasized by different social scientists but that these differences are often matters of emphasis rather than fundamental disagreements. Primarily, the passage underlines that these institutions are structures that coordinate the actions of individuals. Option D best captures the essence of the abovementioned elements.

Option A is incorrect because it only partially reflects what the author says about culture and tradition. While the author does discuss culture and tradition in relation to institutions, they are not treated as being completely separate from institutions. Instead, the author argues that culture and tradition can be seen as subsets of institutions, meaning they are part of institutions rather than completely separate from them. Option B exaggerates the emphasis the author places on language as an institution. While the author does discuss language as an important institution, he does not suggest that it is the only or even the most fundamental institution. Option C, while true, does not capture the main focus of the passage, which is on the concept of institutions in general rather than on specific examples of institutions.

 [VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

175. D

{We begin with the emergence of the philosophy of the social sciences as an arena of thought and as a set of social institutions. The two characterisations overlap but are not congruent. Academic disciplines are social institutions. . .}

In the first paragraph of the passage, the two "characterisations" that are seen as overlapping but not congruent are the philosophy of the social sciences as an arena of thought [academic discipline] and as a set of social institutions. The author suggests that these two characterizations overlap in the sense that they both involve the study of social phenomena, but they are not congruent because the philosophy of the social sciences is a field of study that encompasses a broad range of ideas and theories, while social institutions are specific structures that organize and coordinate social action. Although they are related, they are not identical and can be understood as distinct but overlapping aspects of the social sciences. Option D correctly represents the above.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



176. **A**

By "Depth", the author suggests a scenario that adds value or supplies additional information which supports his claim.

Option A: If the startup products grow exponentially and are self-sufficient and do not expand to other products, this scenario directly contradicts the author's probable prediction of these companies. Hence, it would add the least depth to the author's argument. A is the correct answer.

Option B: Lets consider that startups with few product options already exist. In such a case, these startups are no exceptions. For the sake of steep growth and surviving, they might have to expand into different product categories. Hence it adds some depth to the author's prediction.

Option C: "There may be no way to opt-out of stuff by buying into the right thing." The author is clearly displeased with startups ending up with overwhelming variety. Losing regular customers for better growth further invigorates the author's claim against numerous choices. Hence, it adds some value to his criticism.

Option D: If the government doubles their tax rates, as these startups are dependent on select customers for income, they might have to venture into other products and varieties to accentuate their returns and keep the company afloat. Hence, their fate would likely end up the way author predicted it to be.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

177. **D**

Option A: Paragraph 1 says "choice fatigue is one reason so many people gravitate toward lifestyle influencers on Instagram". Hence, as per the passage, a company with wide range of products and a lifestyle influencer is likely to perform better than a company with only wide range of products. Hence, this statement negates the claim of the author.

Option B: "As options have expanded for people with disposable income, the opportunity to buy even basic things such as fresh food or quality diapers has contracted for much of America's lower classes." The author argues that variety of products are offered only for a certain class of consumers other than the lower class. If variety of options indeed helped the poor, then his argument is weakened.

Option C: "Research has consistently held that people who are presented with a few options make better, easier decisions than those presented with many". "Americans have lost the ability to sort through the sheer volume". Clearly, people are overwhelmed by options and prefer lesser variety. Hence, option C is contradictory.

Option D: This option is largely vague and leaves unanswered questions behind. Also, the author doesn't make any comparison between the growth of these two type of companies. The author only says that, as the company targets only few consumers, for the want of growth they are likely to expand to variety of products. As there is no information about their growths, this option neither strengthens nor weakens the claim.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

178. **C**

Option A: The startups Casper and Glossier are certainly breaking the trend of choice anxiety. Yet, the author argues that they are turning into something that they intended to disrupt. Hence, this does not capture the purpose of the author.

Option B: The author argues that even these startups are targeting select few mid-range customers rather than the lower classes. Hence, this option directly contradicts the author's claim.

Option C: These startups initially started as an exception to offering a wide variety of choices. Yet, due to limited customers, and want of steep growth, they might transform into a type of company that they intended to disrupt. Hence, this option correctly resounds the authors fear and captures his purpose of argument. Hence C is correct

Option D: This option is largely vague and can have multiple interpretations. One interpretation can be that these startups are targeting a selected band of customers and do not have offering for lower-class customers. Hence, there is no uniform distribution.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

179. **A**

The author principally argues for lesser choices. He says that choice anxiety is overwhelming and people make better decisions with lesser choices.

He is also critical about companies targeting only certain band of well-off customers and critiques them for not offering products for consumers of lower classes.

Hence, a product group with lesser variety, and targeted to lower class customers would be most acceptable to the author.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

180. **C**

Option A: Paragraph 1 says "Since Americans have lost the ability to sort through the sheer volume of the consumer choices available to them" Since the product options are overwhelming, they are unable to sort through the options. Hence, option A can be inferred from the passage.

Option B: Paragraph 1 says "Research has consistently industry unto itself." As people experience choice anxiety due to overwhelming options, they are unable to trust products while selecting. Hence, they look-out for celebrities and curators to make a decision.

Option C: There is no such comparison in the passage that shows people's preference towards products by startups. Hence, option C cannot be inferred.

Option D: Paragraph 1 says "a ghost now has to be in the retail machine, whether it's an algorithm, an influencer, or some snazzy ad tech to help a product follow you around the internet". Due to our inability to sort, we depend on influencers or we are vulnerable to snazzy ads to purchase products. Hence, D can be inferred.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



The banner features a yellow background. On the left, there is a photo of a man and a woman standing together. In the center, the text 'CAT Online Coaching' is written in large, bold, black letters. Below this, a red button contains the white text 'your road to IIM stars here'. On the right side, there is a small logo that says 'cracku' and an illustration of a person sitting at a desk with a laptop.

181. D

The passage asserts that "Histories of places live on in many forms, one of which is the human memory or imagination." The passage also implies that these places and their "emotional component, although subjective, is no less 'real' than a surveyor's map." It follows that, in literature, descriptions of places do not need satellite imagery or other visual aids to give a "real" sense of the place. If this were to be false, the arguments made in the passage would be contradicted. Option A is not the correct answer.

From "Both real and imaginary landscapes provide insight into the human experience of place", we can also infer that if option B were to be false, the information would contradict the passage. Option B is not the correct answer.

From "Literature can bring together material that spans different branches of science. For example, a literary description of place may involve not only the environment and geography but the noises and quality of light, or how people from different races or classes can experience the same place in different ways linked to those racial or class disparities. Literary texts can also account for the way in which absence—of other people, animals, and so on—affects a human observer or inhabitant", we can infer that literature can be a powerful device that can produce vivid realities through descriptions. If option C were to be false, it would contradict the information provided in the passage. Option C is not the correct answer.

From "In human experience, geographical places have a spiritual or emotional component in addition to and as part of a physical layout and topography. This emotional component, although subjective, is no less "real" than a surveyor's map," we can infer that the physical and emotional experience of a place is subjective. Therefore, if option D were to be false, the arguments provided in the passage will not be contradicted. Option D is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

182. B

The paragraph states that "For example, a literary description of place may involve not only the environment and geography but the noises and quality of light, or how people from different races or classes can experience the same place in different ways linked to those racial or class disparities."

Based on this and the information provided in the passage, it would be wrong to consider the fact that scientific approaches to place are more (or less) accurate than literary ones. The most we can say is that both are useful and complementary. Option A is incorrect.

Option B follows from the example of literary description, which examines how people from different backgrounds experience the same place differently, and is therefore the correct answer.

Option C mentions architects and the diverse methods they use, which is not the reason why the passage provides the example of literary descriptions. Similarly, option D examines in detail how the absence of people and animals affects the inhabitants and fails to capture the broader message the passage seeks to convey through the example provided.

Option B is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

183. C

The sentence "The pursuit of such a topic speaks to the valuable knowledge produced from bridging disciplines and combining material from both the arts and the sciences to better understand the human condition" refers to the importance of "bridging" or intermixing of the material from both arts and sciences in understanding the human condition. The statement that best captures this is provided in option C.

Option A is incorrect as "bridging of human condition" is a wrong inference. Option B, although partly correct, misses the message of "bridging" which forms the core of the sentence. Option D is incorrect as it reverses the relationship of the importance of knowledge from arts and science in our understanding of the human condition by writing that human emotions are essential contributors to our understanding of arts and sciences.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

184. **C**

The second paragraph primarily emphasises the importance of literature in providing insights into the emotional dimension of physical and cultural geography, which is all too often missing from scientific records. The paragraph notes that this emotional or spiritual component is primarily subjective and that the history of a place also exists in memory and imagination.

Accordingly, options A, B, and D follow. Option C is extreme in that it says that the emotional and spiritual experience of a place can replace a surveyor's map, and is incorrect. Although the emotional and spiritual experience can complement the factual information about geographic and physical world provided by the scientific record, it cannot replace it.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

185. **D**

The passage states that:

The West's great strategic writer, Clausewitz, linked war to politics, as did Sun-tzu. Both were opponents of militarism, of turning war over to the generals. But there all similarity ends.

Hence, we can eliminate options A and B.

The contrast between the two strategic writers view has been described by the following lines. Clausewitz's view was:

In this view, war proceeds along a fixed course and occupies a finite extent of time, like a play in three acts with a beginning, a middle, and an end. The end, the final scene, decides the issue for good.

Hence, the two writers had different conceptions of how the structure, time and sequence of war.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



186. **B**

Option B is given as an example of the Western way of war while options A, C and D are characteristics of the Asian way of war. Hence, option B.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

187. **D**

In the passage, the author talks about how America was not able to adapt its way of fighting according to the terrain and culture it found itself in. America was used to fighting open field battles and struggled to fight in the jungles against guerilla war tactics. Hence, option D best captures this point.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

188. **A**

Option A is contrary to what is stated in the passage.

In Sun-tzu and other Chinese writings, the highest achievement of arms is to defeat an adversary without fighting. He wrote: "To win one hundred victories in one hundred battles is not the acme of skill. To subdue the enemy without fighting is the supreme excellence."

Sun-tzu believed that war should not be the first resort. Hence, option A is definitely not one of his ideas.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

189. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "Pearl Harbor, the Chinese intervention in Korea, and the Tet offensive in Vietnam all came out of a tradition of surprise and stealth. U.S. technical intelligence - the location of enemy units and their movements was greatly improved after each surprise, but with no noticeable improvement in the American ability to foresee or prepare what would happen next".

Here the author suggests that even though the technical intelligence of USA increased, they couldn't counter stealth based attack.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

190. **A**

The passage states that:

To the American strategic mind, the Viet Cong guerrilla did not fight fairly. He should have come out into the open and fought like a man, instead of hiding in the jungle and sneaking around like a cat in the night.

Hence, option A.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Syllabus PDF



191. **B**

The passage states that:

"However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisan secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails."

Hence, we can eliminate options A, C and D as they contradict what is given above. The author states that the state will do anything, including genocide, to preserve order. Hence, we can infer option B.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

192. **D**

Option A can be inferred from the following line: "There are two ways in which the current upsurge in demands for the recognition of identities can be looked at." The author goes on to mention an upside and a downside.

Option B can be concluded from the given lines: "On the downside, however, militant action for recognition tends to make such groups more deeply entrenched in their attitude and to make their cultural compartments even more watertight."

Option C can be concluded from the following lines: "What these groups are doing - proclaiming that they are different, rediscovering the roots of their culture or strengthening group solidarity - may accordingly be seen as legitimate attempts to escape from their state of subjugation and enjoy a certain measure of dignity."

Hence, all three options directly follow from the passage.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

193. **A**

The passage states that:

"In the name of modernisation in the West, of socialism in the Eastern bloc, and of development in the Third World, it was expected to guarantee the happiness of individuals as citizens and of peoples as societies."

Hence, only option A is correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

194. **D**

The passage states that:

"First, we must bear the arbitrary nature of identity categories in mind, not with a view to eliminating all forms of identification—which would be unrealistic since identity is a cognitive necessity."

Hence, we can eliminate option C.

It also states that:

"Identity is thus a necessity in a constantly changing world, but it can also be a potent source of violence and disruption."

Thus option B can be eliminated.

The passage states that:

"Paradoxically, precisely because identity represents a simplifying fiction, creating uniform groups out of disparate people, that identity performs a cognitive function."

Hence, all options except D are eliminated. Hence, none of the above.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

195. **C**

The passage states that:

However, the state today appears to have broken down in many parts of the world. It has failed to guarantee either security or social justice, and has been unable to prevent either international wars or civil wars. Disturbed by the claims of communities within it, the nation-state tries to repress their demands and to proclaim itself as the only guarantor of security of all. In the name of national unity, territorial integrity, equality of all its citizens and non-partisan secularism, the state can use its powerful resources to reject the demands of the communities; it may even go so far as genocide to ensure that order prevails.

Hence, options A, B and D are directly given in the passage. However, option C is not mentioned in the passage and is inconsistent with what is stated in the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



196. **A**

The passage states that :

The dialectic is nowhere more apparent than in the art of writing, for the literary object is a peculiar top which exists only in movement. To make it come into view a concrete act called reading is necessary, and it lasts only as long as this act can last.

Hence, option A directly follows from the passage.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

197. **C**

The passage states that "Each of our perceptions is accompanied by the consciousness that human reality is a 'revealer', that is, it is through ^{human} reality that 'there is' being, or, to put it differently, that man is the means by which things are manifested. It is our presence in the world which multiplies relations."

Hence, option C is stated in the paragraph.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

198. **B**

We can eliminate options C and D as they are contrary to what is stated in the passage. The passage states that all facets of nature, and not artistic creations, are revealed by human consciousness. The passage states that:

"The latter seeks essentiality in the creation and obtains it, but then it is the object which becomes the inessential."

Hence, we can infer option B.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

199. **D**

Perception and Creation are explained in terms of essentiality and non-essentiality in the third and fourth paras of the passage.

Hence the answer is Option D.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

200. **B**

The passage states that:

One of the chief motives of artistic creation is certainly the need of feeling that we are essential in relationship to the world.

Hence, an artist makes us feel essential vis-a-vis nature.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

The banner features a blue background. On the left, there is a photo of two people, a man and a woman, both wearing black t-shirts with 'IIM' on them. To their right, the text 'IIM Call Predictor' is written in large, white, bold letters. Below this text, a yellow button contains the text 'Accurate analysis of your profile'. On the far right of the banner is a white icon of a bar chart with an upward-pointing arrow.

201. **B**

(b) is the correct answer choice: This answer emerges from para 2, second sentence: "... WTO was a product of a series of trade-offs between principal actors and groups." The important players were essentially the United States; Europeans; countries like Canada and other middle and smaller trading partners; and the developing countries, which continued negotiations as part of the Uruguay Round till the 1990s. The Tokyo Round of the 1970s was an attempt at a 'constitutional reform' of the GATT, while what the important players eventually settled for in the WTO was the evolution of a rules-based system through multiple negotiations which obviously required time.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

202. **D**

The passage states that:

Over the past two decades the European Court of Justice (ECJ) has consistently rendered decisions that have expanded incrementally the EU's internal market, in which the doctrine of 'mutual recognition' handed down in the case Cassis de Dijon in 1979 was a key turning point.

Hence, the doctrine of "mutual recognition" was a key turning point. Hence, option D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

203. **A**

Refer to the lines "Legal development can be defined as promotion of the technical legal values of consistency, clarity (or, certainty) and effectiveness; these are values that those responsible for administering any legal system will seek to maximise. As it played out in the WTO, consistency meant integrating under one roof the whole lot of separate agreements signed under GATT auspices; clarity meant removing ambiguities about the powers of contracting parties to make certain decisions or to undertake waivers; and effectiveness meant eliminating exceptions arising out of grandfather-rights and resolving defects in dispute settlement procedures and institutional provisions." Hence, we can eliminate options C and D as the passage states that these are contrary to technical legal values. From the passage, we can infer that technical legal values were promoted by integrating under one roof the different agreements signed under GATT. Hence, option A.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

204. **B**

The passage states many countries individual reasons for accepting WTO. However, it highlights that "Finally, and perhaps most important, many countries at the Uruguay Round came to put a higher priority on the export gains than on the import losses that the negotiation would produce, and they came to associate the WTO and a rules-based system with those gains. This reasoning - replicated in many countries - was contained in U.S. Ambassador Kantor's defence of the WTO, and it amounted to a recognition that international trade and its benefits cannot be enjoyed unless trading nations accept the discipline of a negotiated rules-based environment." Hence, option B correctly captures why many countries accepted WTO.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

205. **D**

The passage states that:

One means the Court used to expand integration was the 'teleological method of interpretation', whereby the actions of member states were evaluated against 'the accomplishment of the most elementary community goals set forth in the Preamble to the [Rome] treaty'.

Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



206. **A**

Let's look at the passage:

"Finally, and perhaps most important, many countries at the Uruguay Round came to put a higher priority on the export gains than on the import losses that the negotiation would produce, and they came to associate the WTO and a rules-based system with those gains. This reasoning - replicated in many countries - was contained in U.S. Ambassador Kantor's defence of the WTO, and it amounted to a recognition that international trade and its benefits cannot be enjoyed unless trading nations."

Here, "it" refers to the subject of the sentence which is "This reasoning" as contained in the defence of Ambassador Kantor of the WTO. Hence, option A.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

207. **A**

The author gave the example of Archbishop to illustrate why the wealth cannot be distributed according to human souls.

Option A is similar to the above statement.

Hence, A is the answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

208. **C**

"On the other hand, people who are generous, public spirited, friendly, and not always thinking of the main chance, stay poor when they are born poor unless they have extraordinary talents."

According to the author generous people need extraordinary talents to become rich.

 VIEW SOLUTION

209. **B**

"that the industrious and sober and thrifty are never in want, and that poverty is due to idleness, improvidence, drinking, betting, dishonesty, and bad character generally."

Idleness, Alcoholism(drinking) and gambling(betting) are mentioned in the passage whereas drug addiction is not.

Hence, option B is the answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

210. **C**

"The very first one settles the question for good and all. It is, that the proposal is impossible and impractical. How are you going to measure anyone's merit in money?"

From this statement, we can say that the author feels that there are no standards to judge goodness or badness in relation to money.

Hence, option C is the answer

 VIEW SOLUTION



CAT Score Calculator



211. **A**

Improvvidence is spending extravagantly.

Hence, option A is the answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

212. **D**

"People who are hard, grasping, selfish, cruel, and always ready to take advantage of their neighbours, become very rich if they are clever enough not to overreach themselves."

Only "ambitious people" is not mentioned in the above statement.

Hence, option D is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

213. **C**

"On this, intelligent Lady, your first thought may be that if

Through the words "intelligent lady", we can say that the author has written this letter to someone.

Hence, option C is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

214. **B**

"Everyone can see that it generally has the contrary effect; it makes a few idle people very rich, and a great many hardworking people very poor."

From this statement, we can say that the author feels that the distribution of wealth is in favour of the rich. Hence, option B can be inferred.

The author does not agree with the sentiment that the poor will become rich only if they work hard. He believes that the world is unfair to them. Hence, he will not agree with option A.

Though the author says that being deceitful can make a person rich, he does not recommend being deceitful. Hence, option C is incorrect.

Option D is not supported by any information given in the passage.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

215. **B**

Fungi multinucleate because they frequently do not have cross walls, which divide mycelium into specific cells.

Hence, option B is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



216. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "The uninucleate situation, however, is typical for the vast majority of cells, and it would appear that this is the most efficient and most economical manner of partitioning living substance into manageable units". It correctly summarises option c.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

217. **A**

Refer to the following lines: "Schleiden and Schwann, when setting forth the cell doctrine in the 1830s, considered that it had a central role in growth and development. Their belief has been fully supported even though they had only vague notions as to what that role might be, and how the role was to be expressed in some cellular action." Here the author suggests that although the contention is true but Schleiden and Schwann had only little idea at the time. Option A is correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

218. **D**

Sieve tubes and red blood cells of mammals do not have nuclei during a greater part of their existence but they have nuclei when they are in a less differentiated state.

Prokaryotic cells have nuclei according to the passage.

Hence, the answer is "none of these".

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

219. **D**

The function of the crystalline layer is undetermined yet.

Hence, option D is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

220. **B**

Option b can be inferred from the given lines: "Some, like the unicellular protozoan paramecium, are normally binucleate, one of the nuclei serving as a source of hereditary information for the next generation, the other governing the day-to-day metabolic activities of the cell."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



221. **C**

"In some white blood cells, such as polymorphonucleated leukocytes, and in cells of the spinning gland of some insects and spiders, the nucleus is very much lobed. The reason for this is not clear, but it may relate to the fact that for a given volume of nucleus, a lobate form provides a much greater surface area for nuclear-cytoplasmic exchanges, possibly affecting both the rate and the amount of metabolic reactions."

From the above statement, we can say that option C is true.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

222. **C**

"The fact is that most subsidies go to the 'rich' (defined in the Indian context as those who are above the poverty line, and much of the tab goes indirectly to the poor." => Addresses option A

"Because the hefty subsidy bill results in fiscal deficits, which in turn push up rates of inflation." => Addresses option B and D

Hence, option C is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

223. **D**

In the whole part of the passage the author laments the subsidy system and highlights that how subsidy system is inefficient and hits the poor the hardest. In all of the options the author substantiates removing subsidy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

224. **A**

"The Deve Gowda government has shown some courage in biting the bullet when it comes to the price of petroleum products."

The only statement that is said in a positive connotation about Deve Gowda government by the author is about petroleum products' prices.

His government was not able to avoid subsidy issue.

Hence, option A is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

225. **D**

"Because the hefty subsidy bill results in fiscal deficits, which in turn push up rates of inflation — which, as everyone knows, hits the poor the hardest of all." => Addresses option A

"The Andhra Pradesh Government has been bankrupted by selling rice at Rs. 2 per kg." => Addresses option C

"Delhi's subsidised bus fares have bankrupted the Delhi Transport Corporation." => Addresses option B

Hence, option D is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



226. **A**

Refer to the following sentences: "This thesis has been applied not just in the poor countries but in the rich ones as well; hence...incentive to work". In these sentences, the author is pointing out the fact that the belief in the efficacy of the system in the western countries was false because it could not possibly be sustained. Option a) brings this out clearly and is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

227. **B**

"Because the hefty subsidy bill results in fiscal deficits, which in turn push up rates of inflation — which, as everyone knows, hits the poor the hardest of all."

The author feels that subsidy is more destructive to the economy than constructive.

Option B is the best fit.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

228. **D**

"The theory — and the political fiction on the basis of which it is sold to unsuspecting voters — is that subsidies go to the poor, and are paid for by the rich."

The author has used the word fiction for the above theory.

Hence, option D is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

229. **A**

The author talks about subsidy in a negative connotation throughout the passage.

Option A talks about the same in a sarcastic way.

Hence, option A is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

230. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "Again they call on their home government to civilize a further area; and so bit by bit the civilized Empire grows at the expense of the home taxpayers, without any intention or approval on their part, until at last although all their real patriotism is centred on their own people and confined to their own country, their own rulers, and their own religious faith; they find that the centre of their beloved realm has shifted to the other hemisphere."

In the passage the author talks about how the capitalists come in the country on pretext of selling goods and ultimately rule the entire nation.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



231. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "Now it is not easy to send them to civilized countries, because they practise Protection, which means that they impose heavy taxes (customs duties) on foreign goods. Uncivilized countries, without Protection, and inhabited by natives to whom gaudy calicoes and cheap showy brassware are dazzling and delightful novelties, are the best places to make for at first." These lines confirm option b to be the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

232. **D**

Refer to the following lines: "Of course the business does not stop there. The riff-raff who have created the emergency move out just beyond the boundary of the annexed territory, and are as great a nuisance as ever to the traders when they have exhausted the purchasing power of the included natives and push on after fresh customers. Again they call on their home government to civilize a further area; and so bit by bit the civilized Empire grows at the expense of the home taxpayers, without any intention or approval on their part, until at last although all their real patriotism is centred on their own people and confined to their own country, their own rulers, and their own religious faith; they find that the centre of their beloved realm has shifted to the other hemisphere." In this paragraph, the author highlights how the civilized empire grows at the expense of home taxpayers without their consent. Hence the answer is D.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

233. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "This, as we have seen, does go abroad in heaps of finished products. But the British land held by him on long lease, must, when once he has sold all the goods at home that his British customers can afford to buy, either shut up his works until the customers have worn out their stock of what they have bought, which would bankrupt him (for the landlord will not wait), or else sell his superfluous goods somewhere else" In this passage the author tries to give the reasons of trade of finished goods not coming under capital already invested. The correct option is c

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

234. **A**

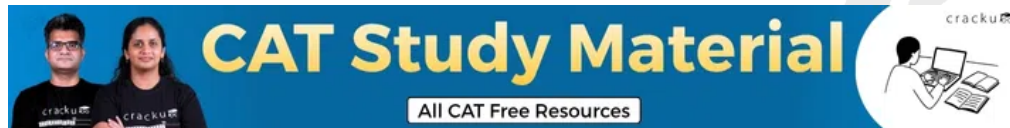
From the passage, we cannot infer that author was in a bad mood or that he was working in the British foreign service. Also, there is nothing to suggest that the author's country was overrun by the British. However, we can infer that the passage belongs to a period when the British was still a colonial power. Refer to the following sentence: "This, as we have seen, does go abroad in heaps of finished products". The tense of this sentence gives us a hint that the passage was written when the British was still a colonial power.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

235. **A**

The meaning of officious is self important or bumptious which matches with option A

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



236. **A**

"But trade requires a settled government to put down the habit of plundering strangers. This is not a habit of simple tribes, who are often friendly and honest. It is what civilized men do where there is no law to restrain them."

From the above statement, we can say that option A is true.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

237. **A**

Option B is irrelevant to the passage.

The author does not mention machines as gods => Option C is wrong.

The quality of leisure activities differs from person to person. This serves as a suitable first line of the next paragraph as the author discussed about leisure in the passage.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

238. **B**

"And the only compensation we have for this deterioration is that pins are so cheap that a single pin has no expressible value at all. Even with a big profit stuck on to the cost-price you can buy dozens for a farthing; and pins are so recklessly thrown away and wasted that verses have to be written to persuade children (without success) that it is a sin to steal, if even it's a pin."

From the above statement, we can say that option B is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

239. **D**

"By the end of the 18th century Adam Smith boasted that it took 18 men to make a pin."

"Now, the men, it is said, could turn out nearly 5000 pins a day each."

These two statements can be used to infer that it took much longer to make a pin earlier.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

240. **B**

The author talks about capitalism in the passage. Also, he had a negative connotation towards capitalism.

Between B and D, B is more suitable because D has a positive tone towards capitalism.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



241. **C**

The author is not showing any revenge => Not vindictive

The author is not showing exaggerated patriotism => Not chauvinistic

He never meant any disrespect => Not demeaning.

Satirical is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

242. **B**

In the passage, the author talks about how men forget the nuances of individual ability as they get better off monetarily. Option B correctly summarises the dictum.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

243. **A**

Consider the lines "There was a time when pinmakers would buy the material; shape it; make the head and the point; ornament it; and take it to the market, and sell it and the making required skill in several operations. They not only knew how the thing was done from beginning to end, but could do it all by themselves."

The author is complaining how despite increased volume of production, the workers have lost their skills and a single worker does not have the complete knowledge to make things. He calls the people who make everything for themselves intelligent and resourceful. Hence it can be inferred that he supports craftsmanship over bulk production.

Hence, option A is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

244. **B**

In the passage, the author discusses how spreading the production of a pin from one person to 18 people led to an increase in overall production but a decay in quality of labor. Hence, he believes that this is an undesirable way of producing things. By giving the example, the author tries to show how the economist Adam Smith was proud of an achievement in production that had substantial negative impact on people. Thus, only option B correctly conveys this sentiment.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

245. **C**

Though the new pin makers were less knowledgeable than the old pin makers, Adam Smith boasted it as a triumph in civilization because of the mass production that the new pin makers could make.

Hence, Adam Smith is not against mass production.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT Quant Questions



246. **A**

Refer to the lines of the third paragraph: "A subject does not start with what is put in front of the easel or with something which the painter happens to remember."

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

247. **A**

Refer to the following lines of the paragraph: "When a culture is in a state of disintegration or transitions the freedom of the artist increases – but the question of subject matter becomes problematic for him: he, himself, has to choose for society."

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

248. **C**

Refer to the lines of the para: "The subject may have a personal meaning for the painter or individual spectator; but there must also be the possibility of their agreement on its general meaning. It is at this point that the culture of the society and period in question precedes the artist and his art." This implies that the subject need not necessarily have a personal meaning for the painter.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

249. **B**

Refer to the lines: "When a culture is in a state of disintegration or transitions the freedom of the artist increases – but the question of subject matter becomes problematic for him: he, himself, has to choose for society." This implies option 2.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

250. **C**

In first para we find the 2nd last sentence as '... by the next generation, painters began to abandon the subject altogether, and began to paint abstract pictures...' Then second para is continued on connection between these 2 developments. Hence option C is the correct answer.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions



251. **D**

Statement A has been discussed in the passage while giving the example of clergymen and waiter. Hence, it is correct.

By the example of the father, we can say that statement B is true.

In the passage, the author has not mentioned that development of skill may result in denial of the self. So, statement C is incorrect.

So, only statements A and B are correct. Option d) is the correct answer.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

252. **E**

The passage does not talk about "absence of strong biological linkages". Hence, option A is wrong.

The statement in option 2 does not agree with the passage. Hence, option B is wrong.

Option 3 is contrary to the passage.

The passage never stated that human behavior depends on biological linkages. Hence, option D is wrong.

Option E correctly captures the theme of the passage.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

253. **B**

We must look for an option that we do not consider as normal.

Except option B, all the options are normal.

For example, it is absolutely fine with us if a waiter serves more than that is expected from him.

But we are offended when a father behaves in a tongue in cheek manner. If biological linkages structured human society, it should not matter to us how a father behaves. Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

254. **A**

From the part of passage where the following sentence occurs '... they exist, for Derrida, in a series of hierarchical relationships with the first term normally occupying a superior position..' we can infer that option A is correct option.

 [VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

255. **A**

From the following sentences '... refer not only to what the author of a text intends, but also to what is absent from his or her intention. This insight leads, once again, to Derrida's further rejection of the idea of the definitive authority..' we can make out that option A is the reason why Derrida rejects the idea of 'definitive authority of the subject'.

 [VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



256. **C**

In the lines "Logocentrism is the search for a rational language that is able to know and represent the world and establishing systems of binary opposition", Derrida has mentioned three characteristics of logocentrism, which are options A, B and D.

Only option C is not mentioned and is hence the answer.

 [VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

257. **D**

From the starting part of the passage we have '..can be taken to refer to a methodological strategy which seeks to uncover layers of hidden meaning in a text that have been denied or suppressed..' Hence option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

258. **A**

The entire passage revolves around how cities provide grounds for creativity to flourish and how our education system stifles it.

Option B states that creativity and ideas are gradually declining. But, in the last paragraph, the author mentions that 'Creativity itself is not in danger'. Therefore, we can rule out option B.

Option D states that more people must engage in creative jobs. But it cannot be said to be the central idea of the passage. As we have discussed, the passage revolves around social interaction and creativity divide. Therefore, we can eliminate option D too.

Options A and C are close. But, the author describes creativity divide more as an effect than the problem itself. Barring the last 2 paragraphs, the author describes about the importance of social interaction and how the lack of it kills creativity. Since the question is about the central idea, option A can be deemed a better fit than option C.

Therefore, option A is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

259. **B**

There has been no talk about technology in the entire passage. Therefore, we can eliminate option B straight away.

Also, option A states that children become more creative as they get older. However, the exact opposite has been discussed in the passage. Therefore, we can eliminate option A too.

Among options B and C, option C attributes reduction in creativity to learning more. But, in the paragraph about 'what stanches creativity', the author mentions that institutions that were created to promote creativity stifle it. He then produces the 1968 study as a validation of the argument. Therefore, the author implies that schools and colleges stifle creativity.

Hence, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

260. **C**

In the passage, the author clearly describes that Jane Jacobs attributes creativity to the type of leaders. From the paragraph about 'squelchers', we can infer that Jane Jacobs holds leaders responsible for the creativity of the people. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF

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261. **D**

In the paragraph starting with 'cities are true fronts of creativity', author mentions that cities have diverse population.

The author also mentions that cities provide the space where people can meet and share ideas. Then, the author discusses the financial and organizational infrastructure that cities provide for ideas to flourish.

No where has it been mentioned that cities provide access to cultural activities. We cannot infer option D from the passage.

Therefore, option D is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

262. **A**

In the paragraph regarding creative cities, the author makes a remark that the creativity of only those people who work with their mind are utilized. Therefore, we can infer that the author thinks that the creativity of people who do not work with their minds (who work with their hands) is not utilized. Therefore, option A is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

263. **B**

'Irony' is a term used to define an activity defeating its very purpose. Therefore, the answer must be along similar lines - a method or activity that stifles its purpose.

In the passage (1968 survey), the author describes how schools and colleges, the institutions that were supposed to foster creativity, stifle it. Also, in the paragraph preceding the paragraph about survey, the author mentions explicitly that the institutes created to promote creativity stifle it. Therefore, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

264. **C**

The entire passage revolves around the effects of climate change on subnivium. We can eliminate option D directly as it talks about a small illustration. It cannot be said to be the purpose of the passage. Options A and B emphasize subnivium as the subject. However, the passage is about the effects of climate change on subnivium rather than subnivium itself. Throughout the passage, the author discusses the effects of various climatic changes and how it affects the subnivium.

Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

265. **A**

Options B and D mention that it will be the arctic and the temperate regions that will be affected. Though we do not know the effect of climate change on the tropical regions, we cannot claim that there will be no effects. The passage does not give us sufficient information to make that claim. Therefore, we can rule out options B and D.

Option C states that a compact layer of wool is warmer than a similarly compact layer of goose down. Again, the passage does not provide us with sufficient information to substantiate this claim. We do not have sufficient details to compare 2 different materials. Therefore, option C can be ruled out as well.

Option A talks about ripple effect. The entire passage is about how the effects of climate change are interrelated. Ripple effect also discusses the same. Therefore, option A is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

**CAT Important Topics**

266. **D**

The reason for the inclusion of the shrubs must be in line with the central idea of the passage. Options A and C are too general and hence, can be ruled out easily. Option B states that plants that tend to survive turn out to be shrubs. But, it has not been mentioned anywhere in the passage.

The last paragraph clearly mentions that the effects of colder subnivium are multilayered and interrelated. The shrubs tend to prove the point. The paragraph discusses the effect on the shrubs in detail, adding substance to the statement.

Therefore, option D is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

267. **B**

The author mentions in the passage that the quality of snow also plays a vital role. Therefore, maintaining 8 inches of snow with a machine will not fix the problem. Moreover, the option feels too shallow and unsustainable. Therefore, we can eliminate option A.

Option C also feels shallow and unrealistic. Moreover, it has not been mentioned that adding nutrients will fix the issue.

Option D suggests planting shrubs. But, in the last paragraph the author mentions that the effects are multilayered and complex. Options A, C, and D try to address the symptom than attacking the cause. Option B offers a more viable solution and addresses the cause of the issue rather than its manifestation. Therefore, the author is most likely to agree with option B and hence, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

268. **B**

The author mentions that 'Both depth and density of snow are sensitive to temperature.' Therefore, we can easily eliminate option A.

Option C talks about the insulating properties of subnivium which has been explicitly mentioned in the passage - 'Although that might still sound cold, a constant temperature of 32°F can often be 30 to 40 degrees warmer than the air temperature during the peak of winter.' Therefore, we can eliminate option C too.

Option D states that researchers have established the adverse effects of the dwindling snow cover in subnivium. From the line starting with 'research has shown that...', we can infer that the effects of the dwindling snow cover on subnivium has been established.

The entire passage does not discuss any positive effect of climate change on the subnivium. Therefore, we can say that option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

269. **C**

In the passage, author uses the example to explain how having some spaces between layers increases the insulating property. He then uses the same logic to explain the effects of increase in density of snow on subnivium. Therefore, the author uses the example to draw an analogy. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

270. **D**

Refer to following lines, "...Mr Musk is selling a dream that the world ...This last may be the most important factor in the story. The private car..". Since people believe in the autonomy represented by private cars, Tesla had remarkable sales.

Option A is nowhere stated as the reason for high sales for Tesla. Hence, it can be eliminated.

Nowhere in the passage has the author mentioned about tax subsidy to Tesla buyers. Hence, option B can be eliminated.

The author states that there are limited number of specialised charging stations. But the author doesn't state that there will be significant increase in charging stations rapidly which would increase the sales. Hence, option C can be eliminated.

Option D correctly highlights the main reason for Tesla's remarkable sales. Hence, option D is the right choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT WhatsApp Group



271. **C**

The main argument around which the passage revolves can be referred from following statements made by the author "...The private car is...a device of immense practical ... but at the same time a theatre for myths of unattainable self-fulfilment... ". In the later part, the author substantiates this argument. Hence, option C, which states the same, must be the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

272. **C**

In paragraph 5 and 6 the author states that instead of cars having owners they'll work as taxis do, call the taxis at will and use only for journey which we actually need. According to the author this is the future towards which Uber is working.

Option A, which states that electric cars will have mechanisms to prevent collisions, is out of context. Hence, it is incorrect and can be eliminated.

Option B, which states that future will definitely have no traffic jams, is incorrect. Hence, option B can be eliminated.

Option C captures the points which we discussed. Hence, option C is the right answer.

The passage doesn't give any comparison about Uber rides and Tesla sales. Hence, option D is incorrect and can be eliminated.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

273. **D**

Refer to the following lines, "...the rarest materials for batteries would make undeserving despots and their dynasties fantastically rich..." Thus, the author states that relying on rare materials will support despotic rule. Hence, option A is correct and can be eliminated.

Refer to the following lines, "...The air in cities would once more be breathable and their streets as quiet as .. Cars that were as silent as bicycles ...". Hence, option B is correct and can be eliminated.

Refer to the following lines, "...traffic jam is trying to escape from it, yet it is the inevitable consequence of mass car ownership..." Hence, the author points out that the problem of traffic jam which persists with electric car as it is a consequence of mass car ownership. Hence, option C is correct and can be eliminated.

Option D, which states that electric cars will undermine the driver autonomy, cannot be inferred from the passage. Hence, option D is the right choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

274. **C**

Refer to the following lines, "...Traffic jams will be abolished only when the private car becomes a public utility...". According to the author the fantasy of autonomy comes full circle. Thus the author states that car drivers want autonomy but public transport will be the future as only then the traffic problem will be solved.

Option A, which states that car drivers will no longer own cars, is too extreme and can be ruled out.

Option B specifies something that is out of the scope of the paragraph. Hence, option B is incorrect.

Option C completely reflects what the author says in the end. Hence, it is the right choice.

Option D is again too extreme and cannot be found in the passage. Also, the author mentions electric bicycles just to provide an illustration. Hence, it can be eliminated.

Hence, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

275. B

According to the author we'll have no traffic jams only when cars become public utility. And, for us (people) to have independence, we'll have to start using electrically powered bicycles. Hence, option B, which states this, is the right answer.

Option A is nowhere mentioned in the passage. Hence, can be eliminated.

Author doesn't give any comparison, as mentioned in option C, between electric powered bicycle and electric cars. Hence, option C can be eliminated.

The author nowhere mentions that electric buses are the best form of public transport. Hence, option D can be eliminated.

Hence, option B is the right choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



276. C

The passage revolves around how vikings did not start out as pillagers but as traders. The intention of the author seems to dispel the notion that the Vikings were pillagers. The combs have been used just as an illustration to prove the author's hypothesis. Therefore, option A can be ruled out.

Option B states that the purpose was to change the period of Viking age. However, the passage does not hint any such intention. The author cites that the combs had made their way to Britain before the Viking age to substantiate the fact that Vikings were traders before they became pillagers. Therefore, we can rule out option B too.

Option D states that despite being pillagers, Vikings were efficient traders and craftsmen. However, the passage talks about a period prior to which Vikings turned pillagers. Therefore, we can eliminate option D too.

Option C states that the purpose of the passage is to dispel the notion that Vikings were pillagers. This seems the most appropriate option as the passage tries to establish the fact that Vikings started out as traders. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

277. D

The author mentions the statement to imply that the Vikings had trade relations with the British before the Viking age. The Viking age started in 793, whereas the artifacts predate this period. Therefore, the intention of the line "Most of the artifacts also date to the 780s, but some are as old as 725" is to emphasize that Vikings had trade relations. Therefore, option D is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

278. **A**

In the passage, it has been mentioned that "Such combs served as symbols of good health, Geggel writes". Therefore, we can infer option C and hence, it can be eliminated.

Option D states that "Vikings, once upon a time, had trade relations with Denmark and Scandinavia". The last paragraph mentions that "Beyond Norway, these combs would have been a popular industry in Scandinavia as well. It's possible that the antler combs represent a larger trade network, where the Norsemen supplied raw material to craftsmen in Denmark and elsewhere". Therefore, we can rule out option D too.

Option B states that the Vikings had trade relations with Northern Europe. This is the very theme of the passage. Hence, we can eliminate option B too.

Option A states that "Vikings brought reindeer from Norway to Denmark for trade purposes". However, the passage only mentions that they brought the antlers - not the Reindeers itself. Therefore, option A is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

279. **C**

"Residents of upscale residential developments have disclosed how important it is to maintain their community's distinct identity, often by casting themselves in a superior social position and by reinforcing class and racial differences."

Option A: The option implies that the clients are made to feel at home. While the phrase "Residents of upscale residential developments" is used to capture the intent of social dominance of a particular class. Hence this option is incorrect.

Option B: The option implies that jingoism of a certain class might lead to topophobia. The option is yet again unrelated.

Option C: Residents of upscale residential developments intend to promote their community by reinforcing sectarian differences. This exclusivism(Practice of being exclusive/important) is clearly captured in the option. Hence C is correct.

Option D: Sensitive response indicates a considerate response where other's sentiments are considered. While these residents are inconsiderate and consider themselves superior. Also, the option doesn't capture the purpose clearly. Hence, incorrect

 VIDEO SOLUTION

280. **B**

Option A: The entire passage deals with "TOPOPHILIA" and "TOPOGRAPHY" is unrelated. Also, the author says that we experience topophilia in three forms and that we are not born with it.

Option C: An illustration of topophobia doesn't represent the author's view on topophilia

Option D: The option speaks about glossophilia(Love of language) and is unrelated to topophilia

Option B: "Topophilia connotes a positive relationship, but it often is useful to explore the darker affiliations between people and place. Patriotism, literally meaning the love of one's terra patria or homeland".

Despite a negative tone, the author says that one form of topophilia is patriotism. Even though not wholesome, it comes "closest" to the author's understanding of topophilia among the given options. Hence B is correct.



281. **D**

Option A: "new urbanism seeks to... Although motivated by good intentions, such attempts to create places rich in meaning are perhaps bound to disappoint." The author says new urbanism that tries to induce sense of place is bound to fail. Since there is no mention of clients, irrespectively new urbanism is going to fail. Hence, it is contradicting the author.

Option B: "His 1974 book set forth a wide-ranging exploration of how the emotive ties with the material environment vary greatly from person to person and in intensity, subtlety, and mode of expression." This option is contradicting the passage yet again.

Option C: The author lists out three ways of experiencing topophilia but doesn't emphasize about any one way. Hence, even though not contradictory, this option is factually misquoting the passage.

Option D: "Topophilia connotes a positive relationship, but it often is useful to explore the darker affiliations between people and place. Patriotism, literally meaning the love of one's terra patria or homeland.." Clearly, the author has a negative intonation when he says "darker affiliation". He presents patriotism as a darker manifestation of topophilia. Hence, this statement is correct and does not contradict the author. Hence option D is correct.

282. **A**

"And just as a beloved landscape is suddenly revealed, so too may landscapes of fear cast a dark shadow over a place that makes one feel a sense of dread or anxiety—or topophobia."

Option B speaks about topography, while Option C speaks about dread towards people.

Option D is unrelated to topophobia. Hence, all of them are incorrect

Option A clearly captures the essence of the last sentence in the passage.

283. **D**

"As Tuan noted, purely aesthetic responses often are suddenly revealed, but their intensity rarely is longlasting. Topophilia is difficult to design for and impossible to quantify". The author says that people's response to aesthetics is shortlived and usually subsides overtime. Hence, it is difficult to design or quantify.

Option A: "Amomie" means lack of morals or ethics. It is unrelated to the passage.

Option B: An objective analysis by architects does not explain the reason as to why it is difficult to quantify topophilia.

Option C: This statement is in the form of an opinion and does not explain the above statement.

Option D: Since every person has different topophilic attractions and have different responses to aesthetics. Capturing topophilia in the form of design is impossible. This option elaborates and explains the reason for quantifying topophilia. Hence option D is correct.

284. **A**

"In the late 1960s, purists were suspicious of folk songs recast in rock idioms." Purists oppose any alteration or adaptation of original folk from and they criticized the adaptations by rock too. Hence, option B can be inferred

Folk music was inspired by revolutionary intentions in 1940s, various philosophies and school of thoughts in 1960s, Freedom of expression(Bob dylan) and psychedalia.

This shows a constant transformation of folk reinforcing the beliefs of Cecil Sharp. Option C is correct. Option D can be rightly inferred from the lyrical freedom of bob dylan and revolutionary intentions in 1940s.

Option A : "In the late 1960s, purists were suspicious of folk songs recast in rock idioms. Electrification, however, comes in many forms." Even though the electrification of folk by rock was rejected by purists, electrification came in many forms and not individually by Rock alone. Hence, electrification of folk music is not caused by rock alone. Hence option A cannot be inferred.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

285. **B**

"Free of the taint of manufacture" been contested territory."

The phrase "Free of the taint of manufacture" is likely to have emerged post-industrialisation when conservationists (conserving status quo especially natural resources) fancied a pre-industrial age and expressed nostalgic attachment towards it. Hence the main point of the first paragraph can be summarised as "Conservationists envisioned a cosy folk form inspired by preindustrial times".

Hence option B is the correct answer

 VIDEO SOLUTION



286. **A**

Cecil Sharp says "One man sings a song, and then others sing it after him, changing what they do not like". This signifies that folk music is constantly evolving. Hence, this adaptability contributes to its plurality. Hence the author is going to agree with option B

"Just as the effusive on countless record labels" This indicates that - "Just as the radical views of Morris became popular and mainstream, similarly folk music which is considered parochial is becoming popular and conformist. This popularity is being rejoiced by media as "folk is hip again". Hence, option C correctly captures this sentiment.

"For the early-20th-century composers tradition itself." This line captures the idea that folk is also inspired by various philosophies and schools of thought. Hence, we can infer that folk is intellectually relevant in contemporary times. Option D is in coherence with the author's views.

Option A says that folk forms exhibit homogeneity. The author in the entire passage describes the diversity of folk and says it paves way for vivid imagination. "The very obscurity and anonymity of folk music's origins open up space for rampant imaginative fancies". Cecil Sharp cites an analogy of an oak tree to show the constant transformation of folk. Hence, this option is contradicting author's opinion and he is least likely to agree with it.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

287. **C**

"Just as the effusive floral prints of the radical William Morris now cover genteel sofas, so the revolutionary intentions of many folk historians and revivalists have led to music that is commonly regarded as parochial and conservative.

Here the author compares two aspects. We know that William Morris is a radical conservationist as per para 1. (genteel refers to respectable/gentlemanly, genteel sofas refers to people in respectable place in life) As the footprints/views of William Morris becomes more popular i.e. as conservative folk forms once considered radical became more mainstream, similarly folk music which is considered parochial is now being revived by revivalists. The primary purpose is to show an analogy that a radical folk form became more mainstream/acceptable over time. This expression is best captured in option C

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

288. **B**

Option A and option D both signifies the inspiration of folk music from two different times. Folk is not limited to immediate past or to any specific time-line. This contributes to the plurality of folk music.

Option C talks about "fluidity". Fluidity indicates flexibility or different modes of oral rendition. For example different vocal styles can be generated by pitch, rhythm, style of rendition. Hence, the variance in oral transmission of music can lead to various iterations of one original form. Hence, this again contributes to the diversity and plurality of folk music.

Option B: Popularity or unpopularity is an opinion. An opinion in no way contributes to the diversity of a folk form. It might be regarded as diverse opinions but does not inherently contribute to the diversity of folk itself. Hence, option B does not contribute to folk's plurality.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

289. **A**

Option B is a problem of relocating government agencies and it can be inferred from this line " Pick small, poor towns, and areas of high unemployment get new jobs, but it is hard to attract the most qualified workers". Hence, option B is incorrect.

Option C is true with respect to the passage. It can be inferred from the line " Others contend that decentralisation begets corruption by making government agencies less accountable ." Hence it is incorrect.

Option D is also mentioned in the passage. Qualified workers do not want to live in smaller cities. Hence, it is also a reason for relocation not being a success.

Option A is not mentioned in the passage and hence it is the correct answer.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

290. **B**

"The dilemma is obvious. Pick small, poor towns, and areas of high unemployment get new jobs, but it is hard to attract the most qualified workers; opt for larger cities with infrastructure and better-qualified residents, and the country's most deprived areas see little benefit"

Option A is incorrect. The passage makes no mention of having the government agencies in the "largest" city. It talks about having them in "larger cities". Hence it is incorrect.

Option C talks about the relocation of private enterprises. This is not mentioned in the passage as the passage is primarily about the relocation of government bureaucrats.

Option D makes no mention of decongesting large cities. Hence it is incorrect.

Option B makes the right comparison. It compares the hard task of relocating qualified workers to smaller towns, to allocating workers to larger cities, which would result in smaller towns receiving little benefit.

Option B is the correct answer.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



291. A

The passage states that regulators perform best if they are far from the lobbying of a big city. Hence, the people who support decentralizing central government functions are likely to cite the above reason for their view.

Option B and C are incorrect for this reason.

Option D is incorrect as the passage states that infrastructure costs and salaries would become lower in smaller cities. The argument is used in the passage. Hence it is correct.

The nexus between bureaucrats and media is not mentioned in the passage. Hence the argument is least likely to be used by people who support the decentralising of central government functions.

Option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

292. D

The word pedigree has a meaning, " history of an idea or an activity". The term long pedigree indicates that the idea has been touted with a lot of times in the past.

Option D is the only option that conveys this meaning and hence it is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

293. B

"In the post-colonial fervour of the 20th century, coastal capitals picked by trade-focused empires were spurned for "regionally neutral" new ones".

From these lines, it can be inferred that the colonial empires had their capitals in the coasts as the empires were mostly focused on trade. It goes on to say that, post - colonisation, empires had their capitals changed to regionally neutral areas.

Hence, it can be directly inferred that colonies had capitals in coasts to promote their trading interests.

Option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

294. A

This is a direct inference question that requires minimal effort and can be accurately answered using the option-elimination mechanism. The first sentence of the passage is as follows: " ...I've been following the economic crisis for more than two years now...". It is evident that the author has been following {events/information associated with} the economic crisis for at least two years if not more. Thus, Option A is a sensible inference to draw from this statement. Options B, C and D are inane interpretations of the same and can be effortlessly eliminated.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

295. D

In the final paragraph, the author highlights the crisis as an ironical situation: a group of individualistic entities facing an issue with collective impact and thereby, needs to be dealt with "together" or by shifting from the existing self-centred setup {"...That's one of the strangest ironies of this story: after decades in which the ideology of the Western world was personally and economically individualistic, we've suddenly been hit by a crisis which shows in the starkest terms that whether we like it or not—and there are large parts of it that you

would have to be crazy to like—we're all in this together...."). Option D is the closest choice that captures this element. Option A is contrary to the point presented in the concluding para. Options B and C are either divergent to the point made or merely distorted comments. Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



296. **A**

Let us inspect the individual options:

Option A: If true, this statement could be antithetical to the point put forth in the concluding paragraph: the author believes that an individualistic ideology isn't the right way forward; instead, we need to deal with such crises collectively. Thus, this is a conflicting viewpoint and thereby, the correct answer.

Option B: If true, aligns with the author's point in the first paragraph: *{...It seems to me that there is a much bigger gap between the world of finance and that of the general public and that there is a need to narrow that gap, if the financial industry is not to be a kind of priesthood, administering to its own mysteries and feared and resented by the rest of us...}*

Options C and D: If true, this is in tune with the author's claim {made in the final segment} about dealing with such crises together.

Hence, of the given statements, Options A deviates from the author's argument and thus, is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

297. **C**

A predominant idea discussed by the author is regarding the lack of financial literacy that could be truly beneficial to our understanding of the world. This is emphasised via the following excerpt:

{...It seems to me that there is a much bigger gap between the world of finance and that of the general public and that there is a need to narrow that gap, if the financial industry is not to be a kind of priesthood, administering to its own mysteries and feared and resented by the rest of us. Many bright, literate people have no idea about all sorts of economic basics, of a type that financial insiders take as elementary facts of how the world works. I am an outsider to finance and economics, and my hope is that I can talk across that gulf....}

Option C aligns with this concern and is, consequently, an idea that the author is bound to support. Option B appears as another likely candidate; however, economic research is not one of the focal points mentioned. Options A and D contain elements that are not discussed or are opposite to the author's ideas. Hence, Option C is a programme that the author is most likely to be supportive of.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

298. **B**

On skimming through the statements, it is evident that Options A and D do very little, if at all anything, to support the author's claim. Option C, in its current form, aligns with the author's assertion; however, if false, it is opposite to the author's argument about financial literacy {on negating the statement, it indicates that most people do have an understanding of the workings of the financial world}. Option B, if false, is in line with the assertions made in the concluding paragraph.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

299. **A**

Refer to the starting paragraph " Electronic memory chips are fast but volatile (their contents are lost when the computer is unplugged."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

300. **D**

Refer the lines "Not content with shaking up the multi-billion-dollar market for computer memory, some researchers have even more ambitious plans for magnetic computing. In a paper published last month in Science, Russell Cowburn and Mark Welland of Cambridge University outlined research that could form the basis of a magnetic microprocessor chip capable of manipulating (rather than merely storing) information magnetically"

So the mentioned research is being pursued by Russell Cowburn and Mark Welland, hence the correct answer is D.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



301. **D**

Refer to the lines "So by measuring the current that flows through the sandwich, it is possible to determine the alignment of the topmost layer, and hence whether it is storing a zero or a one."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

302. **B**

Refer these lines "Individual bits of information would travel down the rows as magnetic pulses, changing the orientation of the dots as they went. Dr. Cowburn and Dr Welland have demonstrated how a logic gate (the basic element of a microprocessor could work in such a scheme."

This makes B correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

303. **C**

Refer these lines "According to Paulo Freitas, an expert on chip manufacturing at the Technical University of Lisbon, magnetic memory elements will have to become far smaller and more reliable than current prototypes if they are to compete with electronic memory."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

304. **A**

Refer to the lines " It turns out that such tunneling is easier when the two magnetic layers are polarized in the same direction than when they are polarized in opposite directions."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

305. **C**

Refer to the lines "In the NRL's magnetic design, by contrast, each bit is stored in a magnetic element in the form of a vertical pillar of magnetisable material."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



306. **B**

Refer to the lines "The first being investigated by Gary Prinz and his colleagues at the Naval Research Laboratory (NRL) in Washington D.C. exploits the fact that the electrical resistance of some materials changes in the presence of a magnetic field- a phenomenon known as magneto-resistance." "Most attention in the field is focused on an alternative approach based on magnetic tunnel-junction (MTJs), which are being investigated by researchers at chip makers,"

This makes B correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

307. **A**

Look at the last paragraph of the passage, "Other influential perspectives supporting a biological basis for aggression conclude that humans evolved with an abnormally low neural inhibition of aggressive impulses". While the first option talks about neural regulation of testosterone, which is factually incorrect. Hence this is the answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

308. **A**

Let's look at the options one by one.

Option B is a distorted option. The sentence is not about the reliability of the information. Its about the inherent aggression involved.

Option C is also incorrect. Nothing has been mentioned about when the enemy refuses to reveal information. Hence this is beyond the scope of the passage.

On similar lines option D is also incorrect. Nothing has been said about the most effective method to extract information.

Option A correctly captures the essence. Sometimes the aggressor has no intention to inflict pain, its just a means to an utilitarian end. Hence this is the correct option.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

309. **C**

Option C is a twisted option. It distorts what is given in the passage. The passage talks about the identification of death instinct by Freud. It doesn't talk about its moderation and keeping the resulting aggression in check. Hence this option is completely out of context and is incorrect.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

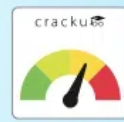
310. **A**

The author explains that theories of aggression are often categorized based on three main factors: the aggressor (the person or group committing the aggression), the circumstances surrounding the aggressive act, and the victim (the person or group being targeted). These factors help to understand and explain different types of aggression.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)



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311. **B**

In the penultimate paragraph, the author uses the line "[T]he greatest success of Keep America Beautiful has been to shift the onus of environmental responsibility onto the public while simultaneously becoming a trusted name in the environmental movement". From the tone of the line, we can infer that the author believes that the sole purpose of 'Keep America Beautiful' was to shift the blame on the consumers. Therefore, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

312. **C**

The author believes that the corporates are responsible for the plastic menace. He states that recycling the plastics or targeting the consumers are ineffective to tackle the problem.

'Encouraging individuals to recycle more will never solve the problem of a massive production of single-use plastic that should have been avoided in the first place'.

In the last paragraph, the author recommends responsible use of plastics. Therefore, he is unlikely to support a complete ban on single use plastics as well.

The author holds the corporates squarely responsible for the plastic menace. Therefore, the author is most likely to suggest passing regulations targeted at the producers rather than at the consumers. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

313. **C**

The author uses the term 'lie' to emphasize that the fact that the consumers are made to believe that they are responsible for the plastic menace. Through out the passage, the author explains how the corporates tricked people into believing that the blame lies on them for using the plastics. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

314. **D**

The author believes that plastic production should be restricted. He finds asking consumers to stop using plastics or recycling plastics to be inadequate measures.

The author uses the analogy to drive home the point that focusing on consumer behaviour will be totally incommensurate to tackle plastic pollution. Therefore, option D is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

315. **A**

In the third paragraph, the author mentions that plastics get absorbed in the water and some animals mistake plastic for their natural food and consume them. Therefore, we can infer options B and C. In the same paragraph, the author explains how plastics we use for a few minutes will stay on the planet for millions of years. Therefore, we can infer option D as well.

The author has not mentioned about air pollution caused while recycling the plastics anywhere in the passage. Therefore, option A is the right answer.



316.C

In the first line of the passage, the author describes loci of commitment as accepted rules. The passage talks about the historian trying to isolate the particular loci of commitment, which he later concludes as the community's paradigms.

Option c) succinctly captures this idea. None of the other options are applicable.

317.D

The main point of the first paragraph is to define what are accepted rules and how to identify them. In the second paragraph, the author talks about comparing different sets of accepted rules or community paradigms and analysing them. In the last paragraph, the author talks about how paradigm, even if they cannot be distilled into rules, can yet guide research and be widely accepted. Thus, the main point of the passage is how to understand scientific paradigms.

Option a) is an answer to how the author is attempting to illustrate his point through the passage. It does not answer the 'what' part.

Options b), c) and e) give only partial answers to what the author is trying to illustrate through the passage.

Hence, Option d) is the correct answer.

318.E

Throughout the passage, the author highlights that "the paradigms" are "the general rules of science".

Rules are difficult to be defined. On the other hand, paradigms can follow without any rules. Option e) accurately represents the idea.

319.A

The first part of the passage talks about British colonial policy, which went through two policy phases.

Hence, the options B and C which have military power as the introductory idea are incorrect.

The second idea mentioned in the passage is about Enlightenment rationalism, of which the British colonizers were inheritors and representatives of.

The subsequent ideas are about how modernity was inorganically injected into India by subjecting it to external forces. The passage further talks about how these economic alterations did not give rise to the construction of a classical capitalist economy, but rather led to the development of underdevelopment.

Option A mentions all the ideas correctly and hence it is the correct answer.

320. **B**

". Theoretically,because modernity was externally introduced, it is explanatorily unhelpful to apply the logical format of the 'transition process' to this pattern of change."

From the given lines it can be understood that the general endogenous method of the process of transition could not be accepted to British colonialisation of India, because modernity did not occur naturally but was externally introduced.

The passage only states that initiatives for modernity were introduced to India through external sources. It does not state that all colonised societies cannot be changed by logic. Hence this option is incorrect.

In the case of India, the transformational agents themselves are inorganic external forces. Hence, option C cannot be inferred.

The passage nowhere states that Indian society is exogamous. Hence option D is incorrect.

Option B best describes the conclusion that can be drawn from the author's statement. Hence it is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



321. C

".....empirically inclined theorists of that generation considered the colonies a massive laboratory of utilitarian or other theoretical experiments." From the aforementioned lines, option A can be inferred.

"What happened was the creation of a degenerate version of capitalism —what early dependency theorists called the 'development of underdevelopment'." From these lines it can be inferred that, because modernity was imposed upon India by the British, it led to the development of underdevelopment. Option B can be inferred.

From the passage, it can be understood that feudalism underwent a transformative process into capitalism, unlike the Indian transition which happened inorganically through external factors. Hence, option D can be inferred as well.

The change in British colonial policy was not induced by resistance to modernity in Indian society, but due to the perception that the British were marginalised in the context of the Indian society. Hence, option C, which cannot be inferred is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

322. D

From the passage it can be inferred that though the British enjoyed political eminence in India, they felt that they were still marginalised from Indian society, and hence, to bring the Indian state to the same footing, they sought to introduce modernity, which they felt was the next logical step into Indian society.

It cannot be inferred from the passage that the British introduced modernity because they believed that the cost of their eminence was not settled. Hence, option A is incorrect.

The colonial enterprise tried to introduce the logic of modernity because it felt marginalized, rather than to justify the cost of colonization. Hence option B is incorrect.

Option C states that the introduction of modernity developed Indian society. However, the last paragraph states that the exercise proved counterproductive, and there was a development of underdevelopment. Option C is incorrect.

Option D best explains the reason for the author introducing the statement mentioned in the question. Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

323. B

".....empirically inclined theorists of that generation considered the colonies a massive laboratory of utilitarian or other theoretical experiments" From these lines option A can be inferred.

Consider the lines, "e British colonial state represented the great conquering discourse of Enlightenment rationalism, entering India precisely at the moment of its greatest unchecked arrogance. . As inheritors and representatives of this discourse, which carried everything before it, this colonial state could hardly adopt for long such a self-denying attitude." Option C can be inferred from it.

Consider the lines , " It had restructured everything in Europe—the productive system, the political regimes, the moral and cognitive orders—and would do the same in India, " Option D can be inferred from these lines.

It is nowhere mentioned in the passage, that British colonialism faces resistance from the existing structural forms of Indian modernity. Hence , option B is the correct answer.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

324. **D**

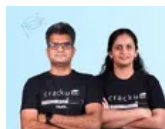
It is nowhere mentioned in the paragraph about the support of pro-choice group. Likewise, it is mentioned that the banning of abortion was influenced by medical profession. Patriarchal religions always observed that the women reproductive freedom is always in the domain of men. Hence the correct answer is option D.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

325. **C**

Refer to the lines "In the early 1960s, even when it was widely known that the drug thalidomide taken during pregnancy to alleviate anxiety was shown to contribute to the formation of deformed 'flipper-like' hands or legs of children, abortion was illegal in the United States. A second health tragedy combined with a change of attitude towards a woman's right to privacy led a number of states to pass abortion-permitting legislation." As some abortion permitting laws are passed, it can be inferred that some of the anti abortion laws must have been scrapped in those states. Hence, option C is the right answer.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)



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326. **D**

Refer to the lines of the last para where it is written " Pro-choice advocates reject the view of separate spheres. They object to the notion of the home being the 'women's sphere'. Women's reproductive and family roles are seen as potential barriers to full equality. Motherhood is seen as a voluntary, not a mandatory or 'natural' role." Both option B and option C are stated in these lines.

Hence, option D is the answer.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

327. **A**

Refer to the lines of the 2nd para "In recent times, governments, usually controlled by men, have 'given' women the right to contraceptive use and abortion access when their countries were perceived to have an overpopulation problem, when these countries are perceived to be under-populated, that right has been absent."

According to this, we can say that option A is the answer.

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)

328. **D**

In the paragraph, it is not mentioned when the pro-life would advocate abortion.

Hence, none of these is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

329. **D**

Refer to the 2nd para and the 3rd para "The change was strongly influenced by the medical profession, which focused its campaign ostensibly on health and safety issues for pregnant women and the sanctity of life. Its position was also means of control of non-licensed medical practitioners such as midwives and women healers who practiced abortion." "The large influx of eastern and southern European immigrants with their large families was seen as threat to the population balance of the future United States."

Options A, B and C are stated in these lines. Hence, option D is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

330. **B**

The answer to this question can be referred from the given lines: "And to that extent that is true now, if someone was born today, they would be born into a very different set of cultural assumptions and hopes than somebody born 50 years ago. We were entirely sold on the Nehru-Gandhi kind of plan." Here the author says that they were inspired from the idea of Nehru-Gandhi ideology.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



331. **B**

The answer can be deduced directly from the given lines: "It creates backlashes, it creates polarisation, and it creates the risk of more upheaval. Partly, I am saying this as a kind of objective observer, but nobody is an objective observer."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

332. **D**

Refer to the following sentence: "The civilizing influence is what prevents most of us from giving vent to those terrible urges". This idea is mentioned in option d). Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

333. **D**

Refer to the following two sentences in the passage: "I think, in a way the strength of the nationalist idea is shown by its ability to survive", "But that it does exist and that it is something to which people feel they belong". The secret of India's survival, according to the author, lies in its ability to fight back stress and strains and a sense of belonging that people feel for it. Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

334. **C**

The answer can be interpreted from the following lines: "One of the things that I remember very vividly, being there 10 years ago at about the time of the killings that took place in Assam, is discussing this with good friends and fellow writers. And I remember somebody said to me, until we understand that we are capable of these things, we can't begin to move beyond them." Here the author's friend says that we can move beyond some things after we are capable to do those things.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

335. C

Both the options can be inferred from the given lines: "Anybody who knows anything about these countries, and I do know something about these countries, knows that every cheap politician can put a demonstration in the street in five minutes. That doesn't represent in any sense the people's will."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



336. C

Refer to the following sentences: "Where Naipaul is right, although I don't share his conclusions about it, but I think where he is right, is in saying that this is a great historical moment". So, the writer does not share Naipaul's conclusion on the 50th anniversary being a historical moment. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

337. B

Refer to the following lines: "If you ask people in general, they would have absolutely no problem with the idea of India at all. I think, in a way the strength of the nationalist idea is shown by its ability to survive the extraordinary stresses that it was placed under" This quality is resilience where we can endure more stress and still emerge victorious.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

338. A

Refer to the following sentences: "The thing that became independent had never previously existed, except that there had been an area... was an invention". So, the writer is questioning the existence of a political entity called India prior to independence. Option a) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

339. B

Refer to the following sentences: "I think corruption to call itself a democracy.". From these sentences, we can infer that the author fears the long-term damage to democracy which corruption can bring about. Hence, option b) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

340. A

The given passage is based on the experience of the author. Here the author states the democratic credentials of India and highlights the resilience of Indians. In the last line of the passage, the author mentions about his life experience specifically. Hence the answer is a.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



341. D

Refer to the following lines in which the author clearly mentions that the creation of Pakistan was under-imagined: "The history of India is a history of independent nation-states. It is a history of Oudh or Bengal or Maratha kingdoms. All those independent histories agreed to collectivise themselves into the idea of the nation of India. In the case of Pakistan, it was less successful. Pakistan was under-imagined. It did not survive as a nation-state."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

342. B

Refer these line "The new technology is called 'bereavement counselling'. It is a tool forged at the great state university, an innovative technique to meet the needs"

This makes A correct.

Refer the line "Like John Deere's plow, the tools of bereavement counselling will create a desert where a community once flourished."

This makes C correct

Refer the line "A century later, the land of the Sauks is now populated by the children of a second wave of European farmers who learned to replenish the soil through the regenerative powers of dairying, ground cover crops and animal manures."

This makes D correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

343. A

Option C and D are incorrect as these options are nowhere mentioned as the cause for the utilisation of the said services.

Refer to these lines "Several people will begin to use the bereavement counsellor because, since the Country Board now taxes them to insure access to the technology, they will feel that to fail to be counselled is to waste their money, and to be denied a benefit, or even a right." This makes option A more suitable than B

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

344. D

It is clearly stated in the passage '...schooled to believe in the innovative new tools certified by universities and medical centres ...' which makes option D as answer

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

345. C

Among options only C perfectly explains the reason behind the question. Its not mentioned in that, Over a period of time, working with Sauk Indians the bereavement counsellor becomes one of them. SO option A is out also option B is never mentioned .

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346. C

The author didnt illustrate the failure of both the inventions. Also option D is clearly not the answer. Option C perfectly captures the approach of author

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

347. B

As is it clearly stated in the passage that traditionally '... farmers and the townspeople mourn at the death of a mother, brother, son or friend. The bereaved is joined by neighbours and kin. They meet grief together in lamentation, prayer and song...' . Hence option B

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

348. A

In the forth line itself , term 'great grass prairie ' is used . The first paragraph conveys the reasons of puzzlement of Europeans. Refer to the lines:"When they finally reached the western edge of the place we now call Indiana, the forest stopped and ahead lay a thousand miles of the great grass prairie. The Europeans were puzzled by this new environment. Some even called it the "Great Desert". It seemed untillable."This substantiates the point made in A.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

349. D

Refer to the lines "When they finally reached the western edge of the place, we now call Indiana, the forest stopped and ahead lay a thousand miles of the great grass prairie. The Europeans were puzzled by this new environment. Some even called it the 'Great Desert'."

This makes B correct

"Like John Deere's plow, the tools of bereavement counselling will create a desert where a community once flourished" This makes A and C correct

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

350. A

Refer to the 4th para "At the same time, Indian abstractionists have rarely committed themselves wholeheartedly to non-representational idiom. They have been preoccupied with the fundamentally metaphysical project of aspiring to the mystical holy without altogether renouncing the symbolic. This has been sustained by a hereditary reluctance to give up the murti, the inviolable iconic form, which explains why abstractionism thus entered India as a double-edged device in a complex cultural transaction."

This makes option A correct. Further option A is mentioned as a revolutionary idea in the last lines of the third para.

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351. B

Refer to the lines of the 3rd para "In such a situation, abstractionism was a revolutionary move. It led art towards the exploration of the subconscious mind, the spiritual quest and the possible expansion of consciousness. Indian painting entered into a phase of self-inquiry, meditative inner space where cosmic symbols and non-representational images ruled. Often, the transition from figurative idioms to abstractionist ones took place within the same artist."

This makes option B correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

352. **D**

Refer to the last para "Such symbolism falls into a dual trap: it succumbs to the pompous vacuity of pure metaphysics when the burden of intention is passed off as justification; or then it is desiccated by the arid formalism of pure painterliness with delight in the measure of chance or pattern guiding the execution of a painting. The ensuing conflict of purpose stalls the progress of abstractionism in an impasse."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

353. **C**

Refer to the lines " The third idiom is based on the lyric play of forms guided by gesture or allied with formal improvisations like the assemblage. Here, sometimes, the line dividing abstract image from patterned design or quasi-random expressive marking may blur. The flux of forms can also be regimented through the policies of pure colour arrangements, vector-diagrammatic spaces and gestural design."

This makes option C correct

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

354. **D**

The 2nd para clearly mentions all the reasons. So the 4th option is correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

355. **B**

Refer to the lines of the last para " Abstractionism is not a universal language; it is an art that points up the loss of a shared language of signs in society. And yet, it affirms the possibility of its recover through the effort of awareness. "

It clearly implies B.

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100+ CAT VARC Questions



356. **A**

Refer to the part of 2nd para "At the same time, Indian abstractionists have rarely committed themselves wholeheartedly to non-representational idiom. They have been preoccupied with the fundamentally metaphysical project of aspiring to the mystical holy without altogether renouncing the symbolic. This has been sustained by a hereditary reluctance to give up the murti, the inviolable iconic form, which explains why abstractionism thus entered India as a double-edged device in a complex cultural transaction. Ideologically it served as an internationalist legitimisation of the emerging revolutionary local trends. However, on entry, it was conscripted to serve local artistic preoccupations- a survey of indigenous abstractionism will show that its most obvious points of affinity with European and American abstract art were with the more mystically oriented of the major sources of abstractionist philosophy and practice, for instance, the Kandinsky Klee School. "

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

357. **C**

Refer to the last line of the 1st para where it is written "By this criterion, it would appear that the practice of abstractionism has failed to engage creatively with the radical change in human experience in recent decades. It has seemingly been unwilling to re-invent itself in relation to the systems of artistic expression and viewers

expectations that have developed under the impact of the mass media."
This covers the option A,B and D while the option C is nowhere mentioned.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

362. **B**

This fact is mentioned in the first sentence of the passage: "A difficult readjustment in the scientist's conception of duty is imperatively necessary."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

363. **D**

Refer to the following lines: "I think it is the duty of science . I do not say of every individual man of science, to study the means by which we can adapt ourselves to the new world." Here the author states that a man of science has to study the means by which we can adapt ourselves to the new world.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

364. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "Loyalty to the human race must take its place. Everyone in the West will at once admit this as regards Soviet scientists. We are shocked that Kapitza who was Rutherford's favourite pupil, was willing when the Soviet government refused him permission to return to Cambridge, to place his scientific skill at the disposal of those who wished to spread communism by means of H-bombs." From this we can see that Kapitza agreed to help Soviet Union when they did not permit him to return to Cambridge. The Soviet Union could do so because he was a citizen of the Soviet Union.

From this we can infer that firstly, the author is shocked that Kapitza agreed to help his own state of Soviet Union even when their actions were against humanity and secondly, the author feels that the example of Kapitza shows that we should be loyal to humanity and not individual countries. Hence, the example of Kapitza is used to show that current system of loyalty to home country is a wrong one. Hence, option C is the right answer.

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CAT Expected Questions PDF



365. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "We do not so readily apprehend a similar failure of duty on our own side. I do not wish to be thought to suggest treachery, since that is only a transference of loyalty to another national state. I am suggesting a very different thing; that scientists the world over should join in enlightening mankind as to the perils of a great war and in devising methods for its prevention. I urge with all the emphasis at my disposal that this is the duty of scientists in East and West alike."

In this passage the author requests the scientists to enlighten the people in perils of great war as the science is intimately associated with war. This is substantiated by providing the examples of Galileo, Leonardo and Archimedes. Option B is the correct answer

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

366. **D**

Refer to the following sentences: "A difficult readjustment in the scientist's conception of duty is imperatively necessary", "Hitherto, in the East and in the West alike, most scientists, like most other people, have felt that loyalty...paramount", "But after all, it is the labours of the scientists which have caused the danger...possible".

From these three sentences, we can see that the statements in options a), b) and c) are true. Option d) is not true according to the passage.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

367. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "We must learn to think rather less of the dangers to be avoided than of the good that will be within our grasp if we believe in it and let it dominate our thoughts. Science, whatever unpleasant consequences it may have by the way, is in its very nature a liberator, a liberator of bondage to physical nature and, in time to come a liberator from the weight of destructive passion."

Option C can be deduced from the given lines.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

368. **A**

Refer to the following lines: "To come to more recent times, Archimedes was respected for his scientific defense of Syracuse against the Romans; Leonardo obtained employment under the Duke of Milan because of his skill in fortification, though he did mention in a postscript that he could also paint a bit. Galileo similarly derived an income from the Grand Duke of Tuscany because of his skill in calculating the trajectories of projectiles. In the French Revolution those scientists who were not guillotined devoted themselves to making new explosives. "

In this paragraph, the author mentions the relation between the aspects of science and war by taking the examples of Syracuse vs Romans, fortification and trajectories of projectiles. The author wants to state the intimacy between science and war.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

369. **C**

Refer to the following lines in the passage: "but it is part of the duty of men of science to see that important knowledge is widely disseminated and is not falsified in the interests of this or that propaganda. Scientific knowledge has its dangers; but so has every great thing." Here it is clearly mentioned that the duty of scientist is to see that important knowledge is widely disseminated and is not falsified in the interests of propaganda

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



370. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "It is progress in the human sciences that we must look to undo the evils which have resulted from a knowledge of the physical world hastily and superficially acquired by populations unconscious of the changes in themselves that the new knowledge has made imperative." Option C correctly highlights this fact.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

371. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "The therapeutic promise of psychoanalysis came as the most novel, most ambitious, most releasing of the long procession of curative systems that mark the History of mental healing. To the contemporary trends in psychology psychoanalysis actually offered a rebuke, a challenge, a supplement, though it appeared to ignore them."

In this line, the author states that psychoanalysis broke the conventions due to its dealing with the crucial human issues.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

372. **C**

Refer to the following lines of the passage: "The therapeutic promise of psychoanalysis came as the most novel, most ambitious, most releasing of the long procession of curative systems that mark the History of mental healing."

In this line, the author clearly mentions the use of psychoanalysis for mental healing. Besides that, in whole of the passage the author discusses the mental healing aspects of psychoanalysis and how it is accomplished.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

373. **D**

Refer to the following lines: "From the outset in the days of struggle, when it had but a sparse and scattered discipleship, to the present position of prominence, Freudianism went its own way, for the most part neglected by academic psychology. Of dreams, lapses and neuroses, orthodox psychology had little say."

In this the author clearly states that Freudianism went on its own way due to its concepts which were hardly followed by others.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

374. **D**

The answer can be determined from the following lines: "The second reason for the impression made by psychoanalysis when once launched against the tide of academic resistance was its recognition of depth psychology, so much closer to human motivation, so much more intimate and direct than the analysis of mental factors." The author mentions that the popularity was due to its intimacy with the human issues.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)



375. **C**

Refer to the second last line of the passage: "Psychoanalysis belongs to the typical groups of therapies in which practice is entirely a derivative of theory."

Here the author clearly mentions that the theory leads to practice.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

376. **C**

Refer to the last line of the passage: "Create a belief in theory and facts will create themselves."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

377. **B**

Option B is incorrect as the author clearly mentions that psychoanalysis had no relation to other branches of psychology and hence had no quarrel with them. Refer to the following lines: "With the practical purpose of applied psychology directed to human efficiency it had no direct relation and thus no quarrel. The solution of behaviorism, likewise bidding for popular approval by reducing adjustment to a program of conditioning, it inevitably found alien and irrelevant, as the behaviorist in reciprocity found psychoanalytic doctrine mystical, fantastic, assumptive, remote."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

378. C

Refer to the following lines: "With the practical purpose of applied psychology directed to human efficiency it had no direct relation and thus no quarrel. The solution of behaviorism, likewise bidding for popular approval by reducing adjustment to a program of conditioning, it inevitably found alien and irrelevant, as the behaviorist in reciprocity found psychoanalytic doctrine mystical, fantastic, assumptive, remote. Even to the cognate formulations of mental hygiene, as likewise in its contacts with related fields of psychology, psychoanalysis made no conciliatory advances."

Here the author states that the behaviorism reduces the adjustment to conditioning gradually by making the patients comfortable and habitual.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

379. A

The sentence lists factors that made defendants seem *unlike* (different from) the officials judging them. This shows how fragile and subjective judgments about mental state could be. The word "confession" is included with disease, gender, and race, which are all seen as forms of perceived difference, not actions in a trial.

Option A best explains this use. In this context, "confession" means *religious confession or religious affiliation*. Like race or gender, it could set a defendant apart from officials in cultural or social ways. In the nineteenth century, religious identity often marked someone as different, and the sentence uses it in that sense.

The other options misunderstand the term. Option B wrongly treats "confession" as a verb meaning to claim an identity, which the sentence does not support. Option C does not make sense in the context, as it brings in the idea of a false confession, which is not mentioned. Option D takes "confession" to mean admitting a violent act, but this does not fit the sentence's grammar/structure or the way the terms are grouped. So, **option A** is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



380. A

The last paragraph discusses the social and professional ties between nineteenth-century physicians and lawyers, such as their class, race, gender, institutional affiliations, and access to power. In this elite group, their interactions centred on a shared professional issue: how to define and enforce criminal responsibility, a topic on which they often disagreed.

Option A best explains this connection. Specifically, the paragraph states that, although these men had much in common, they were "divided by contests over the borders of criminal responsibility," both within and between their professions. This wording shows that debates over the limits of criminal responsibility were central to how these groups interacted in courtrooms and intellectual circles.

In contrast, the other options do not describe the connection between these men in this paragraph. Option B refers to an earlier time when family and neighbours judged sanity, before medical experts were involved in court. Option C mentions traits that alienists started to medicalise, but not what linked lawyers and doctors socially or professionally. Lastly, option D explains how jurors infer mental states in the first paragraph, not the elite networks or professional debates in the last paragraph.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

381. B

The passage explicitly defines who alienists were in the nineteenth century: “*physicians who specialized in the study of madness and the care of the insane... often called alienists or mad doctors.*” They are described as the predecessors of modern psychiatrists, neurologists, and psychologists.

Option B matches this description. It correctly identifies both the profession (physicians) and their focus (madness and care of the insane), just as the passage describes.

The other options misread or exaggerate the term. Option A is too vague and does not mention the medical role described in the passage. Options C and D wrongly link “alienist” to immigrants or extraterrestrials, which the passage does not suggest. Therefore, option B is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

382. **D**

The passage mainly discusses how mental state is judged in criminal law, how insanity is defined and assessed, and how these ideas affect legal responsibility and punishment. It often highlights the challenge of understanding mental states, the legal definition of responsibility as liability to punishment, and how medical and legal views on insanity became linked in the nineteenth century.

Option D best matches the ideas presented in the passage. *Judgement* refers to how jurors and officials make inferences. *Insanity* is the medical idea discussed and expanded by experts. *Punishment* links directly to Stephen’s idea of responsibility as “liability to punishment.” *Responsibility* is the key idea that connects law and medicine throughout the passage.

The other options include terms that are either not central to the discussion or do not encapsulate the ideas in the passage as well as D does. Option A mentions *business*, which only comes up as part of social ties, not as a main point. Option B lists *patronage* and *belief*, which are more about background networks than the main ideas of the passage. Option C combines ideas like empathy, which fits, with *patriotism*, which is only mentioned socially and not as part of the main analysis. So, option D is the set that is conceptually closest to the passage.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

383. **B**

The passage explains how complex systems act when faced with uncertainty and contagion. It starts by showing that randomness, or “noise,” can sometimes create order, like in fish schools. Next, it describes how systems shaped by imitation or contagion are open to heavy-tailed events, meaning extreme outcomes happen more often than a normal distribution would predict. The passage then discusses how one extreme event can lead to others, since big shocks change incentives, risk perceptions, and behaviour. This is summed up by the idea of nonstationarity, with examples from pandemics, financial markets during COVID-19, and evolutionary arms races.

Option B best summarises this sequence. It includes the opening idea that ‘noise can create order’, includes the main point about heavy-tailed events in contagion-driven systems, and notes that early shocks change the system’s rules through nonstationarity. It also uses the COVID-era market as an example, not the main point, which matches the passage’s focus.

The other options each have problems. Option A goes against the passage by saying social outcomes usually follow normal distributions and that extreme events are rare, while the passage argues the opposite. Option C overgeneralizes the example of the bettors: the passage only suggests that market dynamics may have been affected by displaced sports bettors, not that these entrants *always* cause inefficiency or guarantee profits for long-term investors. Moreover, option C frames the example, or rather the inference from it, as the primary argument in the passage, which is clearly a supporting argument. Option D goes beyond the scope of the passage by incorrectly associating ‘nonstationarity’ with ‘evolutionary biology’, even though the passage only applies it to markets, pandemics, and technology-driven social systems.

384. D

We evaluate each option individually:

Option A is supported because the passage clearly describes a cause-and-effect process. When contagion shapes behavior, individual choices feed back into the system and lead to unexpected group outcomes. The passage says that “in collective settings where contagion shapes behaviour,” events follow heavy-tailed distributions, like “a run on the banks” and “a scramble to buy toilet paper.” It also mentions that local changes in behavior can “generate a collective pattern we had aimed to avoid.” These points together show a clear link from individual decisions, through feedback loops, to surprising system-wide effects.

Option B is supported because the passage directly explains how a first-order tail event *changes the system itself*, which then raises the probability of further shocks (second-order tail events). It states that once a rare but significant tail event occurs, “the rules change,” and that this happens because such events “change the perceived costs of our actions.” This shift in incentives leads to changes in behavior, which is why more big events can happen later. The inference that learning or adapting changes outcomes (reshapes payoffs) and increases subsequent disruptions follows directly from this process.

Option C is supported as well, because the passage compares normal and heavy-tailed distributions in a way that affects predictability. With heavy-tailed distributions, there is “a much higher probability of extreme events,” which “occur more frequently and are larger than would be expected under normal distributions.” This means that usual expectations based on bell curves do not work in these systems, so forecasting and managing risk are harder in group settings shaped by contagion and imitation.

Option D does not follow the careful approach to causality in the passage. The text is cautious in explaining the COVID-era market rebound, saying that “some of these dynamics are potentially attributable to former sports bettors... entering the market as speculators.” This shows only a partial contribution, not the only cause. The passage never claims there is just one main reason, or that the rebound is “solely” or “overridingly” due to displaced bettors. By leaving out these words, option D gives a single-cause explanation for the market rebound that the passage avoids.

So, the only inference the passage does not support is option D.



385. C

The passage says that in complex systems, a rare but extreme event can change how the system works, making more extreme events likely. This usually happens because incentives, behaviour, or limits change after the first shock. To support this idea, we need to see that after one extreme event, more extreme events happen more often than usual. To identify which option strengthens this claim the most, we evaluate each option individually.

Option A weakens the claim rather than strengthening it. It explicitly states that super-spreading events are isolated spikes and that later outbreak sizes revert to baseline distributions with no increase in extreme clusters. This directly contradicts the idea that first-order tail events raise the probability of subsequent tail events.

Option B does not relate to the passage’s argument. If river discharge stays normal and stable during storms, it shows there is no link between extreme events. This does not support the idea of cascading tail events in complex systems.

Option C strongly supports the passage's claim. It shows that after a major equity crash (a first-order tail event), extreme price movements cluster densely over subsequent weeks, occurring far more frequently than under normal conditions. This directly illustrates second-order tail events: the initial shock changes market dynamics so that further extreme outcomes become more likely, exactly as described in the passage.

Option D also goes against the claim. It describes how seismic activity returns to normal with no aftershocks, which suggests that events are independent and that one extreme event does not make others more likely.

So, the observation that best supports the passage's claim is option C.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

386. **B**

The passage explains that when people make sensible choices individually, these actions can add up and create unexpected group results. For contact-tracing apps to increase risky interactions, people's actions need to affect each other rather than being independent. To check if an assumption is necessary for this argument to hold true, we can use the negation test.

Option A says most users stop using the app quickly, so only highly exposed users remain, which stops any big changes in movement patterns. Even if this happens, the main concern of the passage still stands, because the argument is about how people's behaviours interact, not about participation bias cancelling effects. The claim does not depend on early uninstallation stopping feedback, so this assumption is not necessary.

Option B says people change their movement partly because of infection information and partly because of what others do, so many small actions add up. If this were not true, and people made decisions on their own without reacting to others, then local changes from the app would not build into the group patterns the passage warns about. The whole process described in the passage would not work. So, this assumption is necessary.

Option C says the app alerts are always perfectly accurate and real-time for everyone. The passage does not rely on perfect technology; it relies on how people react. Even if the information is not exact or is delayed, it can still affect movement choices and create feedback effects. So, the argument does not need this condition to be true, and hence it isn't a necessary assumption.

Option D says that urban movement is uniform and predictable, leaving little room for interdependent behaviour. If this were true, cascading effects would be unlikely, but the passage clearly assumes the opposite: that behaviour is responsive and interlinked. Since the argument does not require uniformity and would actually be undermined by it, this assumption is also not necessary.

Hence, option B is the correct choice.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

387. **A**

The phrase "sui generis" is mentioned in the last line of the third paragraph of the passage.

The author mentions that the magic of the new medium lies in the exploration of "sui generis" languages and forms.

So, from here, we can understand that the author is referring to certain unique or particular languages.

So, the correct answer is option A, particular.

Option-B (generic), option-C (unaesthetic), and option-D (indescribable) do not fit the context of "sui generis" language and hence can be eliminated.

So, option A is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

388. **D**

In this passage, in the very first paragraph, the author asks two basic questions about the phenomenon of electronic music. In the following paragraphs, the author tries to give an explanation of these questions.

Let's analyse each and every option.

Option A: The goal of the author is not to differentiate between a modern composer and a nineteenth-century composer. So, we can eliminate this option.

Option B: The author does not differentiate electronic music and other forms, but defends electronic music against some questions. So, we can eliminate this option.

Option C: This is a sub-idea, not the author's main goal. We can eliminate this option.

Option D: This option captures the main goal of the author, as essentially the main idea is to defend electronic music against common charges. So, this is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

389. **A**

The "communication problem" is stated in the first line of paragraph 2. The author basically expands on this in further lines of the same paragraph. He mentions that new language of forms like 'densities', 'indefinite pitch relations' are used instead of traditional concepts of harmony, melody, rhythm, etc. He further states that once these terminologies are understood, the barrier between the listener and the work will be removed.

Let's analyse the options.

Option A: This option captures the author's idea exactly, and hence it is the correct answer.

Option B: "We cannot see electronic music as music" sounds extreme and hence can be eliminated.

Option C: This is again wrong. There is a relation between the discussions mentioned by the author in the first and second paragraphs. So, we can eliminate this option.

Option D: This is not the correct idea. The communication problem is not something that helps us to see electronic music as music. So, we can eliminate this option.

So, the correct answer is option A.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



390. **A**

This is a single negation question based on Stravinsky's description in the first paragraph of the passage.

Let's analyse the options.

Option B: "respond to and expand upon earlier understandings of music", this idea is conveyed by Stravinsky's description of music as "a form of speculation in terms of sound and time". So, we can eliminate this option.

Option C: This idea is also conveyed in Stravinsky's description, so we can eliminate it.

Option D: This idea is also conveyed through the lines: "characteristic twentieth-century view of the art of musical composition will of course immediately bring the layman closer to an understanding of,..." So, we can eliminate this option.

Option A: Helping us to determine which sounds are musical and which are not, this idea is not conveyed by Stravinsky's description. So, this is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

391. **D**

The passage explicitly states Riddle's conclusion: *"Instead, Riddle thinks these carotenoids may be another adaptation to suppress inflammation."* This directly points to carotenoids playing a role in controlling inflammation, especially in the context of fat cells becoming large and potentially causing inflammatory

damage. Therefore, the correct answer is **option D**.

The other options are either not mentioned in the passage or, if mentioned, are discussed in a different context. Option A is mentioned only as an initial hypothesis that carotenoids might be linked to eye loss, but this idea is explicitly rejected after cross-breeding shows “*no link between eye presence or size and the accumulation of carotenoids*.” Option B is not mentioned at all in connection with carotenoids; nutrient storage is discussed as a general metabolic adaptation, not as a function of carotenoids. Option C refers merely to the observed yellow colour of fat, which the passage treats as a visible effect, not as the biological purpose of carotenoids.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

392. **C**

The experiment tests Riddle’s idea that carotenoid accumulation (yellow fat) is not linked to eye loss but serves another purpose, like reducing inflammation. To disprove this, results must show a direct connection between losing eyes and carotenoid accumulation.

Option C would directly invalidate this inference. If *only* the eyeless offspring had yellow fat, it would provide a strong link between the absence of eyes and carotenoid buildup. This would go against Riddle’s statement that there is “no link between eye presence or size and the accumulation of carotenoids,” and would support the earlier idea that carotenoids build up because cavefish lack eyes.

The other options do not challenge her idea. Options A and D show that white fat can appear whether or not the fish have eyes. Option B shows that fish with eyes can also have yellow fat. These results fit with Riddle’s claim that carotenoid buildup does not depend on eye presence. So, only option C would disprove her inference.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

393. **D**

The idea of “apparent inefficiency is unavoidable” refers to the fact that cavefish embryos begin developing eyes only for those eye cells to die off later, and this process is, however, unavoidable. The explanation must therefore point to a constraint in early development that makes it impossible to avoid initiating eye formation in the first place. The correct option must directly account for *why this sequence cannot be skipped*.

Option D gives this explanation. It says that Mexican tetra cavefish develop in the same way as their non-cave-dwelling relatives at first. The passage also says that eye and brain development are “completely intertwined” early on. Since cavefish embryos follow the same path as non-cave-dwelling fish, evolution cannot remove eye formation at the start without affecting brain development. Hence, starting eye formation and then dismantling it becomes unavoidable.

The other options do not work because they focus on selective pressure or later results, not on why eye formation must start. Option A talks about why eyes are costly for adult fish, not why embryos begin forming them. Option B incorrectly blames eye loss on darkness instead of on the intrinsic developmental processes. Option C mentions changes that happen after eye loss, but does not explain why the inefficient developmental sequence itself cannot be avoided.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

394. **C**

The passage describes how Mexican tetra cavefish have developed specific traits that help them survive in caves. These include losing their eyes, changing their metabolism, and controlling inflammation to cope with limited and unpredictable food. Of the choices, we need to identify which statement does not describe an adaptation in cavefish, and for that, we evaluate each option individually.

Option A [... *maintain expensive tissues they aren’t using* ...]shows an example of adaptation. The passage clearly says that keeping unused tissues like eyes is a disadvantage in caves where energy is limited. Losing eyes is described as an evolutionary change that helps save energy.

Option B [... *fish are likely surviving on a meager diet* ...] talks about the environmental pressure that cavefish have adapted to. The limited diet of bat feces and organic waste shows *why* adaptations for absorbing and storing nutrients are helpful. Even though this sentence describes the environment, it is still part of the adaptation story because it explains what drives these traits.

Option C [...*cells get too big, they can burst*...] does not describe an adaptation in cavefish. Instead, it explains why fat storage causes inflammation in humans and other animals. This sentence gives background information, but the passage later points out that cavefish *do not* have this inflammation. So, this statement is about other organisms, not about cavefish adaptation.

Option D [...*cavefish can sometimes get very fat*...] also describes an adaptation. Cavefish can become very fat even when food is scarce, which shows their evolved ability to overeat when possible and store nutrients well. This is an advantage in an environment where food is unpredictable.

So, the statement that does not describe an adaptation in Mexican tetra cavefish is option C.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Syllabus PDF



395. **A**

The passage describes instruments as active, technology-based tools that play a role in practice. They help us see more, take action, or support skilled work. Whether they receive information, like telescopes, or allow intervention, like biotechnological tools, these instruments are not passive. They influence what we can notice, do, or understand. Looking into the options, we can say that the only option that doesn't fit this common definition of being an 'active mediator' is a milestone (Option A). A kitchen oven (Option B) changes materials by controlling conditions, a scalpel (Option C) acts directly on biological matter, and a saxophone (Option D) needs skill to create music. A milestone is just a fixed marker that shows distance. It does not help us perceive, change, or take part in any technical process as described in the passage. It does not detect or affect anything. So, the characterisation is least applicable to option A.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

396. **C**

We evaluate each option individually, against what the passage truly supports, and then reject it if it is an invalid inference.

Option A should be rejected. The passage does not set "interventionist instruments" and "embodied instruments" as separate categories. Instead, it states that sciences are "technologically, instrumentally embodied," whether the instruments are receptive or interventional. The author's point is about different *styles of embodiment*, not a contrast between embodiment and intervention. So, this inference misunderstands the main idea.

Option B should also be rejected. The passage credits Galileo with observing "the phases of Venus" and "the satellites of Jupiter," saying "it was with his own telescopes that he made the observations launching early modern astronomy." Newton's reflecting telescopes are mentioned as *later improvements*, not as the tools for those discoveries. This inference does not match the historical order described.

Option C is valid and should NOT be rejected. The passage clearly compares astronomy and biology based on how they use instruments. Astronomy is called "largely a 'receptive' science, dependent upon instrumentation which can detect and receive emissions," while biology, especially with biotechnology, uses instruments that are "far more interventional in style." This comparison is a key part of the author's point.

Option D should be rejected. The passage links the "new astronomy" to the use of the full electromagnetic spectrum, starting with radio astronomy in the twentieth century. Newton's reflecting telescopes belong to optical astronomy and the trend of increasing magnification and resolution. Calling Newton's work the start of the "new astronomy" does not fit the passage.

Therefore, option C is the only valid inference.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

397. **B**

The passage compares scientific fields by looking at their use of instruments. It highlights the difference between receptive sciences, such as astronomy, and interventional ones, like biology. It also points out that all modern sciences rely on technology and instruments. Each option should be evaluated based on these ideas.

Option A does not go against the passage. The author describes astronomy as mostly “receptive” and biology as more “interventional,” but does not say these categories cannot overlap. The phrase “largely a ‘receptive’ science” suggests there can be some crossover. The passage does not say that instruments cannot have both roles, so this option fits with the argument.

Option B contradicts the passage. The passage says mathematics is “perhaps the last of the scientific disciplines to move into such technical embodiment,” and that it “only temporarily has come to rely more and more upon the computational machinery.” This is about using instruments, not about whether mathematics had a scientific culture before computers. The passage does not say that mathematics lacked a scientific culture before, so saying it is “only now beginning to develop a scientific culture” is inaccurate and goes against the author’s point.

Option C does not contradict the passage. The text says astronomy now explores the whole electromagnetic spectrum, not just visible light, and that biology, especially microscopy and biotechnology, uses many instruments. The passage never directly discusses microscopy moving beyond the visible spectrum in the way astronomy does with the electromagnetic spectrum. Since the passage does not explicitly restrict microscopy to the visible spectrum, nor deny that it might move beyond it, the claim in option C cannot be said to contradict the argument. It simply goes beyond what is stated.

Option D also does not go against the passage. The passage talks about Newton improving telescopes and their use in astronomy, but it does not say that *all* of Newton’s discoveries relied on instruments. Newton’s discovery of gravity without instruments does not conflict with the discussion about telescopes in astronomy.

So, only option B contradicts the passage.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

398. **C**

The statement says that modern sciences rely heavily on instruments and that progress depends on constantly improving these tools. So, any valid conclusion should keep this link between instruments and progress, without introducing new ideas. Let’s examine each option in relation to the passage.

Option A is not a valid conclusion. The passage describes how science progresses, but does not say anything about what “must be respected.” The author does not argue that using instruments deserves respect. Instead, the focus is on dependence and necessity, not on obligation or values.

Option B is also not a valid conclusion. The passage says sciences are “technologically, instrumentally embodied,” but this option confuses the direction of the relationship. It suggests that progress is embodied in instruments, while the text actually says that instruments embody science, not progress.

Option C is a valid conclusion. The passage gives examples, like how astronomy advanced with better telescopes: “from Newton to the twentieth century, improvement continued on to the later very large array of light telescopes”, and how biology depends on tools like microscopes and biotechnology. These examples show that in both fields, scientific progress has followed improvements in instruments.

Option D is not valid. The passage does not mention “scientific constants” or say that instruments improve them. Bringing up constants adds something that is not in the text and cannot be inferred.

So, the correct answer is **option C.**

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

399. **A**

Let's examine each option in relation to the passage.

Option A is the one the author is least likely to agree with. The author is concerned that AI's neutral, friendly tone actually reduces critical thinking instead of encouraging it. She writes that the product's "veneer of collegial neutrality could lull us into absorbing false or biased responses without much critical engagement." This goes against the idea that neutrality helps critical thinking.

The author is cautious about option B but does not reject it. She says that ChatGPT "seemed to be guiding me to write a more positive book about big tech," and even changed her description of Sam Altman. She also says she is "not aware of research" and can "only guess why it seemed that way." This shows she is sceptical and careful, but she does not completely agree or disagree with the idea.

Option C matches the author's view. Early on in the passage, she says that using big tech products makes users "complicit in big tech's accumulation of wealth and power," and calls us "both victims and beneficiaries." This directly supports the claim; the author will definitely agree with this statement.

Option D also fits with the passage. The author says that funders "seek a return on their investment" and that it is easier to get people to use products like ChatGPT "if people see those products as trustworthy collaborators." This connects AI's neutral tone to business goals. The author will therefore agree with this statement as well.

So, the author is least likely to agree with option A.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



400. **B**

The phrase "a beige office building" is used to describe the *style and effect* of AI-generated language, not how AI explains or defends itself when questioned. The passage says people often call chatbot output "bland" or "generic," which supports option A. It also mentions that OpenAI wants its products to "*sound like a colleague*," using language that is "polite," "empathetic," "kind," "rationally optimistic," and "engaging," which supports option D. The same design is said to help us feel safe and makes the product seem "professional" and "approachable," which supports option C.

Option B is not connected to the "beige office building" metaphor. The part about ChatGPT blaming "biases in its training data" comes later and is about how the system answers questions about its mistakes, not about the bland, generic, and trust-building tone described by the metaphor. So, the correct answer is option B.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

401. **C**

The passage highlights a gap between what AI companies say their systems do, such as being neutral, inclusive, and trustworthy, and what these systems actually produce. We need to check each option to see if it supports this gap or not. For that, we review each option individually:

Option A clearly supports the gap. The system claims to be neutral or inclusive, but when asked for engineers and space explorers, it produces an "entirely male cast of characters." This shows a clear difference between what is promised and what actually happens.

Option B also supports the gap. It points out the difference between the appearance of neutrality and the fact that this tone can make users accept biased or false answers. This sentence almost directly states the gap the passage discusses.

Option C does *not* support the gap. Here, the author holds back from making a judgment, saying they are "not aware of research" and can "only guess" why ChatGPT seemed to favour big tech or its CEO. Instead of showing a mismatch between claims and actions, this sentence adds uncertainty and does not reinforce the gap.

Option D does support the gap, but in a broader way. It shows that users benefit from AI products while also helping big tech gain more wealth and power. This highlights the difference between positive talk and real-world results.

So, the statement that does not support the gap is option C.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

402. **A**

The passage gives specific examples of AI-generated outputs to highlight a broader issue: the polite, *trustworthy tone* of AI systems can mask problems such as bias, distortion, and subtle influence on how users think. These examples show how those risks appear in real situations.

Seen under this light, **options B, C, and D** share a common feature. Each of these three options presents a clear example of an AI system producing an outcome that matches the author's concern. This could be cultural bias, like changing Indian English to American English, representational bias, such as only showing male engineers and space explorers, or directional influence, like encouraging the author to describe a tech CEO more positively. These examples are used as evidence to show harm or distortion.

Option A falls outside this pattern. It does not show a problematic output, but instead gives a higher-level explanation from ChatGPT about its own 'rhetorical' design. Instead of showing bias or influence, it directly explains how trust can be built and possibly misused. So, **option A** does not fit with the rest, and is the odd one out.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

403. **D**

Refer to the following lines: "If the more articulate members of a community formed a coherent and united class with a common interest, democracy would probably replace in to the rule of that intelligent, educated minority;" Here the author mentions the present context where the rule is of educated minority which can be removed by a coherent and united class. Option D mentions this aspect of the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

404. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "This is the lesson of experience. It might also have been derived from an analysis of the concept of democracy, if the concept had been accurately analyzed." Here the author mentions the proven record of democracy when he mentions his experience. Option C correctly states the fact.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



405. **B**

In the whole passage, the author seems to favor democracy over the rule of the minority. He offers various context in this support and concludes that democracy is better in terms of taking care of minority.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

406. **D**

Refer to the following lines: "It might also have been derived from an analysis of the concept of democracy, if the concept had been accurately analyzed." Here the author states that if the concepts of democracy are analysed properly then its wide scope can be deciphered.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

407. **C**

Although articulate refers to the person having clarity of thought but in this case it is contextually incorrect. Here the author wants to mention those persons who are well educated and can form a coherent class. Option C mentions the meaning in the correct context.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

408. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "Far from oppressing the cultured minority, or any other minorities, democracy gives more of them more scope to have their way than any other system does." The author clearly mentions that the minorities are given more voice in a democracy which is mentioned in C.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

409. **B**

Before the word "recognize", "by accident" has been used. The author wants to convey that computers might produce poetry by accident but they cannot produce the poetry by will because poetry requires emotional height that man is capable of attaining.

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410. **D**

In the last line of the passage, the author states that there is no break of continuity between what is human and what is mechanical. It means that human and mechanical forms are continuous which is mentioned in D.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

411. **D**

The author compares the functional aspects of organizing and communication between computers and human brains when he states that machines are becoming more and more like humans.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

412. **C**

In this passage, the author compares the aspects of organizing and communication between computers and human brains which is similar in both the cases. Refer to the following line for better illustration: "Further more, brains and computers can both be organized so as to solve problems. The mode of communication is very similar in both the cases,"

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

413. **D**

In the second last line, the author clearly mentions the accidental mixing up of the words by computer can result in poetry which is clearly mentioned in D.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

414. **B**

The author clearly states that computers compose the poetry by accident while the mode of communication is same in both the cases.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



415. **D**

Primary education is not a fundamental right yet. A bill was tabled seeking to make primary education a fundamental right.

It is not mentioned in the passage that primary education is only for privileged sections of the society.

Hence, none of the options are true.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

416. **C**

"One has only to look at the success of the district primary education programme, which was launched in 1994. It has met with a fair degree of success in the 122 districts it covers."

From these lines, we can say that the programme was launched in 1994 and it was successful in 122 districts.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

417. **B**

Consider the following sentence: "But the task of universalizing elementary education (UEE) is complicated by various socio-economic and cultural factors...within regions". So, diverse cultural and socio-economic factors is one of the problems plaguing Indian education system. Option b) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

418. **A**

Refer to the following lines: "The key then is to decentralise education planning and implementation. What's also needed is greater community involvement in the whole process." This is highlighted in option A.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

419. **C**

"Unfortunately, the Panchayat Raj Act has not been notified in many states. After all, delegating powers to the panchayats is not looked upon too kindly by vested interests. More specifically, by politicians, since decentralisation of education administration takes away from them the power of transfer, which they use to grant favours and build up a support base."

Through these sentences, we can infer that politicians obstruct successful implementation of educational policies.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



420. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "The trouble has been that education policy has been designed by grizzled mandarins ensconced in Delhi and is totally out of touch with the ground reality." Here the author states that the people who make education policies are not in touch with reality.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

421. **C**

Refer to the following sentence: "Believe it or not, this list actually includes Bihar, Madhya Pradesh (MP) and Rajasthan". So, very low education levels are visible in these three states. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

422. **D**

The term "grizzled" refers to the grey or white hair indicating older people. "mandarin" is a word used to indicate bureaucrats - China was one of the earliest countries to have a civil service and thus members of the Indian Civil Service are sometimes referred to as mandarins. Hence, the phrase refers to old bureaucrats. Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

423. **D**

"In MP, the village panchayats are responsible for not only constructing and maintaining primary schools but also managing scholarships, besides organising non-formal education."

Through the above information, we can say that both B and C are true.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

424. **A**

The answer to this question can be concluded directly if we refer to these lines: "The trouble has been that education policy has been designed by grizzled mandarins ensconced in Delhi and is totally out of touch with the ground reality. The key then is to decentralise education planning and implementation. What's also needed is greater community involvement in the whole process. " Here the author states that the key to solve the problems is to decentralize education,

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



425. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "But there the trouble begins. First, there is no guarantee that a dictatorship will be an enlightened one." This is highlighted in option B.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

426. **B**

Refer to the given lines in the passage: "Almost all politicians are convinced of the merits of liberalization though they may occasionally lose sight of the big picture in pandering to their constituencies. India has moved slower than China on liberalization, but whatever moves it has made are more permanent. Democracies are also less likely to get embroiled in destructive wars." The author wants to highlight that the liberalization measures can be embroiled in difficulties if there is a dictatorship in a country.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

427. **C**

Refer to the following sentence: "Few doubt that the Internet will play an important role in the global economy in the decades to come". Option c) is correct. However, there is nothing in the passage from which we can infer that India stands to gain from its Internet policy. We can rule out options b) and d). Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

428. **C**

Refer to the following sentences: "Democracies make many small mistakes. But dictatorships are more susceptible to making huge ones and risking everything on one decision". Option c) brings out this idea clearly.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

429. **C**

Refer to the last few sentences of the passage. The author is of the opinion that it is better to have a slow and stable rate of growth than a high and unstable rate of growth. This is best captured in option c). Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

A promotional banner for 'CAT Daily Targets'. On the left, a man and a woman are standing with their arms crossed. In the center, the text 'CAT Daily Targets' is written in large, bold, black letters. Below this, a yellow banner says 'Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile'. On the right, there is a logo for 'cracku' and an illustration of a calendar with a clock.

430. **D**

Option A is incorrect as the author mentions Israel to be the only democratic nation where dictatorship is the norm.

Option B is incorrect as the author compares Myanmar with Bangladesh and not with Israel.

Option C is incorrect as the author says that policies can be reversed in a dictatorship and highlights Israel to be a dictatorship.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

431. **D**

Refer to the following sentences: "Democracies are like political equivalents of free markets....The same goes for political parties...competition". From these sentences, we can infer that options a), b) and c) are all correct. So, option d) all of the above is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

432. **B**

Option a) is incorrect. The author feels that it is better to have a democracy that is faulty than to have a dictatorship that is benign. Statements in options c) and d), though correct, are not the conclusions that the author is drawing from the passage. Option b) is the correct answer. The conclusion that the author is drawing is that statism should not replace the voice of the people under any circumstances.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

433. **D**

Throughout the passage, the author is of the opinion that though the moves of China have been more confident than the nimble steps of India, it is better to go India's way rather than the way of China's dictatorship. Options a) and c) are incorrect. Also, there is nothing in the passage to suggest that India has failed as a democracy. Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

434. C

The authors mentions that in a democratic country like India the actions and the decisions of the leaders are scrutinized while Chinese leadership can go ahead with any decision without opposition. He further states that the growth of a democratic economy may be slower because the process of decision making will take in account the contrary views too. Hence C is the answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



435. A

The discourse of nationalism shows that the material/spiritual distinction was condensed into an analogous, but ideologically far more powerful, dichotomy: that between the outer and the inner....

The above excerpt shows that the material/spiritual distinction was condensed to form a far more superior dichotomy of the outer and the inner. Thus, the former was the premise for the latter, as well as inferior to the latter. Hence, Options B and C are true.

To overcome this domination, the colonized people had to learn those superior techniques of organizing material life and incorporate them within their own cultures. . . . But this could not mean the imitation of the West in every aspect of life, for then the very distinction between the West and the East would vanish—the self-identity of national culture would itself be threatened. . .

From the above excerpt, we can infer that the dichotomy helped save the identity of Indian Nationalism. Option D is also true.

Option A is not true as per the passage, and hence, is the answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

436. B

Once we match this new meaning of the home/world dichotomy with the identification of social roles by gender, we get the ideological framework within which nationalism answered the women's question. It would be a grave error to see in this, as liberals are apt to in their despair at the many marks of social conservatism in nationalist practice, a total rejection of the West. Quite the contrary: the nationalist paradigm in fact supplied an ideological principle of selection.

From the above excerpt, we can see that the liberals were concerned over the social conservatism that nationalist practice promoted as an ideological principal of selection, where social roles would be selected according to the gender of the person. Hence, Option B is the answer, as it comes the closest in capturing the liberal perception of the same.

The material/spiritual dichotomy has not been discussed in terms of liberal perspective, hence, Option A is out of the score here.

Option C is incorrect. Indian nationalism did not accept the changes brought about the colonialism, rather, promoted the segregation of gender roles according to their spiritual ideology of home/ world dichotomy.

Option D is contrary to what is mentioned in the passage. The author says that the 'ideological principle of selection' was the actual truth, and the liberal perspective was just contrary to what was actually happening.

437. D

I have elaborated . . . a framework for analyzing the contradictory pulls on [Indian] nationalist ideology in its struggle against the dominance of colonialism and the resolution it offered to those contradictions. Briefly, this resolution was built around a separation of the domain of culture into two spheres—the material and the spiritual. It was in the material sphere that the claims of Western civilization were the most powerful. Science, technology, rational forms of economic organization, modern methods of statecraft—these had given the European countries the strength to subjugate the non-European people . . . To overcome this domination, the colonized people had to learn those superior techniques of organizing material life and incorporate them within their own cultures. . . . But this could not mean the imitation of the West in every aspect of life, for then the very distinction between the West and the East would vanish—the self-identity of national culture would itself be threatened. . . .

The first paragraph acknowledges that the nationalist ideology was fighting against colonial dominance, and there were certain inherent contradictions in the way this struggle was being carried out. The author says that a method of resolution of these contradictions was to separate material and spiritual domains. This hints at the contradiction present. We can infer from here that this is being done because the nationalists acknowledge that the colonial countries were superior in certain aspects, which allowed them to subjugate non-Europeans, as is also mentioned later in the paragraph. The author also mentions that the colonized people had to learn those superior techniques, instead of all-out rejection of colonialist ideas and the progress they brought with them. Thus, the contradiction was that to overcome colonial dominance, nationalism had to accept that the material ways of the West were superior and incorporate them. Hence, Option D is the answer.

438. C

The arguments in the passage are based on the premise that the material and spiritual aspects of culture were different. Hence, even if Indian nationalism accepted the superior material ways of the west, they still would not be giving in to colonial dominance and their identity would be preserved by the spiritual aspect, as it remained unaffected. Hence, to weaken the author's argument, we can give a statement that proves that the spiritual aspect was affected too. Option C does that and is the answer.

Rejecting education for women could have more than one reason. It does not imply that the spiritual part of Indian culture was affected by colonialism. Moreover, the separation of roles according to gender is something that nationalist ideology supported, hence, rejecting education based on gender would not contradict it. Option A can be eliminated.

Option B does not weaken the author's argument since the author already agrees that the forces of colonialist modernity helped shape Indian nationalism, but only in the material aspect.

Option D is unrelated to the argument at hand and can be eliminated too.

439. E

Refer to the last 3 lines

"From the point of view here developed, all laws, all theories, remain essentially tentative, or conjectural, or hypothetical, even when we feel unable to doubt them any longer. Before a theory has been refuted we can never know in what way it may have to be modified."

Option E clearly supports this argument.

Option A contains a distortion of "endless questioning". A critical attitude requires questioning but not endless questioning.

Option B has not been implied anywhere in the passage.

The first part of option C is true but the second part is false. The result of a critical attitude is not noise but tested beliefs that are subject to change.

Option D has not been implied anywhere in the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



440. C

Refer to these lines

"But the distinction between dogmatic and critical thinking, or the dogmatic and the critical attitude, brings us right back to our central problem. For the dogmatic attitude is clearly related to the tendency to verify our laws and schemata by seeking to apply them and to confirm them, even to the point of neglecting refutations, whereas the critical attitude is one of readiness to change them – to test them; to refute them; to falsify them, if possible. This suggests that we may identify the critical attitude with the scientific attitude, and the dogmatic attitude with the one which we have described as pseudo-scientific."

Option C is the main point of the above paragraph. Hence, option C is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

441. D

Refer to the lines:

It further suggests that genetically speaking the pseudo-scientific attitude is more primitive than, and prior to, the scientific attitude: that it is a pre-scientific attitude. And this primitivity or priority also has its logical aspect. For the critical attitude is not so much opposed to the dogmatic attitude as super-imposed upon it. It clearly illustrates option 4.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

442. B

It has been stated in the passage that "For the critical attitude is not so much opposed to the dogmatic attitude as super-imposed upon it: criticism must be directed against existing and influential beliefs in need of critical revision - in other words, dogmatic beliefs. A critical attitude needs for its raw material, as it were, theories or beliefs which are held more or less dogmatically."

From this we can infer that critical attitude is not opposed to dogmatic beliefs. Rather it uses dogmatic beliefs as raw material. Hence, we can eliminate options A, D and E.

From the passage, we can infer that the critical attitude acts on dogmatic beliefs to refine them. Hence, option B is more appropriate.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

443. A

Options C,D,E do not hold true.

Amongst option A and B, option A is more appropriate. Refer to the 3rd paragraph. It is written that "the pseudo-scientific attitude is more primitive than, and prior to, the scientific attitude: that it is a pre-scientific attitude. And this primitivity or priority also has its logical aspect. For the critical attitude is not so much opposed to the dogmatic attitude as super-imposed upon it: criticism must be directed against existing and influential beliefs in need of critical revision – in other words, dogmatic beliefs. A critical attitude needs for its raw material, as it were, theories or beliefs which are held more or less dogmatically".

 VIDEO SOLUTION

444. **B**

Option A: He gives explanation/reasoning behind the various methods adopted in history but does not question them.

Option C: The author doesn't discuss about the merits/ demerits or evaluate a method of map-making. It is involved more with the history of the method.

Option D speaks about myth. While most of the data are quoted from history, they cannot be misrepresented as a myth.

The author starts the passage by talking about the history of map making. The author then mentions how north was never put at the top in ancient times.

"Given such a long history of human map-making, it is perhaps surprising that it is only within the last few hundred years that north has been consistently considered to be at the top. In fact, for much of human history, north almost never appeared at the top".

He implicitly means that people have a preemptive notion of maps facing the north. He goes on to mention that it was considered a bad direction. He says that north being put at the top is a fairly recent phenomenon. He then goes on to discuss why different people started putting north at the top. He mentions that the reasons for different people putting north at the top were different from what people think now.

He cites various examples to show that north's presence in top is more recent and due to varied factors.

Hence, he is trying to clear certain misconceptions about why north is put at the top in the maps. Thus, option B is the most suitable answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



445. **A**

According to the passage, early Egyptian maps placed the East at the top because that was the position of sunrise. Hence, we can say that natural phenomena dictated the map-making convention in this case. Thus, option A is correct.

Options B and D are incorrect as the conventions were decided by religious factors and not natural phenomena. Option C also can be eliminated as the orientation was a result of their desire to honour their emperor. Hence, the answer is option A.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

446. **C**

We can straightaway eliminate option A. The author says that though one might think that the trend of north-up maps was set by these explorers, this is in fact not true. Options B and D are also incorrect. The passage says that the explorers navigated with the help of the North Star.

In the passage, it is given that "When Columbus describes the world it is in accordance with east being at the top, he says. "Columbus says he is going towards paradise, so his mentality is from a medieval mappa mundi." Hence, we can infer that statement C is true.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

447. **D**

In the passage, the author discusses how North was traditionally not put on the top of early maps. The author explicitly refutes the role of the compass and of European explorers in placing North at the top of maps. Hence, we can eliminate options A and B. The author says that East was placed at the top of Christian maps. Hence, option C is also incorrect. Though the author counters all known explanations as to why North was placed on the top, he does not offer any explanation of his own. Hence, option D is correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

448. **B**

The passage mentions that the Chinese put North at the top of the map because the emperor would live in the North and he preferred to look towards South. Hence, the fact that South was preferred by some emperors is not a reason why North was put at the top. Hence, option B is false. All other options are mentioned in the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

449. **B**

We can straightaway eliminate options A and D. The passage states that the Chinese compasses pointed to magnetic south and that south was considered a more desirable direction. While option C is true, that is not the reason why North was placed at the top.

The passage states that the emperor lived in the north and hence maps depicted him as above his subjects. Thus, north was placed at the top of the map to show respect for the emperor. Thus, option B is correct.

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450. **C**

The author argues that malls were more than just shopping places. Towards the end of the passage, the author tries to invoke a sense of nostalgia by stating how malls used to play an important role in everyone's life and how that function is getting lost.

Let us evaluate the options.

Option B states that the advantages of the malls outweigh the disadvantages. The author has not mentioned anything about the disadvantages of the malls. Therefore, we can easily eliminate option B.

Option D states that malls are closing down since people have found an alternate way to shop. Though the option is true, the main point of the author is not that malls are closing down. The author is concerned about the fact that malls were places of congregation and the closure of malls takes a social function away with them. Therefore, we can eliminate option D as well.

Options A and C are close. Option A states that the closure of malls has affected the social and economic life of America. However, the author states that the closure of malls is reflective of the changing social structure of America. Option A gets the relationship backwards and hence, option A can be eliminated.

Option C states that malls used to perform a social function that has been lost. This seems to be the main point that the author is trying to emphasize through the paragraph. The author states how malls used to be places of congregation and how the new generation finds no need to go to malls. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

451. **A**

No where has it been mentioned that Amazon is helping brands go online. Therefore, we can eliminate option C.

Option D states that the purpose of the line is to indicate that the shopping habits of the middle class America has changed. However, the author talks about shopping habits towards the end of the passage. The author has not introduced the topic of 'shopping habits' when the given line has been mentioned. Therefore, we can eliminate option D as well.

Option B states that the author uses the line to indicate that the malls and distribution centres are located in the same area. However, the author states that the distribution centres are replacing the malls. He does not intend to convey that they co-exist. Therefore, we can eliminate option B as well.

Option A states that the author uses the line to indicate the irony of the situation. Option A captures the fact that the author finds it ironic that distribution centres are springing up near the places where the malls once existed. Therefore, option A is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

452. **B**

In the first paragraph, the author states that "many of them the brand-name anchor outlets that real estate developers once stumbled over themselves to court", indicating that the brand outlets used to be sought after once but are no longer in demand. The author states that the real estate developers used to fight each other over these outlets earlier. Therefore, we can infer that the real estate developers no longer show the kind of enthusiasm they did (since the outlets are closing down) and hence, option B is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

453. **D**

The main point that the author places is that malls served as places of social interaction and cannot be reduced to merely places of commercial activity. Therefore, the author compares the malls as America's public square to show the bustling social life that the malls hosted. Therefore, option D is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

454. **C**

The author calls malls an ecosystem since they served as places of congregation. The author compares the market places from ancient Greece to emphasize how malls, just like the market places through out the history, served as the places of social interaction as well. Only option C captures the fact that malls serves both as commercial and social centres and hence, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

 **100+ CAT DILR Questions**

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455. **A**

In the last 2 paragraphs, the author tries to invoke a sense of nostalgia by describing the malls. He tries to make the readers feel the ambiance and vibrance of the malls by taking us down the memory lane. Option B adopts an objective tone. The author does not merely describe a mall. He tries to invoke our memories of the malls. Options C and D can be eliminated since the purpose of the author is not to emphasize that all brands were

available at one place or to establish the reason for the sweet smell that the malls carried. The author tries to make an emotional appeal and only option A captures this point. Therefore, option A is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

456. **A**

In the second paragraph, the author mentions that the facilities are not fully utilized due to their sheer capacity. 'The facilities benefit is dubious at best for buildings such as velodromes or natatoriums and problematic for 100,000-seat Olympic stadiums. The latter require a conversion plan for future use, the former are usually doomed to near vacancy'. Nowhere has it been mentioned that the facilities become outdated or that they are located far from the city. The author mentions in the second paragraph that the structures are expensive to maintain.

Therefore, option A is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

457. **C**

The author expresses his views that hosting Olympics cost a lot and the financial prospects are not that good. Towards the end of the first paragraph, he uses the line "Any economic benefit would have to flow from the value of the Games as an advertisement for the city, the new transportation and communications infrastructure that was created for the Games, or the ongoing use of the new facilities". From this line, we can infer that the author states that there are any benefits, it should be from advertisements and the use of the facilities (implying that the other streams are unlikely to yield any revenue).

It has not been mentioned that the 3 committees share the profit equally. Even if they do, it is not the main point that the author intends to convey through the first paragraph. Therefore, we can eliminate option A.

Option B states that the revenue accrues through advertisement and ticket sales. No information has been provided about 'ticket sales' and hence, option B can be eliminated.

Option D states that the revenues are usually eroded by the expenditure incurred by host city. The second paragraph builds on revenue from 'advertising and infrastructure' implying that the primary purpose of the first paragraph was to introduce these topics rather than to lament that the expenditure of the host city erodes the revenue. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

458. **D**

We can infer option A from the line 'Even if they have future use, are they the best use of precious urban real estate?'. The author feels that the urban real estate can be put to better use than hosting Olympics.

The author mentions that the fiscal resources can be used for more productive pursuits than hosting Olympics in the last line of the passage.

We can infer option B from the line "Residential areas often are razed and citizens relocated".

Option D cannot be inferred from the passage and hence, it is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

459. **A**

The answer can be deduced from the following lines:". Being successful with equity investments required no skills; only investible funds. Nor was fund-raising a problem, as investors desperately sought ways to grab a piece of equity boom. Between 1984 and 1989, the mutual funds collected Rs. 13,455 crore as subscriptions, but, in the next five years, they picked up Rs. 45,573 crore."

Here the author highlights the fact that the boom in mutual fund market was due to the boom in equity markets in mid-eighties.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



460. A

The answer can be inferred from the given lines:"According to a study conducted by the Delhi-based Value Research, at least 18 big schemes due for redemption over the next three years will be unable to service their investors, or even return their money at the time of redemption."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

461. C

Option C can be deduced from the following lines:"The individual investor it was who had made the mutual fund post-liberalisation, India's most vibrant vehicle for individual investment. The individual investor it was who brought the curtain down on an act that had started with a virtuoso performance, only to putrefy into a show of ineptitude, imprudence, and irresponsibility. The mutual fund, as we know it, may be dead. It died of many things. "

Here the author states that the individual investors made it most vibrant vehicle and then started acting irresponsibly.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

462. A

The answer can be inferred from the given lines:" In the offices of another asset management company half way across Mumbai, the demand for cellular-phones peaked six months ago. Its employees had, suddenly, realized that making their personal deals using information gathered in the course of their professional work, was best done over cell phones so that the company's records wouldn't show the call being made."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

463. B

The amount can be inferred from the given lines: "As of June 30, 1998, the country's 252 fund-schemes managed assets with a market value of Rs. 69,599 crore, with the UTI alone controlling the fate of Rs. 50,000 crore. That is Rs. 11,000 crore less than the money invested in these schemes as of June 30, 1997, which means that the mutual funds have wiped out Rs. 11,000 crore from the investors' hard earned money in the intervening 12 months."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

464. A

The author highlight that after the collapse of Mutual Fund industry, the investors are in dilemma. "Caught between the devil and deep blue sea" means to be in dilemma.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF

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465. **C**

The given answer can be inferred from the given lines: "According to Marketing And Development Research Associates (MDRA) opinion poll of 342 investors conducted last fortnight in the five metros — Bangalore, Kolkata, Chennai, Delhi and Mumbai — mutual funds as an investment instrument now ranks a lowly fourth on safety — after bank deposits, gold, and real estate — and fifth on returns — ahead only of bank deposits and gold."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

466. **B**

The answer can be concluded from the given lines: "The individual investor it was who had made the mutual fund post-liberalisation, India's most vibrant vehicle for individual investment. The individual investor it was who brought the curtain down on an act that had started with a virtuoso performance, only to putrefy into a show of ineptitude, imprudence, and irresponsibility. The mutual fund, as we know it, may be dead. It died of many things."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

467. **B**

The answer to this question can be deduced from the given lines: "Had they but known of the actual practices seen in the offices and hallways of the mutual funds, which have translated into these results, investors would have shown their disgust long ago."

The author states that if they had not indulged in malpractices than the investors would have withdrawn a long time ago.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

468. **A**

The answer is option A which can be inferred from the given lines: "A cancer that grew from the refusal of the men and women to manage the mutual fund to exercise a mixture of caution and aggression, but to adopt, instead, an indisciplined, unplanned, fire-from-the hip approach to investment."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

469. **C**

The answer is option c which can be inferred from the given lines: "A cancer that destroyed the value of the investments, the mutual funds was made to service the Rs. 85,000 crore that India's investors had entrusted them with ever since they began life way back in 1964 as The Unit Trust Of India's (UTI), now disgraced Unit Scheme 64(US 64)" Here the author refers to the mutual fund industry as a cancer which catered to Rs 85,000 crore entrusted by Indian investors.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Important Topics

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470. **D**

Option d can be directly referred from the following lines: "It is not an exaggeration then to say that the emergence of the cell theory represents biology's most significant and fruitful advance."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

471. **C**

The given answer can be determined from the words which Pasteur said: "And, therefore, gentlemen, I could point to that liquid and say to you, I have taken my drop of water from the immensity of creation, and I have taken it full of the elements appropriated to the development of inferior beings. And I wait, I watch, I question it! — begging it to recommence for me the beautiful spectacle of the first creation. But it is dumb, dumb since these experiments were begun several years ago; It is dumb because I have kept it from the only thing man does not know how to produce: from the germs that float in the air, from life, for life is a germ and a germ is life. Never will the doctrine of spontaneous generation recover from the mortal blow of this simple experiment." Option C is stated in these lines.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

472. **B**

Refer to the following sentences: "In association with Buffon, the Irish Jewish priest John Needham...But wrote Thomas Huxley... for the benefit of Buffon and Needham". From this, we can infer that Buffon, Needham, Voltaire and Huxley were contemporaries. Option b) is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

473. **A**

The answer can be deduced from the given lines: "It was now clear how precisely careful one had to be to avoid bacterial contamination in the laboratory. We now knew what 'sterile' meant and we knew that there could be no such thing as 'partial sterilization'. The discovery of bacteria high in the upper atmosphere, in the mud of the deep sea bottom, in the waters of hot springs, and in the Arctic glaciers established bacterial ubiquity as almost absolute."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

474. **C**

Refer to the following sentence: "In association with Buffon, the Irish priest...theorized that God did not create living things...to bring them forth". From this, we can infer that Needham's theory was posited as an attempt at propitiating a possibly offended God or the religious psyche of the time. Option c) is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



475. **B**

The answer is option b and it can be found from the given lines: "Continuous scepticism drove Pasteur almost to fanatical efforts to control the ingredients of his experiments to destroy the doubts of the most sceptical. He ranged from the mountain air of Montanvert, which he showed to be almost sterile, to those deep, clear wells whose waters had been rendered germfree by slow filtration through sandy soil. The latter discovery led to the familiar porcelain filters of the bacteriology laboratory."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

476. **B**

Option b can be concluded directly from the given lines: "For many, Pasteur's conclusions caused conflict because they seemed simultaneously to support the Biblical account of creation while denying a variety of other philosophical systems. "

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

477. **B**

In this passage the author states that the people who believed in the idea of spontaneous generation did not take into account the experimental error. Refer to the following lines for detail: "In the above controversy, what was unreasonable was the parade of men who claimed to have 'proved' or who resolutely 'believed in' spontaneous generation on the face of proof — not that spontaneous generation cannot occur — but that their work was shot through with experimental error"

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

478. **A**

Option b is the conclusion of the Pasteur's experiment. The contention was option A as expressed in the given lines "Therefore, he contended, either air contained a factor necessary for the spontaneous generation of life or viable germs were borne in by the air and seeded in the sterile nutrient broth."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

479. **B**

Refer to the following line: "To him, the research problem was largely a technical one: to repeat the work of those who claimed to have observed bacterial entry. For the one that contended that life did not enter from the outside, the proof had to go to the question of possible contamination. Pasteur worked logically." The author suggests that Pasteur worked logically unlike his predecessors.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



480. **C**

Refer to the following sentences: "To ring good punning changes, gag writers have to know their way around in a language. They don't get paid for ignorance, only for simulating it". So, the writer means to say that simulating ignorance is the trick that makes gag writers tick. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

481. **A**

This fact is highlighted when the author talks about the gag writers in two aspects of the language. Refer to the following lines: "Gag writers' tricks with words point up the fact that we have two distinct levels of language: familiar, ordinary words that everybody knows; and more elaborate words that don't turn up so often, but many of which we need to know if we are to feel at home in listening and reading today." These line confirm option a as an answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

482. **B**

Refer to the following sentence: "Quite apart from the dollar sign on it,...word trade". From this, we can understand that a large part of the American population indulges in word trade. Option b) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

483. **B**

The answer can be concluded directly from the given lines: "This is the old minstrel trick, using a long fancy term, instead of calling a worm a worm. Chico Marx can stretch a pun over 500 feet of film, making it funnier all the time, as he did when he rendered, "Why a duck?" And even the high-brow radio writers have taken advantage of gagmen's technique."

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

484. **A**

Refer to the following lines: "Gag writers' tricks with words point up the fact that we have two distinct levels of language: familiar, ordinary words that everybody knows; and more elaborate words that don't turn up so often, but many of which we need to know if we are to feel at home in listening and reading today. To be sure gagmen play hob with the big words, making not sense but fun of them. They keep on confusing bigotry with bigamy, illiterate with illegitimate, monotony with monogamy, osculation with oscillation." In this passage the author states that the gag writers make the use of double meaning language in order to make everyone feeling cozy.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



485. **D**

Refer to the following sentences: "This is a portmanteau word or 'combo'...", "For the very fact that gag writers often use a long and unusual word...". From these sentences, we can infer that gag writers combine parts of words to produce a hilarious effect and that long words play a major role. So, option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

486. **B**

Throughout the passage, the author brings out various examples which show that the primary hallmark of a gag writer is that he/she has fun with words. Refer to the words 'hilarious', 'joke' etc. strewn throughout the passage. This is clearly brought out in option b).

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

487. **A**

The author quotes Lord Snow in the passage: "and finally to train politicians, administrators, and entire community...". Option a) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

488. **C**

Refer to the following sentences: "Lord Snow, it will be recalled, talked about 'The Two Cultures'...at the other the scientists". So, according to Lord Snow, the intellectual life of the Western society is split between the scientists and literary intellectuals". Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

489. **A**

Refer to the first sentence of the passage: "In Western civilization is in a state of permanent crisis, it is not far-fetched to suggest that there maybe something wrong with its education". So, the writer's contention is that the crisis in the Western civilization can be explained by the presence of some flaws in its education. Option a) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



490. **A**

Refer to the following sentence: "The essence of education, i suggested, is the transmission of values...". So, according to the author, the main responsibility of education is to transmit ideas of value. Option a) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

491. **D**

Refer to the following sentences: "These ideas on education, which are by no means unrepresentative of our times, ...Second Law of Thermodynamics". From these sentences, we can understand that the author is not of the opinion that the gulf between science and literature needs to be bridged. Also, there is nothing in the passage to suggest that the author believes that ideas should be maintained for a holistic view of society and its problems or that words are not ideas.

Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

492. **B**

Consider the following sentences: "We often notice the existence of more or less fixed ideas in other people's minds - ideas with which they think without being aware of doing so. We then call them prejudices". So, a prejudice is a fixed idea with which people think without being aware of doing so. Option b) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

493. **C**

Refer to the following sentence: "I say, therefore, that we think with or through ideas and that what we call thinking is generally the application of pre-existing ideas to a given situation or set of facts". So, thinking is an application of pre-existing ideas to a situation. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

494. **B**

Refer to the following sentences: "The essence of education, I suggested, ... more than mere formulae or dogmatic assertions..". From these sentences, we understand that according to the author, values are not merely dogmatic assertions". Option b) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



CAT Syllabus PDF



495. C

From the passage, we can infer that the author feels that the neutrality of science would be under threat in the future. Hence, he does not question whether it is currently neutral or not. Similarly, we cannot infer that scientists question the neutrality of science. Hence, we can eliminate options A and B.

The author does question the scientists stand that their labours are neutral and the fruits depend on the actions of others. The author particularly worries about this given the fact that most people don't even understand the work of the scientists. Hence, the author questions the scientists stand on the neutrality of their labours. Hence, option C is the right answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

496. B

Refer to the first few lines of the paragraph: "If Western civilization is in a state of permanent crisis, it is not far-fetched to suggest that there may be something wrong with its education. No civilization, I am sure, has ever devoted more energy and resources to organised education, and if we believe in nothing else, we certainly believe that education is, or should be, the key to everything. In fact, the belief in education is so strong that we treat it as the residual legatee of all our problems." Here the author criticises our view when we consider the solution of some problem as more education.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

497. B

Option A: **[Correct]** The passage states that technical ideals, such as cost and efficiency, are often determined by a dominant culture that prioritizes economic growth for the most privileged segments of society. This can result in technologies and interventions that are not designed with the needs and concerns of marginalized groups in mind, leading to systemic discrimination against these groups.

Option B: **[Incorrect]** The passage does not mention anything about sustainability or medical waste contributing to greenhouse gas emissions as a reason for the systematic discrimination of marginalized people in technology-related interventions.

Option C: **[Correct]** The passage mentions that certain technologies, such as spirometers, have correction factors that assume smaller lung capacity in Black and Asian individuals based on research by eugenicists who believed in racial hierarchies and considered nonwhite people as inferior. This is an example of how subjective beliefs can be treated as facts and encoded into technologies, leading to social inequities.

Option D: **[Correct]** The passage discusses how subjective beliefs treated as facts by those in decision-making roles can result in physical failures, such as incorrect dosing of drugs for people assigned female at birth, and also encode social inequities, such as the correction factors on spirometers that assume smaller lung capacity in Black and Asian individuals.

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 [VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

498. D

Based on the passage, it is likely that the author would approve of all of the options except for Option D, which is moving towards technical-social dualism. Technical-social dualism is described in the passage as the idea that the technical and social dimensions of engineering problems are readily separable and remain distinct throughout the problem-definition and solution process. The passage criticizes this approach, arguing that it ignores the social dimensions of engineering problems and leads to a focus on technical ideals such as cost and efficiency at the expense of broader societal concerns. Therefore, it is unlikely that the author would approve of moving towards technical-social dualism.

Option A is likely to be included because the passage mentions the need for engineers to be aware of the potential impacts of their work on different groups of people, including the environment. It is suggested that ignoring these factors can result in technologies that are not sustainable, which can contribute to a crisis of

medical waste and health care, accounting for 10% of U.S. greenhouse gas emissions.

Option B is likely to be included because the passage discusses the consequences of ignoring social dimensions in engineering, such as physical failures and the perpetuation of social inequities. It suggests that a more responsible approach to technical design and problem-solving would consider the full range of stakeholders and the potential impacts of a technology on different groups of people.

Option C is likely to be included because the passage emphasizes the importance of considering social justice in engineering education and practice. It mentions courses focusing on place-based knowledge and community engagement as examples of efforts to incorporate social justice into engineering education. Such an approach would involve designing technologies that are responsive to the needs of communities, using local knowledge and taking into account local priorities.

Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

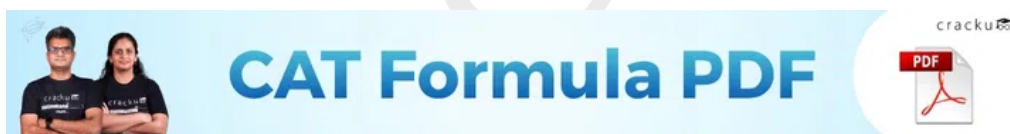
499. **D**

Option D is not mentioned in the passage as a negative outcome of focusing on technical ideals in the medical sphere. The passage specifically mentions that "most FDA-approved drugs are incorrectly dosed for people assigned female at birth, leading to unexpected adverse reactions. This is because they have been inadequately represented in clinical trials," which suggests that the incorrect dosing of drugs for people assigned female at birth is a consequence of inadequate representation in clinical trials, rather than a result of focusing on technical ideals.

The other options are all mentioned in the passage as negative outcomes of focusing on technical ideals in the medical sphere. Option A refers to the passage's mention of the lack of technologies for "systemically marginalized people" such as those with endometriosis. Option B relates to the discussion on spirometers that have correction factors that assume smaller lung capacity in Black and Asian individuals based on research by eugenicists. Option C is tied to the discussion on "most FDA-approved drugs" being incorrectly dosed for people assigned female at birth due to inadequate representation in clinical trials.

Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



500. **B**

The passage discusses the concept of technical-social dualism, which separates the technical and social dimensions of engineering problems and can result in a focus on technical ideals such as cost and efficiency at the expense of broader societal concerns. The passage states that this way of teaching "primes students to believe that their decision-making is purely objective, as it is grounded in math and science" and that "nontechnical parameters such as access to a technology, cultural relevancy or potential harms are deemed political and invalid." These statements support the claim that engineering students are taught to focus on objective technical outcomes, independent of the social dimensions of their work. Option B best captures the above understanding. The other answer choices do not accurately reflect the content or the main argument of the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

501. **D**

Option A: If the workforce size is the largest in the rural area throughout the twenty-first century, then it directly contradicts the theory of the migration of most of the population from rural areas to urban areas. The sample space of the workforce population does not tally with this theory of migration. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option B: If this population census of 1952 is accurate, it directly nullifies the above migration theory. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option C: If the data for the estimation of per capita income in the mid-twentieth century primarily required data from the rural areas, then it is not possible that the majority of the population lives in the urban areas. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option D: If this option is true, it will strengthen the theory of the intermigration of people from rural to urban areas. Thus, this is the correct option.

Thus, the correct option is D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

502. **D**

The above passage is a case study of how rapid or dramatic social change causes relate to increasing crime growth in Chicago. The passage focus on the effects of social disorganization on crime in Chicago.

Option A: There is no comparison of crime in Chicago with that of crime in other states. Thus, this is not the correct answer.

Option B: The passage focus on the effects of social disorganization on crime in Chicago. It is not specific only to the racial aspect. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option C: This is a distortion of the passage's main idea. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option D: This option aptly describes the main conclusion of the passage and hence, is the correct option.

The correct option is D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

503. **B**

"Failure to integrate these immigrants, coupled with other forces of social disorganization such as crowding, poverty, and illness, caused crime rates to climb in the cities, particularly in the segregated wards and neighborhoods where the migrants were forced to live."

From the above excerpt of the penultimate paragraph of the passage, it can be inferred that poverty and the rise in disorganization contributed to the increase in crime in American cities. Thus, option A is a valid inference and hence can be eliminated.

"The social lives of these migrants, as well as those already living in cities they moved to, were disrupted by the differences between urban and rural life . According to social disorganization theory, until the social ecology of the "new place" can adapt, this rapid change is a criminogenic influence."

From the above excerpt of the second passage, it can be inferred that the difference between urban and rural life contributed to the disruption experienced by the migrants. Also, this rapid change contributes to the rise in crime in these cities. Thus, options C and D are also valid and hence cannot be the answer.

"These migrants, unlike their white counterparts, were not integrated into the cities they now called home. In fact, most American cities at the end of the twentieth century was characterized by high levels of racial residential segregation."

Although the African American migrants faced a high level of racial segregation, it is nowhere mentioned that it was because they were less organised. Thus, option B is not true in the scope of the passage and hence is the correct option.

Thus, the correct option is B.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

504. **B**

The passage starts by stating about the sociologists working in the Chicago school tradition on the causality between social disorganization and crime. Then the author describes the immigration experienced in American cities in the 1920s and 1930s. The author then gives the reason why this led to an increase in crime rates (some examples being *failure to integrate these immigrants, coupled with other forces of social disorganization, such as crowding, poverty, and illness, caused crime rates to climb in the cities, particularly in the segregated wards and neighborhoods where the migrants were forced to live.*)

Both options A and C should be eliminated because, in these options, the words social disorganization/ organization or crimes are missing. Compared with D, B is better because the term heavy industry is not a keyword of the passage. Also, more than population growth, migration is the primary reason behind social disorganization.

Thus, the correct option is B.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



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505. **A**

Option A: This is true; for example, the monosyllabic word pray has only one onset /pr/ while the trisyllabic word val:en:tin has two onsets - /v/ and /t/, and three rimes corresponding to the selling patterns 'al', 'en' and 'ine'. Therefore, Option A is a valid inference.

Options B and C: We do not know if these are necessarily true.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

506. **D**

It is clearly stated in the passage phoneme emerges only at the age of 6. Hence option D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

507. **D**

It can be inferred from the passage that phonological skills in young children can be measured at a number of different levels. Hence phonological deficit can be classified in any one or more of the options. Hence D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

508. **B**

It is stated in the passage that 'rimes correspond to rhymes in single-syllabus words'. Hence option B. The onset parts would be different. For example, for cat and hat the onsets would be /c/ and /h/.

 VIEW SOLUTION

509. **B**

We can clearly infer from the passage that 4-5 years old found the onset-rime version to be easier, it was only for the 6 years old who were able to perform both the versions with equal success. Hence option B.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



510.D

It's easy to forget that most of the world's languages are still transmitted orally with no widely established written form. While speech communities are increasingly involved in projects to protect their languages - in print, on air and online - orality is fragile and contributes to linguistic vulnerability. But indigenous languages are about much more than unusual words and intriguing grammar: They function as vehicles for the transmission of cultural traditions, environmental understandings and knowledge about medicinal plants, all at risk when elders die and livelihoods are disrupted.

From the underlined portions of the above excerpt, we can infer options A, B, and C.

The first paragraph does mention that indigenous languages have unusual words and intriguing grammar. But it has not been mentioned as a factor that makes their documentation challenging. Hence, Option D is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

511.B

More commonly, speakers live on but abandon their language in favor of another vernacular, a widespread process that linguists refer to as "language shift" from which few languages are immune. Such trading up and out of a speech form occurs for complex political, cultural and economic reasons - sometimes voluntary for economic and educational reasons, although often amplified by state coercion or neglect. Welsh, long stigmatized and disparaged by the British state, has rebounded with vigor.

In the above excerpt, the trading of language for another (language shift) has been mentioned. The author mentions the reasons why this happens, and then the Welsh language is mentioned as an example which has rebounded against the same with vigour. Thus, it is presented as a ray of hope, that a language can be revived even when cultural shift occurs. Option B is the answer.

The example has not been mentioned to spite the efforts that were put to integrate Welsh speakers into English speaking fold. The purpose of the author is to deal with endangered languages, and the subject in Option A would be out of scope.

The role of state effort in revitalising Welsh has not been mentioned, hence, Option C can be eliminated.

The role of globalisation in revitalising Welsh has not been mentioned either. Hence, Option D can be eliminated too.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

512.A

Multilingualism can help us live in a more connected and more interdependent world.

Throughout the passage, the author is advocating for greater language diversity and suggesting how to counter the threat to the same. Multilingualism is something that the author has supported as cited above. Hence, Option A is the answer.

More commonly, speakers live on but abandon their language in favor of another vernacular, a widespread process that linguists refer to as "language shift" from which few languages are immune.

Since the author advocated the preservation of languages, he would likely be against this shift, as it endangers languages. Option B can be eliminated.

Again, the author is pushing for more diversity and preservation of cultures instead of homogenization of the same. Option C can be eliminated.

The author does not push for state intervention in the preservation of languages. Hence, Option D would not be the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

513.C

Through war, famine and natural disasters, whole communities can be destroyed, taking their language with them to the grave...

Such trading up and out of a speech form occurs for complex political, cultural and economic reasons - sometimes voluntary for economic and educational reasons, although often amplified by state coercion or neglect.

More commonly, speakers live on but abandon their language in favor of another vernacular, a widespread process that linguists refer to as "language shift" from which few languages

From the above excerpts, Options A, B, and D can be supported. The passage supports that Internet technology has allowed certain endangered languages to thrive. Option C is not supported anywhere in the passage, hence, is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

514. D

The author does not support that there is a limit to the influence that myths have on people, nor does he support imposing one. Hence, Option A can be eliminated.

Third, and most important, the truth is often painful and disturbing. Hence if you stick to unalloyed reality, few people will follow you. An American presidential candidate who tells the American public the truth, the whole truth and nothing but the truth about American history has a 100 percent guarantee of losing the elections. . . . An uncompromising adherence to the truth is an admirable spiritual practice, but it is not a winning political strategy. . . .

Option B is contrary to what is being said in the passage. The author says that untarnished truth is not a good recipe for a political win, hence, the candidate should steer clear of that.

Option C is also contrary to what is being said in the passage. According to the author, not conveying the complete truth will allow a person to stay in power.

Option D is in line with the above excerpt and hence, is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



515. C

Even if we need to pay some price for deactivating our rational faculties, the advantages of increased social cohesion are often so big that fictional stories routinely triumph over the truth in human history. Scholars have known this for thousands of years, which is why scholars often had to decide whether they served the truth or social harmony. Should they aim to unite people by making sure everyone believes in the same fiction, or should they let people know the truth even at the price of disunity?

In the penultimate paragraph, the author mentions how successful leaders balance truth and social unity to achieve an optimal outcome. The above excerpt shows that scholars have known this for a long time too, and have implemented it. Thus, Option C is the answer.

That leaders and scholars have improved with time when it comes to achieving social cohesion is not implied in the passage. Option A can be eliminated.

We cannot say that scholars use myths to obtain power as leaders do. Hence, Option B can be eliminated.

We cannot say that scholars use myths to stay in office as leaders do. Option D can be eliminated too.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

516. A

Option A: The author here emphasizes that the choice between truth and social cohesion is a difficult one for scholars, as it means choosing between truth or uniting everyone using a common narrative. Here, the reach and influence of fiction created by that scholar has been overemphasized, and hence, is the answer.

Option B: There is no overemphasis in this option. Since humans have achieved these feats, and these feats do manipulate the objective reality around us, Option B can be eliminated.

Option C: Here too, the importance of fiction has not been overemphasized, but the importance of truth has been downplayed.

Option D: Option D presents a statement, which is unrelated to the emphasis being placed on the importance of myths.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

517. **B**

The author begins that passage by saying that truth does not necessarily carry power. He then goes on to explain that to attain social cohesion, sticking to the truth is not always an optimal strategy. In the last paragraph, the author sums up this trade-off:

Even if we need to pay some price for deactivating our rational faculties, the advantages of increased social cohesion are often so big that fictional stories routinely triumph over the truth in human history. Scholars have known this for thousands of years, which is why scholars often had to decide whether they served the truth or social harmony.

Thus, Option B is the answer.

The author is not fixated upon the types of stories, not upon what kind of stories do the leaders propagate. Hence, Options A and C can be eliminated.

Power has been mentioned to indicate that sometimes, absolute truth is not the way forward to achieve maximum utility. The main contention of the author is not the trade-off between truth and power but between truth and social cohesion. Option D can be eliminated too.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

518. **C**

Since this message was couched in terms of Chomskyan theoretical linguistics, in discourse so opaque that it was nearly incomprehensible even to some scholars, many people did not hear it. Now, in a brilliant, witty and altogether satisfying book, Mr. Chomsky's colleague Steven Pinker . . . has brought Mr. Chomsky's findings to everyman.

From the above excerpt, it is clear that Mr. Pinker's style of writing is much more comprehensible to the common man. Hence, their writing styles are quite different. Also, the above excerpt mentions that the book brings Mr. Chomsky's findings to everyman, hence, it is clear that it draws heavily from the findings. Options A and D are eliminated.

Unlike Mr. Chomsky, Mr. Pinker firmly places the wiring of the brain for language within the framework of Darwinian natural selection and evolution.

The above excerpt shows that they both disagreed on a certain point. Hence, Option B is eliminated too.

Option C finds no mention in the passage, hence, is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

519. **C**

Unlike Mr. Chomsky, Mr. Pinker firmly places the wiring of the brain for language within the framework of Darwinian natural selection and evolution.

The passage suggests that Mr. Pinker and Mr. Chomsky agree on almost all topics. However, the above line indicates that they both disagreed on the application of the Darwinian framework to explain language instinct. Where Mr. Pinker was in favour of the same, Mr. Chomsky was against. Hence, Option C is the answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION



520. D

The fundamental unity of humanity is the theme of Mr. Chomsky's universal grammar, and of this exciting book.

Throughout the passage, the author seems to support the points made by Mr Pinker. The above line also shows that the opinion of the author towards the book is positive, and the author does not think that the book is racist in any way, but promotes unity and cohesion. Option D captures this point correctly and is the answer.

So according to Mr. Pinker, the roots of language must be in the genes, but there cannot be a "grammar gene" any more than there can be a gene for the heart or any other complex body structure. This proposition will undoubtedly raise the hackles of some behavioral psychologists and anthropologists, for it apparently contradicts the liberal idea that human behavior may be changed for the better by improvements in culture and environment....

The book does not support that a complex anatomical structure like a 'voice box' plays a key role in determining language acquisition skills. Nor does it support the role of culture and environment in shaping human behaviour
Options A and B are eliminated.

Option C portrays the book as racist, which is directly in contradiction with the author's opinion. C is eliminated too.

VIDEO SOLUTION

521. A

A half-century ago, this would have been pooh-poohed as a "black box" theory, since one could not actually pinpoint this grammatical faculty in a specific part of the brain, or describe its functioning. But now things are different. Neurosurgeons [have now found that this] "black box" is situated in and around Broca's area, on the left side of the forebrain. . . .

On the other hand, the "language instinct," when it first appeared among our most distant hominid ancestors, must have given them a selective reproductive advantage over their competitors (including the ancestral chimps). . . .

He effectively disposes of all claims that intelligent nonhuman primates like chimps have any abilities to learn and use language.

The above excerpts provide support for Options B, C, and D respectively. Option A is in direct contradiction with Option D, and hence, is the answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

522. D

Let us try to break the sentence down and interpret its meaning:

"The enrichments of literary and intellectual language led to an altered understanding of the meanings that underlie time-honored expressions and traditional catchwords."

In simple words [Enrichments of language] led to [change in understanding] of [time-honoured expressions].

In the context of the passage, the line means that when the terms related to 'the unconscious' were coined, they enriched the vocabulary of the language and this, in turn, changes the meanings of many old expressions related to this term.

Option D comes the closest in capturing the meaning, and hence, is the answer.

B: The meanings of the catchwords were altered. They were not enriched. Can be eliminated.

C: The catchwords did not cause a change. Their own meaning was changed. Can be eliminated.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

523. C

The “unconscious” burst the shell of conventional language, coined as it had been to embody the fleeting ideas and the shifting conceptions of several generations until, finally, it became fixed and defined in specialized terms within the realm of medical psychology and Freudian psychoanalysis.

In the passage, the author has clearly outlined the importance of linguistic developments in helping the knowledge of the field grow. Since the option is not extreme in certainty ('may' not have happened), Option A can be inferred.

Significantly, most if not all of these practices (for example, hypnotism in surgery or psychological magnetism) originated in the waning years of the eighteenth century and during the early decades of the nineteenth century, as did some of the disciplines (such as psychology and psychical research). The majority of topics too were either new or assumed hitherto unknown colors. Thus, before 1790, few if any spoke, in medical terms, of the affinity between creative genius and the hallucinations of the insane . . .

From the above excerpt, we can infer that the affinity between genius and insanity was not looked into before the 18th century.

At the same time, once coined, powerful new ideas attracted to themselves a whole host of seemingly unrelated issues, practices, and experiences, creating a peculiar network of preoccupations that as a group had not existed before.

The above excerpt and the examples the author provides after this excerpt can help us infer that as the knowledge of the mind grew, unrelated activities found a common title. Option D can be inferred.

The passage does not imply anywhere that the new conceptions were able to provide new knowledge only because some fields were established. Option C is out of the scope of the passage and cannot be inferred.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

524. C

The passage starts by highlighting that the term 'unconscious', widely held today, came in conception not long ago. With the coining of this term, many unrelated activities/ideas found a common umbrella under which they could be categorized and also allowed them to prosper. The author then writes the following line, which gives us a clear conception of the main theme:

Thus, the massive introduction of the term unconscious by Hartmann in 1869 appeared to focalize many stray thoughts, affording a temporary feeling that a crucial step had been taken forward, a comprehensive knowledge gained a knowledge that required only further elaboration, explication, and unfolding in order to bring in a bounty of higher understanding.

Thus, the passage is about the assembly of many stray thoughts under the banner of the unconscious. Option C perfectly captures this, and hence, is the answer.

The author does not primarily deal with the unconscious as a part of the mind. Nor does he focus upon the expansion of the vocabulary of the mind and the soul. Thus, Options A and B can be rejected.

'Psychical research' is not the main focus of the passage. The author says that the term allowed certain 'psychic' activities to flourish. He does not focus on the term as an object of psychical research. Hence, Option D can be eliminated too.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

525. C

Unconscious is the primary focus of the passage. Since D does not have that as a main point, it can be eliminated.

Dreams find a single, small mention as an example in the passage. Hence, Option A can be eliminated too.

Insanity finds a small mention in the passage and is not a main point. Hence, Option B is incorrect.

The author initially deals with how the enrichment of vocabulary on the matter of unconscious has a deep effect and how this later became a subject of psychoanalysis. Hence, Option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

526. D

Back in the early 2000s, an awesome thing happened in the New X-Men comics. Our mutant heroes had been battling giant robots called Sentinels for years, but suddenly these mechanical overlords spawned a new threat: Nano-Sentinels! Not content to rule Earth with their metal fists, these tiny robots invaded our bodies at the microscopic level. Infected humans were slowly converted into machines, cell by cell.

The first paragraph talks about the X-men comics, in which the mutant heroes, that X-Men, has been battling giant robots called sentinels. But these Sentinels then developed Nano-Sentinels, which could invade bodies at the microscopic level, and the heroes would now have to fight them too. Option D perfectly captures this, and hence, is the answer.

Option A is incorrect. X-men were battling the Sentinels before the invention of Nano-Sentinels. Hence, the origin of X-men is different.

Option B is incorrect. The mechanical overlords made Nano-Sentinels to convert people into machines. It has not been said that the people were converted into the mechanical lords themselves.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

527. C

A: Sentinel robots are just fiction that is mentioned in the passage to introduce the new wave of development that has taken place. Option A is eliminated.

B: The author has introduced X-men as an example only. His arguments are not related to the creation of X-men in any way. Option B can be eliminated.

C: *.....but some of them could one day swim through our bloodstream to heal us.*

Throughout the passage, the author is trying to highlight the positives of the new robots. Hence, a direct extension of the argument would be the robots healing us at a microscopic level, as is hinted in the above excerpt. Option C is the answer.

D: Option D, though not entirely incorrect, is not a direct extension of the arguments presented in the passage. Unlike Option C, D has not been hinted at in the passage. Hence, it can be eliminated too.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

528. C

The author first introduces an arc of a comic book where nano-robots are used. He then goes on to show how that fiction is increasingly becoming reality. He then goes on to describe the various features present in today's nano-robots. Option C comes the closest in capturing this point, and hence, is the answer.

Option A is just one of the features of the modern nano-robots and is not the focus of the passage.

Hydrophilic and Hydrophobic materials are not the main point of contention here. Option B can be eliminated.

The author uses the example of X-men to introduce the development of technology today. His main contention is not the content of the comic books and how it would be affected by recent developments in technology. Option D can be eliminated too.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

529. D

We will check which option when proven false will support the passage:

A: Robots becoming a part of everyday life is neither supported nor opposed in the passage. Thus, Option A is not the answer.

B: *Instead of gears and wires, it's assembled from two kinds of molecules - some that love water and some that avoid it - which interact to allow the bot to skate on top of a pond.*

Option B has been clearly mentioned in the passage. Hence, if it is proven false, it will contradict the passage. Option B is not the answer.

C: *One team of researchers, for example, has developed a different kind of hydrogel that becomes sticky when exposed to a low-voltage zap of electricity and then stops being sticky when the electricity is switched off.*

Option C has been mentioned in the passage. Hence, if it is proven false, it will contradict the passage. Option C is not the answer.

D: *No, they won't be invading our bodies and turning us into Sentinels...*

Option D is just the opposite of what has been given in the passage. Hence, if Option D is false, it would support the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



The banner features a light blue background. On the left, there is a photo of two people, a man and a woman, both wearing black t-shirts with 'cracku' written on them. In the center, the text 'CAT Daily Targets' is written in a large, bold, black font. Below this, a yellow banner contains the text 'Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile'. On the right side, there is a small icon of a calendar with a magnifying glass over it, and the word 'cracku' is written in a small font above it.

530. B

A: We cannot infer that the 'arrow of time' has not been tested for atomic clocks. Option A can be eliminated.

B: It has been given in the Option that since quantum computers place more emphasis on their clock's accuracy, they would produce more heat.

The researchers found that as they increased the clock's accuracy, the heat produced in the system grew, increasing the entropy of its surroundings by jostling nearby particles...

The passage supports this inference. B is the answer.

C: *The relationship that the researchers found is a limit on the accuracy of a clock, so it doesn't mean that a clock that creates the most possible entropy would be maximally accurate - hence a large, inefficient grandfather clock isn't more precise than an atomic clock.*

The passage gives a specific example of an inefficient grandfather clock. We cannot infer whether all grandfather clocks are efficient or not.

D: *The clock consists of a 50-nanometre-thick membrane of silicon nitride, vibrated by an electric current.*

The clock uses electric current to produce vibrations and not the other way around. Option D can be eliminated.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

531. A

The relationship that the researchers found is a limit on the accuracy of a clock, so it doesn't mean that a clock that creates the most possible entropy would be maximally accurate - hence a large, inefficient grandfather clock isn't more precise than an atomic clock. "It's a bit like fuel use in a car. Just because I'm using more fuel

doesn't mean that I'm going faster or further," says Hube

In the above excerpt, the author gives an example that though a large, inefficient grandfather clock would produce more entropy, it is not necessarily more precise than an atomic clock. Hence, if a clock produces more entropy, it does not mean that it would be more precise than a clock that produces less entropy. Then the mentioned statement is given as an example. If a car is going faster or further, it will definitely use more fuel. But if a car is using more fuel, then the converse is not true. It could just be possible that the mileage of the car is low. Option A comes the closest to capturing this idea, and hence, is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

532. B

There is an evident confusion between Option B and Option C; however, the official answer key marked Option B as the correct choice. Let us try to rationalise this decision. Options A and D can be understood from the passage:

Option A follows from {...*We can't be sure yet that these results are actually universal, though, because there are many types of clocks for which the relationship between accuracy and entropy haven't been tested...*}

Option D follows from {...*Understanding this relationship could be helpful for designing clocks in the future, particularly those used in quantum computers and other devices where both accuracy and temperature are crucial, says Ares...*}

Option C: Pay heed to the following excerpt from the passage - {...*The relationship that the researchers found is a limit on the accuracy of a clock, so it doesn't mean that a clock that creates the most possible entropy would be maximally accurate - hence a large, inefficient grandfather clock isn't more precise than an atomic clock. "It's a bit like fuel use in a car. Just because I'm using more fuel doesn't mean that I'm going faster or further," says Huber...*}

A simple correlation is being highlighted: higher accuracy means higher entropy; however, this does not necessarily imply that higher entropy translates to higher accuracy. The example of a grandfather clock is highlighted to emphasise this point: we will come across higher entropy in this case, but it does not mean that the grandfather clock is any more accurate than an atomic clock. In a way, the author tries to point out that the accuracy could very well be similar. This accuracy is not in absolute terms but in the way accuracy is defined by the author earlier in the passage. Thus, in a way, Option C matches the idea conveyed by the author

Option B: Pay heed to the following excerpt from the passage - {...*The researchers found that as they increased the clock's accuracy, the heat produced in the system grew, increasing the entropy of its surroundings by jostling nearby particles . . . "If a clock is more accurate, you are paying for it somehow," says Ares. In this case, you pay for it by pouring more ordered energy into the clock, which is then converted into entropy. "By measuring time, we are increasing the entropy of the universe," says Ares...*}

The discussion about the price paid appears to be distinct from the earlier segment wherein the author states that when we push for higher accuracy, we will come across more heat. While talking about the cost at which higher accuracy is achieved, the author states that we "pour in" more 'ordered energy' and this subsequently leads to higher entropy. Hence, the focus seems to be on the connection between accuracy and entropy than between heat and its role in creating higher accuracy. We cannot conclusively infer that the "*ordered energy*" stated in the latter half refers to the "*heat*" mentioned earlier on. Thus, claiming that heat is the price we pay for generating higher accuracy might be difficult to substantiate. Hence, Option B is distorted.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

533. C

The maximum accuracy of a clock is directly related to how much disorder, or entropy, it creates every time it ticks.

The author highlights in the beginning of the passage that the accuracy associated with measuring time is directly related to how much entropy it creates while ticking. The author then goes on to talk about the relationship between accuracy and entropy, and how quantum mechanics and thermodynamics come in play here. Thus, the main keywords are the measurement of time, accuracy and entropy. Option C is the answer.

Electric current is just a small part of an example presented in the passage. Option A can be eliminated. The same is the case for Silicon Nitride and Membrane. These are just keywords associated with a particular experiment/example presented in the passage and are not important for the passage as a whole.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

534. A

"In a recent paper published in the journal Diagnosis, three medical researchers . . . examined the misdiagnosis of Thomas Eric Duncan, the first person to die of Ebola in the U.S., at Texas Health Presbyterian Hospital Dallas. They argue that the digital templates used by the hospital's clinicians to record patient information probably helped to induce a kind of tunnel vision."

From the above expert, we can infer that the misdiagnosis of the ebola patient could have been caused by the digital templates used. The information stored in the templates may have helped induce tunnel vision, so the diagnosis could not capture the virus.

"These highly constrained tools", the researchers write, "are optimized for data capture but at the expense of sacrificing their utility for appropriate triage and diagnosis, leading users to miss the forest for the trees". Medical software, they write, is no "replacement for basic history-taking, examination skills, and critical thinking." . . ."

The subsequent excerpt gives information about such tools, which are primarily used to capture/store data at the expense of appropriate diagnosis, which leads the users to miss the more important information[to miss the forest for the trees].

Thus, the major culprit, in this case, is the less important data captured by the doctors, which led them to think in the wrong direction.

Since only option A puts the onus on the data processed by the digital templates, this is the correct option.

Options B, C, and D can be eliminated on the basis of the explanation provided above.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



535. C

Option A: From the findings of the information scientists at Utrecht University research(2nd paragraph), it can be concluded that the excessive usage of sophisticated software stunted the thinking and learning of its users. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option B: From the penultimate paragraph of the passage, it can be inferred that the overemphasis on the data by these 'highly constrained tools' can lead the users astray from their desired target. Thus, this option is also not the correct option.

Option C: Nowhere in the passage is it mentioned or implied that the software can replace human beings. On the contrary, the example of the research paper in the journal Diagnosis points to the limitation of these 'sophisticated' softwares. Thus, this is the correct option.

Option D: This can be inferred from the second and third paragraphs of the passage.

Thus, the correct option is C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

536. C

"There is an alternative. In "human-centred automation," the talents of people take precedence. . . . In this model, software plays an essential but secondary role. It takes over routine functions that a human operator has already mastered, issues alerts when unexpected situations arise, provides fresh information that expands the

operator's perspective and counters the biases that often distort human thinking. The technology becomes the expert's partner, not the expert's replacement."

The above excerpt from the passage defines and applies the human-centred approach. This model should have humans as the primary mind, and the software's role should be restricted only to assistance.

Option A: Since the role of the software is only specified to the feedback on the doctor's analysis, this is a perfect example of the hum-centred approach. Thus, this is not the correct option.

Option B: In this option, too, the role of technology is dependent on the instructions provided by the resident(human), and hence, it is not the correct option.

Option C: Since the software, in this case, operates on its own(auto-completion), it does not take account of human talent and thinking and hence, is not an example of human-centred automation. Thus, this is the correct option.

Option D: In this case, the software only works or provides assistance when the user requests, and hence, it is not the correct option.

Thus, the correct option is C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

537. **B**

"The researchers found that the people using the simple software developed better strategies, made fewer mistakes and developed a deeper aptitude for the work. The people using the more advanced software, meanwhile, would often "aimlessly click around" when confronted with a tricky problem. The supposedly helpful software actually short-circuited their thinking and learning."

The above excerpt gives the findings of the Utrecht University experiment. The two study groups(one assisted by simple software and the other by a more sophisticated one) show contrasting behaviours. When confronted with a tricky problem, the one with the advanced software would often aimlessly click around the screen to solve the problem. This shows the dependent behaviour of the user on the software. In other words, the users, rather than trying to develop a strategy for the problem, were expecting it to get done by the software.

Option A: Nowhere in the excerpt was the competency of the users questioned. Instead, it was the effect of the dependency on the software being tested. Thus, this option cannot be inferred.

Option B: The users expected the software to help with the tricky problems. This was described by the phrase "aimlessly click around" in the above excerpt. Thus, this is the correct option.

Option C: The phrase "aimlessly click around" was not used to contrast the strategies adopted by the two study groups; hence, this is not the correct option.

Option D: This again cannot be inferred from the above excerpt.

Thus, the correct option is B.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

538. **C**

Option C is the correct answer because it aligns with the passage's perspective that the interpretation of facts is subjective and can be influenced by different perspectives. The passage argues that historians play a crucial role in selecting and interpreting facts, and Option C supports this idea by suggesting that facts, like truth, can be relative.

If facts are relative, it means that what one person considers a fact may not be viewed the same way by another person. This relativity of facts supports the notion that the historian's interpretation and perspective play a significant role in determining what is considered a fact. Therefore, Option C, if true, reinforces the passage's claim that facts are not entirely objective and independent of the historian's perspective, and it does not weaken the passage's argument.

539. **A**

The passage suggests that while establishing basic facts is necessary, the essential function of historians goes beyond this. It emphasizes the selective and interpretive nature of historical writing, where historians are expected to go deeper into understanding the context and motivations behind historical events.

Option A, which involves exploring the socio-political and economic factors that led to the Battle of Hastings, is in line with the idea of providing a nuanced interpretation. This option indicates a focus on understanding the underlying causes and influences that shaped the historical event, reflecting a more comprehensive and contextual approach to historical writing.

Option B: While timelines are important, the author suggests that the historian's essential function goes beyond establishing basic chronological facts.

Option C: The author acknowledges the importance of basic facts but argues that historians must go beyond mere fact-finding.

Option D: While the author acknowledges the use of auxiliary sciences, it also suggests that the historian's focus should go beyond relying solely on these sciences for basic facts, emphasizing the historian's selective and interpretive role in presenting historical events.



540. **C**

"According to the common-sense view, there are certain basic facts which are the same for all historians and which form, so to speak, the backbone of history:

The common-sense view of history, as described in the passage, emphasizes that history consists of a body of ascertained facts found in documents and engravings. In contrast, Option C suggests that history is like science, framing it as a selective system of cognitive orientations to reality. This characterization does not align with the common-sense view, which is more concerned with factual accuracy and tangible historical evidence rather than presenting history as a selective system akin to science. Therefore Option C is the correct answer.

Option A accurately reflects the common-sense view as described in the passage.

The common-sense view includes a broader acceptance of historical methods beyond positivism, as mentioned in the passage (option B) and as per the passage, involves a fallacy in believing that historical facts are objective and independent of interpretation (Option D).

541. **B**

The passage suggests that historians can rely on disciplines such as archaeology, among others, to establish basic facts. The relevant portion of the passage is:

"But [to] praise a historian for his accuracy is like praising an architect for using well-seasoned timber or properly mixed concrete in his building. It is a necessary condition of his work, but not his essential function. It is precisely for matters of this kind that the historian is entitled to rely on what have been called the 'auxiliary sciences' of history—archaeology, epigraphy, numismatics, chronology, and so forth."

In this context, the "auxiliary sciences" are mentioned as tools that historians can use to ensure the accuracy of basic facts. Archaeology is included in this list, suggesting that it helps historians in ascertaining factual accuracy by providing evidence from material remains, artifacts, and other archaeological findings. Therefore, Option B correctly reflects the role of archaeology in supporting historians in their pursuit of factual accuracy.

VIDEO SOLUTION

542. C

The passage mentions that certain genres, particularly murder mysteries and dramatic conflicts like "bloodthirsty maelstroms between arch Romans and uppity tribesmen," have a more universal appeal. This suggests that themes involving suspense, mystery, and conflicts can transcend cultural boundaries and be attractive to a broader audience.

Therefore, a murder mystery drama set in North Africa and France aligns with the passage's implication that such themes have a more universal appeal, making it likely to be successful with audiences across the diverse countries of the EU. So Option C is the correct answer.

Option A is incorrect as the passage states that comedy does not travel well.

Option B: While science fiction may have a global appeal, the passage emphasizes genres like murder mysteries having a more universal appeal.

Option D: The passage doesn't discuss the appeal of romantic dramas, and the trans-Atlantic setting may not necessarily align with the passage's suggestion that certain themes work better across borders within Europe.

VIDEO SOLUTION

543. A

The author concludes that the rise of Netflix in Europe is seen as a unifying force, emphasizing shared experiences through common series. If research were to show a wide variance in the popularity and viewing of Netflix shows across different EU countries (Option A), it would suggest that the impact of Netflix on cultural unity is not as consistent or unifying as the author implies. The wide variance could indicate that cultural preferences or barriers within different EU countries limit the effectiveness of Netflix as a unifying force across the entire region. Therefore Option A is the correct answer.

Option B: While this finding could have implications for Netflix's business, it doesn't necessarily address the cultural unifying aspect mentioned in the author's conclusion.

Option C: This finding doesn't directly relate to the author's conclusion about Netflix serving as a unifying force within Eur

Option D: While this finding highlights audience preferences, it doesn't directly address the author's conclusion regarding the cross-border unifying role of Netflix in Europe.

VIDEO SOLUTION

544. A

Option A is the correct answer because the passage emphasizes that the rise of Netflix in Europe is seen as a unifying force. The author notes that Netflix and similar streaming services, by pumping the same content into homes across the continent, contribute to making culture a cross-border endeavor. This is described as a shared experience among Europeans, as they binge-watch the same series. The idea is that having a common cultural experience, facilitated by platforms like Netflix, can be a unifying factor among the diverse populations of Europe. Therefore, the rise of Netflix is portrayed in a positive light as a force that brings people together through shared cultural consumption.

VIDEO SOLUTION



545. B

Option B is not supported by the information in the passage. While the passage mentions that Netflix has offices across Europe, it also notes that the big decisions still rest with American executives. The passage suggests that Netflix's content might still exhibit a somewhat mid-Atlantic quality, and the company's executive decisions remain under the control of Americans, making it less accurate to claim that Netflix has completely transformed into a truly European entity.

Option A is supported by the passage, which mentions shows like "Lupin," a French crime caper on Netflix, becoming global hits.

Option C: The passage specifically mentions that, according to Ampere, a media-analysis company, in 2015, about 75% of Netflix's original content was American, but now the figure is half. This indicates a shift in the geographical distribution of Netflix's original programming, with a decrease in the proportion of American content.

Option D is true as the passage mentions that streaming services like Netflix account for about a third of all viewing hours, challenging the dominance of national broadcasters.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

546. C

The central idea of the passage is the promotion of sustainable shopping practices, particularly second-hand shopping, as a means to combat the detrimental environmental effects of the fashion industry. But, the passage also discusses the need for consumers to be mindful of the environmental impact of their clothing choices, **opting for high-quality items** that last longer and shed fewer microfibers.

The passage argues that opting for second clothing might not always be beneficial for the environment by highlighting the microfibre pollution that they can potentially cause. Now, if the second-hand clothes being sold were only of higher quality, it would take care of this problem (*[They would be well advised to buy] high-quality items that shed less and last longer [as this] combats both microfibre pollution and excess garments ending up in landfills*)

So, the correct answer is Option C.

Option A is more about the purchasing channel than the nature of the clothes so it does not necessarily undermine the central idea of the passage.

Option B supports the central idea by reducing environmental harm.

Option D could align with the sustainability goal and support the central idea, so it doesn't necessarily undermine it.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

547. A

The irony of "thrifting," as discussed in the passage, is rooted in its unintended environmental consequences. While thrifting is commonly associated with sustainable and eco-friendly practices, the passage highlights a potential environmental issue linked to the act. Specifically, the passage mentions a study commissioned by Patagonia that reveals older clothes, often found in second-hand stores, tend to shed more microfibers. These microfibers can end up in rivers and oceans, contributing to microfiber pollution. Therefore, the seemingly environmentally conscious act of thrifting, aimed at reducing waste, may inadvertently result in environmental problems through the shedding of microfibers during the washing of older garments. Therefore Option A is the correct answer

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

548. D

Option D is the correct answer because the passage does not mention or suggest that the British don't buy second-hand clothing. Instead, the passage discusses challenges related to luxury brands and their reluctance to circulate their latest season stock globally at a cheaper price. The reasons mentioned include the financial

aspect(Option A), concerns about brand image(Option B), and the desire to avoid devaluing their products(Option D). Therefore, the passage does not attribute the slow adoption of companies like ThredUP in the UK to the British not buying second-hand clothing.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

549. A

Option A is the correct answer because the passage emphasizes the environmental issues associated with fast fashion, including the wasteful disposal of garments in landfills. The opposite of this disposable and rapid turnover nature of fast fashion would be a more sustainable and durable approach, which aligns with the idea of "slow fashion."

The passage suggests that buying high-quality items that last longer is a way to combat the negative environmental impact of the fashion industry. Therefore, 'slow fashion' can be inferred to refer to clothes that are of high quality and long-lasting, promoting a more sustainable and environmentally friendly approach to fashion consumption.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT Quant Questions



550. A

All the options, other than A, are direct signs of declining or ineffective liberalism.

Option B: *Creation of business aristocracy*, the author in the first paragraph says that liberalism promoted a meritocratic aristocracy and then went ahead to argue why the meritocratic aristocracy is not a good replacement of the old aristocracy. Creation of a business aristocracy and the rise of vast companies are against the ideals of liberalism.

Option C: *Democracy has degenerated into a theatre of the absurd*, this clearly shows the non-functionality of liberalism and is a pretty valid argument for the decline of liberalism.

Option D: *The gap between liberalism's claims about itself and the lived reality of the citizenry' is now so wide that 'the lie can no longer be accepted*, this line says that the gap between what liberalism asked us to do and what is actually different are two very different things. This too can be an evidence of liberalism's decline.

Option A: *And technological advances are reducing ever more areas of work into meaningless drudgery*, while this line does talk about the technological advancement in a negative sense, it does not necessarily provide evidence of the decline of liberalism per se. Instead, it highlights a potential consequence or critique within the context of technological advances. The negative impact of technology on certain types of work might be seen as a challenge that needs to be addressed within the liberal framework rather than direct evidence of the decline of liberalism.

The same challenge could be seen at a time when liberalism was prospering and thus is not an evidence of its decline.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

551. A

Option A is the correct answer because the passage does not explicitly identify Deneen's repeated emphasis on premodern notions of liberty as a reason for faulting his conclusions. While the passage criticizes Deneen for his extreme pessimism about the future of liberalism, his narrow definition of liberalism limited to individual freedoms, and his fixation on the essence of liberalism, it does not specifically address his tendency to hark back to premodern notions. Therefore, Option A stands out as an exception, as it does not align with the explicitly stated reasons for faulting Deneen's conclusions in the passage.

552. C

The author is likely to agree with the statement in Option C, as it aligns with the author's argument in the passage that liberalism has historically reformed itself in the face of challenges. The author emphasizes the ability of liberalism to address internal problems and reform rather than attributing its success to being the dominant ideal in the past century.

Option A: While the author emphasizes the historical ability of liberalism to reform itself, there is an acknowledgment of its current challenges and failures. Therefore, the author might not fully endorse the idea that claims about liberalism's disintegration are merely exaggerated misunderstandings.

Option B: The author may disagree with this statement as it suggests accepting liberalism's decline and seeking a substitute, which contradicts the call to reform liberalism.

Option D: The author may disagree with this statement as it simplifies the essence of liberalism, which the author argues encompasses various intellectual traditions and responses to the trade-off between rights and responsibilities.

553. C

Option C is the correct answer because the mention of "the Davos elite" in the passage serves to illustrate the perceived hypocrisy of wealthy individuals who profess to adhere to liberal values while simultaneously amassing the majority of the wealth. The author points to the contradiction between the elite's participation in events like discussions on creating a shared future and their exclusive access to privileges, symbolized by the use of private planes. This highlights the critique that the liberal rich, represented by the Davos elite, may not align their actions with the egalitarian ideals they claim to support, emphasizing a discrepancy between rhetoric and behavior.

Option A is incorrect because the passage does not explicitly connect the decline in liberal values to the rich benefiting, but rather to internal contradictions and hubris.

Option B is incorrect as the passage does not focus on how the debate around liberalism is captured by the rich; instead, it critiques the actions of the Davos elite.

Option D is incorrect because the passage does not suggest that the rise in liberalism has led to greater interest in shared futures from unlikely social classes; rather, it critiques the behavior of the Davos elite as hypocritical.

554. D

Based on the discussion, Option D is the correct answer: the passage describes an example of what might have happened if an army general accused Marcus Aurelius of treason in front of other officers, implying that Marcus Aurelius was a leader in the Roman army. The other options are neither mentioned nor implied in the passage and are therefore not supported by the information provided.

Option A: is incorrect because the passage does not mention anything about Marcus Aurelius feeling humiliated or embarrassed by the accusation; it only describes the immediate feeling and other reactions that may have occurred in response to the stimulus of the accusation, such as surprise and anger.

Option B: is incorrect since the author does not label Marcus Aurelius as a Stoic or associate him with the philosophy of Stoicism in any way; he only uses him as an example of what might have happened in a specific situation involving an army general accusing him of treason.

Option C: is incorrect since the passage does not state that Marcus Aurelius was plotting revenge or seeking justice; it only mentions that one of the potential second movements that Marcus Aurelius might have chosen in response to the accusation could have been a plot to seek revenge. However, it does not state that this is

what actually happened or that it was the only possible second movement that Marcus Aurelius could have chosen.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT DILR Questions

cracku



555. B

The passage states that "the Stoic idea of developing virtue in oneself, of becoming a good person, which the Stoics believed we could do because we have a touch of the divine, laid the foundation for the three monotheistic religions: Judaism, Christianity, and Islam." This aligns with the claim in Option B. Options A and C are incorrect as the passage states that the Stoics believed in freeing oneself of nearly all desires, including excessive desires for money, power, and sexual gratification [A], and that the Epicureans believed in enjoying simple pleasures but not being indulgent or pursuing things with no real value [not sufficient to validate C]. Similarly, we cannot substantiate the statement in D.

Hence, Option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

556. B

Option A: This is a possible implication because the passage states that through meditation and the right attitude, one allows emotions to happen to themselves, which implies a passive reception of those experiences.

Option B: The passage does not state or imply that meditation allows for certain out-of-body experiences or that it allows an individual to gain distance from their emotions in that way. The passage specifically highlights that through meditation and the right attitude, one allows emotions to happen to themselves and then observes those emotions without necessarily acting on them, which allows one to achieve some distance and decide what has value and what does not have value. It does not mention anything about out-of-body experiences or any other kind of distance that is not achieved through the act of observing emotions.

Option C: This is a possible implication because the passage states that the second movement is what one does next about the emotion and that it occurs after thinking and is under one's control. Observing emotions in a distant manner, as described in the quote, would involve thinking and control and would therefore correspond to the second movement referred to earlier.

Option D: This is a possible implication because the quote mentions that observing emotions allows an individual to decide what has value and what does not have value, implying that emotional responses can make this distinction difficult.

Hence, Option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

557. C

In this question, we need to find a statement which is in line with the ideas given in the passage (then, if it is false, it will contradict the passage).

Option A: "Through meditation and the right attitude, one allows emotions to happen to oneself (it is impossible to prevent this), but one is advised to observe the emotions without necessarily acting on them; one achieves some distance and decides what has value and what does not have value."

The above excerpt was written to describe the similarities between Stoicism and Buddhism. Since option A is not in line with the above excerpt's idea, it is not the correct option.

Option B: This option can easily be refuted on the basis of the information given in the first line of the passage. It cannot be inferred that Zeno survived into the Roman era until about AD 300.

Option C: "The Epicureans, first associated with the Greek philosopher Epicurus . . . held a similar view, believing that people should enjoy simple pleasures, such as good conversation, friendship, food, and wine, **but not be indulgent in these pursuits and not follow passion for those things that hold no real value like power and money.**"

Since this option reiterates the idea mentioned in the underlined portion of the above excerpt, this is the correct option.

Thus, the correct option is C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

558. B

The passage discusses cultural differences in the concept of a copy and the value placed on originality, particularly in relation to art and religious buildings. In China, copies (fuzhipin) are considered to be of equal value to the original and do not carry negative connotations, while in the Western world, the idea of an unassailable original has historically held more importance. This difference in perspective has led to misunderstandings and tensions between China and Western museums when Chinese museums send copies abroad.

Based on the above, a Chinese museum would be unlikely to consider Option B [Pablo Picasso's painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting, identical in every respect] as having less value than the original. This is because the Chinese concept of a copy (fuzhipin) refers to exact reproductions of the original that are considered to be of equal value to the original and do not carry negative connotations. Contrarily, Option A - a painting of Vincent van Gogh's original painting by Pablo Picasso with Picasso's signature - would not be considered a fuzhipin as it is not an exact reproduction of the original and bears the signature of a different artist. Similarly, Options C and D would also not be considered a fuzhipin since they are not an exact reproduction of the original [but merely different versions/formats].

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

559. C

{Back in the 17th century [in the West], excavated artworks from antiquity were treated quite differently from today. They were not restored in a way that was faithful to the original. Instead, there was massive intervention in these works, changing their appearance. }

Based on the passage, the scenario in Option C [A 17th-century French artist who adhered to a Christian worldview would need to be completely true to the original intent of a painting when restoring it] is unlikely to follow from the arguments in the passage. The passage mentions that in the 17th century, excavated artworks from antiquity were treated differently from how they are today and were not restored in a way that was faithful to the original. Instead, there was "massive intervention" in these works, changing their appearance. This suggests that the idea of an unassailable original may not have held as much importance in the 17th century as it does today. Therefore, it is unlikely that a 17th-century French artist who adhered to a Christian worldview would necessarily need to be completely true to the original intent of a painting when restoring it. Contrarily, we cannot definitively comment on the other scenarios - A, B, and D.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

 **100+ CAT VARC Questions**



560. C

{The Ise Grand Shrine [in Japan] is 1,300 years old for the millions of Japanese people who go there on pilgrimage every year. But in reality this temple complex is completely rebuilt from scratch every 20 years. . . }

While we know that the cathedral of Freiburg Minster is continually undergoing restoration, the same cannot be said about Ise Grand Shrine - we are told that it is rebuilt periodically, but there is no information not substantiate that it is being continually restored [at least in the same sense as that conveyed in the passage]. The idea of restoration is based on how these monuments are being rebuilt.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

561. D

Option A: The value placed on an unassailable original in the Western world may discourage the simultaneous display of multiple copies of a painting, as the original is considered more valuable and authentic. Hence, Option A is valid.

Option B: This is a valid option because the value placed on the original artwork in the Western world may lead to the regular employment of craftsmen who are responsible for preserving and restoring original works of art. This can include tasks such as examining the artwork for damage and replacing eroded or damaged materials [restoration].

Option C: It is true that the focus on the original in the Western world may discourage interventions in ancient art that would alter the appearance of the original. In the past, ancient artworks were frequently altered during restoration, but this practice has become less common in recent times as the value of preserving the original appearance of the artwork has increased. Thus, Option C is plausible.

Option D: The passage discusses how the idea of an original work of art that cannot be altered developed in the Western world and how this intellectual position has led to different attitudes towards cloning between Europe and Asia. However, the passage does not directly mention that the value placed on an unassailable original has discouraged or influenced attitudes towards human cloning in the Western world.

Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

562. A

Option A is a valid conclusion to draw from the lines - "*From out of the primal darkness of Mankind's earliest years, come whispers of eerie creatures, not quite alive (or alive in a way which we can understand), yet not quite dead either.*"

The statement mentions that in Mankind's earliest years, there were whispers of eerie creatures that were not quite alive or dead. This suggests that in these early years, there was a belief in the existence of such creatures. Option A accurately captures this idea. Option B is not a valid conclusion as the given statement does not mention anything about eerie creatures whispering about their own death. Option C is also incorrect since the passage does not mention that the creatures were only seen in the darkness. Similarly, Option D is not a valid conclusion as the given statement offers no information on how we can understand the lives of the eerie creatures.

Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

563. B

The passage underlines that the concept of the Undead, or creatures that are not quite alive or dead, has always been a part of human folklore. In ancient times, the Undead were ill-defined and vague, but as human societies became more sophisticated, the Undead took on more definite shapes and were often associated with supernatural powers, such as the ability to transform, drink blood, and influence human minds. The Undead have also been connected to the practice of magic, and in more recent times, specific names such as werewolf, vampire, and ghoul have become associated with the concept of the Undead. These names are often used to

strike fear into the hearts of ordinary humans. The passage suggests that the Undead have evolved and developed over time, and as human societies have advanced, the Undead have become more defined and have gained more specific attributes. Overall, the passage discusses the long-standing presence of the Undead in human folklore and the evolution of their portrayal in various cultures. Option B aptly captures the above idea.

Option A is incorrect since the passage does not mention the transition from primitive thinking to the Age of Enlightenment. Option C is also inaccurate as the author does not emphasize the failure of human beings "to fully comprehend their environment" [not the focus]. Option D is not a complete description of the passage since it only mentions one aspect of the passage rather than the overall theme of the evolution of the concept of the Undead.

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

564. **B**

The multiple negations indicate that if any of the given statements are false, they could be seen as being consistent with the information provided in the passage [i.e. they do not contradict the information provided in the passage]. Since the question involves "except," we need to find a valid statement based on the information provided [since if this statement is correct, it would not be consistent with the information in the passage].

We notice that Option B is consistent with the information provided in the passage: The passage states that as human societies became more sophisticated, the Undead took on more definite shapes and became more defined. It also mentions that from the Middle Ages and into the Age of Enlightenment, theories of the Undead continued to grow and develop. This suggests that the transition from the Middle Ages to the Age of Enlightenment saw new theories of the Undead. There will be inconsistencies if the statement in B is refuted or incorrect.

If the remaining options are false, they will support the discussion in the passage: Option A is not consistent with the passage as it states that the Undead remained vague and ill-defined, even as human societies strove to understand the horror they inspired, while the passage actually states that the Undead became more defined as human societies became more sophisticated. Option C is also incorrect because the passage does not mention that the growing sophistication of Mankind caused humans to stop believing in the Undead. Similarly, Option D is also inconsistent in its current form since the passage does not mention anything about the strength or stability of the relationship between Shamans and the Undead.

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF

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565. **A**

Option A best expresses the claim made in the statement - "*In order to confirm their abnormal status, many of the Undead were often accorded attributes, which defied the natural order of things . . .*"

The passage states that in order to confirm their abnormal status, the Undead were often given attributes that defied the natural order of things. This suggests that humans conceptualize the Undead as possessing abnormal features to confirm their abnormal status. This differs from Options B and C, which suggest that the Undead are deified or that their natural attributes are rendered abnormal by changing their status. Option D is also inaccurate, as the passage does not mention that giving the Undead an abnormal status is a rejection of the natural order of things.

Hence, Option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

566. **D**

The fourth paragraph discusses the ways in which technology shapes society and the values and meanings that are inscribed in technological design. It suggests that technology, like laws and customs, represents the interests of those who use it and shapes the version of human nature that is sanctioned by society. The paragraph compares technology to laws and customs, stating that they are similar in the sense that they are institutions that shape the way people live. Therefore, the correct statement that captures the crux of the fourth paragraph is Option D [Technology, laws, and customs are not unlike each other if considered as institutions].

Option A: While it is true that technology, laws, and customs are comparable phenomena in this sense, the statement does not adequately capture the main point being made in the paragraph.

Option B: is incorrect because it misinterprets the main point of the fourth paragraph. While the paragraph does suggest that technology shapes the version of human nature that is sanctioned by society, it does not directly compare the effectiveness of technological environments and laws and customs in privileging certain dimensions of human nature.

Option C: is only partially true. While the fourth paragraph does mention the idea that technologies represent the interests of those who use them, it does not specifically state that automobiles represent the interest in mobility present in human nature. The paragraph mentions the automobile as an example of a technology that represents its users, but does not explicitly link it to the concept of mobility.

Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

567. **B**

The passage specifically states that "critical theory of technology regards technologies as an environment rather than as a collection of tools," and that "technologies shape their inhabitants" in a way that is similar to laws and customs, which represent certain interests and values of those who live under their sway. There is no mention of the role of nature in shaping society or determining the limits of society's control over history, so options C and D cannot be supporting points. The statement in A wouldn't support the discussion in the passage because the author suggests that institutions such as laws and customs represent certain dimensions of human nature rather than human culture.

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

568. **C**

Option A: This statement is consistent with the arguments of the passage, which claim that the pattern of the capitalist rationalization of production arises from the problems of command over a disempowered and deskilled labor force and is present in many different contexts, including the factory and socialist systems.

Option B: This statement is consistent with the passage, which claims that Marx and Marcuse both contribute to the tradition of critical theory of technology, which seeks to understand the ways in which technological systems are shaped by and contribute to the reproduction of social and political hierarchies.

Option C: This statement contradicts an element discussed in the passage. The passage states that the pattern of the capitalist rationalization of production, which is marked by the centralization of power in institutions and organizations and the deskilling of the labor force, arises in many different contexts, including the factory, prisons, and the public sphere. It does not claim that the patterns in these different contexts are set by Foucault's prisons and Habermas' public sphere.

Option D: This statement is consistent with the passage, which claims that the pattern of the capitalist rationalization of production is present in many different contexts, including socialist systems.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

569.D

Option A: The passage states that "laws of property represent the interest in ownership and control. Customs such as parental authority represent the interest of childhood in safety and growth." It then goes on to say that "interests such as these constitute the version of human nature sanctioned by society." This suggests that the concept of human nature is not fixed but rather emerges out of historical context and is shaped by society. Therefore, it can be inferred that the significance of parental authority to children's safety does not imply that parental authority is a permanent aspect of human nature.

Option B: This claim can be inferred - the author states that "critical theory of technology is a political theory of modernity with a normative dimension" and that it belongs to a tradition "according to which advances in the formal claims of human rights take centre stage while in the background centralization of ever more powerful public institutions and private organizations imposes an authoritarian social order." This suggests that the critical theory of technology argues that as issues of human rights become more prominent, the social order becomes more authoritarian.

Option C: We are told that "a hermeneutics of technology must make explicit the meanings implicit in the devices we use and the rituals they script" and that "social histories of technologies such as the bicycle, artificial lighting or firearms have made important contributions to this type of analysis." This suggests that engaging with the social histories of technologies is necessary to understand their implicit and explicit meanings for us.

Option D: This cannot be inferred from the passage because the passage does not mention any costs or negative consequences of technologies privileging certain dimensions of human nature - it only discusses the idea that technologies represent the interests of their users and shape their behaviour and values; however, no claims are made about the potential negative impacts of this process.

Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



570.C

The passage is about the idea that making music is a fundamental and universal aspect of the human experience, and that it has a long history that is both sociocultural and biological in nature. The author suggests that the capacity for musicking, or making music, is innate in humans and is closely related to other capacities such as language and symbol-making. The author also acknowledges that there are variations in how musical capacities are expressed and developed among different cultures, but maintains that all humans possess these capacities to some extent. The author suggests that the emergence of music can be traced back to at least 50,000 years ago, and that it likely developed gradually over a longer period of time. The author also notes that the emergence of music involved the recruitment of many cognitive capacities, and that understanding this process involves following multiple strands. In this regard, Option C includes all the keywords central to the discussion.

The other choices do not include all of the relevant terms. Option A includes some of the terms mentioned in the passage, but omits important ones, such as humans and modern humanity. Option B includes humans and capacities but omits important terms such as musicking and symbol-making. Option D includes humans and the emergence of music but omits important terms such as musicking and linguistic capacities.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

571.C

In this context, the author is trying to communicate that although there may be various qualifications and considerations that might trail after the statement that "humans today make music," the statement is fundamentally true. The author suggests that almost all humans are musicians to some extent, and that the capacity for making music is a fundamental aspect of the human experience. The author is urging readers to consider this statement without getting bogged down in the various qualifications and considerations that might be attached to it, and to recognize its underlying truth. Option C aptly captures this idea.

Option A: [Incorrect] The phrase "trail after" does not necessarily imply that a bald statement is followed by a series of qualifying clarifications and caveats. Rather, it simply means that something follows after something else. In this case, the author is suggesting that there may be various qualifications and considerations that follow after the statement that "humans today make music," but is not implying that the statement itself is trailed by a series of clarifications and caveats.

Option B: [Incorrect] The phrase "bald statement" does not necessarily imply that a statement requires no qualifications to infer its meaning. Rather, it simply means that the statement is presented in a straightforward and unembellished way. In this case, the author is suggesting that the statement that "humans today make music" is presented in a bald and straightforward way, but is not implying that the statement itself requires no qualifications or considerations.

Option D: [Incorrect] The phrase "give free reign to" does not accurately describe the author's intention in this context. The author is not suggesting that readers should allow musical expressions to be unrestricted or uncontrolled, but rather that they should consider the statement that "humans today make music" without getting bogged down in various qualifications and considerations.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

572. C

Option A: This is incorrect because it overgeneralizes the ideas presented in the passage. The passage does not state that all humans are musicians or capable of musicking, only that making music is a universal aspect of the human experience and that the capacity for musicking is innate in humans.

Option B: The passage does state that musicking is a form of expression, but there is no discussion supporting the claim "musicking is not language-like." Thus, we can eliminate this choice.

Option C: The passage states - *"...if we look back 20,000 years, a small portion of this long period, we reach the lives of humans whose musical capacities were probably little different from our own..."* This suggests that the musical capacities of humans 20,000 years ago were not significantly different from those of humans today.

Option D: This is not supported by the passage. The passage does not state that all musical work is located in the overlap between linguistic capacity and music production. In fact, the passage states that *"most of these capacities overlap with nonmusical ones, though a few may be distinct and dedicated to musical perception and production,"* suggesting that there are some capacities specifically dedicated to musical perception and production that do not overlap with nonmusical ones.

Hence, the correct answer is Option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

573. D

Let us examine the given statements:

Option A: [**Nonmusical capacities are of far greater consequence to human survival than the capacity for music.**] It is unclear how this ties into the discussion since the survival aspect is not touched upon or implied in the passage. Thus, the claim, if true, does little to undermine the author's claim that humans are musicking creatures.

Option B: [**From a cognitive and psychological vantage, musicking arises from unconscious dispositions, not conscious ones.**] This does not weaken the author's claim that musicking is a universal aspect of the human experience - while the author does suggest that musicking arises from innate dispositions, the fact that these

dispositions may be unconscious rather than conscious does not weaken the overall argument.

Option C: [As musicking is neither language-like nor symbol-like, it is a much older form of expression.] This, again, does not contradict the author's claim in the passage. Though the author suggests that musicking is distinct from language and symbol-making, this does not necessarily mean that it is a much older form of expression. In fact, the author notes that the emergence of musicking can be traced back to at least 50,000 years ago, which is relatively recent in evolutionary terms. Even if this were true, it does not undermine the author's claim.

Option D: [Musical capacities are primarily socio-cultural, which explains the wide diversity of musical forms.] If true, this directly contradicts the author's claim that musicking is a universal aspect of the human experience. The author argues that the capacity for musicking is innate in all humans and that it has a long history that is both sociocultural and biological in nature. However, if musical capacities are primarily socio-cultural, as suggested in Option D, this would mean that musicking is largely shaped by cultural and social factors rather than being a fundamental aspect of the human experience. This would greatly weaken the author's overall argument that all humans are musicking creatures. Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

574. A

In the third paragraph, the author has given the example of a school where the villagers forced the teachers to come to school, but the teacher instead of teaching indulged in various other non-productive activities. Further, the author also mentions that as long as the system empowers providers over citizens, technology is irrelevant. So, the author wants to convey that commitment and motivation are the primary requirements in systems which involve face-to-face interaction between service providers and clients. Therefore, using technology to monitor in such scenarios will be ineffective.

Hence, option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



575. D

The author has explained the phrase "Band Aids on a Corpse" by stating that "e-governance can be just as bad as any other governance when the real issue is people and their motivation." From this, we can infer that the solution was not intended to tackle the real cause of the problem which was the motivation of the people. If people are not motivated, forcing them to come on time will act only as a specious way to deal with the issue. Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

576. B

In the last line of the passage, the author mentions about the availability of information which should be the first step towards solving the service delivery in the Indian education system.

In the penultimate paragraph, the author says that the key is to hire those teachers who want to teach. In other words, the author supports the recruitment of motivated teachers.

In the first paragraph, the author states that technology can facilitate better service delivery in Indian education. The author has nowhere talked about the elimination of government involvement. He wants that the autonomy and accountability of the teachers should be increased.

Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

577. C

The author has argued in the passage and proposed some ways to increase productivity and to make the systems more effective. Option C which states "Empowerment of service providers leads to increased complacency and rigged performance results." will undermine the author's main argument because if empowerment of the service providers leads to rigged performance results, the whole purpose will be defeated. Option A supports the passage's main idea. Option B is irrelevant. Option D does not talk about the effect of implementing absolute surveillance on the performance of service providers. Hence, option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

578. **A**

The author has explained in the passage that without increasing the autonomy and accountability of the person involved in a job, monitoring systems will be ineffective in improving the services. So, the author has advocated for making the persons more responsible and give them more independence. Option A is the most relevant in this context.

Option B is narrow in the sense that the passage does not only focus on the case of nurses.

Option C is irrelevant as the author does not criticize the involvement of government.

Option D is incorrect because the author is not trying to find a solution, but he has proposed a solution to deal with the problem.

Hence, option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

579. **C**

Refer to the lines from the passage - "The suggestion that rings and moons are new is," "One reason for thinking Saturn's rings are young is that they are bright.", "Cassini's measurements of the density of comet-dust near Saturn suggests the rings are no older than the first dinosaurs, nor younger than the last of them."

Throughout the passage, the author has emphasized on the fact that the rings and the moons of Saturn are recent phenomena. Option C is the most relevant in this context.

Option A is not the primary objective of the passage otherwise the author would not have detailed the timeline of the formation of the moons and the rings of Saturn.

Option B is factually wrong as per the information given in the passage.

Option D is out of context.

Hence, option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



580. **A**

In the last paragraph, it is given that about 100m years ago, Thethys and Dione were not there. From the last line of the passage we can conclude that Thethys and Dione are less than 100 million years old. Option B can be concluded.

In the third paragraph, it is mentioned "The lighter the rings are, the faster this will happen". Option C can be concluded.

From the fourth paragraph, option D can be concluded.

Sufficient information has not been provided from which we can conclude that none of Saturn's moons ever had suitable conditions for life to evolve.

Hence, option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

581. **B**

The phrase explains how clothes would darken over time if left hanging and facing smokestack. The phrase refers to the darkening of the Saturn's rings under the influence of comet dust. Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

582. **B**

Referring to the first paragraph and first few lines of the second paragraph, it was believed that the celestial bodies had been existing from the beginning. However, the data provided by Cassini gave an insight that the rings and moons of Saturn are newly created. Thus, it challenged the earlier held notion. Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

583. **D**

In the fourth paragraph, it is mentioned that "they suggest that at around the same time as the rings came into being an old set of moons orbiting Saturn destroyed themselves, and from their remains emerged not only the rings.....". From this, we can infer that the rings were formed from the moons. Also, from the third paragraph, it can be inferred that Saturn's rings consist of comet dust. Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

584. **A**

Throughout the passage, the author has contemplated the reasons why the white-lipped variety of grove snails are found only in Ireland and the Pyrenees. This is also evident from the last line of the first paragraph, the first line of the second paragraph and the first line of the fourth paragraph.

The author has not discussed the reasons why the snails were wiped out from the other parts of the world. Option B is incorrect.

The author has focused neither on migration nor on the evolution of the snails. Option C and D are irrelevant. Hence, option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



585. **D**

In the fourth paragraph, the author states that the appearance of grove snails and the arrival of humans in Ireland coincided. Further, the author proves his point by mentioning about the evidence that humans routinely ate these types of snails before the advent of agriculture. From this, we can infer that people who came to colonize Ireland must have brought snails with them as edibles. Option D is the most relevant in this context. Options B and C are out of context.

Option A might be factually true, but it cannot be concluded from the given sentence.

Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

586. **D**

In the second paragraph, the author mentions convergent evolution in which two populations evolve the same trait by coincidence. In that case, if the traits are similar by mere coincidence, the genetic structure must be different as they are part of two distinct populations. However, in the study, it was found that the two groups of snails have genetic similarities and thus, it cannot be a case of convergent evolution. Thus, the author refutes the claim that convergent evolution can explain the similarity in characteristics. Therefore, option C supports the passage's explanation of sea travel/trade while option D rejects.

Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

587. B

In the second paragraph, the author mentions convergent evolution in which two populations evolve the same trait by coincidence. In that case, if the traits are similar by mere coincidence, the genetic structure must be different as they are part of two distinct populations. However, in the study, it was found that the two groups of snails have genetic similarities and thus, it cannot be a case of convergent evolution. Option B states the same. Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

588. A

Option B is the main idea that the author wants to express through the passage. So, it is one of the main reasons why the author criticizes meritocracy.

Option C is also one of the reasons as conveyed by the author through the example of neuroscientists in the second paragraph.

The author mentions in the second paragraph "each of these domains possesses such depth and breadth, that no test can exist." From this, we can infer option D to be a valid reason.

Option A : The idea/term of 'ideal team' is not mentioned in the passage. Best team implies a team which gives the best possible outcome, however an ideal team can be understood as the model/perfect team. In order to critique ideal team, one needs to introduce such an idea. Hence, Option A is not a reason why the author criticizes meritocracy.

Hence, option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

589. C

Throughout the passage, the author has argued that each field of study has become so vast that diversity in knowledge and skills is required to sail through. Meritocracy is not enough to bring the required variety. This is the main idea presented by the author.

Option A is distorted because the author is not concerned about the negative consequences of his proposition and how to deal with them.

Option B is too narrow in its scope as it focuses on random decision trees which is not the main idea.

Option C addresses the primary concerns which the author has and thus, weakens the main idea of the passage.

Option D is irrelevant as the author has no problem with the assessment tests.

Hence, option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



590. D

According to the author's main idea, the problem should be tackled by a diverse group of members from different fields. On the basis of this, we can eliminate options A and C because, in these options, the expert team consists of only nutritionists.

Out of options B and D, option D is better because it mentions a team of members who have performed well in their respective field. In option B, the members are selected on the parameter of meritocracy, which is not concurrent with the author's viewpoint.

Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

591. **B**

In the last two lines of the third paragraph, it has been given that forest is cognitively boosted by training the trees on the hardest cases. So, if a large number of decision trees in the ensemble were trained on data derived from easy cases, the forest will not get a cognitive boost and thus weaken the efficacy of a random decision forest.

Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

592. **C**

Just before giving the example of neuroscience, the author has mentioned that each of these domains possesses such depth and breadth, that no test can exist. From this we can infer that the purpose behind mentioning neuroscience as an example by the author is to show that each field is so complex now that a meaningful assessment of merit is impossible. Option C is the most relevant in this case.

Hence, option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

593. **C**

Let us inspect the individual statements:

Option A: This can be inferred from the second paragraph [*"...It was precisely on the more recently colonized islands where Le Boeuf found that the tempos of the male vocal displays showed stronger differences to the ones from Isla Guadalupe, the founder colony..."*]. The inception of the eventual dialects has been indirectly attributed to the dynamic changes that occurred as a result of the near extinction of the elephant seals. Hence, we can infer Option A from the passage.

Option B: This can be inferred from the fourth paragraph: [*"...At the individual level, the pulse of the calls stayed the same: A male would maintain his vocal signature throughout his lifetime..."*] The changing variables have little to no effect of the individual vocal signature of the elephant seals. Thus, Option B can be inferred from the passage.

Option C: No such claim is made in the passage.

Option D: This can be inferred from [*"...could have been responsible for this increase, as in the early 1970s, 43 per cent of the males on Año Nuevo had come from southern rookeries that had a faster pulse rate..."*] and the discussion at the beginning of the final paragraph: [*"...As the population continued to expand and the islands kept on receiving immigrants from the original population, the calls in all locations would have eventually regressed to the average pulse rate of the founder colony..."*].

Therefore, of the given statements, we cannot infer Option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

594. **B**

The following excerpt serves as an essential source for comparing the difference in the attributes of the elephant seals: ["...Yet there are other differences between the males from the late 1960s and their great-great-grandsons: Modern males exhibit more individual diversity, and their calls are more complex. While 50 years ago the drumming pattern was quite simple and the dialects denoted just a change in tempo, Casey explained, the calls recorded today have more complex structures, sometimes featuring doublets or triplets. . . ."]

In the late 1960s, the elephant seal calls were marked by having a simple drumming pattern which later transformed into calls with marked individual diversity and sophistication. Additionally, the dialects that were present in the 1960s were not evident during the study undertaken in the early 2010s, thereby indicating a decrease in the regional variations in the calls. These elements are aptly captured in Option B.

VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



595. D

A noticeable clue to ensure that the male northern elephant seal dialects did not disappear is presented in the penultimate paragraph: ["...At the individual level, the pulse of the calls stayed the same: A male would maintain his vocal signature throughout his lifetime. But the average pulse rate was changing. Immigration could have been responsible for this increase, as in the early 1970s, 43 per cent of the males on Año Nuevo had come from southern rookeries that had a faster pulse rate..."]. The loss in the dialect is due to the influx of seals with a faster pulse rate and "as the population continued to expand and the islands kept on receiving immigrants from the original population, the calls in all locations would have eventually regressed to the average pulse rate of the founder colony." Thus, if the individual pulse rate of the immigrants varies or adapts to the existing population, this could preserve the dialect in a particular region. The statement in Option D reflects this specific idea and helps sustain the existing dialect in a given population. Options A and C do little to contribute to the cause of preventing the disappearance of the dialects. Option B aligns with the discussion in the passage and is responsible for the regression of the dialects. Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

596. A

We can make a direct inference based on the following excerpt from the fourth paragraph: ["...This led Le Boeuf and his collaborator, Lewis Petrinovich, to deduce that the dialects were, perhaps, a result of isolation over time, after the breeding sites had been recolonised. For instance, the first settlers of Año Nuevo could have had, by chance, calls with low pulse rates. At other sites, where the scientists found faster pulse rates, the opposite would have happened—seals with faster rates would have happened to arrive first..."]

Based on the above information, the only reason behind the call pulse rate of male northern elephant seals in the southern rookeries being faster would be because the male northern elephant seals of Isla Guadalupe with faster call pulse rates might have been the original settlers of this region. Option A correctly highlights this reason and is, hence, the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

597. A

This is an official CAT 2024 Question, and the marked answer is according to the official answer key. We disagree with this answer.

Let us look at falsifying these statements:

Option A: Climate change has had negligible effects on the frequency of carnivore-human interactions in affected regions.

False version 1: Climate change has had no effect on the frequency of carnivore-human interactions in affected regions. - Inconsistent with the passage

False version 2: Climate change has had a lot of effect on the frequency of carnivore-human interactions in affected regions. - Consistent

As one of the versions contradicts the passage, we can say that the statement if false is inconsistent.

Option B:

Predatory attacks by carnivores are a common occurrence and have steadily increased over the past few decades.

False Version: Predatory attacks by carnivores are a rare occurrence and have steadily increased over the past few decades.

This is consistent with the passage.

Option C: Carnivores lose their instinctive fear of humans, when consistently exposed to human food sources.

False Version: Carnivores do not lose their instinctive fear of humans, when consistently exposed to human food sources. -- irrelevant to the passage as the author speaks on reliance on human food and not exposure to human food "sources".

Option D: Human efforts to avoid risky behaviours around large carnivores have proven effective in reducing conflict incidents.

False version: Human efforts to avoid risky behaviours around large carnivores have not proven effective in reducing conflict incidents. -- beyond the scope of the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

598. **D**

Option D is the correct answer.

The passage mentions that 66% of coyote attacks involve a dog, which can either provoke a carnivore or escalate a dangerous situation when the dog chases a carnivore or vice versa. In areas with large carnivores, unleashing dogs can increase the likelihood of encounters and conflicts. Therefore, option D is the most likely scenario to exacerbate carnivore-human conflicts.

Why the other options are less likely to exacerbate the conflicts:

Option A: Preventing wild animals from being attracted to human food sources would actually reduce carnivore-human conflicts by keeping animals from becoming habituated to humans. This would prevent potential issues, not exacerbate them.

Option B: The passage suggests that climate change could increase the frequency of human-carnivore encounters due to scarcity of resources. Therefore, addressing climate change would likely help prevent the issue rather than exacerbate it.

Option C: According to the passage, photographing wild animals in secured viewing areas is not a major driver of carnivore-human conflicts. Conflicts typically arise from behaviours that encourage animals to approach humans or interact in risky ways, not from observation in protected zones. Therefore, this is unlikely to exacerbate conflicts.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

599. **D**

Option D is the correct answer.

The passage states that: *"As they become more reliant on human food they might find at campsites or in rubbish bins, they become less avoidant of humans. Losing that instinctive fear response puts them into more situations where they could get into an altercation with a human, which often results in that bear being put*

down by humans."

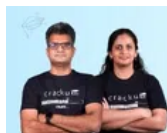
This means that the factor contributing most to carnivores' habituation to human presence is the reduction in instinctive fear response and reliance on human food sources, which is evident in option D.

Option A: The passage does not mention their natural aggression. It focuses more on losing fear due to food reliance on human food.

Option B: The passage mentions climate change as a possible reason for increased conflict, but it doesn't suggest it directly contributes to loss of fear or habituation.

Option C: The passage does not mention about the predatory perception of humans as potential prey, hence eliminated.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Formula PDF



600. **D**

Option D is the correct answer. The passage mentions that landscape heterogeneity (a mix of farmland, forests, and carnivore habitats) in rural areas of low-income countries creates more opportunities for human-carnivore encounters.

As Penteriani's research shows, such landscapes increase the statistical probability of these conflicts because the areas are interspersed with human and carnivore habitats. This aligns with option D.

Option A: This is inconsistent with the passage. The passage states, "*The likelihood of human-carnivore conflicts appears to be higher in areas of low-income countries dominated by vast rural landscapes and farmland*". Therefore, it is not less prone, rather more prone as per the passage.

Option B: The passage does not claim that landscape heterogeneity inherently decreases the chances of human-carnivore conflict. Instead, it states that diversity increases the likelihood of encounters rather than reducing it.

Option C: The passage does not state that homogeneous landscapes cause high rates of conflict due to predictability. Instead, it suggests that landscape heterogeneity increases encounters.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

601. **C**

"Darwinism, I have said, has not even modified our ideas of the Chief Good We may take that as — the welfare of the community realised in its members."

The answer is directly available in the above sentence.

Option C is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

602. **B**

In this passage, the author supports Hellenism and argues that we need such ideas in the world. Refer the given lines: ". And the extent and nature of the community would once more be a subject for some discussion. But we are forced to enter on these controversies here. We may leave welfare undefined, and for present purpose need not distinguish the community from the state. The welfare of this whole exists, of course, nowhere outside the individuals, and the individuals again have rights and duties only as members in the whole. This is the revived

Hellenism — or we may call it in the organic view of things — urged by German Idealism early in the present century." Here the author highlights the support of Hellenism and argues that the welfare will exist due to Hellenism.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

603. **B**

"As to the principles of ethics I perceive, in short, no sign of revolution"

This statement reveals that the author feels that there is no need to modify our core moral principles.

Option B is the best fit.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

604. **C**

"I do not see why Darwinism need change our ultimate moral ideas".

According to the above statement, option C fits the best.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



605. **A**

Refer to the following lines:

"We have the moral code of Christianity, accepted in part; rejected practically by all save a few fanatics. But we do not realise how in its very principle the Christian ideals is false. And when we reject this code for another and in part a sounder morality, we are in the same condition of blindness and of practical confusion."

The above lines means the moral code of Christianity is accepted by only a section of people, except a few extremists it is largely rejected by people. We do not realize that how Christian Ideals is principally false. If we reject the code for another we will be in the same lack of perception and confusion.

This suggests that the moral code of Christianity is not followed by the most people.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

606. **B**

Options A, C and E are irrelevant according to the passage.

Both B and D seem to be the answers, but the question asks for the real reason.

If communism is not a threat, then it is not required to destroy it. So, D cannot be the real reason.

Hence, option B is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

607. **D**

Except D, all the other options are compelling reasons for the silence of Council of Europe over colonial atrocities.

Option D is the compelling reason for condemnation of communism.

Hence, option D is the answer.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

608. **A**

{This was a system of racist despotism, which dominated the globe in Stalin's time. And while there is precious little connection between the ideas of fascism and communism, there is an intimate link between colonialism and Nazism. The terms lebensraum and konzentrationslager were both first used by the German colonial regime in South-West Africa (now Namibia), which committed genocide against the Herero and Nama peoples and bequeathed its ideas and personnel directly to the Nazi parry.}

The term 'racist despotism' coupled with the information on genocide adequately conveys the tyranny of one race/group over another. The author attempts to compare the potential motives behind the atrocities and identifies that the ideas of colonialism and Nazism are similar in that they constitute examples of tyranny of one race over another. Option A correctly captures this.

Option B is incorrect since we do not have enough information on the scale of events: we cannot definitively compare the magnitude of the genocides. Options C, D and E are neither implied nor discussed in the passage.

Hence, the correct choice is Option A.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

609. **C**

From the 3rd para we find the sentences like '... Mr. Lindblad and the Council of Europe adopt as fact the wildest estimates of those "killed by communist regimes" (mostly in famines) from..'. From here we can infer that among all apprehensions that Mr. Goran Lindblad expresses against communism this option C is admitted indirectly.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



610. **E**

Option A,B,C are clearly not the answers and are out of context. Out of D and E, option E gives perfect reason of why author cites examples of atrocities perpetrated by European colonial regimes.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

611. **A**

Following sentences from the passages are in line with the statements A,B and D. In statement A, if modern age is preoccupied with scientific rationality then it is also no less preoccupied with change. In B, a world preoccupied with scientific rationality have advantages system based on impersonal rule of laws should be recommendation with everybody. Statement D, states that democracy guarantees formal equality beyond this it can only what people's appetite for substantive equality.

Option C is a broad statement. In the passage, it has been mentioned that tradition is preferred in music, dance and drama. But in society, modernisation and development have been chosen, instead of tradition. Thus, option C cannot be inferred. So option A is the correct answer.

▶ VIDEO SOLUTION

612. **C**

From the following text, which is picked up from passage '..as greater the urge for a change in society the stronger is the appeal for a dynamic leadership..'. Hence option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

613. C

A can be inferred from 1st para and D can be inferred as continued preoccupation with plans schemes will help to bridge the gap between ideals of equality and reality. Hence only A and D can be inferred.

Option B is a distortion of what is given in the passage. The author says that a need for impersonal rules is not felt in a small society. He is not mentioning it as solution.

Option C is only partly true. Impersonal rules are necessary in large and amorphous societies. Thus, a large society with a clear structure would not require impersonal rules.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

614. D

It can be inferred from the passage that impersonal rules can ensure stability but it can't create any shining version of a future in formal equality. Hence option D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

A banner for 'CAT Score Calculator' featuring two people on the left, the text 'CAT Score Calculator' in the center, and a 'cracku' logo with a gauge on the right.

615. A

We can infer from the passage that equality before law or formal equality is a hindrance to the establishment of real or substantive equality. . Refer to the lines in the last paragraph: "From the argument that formal equality or equality before the law is but a limited good, it is often one short step to the argument that it is a hindrance or an obstacle to the establishment of real or substantive equality." This substantiates the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

616. A

It can be inferred from the passage that tocqueville believed that unlike aristocratic societies there was no proper place in democracy for heroes and hence if they arose they would sooner or later turn to despots. Hence option A is the correct answer. Also refer to the following lines: "Tocqueville viewed this with misgiving because he believed, rightly or wrongly, that unlike in aristocratic societies there was no proper place in a democracy for heroes and, hence, when they arose they would sooner or later turn into despots."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

617. B

The second paragraph is about changes in historians throughout British era. Then author mentioned historians and their work post British era.

In the third paragraph author mentioned

"Along the types of historians with their varying bias have gone changes in the attitude to the content of Indian history. Here Indian historians have been influenced both by their local situation and by changes of thought elsewhere. It is this field that this work can claim some attention since it seeks to break new ground, or perhaps to deepen a freshly turned furrow in the field of Indian history." Here author mentioned that modern historians come with varying bias, change in their attitude. This can also result in new or in depth discoveries, perspectives.

Hence, option B is correct.

Option A is not a complete representation of what author said, or what he intended to. Option B is a closer implication than option A.

By the line "to break new ground, or perhaps to deepen a freshly turned furrow" author do not imply to begin writing a history free of any biases. It is because of historians free of bias we can find new perspective or start a new stream of thought. Hence, option D is incorrect.

Between B and C, B is more appropriate as compared to C because option C only talks about further work rather than starting from new.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

618. **D**

Refer to the following lines

- "Only a few like Abul Fazl had access to official papers. These were personal narrative of events varying in value with the nature of the writer."-1st para - This line eliminates Option A.
- "Then Indian Historians trained in the English school joined in, of whom the most distinguished was Sir Jadunath Sarkar and the other notable writers: Surendranath Sen, Dr. Radhakumud Mukerji, and Professor Nilakanta Shastri. They, it may be said, restored India to Indian history, but their bias was mainly political."-2nd para - This line eliminates option B.
- "The early official historians were content with the glamour and drama of political history: Plassey to the Mutiny, from Dupleix to the Sikhs. But when the raj was settled down, glamour departed from politics, and they turned to the less glorious but more solid ground of administration."-3rd para - This line eliminates option C.

Option D is not mentioned in the passage. Hence, option D is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

619. **A**

"Robert Orme in his Military Transactions gave a straight narrative" => C - E

"Then Indian historians trained in the English school joined in, of whom the most distinguished was Sir Jadunath Sarkar and the other notable writers: Surendranath Sen, Dr Radhakumud Mukherji, and Professor Nilakanta Sastri. They, it may be said, restored India to Indian history, but their bias was mainly political" => B - G

"R. C. Dutt entered the first of these currents with his Economic History" => D - H

=> Option A is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



620. **C**

Refer to the 2nd last para where it is written "The early official historians were content with the glamour and drama of political history: Plassey to the Mutiny, from Dupleix to the Sikhs. But when the raj was settled down, glamour departed from politics, and they turned to the less glorious but more solid ground of administration." Using this line, we can say that option C is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

621. **C**

Refer to the lines where it is written that "Then Indian Historians trained in the English school joined in, of whom the most distinguished was Sir Jadunath Sarkar and the other notable writers: Surendranath Sen, Dr. Radhakumud Mukerji, and Professor Nilakanta Shastri. They, it may be said, restored India to Indian history, but their bias was mainly political."

Also refer the last lines of the 1st para "But they, like the officials, were anglo-centric in their attitude, so that the history of modern India in their hands came to be the history of the rise of the British in India."

This clearly indicates option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

622. D

Let us evaluate the choices based on the information in the passage -

Option A: The author does not dismiss fears about students using AI but instead deems such concerns possibly trivial compared to AI's larger societal threats.

Option B: The author doesn't argue that fears of AI harming humans physically are unfounded, but shifts focus to the linguistic and cultural dangers AI presents. It's unclear whether he will explicitly support the view presented here.

Option C: Though the author briefly acknowledges that AI can be used for good, this idea is not a central focus of the passage; he also does not emphasise technological or industrial benefits. Therefore, it's unclear whether the author will support his view.

Option D: The concern stated here has been clearly underlined in the passage. We are informed of the threat AI poses to democracy through its manipulation of language and ability to generate misinformation, fake intimacy, and propaganda. The author explicitly states that democracy relies on meaningful human conversations, which are undermined when AI becomes indistinguishable from humans. Therefore, this option aligns most closely with the author's argument.

Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

623. B

The author emphasises that language is foundational to human culture and civilisation because it:

- articulates and spreads human values and culture (as noted in Option C).
- lays the groundwork for creating cultural artefacts through storytelling and laws (as noted in Option D).
- influences political views and fosters emotional ties (as noted in Option A).

Option B, however, does not align with the rationale behind the "operating system" metaphor: the author does not suggest that language is the "operating system" of civilisation because it underpins AI tools. Instead, the passage treats AI tools like ChatGPT as leveraging language's existing role in civilization.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

624. D

Let us evaluate the given choices -

Option A: The creation of new culture and ideas is a central theme of the passage, highlighted as a potential outcome of AI's linguistic capabilities: ["...AI can create completely new ideas, completely new culture..."]

Option B: The author hints that AI could surpass human creativity in areas like storytelling, composing music, and drafting laws or scriptures: ["... What would happen once a non-human intelligence becomes better than the average human at telling stories, composing melodies, drawing images, and writing laws and scriptures?..."]

Option C: The threat to democracy through the mass production of fake news and political content is a major concern raised by the author: ["... Think of the next American presidential race in 2024, and try to imagine the impact of AI tools that can be made to mass-produce political content, fake-news stories..."]

Option D: The passage does discuss AI's ability to create emotional connections with individuals: ["...form intimate relationships with people, and use the power of intimacy to change our opinions and worldviews..."] However, it does not explicitly connect this capability to 'exacerbating the polarization' of political views. The focus is on fostering fake intimacy to influence opinions, not specifically on worsening political polarization. Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

VIDEO SOLUTION



625. A

The passage clearly highlights the potential risks associated with AI's linguistic capabilities, urging action to regulate its use. While the passage does present hypothetical scenarios and employs rhetorical questions, its tone is primarily grounded in a warning, not sensationalism or mere speculation. This points us towards Option A. The author systematically explains the dangers of unregulated AI tools, particularly their capacity to manipulate language and influence human culture. The warnings are thoughtful and aim to provoke awareness and a sense of urgency without excessive dramatisation. The tone is serious and measured, which aligns with a cautionary style.

The remaining tones do not describe the discussion appropriately. For instance, consider Option B: though the passage discusses AI's future implications, the focus is less on prediction and more on warning about what could happen if action is not taken. "Prescient" implies a focus on foresight and vision, but the passage emphasises immediate concerns and actionable advice. Similarly, the passage is not "alarmist" (Option C), as it avoids overly exaggerated or emotional claims. It uses logical arguments and examples rather than fearmongering. Option D is also a poor fit: although the passage concludes with a rhetorical question, this is a stylistic device rather than a defining characteristic of the tone. The primary goal is to issue a warning, not to leave the reader in a state of curiosity or wonder, making "quizzical" an incorrect characterisation.

Hence, Option A is the best choice.

VIDEO SOLUTION

626. C

The statement in the question draws a comparison between Moutai's claimed hangover-proof quality and a groundbreaking historical invention (gunpowder). The use of "would make it" suggests a hypothetical scenario, and the comparison is meant to emphasise significance, not an actual invention. This indicates that the comparison is metaphorical/figurative (Option C), conveying the liquor's potential impact on culture and society; hence, we can eliminate Option A.

Option B also implies that the comparison is based on actual substance or tangible qualities. Though the claim about being hangover-proof is substantive, the comparison to gunpowder is not grounded in tangible, measurable terms but rather in its significance. Similarly, Option D suggests that the phrase equates Moutai directly with gunpowder, which is incorrect: the phrase does not treat the two as synonyms but draws a symbolic comparison.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

VIDEO SOLUTION

627. D

To identify the factor that is both a reason for Moutai's success and a potential threat, we could consider aspects that currently drive demand while also holding the potential to hinder it in the future. Looking at the given choices, Option A may be a contributing factor to Moutai's success, as cultural practices around drinking play a role in its popularity. However, the passage does not explicitly frame this as a threat, especially since it is deeply ingrained in Chinese society, making this option less fitting. Option C is also a significant reason for

Moutai's success, as it targets the super-wealthy, but the passage does not indicate that this would become a threat in the future. Option B is presented more as a hurdle to Moutai's success, while the explicit benefits remain to be discussed.

On the other hand, we can deduce that Option D is both a key reason for Moutai's success - by tapping into the spending power of older consumers - and a potential threat, as the younger generations, with different health-conscious lifestyles, could move away from the heavy drinking culture that has driven Moutai's demand. The passage specifically highlights this generational shift as a risk to Moutai's long-term success.

Hence, Option D is the best choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

628. C

The author uses the phrase "the unholy trinity" to describe Moutai's marketing strategy, which relies on three factors: nationalism, elitism, and ageism. The word "unholy" implies that these factors may be unconventional or controversial, which could be why they are described as such. The author presents this idea in the context of Western marketing, suggesting that Moutai might have succeeded due to these factors, even though they seem to defy conventional Western norms. Thus, the phrase reflects how Moutai's marketing strategy is in stark contrast to Western business practices (Option C).

Contrarily, Options A, B, and D either do not address the contrast with Western strategies or misinterpret the focus of the passage. For instance, Option A is not the best choice because the phrase "unholy trinity" isn't a comment on the morality of marketing liquor itself but rather on the controversial nature of Moutai's specific strategy. Options B and D focus on tangential aspects that are irrelevant to the question.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

629. A

Let's evaluate the given choices and check if they are consistent with the information in the passage -

Option A: According to the passage, this is not true. The author emphasises that Moutai deliberately avoids targeting the middle class, as the competition in that market is intense, and instead focuses on the super-rich. This suggests that marketing to the middle class is not as lucrative or straightforward as it might appear.

Option B: The passage mentions that the Chinese government is Moutai's largest shareholder and potentially plays a role in controlling the prices of products, which is a key factor for any firm in this market to consider. Furthermore, the author discusses how the government might further interfere with the operations in this space: ["... in what some see as a travesty of corporate governance, its majority owner has plans to set up its own sales channel ..."]

Option C: The author highlights that the premium market in China is still growing and not overcrowded with luxury brands, indicating a potential opportunity for firms targeting high-end consumers.

Option D: The passage states that many firms have failed in their attempt to cater to the middle class due to fierce competition. This is a valid consideration for any firm looking to enter the market.

Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Daily Targets

Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile



630. C

The phrase "unlikely to disagree + EXCEPT" can seem tricky to interpret. In simple terms, the question requires us to find a statement the author will disagree with. Let us inspect the choices -

Option A: The author supports the proposal for zonal segregation as a reasonable compromise, balancing scientific exploration with human settlement.

Option B: The author agrees that NASA's earlier missions did not prioritise contamination but implies they caused no significant harm.

Option C: This viewpoint reflects a cautious approach to space exploration. The author dismisses concerns about hypothetical extraterrestrial life as speculative and prioritises human exploration and development over minimising contamination. Therefore, he's likely to disagree with this position.

Option D: In the passage, the author argues that the costs of maintaining strict planetary protection measures are excessive and could undermine future exploration efforts. This is consistent with his stance.

Hence, Option C is the best choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

631. **C**

The passage discusses the debate surrounding planetary protection policies, particularly the concerns about contaminating Mars with Earth-based microbes. The author argues against these concerns, citing several reasons why the risk of contamination should not hinder human exploration and development of Mars. These reasons include:

- the lack of evidence for life on Mars (describes Mars as a "bleak, rusted landscape" with no confirmed life) [Option A]
- the disregard for such protocols by international competitors (China's lenient approach to planetary protection) [Option B]
- the historical precedent of contamination from earlier human missions (Apollo missions left waste on the Moon) [Option D]

On the other hand, Option C is not presented as a valid reason. The author does not specifically argue that probes have had "little effect" on the Moon's environment but instead focuses on human waste and contamination from earlier human missions, not robotic probes.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

632. **A**

The first paragraph critiques the stringent planetary protection policies advocated by a group of scientists who aim to prevent biological contamination of celestial bodies. The author portrays these efforts as excessive, particularly given the lack of evidence for extraterrestrial life, and highlights the significant financial burden these measures place on space agencies like NASA. Option A accurately reflects this scepticism, as the author questions the need to sterilize planets where life has not been proven to exist.

Option B is incorrect because the author is not equivocal (i.e., ambiguous or undecided); instead, he expresses a clear stance against these strict protocols. Option C is also inaccurate, as the author is not indifferent to elitism but rather critiques the scientists' restrictive approach. Similarly, Option D can be eliminated because the author does not approve of NASA's spending on sterilization but views it as an unnecessary expense.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

633. **C**

The passage highlights contrasting reactions to two instances of potential contamination of the lunar environment: China's germination of a plant seed on the Moon, which elicited little controversy, and Israel's accidental release of tardigrades aboard the Beresheet probe, which sparked significant backlash within the space community. This contrast underscores differences in how national or regional scientific communities respond to issues of planetary protection. Option C most closely reflects this idea.

The passage does not suggest that contamination from animals is inherently more harmful than from plants, as suggested in Option A. Similarly, Option B inaccurately implies that the passage endorses China's approach as inherently "reasonable," which it does not. Option D diverges a bit from the discussion by emphasising global

biases against specific countries, but the passage provides no evidence of such biases, focusing instead on scientific reactions.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

634. D

Option A: The author has already discussed a point along similar lines towards the end of the passage: {... *There is also the reality that in our culture of increasing isolation, in which so many of the traditional gathering places and social structures have disappeared, screens are filling a crucial void...*}. Hence, the author definitely considers this as one of the causes behind the increase in screen time.

Option B: The discussion in passage 4 and 5 highlights how the tech companies have {perhaps successfully} convinced schools to integrate a screen-based educational culture to prepare students for a "screen-based future". Thus, this is another factor that the author attributes to the rise in screen time.

Option C: This aspect has been discussed towards the end of the passage: {... *There is a small movement to pass a "right to disconnect" bill, which would allow workers to turn their phones off, but for now, a worker can be punished for going offline and not being available...*}. Hence, the author considers this as another factor contributing to the increase in screen time.

Option D: There is no discussion mentioning or detailing the elements presented in D. Thus, we cannot conclusively comment on whether the author is likely to agree with this point.

Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



635. B

At the very beginning, the author highlights the disparity in the screen time with regard to the wealthy and the common masses: {... *As more screens appear in the lives of the poor, screens are disappearing from the lives of the rich. The richer you are, the more you spend to be off-screen...*}. The statement in Option B supplements this assertion by further highlighting this observed difference in activity between the rich and the common: {... *As more screens appear in the lives of the poor, screens are disappearing from the lives of the rich. The richer you are, the more you spend to be off-screen...*}. None of the other options can be attached to the given statements. Hence, Option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

636. B

Option A: This author will agree with this assertion. It has been mentioned in the third para: {... *For some kids, there is premature thinning of their cerebral cortex...*}.

Option B: Reduction in human contact or social engagement is one of the negative impacts of screen time that the author highlights in the passage. Option B is antithetical to this presentation and is, hence, not a claim that the author is likely to endorse.

Option C: The author states this element in the third para: {... *In adults, one study found an association between screen time and depression...*}.

Option D: A point along similar lines has been presented in the fifth para: {... *There are fleets of psychologists and neuroscientists on staff at big tech companies working to hook eyes and minds to the screen as fast as possible and for as long as possible. And so human contact is rare...*}.

Hence, Option B is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

637. D

The following excerpt from the fourth paragraph throws light into this matter: *{...Tech companies worked hard to get public schools to buy into programs that required schools to have one laptop per student, arguing that it would better prepare children for their screen-based future. But this idea isn't how the people who actually build the screen-based future raise their own children...}*. It is understood that though tech companies manipulate public schools into engaging in a process involving more screen time, they avoid a similar course of activity when it comes to their own children {whom they subject to a screen-free education and upbringing}. Option D aptly captures this two-facedness. Option B is a distorted interpretation, while Options A and C cannot be inferred from the passage.

Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

638. D

Bregman disagrees with Hobbes' standpoint of humans being inherently selfish or bestial and instead takes Rousseau's side. He asserts that civilizational progress caused by the post-agricultural setup is responsible for the negative/undesired circumstances. In this regard, he presents the contrasting picture of pre and post-agricultural societies {attaches the image of "a prelapsarian idyll" to the nomadic lifestyle, while considers the discovery of agriculture as a misevent}. Thus, this depiction supplements "his argument that people are basically decent, but progress as we know it can make them selfish." Option D is the appropriate answer.

Option A: The aspect of complexity is not the primary focal point. Thus, this option can be eliminated.

Option B: This diverges from the discussion onto a new line of discussion: "impact that settled farming had on population growth". Hence, we can discard this choice as well.

Option C: Again, the focus is not on the environment; hence, we can scrap off this option.

VIDEO SOLUTION

639. A

We need to find a viewpoint that is presented in the passage. Let us inspect the individual options:

Option A: The introductory lines of the passage helps us infer this: *{...Although one of the most contested concepts in political philosophy, human nature is something on which most people seem to agree. By and large, according to Rutger Bregman in his new book Humankind, we have a rather pessimistic view - not of ourselves exactly, but of everyone else. We see other people as selfish, untrustworthy and dangerous and therefore we behave towards them with defensiveness and suspicion...}*

Option B: The author calls the viewpoints of Hobbes and Rousseau as polar opposites {"Hobbes and Rousseau are seen as the two poles of the human nature argument"} and does not present a similarity, especially any comment of the form: "both believed in the need for a strong state." Thus, we can eliminate this option.

Option C: No such view has been presented.

Option D: The author's opinion of Frans de Waal's "veneer theory" is not evident/not highlighted. Hence, we can eliminate this option.

Thus, of the given statements, Option A is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION



640. **A**

Bregman considers the aftermath of civilizational collapse as a period that allows for certain changes or alterations in the society {...*"Civilisation has become synonymous with peace and progress and wilderness with war and decline,"* writes Bregman. *"In reality, for most of human existence, it was the other way around."* Whereas traditional history depicts the collapse of civilisations as "dark ages" in which everything gets worse, modern scholars, he claims, see them more as a reprieve, in which the enslaved gain their freedom and culture flourishes...}. Option A correctly captures this point. Options B, C and D are either not stated or distorted interpretations.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

641. **D**

At the end of the passage, the author states the following: {... *There's a great deal of reassuring human decency to be taken from this bold and thought-provoking book and a wealth of evidence in support of the contention that the sense of who we are as a species has been deleteriously distorted. But it seems equally misleading to offer the false choice of Rousseau and Hobbes when, clearly, humanity encompasses both...*}. Thus, he does not truly agree with Bregman's portrayal of the civilized society. Option D correctly captures this disagreement.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

642. **C**

Since travel writing involves the presentation and recounting of personal travel experiences and/or perspective of the world, the closest category to this would be autobiographical writing [Option C]. Political journalism and feminist writing can be hurled out the window. Associating travel literature to historical fiction would be inappropriate as well. Hence, of the given choices, Option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

643. **B**

The aspects that guided/influenced the understanding of feminist scholars who examined Victorian women's travelling experiences need to be found out. We understand that the attempt made by feminist scholars was to "challenge the masculinist history of geography by (1) questioning who and what are relevant subjects of geographic study, and (2) what counts as geographic knowledge itself." And considering the role of women in travel writing during the Victorian era enabled these scholars to inspect new perspectives and achieve the aforementioned objectives {...*such questions are worked through ideological constructs that posit men as explorers and women as travelers—or, conversely, men as travelers and women as tied to the home...*}[Option C]. The varied viewpoints offered by women during this period originated from the difference in the gendered identities, implicitly indicating that the presence of an inequality/inequity in the gender roles [Option A]. Additionally, studies concerning the manner in which travel altered a woman's gendered identities were also available; this further shaped the feminist scholars' understanding of the travelling experiences of Victorian women [Option D]. It has not been presented or implied that the knowledge of "class" tensions, as stated in Option B, was an imperative element that influenced scholars' understanding. Hence, Option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

644. **D**

We can zero-in on the answer based on the following excerpt: {...*The completion of the first U.S. transcontinental highway during the 1920s . . . for example, inaugurated a new genre of travel literature about the United States—the automotive or road narrative. Such narratives highlight the experiences of mostly male protagonists "discovering themselves" on their journeys, emphasizing the independence of road travel and the value of rural folk traditions...*}.}

Option A: talks about participation in local traditions which is not mentioned or implied.

Option B: is a distorted comment that does not align with the idea discussed. The author states that road journeys enabled the male protagonist's experience of "discovering themselves"; the phrase "desire for independence" would be incorrect in this regard.

Option C: is not even remotely discussed/implied.

Option D: It is mentioned that the inauguration of a transcontinental highway during the 1920s paved the way for a new genre that emphasised the freedom attached to such road travelling enterprises. Hence, it implicitly depicted travel as an experience celebrating an individual's independence {...*emphasizing the independence*...}.

Hence, of the given options, Option D aptly captures the characteristics of American travel literature of the 1920s.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



645. D

A direct inference from the excerpt: {...*Said's work became a model for demonstrating cultural forms of imperialism in travel texts, showing how the political, economic, or administrative fact of dominance relies on legitimating discourses such as those articulated through travel writing.* . .}. It is stated that Said's work rendered scholars with an understanding of "cultural imperialism" and the manner in which it was used to justify colonial domination {or similar pursuits thereof}. Option B aptly captures this aspect. Options A, B and C either diverge from the discussion or are distorted comments.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

646. D

The question requires us to probe the reason behind why the scholars argue that Victorian women experienced self-development through their travels. Let us pay heed to the following segment from the passage: {...*Many studies from the 1970s onward demonstrated the ways in which women's gendered identities were negotiated differently "at home" than they were "away," thereby showing women's self-development through travel*...}. It is highlighted that travelling {being "away"} enabled women's identities to be "*negotiated differently*" {highlighting transformation/reconfiguration}, which in turn was the cause of their self-development. Option D is closest to this understanding. Options A, B and C fail to present the reason and are invalid statements/inferences.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

647. A

Option A is the correct answer.

The passage mentions that medieval craft guilds were monopolies that resisted new entrants and required long apprenticeship periods, which could stifle innovative spirit. Similarly, the ethos of mass production prioritizes efficiency and consistency, which often comes at the expense of creativity. Therefore, Option A could be inferred.

Option B: While it is true that medieval guilds restricted entry through strict rules, the passage does not suggest that mass production involves such restrictions.

Option C: The passage does not discuss whether mass production or medieval guilds employed egalitarian processes.

Option D: The passage does not mention that medieval guilds or mass production focused excessively on product quality.

648. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

The passage mentions that medieval craft guilds were monopolistic and hierarchical, resisting new entrants and imposing long apprenticeships, which could stifle innovation. It also warns that modern craft workers “can thrive... only if they don’t get too organised,” supporting option B.

Option A: This is an extreme interpretation. The passage does not argue that supporting crafts is the only way to retain the creativity intrinsic to their production.

Option C: The Arts and Crafts movement is described as a reaction against the “American system” and the rise of mass production, not an inspiration drawn from it.

Option D: Agile movement is praised for prioritizing creativity and collaboration, whereas medieval craft guilds are described as hierarchical and restrictive, which stifled innovation. These are contrasting ideas. Therefore, agile movement cannot be a throwback to the tenets (principles) of medieval craft guilds)

649. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

The author says *“In a world where products and services often have to pass through regulatory hoops, large companies will usually have the advantage.”* From this, we can infer that the author doubts whether crafts can create substantial employment opportunities because smaller craft businesses may struggle to compete with larger companies due to regulatory barriers.

Option A: The passage does not focus on the low scale of crafts production as the primary obstacle. Instead, the author emphasizes regulatory challenges and not the scale.

Option C: The passage does not argue that workers wouldn’t want to pursue crafts-related work, just that retraining them for these roles might be difficult.

Option D: The passage mentions that craft guilds resisted new entrants, but it does not suggest that they are unlikely to accept large number of trainees. The passage suggests that craft workers can thrive in the modern era, but the challenge lies in how modern crafts are organized and their potential to scale up in a competitive market.

100+ CAT Quant Questions



650. **A**

Option A is the correct answer.

While the passage mentions the premium for high-quality crafted goods and the contrast between mass production and craftsmanship, it does not mention that there is support for “individual creations” as opposed to mass-produced goods. The focus is on quality and sustainability rather than explicitly advocating for individuality in products.

Option B: This is mentioned. The passage talks about consumers wanting to reduce environmental impact by supporting local workers or recycling goods, which reflects growing concerns over mass production.

Option C: This is mentioned. The passage describes a market of consumers who pay a premium for high-quality, hand-crafted goods.

Option D: This is mentioned. The passage highlights a market where consumers buy from local workers to support the community and reduce environmental impact.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

651. **C**

Option C is the correct answer.

The passage suggests that the idea of 'homo economicus' assumes that people have "preferences" that determine their choices. Deciding whether to spend limited money on food or warmth illustrates this rational decision-making based on individual preferences. This aligns with option C

Option A: The passage does not suggest that 'homo economicus' is not influenced by others' preferences. It only states that this model assumes people have their own preferences that determine their actions.

Option B: This is wrong as the passage states that economists like Gary Becker, associated with the homo economicus model, did not borrow or collaborate with other disciplines.

Option D: The passage mentions applying economic reasoning to nonmarket domains but does not tie this specifically to homo economicus.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

652. **A**

Option A is the correct answer.

The tone of the phrase "almighty discipline" suggests mild sarcasm regarding economics' earlier dominance and self-containment. The statement reflects a shift in economics from being insular and self-assured to being more open to interdisciplinary borrowing. The author describes earlier economists, like Gary Becker, as imperialistic and unwilling to incorporate ideas from other disciplines. In contrast, contemporary economists like Thomas Piketty are portrayed as reaching out and collaborating.

Option B: The passage mentions that economists are now collaborating with other disciplines, but it does not suggest this is due to their inability to predict market behaviour. The focus is on how the discipline has shifted over time, not any predictive failures.

Option C: The author does not criticize economic tools for managing crises or say that economics as a discipline has fallen. The passage highlights a transformation toward openness, not a downfall.

Option D: The author is not critical of economists collaborating with other disciplines. Instead, the passage presents this shift as a positive change, contrasting it with the earlier insularity of the discipline.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

653. **C**

Option C is the correct answer.

The first paragraph describes how Becker projected economics into non-market domains like crime and domesticity, analyzing them with economic tools. It also states that he did not borrow ideas or perspectives from fields such as anthropology or history. Option C aligns with this.

Option A: The passage mentions that Becker applied economic principles to non-market phenomena like crime and domesticity, but it does not state or imply that he benefitted from this.

Option B: The passage explicitly contradicts this idea, stating: *"At the same time, he did not let other ways of thinking enter his own economic realm: for example, he did not borrow from anthropology or history."* Becker did not borrow from other disciplines, so this option is incorrect.

Option D: The passage does not state that Becker actively guarded economics against outside influence. Instead, it focuses on Becker's one-sided application of economics to other areas, without accepting external perspectives.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

654. C

Option C is the correct answer.

The author critiques Schiller for focusing on the direct relationship between emotions, perceptions, and behaviour while excluding the mediating role of institutions such as political parties, media organizations, and lobby groups. The passage states that these institutions historically played a vital role in framing perceptions and legitimizing interests, which Schiller's narrative leaves out.

Option A: The passage suggests that media and politics are key intermediaries in shaping perceptions and behaviour and not a marginal role.

Option B: The passage does not suggest that Schiller actively denigrates or diminishes the role of institutions. The issue is his omission of institutions, not his critique of their importance.

Option D: The passage mentions that storytelling is part of Schiller's approach but does not critique him for relying excessively on it. The critique is about the exclusion of institutions, not the use of storytelling.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT DILR Questions



655. B

Option B is the correct answer.

Option B would invalidate the main argument because it directly addresses the issue raised in the passage, i.e., the lack of permanent access to digital content. The passage highlights concerns about the temporary and restricted nature of digital ownership. If studios and streaming services committed to providing perpetual and platform-independent access, it would resolve the problem of content being removed or restricted, making the author's argument about the instability of digital media irrelevant.

Option A: This would not invalidate the argument because the passage mentions that Blu-ray discs have a theoretical shelf life but acknowledges that their durability depends on storage conditions and the availability of playback equipment.

Option C: This option doesn't directly invalidate the argument either. While VPNs might help users bypass geo-restrictions, it doesn't address the broader issue of digital ownership and the fragility of digital rights, especially the fear of losing access to content due to different rights agreements. The passage focuses on the unreliability and restrictions of digital ownership, not just geographical access.

Option D: While this option touches on the potential for preserving digital content, it doesn't directly address the problem raised in the passage: the lack of permanent, independent access to content.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

656. B

Option B is the correct answer.

The passage contrasts the past and present by mentioning that, in the past, films were considered "as good as gone" once they left the cinema, meaning they were ephemeral and not readily accessible afterwards. Whereas, today's audience expects ongoing access to films well beyond their initial cinema run, thanks to technological

advancements like streaming services and digital media. This shift in expectations is what the passage implies when referencing the previous era's ephemerality versus today's more lasting availability.

Option A: This is not the main point. While it may be true that people accepted films as temporary, the passage emphasizes today's expectations rather than discussing past acceptance.

Option C: The passage does not mention technology improvements. It focuses more on audience expectations or belief that films should now be available beyond just the cinema.

Option D: While the passage suggests that audiences may expect films to remain accessible, it does not claim there is no reason for studios to remove access. The passage acknowledges that financial motives may lead to films being removed from platforms.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

657. **C**

Option C is the correct answer.

The passage highlights that the practice of streaming services, like Netflix, editing old episodes of *Stranger Things* retroactively raised concerns. Altering a popular show's content without consent or transparency supports the concern that such platforms can tamper with or erase parts of culture at their discretion rather than preserve them as they were originally created.

Option A: This option doesn't fully address the specific concern raised by the *Stranger Things* editing example. The example focuses on altering the content, not controlling access.

Option B: The example concerns the possibility and practice of editing content on streaming platforms, not whether unsubstantiated reports cause distrust.

Option D: The example of *Stranger Things* is not necessarily about changing films to suit new tastes or technology. Rather, it's about the platform's ability to alter existing content without transparency or input from the original creators.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

658. **B**

Option B is the correct answer.

The passage argues that, despite the advances in digital distribution and storage of films (via streaming services or digital purchases), access to art is becoming more fragile. It mentions how content can disappear from platforms, how digital files deteriorate over time, and how rights agreements can limit access based on geographical location. The idea that technology and platform control lead to difficulties in maintaining access captured in Option B

Option A: The passage does not advocate changing the understanding of art as immutable or easily available. Hence, this is wrong.

Option C: This is an overstatement of the passage's argument. While the passage briefly touches on the idea of retroactive changes to works like *Stranger Things*, it does not present these changes as inherently "dangerous."

Option D: The passage does not argue for the availability of art in the cultural commons in perpetuity. Instead, it highlights how access is controlled by platforms and technological challenges rather than making a broader ideological statement about cultural commons.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

659. **D**

Through the first two paragraphs, the author highlights how New Imperialism created uneven systems which in turn created class divisions. The author then goes on to say that New Mercantilism suffers from the same issues. Hence, option D correctly captures the parallels between the two systems.

Options A and B have not been implied in the passage. Thus, we can eliminate these options.

Option C is partly true. It was true for New Imperialism but in the case of New Mercantilism there are divisions along multiple lines - nationalistic rivalries between countries, difference between middle classes and underdeveloped groups in developing vs developed countries etc. Moreover, these divisions are issues presented by the system. They are not outputs of the system. Hence, option C is incorrect.

Thus, option D is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT VARC Questions



660. A

Refer to the following lines of the paragraph: "A major reason was Britain's inability to cope with the byproducts of its own rapid accumulation of capital; i.e., a class-conscious labour force at home; a middle class in the hinterland; and rival centres of capital on the Continent and in America. Britain's policy tended to be atavistic and defensive rather than progressive — more concerned with warding off new threats than creating new areas of expansion."

Hence, the answer is either A or B. Option B incorrectly places the blame on the capital - instead of on Britain's inability to deal with it. Britain was defensive because it could not effectively deal with the problems that arose. Hence, option A is better.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

661. D

Throughout the passage, the author uses the term "centre" to refer to the multinational corporations that are at the centre of power in the multi-national corporate system. Hence, the answer is none of the above.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

662. C

Consider the second last paragraph for the answer: "In the last analysis their power derives from the metropolis and they cannot easily afford to challenge the international system. They do not command the loyalty of their own population and cannot really compete with the large, powerful, aggregate capitals from the centre. They are prisoners of the taste patterns and consumption standards' set at the centre." This implies that they are not in position to challenge the status-quo.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

663. B

The passage explains that tribal imagination naturally blends different planes of existence. It mentions that tribal stories "*admit fusion between various planes of existence and levels of time in a natural and artless manner*," and that "*stars, seas, mountains, trees, men and animals can be angry, sad or happy*." This means emotions are not limited to humans and can pass across boundaries between living forms. What explains non-human forms having human emotions is the acceptance of fluid boundaries between beings, time, and space. Hence, the correct answer is **Option B**.

Option A is not correct because the passage contrasts tribal imagination with secular creativity, which is described as "self-conscious." Tribal stories are clearly not self-conscious. Option C is also wrong because the author says tribal creations do have conventions and rules. Option D is incorrect because the passage does not call tribal art undeveloped, but instead says it follows a different kind of imagination.

 VIEW SOLUTION

664. A

The passage explains ancestor worship in the context of how tribal communities relate to time rather than space, stating that the tribals realised they could not dominate territorial space, and as a result, they “*turned almost obsessively to gaining domination over time.*” This idea is directly connected to the ritual of conversing with dead ancestors, where tribals aspire to enter a trance and communicate with those from the past. Worship is therefore not just reverence, but a way of overcoming temporal limits. This reasoning clearly leads to option A, which explains ancestor worship as a means of seeking control over time.

Option B only explains the way ancestors are worshipped, not the reason for it. Option C talks about the result of strong memory over time but does not address the main motivation for ancestor worship. Option D is the opposite of what the passage says, since it states that tribals did not try to control land.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF

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665. D

Let us look at each option one by one.

Option (a) would weaken the passage. The author explains that tribal art can start with “*a trivial everyday event*” and that art blends into daily life. If tribal art left out ordinary reality, the idea of mixing everyday life with imagination would not make sense.

Option (b) would also weaken the argument. The passage points out more than once that there is no strict order, saying “*spatial order and temporal sequence do not restrict the narrative*” and that episodes have “*the chaotic shapes of dreams.*” Having a clear timeline would go against this idea.

Option (c) also directly weakens the passage. The hallucinatory nature of tribal imagination is shown by images that break rational or scientific logic, like oceans flying and mountains swimming. If tribal stories followed scientific rules, this key feature would be lost.

Option (d) does not weaken the passage. The text mentions the ritual of talking with dead ancestors as proof that tribal people engage with time and trance-like states. So, shamanic rituals actually support the idea of a hallucinatory imagination.

So, the correct answer is option (d).

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

666. D

The passage explains the difference between imagination and memory by linking them to how humans deal with space and time. It says that we “put meaning into space” by forming images, and this image-making ability is imagination. When it comes to time, we rely on memory to make connections, such as recognising ourselves as the same person across different moments. So imagination helps us understand space, while memory helps us understand time, which leads directly to **option D**.

The other options do not address this main difference. Option A says imagination is a genetic gift, but also claims memory is central to consciousness, which the passage does not mention. Option B talks about tribal art preferences, but the question is about the general difference between imagination and memory. Option C incorrectly says imagination needs to be developed, even though the passage calls it a genetic ability.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

667. C

There is a distinct argumentative arc in the passage. Using examples of well-known and pervasive mega-infrastructure, the passage begins by portraying dams as symbols of ambition and extensive control over nature. It then demonstrates how every significant dam serves as a sacrifice zone, uprooting people, devastating ecosystems, and eradicating lifestyles. These losses have been justified as offerings at the "temples of modernity" or in the name of progress. Lastly, the passage notes that global trends continue to favour water impoundment despite mounting evidence of harm and the aging of existing dams.

Option (c), which maps motivation, consequence, justification, and the current trajectory of dam building, best captures this progression. The other options do not represent this overall argument; instead, they list isolated terms or partial effects.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

668. **B**

Let us evaluate each option one by one.

Option A can be inferred from the passage. The author notes that "a combination of opposition, alternative energy sources, and a lack of viable projects has slowed the construction of major dams," but immediately adds that "a wave of recent and ongoing construction... continues to tilt the global balance firmly in favor of water impoundment." This clearly supports the idea that dams continue to be built despite resistance and alternatives.

Option B cannot be inferred from the passage. While the author refers to "smaller, though not inconsequential, barriers," this phrase is used to stress their cumulative impact on rivers, not their safety. There is no comparison anywhere in the passage suggesting that smaller dams are safer than large ones. The text discusses ecological damage and displacement caused by dams in general, without ranking them by safety.

Option C is supported by the passage. It explicitly states that "in the western United States, dams were often an instrument of colonialism, used to dispossess Indigenous people and subsidize settler agriculture." This directly implies that dam-building was used to force people off their land.

Option D is also a valid inference. The passage quotes the World Commission on Dams questioning whether we are getting "a fair return from our \$2 trillion investment," and points out that many dams are ageing, running below capacity, and facing durability issues. Together, this supports the idea that dam-building has been extremely costly and may not be justifiable.

Since option B introduces a claim that the passage does not support, it is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

669. **D**

The Aswan and Hoover dams are referred to in the passage as "charismatic mega-infrastructure," instances that clearly reflect the human desire to dominate land and the natural world. However, the author immediately draws a comparison between these well-known projects and the tens of thousands of smaller dams that collectively alter rivers worldwide but receive far less attention. The goal is to demonstrate that the same mindset that underlies large dams is present at all scales rather than to exalt them. This larger pattern is easier to see thanks to the identifiable symbols of the Hoover and Aswan dams. This leads to option D, which accurately conveys the idea that the desire to control nature is present in both the numerous smaller dams that currently dominate waterways worldwide and the famous mega-dams.

Option A misreads the reference; the "thin blue line" refers to rivers altered by dams, not specifically to the Colorado or Nile. Option B confuses employers and contracts with dams themselves being symbolic structures. Option C wrongly shifts attention to the personal charisma of designers or builders, which the passage never suggests.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

670. A

In the first paragraph, dams are called “the physical instantiation of a messianic drive to conquer territories and control nature.” Here, *instantiation* means turning an abstract idea into something real. In this case, it is the idea of dominating nature, shown in the form of steel and concrete dams. The dams are more than just buildings; they make that drive real. This meaning is best captured by “exemplification and manifestation,” which together convey the sense of something abstract being shown or realised in a tangible form. Hence, option (A) is the correct answer.

The other choices do not fit as well. “Concreteness and viability” (Option B) are about whether something can be done, not about showing an idea. “Durability and timeliness” (Option C) are about how long something lasts and when it happens, which is not the point here. “Development and construction” (Option D) are about building things, but the passage is more about the meaning behind the dams, not how they were built.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

671. E

Refer to the lines, “As T.S. Eliot observed, no one starts anything from scratch; however consciously you may try to live in the present, you are still involved with a nexus of behaviour patterns bequeathed from the past. The original and creative person is not someone who ignores these patterns, but someone who is able to translate and develop them so that they conform more exactly to his - and our - present needs.”

It clearly states that innovations are developed on the past thoughts to suit the contemporary needs.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

672. E

Refer to these lines “As an art movement slips into temporal perspective, it ceases to be a living organism - becoming, rather, a fossil. This is not to say that it becomes useless or uninteresting. Just as a scientist can reconstruct the life of a prehistoric environment from the messages codified into the structure of a fossil, so can an artist decipher whole webs of intellectual and creative possibility from the recorded structure of a ‘dead’ art movement.”

Through these lines, the author is explaining how codifying past art movements would not amount to demeaning their importance. It would just be a way of studying and better understanding the movement. Thus, by using the example of how scientists study fossils the author wants to make the larger point of how codification would help in better studying past art movements. Hence, the term “fossil” is used to indicate an art movement that is in the past.

Options A and C are opposite to what the author has said in the passage. Hence, we can eliminate them.

The term is not used only for “historic” art movements but any art movement that is in the past. Hence, we can eliminate option B.

Option D misses the comparison that is being made to art. Moreover, a fossil need not only be of pre-historic life. A fossil is any remnant of something that has died.

Option E correctly captures what the author is trying to denote through the use of the term.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

673. C

Refer to the lines of the 1st para “Many of the concepts of modern art, by contrast, have resulted from the almost accidental meetings of groups of talented individuals at certain times and certain places. The ideas generated by these chance meetings had twofold consequences.”

This clearly illustrates the point 3.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

674. **A**

Refer to the line of the 1st para "It is almost tempting to see a pattern emerging within the art field - or alternatively imposed upon it a posteriori - similar to that which exists under the umbrella of science where the general term covers a whole range of separate, though interconnecting, activities."

This implies option A

 VIDEO SOLUTION



675. **D**

Refer these line in the 1st para "Briefly, then, the concepts of modern art are of many different (often fundamentally different) kinds and resulted from the exposures of painters, sculptors and thinkers to the more complex phenomena of the twentieth century, including our ever increasing knowledge of the thought and products of earlier centuries. Different groups of artists would collaborate in trying to make sense of a rapidly changing world of visual and spiritual experience. We should hardly be surprised if no one group succeeded completely, but achievements, though relative, have been considerable"

Option D has a mention o the fast changing world.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

676. **D**

The author has sarcastically written this line. The main argument of the author is "It is a period when the dominance of the world's superpower is coming under threat. It is an epoch when prosperity masks underlying economic strain. And, crucially, it is a time when policy-makers are confident that all is for the best in the best of all possible worlds." Author don't agree with the arguments, thus he has provided others views for the following as oil prices is likely to come down due to market incentives.

Tommy Cooper's argument was that the oil price would go down once the correction takes place.

But the author has made arguments throughout the passage that it might not happen soon.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

677. **B**

The author talks about the complacency of people due to economic prosperity in the 1st para.
Hence the answer is B

 VIDEO SOLUTION

678. **C**

Refer to the lines :

There are those who point out, rightly, that modern industrial capitalism has proved mightily resilient these past 250 years, and that a sign of the enduring strength of the system has been the way it apparently shrugged off everything - a stock market crash, 9/11, rising oil prices - that have been thrown at it in the half decade since the millennium

Option C is a gist of these reasons. Hence, option C is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

679. **A**

Options B and C are negated as the author does not support any of these: B is too narrow while C is a universal truth which may not be the case.

Option D is incorrect as the author does not say that the crisis is imminent in the west. Additionally, this is one of the reasons supporting the author's argument but is not his key argument as such.

Option A is correct as the author has made arguments in its support.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



680. **A**

Refer to the following lines: "Transparency is still a longer way off. And there is no exit policy. In defending the existing policy, politicians betray an inability to see beyond their noses." It means that the Indian politicians are shallow in their vision.

 VIEW SOLUTION

681. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "So is Taiwan. If a symbol were needed of how far we have fallen back, note that while Korean Cielos are sold in India, no one in South Korea is rushing to buy an Indian car. The reasons list themselves. Topmost is economic isolationism." This point highlights India's poor performance in the international market.

 VIEW SOLUTION

682. **D**

Refer to the following sentences: "It began with a far better infrastructure than....an English speaking elite". From this, we can understand that the India was in a better condition than the other south Asian nations because a) it did not have to face the ravages of the second world war and b) it had an English speaking populace.

Option d) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

683. **B**

Refer to the following lines: "Compared with large chunks of what was then the developing world – South Korea, Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand, Indonesia, China and what was till lately a separate Hong Kong – India has fared abysmally. It began with a far better infrastructure than most of these countries had. It suffered hardly or not at all during the World War II. It had advantages like an English speaking elite, quality scientific man." It states that India was better in infrastructure in starting but couldn't perform well.

 VIEW SOLUTION

684. **A**

The author has criticized the government throughout the passage when it mentions that the government sheltered the industrialists from the foreign competitions. The author highlights the consequence of this measure and concludes that it had an adverse consequence on Indian Economy.

 VIEW SOLUTION



685. D

Refer to the following sentences: "The government discouraged imports and encouraged self-sufficiency....absolutely uncompetitive". So, discouragement of imports was one of the features of government policy. Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

686. B

The writer ends the note in pessimism when he states that if we hadn't taken these erroneous measures, then we would have been in the much better position as compared to today.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

687. C

Refer to the following lines: "For, in all other respects, it operated under the conviction that businessmen were little more than crooks who were to be prevented from entering the most important areas of the economy, who were to be hamstrung in as many ways as possible, who were to be tolerated in the same way as an inexcusable wart" The writer is surprised because the government shielded the industrialist from the foreign competitors while considering them to be crooks.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

688. C

Refer to the following line: "And the gates of global trade have been opened wide. But most of these changes were forced by circumstances partly by the foreign exchange bankruptcy of 1991 and the recognition that the government could no longer muster the funds to support the public sector, let alone expand it." This is the same reason which is mentioned in C.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

689. A

Refer to the following sentences: "The reasons list themselves. Topmost is economic isolationism". Economic isolationism led to an inefficient industry. So, the major reason is economic isolationism. Option a) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



690. B

The author has criticized the method of metric fixation in the passage. He has stated that metric fixation will lead professionals to adhere to practices that are at odds with the larger purpose of the organization. He has also explained that metric fixation will lead to goal displacement. In this light, option B is the most relevant. Option A is incorrect because it is against the author's view.

Option C is narrow as it focuses on short-termism only which is one of the ill-effects of metric fixation as mentioned in the passage.

Option D does not state that the author is criticizing the metric fixation method to measure the performance. Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

691. **C**

The author has criticized the No Child Left Behind Act of 2001. So, it should be against what the author has supported in the passage. We know that the author has been critical of metric fixation. Therefore, the No Child Left Behind Act of 2001 must have the features of metric fixation.

Option C cannot be a feature of the No Child Left Behind Act of 2001 as it mentions the subjective evaluation of students based on their participation in the class which is against the theory of metric fixation.

Hence, option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

692. **B**

In the second paragraph, the author discusses that one of the major drawbacks of metric fixation is the rise in unethical behaviour in order to maximize the metrics. The author, further, goes on to give the examples of the police officer and the surgeon to substantiate his claims. Therefore, option B is the correct answer.

Option A does not mention that the influence would be unethical and harmful in nature.

Option C is the underlying message of the author but, he does not explicitly provide the examples of the police officer and the surgeon to prove this.

Option D is too broad and has no specifics about the unethical behaviour which could be encouraged by metric fixation.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

693. **D**

In the passage, the author has discussed the ill-effects of metric fixation. He has discussed gaming of the metrics-based performance system in detail. By providing more real-life illustrations of the same, the author would not have added any value to the main argument.

Options A, B and C are relevant to the discussion and will surely add weight to the main idea of the passage.

Hence, option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

694. **B**

From the second paragraph, we can say that metric fixation encourages professionals to maximize the metrics in ways that are at odds with the larger purpose of the organization. Option A is a consequence of metric fixation.

From the third paragraph, we can infer that metric fixation leads to goal displacement.

The author has stated short-termism as a consequence of metric fixation in the penultimate paragraph.

Option B as a consequence of metric fixation has not been discussed in the paragraph.

Hence, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



695. **D**

"The main prime ministerial candidate from the opposition has had to bow out because he too has been charged in the hawala case."

"The head of the 'third force' has his own fodder scandal to face."

"The prime minister himself is under investigation for his involvement in not one scandal but two"

From these statements, we can say that options A, B and C can be eliminated.

Hence, option D is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

696. **C**

Refer to the following sentences: "There could be as many as a dozen prime ministerial candidates ranging from Jyoti Basu to Ramakrishna Hegde, and from Chandra Shekar to (believe it or not) K.R.Narayanan. The sole personality who stands out, therefore, is none of the players, but the umpire: T.N.Seshan". The author is of the opinion that it is a level playing field as far as the candidates are concerned so the stand-out personality is the umpire. The drama unfolds depending on the strictures of the umpire. So, option c) is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

697. **A**

Pay heed to the following excerpt:

{If all this does not make the parties (almost all of whom have broken the law, in not submitting their audited accounts every year to the income tax authorities) realise that the country both needs — and is ready for- change in the Supreme Court; the assertiveness of the Election Commission, giving new life to a model code of conduct that has been ignored for a quarter century; the independence that has been thrust upon the Central Bureau of Investigation; and the fresh zeal on the part of tax collectors out to nab corporate no-gooders. Think also that at no other point since the Emergency of 1975-77 have so many people in power been hounded by the system for their misdeeds.}

The author attributes the above factors to the 'winds of change blowing throughout the country.' Hence, Options B, C and D have been presented as important factors that portend a nation on the brink of transformation, while Option A has not been presented in the passage. Though the author talks about "people (voters)...looking for accountability", this doesnot translate to "greater awareness" in the masses.

Hence, the correct choice is Option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

698. **D**

"almost all of whom have broken the law, in not submitting their audited accounts every year to the income tax authorities".

Through this sentence, we can say that parties failed to submit audited accounts to tax authorities and hence the author feels that the parties broke the law.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

699. **B**

There was no instance in the passage where the author talked about women or their empowerment.

Hence, option B is the answer as it has not been mentioned anywhere in the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



700. **B**

The first line, the last line and most of the discussion in the passage are about "issue-less elections".

Hence, option B fits to be a suitable title.

701. **A**

*We hold our beliefs and presumptive knowledges more or less confidently, usually **depending on how we acquired them** (I saw it with my own eyes; I heard it on Fox News; a guy at the office told me) **and how broadly and strenuously they seem to be shared or endorsed by various relevant people**: experts and authorities, friends and family members, colleagues and associates.*

From the above excerpt, it is clear that held beliefs and presumptive knowledges depend upon how we acquired them, and how strongly they are shared or endorsed by relevant people in our circle. Hence, Option A is the answer.

702. **B**

We hold our beliefs and presumptive knowledges more or less confidently, usually depending on how we acquired them...

As mentioned in the above line, Option A directly contradicts what the author says.

It has been said that knowledge, or the problem of knowledge, is the scandal of philosophy. The scandal is philosophy's apparent inability to show how, when and why we can be sure that we know something or, indeed, that we know anything.

The author then goes on to explain that sceptic view is the skeleton in western philosophy's closet when trying to negate this scandal. Thus, it means that the scandal has to do with the sceptic way of thinking.

In the next paragraph, the sceptic view has been explained, which talks about our inability to grasp reality if we think of it as independent of our perceptions. Hence, the scandal can be construed to be the same. The author is likely to agree with this view. Option B is the answer.

In the last paragraph, the author points out that we defend a viewpoint strongly if we feel that it is held widely in our social circle. However, the author does not allude to the fact that it is appropriate or not. Also, such an argument would bolster the inherent bias we have, and hence would point towards a fault in our decision making. Hence, Option C is incorrect.

Option D is not supported in the passage. The passage presents the sceptic view that if reality were construed as independent of our perceptions, then it would be impossible to grasp reality. It has not been mentioned that in this case, we should aim to study that reality in a similar manner.

703. **C**

The argument in Option A has been discussed in the following excerpt:

...the sceptic's contention that we cannot be sure that we know anything - at least not if we think of knowledge as something like having a correct mental representation of reality, and not if we think of reality as something like things-as-they-are-in-themselves, independent of our perceptions, ideas or descriptions.

The argument in Option B has been discussed in the following excerpt:

For, they explain, unless we can ground our claims to knowledge as such, which is to say, distinguish it from mere opinion, superstition, fantasy, wishful thinking, ideology, illusion or delusion, then the actions we take on the basis of presumed knowledge - boarding an airplane, swallowing a pill, finding someone guilty of a crime - will be irrational and unjustifiable.

The argument in Option D has been discussed in the following excerpt:

While it is not clear that the scandal matters to anyone but philosophers, philosophers point out that it should matter to everyone, at least given a certain conception of knowledge.

The author does say that ignoring the scepticism about the veracity of knowledge is the most common way of dealing with it, not the best way. Hence. Option C has not been discussed.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

704. D

*...and not if we think of reality as something like things-as-they-are-in-themselves, **independent of our perceptions, ideas or descriptions**. For, the sceptic will note, since **reality, under that conception of it, is outside our ken** (we cannot catch a glimpse of things-in-themselves around the corner of our own eyes; we cannot form an idea of reality that floats above the processes of our conceiving it), we have no way to compare our mental representations with things-as-they-are-in-themselves and therefore no way to determine whether they are correct or incorrect.*

The author is making a logical argument in the sentence given in the question. According to the author, if we say that the reality of objects is independent of our perceptions, then it is out of our ken. Hence, we cannot for this idea of reality, and logically, we would be unable to comprehend it. Option D comes the closest to capturing this point.

Option A is incorrect. The sceptic argues that if reality were independent of individual perceptions, then the reality would float above the processes with which we conceive it. It is being presented as an argument to negate the viewpoint, while the Option takes it as an established fact.

Perception is more than eyesight. Option B captures only eyesight, and hence, is a distortion.

The process of conceiving reality and our knowledge is not the argument the author presents in the mentioned lines. Hence, Option C is incorrect.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



705. D

Statements A and B are not given as aims of research on the power source of movement in cells. Hence, we can eliminate the options.

Refer to the lines: "Because these molecules are essential for cell division, scientists hope to shut down the rampant growth of cancer cells by deactivating certain motors. Improving motor-driven transport in nerve cells may also be helpful for treating diseases such as Alzheimer's, Parkinson's or ALS, also known as Lou Gehrig's disease."

Between C and D, D is directly inferable from the information given above. Option C is incorrect since arresting the 'growth of cells' is not the same as arresting the 'rampant growth of cancer cells'.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

706. A

Refer to the 2nd last para "Some sperm use spring like engines made of actin filaments to shoot out a barb that penetrates the layers that surround an egg." This makes the argument A correct.

Refer to the 4th para "Each myosin molecule has a tiny head that pokes out from the chain like oars from a canoe. Just as rowers propel their boat by stroking their oars through the water, the myosin molecules stick their heads into the action and hoist themselves forward along the filament. While myosin moves along in short strokes, its cousin Kinesin walks steadily along a different type of filament called a microtubule. Instead of using a projecting head as lever, kinesin walks on two 'legs'. Based on these differences, researchers used to think

that myosin and kinesin were virtually unrelated. But newly discovered similarities in the motors' ATP processing machinery now suggest that they share a common ancestor-molecule." Hence, we can infer that Myosin and Kinesin are in fact related. Therefore, statement B is False.

Refer to the 1st line of 2nd para "The ability of such engines to convert chemical energy into motion is the envy of the nanotechnology researchers looking for ways to power molecule-sized devices." This makes C correct.

The third para states that "We wouldn't make it far in life without motor proteins. Our muscles wouldn't contract." Hence, statement D is true.

Statement E is directly given in para 4, line 2.

Hence, only statement B is incorrect. Thus, the only option that includes a statement that is not representative of an argument presented in the passage is option A which includes statement B.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

707. **A**

Refer to the 3rd para "The engines that power the cell's freight are three families of proteins, called myosin, kinesin and dynein." It is given that Actin is a protein in the sentence, "Myosin molecules, best known for their role in muscle contraction, form chains that lie between filaments of another protein called actin". Hence, argument A is true.

Statement B is given in para 3 in the third line.

Statement C is not given - we know that Myosin causes contractions but not vibrations.

Statement D is not true according to the paragraph.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

708. **B**

Refer 1st lines of 3rd para "We wouldn't make it far in life without motor proteins. Our muscles wouldn't contract. We couldn't grow because the growth process requires cells to duplicate their machinery and pull the copies apart" This makes A correct.

Refer to the last para "Both springs and ratchets are made up of small units that each move just slightly, but collectively produce a powerful movement. Ultimately, Mahadevan and Matsudaira hope to better understand just how these particles create an effect that seems to be so much more than the sum of its parts." This makes C correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

709. **A**

Refer to the lines of the 1st para where it is written that "the inside of the cell bustles with more traffic than Delhi Road".

Also refer to the middle of 3rd para "The movements that make these cellular activities possible occur along a complex network of threadlike fibers, or polymers, along which bundles of molecules travel like tram"

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



710. **B**

A and C are incorrect as there are no references to these options.

Between B and D, B is more suitable if we read the lines of 3rd para "All definite knowledge-so I should contend-belongs to science; all dogma as to what surpass definite knowledge to theology. But between theology and science there is a 'No man's Land' exposed to attack from both sides; this 'No Man's Land' is philosophy.

Almost all the questions of most interest to speculative minds are such as science cannot answer, and the confident answers of theologians no longer seem so convincing as they did in former centuries. Is the world divided into mind and matter, and if so, what is mind and what is matter? "

 VIDEO SOLUTION

711. **B**

Refer to the last lines of the last para "To teach how to live without certainly, and yet without being paralyzed by hesitation, is perhaps the chief things that philosophy, in our age, can still do for those who study it."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

712. **D**

Refer to the lines of the 3rd para "Is mind subject matter, or is it possessed of independent powers? Has the universe any unity or purpose? Is it evolving towards some goal? Are there really laws of nature, or do we believe in them only because of our innate love of order? "

All options are covered in these lines. According to the author, there are no definite answers to these questions. Hence, none of these statements is definitely true.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

713. **D**

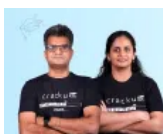
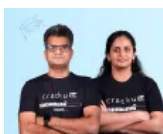
The correct answer is D as the author does not give the positive views about theologians throughout the passage. For eg. refer to the given lines:"Almost all the questions of most interest to speculative minds are such as science cannot answer, and the confident answers of theologians no longer seem so convincing as they did in former centuries." There are many examples in the passage in which the author does not present the favourable views about theologians.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

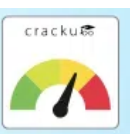
714. **D**

In the last para it is described that 'The hallucinatory dreams and visions of Dodeskaden are succeeded by nostalgic, melancholy ruminations..'. Option D is perfect.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Score Calculator



715. **C**

IN the 3rd para we can find the sentence '....and to delineate the code of ethics by which Dersu lives and which permits him to survive in these conditions...' Which is part of 1st section after prologue. Hence option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

716. **D**

We can easily find option B and C referred in last para. hence it has to be all of these.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

717. **C**

In the first para and 2nd sentence itself the author mentions that Kurosawa uses 3 frames and shift them. Hence option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

718. **A**

We can see 'We see all this at work in the enormously evocative prologue...' in 2nd para starting sentences where Arseniev's search for Dersu's grave is described. Since it is part of prologue it's in start of film. Hence option A.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

719. **C**

The film clearly doesn't express its arguments in circuitous way. Also it doesn't highlight insularity of anyone. Option C is correct as Dersu - the main protagonist is not in the beginning part. Also refer to the following lines of the paragraph: "The first section of the film has two purposes: to describe the magnificence and in human vastness of nature and to delineate the code of ethics by which Dersu lives and which permits him to survive in these conditions". These lines confirm that the protagonist does not appear in the first part.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



720. **C**

The passage starts with the author's perception of social life. In the whole passage the author criticises the fact that we do not possess any social life. The author also gives his opinions of social life and then moves on to lament our little social life we have left. Option b and d are not clearly the main subject of the author. Option a is inappropriate as the author does not highlight our real social life but rather complaints of the social life.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

721. **A**

Refer to the last lines of the second paragraph: "These large gatherings will be only what we make of them if not anything better, they can be as good places to collect new friends from as the slavemarkets of Istanbul were for beautiful slaves or New Market for race horses."

Here "They" refers to the large gatherings of casual acquaintances as illustrated in these lines.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

722. **B**

The author's conception of social life is mentioned in the fourth paragraph where he says wonder and interest. Hence B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

723. **D**

The author has not mentioned that crowd in poor Calcutta can turn violent => option A is wrong.

B negates the statements said by the author in the passage.

C is too generalized to be the answer for this question.

Hence, option D is the answer.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

724. **A**

The author is trying to say that people are not able to recognize the passionate attitude.

So, the word "discriminate" in this context means "recognize".

[▶ VIEW SOLUTION](#)



725. **C**

A just society is not a utopia according to the passage => option A is wrong.

The society mentioned in the passage is not hypothetical => options B and E are wrong.

Between option C and option D, option C fits better to be the answer because it is similar to the authors views in the passage whereas option D is too generalized.

Hence, C is the answer.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

726. **D**

The author says that the initial equality and the veil of ignorance are the most important.

Among the given options, only option D fits to be the answer because of the initial equality it poses.

Hence, option D is the answer.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

727. **D**

Consider the lines "Among the essential features of this situation is that no one knows his place in society, his class position or social status, nor does anyone know his fortune in the distribution of natural assets and abilities, his intelligence, strength, and the like. I shall even assume that the parties do not know their conceptions of the good or their special psychological propensities. The principles of justice are chosen behind a veil of ignorance". Thus, the author feels that for the rules to be truly unbiased, the rule-makers should have no information about their natural advantages (i.e. social position, strengths etc). Thus, we have to select an option where the rule makers have no idea about their own individual advantages.

Of the given options, only option D presents such a situation. The rule-makers are not aware of where they will be born or what their capabilities will be. Hence, option D.

In the case of the businessmen, irrespective of whether they can return to society, they are aware of their individual strengths. Same is the case with the immigrants. Even if they don't know what resources are needed, they know their own capabilities. In the case of the students, we don't know if they are unaware of where they are born and their natural advantages. Hence, the right option is option D.

[▶ VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

728. **B**

Refer to the sentence "Our social situation is just.....general system of rules which define it." Option B justifies this whereas other options deviate from this statement.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

729. **A**

It is clearly mentioned in the 2nd para of the passage that the original agreement is a hypothetical situation and is not influenced by position or status of the individual. Refer to the sentence "It is understood as a purely hypothetical situation.....intelligence, strength and the like."

 VIDEO SOLUTION



730. **A**

Refer to the following sentences: "They are very much part of the people. It is important that self-criticism does not stop". These indicate that for a country to be alive and progressive, self-criticism does not stop. Option a) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

731. **C**

Option B is incorrect as 'India is going back to its past status.' is never mentioned by the author.

Option D is incorrect. It is mentioned in the passage that glorious representation of India " is a great simplification and it occurs because it is intellectually, philosophically easier for Indians to manage" and it is not the central idea of the passage too.

Option A is incorrect, as it is a false inference of the central idea of the passage. The author does not want to express the new awakening of future India.

The central idea of the passage is that we have glorified our history, while actually, it was a significant loss of intellectuals. While in the latter half, the author explained that India post-independence is still trying to understand and come to terms with itself after such a chequered past.

Option C succinctly captures this idea and is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

732. **C**

Through the Vijaynagar example, the author is definitely not trying to refer to a 'historic' past. He is of the opinion that every Indian should visit the site to understand what the invasion of India has led to. In other words, he wants Indians to come to terms with its past. Option c) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

733. **D**

Refer to the following sentences: "...They have a higher idea of human possibilities...", "People begin to make more demands on their leaders...more in everything". From these sentences, we can infer that self-awareness is followed by a higher idea of human possibilities and a desire for more in everything. Option d) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

734. **B**

The writer is not critical or cynical about India in general. In fact, he is optimistic about India's future. The author laments its past but does not write off its future. Moreover, when the author talks about how India's politics is evolving, the author feels that there are short-term problems but a longer term positive movement is afoot. Hence, we can eliminate the negative options A and C. The author's tone is not distant or lacking in emotion. Hence, we can eliminate option D.

Throughout the passage, he gives various insights about India's past. The attitude can be said to be 'insightful'. Option b) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



735. **C**

Refer to the following sentences: "I think that in the British period and in the 50 years after the ...revival of energy and intellect". From this, we understand that the revival took place during and after the British period. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

736. **C**

At several places in the paragraph, the author refers to India's current position as 'primitive' and 'messy'. Option c) is the correct answer. Both 'bleak' and 'horrific' are not applicable in this context.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

737. **A**

The author cites a story-'that anyone could pull a bell and the emperor would appear at his door to deliver justice' he calls this a child's view of history, which like the slave's view talks about the mercy and generosity of emperors. The author is against this, because he believes that instead, people (even at the bottom) must hold justice in their own hands and not rely on a monarch. Hence, Option A is correct.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

738. **C**

Refer to the following lines: "The invasions are in all the schoolbooks. But I don't think that people understand that every invasion, every war, every campaign, was accompanied by slaughter, a slaughter always of the most talented people in the country." This point is mentioned in option C.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

739. **B**

Refer to the following sentence: "...But the future will be fairly chaotic". So, the writer's prognosis for the future of India is that it will be chaotic. Option b) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



740. **A**

The dictionary meaning of arcane is deceptive.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

741. **D**

Option A,B and C clearly qualifies for the rhetoric as they persuade people to be heard.Option D does not fit the criteria. it is giving orders and not persuading people to be heard.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

742. **C**

Option A and C are correct.Refer to the words"they think for us" and "giving a language a lot of responsibility"

 VIDEO SOLUTION

743. **C**

Only option C correctly depicts the meaning of the statement.Rest of the options are deviating."Arcane" means unfamiliar to the layman. Hence option c correctly depicts the meaning.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

744. **C**

If you refer these line:"Since the Greek flame was lit, though, the word has been used also in a broader and more amiable sense, to mean the study of all the ways of accomplishing things with language: inciting a mob to lynch the accused, to be sure, but also persuading readers of a novel that its characters breathe, or bringing scholars to accept the better argument and reject the worse.", it suggests that both views persuade people through rhetoric.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



745. **B**

By the term "mood music", the author intends to convey that the war set the stage for the Independence and partition of the country. He does not mean that the war was an allied effort and India's contribution to the war was merely supportive.

The author mentions that the political trajectory in both the countries has been against the popular remembrance of war. He states that the countries were focused on building a non-colonial identity and the war narrative did not fit in well in the picture.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

746. **B**

The author states that the new war memorial to commemorate various soldiers who lost their lives since independence will be built near India gate, a World War I memorial. The author regrets the fact that the contribution of Indian soldiers to World War II is being air brushed out of existence. The author laments the fact that the nation fails to recognize the sacrifice of the Indian soldiers who served in the World War II and hence, option B is the right answer.

747. D

In the second paragraph, the author mentions "Rather, it accurately reflected the fact that both academic history and popular memory have yet to come to terms with India's Second World War". The author states that the act was not merely absent-minded. Therefore, the author considers the omission to be reflective of India's academic and popular views and hence, option D is the right answer.

748. D

The author uses the phrase "mood music" to indicate that (the contribution of Indians to) the Second World War is not given the importance it deserves. The author does not state that the war led to the rivalry. Though he mentions the ill-effects of the war on India, he does not refer to them when he uses the term "mood music". He feels that the war is largely seen as a warmer to the Independence and partition of the country. Therefore, option D is the right answer.

749. B

In the fourth paragraph, the author states "This led the United States to take considerable interest in the country's future". We can infer that India's strategic location led to US's interests towards India and hence, we can eliminate option A.

In the first line of the second paragraph, the author mentions that the Second World War played a crucial role in the independence of India.

In the sixth paragraph, the author mentions that the war was achieved at great human cost. He states that the Bengal famine was the most extreme manifestation of the human costs of the war.

In the fifth paragraph, the author states "In a stunning reversal of its long-standing financial relationship with Britain, India finished the war as one of the largest creditors to the imperial power". From this line, we can infer that India lent its resources to Britain, not the other way around. Therefore, option B is an incorrect interpretation of the given sentence and hence, option B is the right answer.

100+ CAT Quant Questions



750. C

Option A would help keep squatter cities environment friendly, as recycling material would reduce the amount of non-biodegradable materials present in the environment.

Option B would also help squatter cities be more environment friendly by reducing pollution.

Option D would also help squatter cities be more environment friendly as sorting garbage and treating them would go a long way in preventing soil and water pollution.

Option C is incorrect. This is because, keeping the streets clean would mean that the wastes are somewhere in dumped in the environment near the local community.

Hence, option C cannot be inferred from the passage and is the correct answer.

751. **D**

From the sentence, "One hundred thousand people who would otherwise be deforesting the jungle around Manaus are now prospering in town making such things as mobile phones and televisions" given in the passage, option A can be inferred.

"But if they are overall a net good for those who move there, it is because cities offer more than just jobs. They are transformative" From this line, option B can be inferred.

The entire second paragraph of the passage mentions how multiple people have got jobs in squatter cities. Hence, option C can be inferred.

Option D is not a reason for cities being a good place to live in. Hence, this option cannot be inferred and is the correct answer.

752. **A**

"The city is the most environmentally benign form of human settlement. Each city dweller consumes less land, less energy, less water, and produces less pollution than his counterpart in settlements of lower densities."

Calthrope's major contention is that cities are eco-friendly as they consume less resources than people living in places that have lower population densities.

Options B,C,D does not directly contradict Calthrope's statement. Hence, they cannot be the reason why the statement that jars with most people.

Option A is directly opposed to Calthrope's viewpoints. Hence, this option is most likely to jar with most people.

Option A is the correct answer.

753. **A**

The author gives the example of Manaus to show how an entire community of people whose major job was deforestation of the jungle have now been able to prosper by making things such as mobile phones and televisions.

Option A is the correct answer. It is the major reason for the author giving out the example of Manaus.

Options D is incorrect and is not mentioned in the passage.

Option B and C are the pros of being in a squatter city, but it is not the reason why the author gives the example of Manaus.

Option A is the correct answer.

754. **B**

The rapid spread of diseases in the slum would only affect the people in the slums and not the greenness of the cities. Hence it is incorrect.

Option C is incorrect as the incidence of crime in the West would not impact the greenness of the cities.

Increasing cost of utilities, in the same way would not affect the flora of the cities.

An increase in carbon-di-oxide and global warming, however, would contribute greatly to the change in climate. A change in climate would adversely affect the greenery in the cities. Hence, this would greatly undermine the author's stand that cities are indeed green.

100+ CAT DILR Questions

cracku



755. B

The author highlights multiple elements that constitute the Classic Mayan worldview pertaining to personhood:

- "Nonhuman persons were not tethered to specific humans, and they did not derive their personhood from a connection with a human."
- "The Maya saw personhood as 'activated' by experiencing certain bodily needs and through participation in certain social activities. For example, among the faced objects that I examined, persons are marked by personal requirements (such as hunger, tiredness, physical closeness), and by community obligations (communication, interaction, ritual observance)"
- "Personhood was a nonbinary proposition for the Maya. Entities were able to be persons while also being something else... With these Maya examples, we are challenged to discard the person/nonperson binary that constitutes our basic ontological outlook"

Inspecting the options using the above ideas as filters, we notice that Option B is closest to the Classic Mayan worldview. A tribe that "perceives plants as person-plants because they form an ecosystem and are marked by needs of nutrition" acknowledges the two elementary variables for defining personhood - *personal requirements* and *community obligations*.

Options A and C tether the personhood of the objects to their utility to humans - this does not coincide with the Classic Mayan belief. Although Option D mentions bodily needs, the interpretation of the term 'functionality' remains unclear. Hence, we can eliminate Option D.

756. D

The author supplements the example of the i-phone with a pertinent question: "Does it have personhood (if at all) because it is connected to me, drawing this resource from me as an owner or source?" He proceeds to then highlight the key takeaway from the example: "For the Maya (who did have plenty of other communicating objects, if not smartphones), the answer was no. Nonhuman persons were not tethered to specific humans, and they did not derive their personhood from a connection with a human." The end idea: the personhood of an object is not a function of its utility or attachment to humans {an object can be categorised as a person based on certain distinct variables aside from its relation to a human}. The only relevant information invalidating this portrayal is in Option D: if the personhood of the incense burner or stone chopper is dependent on their usefulness to humans, the purpose of presenting the example and the associated idea is undermined.

It is unclear how Options A and B invalidate the purpose of the example. Option C aligns with the author's assertions and does not touch upon the idea emphasised by the example.

Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

757. A

One additional complexity: the incense burner (which would have been made of clay, and decorated with spiky appliques representing the sacred ceiba tree found in this region) is categorised as a person - but also as a tree.

The additional complexity that the author talks about here is the addition of another layer in the non-binary understanding of personhood. The incense burner was already classified as a person, but now it has also been classified as a tree. Hence, we have Options A and C. Note that the third category, that is tree, has a relation with the previous two categories. The boundary separating tree and person is porous. And since the incense

burner has been categorized as a tree too, the relationship between them is porous too. Hence, we can infer that the third category shares a similar relationship with the previous two categories, and A is the correct answer.

The author is not exemplifying an exception but citing an additional complexity that is present in the definition. Hence, B can be eliminated.

The author does not establish the porosity of the divine and the profane. Hence, Option D is out of the scope of the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

758. D

The idea concerning the democratising potential can be retraced to the first paragraph wherein the author states: *"Nonhuman persons were not tethered to specific humans, and they did not derive their personhood from a connection with a human. . . . It's a profoundly democratising way of understanding the world. Humans are not more important persons - we are just one of many kinds of persons who inhabit this world"*

Option A: Considering proximity as an idea would undermine the portrayal of the Classic Mayan worldview. The author presents the example of the I-phone to convey how the personhood of an object is not a function of its utility or attachment to humans. If true, the statement in A would counter the premise of this example. Hence, we can eliminate this choice.

Option B: the assessment here is quite similar to Option A; if we create distinctions within the realm of inanimate objects, this will weaken the Mayan worldview. It would diminish the democratising potential of such a viewpoint by introducing specific barriers or criteria for the classification of personhood.

Option C: The claim here runs against the Mayan idea of personhood being nonbinary. Thus, we can eliminate it since it undermines the democratising potential of the Classic Mayan worldview.

Hence, Option D is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

759. A

An important clue to analyse the options lies in the following excerpt: *{Yet tea is, Rappaport makes clear, a world apart - an astonishing success story in which tea marketers not only succeeded in conveying a sense of moral elevation to the consumer but also arguably did advance the cause of civilisation and community.}* It is emphasised that the moral praise that tea received was not mere talk - tea as a 'morality product' did produce desirable outcomes. Option A is closest to conveying this idea. Options B, C and D fail to highlight the attribute that separates tea from 'other morality products' {as per the passage}.

Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT VARC Questions



760. C

{During the Second World War, tea service was presented as a social and patriotic activity that uplifted soldiers and calmed refugees.}

{I have been offered tea at a British garden party, a Bedouin campfire, a Turkish carpet shop and a Japanese chashitsu, to name a few settings. In each case the offering was more an idea - friendship, community, respect - than a drink, and in each case the idea then created a reality. It is not a stretch to say that tea marketers have advanced the particularly noble cause of human dialogue and friendship.}

Options A, B and D have been implied in the above excerpts - we can safely assume that the author will agree to the claims made in these options. Option C, however, has not been stated in the passage. There is no information to deduce that the author will agree with the assertions that tea became the leading drink in Britain in the nineteenth century. Thus, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

761. **A**

Although mildly subjective, the question tests our understanding of the central idea. Across the passage, we notice the 'conflation' of tea consumption with particular virtues: it was not merely limited to benefits to the consumer but served a greater purpose. The narrative was that by drinking tea, people were/are advancing the cause of civilisation and community {thereby, imparting a sense of moral elevation}. Thus, the welfare highlighted is two-fold: both the consumer and society is benefitted. Towards the end, the author supports the narrative as follows: "*It is not a stretch to say that tea marketers have advanced the particularly noble cause of human dialogue and friendship.*" Any choice showcasing this dual benefit might be the potential answer.

Option A presents sustainably farmed foods; it is easy to identify that any associated marketing mechanics will emphasise the benefit of such food to both people and the environment. Thus, advertisers will make a case for how sustainably farmed food is beneficial not just to the consumer but also to the world at large. This will be equivalent to the 'conflation' that we came across in the passage.

Option B mentions natural health supplements; although we can discern the benefit to the consumer, the benefits to society is hard to perceive. Similarly, Options C and D appear irrelevant; it is difficult to identify what virtues we are conflating here with the subject.

Hence, of the given choices, Option A appears most appropriate.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

762. **B**

We can refer to the following excerpt to examine the choices: { *Beginning in the 1700s, the temperance movement advocated for tea as a pleasure that cheered but did not inebriate, and industrialists soon borrowed this moral argument in advancing their case for free trade in tea (and hence more open markets for their textiles). Factory owners joined in, compelled by the cause of a sober workforce, while Christian missionaries discovered that tea "would soothe any colonial encounter".* }

Options A, C and D can be directly inferred from the excerpt. The author does not present any information pertaining to tea drinkers lobbying for product diversity - hence, we can identify this as an incorrect reason.

Therefore, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

763. **A**

Refer to the given lines "Recently some members of Dr. Becker's team announced their discovery of the four most distant quasars known, all the new quasars are terribly faint, a challenge that both teams overcame by peering at them through one of the twin Keck telescope in Hawaii. These are the world's largest and can therefore collect the most light."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

764. **B**

Refer these line "The main problem that plagued previous efforts to study the Dark Age was not the lack of suitable telescopes but rather the lack of suitable things at which to point them. Because these events took place over 18 billion years ago, if astronomers are to have any hope of unraveling them they study objects that are at least 13 billion light years away."

This indicates B.

Option D is incorrect as by referring to these lines "However at the distances required for the study of Dark Age, even quasars are extremely rare and faint." , it is clear that the quasars are not faint to begin with but the distance which is required to study them is too large, so they appear faint.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Expected Questions PDF

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765. B

Refer to the given lines "The fog prolonged the period of darkness until the heat from the first stars and quasars had the chance to ionize the hydrogen (breaking it into its constituent parts, protons and electrons). Ionized hydrogen is transparent to ultraviolet radiation, so at that moment the fog lifted and the universe became the well-lit place it is today."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

766. B

Refer to the given lines "Sir Martin Rees, Britain's astronomer royal, named the long interval between these two enlightenments the cosmic "Dark Age". The name describes not only the poorly lit conditions, but also the ignorance of astronomers about the period."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

767. C

Refer to the lines of the paragraph "The argument was that incentives are necessary to stimulate innovations, and that this calls for a system of patents which gives innovators the sole right to use (or sell/lease the right to use) their innovations for a specific period and protect them against unauthorised copying or use."

This makes option C correct

 VIEW SOLUTION

768. A

Refer to the lines in the 2nd para "The larger, longer-term consequences of reduced biodiversity that may follow from the use of specially bred varieties are also another cause for concern." which is just the opposite of what is stated in A.

 VIEW SOLUTION

769. A

Refer to the given lines "The deciphering of the structure and functioning of DNA forms the basis of much of modern biotechnology. But this fundamental breakthrough is a 'public good' freely accessible in the public domain and usable free of any charge."

This makes option A correct.

 VIEW SOLUTION



CAT Important Topics

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770. B

Refer to the lines of the para "The current debate on TRIPs in India-as indeed elsewhere-echoes wider concerns about 'privatisation' of research and allowing a free field for MNCs in the sphere of biotechnology and agriculture." Hence, a and d have been given as issues that have been raised. Also, in the first paragraph it is given that "The current debate on intellectual property rights (IPRs) raises a number of important issues concerning the strategy and policies for building a more dynamic national agricultural research system, the relative roles of public and private sectors". Hence, option C has also been given in the passage.

The author says that important issues regarding some the IPR regime have not been discussed - like the complementarity between various elements of research between the private and public sector, the use of knowledge developed by publicly-funded research organisations to develop patented products etc. Hence, the author believes that important issues regarding the strategy and policies for implementation of IPR regime in Indian agriculture have not been discussed. Hence, option B.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

771. **C**

Refer to the fourth para, especially to the lines "We need to address problems likely to arise on account of the public-private sector or of privatisation of research and need to ensure that the public research systems perform efficiently. Complementarity between various elements of research raises several issues in implementing an IPR regime."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

772. **D**

Refer to the last lines of the 2nd para "On the other hand, high-pressure advertising and aggressive sales campaigns by private companies can seduce farmers into accepting varieties without being aware of potential adverse effects and the possibility of disastrous consequences for their livelihood if these varieties happen to fail. There is no provision under the laws, as they now exist, for compensating users against such eventualities."

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

773. **D**

Refer to the given lines "Public research, which is not driven by profit, is better placed to take corrective action. Research for improving common pool resource management, maintaining ecological health and ensuring sustainability is both critical and also demanding in terms of technological challenge and resource requirements. As such research is crucial to the impact of new varieties, chemicals and equipment in the farmer's field, private companies should be interested in such research. But their primary interest is in the sale of seed material, chemicals, equipment and other inputs produced by them. Knowledge and techniques for resources management are not 'marketable' in the same way as those inputs. Their application to land, water and forests has a long gestation and their efficacy depends on resolving difficult problems such as designing institutions for proper and equitable management of common pool resources. Public or quasi-public research institutions informed by broader, long-term concerns can only do such work"

This covers all the options given in the paragraph.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

774. **B**

Refer to the lines of the para "Public or quasi-public research institutions informed by broader, long-term concerns can only do such work."

This makes B correct.

A and C are out of context of this question while D is just a fact and not a reason.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



775. **A**

The passage starts by introducing typewriters. The author later states that some government offices in Russia are going back to typewriters and that in the US some offices still use them. The author then goes on to give reasons for the same by highlighting positive aspects of the typewriter.

Option A correctly describes what the passage is trying to do. Hence, it is the right choice.

The author doesn't state that use of typewriters will be perennial. Hence, it can be eliminated.

The main aim of the passage is not to highlight personal benefit. Hence, it can be eliminated.

Option D is out of scope as the author nowhere states or highlights that computers offer less options than typewriters. Hence, it can be eliminated.

Hence, option A is the right answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

776. **D**

The author states that, "...Nor are there any easy distractions...". Hence, the only thing one can do using typewriter is write, unlike computers. Hence, option A is correct.

Refer to following lines "... there's a big premium on hitting the right key...". Thus, there's premium attached on hitting right keys because as you cannot revise what you've typed on the typewriter. Hence, option B is correct.

Refer to following lines "...thinking process is accompanied by the encouraging clack of keys...". Hence, typewriters are noisier than computers. So, option C is correct.

Nowhere in the passage does the author state or highlight that typewriters are messier than the computers. Hence, option D is not the reason why the author praises typewriters.

Thus, option D is the right choice.

VIEW SOLUTION

777. **D**

Refer to the sentence, "... the only way anyone else can get it is if you give it to them. That is why the Russians have decided to go back to typewriters in some government offices..." Hence, the government uses typewriters to control who views the document as the only way someone can read the document is by physically accessing it to them. Option D, which highlights this, is the right answer.

VIEW SOLUTION

778. **B**

After reading the lines, "Erin Thompson, a professor of art crime at John Jay College of Criminal Justice in New York City, says it's the latest example of a Western nation appropriating a foreign culture, a centuries-long battle." it can be inferred that professor accuses CyArk of appropriating a foreign culture.

The only option present that is an example of a western nation appropriating a foreign culture would be the seizing of ancient Egyptian artefacts by a Western museum. Hence, option B is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

779. **C**

From the passage, it can be inferred that Dr. Watrall is not comfortable with the arrangement between Cyark and Google. He is of the opinion that though the material is promoted as a means for people to view the artifacts, the ulterior motive is for advertisements and commercial purposes.

Option A is incorrect. The professor is uneasy about the arrangement between a non-profit organisation and a commercial organisation, whose values are, in reality, different from what they portray.

Option B is incorrect. The professor is not dismissive of laypeople's access to specialist images and such information is not given in the passage.

Option D is incorrect. The professor is only dismissive of the commercial agreement between two organisations that portray themselves to be involved in non-profit work. He is not against the use of digital technology in archaeological and cultural sites in developing countries.

Option C is correct and it correctly represents the views of professor Dr. Watrall.

VIDEO SOLUTION



780. C

"They want to make this material accessible so people will browse it and be filled with wonder by it," he says. "But at its core, it's all about advertisements and driving traffic." Watrall says these images belong on the site of a museum or educational institution, where there is serious scholarship and a very different mission".

From the above-mentioned lines, it can be reasonably inferred that Dr Watrall is not critical if the digitally scanned images are on official museum websites and archaeological sites.

Watrall's objections do not touch upon the ownership of the copyright of the scanned images. His objections are mainly about the uneasy relationship between Cyark and Google, and the profit-based motive of Google. Hence, option D is incorrect.

Option C mentions the case when CyArk uploads the scanned images on museum sites only. This would invalidate the arguments made by Dr Watrall.

Option A is incorrect as Dr Watrall considers the venture as a medium to promote Google itself. Just taking down advertisements would not invalidate the professor's claim.

Option B is incorrect, as a ban in certain locations would certainly not prevent the promotion of and commercialization by Google. The same reason can be attributed to option D. CyArk not owning the copyright of the archaeological sites would not prevent using it for commercial purposes.

Hence, option C is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

781. D

The option that would not help a company that digitally scans cultural sites would be the given answer.

Option A is incorrect as preserving images of sites in case they are damaged would be one of the foremost arguments made by these companies.

Option B and C would surely help the cause of companies that scan cultural sites. Hence, they are incorrect.

Option D is the correct answer. A company that digitally scans cultural sites would not give the reason of being able to project itself as a protector of culture as a reason to scan the cultural sites. This is a self centered goal such a company and hence is the least likely of the arguments that would be used in this case.

Hence, option D is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

782. C

From the lines, " [There's] another issue for some archaeologists and art historians. CyArk owns the copyrights of the scans — not the countries where these sites are located. That means the countries need CyArk's permission to use these images for commercial purposes", it can be seen that critics view the Google-CyArk project as one that appropriates the copyrights of the digital scans in such a way even the countries in which the sites are located need CyArk's permission to use the images.

Option A, D , B are not mentioned anywhere in the passage.

Option C is describes perfectly why the critics of the Google-CyArk project term it as digital colonialism and hence it is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

783. A

The last paragraph talks about how renewable energy can be produced at local or household level but it also talks about the roadblocks in terms of financing. Hence it portrays two sides of the coin, talking about both the positives and negatives. Thus we can fairly conclude that renewable energy is a double edged sword. Option1 is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

784. A

Let's look at the options one by one. Option 2 states "The study of the coexistence of marginalised people with their environments." This passage is about the impact of renewable energy on marginalized people, not about their coexistence. Hence ignore this option.

Option 3 states "Encouragement for the development of more environment-friendly carbon-based fuels". In the third paragraph, the author talks about reducing carbon footprint. Hence he will never support carbon based fuels. This option is incorrect.

Option 4 is completely negated by the last paragraph. The author talks about the financial viability of the localised small scale production. Hence this option too is incorrect.

Option 1 is completely correct."many of the world's largest reservoirs of minerals like cobalt, copper, lithium, [and] rare earth minerals"—the ones needed for renewable technologies—"are found in fragile states and under communities of marginalized peoples in Africa, Asia, and Latin America." Since the demand for metals and minerals will increase substantially in a renewable-powered future . . . this intensification could exacerbate the existing consequences of extractive activities."

This intensification could exacerbate the existing consequences, i.e. if proper disposal of toxic materials is not done it can make the conditions worse. Option 1 is the correct answer.

VIDEO SOLUTION

A banner for CAT Online Coaching. On the left, a man and a woman are standing. In the center, the text "CAT Online Coaching" is written in large, bold, black letters. Below it, a red button contains the text "your road to IIM stars here". On the right, there is a small logo for "cracku" and an illustration of a person sitting at a desk with a laptop.

785. A

Look at these lines from the first paragraph of the passage, "But renewables need to be further scrutinized before being championed as forging a path toward a low-carbon future. Both the direct and indirect impacts of renewable energy must be examined to ensure that a climate-smart future does not intensify social and environmental harm. As renewable energy production requires land, water, and labor, among other inputs, it imposes costs on people and the environment."

These lines clearly indicate that the author has reservations about the renewable energy systems.

Option (2) is factually incorrect. Option 3 is beyond the scope of the passage. No comparison has been made as such. Option (4) is partially correct. The author has reservations about profitability and various other factors too which is accurately captured by the first option.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

786. **B**

Here we have to look at those options which if false will support the author's arguments. Look at the option 2. It states that renewable energy have little or no environmental impact. Its negation will be renewable energy have considerable environmental impact, this is what the author states throughout the passage, about the harmful impact of renewable energy. Hence option 2 is correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

787. **D**

Look at the last line of the passage, "For financial growth to be sustained and expanded by the renewable sector, production and trade in renewable energy technologies will need to be highly concentrated, and large asset management firms will likely drive those developments " Nowhere it is mentioned that the negative impacts of renewable energy needs to be studied , for it to be financially viable. Hence option 4 is incorrect.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

788. **B**

Option A is out . Option D is also out as caste is completely social construct. Out of B and C , B can be inferred from the last part of the passage.

 VIEW SOLUTION

789. **A**

Read these lines "Yet, we would humbly submit that if globalising our markets are thought good for the 'national' pocket, globalising our social inequities might not be so bad for the mass of our people. After all, racism was as uniquely institutionalised in South Africa as caste discrimination has been within our society; why then can't we permit the world community to express itself on the latter with a fraction of the zeal with which, through the years, we pronounced on the former?"

The issue at the hand is to openly discuss the social inequities. Hence option A is correct.

Option C is incorrect as delimitation means to fix the limits which is nowhere mentioned in the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



790. **B**

From the following part of the sentence taken up from the passage '.. however tangentially, that caste discrimination is a reality, ' we can say that option B is the correct answer out of all others.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

791. **C**

In the start part of the passage we find ' Inverted representations, as we know, have often been deployed ...' . From here out of all the options only option C can be inferred.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

792. **A**

Option C is out. Also there is nothing related to racial pride. Out of others only A and E are the broad areas that fall under UN preview of discussion.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

793. **A**

The major idea put forth by the author is that cultural barriers can be broken down and an outsider can ingrain himself with the local culture by learning the language of the culture.

The author himself says that an individual who wrestles with a difficult language would learn to be more sympathetic to outsiders. He also says that empathy is not tied to gender and race, and therefore a individual who learns languages is usually empathetic to different races in the world. Thus option B can be inferred from the passage and is incorrect.

The passage makes no mention of linguistic politics. Also he is of the opinion that a person's characteristics can be changed for the good by learning another language. Hence option C can be inferred from the author's argument and is incorrect.

The word orientalism itself means looking down upon middle eastern countries by the US and European countries. Hence, option D does not make sense.

Option A is directly in conflict with the author's main point and that would be the major criticism by the author's critics. Hence it is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

794. **B**

The author is of the opinion that learning the language of local cultures would help bridge cultural barriers.

Option D is against the author's point of view. Hence it is definitely incorrect.

Option A is incorrect. The author is of the opinion that the ability to communicate is far more important than the racial divide between two people. Hence it is unlikely to be the view of the author.

Option C is incorrect as the author, in the passage is much more concerned about the ability to communicate that racial and gender identity of the person.

Option B falls in line with the viewpoint of the author. Hence it is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Syllabus PDF



795. **D**

"And that easily lobbed word—"Orientalist"—hardly captures the complexity of our interactions. What exactly is the dynamic when a man from Missouri observes a Zhejiang native selling lingerie to an Upper Egyptian woman? . . . If all of us now stand beside the same river, speaking in ways we all understand, who's looking east and who's looking west? Which way is Oriental?"

From the above passage, it is clear that the author consider the word Orientalist an easily lobbied word that does not capture the complex nature of interactions between people of different cultures. The author is of the opinion that if people in different parts of the world all speak in tongues that all of them understand, then the east west divide would be broken.

The author is of the opinion that learning new languages would help bridge the east west divide. There is no information provided in the passage that globalization has enabled people learn more languages and thereby mitigated cultural hierarchies and barriers. Hence, option A is incorrect.

Option B is incorrect. The author never makes the claim that Orientalism has disappeared for the most part.

The author makes no claim about goodwill. Hence option C is incorrect.

Option D correctly encapsulates the arguments made by the author. Hence it is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

796. C

" This learning process—the embarrassments, the frustrations, the gradual sense of understanding and connection—is invariably transformative." From this sentence, the option A can be inferred. Hence it is incorrect.

" After all, you can always learn another language and change who you are." From this line, option B can be inferred. Hence it is incorrect.

"You are what you speak—the words that run throughout your mind are at least as fundamental to your selfhood as is your ethnicity or your gender" From this option D can be inferred. Hence it is incorrect.

The author makes no mention about the inherent ability of language to evolve over time to change a person. Hence, it is not responsible for language's ability to change us. Option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

797. A

Option A:

Indeed, they might be twins, the progeny of the same parents. Insofar as this proves to be the case, my linkage of both here will be uncomfortably close for some readers.

The above excerpt implies that utopia and dystopia **might** be twins. The level of certainty is not absolute. However, Option A goes one step further to assert that they **are** twins and the progeny of the same parents. Hence, A cannot be inferred and is the answer.

'Insofar as this proves to be the case' can cause confusion while answering. But note that the case the author is talking about is the level of similarity between the two. Hence, what is being proven is that the two are quite similar to each other, and hence some would presume that they are twins. The excerpt, however, does not support that they actually are.

Option B: The whole passage supports the inference that utopias can be perceived as dystopias by different people. E.g. The author mentions that where some people push for relentless transparency so that they are secure, some people would perceive this as a breach of their privacy. Hence, a utopia for the former would be a dystopia for the latter.

Option C:

People become more alike in appearance, opinion, and outlook than they often have been. Unity, order, and homogeneity thus prevail at the cost of individuality and diversity. This model, as J. C. Davis demonstrates, dominated early modern utopianism. . . . And utopian homogeneity remains a familiar theme well into the twentieth century.

Option C is a direct inference from the above excerpt. It has been mentioned that this theme of homogeneity and uniformity dominated early modern utopianism.

Option D: Throughout the passage, the author deals with conceptions of utopian societies as dealt with in literary works. We can infer that utopian societies do exist in literature where the characters practice traditions that the author made up to portray a utopian society.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

798. C

Option A: The author does not discuss a utopian narrative that involves a society without laws or social structure. Instead, he talks about regulations that curb individuality and promote homogeneity. Hence, we can eliminate Option A as a potential choice.

Option B: The second paragraph relays the following idea: "*The passions are regulated, and inequalities of wealth and distinction are minimized. Needs, vanity, and emulation are restrained, often by prizing equality and holding riches in contempt. The desire for public power is curbed*" Given that public power is not looked at favourably, the entire debate on the mechanism to attain this facet (public power) becomes irrelevant. Thus, we can eliminate Option B.

Option C: "*Such a conclusion might be fortified by examining selectively the tradition which follows More on these points. This often portrays societies where . . . 'it would be almost impossible for man to be depraved, or wicked'. . . . This is achieved both through **institutions** and mores, which underpin the common life*" From the above excerpt, it is clarified that the utopian doctrines are enforced by institutions present in the society; additionally, the author mentions in the preceding paragraph that security in a utopian setting is attained through the curtailment of privacy. Hence, Option C is likely to be the correct choice.

Option D: There is no mention of regulating homogeneity through promoting competitive heterogeneity. We can, therefore, eliminate this choice.

Hence, Option C is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

799. **A**

The passage begins by portraying a **utopian** society. The author then discusses the difference in perspective concerning the underlying elements of such a society. A disagreement originates about the perception of **security** - while the people part of the utopia might find the shackles on their freedom to be reasonable, modern readers perceive this as suppression of heterogeneity and violation of privacy. This is presented with the intention to direct attention towards the tradeoff that exists between security and certain other essential variables. It additionally puts the spotlight on the thin line that exists between a utopia and a dystopia. The author then cites other works in literary history that depict a utopian setting along with certain key attributes that one might stumble upon in such narratives. **Homogeneity** comes across as a prominent idea (a set of beliefs are considered acceptable, and the masses are expected to conform to the same). Towards the end of the discussion, the author reiterates the thin film that separates a utopia from a dystopia. He adds that while many individuals might be tempted to use these two ideas interchangeably, this shouldn't be the case. According to the author, the assertion that "all utopias are, or tend to produce, dystopias" is fallacious. He presents justification concerning the same: there are many utopian settings wherein conformity to doctrines or sacrifice of individuality is intentional - the person voluntarily submits to the group's norms for the greater good. This resonates with the term **intentional community** stated in the options. Option A aptly captures these principal themes.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



CAT Formula PDF

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800. **A**

Option A: The statement here appears to be a distortion. The author says: "*In More's time, for much of the population, given the plenty and security on offer, such restraints would not have seemed overly unreasonable.*" It is being conveyed that the form of restrictions discussed at the beginning of the passage would not seem unreasonable to the citizens/members of More's utopia. However, the author feels that the opinions of modern readers would be drastically different.

Option B: "For we have only to acknowledge the existence of thousands of successful intentional communities in which a cooperative ethos predominates and where harmony without coercion is the rule to set aside such an assertion. Here the individual's submersion in the group is consensual (though this concept is not unproblematic). It results not in enslavement but voluntary submission to group norms. Harmony is achieved without . . . harming others." Towards the end of the discussion, the author indicates that homogeneity and stability (that often constitute a utopian universe) need not be achieved via coercion. Members of many communities voluntarily concede to the group's norms at the cost of their individuality.

Option C: The statement here correlates to the assertion made by the author in the second paragraph: "Such a conclusion might be fortified by examining selectively the tradition which follows More on these points. This often portrays societies where . . . 'it would be almost impossible for man to be deprived, or wicked'. . . . This is achieved both through institutions and mores, which underpin the common life."

Option D: The introductory segment of the discussion highlights the restraints placed on individual freedom in a utopian society. Furthermore, the author mentions that many most utopian narratives in literary history are built on a premise devoid of individuality or diversity, as stated in the following excerpt: "People become more alike in appearance, opinion, and outlook than they often have been. Unity, order, and homogeneity thus prevail at the cost of individuality and diversity. This model, as J. C. Davis demonstrates, dominated early modern utopianism. . . . And utopian homogeneity remains a familiar theme well into the twentieth century."

Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

801. B

The central idea of the passage is that endangered languages, as carriers of unique cultural perspectives and human knowledge, must be preserved to benefit humanity. The author argues that liberal arts education plays a vital role in this preservation, both by fostering global citizenship and by encouraging some individuals to directly engage in preservation efforts. Liberal arts education, as framed in the passage, sensitises students to cultural diversity and equips them with the tools to support endangered languages and cultures.

We observe that Option B, however, directly undermines this central idea by redefining the focus of liberal arts education. Requiring fluency in two of the most widely spoken global languages (e.g., English, Spanish, Mandarin) would prioritise dominant languages rather than endangered ones. This hypothetical scenario shifts resources and attention away from the preservation of linguistic diversity, which is central to the passage's argument. Such a requirement would reinforce the dominance of already powerful languages, the very phenomenon identified as a major "language killer" in the passage. By institutionalizing the focus on dominant languages, it would erode the argument that liberal arts education fosters support for endangered languages and cultural preservation, ultimately weakening the role of liberal arts in addressing language extinction.

In contrast, the remaining choices either align with the discussion or do not serve as strong counterarguments to the points presented in the passage. For instance, Option A acknowledges that most liberal arts students will not directly engage in language preservation but does not challenge the broader idea that liberal arts education fosters empathy and support for endangered languages. Option C limits the long-term success of language preservation but does not negate its immediate benefits or the potential for renewal in subsequent generations. Similarly, Option D highlights a limitation of recording dying languages but does not undermine the broader argument that documentation is a valuable and necessary tool in preservation.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

802. B

The question asks us to identify the hypothetical scenario that does not reflect the kind of loss described in the passage. The passage discusses cultural, ecological, and intellectual losses caused by language extinction, including the loss of:

- Unique cultural expressions (e.g., music, art, and emotions tied to language).
- Knowledge about the environment (e.g., relationships between plants and illness).
- Worldviews and philosophical insights.

We need to identify a scenario that doesn't align with these themes. Let us examine the options based on this understanding -

Option A: This scenario reflects the loss of unique cultural knowledge - in this case, the ability to describe the "20 different moods of the ocean," which likely represents detailed ecological and environmental understanding.

Option B: This scenario focuses on some form of administrative or statistical change in a government list; the focus is not on the cultural, ecological, or intellectual loss emphasised in the passage. Therefore, the option does not reflect the deeper, humanity-wide loss described in the passage.

Option C: This scenario aligns with the loss of unique cultural concepts and the emotional depth tied to a word or phrase. In the author's perspective, losing this concept would diminish humanity's understanding of the complexity of human relationships.

Option D: This scenario reflects the loss of ecological knowledge about snow textures, which likely has practical implications for living in the Arctic environment. This aligns with the passage's discussion of losing environmental wisdom when languages die.

Hence, Option B is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

803. **D**

The passage highlights the widespread extinction of indigenous languages in North America due to colonisation, physical annihilation, and assimilation policies while noting slightly better survival rates in Central and South America. It implies that language survival may be influenced by factors such as social policies, cultural integration, and the extent of physical and cultural displacement.

Evaluating the choices, we note that Option A is plausible since allowing children to stay with families would help preserve native languages, unlike the North American policy of removing children to boarding schools, as discussed in the passage. Option B is also reasonable, as less effective assimilation efforts by colonial governments could lead to better language retention. Option C also aligns with the passage's context, as it discusses physical annihilation as a significant driver of language extinction, but the survival rate being slightly better in South America could suggest marginally less physical annihilation.

However, Option D is problematic; while providing locals with jobs in the colonial administration might seem like a factor that supports language retention, this scenario is not consistent with the passage. The passage emphasises that dominant languages often replace indigenous ones through socio-economic pressures, and employment in colonial administration would likely reinforce the use of the dominant language rather than preserve native languages.

Hence, Option D is the best choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

804. **C**

The author discusses how a liberal arts education, combined with participation in language preservation efforts, empowers students in several significant ways. He highlights that such an education broadens students' cultural understanding, helps them communicate across linguistic barriers (Option A), and enables them to gain insights into both their own and others' cultures (Option D). Option B is an implicit aspect of this discussion. The passage also suggests that some students may even become involved in active language preservation, though it emphasises that the majority might not pursue this path. Contrarily, Option C is not explicitly mentioned or understood: while the passage provides examples of communities that have established such schools, it does not suggest that students themselves will take on this role.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



805.D

Let us pay heed to the following excerpt: "...In actuality, our own currency system today has some similarities even as it is changing in front of our eyes. . . . We have cash - coins for small transactions like paying for parking at a meter, and banknotes for other items; cheques and debit/credit cards for other, often larger, types of payments. At the same time, we are shifting to electronic banking and making payments online. Some young people never use cash [and] do not know how to write a cheque..."

Based on the above, we can infer Options A, B and C as the similarities that are implied. Concerning Option D, while the author does mention the present currency system as a changing/dynamic one, the same cannot be said about the Tang dynasty. The author does not highlight this element as a similarity. Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

806.D

Options A and C are economically sound decisions. Option B might be a viable choice, as well. However, Option D would not be an economically sound decision for a small purchase in the local market that is worth one-eighth of a bolt of cloth. Concerning small transactions, the author highlights the limitations that stemmed from a textile form of currency: "...Furthermore, a full bolt had a particular value. If consumers cut textiles into smaller pieces to buy or sell something worth less than a full bolt, that, too, greatly lessened the value of the textiles..." Thus, cutting the cloth would greatly diminish its value {and consequently cannot be considered as a sensible decision}. Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

807.A

The author evidently highlights the stability of utilizing textiles given its abundant supply{"...textile production was widespread and there were fewer problems with the supply of textiles..."}, the steady standard of measurement {"...the dimensions of a bolt of silk held remarkably steady from the third to the tenth century: 56 cm wide and 12 m long..."} and reliable quality {"...Furthermore, a full bolt had a particular value. If consumers ...". Transportation is not a dominant variable that is considered in the discussion pertaining to textiles. Hence, Option A is the correct choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

808.D

Let us inspect the individual statements:

Option A: The author does not make any such claim. The following is stated in this regard: "...Grain, because it rotted easily, was not used nearly as much as coins and textiles...". Thus, the marginal usage of grains is presented relative to that of coins and textiles. Therefore, it cannot be understood that perishable currencies such as grains were not utilised for official work.

Option B: The author simply states that "...Coins did have certain advantages: they were durable, recognisable and provided a convenient medium of exchange, especially for smaller transactions..." Presenting them as being more valuable than textile currency would be incorrect.

Option C: This would be imprecise as the author portrays the following: "...Grain, because it rotted easily, was not used nearly as much as coins and textiles, but taxpayers were required to pay grain to the government as a share of their annual tax obligations, and official salaries were expressed in weights of grain..." The statement here deviates from this depiction.

Option D: This statement can be understood from the final paragraph, wherein the author states: "...In actuality, our own currency system today has some similarities even as it is changing in front of our eyes. . . . We have cash - coins for small transactions like paying for parking at a meter, and banknotes for other items; cheques...". Hence, Option D is a valid inference

 VIDEO SOLUTION

809. **D**

Option D states "studying visual culture requires institutional structures without which the structures of perception cannot be analysed".

Look at the penultimate paragraph of the question, "Vision is a socially and a biologically constructed operation, depending on the design of the human body and how it engages the interpretive devices developed by a culture in order to see intelligibly"

Studying visual culture thus depends on the design of human body and interpretative devices developed by the culture. Nowhere it is mentioned that ,without institutional structures of culture vision can't be analysed as it also depends on the design of human body. Hence this is a wrong inference. Remaining all three options are correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

CAT Percentile Predictor



810. **B**

Let's look at the options one by one.

Option A states that ,"Socially existing beings cannot be analysed, unlike the art of Michelangelo or Leonardo which can." Twisted option. The excerpt from the passage states that "no amount of social analysis is enough for Michelangelo and Leonardo, because they were such vast artists" However other beings could be socially analysed because not everyone is like Michelangelo or Leonardo.

Option C states that ,"Michelangelo or Leonardo cannot be subjected to social analysis because of their genius." This is an entirely wrong option. These artists can be subjected to social analysis, but nothing will do justice to them.

Option D states that ,"No analyses exist of Michelangelo's or Leonardo's social accounts.". This is beyond the scope of the passage, as nothing has been mentioned about this.

Option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

811. **D**

This is a vocab question. Epiphenomena means "a secondary effect or byproduct". The option "Phenomena supplemental to the evidence", is the closest one. Hence it is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

812. **C**

This is a fact based easy question. Read the passage carefully. Imagery can be inferred from the second paragraph. And from the subsequent paragraphs you can also infer Visual Practices, Lifeworlds and Structures of Perception(penultimate paragraph).

Hence Option C is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

813. **A**

Let's look at the options one by one.

Option B is "Images are meaningful visual experiences when they have a foundation of covenants seeing them." This is a distorted option. The actual statement states that sight becomes a meaning visual experience when images are associated with covenants . There is nowhere any discussion about the meaningfulness of images

Option C is "Sight as a meaningful visual experience is possible when there is a foundational condition established in images of covenants." Again a twisted option. There is nothing said about the possibility of sight as a visual experience. There could be other cases too in which meaningful visual experience could be established

Option D is "The way we experience sight is through images operated on by meaningful covenants." Entirely out of context option. The statement is about meaningful visual experience not about meaningful covenants.

Option A correctly encapsulates all the points. Hence it is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

814. **C**

The passage states that

"People feel more comfortable with something they can relate to and understand immediately without too much thought. "

Thus, option C correctly states why people are more comfortable with representational art.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



815. **D**

All of the options have been stated in the passage by the author as reasons given by critics of modern abstract art. Hence, option D.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

816. **B**

The passage states that:

Guernica was meant as a protest against the bombing of that city by the Germans. To express the terror and suffering of the victims more vividly, he distorted the figures and presented them in a black and white journalistic manner. If he had used representational images and colour, much of the emotional content would have been lost and the piece would not have caused the demand for justice that it did.

Thus, the reason Guernica caused the demand for justice was because it vividly conveyed the terror and suffering of the victims. As the emotional content of the suffering was conveyed through the art, it produced the desired impact. Hence, option B correctly captures this point and is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

817. **A**

The passage states that:

Finally, abstract artists and representational artists maintain different ideas about 'reality'. To the representational artist, reality is what he sees with his eyes. This is the reality he reproduces on canvas. To the abstract artist, reality is what he feels about what his eyes see. This is the reality he interprets on canvas.

Hence, the two types of artists have completely different ideas about reality and how they represent it on canvas also differs. Thus, option A.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

818. **C**

The passage states that:

For example, through his work, Mondrian was trying to present a system of simplicity, logic, and rational order. As a result, his pieces did end up looking like a scrabble board.

Hence, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

819. **B**

The question asks which of the following cannot be inferred with respect to the passage.

From the last paragraph, we can understand that she had a honest producer to work with, that she had the looks, and also that at her prime she had religious fan following.

But, the fact that Bessie and Louis Armstrong accompanied her cannot be inferred from the passage as it is only mentioned that she was inspired by the singing styles of Bessie and Louis Armstrong.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



820. **D**

Following sentences from the passage shows that option D is not what author said 'Suffering was her profession; but she did not accept it.'

 VIDEO SOLUTION

821. **C**

The passage explains that her physical death has been called for as relief rather than sorrow. Hence option C is clearly the answer.

You can also refer to the following lines: "What sort of middle age would she have faced without the voice to earn money for her drinks and fixes, without the looks – and in her day she was hauntingly beautiful – to attract the men she needed, without business sense, without anything but the disinterested worship of ageing men who had heard and seen her in her glory?" This implies option c.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

822. **A**

The term, survive many who shall receive longer obituaries, means that her name and fame would continue to live longer than most people.

From the passage it can be inferred that her claim to fame was her creation of the Blues. Option B and D cannot be inferred from the passage. The passage does not state that she had a mellow voice as well. Instead it states that she had a thin and gritty voice. Hence, option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

823. C

The author says that the iPhone has not fulfilled its potential as a piece of revolutionary technology. He goes on to say that the hope was that the iPhone could help in liberating people in closed societies. However, the failure of the Arab spring and continued suppression in places like North Korea shows that this has not happened. Hence, the author uses the continued suppression of free speech in closed societies to indicate why he is still uncertain about the potential of the iPhone. Hence, option C is correct.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

824. B

The main point of the passage is that unlike the Gutenberg printing press, the iPhone has in comparison done nothing to make the society more liberated or enlightened. This point has been accurately captured by option B.

The author is not weighing the advantages or disadvantages of new technology. Hence, we can eliminate option A.

The author does not say that the society has rapidly changed as a result of new technology. In fact, he says that nothing really has changed as a result of it.

The author says that people are no longer daydreaming as a result of new technology. Hence, option D, which contradicts what is given in the passage, can be eliminated.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



825. D

From the lines "Medical information passed more freely and quickly, diminishing the sway of quacks" and "Gutenberg's brainchild broke the monopoly that clerics had on scripture", we can infer that option B is true.

From the lines "And later, stirred by pamphlets from a version of that same press, the American colonies rose up against a king and gave birth to a nation" and "it's hard to imagine the French or American revolutions without those enlightened voices in print", we can infer option A is true.

From the lines "Before the invention of the printing press, it used to take four monks up to a year to produce a single book. With the advance in movable type in 15th-century Europe, one press could crank out 3,000 pages a day", we can infer that option C is true.

Option D has not been stated nor implied anywhere in the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

826. B

Refer to the line "it's hard to imagine the French or American revolutions without those enlightened voices in print". Hence, from this we can straightaway eliminate options A and C. Between options B and D, B correctly captures the point made by the author. The printing press allowed the spread of enlightened voices and as a result people were exposed to new ideas on freedom and democracy.

Option D slightly distorts what is given in the passage. The passage does not mention any revolutionary "strategies". Hence, we can eliminate this option.

Thus, the answer is option B.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

827. **A**

In the first passage, the author mentions printing press as the internet of its day. Immediately, in the next paragraph he elucidates how printing press helped in spreading ideas and information. Thus, the author likened the printing press to the internet because it enabled access to new information and sharing of ideas.

Hence, option A is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

828. **C**

Refer to the following lines - "Not long after Steve Jobs introduced his iPhone, he said the bound book was probably headed for history's attic". Thus, we can infer that Steve Jobs predicted that reading printed books would become a thing of the past. Hence, option C is the right answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

829. **C**

In the last paragraph, the author uses the line "They also asserted that isolation and gene flow were less important to evolutionary divergence than natural selection". Also, through the example of checkerspot butterflies, the author brings to light the fact that isolation, though a factor, is not very dominant in influencing speciation. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION



The banner features a light blue background. On the left, there is a photo of a man and a woman standing together. In the center, the text "CAT Daily Targets" is written in a large, bold, black font. Below this, a yellow banner contains the text "Step by step, heading towards 99+ percentile". On the right side, there is a small logo for "cracku" and an illustration of a calendar with a clock.

830. **B**

In the second line of the first paragraph, the author mentions that evolutionary changes evolve imperceptibly over time.

In the third paragraph, the author mentions that "Isolation and gene flow were less important to evolutionary divergence than natural selection". Therefore, we can infer that gene flow contributes to evolutionary divergence.

The author explains that 3 species of checkerspot butterflies living within 50 acres hardly interact with each other. Therefore, we can infer option D.

The author mentioned the book "the population bomb" as an introduction to the biologist Paul Ehrlich. Option B cannot be inferred from the passage and hence, it is the right answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

831. **C**

The author provides 'Checkerspot butterflies' as an example to drive home his point. The primary intention of the author is not to discuss checkerspot butterflies. Therefore, we can eliminate option D. Option B can be eliminated as well since the author has not mentioned that the theories are widely accepted.

The author explains the contrasting views of the scientists to show that speciation is a debated topic. Option A states that evolution is a controversial topic. The passage deals with speciation. We cannot generalize speciation to evolution. Also, the intention of the author is to show the differing views among the scientists rather than to establish that the topic is controversial. Therefore, option C is the right answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

832. **B**

Through the passage, the author explains how the ways elephants behave is similar to the trauma related response evoked in individuals. He explains how the elephant society is affected by the human activity and the impact of the same on the brain development of young elephants.

The primary purpose of the passage is not to draw an analogy between elephants and humans in any way. Therefore, we can eliminate options A and D. Option C states that the relationship between elephants and humans has changed from one of coexistence to one of hostility. Though this point is true, it is not the central theme of the passage. The author places much emphasis on how the elephant behaviour can be explained as a species-wide trauma response and hence, option B is the right answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

833. **D**

The author explains how elephants are profoundly social creatures like humans and how human activities are putting elephants under stress. Then, he explains how the recent elephant behaviour is similar to post traumatic stress syndrome observed in humans. Options A, B, and C can be inferred.

The author expresses apprehension that young calves are raised by inexperienced elephant mothers and this, in turn, affects the brain development of the calves. Nowhere has it been mentioned that elephant mothers are developing newer ways of rearing their calves. Therefore, option D is the right answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)

834. **B**

The author uses strong comparison in the given line. The author has not mentioned that the elephant society, which is like a fabric, is frayed by human activities. He uses the term 'the fabric of elephant society' and this comparison is called a metaphor.

We can eliminate option A since it fails to capture the fact that a comparison has been used.

Option D states that the line is an ode to the fragility of elephant society today. Option D fails to capture the fact that human activities are wrecking the social structure of elephants.

Option C states that the line is an exaggeration to bolster Bradshaw's claims. The author is not exaggerating the facts to substantiate Bradshaw's claims. He tries to capture the effects of human activities on the elephant society metaphorically. Therefore, option B is the right answer.

[VIDEO SOLUTION](#)



835. **B**

In the first paragraph of the passage, the author uses the line "Now, I use the term 'violence' because of the intentionality associated with it". Therefore, we can infer that the author specifically uses the term violence to emphasize that the actions of the elephants on humans are deliberate just like those of humans on elephants. Therefore, option B is the right answer.

836. **A**

The author tries to establish that the elephant behaviour is similar to stress related response induced in humans. From the tone of the passage, we can infer that the author is concerned about the elephants. He does not adopt a detached view point. The passage tries to evoke empathy from the audience and has not been written as a science research paper.

Options B, C, and D do not address the issue at hand. They are not steps towards addressing elephant aggression. Only option A proposes a method to treat the elephants and hence, option A is the right answer.

837. **C**

Option A: It has been mentioned that food metabolism is used to maintain body temperature. But it cannot be inferred that heat is lost due to food metabolism.

Option B: The colder temperature of plumage results in slight heat gain from the surrounding air. Hence this option is incorrect.

Option C: In the last paragraph of the passage, it has been mentioned that heat is very important for the breeding of Emperor Penguins. So it can be inferred that this conserved heat might be used in the reproductive process of Emperor Penguins. Hence C is the answer.

Option D: Consider the line: "Since their outer plumage is.....thermal convection—the transfer of heat via the movement of a fluid (in this case, the air)." It is clear that the process of thermal convection is responsible for heat gain and not heat loss. Hence D is incorrect.

838. **B**

The primary findings of the study conclude that Emperor Penguins reduce the heat loss by keeping the temperature of the outer surface of their plumage lower than the surrounding air. In fact, they gain a little heat from the surrounding air through thermal convection.

Option A: If the plumage did not allow thermal convection, it would contradict the findings of the study. Hence A is not the answer.

Option B: Since the transfer of heat takes place through the plumage, variation in the average temperature of feet will not affect the conclusions of the study. Hence B is the answer.

Option C: The average temperature of plumage should be lower than that of the air. It has been mentioned in the passage that the temperatures of the plumage on their heads, chests and backs were -1.84, -7.24 and -9.76 degrees Fahrenheit respectively. If the temperature of the air is -10 degrees Fahrenheit, Penguins would not be able to gain the heat. Hence, this will negate the study findings.

Option D: All the temperatures mentioned in this option are higher than the temperature of the air, but the study assumes the surrounding air temperature to be higher. This option will also negate the study findings.

839. **A**

Option A: Consider the sentence: "As the cold Antarctic air cycles around their bodies, slightly warmer air comes into contact with the plumage and donates minute amounts of heat back to the penguins, then cycles away at a slightly colder temperature." It has been mentioned in the passage that the plumage temperature is lower than the surrounding air temperature. Hence, "slightly warmer air" refers to the Antarctica air that surrounds the plumage and "at a slightly colder temperature" refers to the fall in temperature due to heat loss.

Option B: The process of convections and not radiation is involved in this case. Hence the first part of the option is incorrect. B is not the answer.

Option C: The passage does not mention air trapped in plumage. Hence this option is rejected.

Option D: "slightly warmer air" refers to the Antarctica air and not the air inside the penguins' bodies. Hence D is incorrect.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



840. D

The word "paradoxically" has been used by the author to indicate the two contradictory characteristics mentioned in the statement.

Option A: This option states the exact opposite conclusion mentioned in the passage. As per the passage, penguins keep their plumage colder to keep their body warmer. Hence A is incorrect.

Option B: It has been mentioned that the penguins lose heat through radiation and gain heat through convection. Hence B is incorrect.

Option C: Although this statement is true, it does not contain self-contradictory parts. It has been mentioned that the heat loss and heat gain happen through the given processes but one has no relation to the other. Hence C is not the answer.

Option D: This statement combines two contradictory qualities. The penguins are keeping their plumage colder, which is responsible for the heat gain from the surrounding air and making their body warmer. Hence D is the answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

841. D

Option A: This element is discussed in the third paragraph: {"...*The anarchists and their precursors were unique on the political Left in affirming that workers and peasants, grasping the chance that arose to bring an end to centuries of exploitation and tyranny, were inevitably betrayed by the new class of politicians, whose first priority was to re-establish a centralized state power...*"}. Prior to making this claim, the failure of the French revolution is highlighted, and this segment is subsequently tied to it. Hence, Option A is definitely a point that is made in the passage.

Option B: This has been outlined in the fourth paragraph: {"...*For anarchists, the state itself is the enemy, and they have applied the same interpretation to the outcome of every revolution of the 19th and 20th centuries. This is not merely because every state keeps a watchful and sometimes punitive eye on its dissidents, but because every state protects the privileges of the powerful...*"}

Option C: The last two paragraphs present the perception associated with individualist-anarchism: {"...*desirable freedom of an individual or family to possess the resources needed for living, while not implying the right to own the resources needed by others. . . . There are, unsurprisingly, several traditions of individualist anarchism, one of them deriving from the 'conscious egoism' of the German writer Max Stirner (1806-56), and another from a remarkable series of 19th-century American figures who argued that in protecting our own autonomy and associating with others for common advantages, we are promoting the good of all...*"}. Thus, we can evidently understand the statement in C to be true.

Option D, however, is not inferable from the discussion undertaken in the passage. The author does not pinpoint "a mainstream mistrust of collectivism" as the source of the misconception of anarchism "espousing lawlessness and violence". No causal element is discussed, and thus, the statement in D is not an argument that is made in the passage.

Hence, Option D is the correct answer.

842. D

The third paragraph renders us with sufficient information concerning the manner of betrayal. The failure of the French Revolution is being attributed to the deceit of the new class of politicians who not only prioritised the re-establishment and centralisation of authority but also unleashed a reign of terror on the ordinary masses. The author hints at this re-installation of power and the atrocities committed on the common people, who are the very drivers of the revolution, being the desertion of the principles of the French Revolution by the new ruling class of politicians. Any statement that aligns with this understanding would be a suitable answer. Option A brings in the concept of an impact on the market, which is not mentioned in the passage. Additionally, it does not signify betrayal of any kind. Same can be said about the statement in Option B. Option C is a strong candidate that symbolises betrayal. However, can we appropriately associate it with the underlying principles of the revolution? The author's primary focus is on the cost borne by the ordinary populations, and despite the revolution being realised by their sacrifices, they are still the ones being subjected to inequity and torment. Although C highlights betrayal, it does not truly coincide with the idea being conveyed. The afore-mentioned element is appropriately captured by Option D: it highlights how the new class of politicians utilised the indignation of the masses/workers for the revolution - to topple authority and rise to power - and then stab them in the back by turning to oppress them.

843. B

Option A: The various derivations of anarchism cannot be associated with Pierre-Joseph Proudhon. We don't have the requisite information to support this claim.

Option B: This has been presented as the motto of every anarchist faction: wherein the state is the enemy {opposition to the centralization of power}. While there are additional beliefs associated with different schools of anarchist thought, this antagonism towards centralised power forms their core.

Option C: This belief has been shown to be limited to individualist anarchism {based on the information from the passage}; cannot be stated as a common attribute.

Option D: This assertion would be a gross understatement; the latter half of the option is especially a bit odd {no such idea has been implied}.

Hence, of the given choices, Option B is the correct answer.

844. A

We can derive our understanding of these two groups from the following: {"... *There are, unsurprisingly, several traditions of individualist anarchism, one of them deriving from the 'conscious egoism' of the German writer Max Stirner (1806-56), and another from a remarkable series of 19th-century American figures who argued that in **protecting our own autonomy** and **associating with others for common advantages**, we are promoting the good of all. These thinkers **differed** from free-market liberals in their absolute **mistrust of American capitalism**, and in their **emphasis on mutualism**...*"}

It is evident that both the groups prioritize individual autonomy; however, the latter does not put emphasis on mutualism. The mistrust of American capitalism is an additional facet marking the difference {but not captured in any of the options}. Option A aptly highlights the difference between the two factions, and is, hence, the correct answer.

Option B: Preferences concerning state configuration or involvement are not discussed in the passage, and hence, we can eliminate this option.

Option C: Perspectives regarding the nature of capitalism are not stated in the passage, and thus, we can effortlessly discard this option

Option D: None of the elements stated in this option can be understood from the passage, and therefore, can be rejected.

 VIDEO SOLUTION



845. **A**

One has to be mindful of the question: the set that is **conceptually closest** to the **concerns** of the passage.

The passage is clearly about 'Anarchism', and the discussion pertaining to 'Revolution' is a sub-element. This elementary understanding helps us pare down the viable choices to Options A and D. 'Betrayal' is again a minor sub-element used to supplement the core argument concerning the authority of the 'State' and the justified antagonism of the anarchists towards it. Additionally, towards the end of the discussion, individual autonomy and freedom serve as the focal points. Thus, of the two likely choices, Option A is more appropriate and conceptually closest to the concerns of the passage.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

846. **A**

The author intends to highlight that the rudimentary combination of a noun and a verb serves as the simplest form of expression; two basic yet immensely significant entities coupled together that is representative of a broader and perhaps, complex group of entities {a sentence}. Option A is closest to such a relationship: vegetables and spices (two elements) combined to represent a larger group - 'dishes'. The same cannot be said about the rest of the options, since they evidently deviate from the core message being conveyed.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

847. **B**

The author begins by highlighting the necessity for a set of codes (enabled by grammar) to organize communication and avoid confusion. He then proceeds to present supplementary arguments in this regard (elements associated with rhetoric and its specialists) and emphasizes how even proper, intentional simplification can be attained only through a firm grasp of the rudiments of grammar. Therefore, it can be observed that grammar is the focal point here and the correct choice should definitely align with this. Option B aptly captures the main concern raised in the passage. Options A and C fail to include the idea revolving around grammar and instead focuses on the additives. Option D is close; however, the mention of nouns and verbs is with the intention to supplement the idea highlighted in B. These simply serve as an illustration to emphasize the significance of grammar. Thus, between the two options B and D, Option B is the suitable choice.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

848. **C**

Option A: This can be inferred from "...*Must you write complete sentences each time, every time? Perish the thought. If your work consists only of fragments and floating clauses, the Grammar Police aren't going to come and take you away...*" The author presents an illustration to show how a simple combination of a noun and verb forms a complete expression.

Option B: Based on the limited information available from the passage, we can make this inference from "...*no group of words can be a sentence, since a sentence is, by definition, a group of words containing a subject (noun) and a predicate (verb)...*"

Option C: The author does not make any such claim. Grammar serves as a mechanism to organize communication and avoid confusion. However, the "primary purpose" of grammar is not to ensure that sentences remain "simple". Since we cannot infer this statement from the passage, it is the correct answer.

Option D: Although not explicitly mentioned, we can understand the sentiment behind using the term "Grammar Police". The author is using this as a metaphor for the strong adherents of the grammatic rules (who are perhaps swift to judge and criticize).

Therefore, we can infer all of the statements except for the one in Option C.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

849. **A**

In this question, we need to identify the statement that coincides with the aspects discussed by the author. Putting ourselves in the author's shoes, we know that grammar (and the necessity to appropriately learn it) is the primary idea that needs to be conveyed. Writers with a substantial understanding of the elementary rules in grammar can appreciate the "*comforting simplicity at its heart*" (is what the author claims). Thus, the author will surely support any stance that concurs with the above.

Option A: This will definitely supplement the assertion made by the author. It will enable writers with the requisite understanding of the standard governing rules - a significant necessity highlighted by the author. He is bound to favor such an action.

Option B: The author would endorse such drastic measures (does not match the tone). The pliability of grammatical rules is a noticeable comment made by the author (but only for those well-versed with it). Hence, we can eliminate this option.

Option C: The author does not portray any view that promotes the eschewal of rhetoric. This again deviates from the discussion in the passage and can be scrapped as the correct choice.

Option D: The focus is broad: on grammar (not just on punctuation and capitalization).

It is evident that Option A is the only sensible statement that the author would support here.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT Quant Questions



850. **D**

We need to find a statement, which if **false**, aligns with the discussion/serves as a supporting argument. Let us inspect the individual options:

Option A: In its current form, this statement is in tune with the author's assertion. However, if false, it is antagonistic to the claim being made in the passage. Hence, we can eliminate this option.

Options B and C: Regardless of whether these statements are true or false, they do very little to further the idea presented in the passage.

Option D: This statement implies that complete sentences do not need nouns and verbs. However, in the passage, the author says otherwise; thus, if this sentence is false, it perfectly aligns with the argument made in the passage. Therefore, Option D, if false, could be seen as a supplementary argument.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

851. **B**

Refer to the starting of the fourth paragraph: "There is now considerable evidence that Type B malnutrition is a major cause of chronic degenerative diseases."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

852. **C**

Refer to the start of the fifth paragraph: "While we do not have the resources to analyze millions of individual cases, there is no need to do so. The vast majority of people are consuming suboptimal amounts of most micronutrients, and most of the micronutrients concerned are very safe."

Hence, the correct option is option 'C'

 VIDEO SOLUTION

853. **B**

Refer to the first line of the fourth paragraph: "There is now considerable evidence that Type B malnutrition is a major cause of chronic degenerative diseases. If this is the case, then this logical to treat such diseases not with drugs but with multiple micronutrient repletion, or pharmaco-nutrition'."

Hence, the correct option is option 'B'

 VIDEO SOLUTION

854. **A**

Refer to the first paragraph. Here author says that large number of people may have chronic degenerative diseases but due to their latency period, they are not detected easily. That eliminates options B and C.

Options A and D are close. But as the question asks why the people are considered as pre-ill, the answer should be because they may have chronically degenerative diseases they don't know about. Hence, A is the better option.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT DILR Questions



855. **D**

Refer to the following lines of the paragraph: "But if we asked our fathers and grandfathers, would they have said that they lived in a period of little change? Structure may not have changed much. It may just be the speed with which we do things."

 VIDEO SOLUTION

856. **A**

Refer to the following lines of the passage: "Why didn't it go anywhere? Because auto executives understood pistons and carburettors, and would be loath to cannibalize their expertise, along with most of their factories". This indicates that the auto executives do not want to change themselves.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

857. **B**

Clearly the second option is the main idea of the passage. In this passage the author talks about the over-exaggeration made by automobile industry and airplane industry while on the whole there are not many changes which have taken place.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

858. **B**

In the fourth paragraph it is clearly mentioned that change is over-rated. Refer to the following lines: "Change is over-rated, anyway, consider the automobile. It's an especially valuable example, because the auto industry has spent tens of billions of dollars on research and product development in the last 100 years."

 VIDEO SOLUTION